IsHaunted.com

PRODUCT DOCUMENTATION

Everything IsHaunted does.

The complete product documentation — every screen, rule and safeguard, written for the people who use it.

DOCUMENTS	SECTIONS	UPDATED
21	6	10/25/2026

About this document. This is the in-product help, reproduced in full and unaltered — the same text the application serves to its users. It describes the software as built. It contains no business, market or financial information, and no usage figures.

Contents

GETTING STARTED

What IsHaunted.com Is — Public — no account needed
How the site works and who it is for.

The Feed — Public — no account needed
Short public posts, mentions, tags and following.

Reading Publications — Public — no account needed
Long-form writing from investigation groups, and how to follow the ones you like.

The Equipment Catalog — Public — no account needed
Browsing the gear people use, make and model pages, photos, questions, and feedback.

The iPhone and iPad Apps — Public — no account needed
What the apps do, how to get signed in, and what still lives on the website.

Going to an Event — Public — no account needed
Asking for a place, choosing your own seats, and what the venue's answer means.

Shopping at the Store — Public — no account needed
Finding gear, choosing options, your cart, placing an order, delivery, returns, favorites and reviews.

Selling in the Store — Signed-in users
Your items in the store — adding them, asking for them to go on sale, and where each one stands.

FOR CLIENTS

Requesting an Investigation — Public — no account needed
How to ask a group to look into what you have experienced.

Following Your Case — Signed-in users
The case page, logging occurrences, and who can see what.

FOR GROUP MEMBERS

Working a Case — Group members
The case page from the investigator's side — timeline, files, investigations.

YOUR ACCOUNT

Your Profile and Photos — Signed-in users
Display name, contact details, public and private photos, and who can see them.

Your Files — Signed-in users
The files you upload, what sharing them means, and what happens when you delete one a group is using.

Using the Audio Editor

Signed-in users

Listening closely to a recording — regions, the spectrogram, EVP scanning, clips and the case mixer.

Your Equipment

Signed-in users

Logging the gear you own, adding photos, and what stays private.

Borrowing Equipment

Signed-in users

Asking to borrow gear, handing it over, and getting it back.

Using the Video Editor

Signed-in users

Turning raw footage into something worth watching — import, trim, title, and export.

GROUP ADMINISTRATION

Administering a Group

Group owners & administrators

Settings, members, requests, and the decisions only owners and administrators make.

Publishing with Publications

Group owners & administrators

Setting up a publication, writing posts, and deciding when the public sees them.

SITE ADMINISTRATION

Site Administration

Platform administrators

Sitewide settings, the clipart library, and the audit log.

Moderating the Feed

Platform administrators

The reported-posts queue, and what hiding a post does.

GETTING STARTED

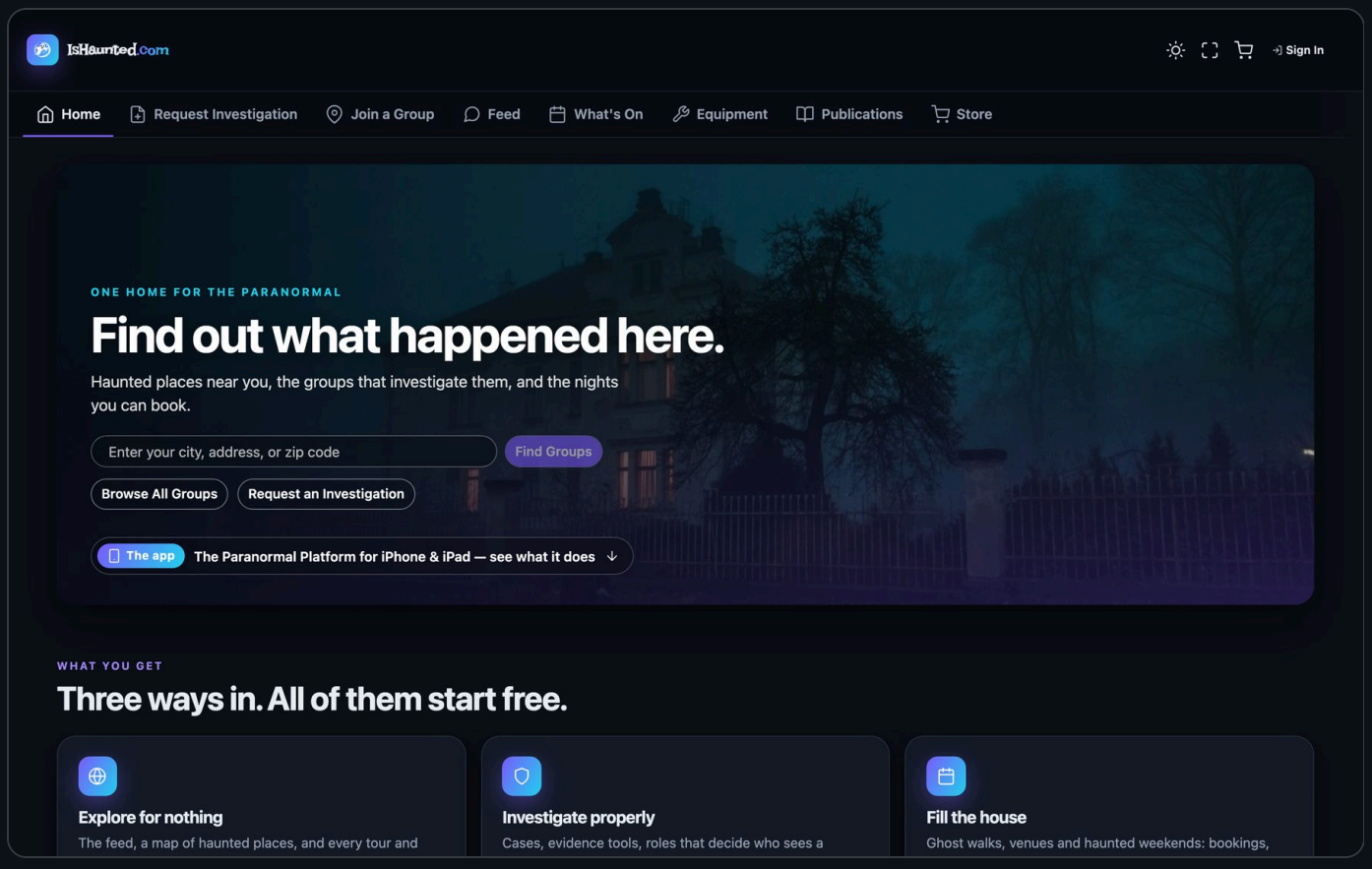
What IsHaunted.com Is

How the site works and who it is for.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

IsHaunted.com connects people who have experienced something unexplained at a property with paranormal investigation groups who can look into it.

The short version

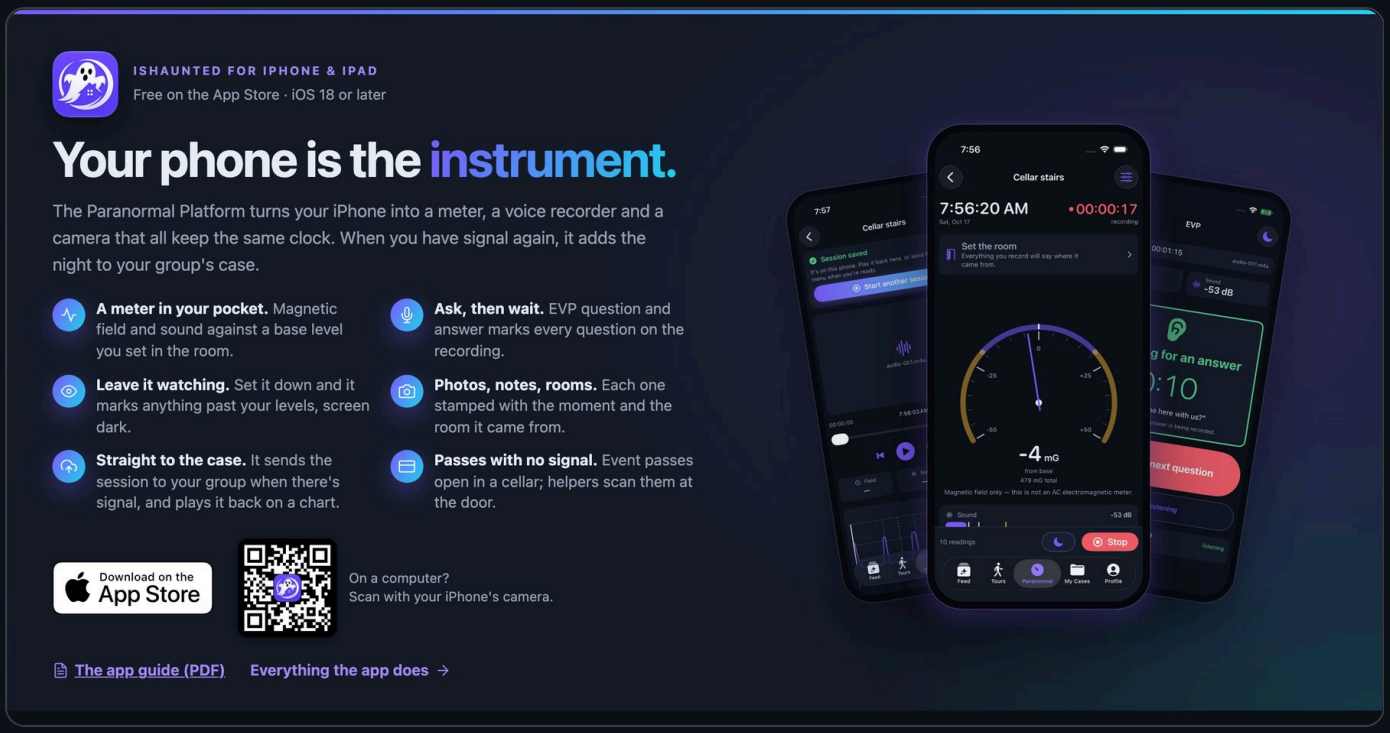


The home page: search for groups near you, and browse the cases groups have published.

A **client** describes what has been happening and asks one or more **groups** to take a look. A group that accepts opens a **case**. From there, the client and the investigators share a timeline of what happened and what was found, and the group schedules **investigations** — visits to the property.

Nothing about a case is public unless the group publishes it. Even then, the client's real name is replaced with a name they chose.

The iPhone and iPad app



Near the bottom of the home page: the App Store badge, a QR code to scan from a computer, and screens from the app.

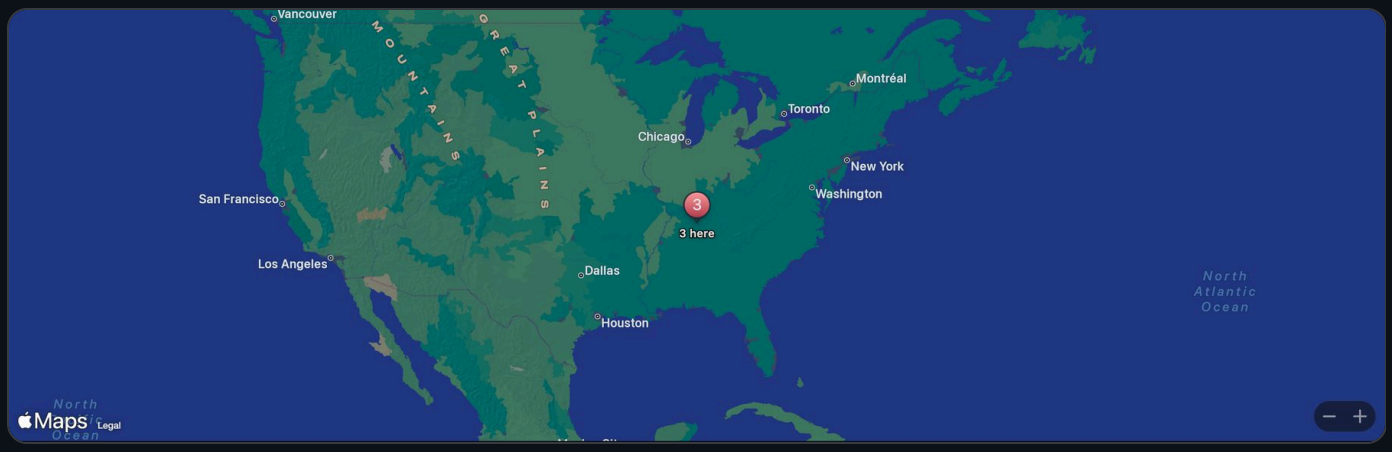
IsHaunted is also a free app for iPhone and iPad, available on the App Store. Select **The Paranormal Platform for iPhone & iPad** at the top of the home page to jump to the app's section near the bottom. There, the badge opens the App Store. If you're on a computer, scan the QR code with your phone's camera to get there instead. The Paranormal Platform turns your phone into a meter, a recorder and a camera that all share the same clock, then sends the whole night to your group's case. The iPhone and iPad Apps explains everything it does.

Who does what

YOU ARE	YOU CAN
A visitor	Browse groups and any cases that have been published.
A client	Ask groups to investigate, log what happens, and follow the case.
A group member	Work cases, record findings, attend investigations.
A group owner or administrator	Configure the group, manage members, accept or decline requests.

The map of published cases

Below the search on the home page, a map shows every case a group has published, with the same cases listed underneath. When pins are close together at your current zoom level, they combine into a single pin showing how many cases are there; zoom in and they separate. Click a pin to see the case (or cases) at that spot. As you pan or zoom, the list below updates to match the part of the map you're looking at.



Three cases near Nashville, combined into one pin at this zoom level.

If your browser is allowed to share your location, the map starts there. If not, it shows the whole country and works just the same. A pin marks the general area of a case, not its front door — the site deliberately places it a little way off.

Voting on a published case

Anyone with an account can vote on a published case, and on individual pieces of evidence within it. There are three choices: **confirms**, **inconclusive**, and **disputes**. You get one vote. If you change your mind, your new vote replaces the old one.

One button to vote with, and the choices it offers. Hover over anything in the row to see what it does.

To vote, use the **one button** under the counts. It shows a hollow thumb until you vote, then the filled icon for your answer, so you can always see how you voted. Press it and the three choices appear underneath; hover over one to see what it means. Press your own answer again to take your vote back.

Next to the three counts is a single **score**. It adds up the votes: confirms count **+1**, disputes **−1**, and inconclusive **0**. So a green **+4** means the people who looked lean toward something being there, and a red **−3** means they lean the other way.

An inconclusive vote still matters. It adds to the number of people who looked without moving the score, which is exactly what "I've seen it and I honestly can't say" should do.

The score is always shown with the number of votes behind it, because **+4** from five people means something very different from **+4** from ninety. A score of **0** can mean the votes are evenly split, or that everyone was undecided — the counts beside it tell you which.

The other buttons beside it

Four more buttons sit in the same row. None of them has a text label — hover over one to see what it does.

- **Share** shows where you can share the case when you hover over it: Facebook, X, Bluesky, Reddit, WhatsApp, email, and **Copy link**. On a phone, where you can't hover, pressing the button opens your phone's share sheet instead.
- **Repost** puts the case on the feed as a post from you. It's a link to the case from you personally — one person saying *look at this*. Posting on behalf of a group is different and needs permission.
- **Comments** jumps straight down to the comments on this page, and shows how many there are.

- **Report** flags the case for a site moderator. Reporting never hides anything by itself.

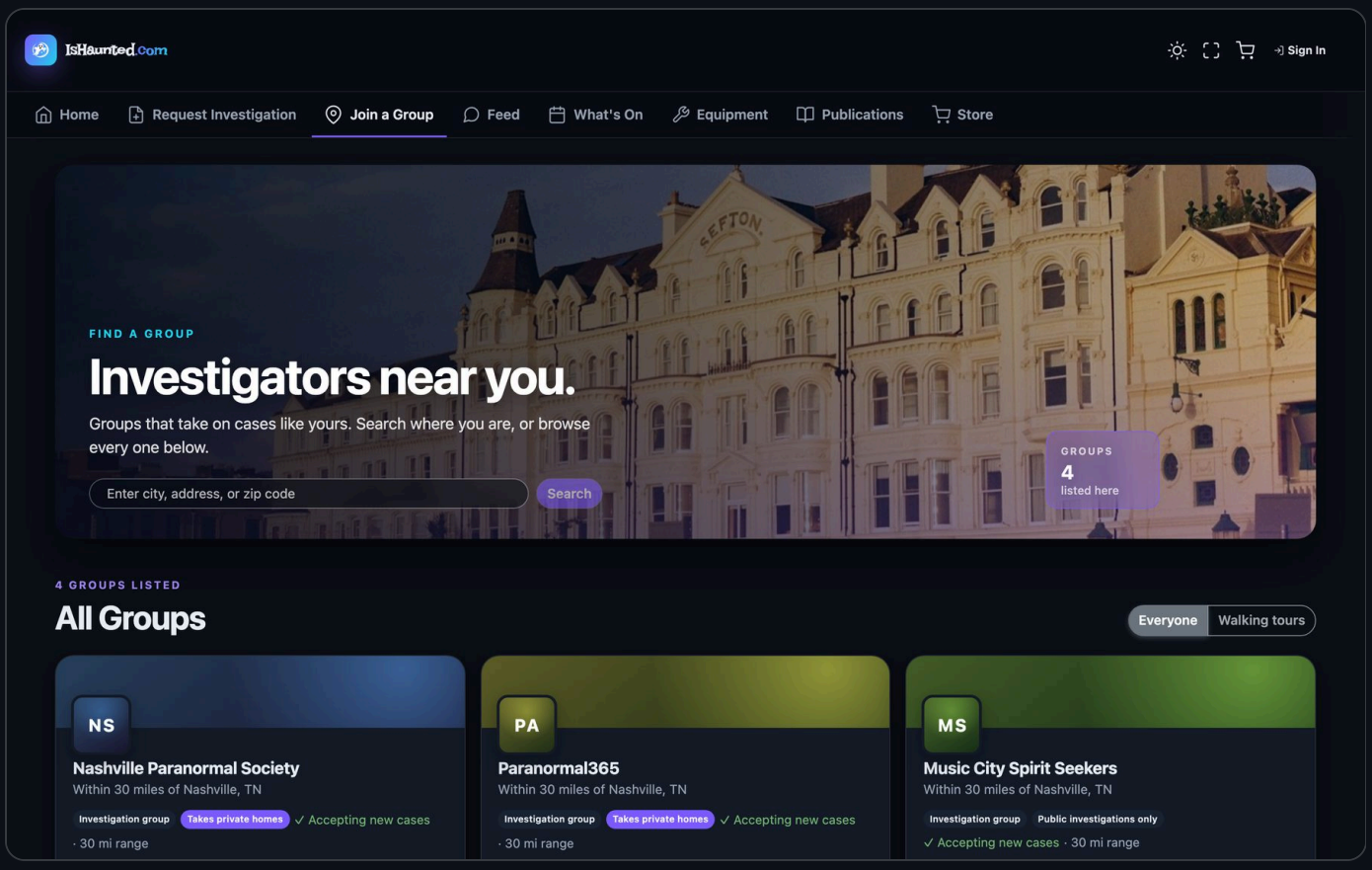
If you're not signed in, you can still see the counts, with **Sign in** underneath.

Commenting on a published case

Under each published case is a box where you can comment on it. Comments are plain text — no formatting and no attachments. You can delete your own comments at any time. You can report someone else's, which sends it to the same moderation queue as any other report.

When you type a web address into a comment, a message or a feed post, a small card appears under it showing what it links to. Cards only appear for addresses **on this site** — a case, a tour, an event or a group. They're built from our own records, so they stay correct if something is renamed. A link to another site stays a plain link, with that site's name shown under it.

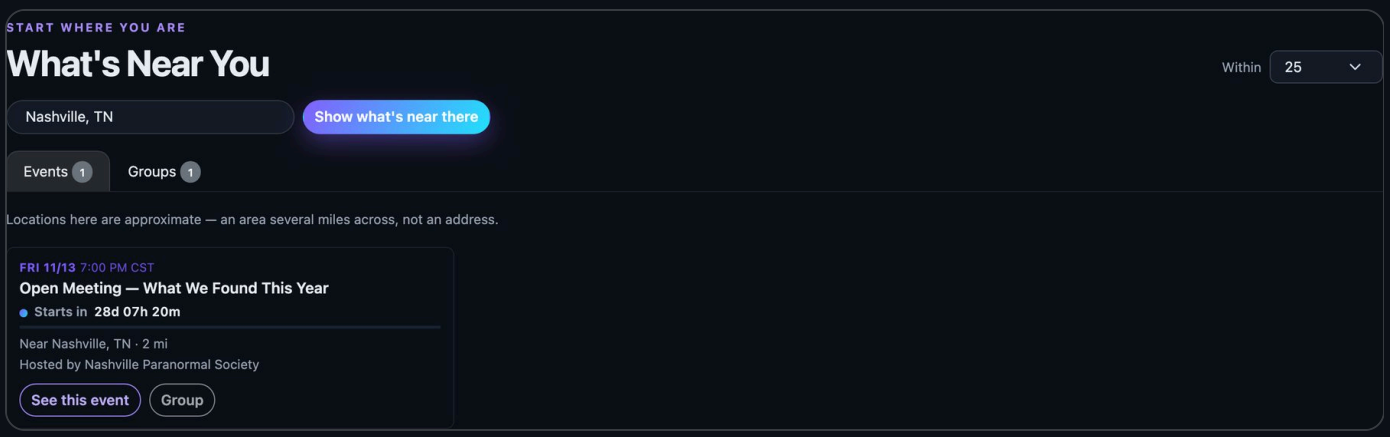
Finding what's near you



Browse Groups lists every group, closest first once you've given it a location to measure from.

The home page shows what's happening close to you — walks you could book, public events you could attend, and groups that serve your area. If your browser allows it, this uses your current location automatically; if not,

type a city, address, or zip code instead. Either way, choose how far to look with the distance dropdown.



Each tab shows a count, so you can see what was found before opening anything. A tab only appears when it has something in it.

A group that keeps its address private shows how close it is in rounded steps, such as **Within 10 mi**, and never a pin on the map.

Places is the fourth tab, and it works differently from the other three. A place is a location rather than a group or an event — a cave, a mill, a hotel. The tab lists places near you where groups have published their work. Opening one shows everything people have shared about that location: which groups have investigated there, what they concluded, recorded sessions, photos from events held there, and what visitors have posted.

A place only appears once there's something to see there. **Private residences never appear**, no matter what has happened at them.

Tours are listed first, because a walk with a date on it is the most useful thing the page can offer you. Every tour card shows a picture. If a walk hasn't added one yet, it gets a colored tile based on its name, so it looks the same here, on the group's page, and on the tour's own page.

Once you belong to a group, your Home page becomes your dashboard: your next investigation, the open cases in your groups (yours first), how many messages and requests are waiting, and any gear checked out to you with its due date. Each tile opens exactly what it counts.

Counting down to your next event. When you're signed in and have something coming up, a small card at the top of the home page shows the next event you're going to and how long until it starts, in the event's own time zone. That's an event you booked, one you said you'd come to, a tour seat, or an investigation you're on the team of. Bookings the venue hasn't confirmed yet say **Asked for** or **Held for you**. The card reads **Tonight** on the day and **Happening now** while it's on, then moves on to the next one. If you have more coming up, **and 2 more** takes you to *What I'm going to*, which lists them all. Tap the card to open your pass, or the event's page. With nothing coming up, there's no card.

Every event in **What's near you** counts down to its start too, with a thin bar that fills from the day it was listed to the moment it begins. When you're signed in, the list also shows your own groups' events that aren't public, marked **Your group**, and marks public events you've been **Invited** to or said **You're going** to. An event at a private residence never appears here.

If a group hasn't written its own public page yet, the site builds one from what the group has already entered: what kind of group it is, the area it serves, how many members it has, its public cases, whether it's taking new cases, and its next public event.

Groups and events are shown differently on purpose. A group that has chosen to be listed is shown at its exact location — that's the point of being listed. An event's location is only ever approximate, because it's an invitation, not a business address. The exact place isn't shown until you're attending.

Finding your way around

The **bar along the top** holds the site's main sections. It only lists what applies to you, so more sections appear once you sign in, and more again if you run a group. Pick a section to open its page.

A little way down the page, the **menu card on the left** lists the pages in the section you're in. It stays in place as you scroll, so it's always within reach.

- **Your groups come first.** When you're signed in, the bar starts with Home and **Your groups**. Its card lists each group you belong to by name, plus **All your groups** for the full list with each group's roster and settings. (On a phone, the menu lists your groups by name directly.)
- **Notifications** has its own spot on the bar. You'll check it often, so it isn't tucked away inside anything.
- **My Work**, **Equipment**, **Media** and **Community** each open their own short menu in the card.
- **Administration**, for site administrators, holds the site-wide tools, grouped by purpose.

The menu goes deeper with you

An entry with a **chevron** (›) is a group of pages rather than a single page. Click it and the card switches to that group's menu, with a way **back** at the top. When you open a page inside it, the card stays on that menu, so the pages next to the one you're on are always one click away.

The same thing happens inside your own work:

- **Inside a group**, the card switches to **that group's menu** — Details, Members, Cases, Investigations, Calendar, Files, Settings and the rest, showing only the ones your role gives you access to — with **← Your groups** at the top. These are the group page's tabs. On a phone, where there's no room for the card, they appear as tabs across the top of the page instead. The guides call them tabs either way.
- **Inside one of the group's events**, the card switches to **that event's menu** — the plan, bookings, the door, menus, gallery and the rest — with the group's name at the top to take you back.

A few more things worth knowing:

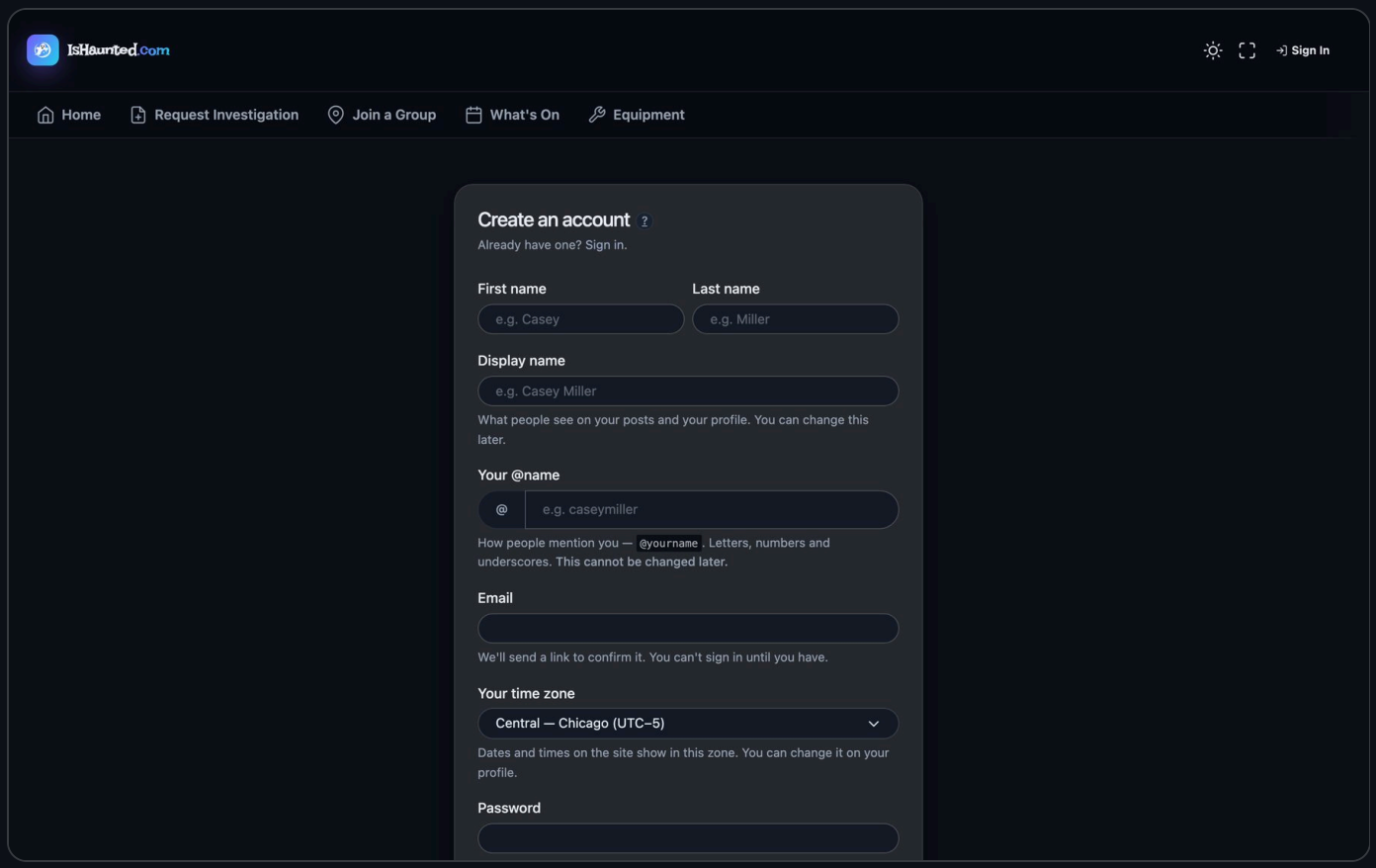
- A **number beside an entry** is work waiting for you. Its color deepens the longer it waits. **A group shows the total of everything inside it**, so nothing gets hidden by being grouped.
- **On a phone**, the button beside the site name opens the full menu as a drawer. Its **Filter** box narrows the list as you type, and searches *inside* the groups too — type "checkouts" and you get just that one entry.

In the top right are the display controls: the **sun or moon** switches between light and dark mode, and the **arrows** expand the page to fill the screen. This device remembers both settings.

Getting an account

Accounts are free, and the email address you sign in with is never shown publicly.

You don't need an account to ask for help. Anyone can open the investigation request form. Fill it in, and the last step asks for your name, email and a password so the group has a way to reply. Your account is created from the request itself — see Requesting an Investigation. You do need an account before you can join a group.



Your @name is checked as you type, so you'll know if it's taken before you fill in the rest.

To create an account on its own, go to the sign-in page and choose *New here? Create an account*, or go straight to `/signup`. You'll be asked for five things:

Your name	What people see on your posts and your profile. Change it whenever you like.
Your @name	How people mention you. **Chosen once and permanent** — see below.
Email	Where we send the confirmation link. Never shown publicly.
Your time zone	The time zone dates and times are shown in. It's already set to your device's zone; you can change it on your profile whenever you like.
Password	At least 8 characters, with an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter and a number.

Your time zone

Every date and time on the site is stored in one universal time and shown to you in your own time zone. The sign-up form starts with the zone your device reports — most people just confirm it. It lists US zones first, then every zone in the world by region.

If you never choose one, the site uses your device's zone, or Central time (Chicago) if your device doesn't report one. You can change it any time on your profile.

Your @name

Your **@name** is your handle — like `@sarahmitchell` — and it's how people mention you or write to you. It can only contain letters, numbers and underscores, and it has to be one nobody else has taken. The page tells you as you type.

It can't be changed later. That's deliberate: your @name appears inside other people's posts, and if it could change, those posts could end up pointing at someone else. Pick one you'll still be happy with in a year.

Confirming your email

You can't sign in until you confirm your email. We'll send you a link; open it, then press the button on the page it takes you to. If your account was created from an investigation request, that page also shows where your request stands and the @name we chose for you.

You do need to press the button — just opening the link doesn't confirm your address. Email security filters often open links automatically, so pressing the button is what shows a real person received the email.

If the email never arrives, don't sign up again — a second account with the same address will be refused, and so will a second investigation request from it. Instead, try to sign in. You'll see the message *"Confirm your email address first"*, with a **Send the email again** button. Press it and a new link is sent.

Whatever happens, the reply is the same: *"If that address has an unconfirmed account, a new link is on its way."* That's deliberate — it doesn't reveal whether an address is registered, so nobody can use it to find out who has an account here. Check your spam folder too, since filters are often suspicious of emails that contain links.

You can only request a new email once a minute, so pressing the button repeatedly won't send more.

If the link has expired, use the same button to get a new one.

Signing in with Apple or Microsoft

The sign-in page also offers **Sign in with Apple** and **Sign in with Microsoft**. Either one lets you sign in with an account you already have there, without needing a password for this site.

The first time, we need to know who you are here. You can **make a new account** — it only asks for a display name and a permanent @name. Or, if you already have an account here under a different email address, you can **link it instead**: enter that account's email and password (and its code, if it uses two-step sign-in). Linking is always offered because the address Apple or Microsoft shares with us is often not the one you signed up with, and it's better to join your accounts than to start a second one without any of your history.

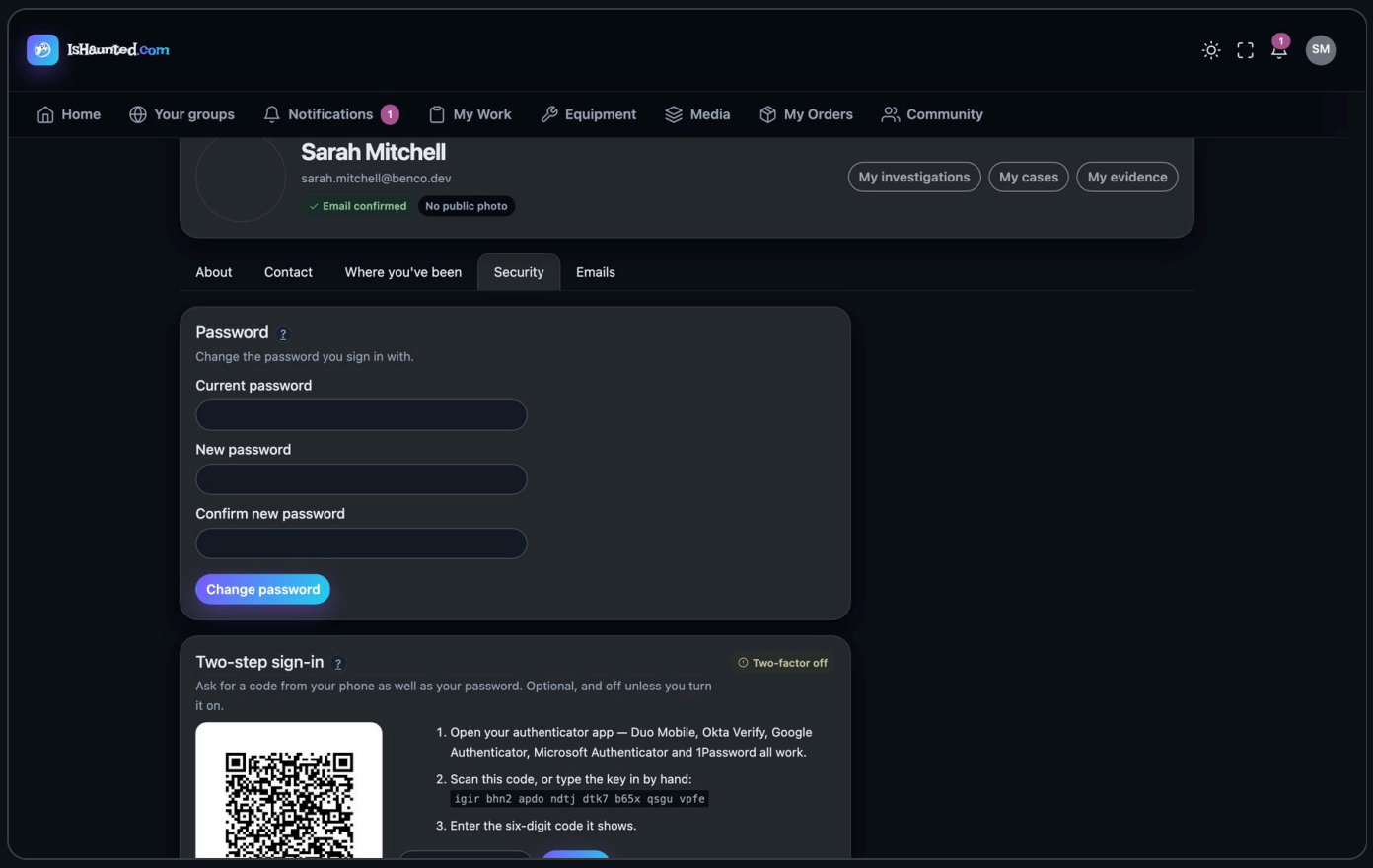
Apple lets you **hide your email**. If you do, we receive a forwarding address that reaches you only as long as Apple allows it, and your profile tells you so instead of showing an address you wouldn't recognize. If you don't share any address at all, your profile warns you: Apple is then the only way into your account, and there's no password reset link to fall back on until you add an email address.

Your first minute

Right after you sign in for the first time, a short welcome walks you through the basics: what people should call you, what brought you here (so it can send you to the right place — requesting an investigation, finding a group, or starting one), and a ten-second tour of where everything is. You can skip any step, and once you skip it, it won't ask again.

Two-step sign-in

You can choose to enter a code from your phone as well as your password when you sign in. It's **entirely optional** and stays off unless you turn it on, under **Security** on your profile. Nobody else can turn it on or off for you — not even an administrator — because only you have the app that makes the codes.



Scan the square code with your app, or type in the key beside it by hand.

Any authenticator app works — **Duo Mobile**, **Okta Verify**, Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, 1Password. Scan the square code with the app, enter the six digits it shows, and two-step sign-in is on. If you can't scan, type in the key shown beside the code instead.

Save the recovery codes. They're shown only once. We keep a scrambled copy that can't be read back, so nobody can recover them for you later. Each code lets you sign in one time if you lose your phone. Print them, or keep them somewhere other than your phone.

To turn it off, you'll need a current code from your app. That stops someone at your unlocked computer from removing it.

Signing in once it is on

Enter your email and password as usual. We'll then ask for the six-digit code. On a phone, the keyboard can usually fill it in straight from the notification, so you rarely have to copy it yourself.

If you've lost your phone, choose **I can't use my app** and enter one of your recovery codes instead. Each one works once.

When sign-in will not let you in

The message tells you which of these happened, because each one has a different fix:

WHAT IT SAYS	WHAT TO DO
Invalid email or password	Check both — or see the note below if you usually sign in with Microsoft.
Confirm your email address first	Open the link we emailed you when you signed up — or press **Send the email again** in that message if it never arrived.
This account is locked for a few minutes	Too many attempts. **Wait** — resetting your password won't help, because your password wasn't the problem.
Too many sign-in attempts	The same thing, but counted across the whole site instead of just your account. Wait a minute.
Couldn't reach the sign-in service	Nothing is wrong with your password — it was never checked, because the site couldn't reach the service that checks it. Try again shortly.

If you're asked for a code, nothing has gone wrong — your password was right, and this is simply the second step.

Forgot your password — or never had one

Forgot your password? on the sign-in page emails you a link to choose a new one. The link brings you back to the site. If your email app breaks the link, the email also includes a code you can paste in by hand.

The same steps work if you've never had a password: **an account created by signing in with Microsoft has no password**. If you try to sign in to it with a password, you'll see "invalid email or password", because there's no password set yet. Use the reset link to add one, and after that both ways of signing in will work.

One thing to check first: the reset link is only sent to a **confirmed** address, and an account created through Microsoft starts with its address unconfirmed. We sent a confirmation link when the account was made. If you never followed it, sign in with Microsoft, open your profile, and press **Send the link again** in the notice at the top.

Already signed in? **Profile → Security → Password** does the same thing without the email. It offers *Add password* if your account doesn't have one, and an ordinary change-password form if it does.

An account somebody else made for you

Sometimes an account is created for you before you ask for one — someone at IsHaunted.com sets it up so you can be added to something. When that happens, you'll get an email telling you so, including who created it.

Read it even if you were expecting it. The account was created with a password someone else typed, so until you change it, you aren't the only person who knows how to sign in. The email has a button that lets you

choose your own password. That replaces theirs, and from then on the account is yours alone.

If you **weren't** expecting it, choosing a password is still the right first step — it takes the account out of anyone else's hands while you find out what happened. Reply to the email if you'd rather the account was removed altogether.

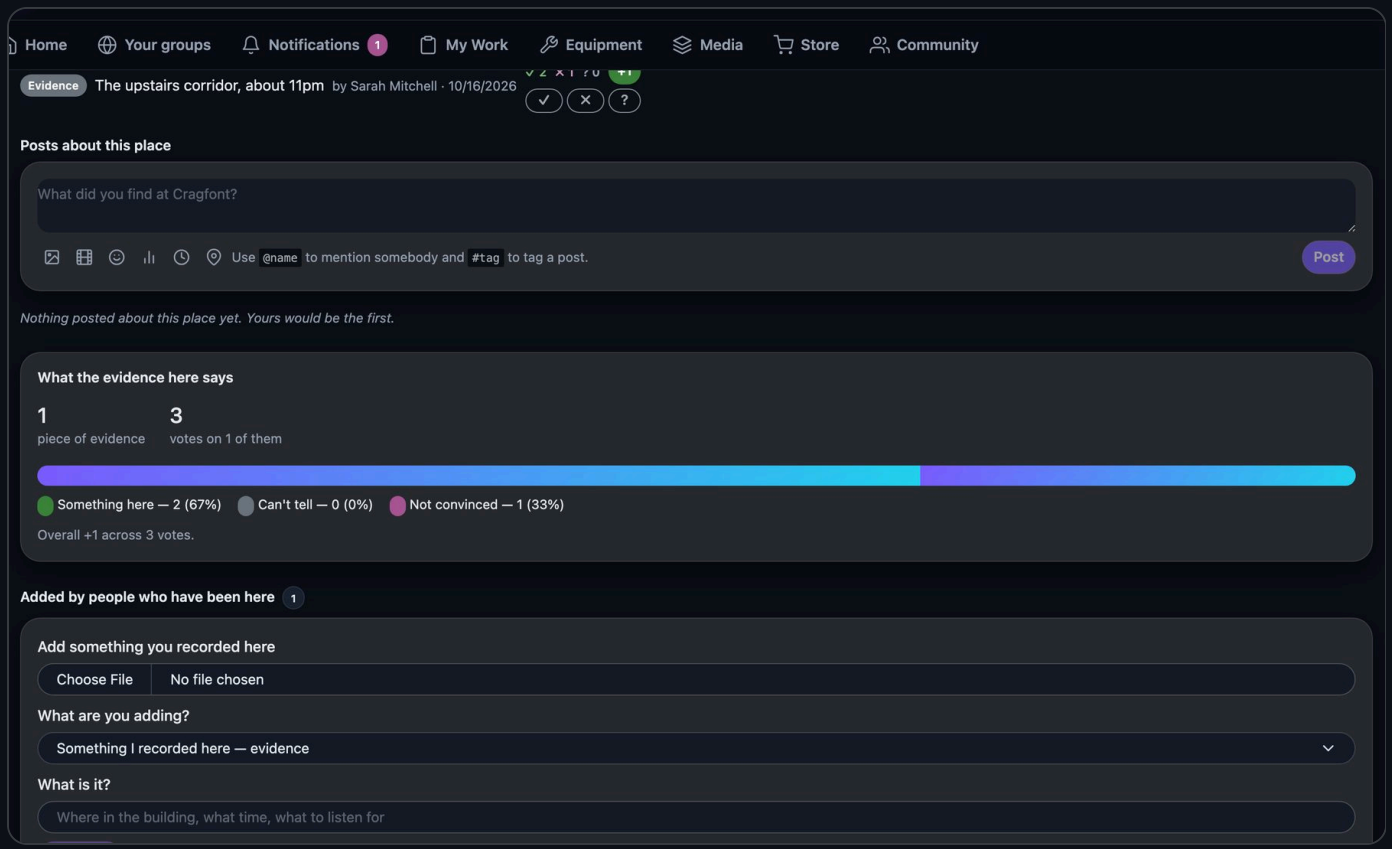
This is one of the few emails you can't turn off. You should always hear about an account created in your name, even if you've turned every other email off.

Public locations

Some places aren't anyone's home — a landmark, a cemetery, a bridge, a business that welcomes visitors. Anyone signed in can add one to the map with **Add a public location**, on the Places tab of what's near you.

Give it a name and a town. A street address helps, and keeps two people from creating two pages for the same building — if the address is already here, you're taken to the existing page instead of making a new one.

Homes aren't added this way. A private residence only gets a page through the group the client invited, because somebody has to have asked for help. There's no way to type in a home address here and publish a page about it, and that's deliberate.



Adding what you recorded

On a public location's page, anyone signed in can add a photo, a recording or a video, with a note saying what it is — where in the building, what time, what to listen for. It joins that place's evidence, alongside what groups have published from their own investigations.

Everything is checked before it appears. Most things go up right away; if yours is held, the page tells you so instead of pretending it's showing. You can withdraw anything you've added.

The place itself

A public location's page has room to describe what the place **is** — when it was built, who lived there, what it is now. Anyone signed in can write it, and anyone after them can improve it. It's plain text only, so stray links or pasted layouts can't end up on a page that anyone might read.

You can also add **photographs of the building** — the front, the grounds, the rooms in daylight. Choose "a photograph of the place itself" when you add one.

These are kept separate from evidence, and that's the whole point. A daylight photo that shows a reader what a staircase looks like, and a photo of the same staircase where someone thinks they see a figure, are two very different claims. Photos of the place are never voted on or counted. If they were mixed in with the evidence, every number on the page would be wrong and nobody could tell what was being claimed.

What the evidence says

Anyone signed in can vote on a piece of evidence: **something here**, **can't tell**, or **not convinced**. Above the list, the place's page adds these up: how many pieces of evidence it has, how many votes have been cast, and what share of the votes falls each way.

Each file counts **once**, however it got there. If the same photo was published in an investigation and also added to the place directly, it's one piece of evidence, not two — otherwise a place would look like it had more evidence than it does.

There's no leaderboard. Each place shows its own figures, and the site doesn't rank one property against another. These are real buildings with real owners, and a pile of votes isn't enough to call one "the third most haunted house in Tennessee."

The overall score is a simple sum — **+1** for something here, **0** for can't tell, **−1** for not convinced — and it's always shown beside the number of votes, because a score means little without knowing how many people voted.

Empty, or broken?

When a list shows nothing, it means one of two things, and the page tells you which.

"Nothing here yet", or a sentence like *"This group hasn't shared any files yet"*, means the list really is empty. Nothing is wrong, and there's nothing to retry.

"Couldn't load this", in a bordered box with a **Try again** button, means the page couldn't fetch the list at all. What you're looking for is still there — the site just couldn't reach it, or wasn't allowed to. Try again first. If it keeps happening, the box usually names the reason, and including that on the contact form helps us find the problem much faster.

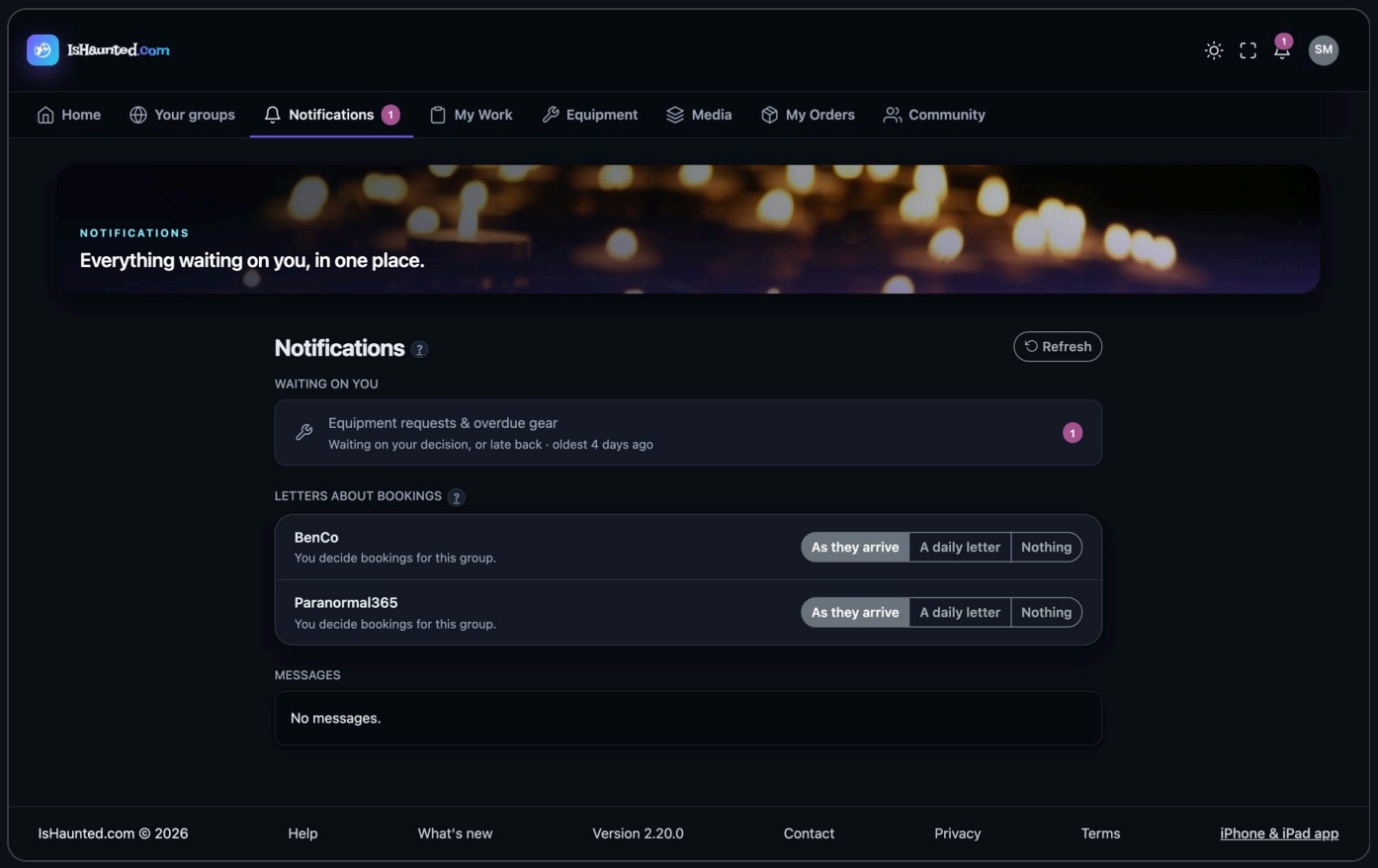
Notifications

The **bell** in the top bar counts everything waiting for you, across several different kinds of thing. Open it, or the **Notifications** page, to see what they are.

The sidebar's **Notifications** entry, the bell and the page all show the same number, and it's always the total of the items listed. If the bell says four, four things are listed.

Replies on your cases	A group has written back about a case of yours.
Client messages awaiting a reply	Somebody has written to a group you belong to.
Unread group messages	Internal mail at one of your groups.
File permission requests	Somebody wants access to a file you own, and is waiting for your answer.
Equipment requests & overdue gear	Waiting for your decision, or overdue.
Posts that mention you	Somebody named you with an **@name** in the feed.
Unread messages	Sent to you through the platform.
Bookings waiting on you	Somebody has asked for, or picked, a place at an event where you decide bookings.
Holds running out	Places picked at your event that will lapse within a day unless somebody confirms them.
A venue answered you	Your booking at an event has been decided.
Your hold is running out	You picked places, the venue hasn't confirmed them, and they'll lapse within a day.

Every row opens the thing it counts. *Posts that mention you* opens the feed's **Mentions** tab — posts that name you, and posts with replies that do. *Unread messages* opens the oldest unread message and marks it read, so the number goes down as you read. *Bookings waiting on you*, *Holds running out* and a tour's sign-ups open the page for that event or date, rather than your list of groups.



Everything waiting for you, grouped by type.

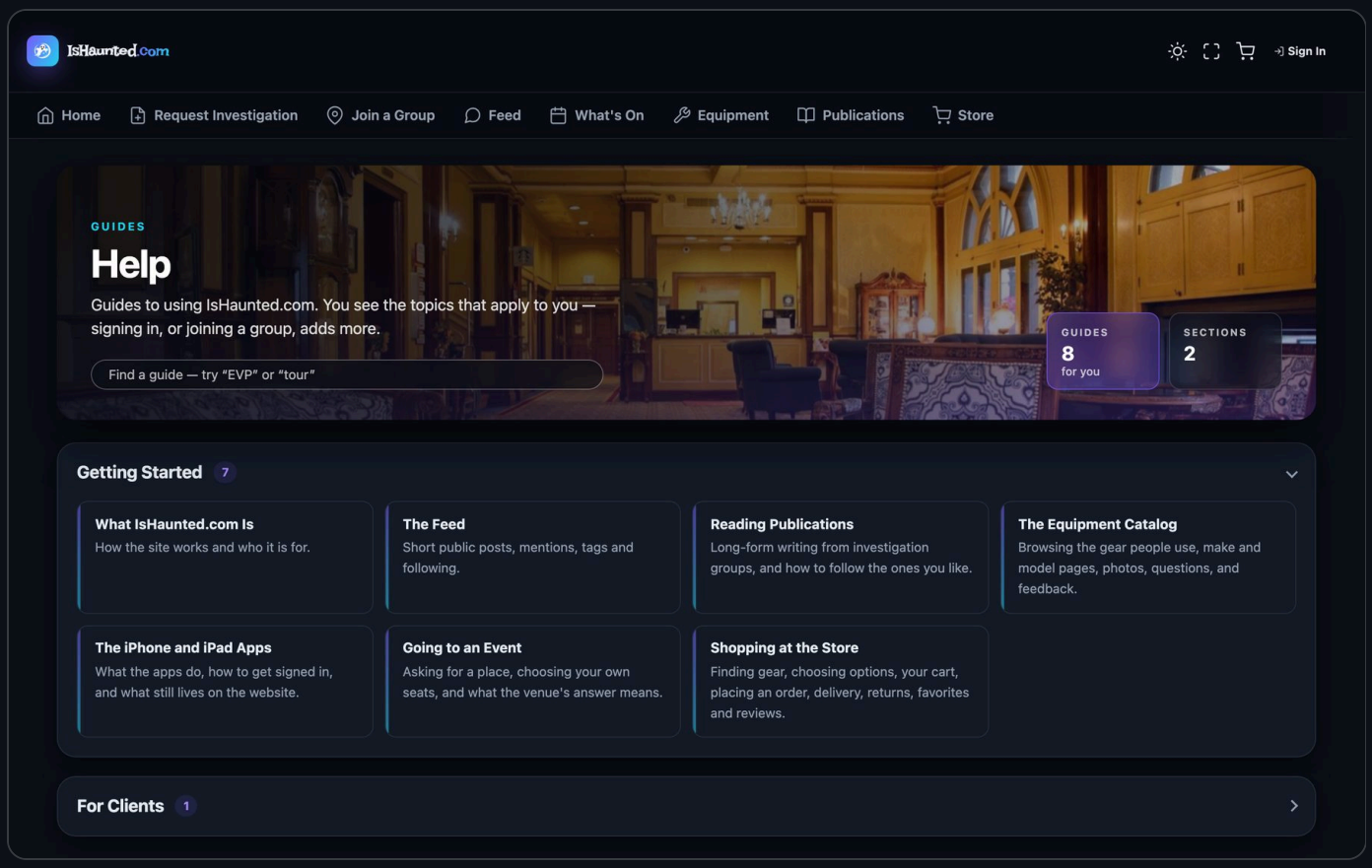
Empty categories aren't shown. The page is a list of things to do, not a dashboard full of zeros.

The color shows age, not importance. One item from last week gets a more urgent color than five from this morning, because the older one is the one somebody is still waiting on.

If you decide bookings for a group, the page also has **Letters about bookings**, where you choose how often that group sends you updates about them.

Opening something is what clears it — a message you've read, a post you've opened, a request you've answered. Nothing disappears before you've seen it.

Finding help



The help index. You only see the topics that apply to your account.

Every page that does something non-obvious has a small **?** beside it. It opens the relevant part of this help in a new tab, so you don't lose your place.

Getting in touch

Contact, in the footer, reaches the people who run the site — not a group. Use it for anything about the site itself: an account you can't get into, something that looks broken, or a question this help doesn't answer. To ask a group to investigate something, send a request instead. That's a different thing entirely, and it goes to the group, not to us.

You don't need an account to contact us. After you send the form, you'll get a **tracking link** — keep it. It's how you read our reply and see whether your message has been picked up, and it's the only way back to a message sent without an account. If you were signed in when you wrote, the message is also linked to your account.

Joining a group — or starting your own

On a group's public page, when you're signed in, you'll see an **Apply to join** box (if the group is taking applications). Add a line about yourself if you like, send it, and the group will respond. You'll see the status of your application right there on their page.

Or start your own: **Organizations → Start a Group** walks you through four short steps — what you're starting, with its name and web address; where you work (optional, but it's used for the "near you" search); whether you're taking applications; and a final review. Only the first step is required, and if you close the tab, a draft is saved so you can pick up where you left off.

You can also start from the **Pricing** page. Each plan's **Start a group on this plan** button opens the same steps with that plan shown at the top, and once the group is created, you go to its billing page to confirm the plan. Starting on the free plan works the same way, with nothing to pay.

The first question is **what kind of group this is**, because it sets the starting point for everything else:

Investigation group	Starts **private**: your address is hidden from the public and your calendar is members-only. Cases stay between you and your clients. This is what most groups are, and it's the default.
Ghost walking tour	Starts **public**: your meeting point is shown and searchable, and the tours you schedule are visible to everyone with no account needed. A tour nobody can find is no use to anyone, so it doesn't start hidden.

Neither choice locks you in — a tour company can take investigation requests, and an investigation group can run public tours. It's just a starting point, and you can change all of it in your group's settings later. If you run tours as well as investigations, turn on **runs public tours** in your settings. You'll be listed under walking tours in the group finder, while your badge still shows what you mainly do. You're the owner from the start, and your new group's page offers a quick tour of what to do next. You can relaunch it any time from the **?** button on your group's page.

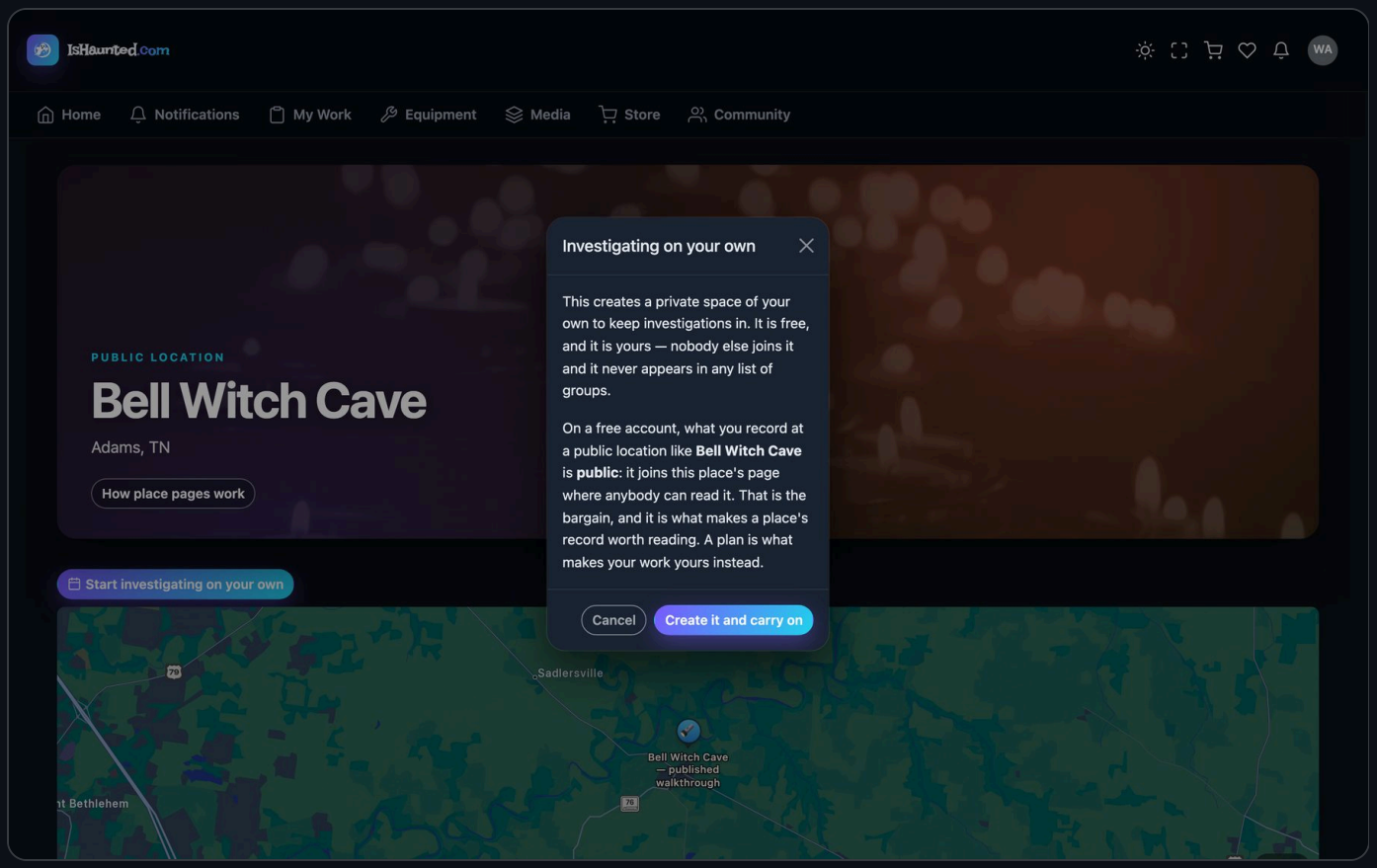
What you'll see as a new member

Once a group accepts you, its hub shows you what every member gets: the group's details, the member list, the calendar, messages, and files. **Cases and investigations aren't included by default** — those tabs appear when the group gives you a role that includes them (many groups use an "Investigator Role" for exactly this). Titles like *Probationary* or *Senior Investigator* show seniority and don't unlock anything on their own. If a tab you expect is missing, you're missing a role — it isn't a bug. Ask whoever runs your group.

Investigating on your own

You don't need a group. Open any **public location's** page — a landmark, a cemetery, a museum — and if you're signed in without a group of your own, you'll see **Start investigating on your own**.

Pressing it first explains how it works, then does two things at once: it creates a private space of your own to keep your investigations in, and it opens the form to schedule your first visit to the place you were looking at. The space is free and it's yours alone. Nobody else joins it, and it never appears in any list of groups. It's there so your investigations, evidence and reports have somewhere to live.



What the button explains before it does anything: you get a free space of your own, and what you record at a public place is public.

What you record at a public location is public. That's the trade-off, and it's worth understanding before you start: your visit is added to that place's own page, where anyone can read it. One person's night somewhere is an anecdote; the same place recorded by eleven people is a record worth having, and free accounts are what build it. If you want your work to stay your own, that's what a plan is for — see Having a plan, and not having one.

Private homes are never part of this. Work at a private residence is client work and needs a paid plan, and a home's page doesn't offer any of these buttons.

You can also just **post** about a public place, without a space or a visit: see Posting about a place. And what you record on your phone can be published to a place's archive the same way — see the mobile apps.

How much you can store

A free account has a **storage allowance**, and everything you keep to yourself counts toward it: recordings, photos, video projects, equipment pictures, anything you add to a public location, and anything you post. The

allowance is the same for everyone, and a site administrator can change it.

Contributing gives you space back. A recording published to a public location's archive no longer counts against you, because it helps make the archive worth reading for people who have never been there. A recording only you will ever see still counts. So the allowance is a nudge, not a bill: contribute, and you get the room back.

What doesn't count. Work that belongs to a group — a case's files, a group's equipment — is the group's, not yours, so it never counts against you. Neither does the old version of a file you've replaced: trimming a long recording down to a short one lowers your usage, as you'd expect. And if you belong to a group on a paid plan, none of this applies to you.

What does count, and is worth knowing: a clip you cut from a recording is a second file. If you keep the original too — as most people do — you're storing both, and both count. Deleting either one frees its space right away.

Being told before you run out

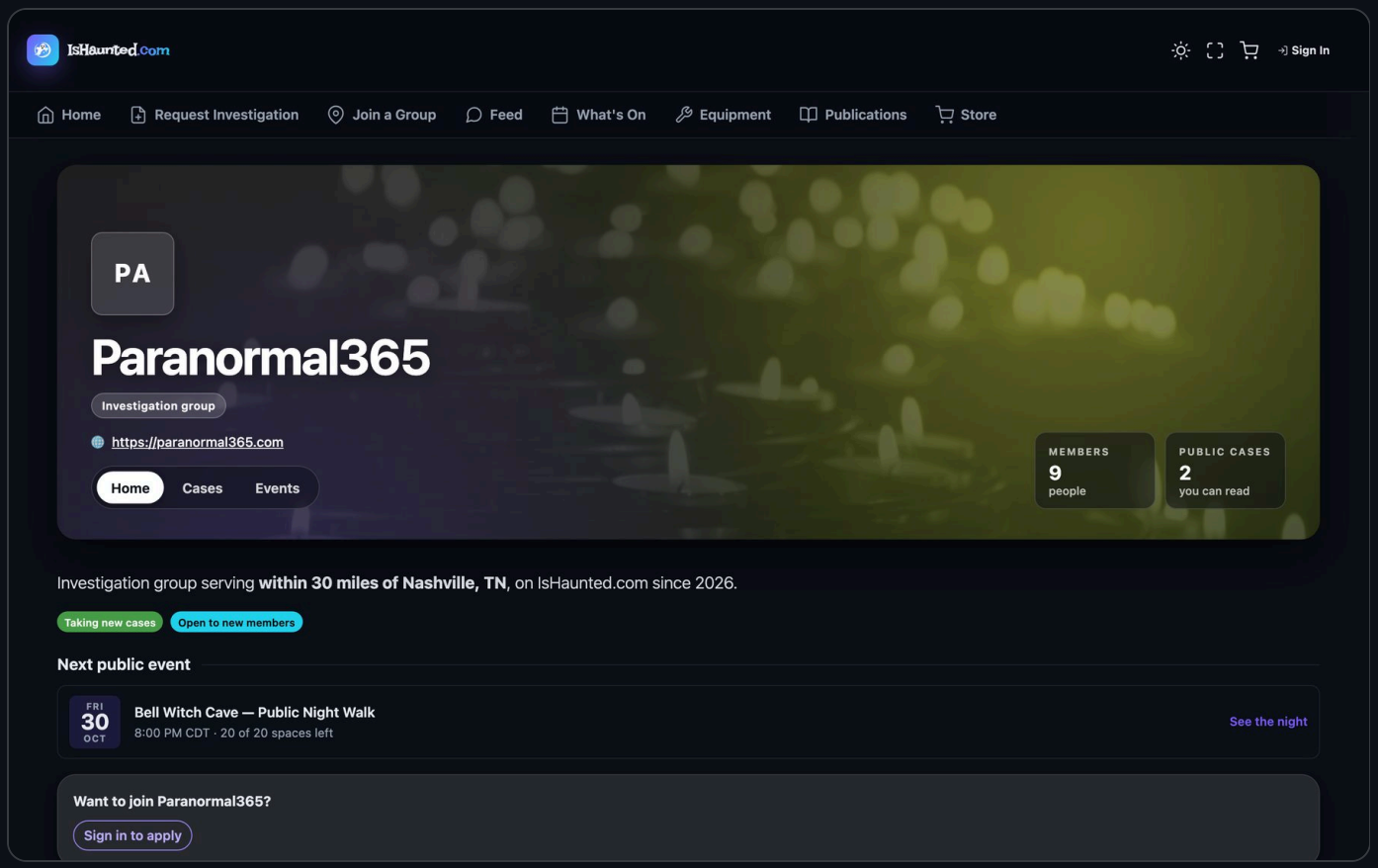
You don't have to keep an eye on it. When you've used about 90% of your allowance, the site sends you a message letting you know, with nothing you need to do yet. At 95% it sends a stronger warning, because your next upload may be refused.

Each warning is sent **once**. If you free up some space and drop back under 90%, the warnings reset, so if you fill up again later, you'll be warned again instead of hitting the limit without notice.

There are three ways to make room, and the messages list them: publish a recording to a public location, delete files you no longer need, or join a group on a paid plan, which removes the limit entirely. Nothing is ever deleted to make room — the limit only stops you from adding more; it never touches what you already have.

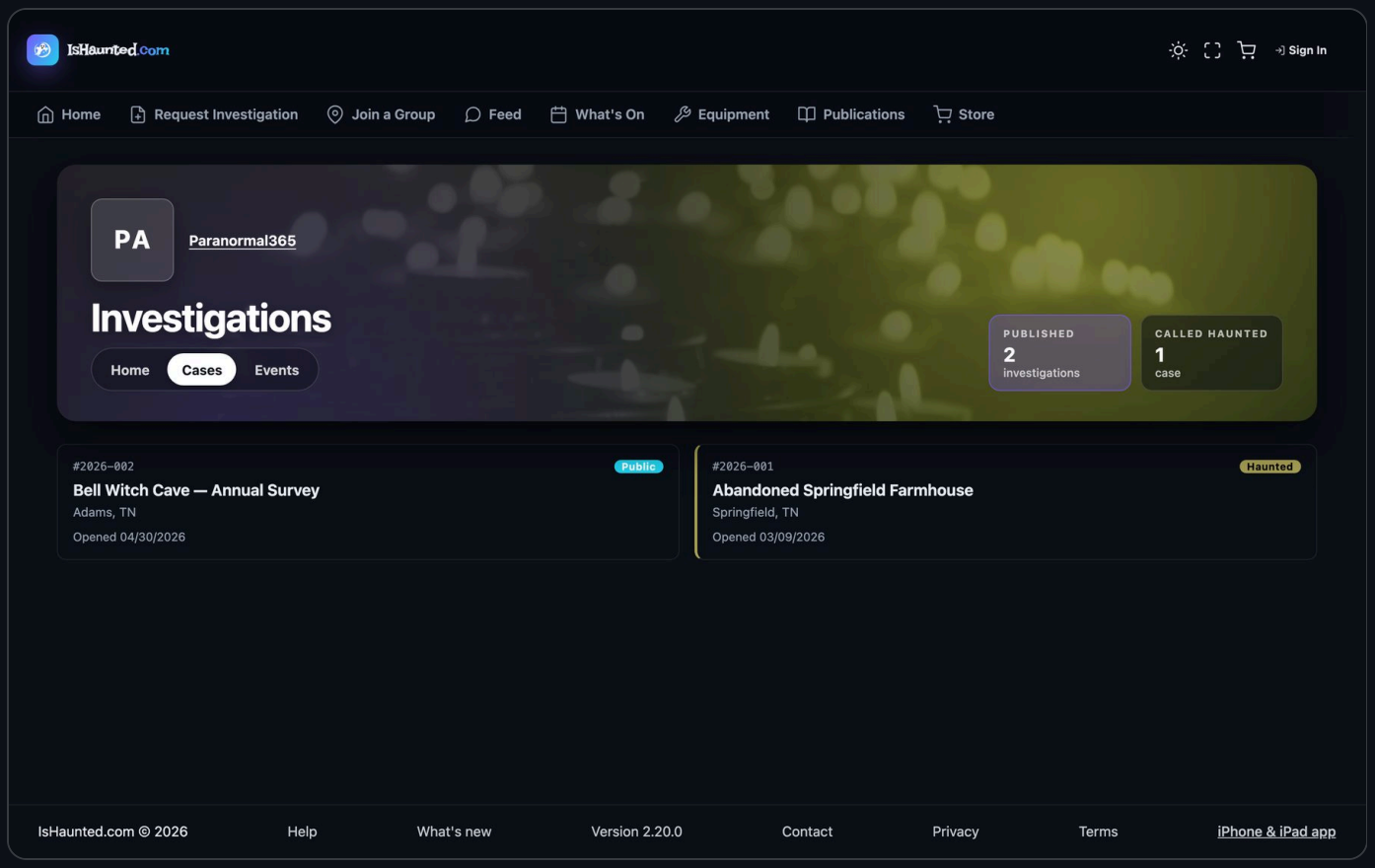
A group's own pages

Every group has its own page at `/o/their-name`, and everything they publish is linked from it. A row of buttons across the top takes you to their **Cases**, their **Events**, any pages they've written, and back to their home page.



What the group is, where it works, how many people it has, and the next event you could go to.

Cases shows the investigations they've chosen to publish.

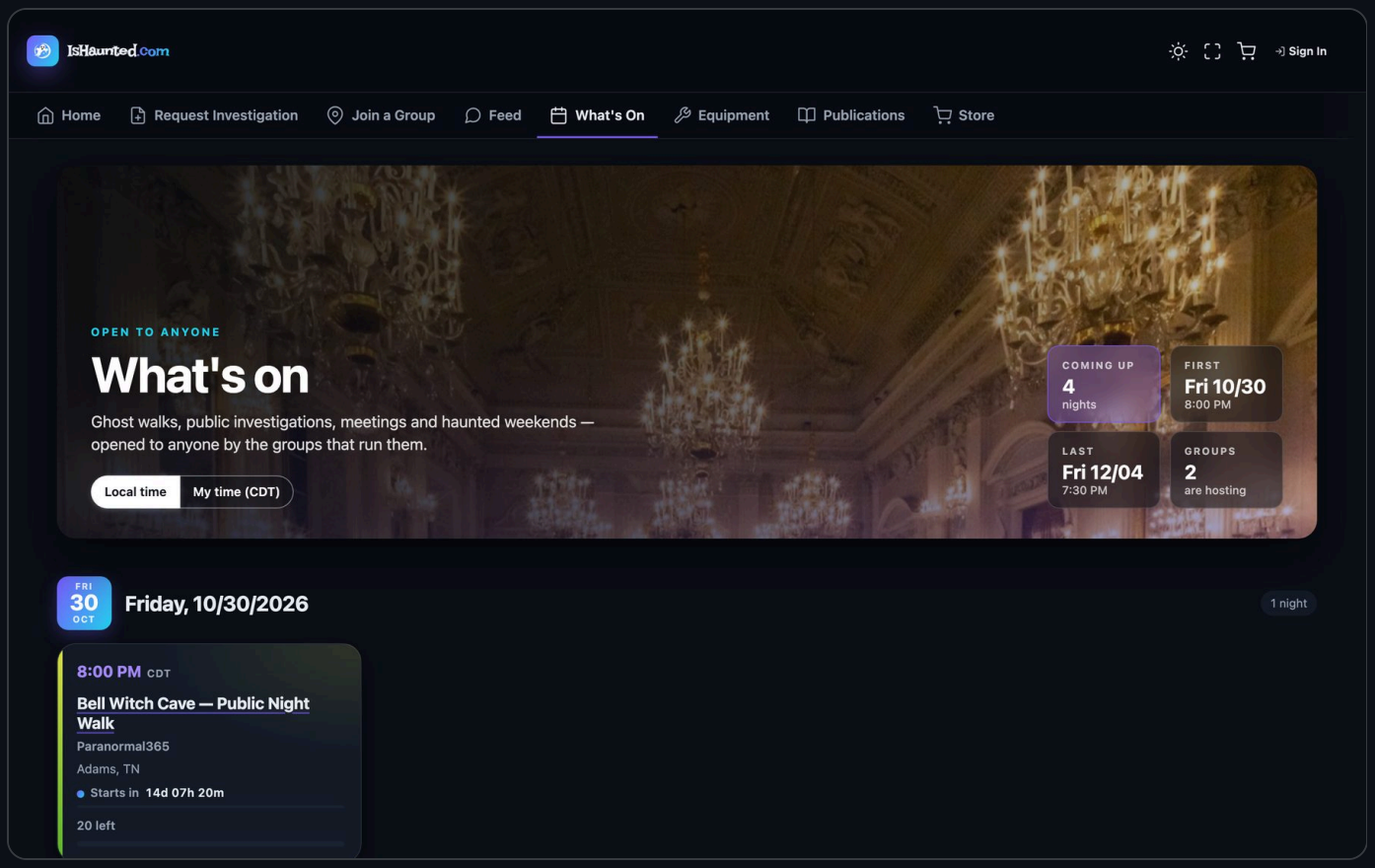


If the group concluded a case is haunted, it's marked along the card's left edge. Click anywhere on the card to open it.

Each case has a page with the group's summary, what they found (if they chose to publish it), a timeline of what happened and when, and a community rating you can vote on once you're signed in.

What's on

What's On in the menu lists every public event any group has opened to everyone — walks, investigations and open meetings together, soonest first.



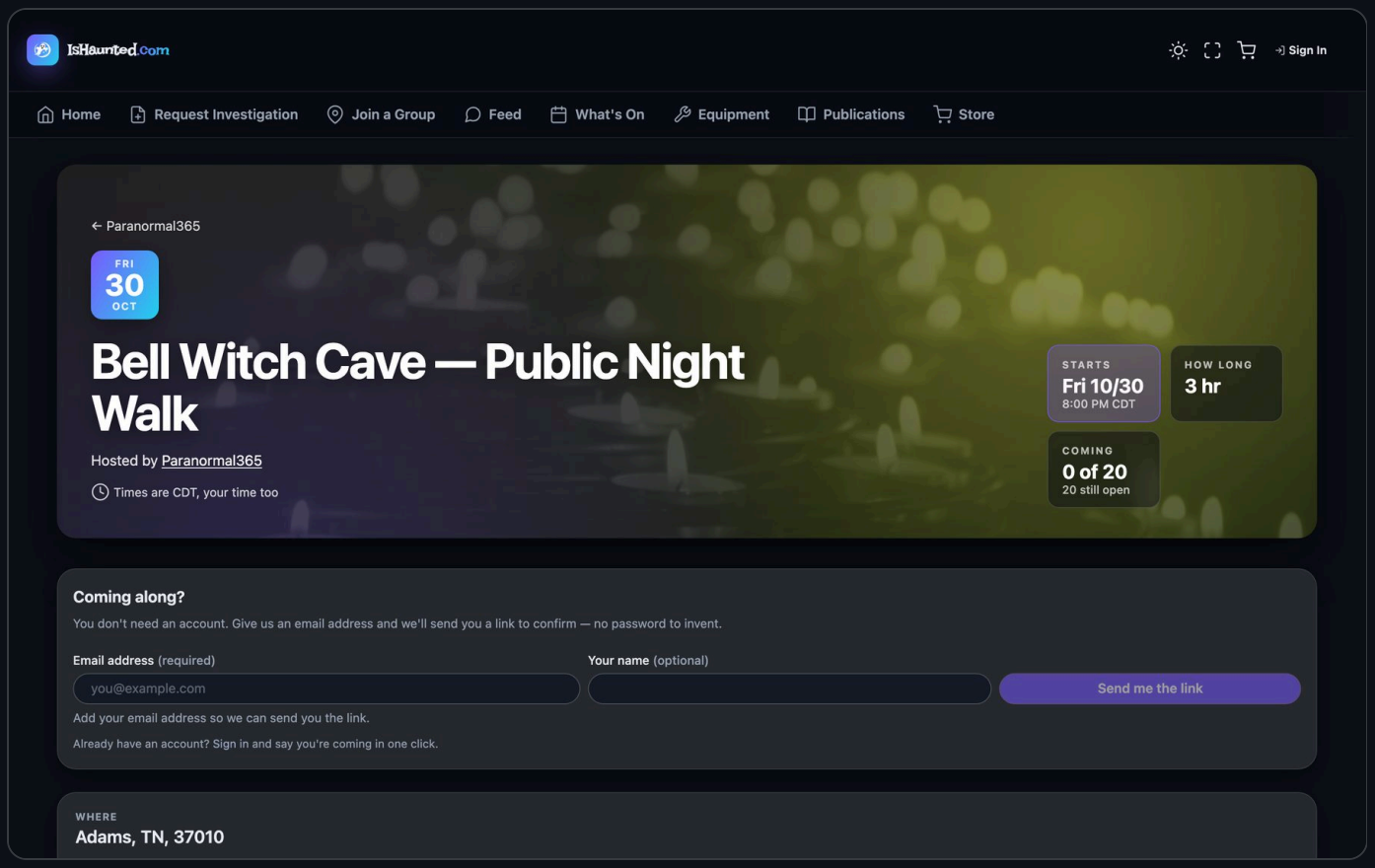
Grouped by day, so each date is shown once and each event under it only shows what's different about it. The bar on the right shows how full it is.

Each event counts down to its start, with a thin bar that fills as it gets closer and **Happening now** while it's on. Signed in, you also see your own groups' events that aren't public, marked **Your group**; they open on your group's calendar.

Times are shown in the event's own time zone — or yours, if you prefer. A walk that starts at eight in Nashville shows as eight wherever in the world you're reading it, with the time zone named beside it. That way this page, the event's page, the email you're sent and the calendar file all agree. Switch **Local time · My time** at the top of the list to see every event in your own time zone instead. The site remembers your choice, and hovering over any time shows it in the other time zone. If a group hasn't set a time zone for an event, it's shown in the group's home time zone.

Going to a group's public event

Public events are open to anyone — you'll find them on a group's page and under **Join a Group**. Sign up with your email address, click the link we send you, and you're on the list. (That also creates an account for you, with no password to come up with.)

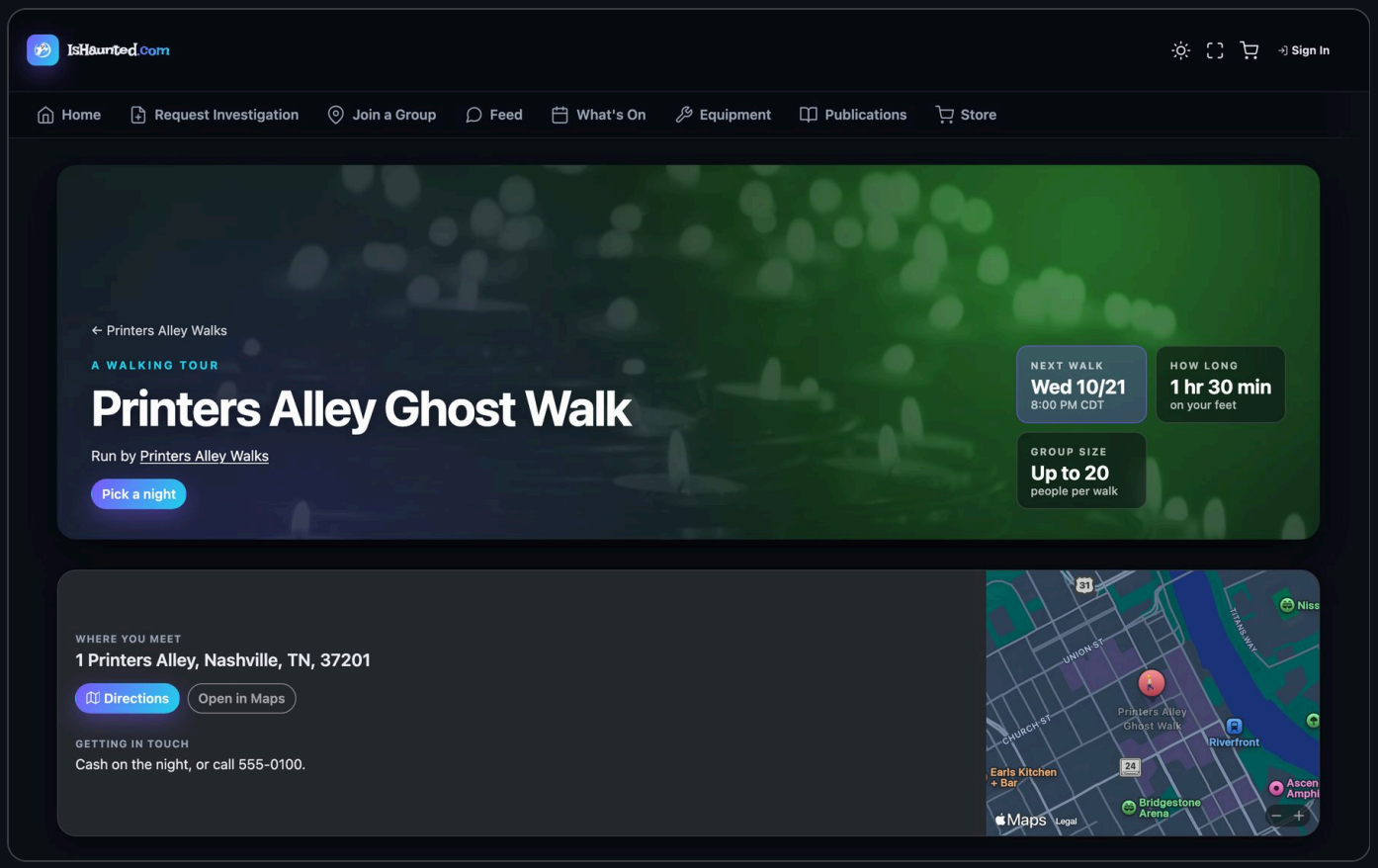


Signing up is the first thing on the page. When the event is a tour date, the meeting point is shown on a map, because a walk's meeting point is exact; an ordinary event only shows the town.

Afterward, if you captured something, you can **offer it to the group** from the event's page. A member reviews every submission. If yours is accepted, it becomes part of that event's public record, credited to you. If it's declined, you're told why, and your file stays private. You can see the status of each of your submissions on the same page.

Ghost walks and tours

A tour is a walk that a business sells: it has a meeting point, a length, and dates you can sign up for. Tours show up on the map on the home page, in **What's near you**, and on the business's own page. Each one has its own page with its pictures, its guides, and when it runs.



Asking for a place

You **ask** for a place on a walk, and the tour confirms it. Say how many of you are coming — one sign-up can cover several places — and the page will show *your seat is with the tour* until someone there makes a decision.

Two places reserved, and the optional button to let the tour know you've seen it.

When your place is approved, you'll get an email with the meeting point, the time in the tour's own time zone, who's leading it and what they look like, and a calendar file so your phone reminds you. You'll get the same email again the night before. If you ask for something the tour can't fit, they'll let you know and you can try another night.

Payment is arranged with the business. Nothing is charged through this site. The tour's page and the email explain how they'd like to be paid, and when they approve your seat, that means the payment side is settled between you.

Once your seat is reserved, **Got it** lets the tour know you've seen it. That's entirely optional — your place is held either way. It just tells them to expect you.

A walk that's full still accepts requests. You go on a waiting list instead, and the tour will get back to you if a spot opens up.

Afterward, you can rate the walk out of five and leave a few words. Anything you sent in from the night is on the tour's page for you to download.

Times are shown in the event's own time zone — or yours, if you prefer. A walk that starts at eight in Nashville shows as eight wherever you're reading it, with the time zone named beside it, so the page, the email and the calendar file all agree. **Local time · My time** on the page switches every time to your own time zone, and the site remembers your choice.

At the bottom of a tour's page, you may find the walk's other accounts — its website, Instagram, YouTube and so on — if the business has added them.

GETTING STARTED

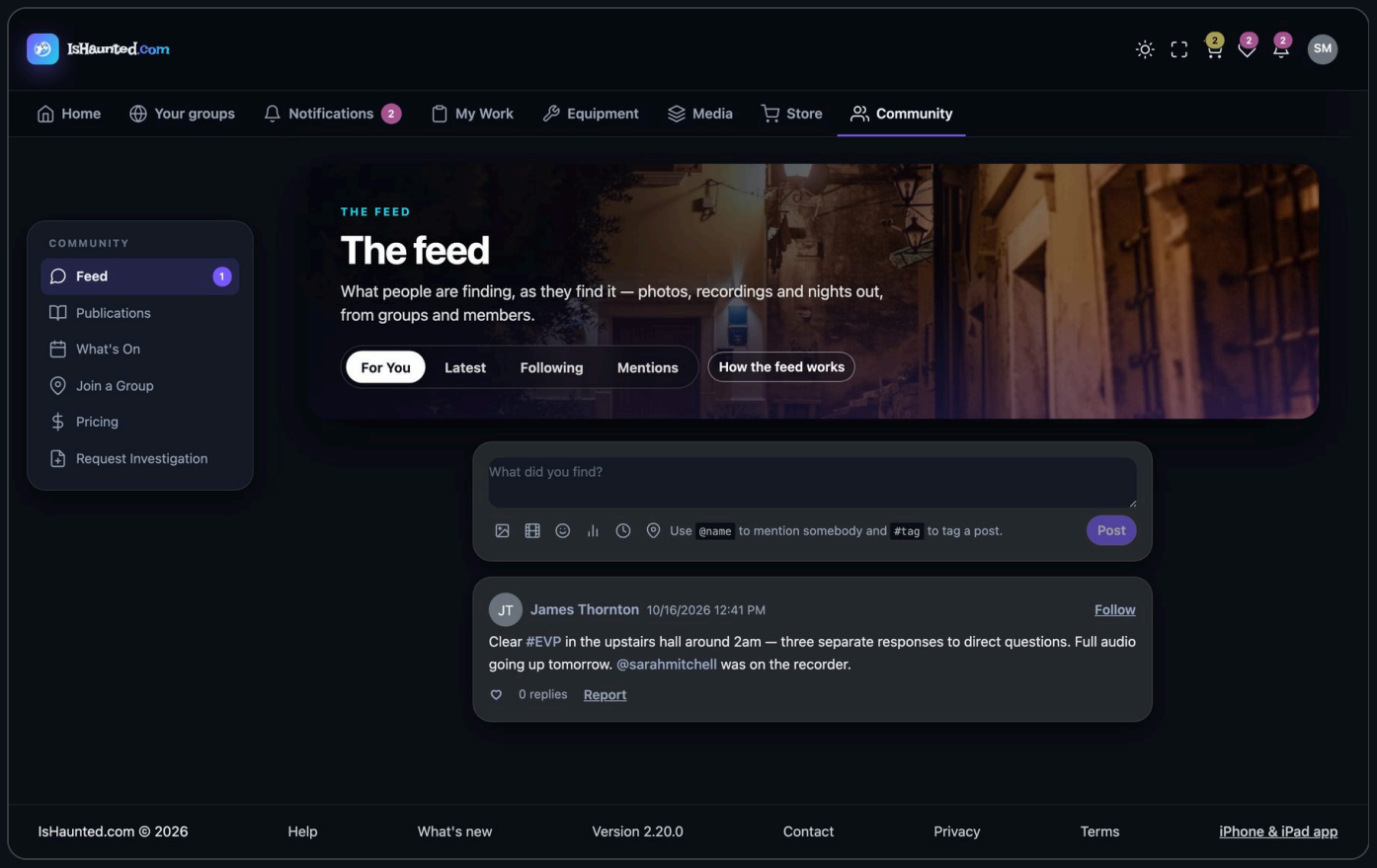
The Feed

Short public posts, mentions, tags and following.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

The **Feed** is the site's place for short public posts. Anyone signed in can post, and everyone signed in can read. It's where you share what you found last night, without writing it all up.

Long pieces don't belong here: a post can be at most 1,000 characters.



A post.

#EVP and @sarahmitchell turned into links automatically — you only had to type them.

Writing a post

Type in the box at the top of the feed and press **Post**. Posts are plain text with no formatting, so they're quick to write and quick to read.

Mentioning somebody

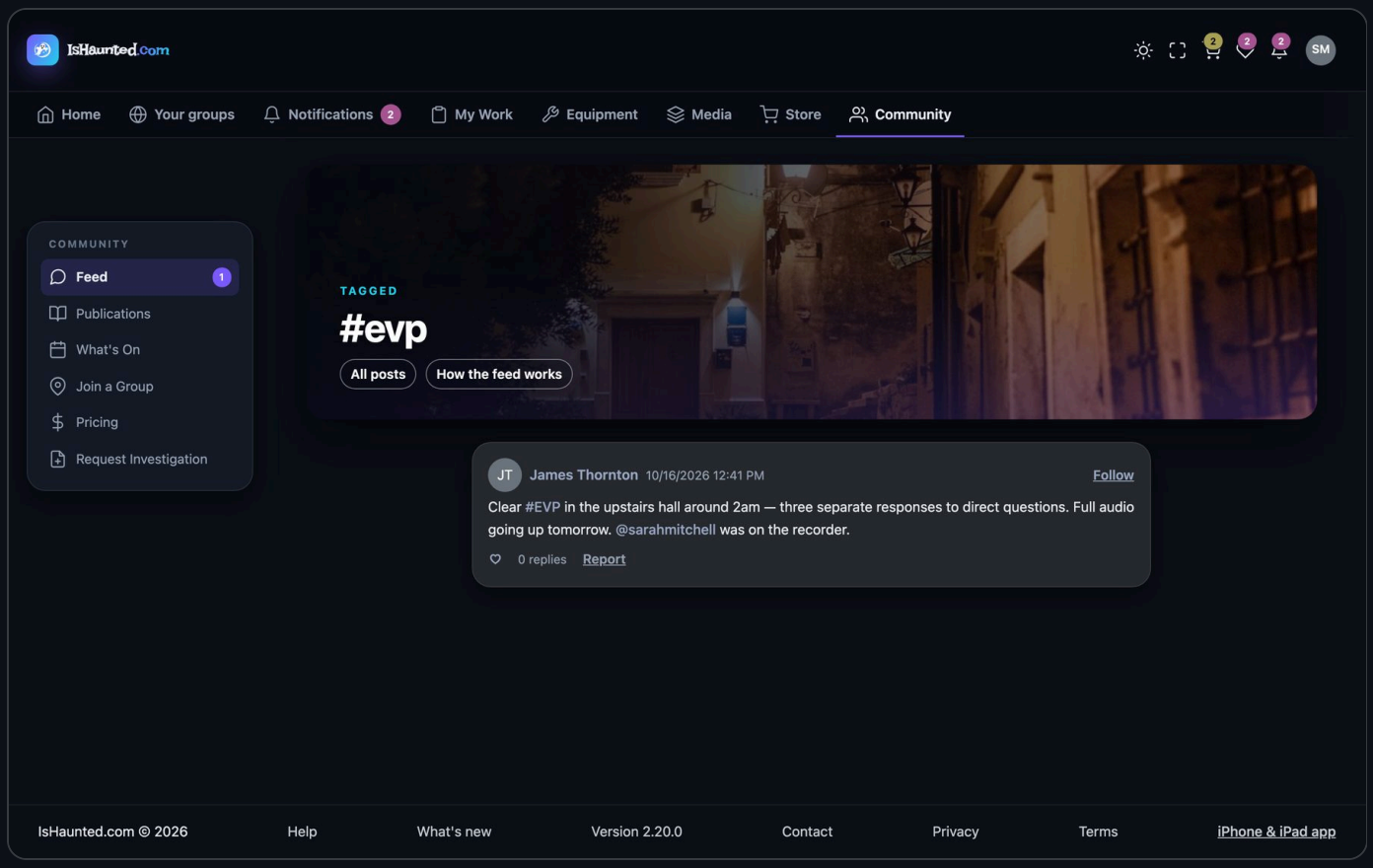
Type @ followed by the person's name, like `@sarahmitchell`. If it matches someone, their name becomes a link and they're notified that you mentioned them. If it doesn't match anyone, it stays as plain text, which makes a typo easy to spot.

An **@name** is the permanent name someone picked when they created their account, not their display name. So a mention still points to the right person even if they later change how their name is shown.

An email address in a post isn't treated as a mention. `ben@example.com` stays an email address.

Tagging a post

Type # followed by a word, like `#evp` or `#bellwitch`. The tag becomes a link to every other post that uses it.



Clicking a tag shows every post that uses it. You can share the page's address.

Capitalization doesn't matter: `#EVP`, `#evp` and `#Evp` are the same tag, so they all show up together. Tags can't start with a number, because `#1` and `#2026` are almost always a list number or a year, not a subject.

Saying what a post shows

When you attach a photo or video, you can choose a **category** from the same list of experience types used everywhere else on the site (Apparition, Voices / Whispering, EMF Spike, and so on). It's always optional, and a text-only post doesn't need one.

Choosing a category does two things. It adds a small label to your post that readers can click to see other posts of the same kind, and it tells the site what your footage is supposed to show. If the site's own checks disagree — for example, a clip labeled as voices that has no audio track — **you, and only you**, will see a gentle note on your post suggesting a different category. Nothing is blocked and nobody else sees the note. An honest mislabel isn't treated as misconduct, and fixing it takes one click. Until it's fixed, a post whose content clearly doesn't match its label ranks a little lower in **For You**.

Posting straight from the video editor

When you export a finished video in the editor, a **Post to the feed** option appears next to "Upload to server" and "Save to my machine" (as long as you're allowed to post). If the video was made from a case, you'll see which case before anything goes public. Footage from a **private engagement** needs an extra confirmation: the client was promised privacy, so publishing any of it has to be a deliberate choice, and that choice is recorded.

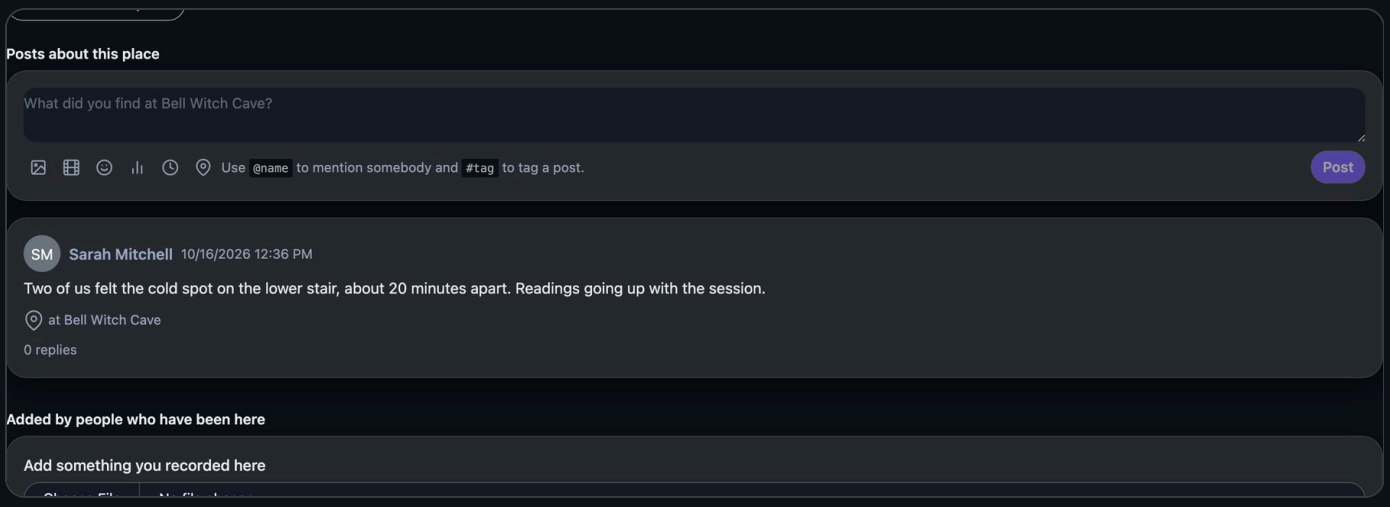
The group that worked the case decides separately whether the post carries **their** name. Until they claim it, the post is credited only to you. A claimed post shows the group's name, a link to their page, and a **Group verified** badge, which means the group vouches that the footage is what it says it is. **Moderator reviewed** appears when a site moderator has personally checked and approved the video. Both badges help a post rank higher in **For You**.

Posting about a place

A public location's page has the same posting box, under **Posts about this place**. A post you write there is an ordinary post that's also linked to that place. It appears on the place's page, in the feed, and anywhere else the post shows up, with **at {the place}** underneath linking back to the place.

That box works differently in two ways, both on purpose:

- **Anybody signed in may use it.** Posting on the main feed is for people who belong to the site — members of a group, and clients whose case is being worked. A public location's page is different. It's a shared record of somewhere anyone can visit, and the visitor who went on the evening tour and photographed something is exactly who it's for.
- **Private residences have no box at all.** Posting about what happens inside someone's home needs their permission, and there's no way to ask for it yet. So a home's page doesn't accept posts.

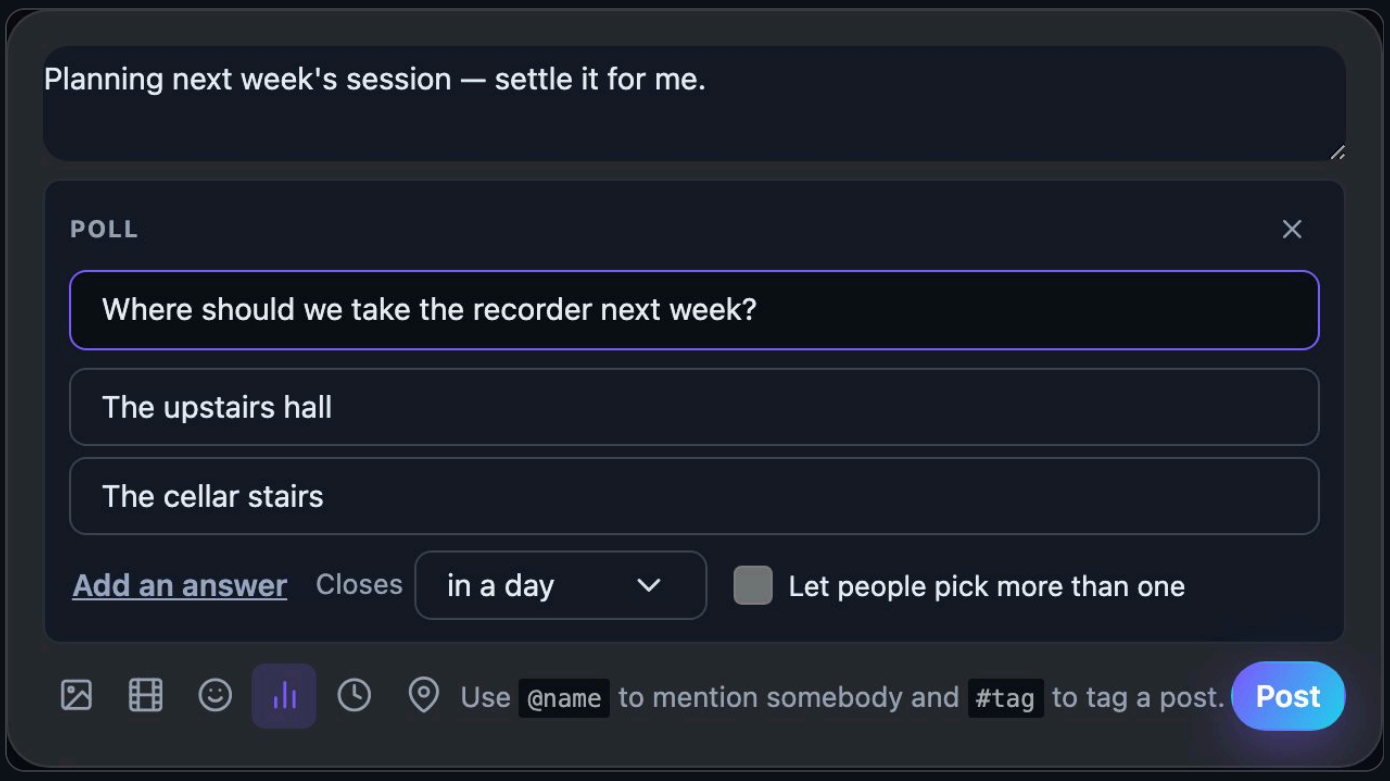


The same box, on a public location's page. Posts written here show

at the place wherever they're read.

Everything else works like any other post: photos and videos go through the same check, reporting and hiding work the same way, and replies belong to the thread rather than to the place. **See all posts about this place** opens the full list on its own page, which you can share.

The tools under the box



Writing a poll. Hover over any icon in the row to see its name.

Under the writing box is a row of small icon buttons with no labels. Hover over one to see what it is.

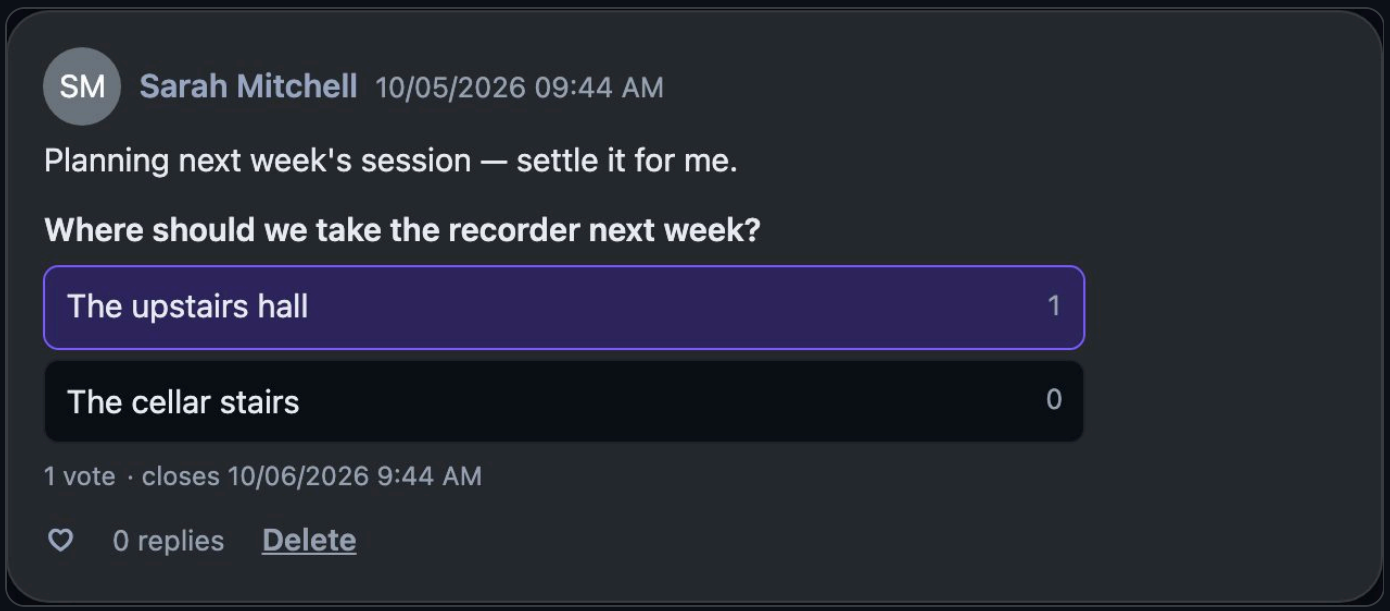
TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Photo or video	Attaches a photo or video to the post. Only one file per post.
GIF	Opens a GIF picker from Giphy. Choosing one adds its address to your post, and the GIF plays wherever the post appears.
Poll	Opens the poll writer described below.
Emoji	A short list of the emoji people use most. Anything your keyboard can type works too.
Schedule	Picks a time for the post to appear.
Location	Adds where you're posting from.

Writing a poll

A poll has a question and **between two and six answers**. Use **Add an answer** to add one, and the **×** next to an answer to remove it. You can't remove the last two, because a poll needs at least two answers.

Closes sets how long the poll runs: 6 hours, a day, 3 days, a week, or never. Check **Let people pick more than one** if more than one answer can be true.

Blank answers are dropped when you post, so if you fill in two of four boxes, you get a two-answer poll. To remove the whole poll, use the **×** in its top corner.



An answered poll. The bar sits behind each answer instead of beside it, so long answers get the full width.

Anyone signed in can answer a poll. You get one answer unless the poll allows more, and pressing your answer again takes it back. Everyone can see the counts from the start, not just after voting — the counts are public anyway, and hiding them only leaves people guessing. The number under a poll counts **people**, not answers, so a poll that allows several answers still shows how many people took part.

Scheduling a post

Pick a date and time, and the post waits until then. The time is on **your own clock**, wherever you are, so you never have to work out a time zone.

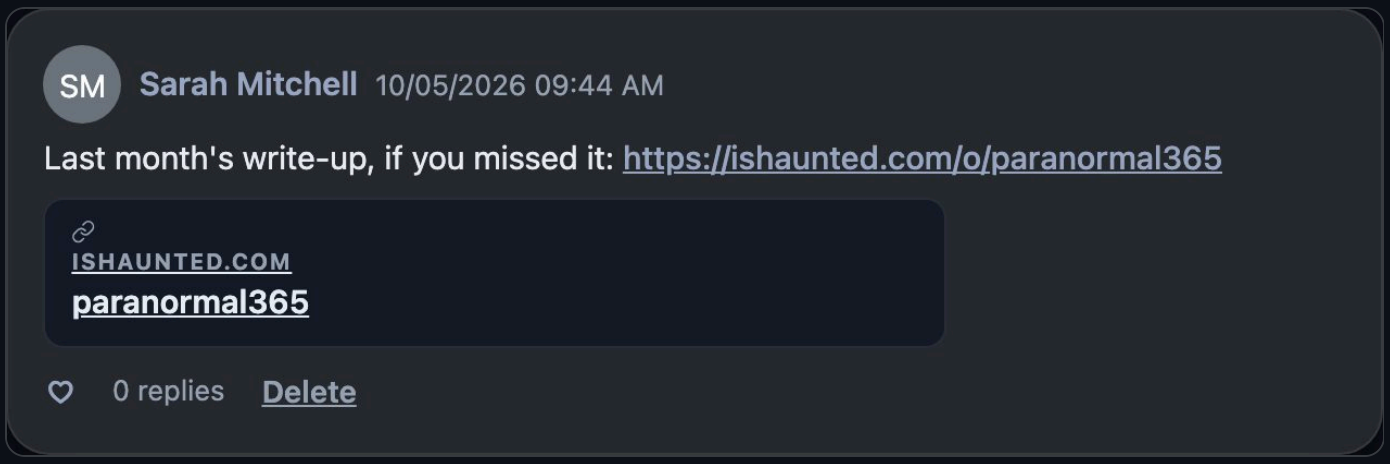
Until it goes up, **only you** can see it. It's marked *Goes up …* and gives you two options: **Post it now** publishes it right away, and **Cancel it** takes it back. Since nobody else has seen it yet, canceling leaves no trace.

Saying where you are

The **location** tool asks your browser where you are, turns that into a place name, and adds *said at …* under your post, with a small icon that opens the spot in Maps. It asks every time and never uses your location without asking. Press **Remove** to take it off before you post.

Links in a post

A web address you type stays in your sentence where you typed it, and a small card under the post shows where it leads.



The address stays in the sentence. The card underneath shows where it leads.

Full cards are made for addresses **on this site** — a case, a tour, an event or a group — using information the site already has, so the card stays correct even if something is renamed later. The site never visits other websites to build a card, so a link to another site gets a simpler card that just names that site.

Promoted cards

Every eighth spot in the main feed shows a card instead of a post. The cards take turns between a group promoting itself (always marked **Promoted**) and the site's own link to the group finder. If you choose **Show groups near you** on a promoted card, your browser asks for permission to use your location, and the cards are re-sorted with the nearest first. Your location is used only for that sorting and is never stored — it's forgotten as soon as you leave.

Reading

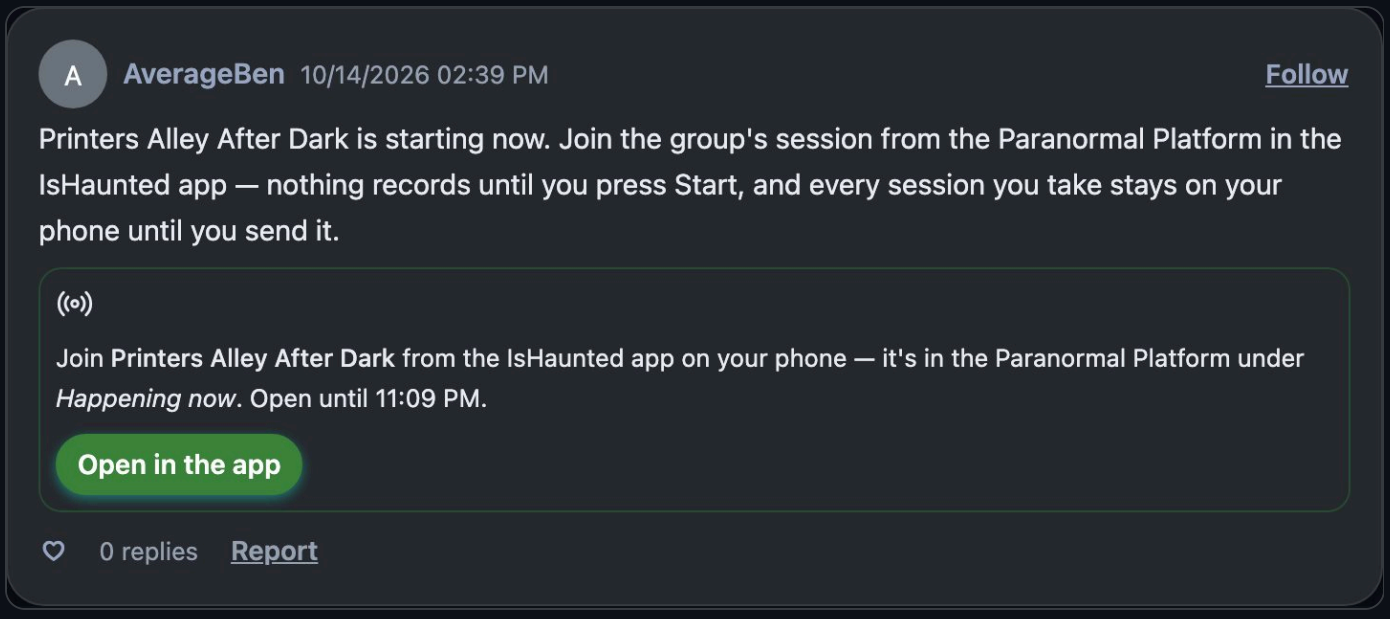
All posts	Everything, newest first.
Following	Only people you follow, plus your own posts so you can see what you just wrote.
Mentions	Posts that mention your **@name**, and posts with replies that do. The *Mentions* row in the bell opens this.

Click a post's reply count to open it and read the replies. The "mentioned you" badge on your **Feed** menu item clears only when you open the post, so it never disappears before you've seen it.

While the page is open, it checks for newer posts in the background. When there are some, a **"new posts"** button appears; click it to load them without losing your place. The site's home page also shows a few of the feed's current top posts.

When a group's session starts

A guide, organizer or investigation lead can start a session for everyone from the app. When they do, a card in the feed says so and offers **Open in the app**. You join in the Paranormal Platform on your phone, since that's where the recording happens. On a phone with the app, the button opens the session there, and the app also lists it under **Happening now**.



For a public tour or event, the card shows up in everyone's feed. For anything private, only the people it's meant for see it. Either way, the card goes away six hours after the tour or event ends.

Following

Press **Follow** next to someone's name on a post, or on their feed page. Following is one-way, and the other person isn't asked. It changes what you're shown, not what you're allowed to see — everything in the feed is visible to signed-in people either way.

Press it again to unfollow.

Reporting a post

If a post shouldn't be here, press **Report** on it. An administrator reviews it and decides what to do.

Two things to know:

- **Reporting does not hide anything**, even when lots of people report the same post. A person makes that decision, so a group of people who dislike someone can't get their posts removed by ganging up on them.
- **You can report a post once.** Pressing it again does nothing, and the button changes to *Reported* so you know it worked.

You can't report your own post.

Taking down your own post

Your own posts and replies have a **Delete** button (in the app, it's in the post's **...** menu). You're asked to confirm — *Delete this post?* — because it can't be undone. A deleted post disappears from the feed for everyone right away, and **its replies go with it**, since there's no post left for them to answer. Deleting one of your replies doesn't affect the post it answered.

Nobody else can delete your post. If someone else's post should come down, report it.

If the feed is not there

An administrator can turn off the feed for the whole site. When that happens, the menu item and the feed's pages simply don't appear. That's a choice made by whoever runs the site, not an error.

GETTING STARTED

Reading Publications

Long-form writing from investigation groups, and how to follow the ones you like.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

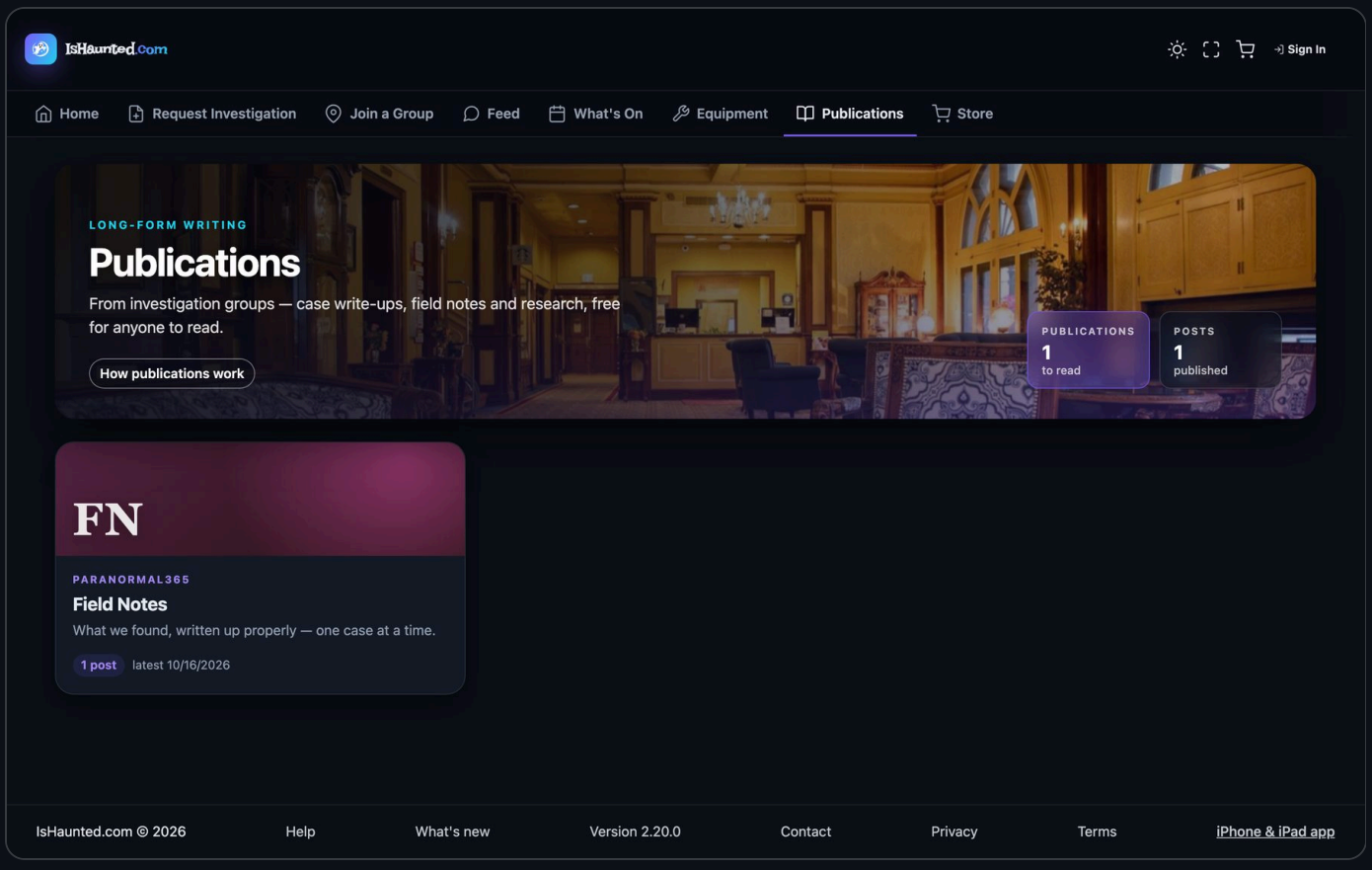
Publications are where groups write at length. Each publication has its own title — *Field Notes*, *The Ridgeway Case*, whatever the group calls it — and inside it are posts: case write-ups, research, notes from a night that turned into something worth explaining properly.

Posts on the Feed are quick updates; a publication is for longer, more considered writing.

You do not need an account

Anyone can read everything that's published. There's no sign-in, no email address to give, and nothing to dismiss before you can read. If you share a link to a post, the person you send it to can read it right away.

You only need an account to **subscribe**, which is how you keep up with the groups whose writing you like.

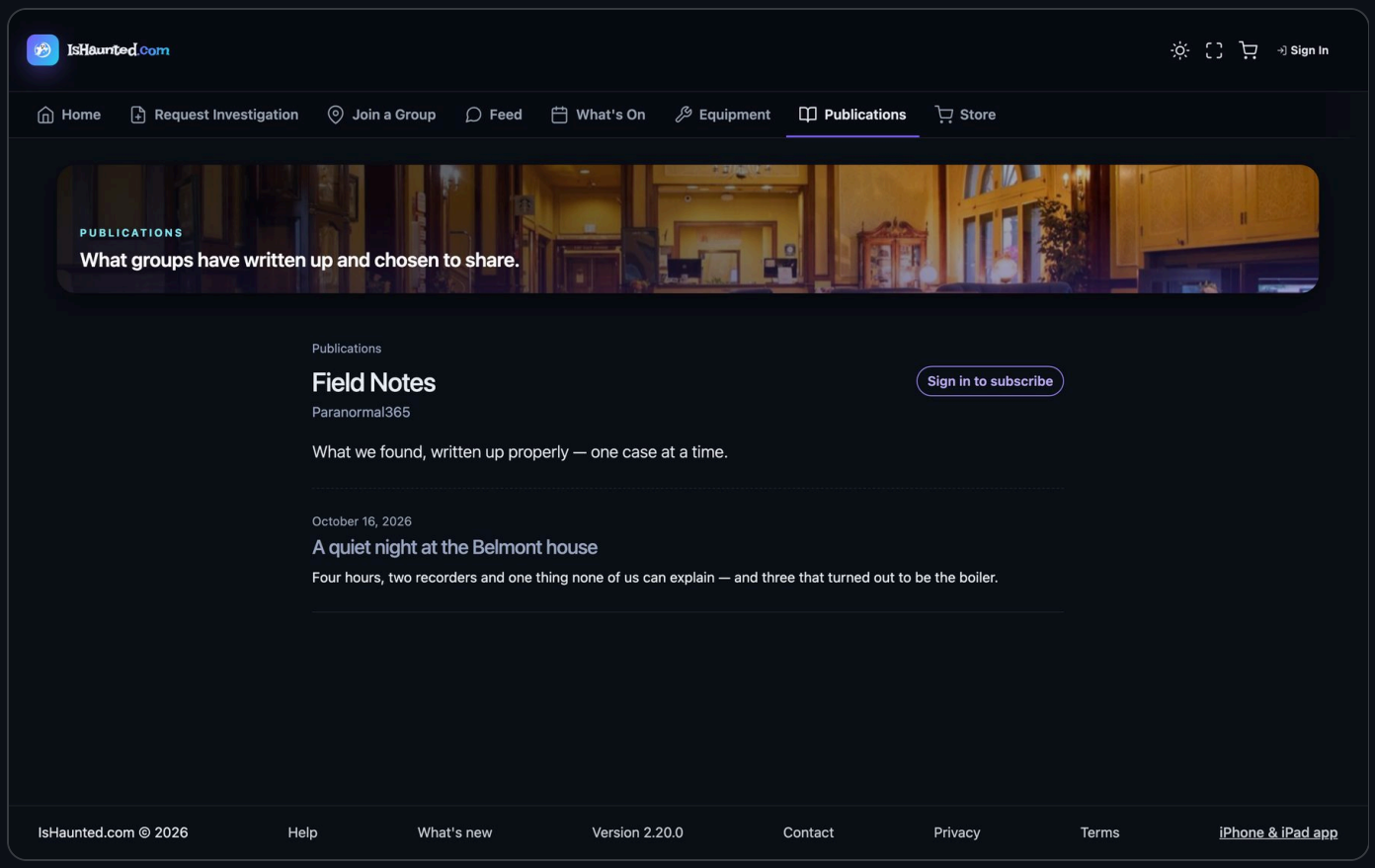


Every group with something published. The card shows how many posts there are and when the most recent one went up.

Finding something to read

Publications in the left-hand menu — under **Community** once you're signed in — lists every publication with at least one published post. Publications with nothing in them yet aren't listed.

Open one to see its posts, newest first, each with a line or two about what it covers.



A publication's own page. The group's name links back to its profile, and *Subscribe is in the top right.*

Subscribing

Subscribe on a publication's page lets the group know you're reading. If you aren't signed in, the button says **Sign in to subscribe** instead, and brings you back to the same page once you've signed in.

Your subscriptions appear at the top of the **Publications** page, with the date of each one's most recent post, so you can see at a glance who has written something new.

On a publication you already follow, the button says **Subscribed**; press it to unsubscribe. Nothing is lost by unsubscribing — you can subscribe again later, and everything published stays readable either way.

Posts marked "Subscribers"

Some posts may be marked **Subscribers**. You'll see the title and the opening lines, and the rest is only for people who subscribe.

Right now, no posts on the site are marked this way — every post is free to read in full. We mention it here so you'll know what it means if you ever see it.

Reading a post

Each post is a single page: a title, the date it was published, and the piece itself. There is nothing to expand, no "continue reading", and no interruption partway through.

If a link to a post doesn't work, the post has been withdrawn. Groups can take a post down — usually because something in it was wrong — and it disappears from the site right away.

GETTING STARTED

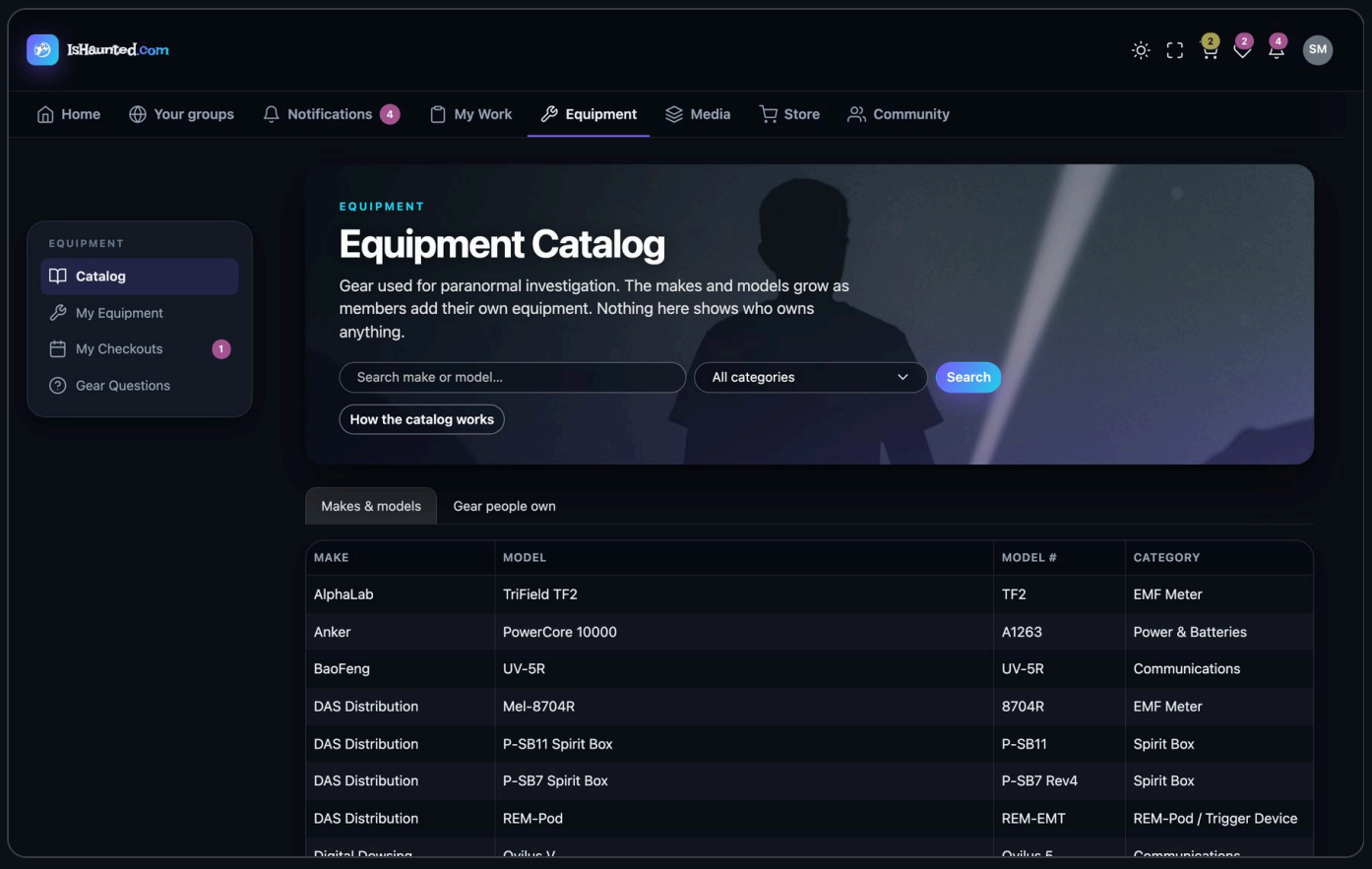
The Equipment Catalog

Browsing the gear people use, make and model pages, photos, questions, and feedback.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

The catalog is public. Anybody can browse it, read a model's page and its questions, and see what people use; asking a question or sending feedback needs an account. To record gear of your own, see Your Equipment.

The public catalog



The catalog lists makes and models, and — on its second tab — the gear people have chosen to list. It never names an owner.

The equipment catalog is **Equipment → Catalog** in the menu, or just **Equipment** if you aren't signed in. Anyone can browse it, including visitors who aren't signed in. It has two parts. *Makes & models* lists the gear that exists, by make and model. *Gear people own* lists individual pieces whose owners chose to list them. Neither part ever shows who owns anything, or any serial numbers.

When you add a make or model that isn't listed yet, it goes into the catalog as a proposal. You can use it right away on your own equipment. It appears in the public catalog once a site administrator approves it, which keeps the shared list from filling up with typos and duplicates.

Make and model pages

Every make and model has its own page, reached by clicking the make and model under any piece of gear. It brings together what everyone who owns one has contributed: how many are owned, how many are offered for borrowing, the manufacturer links people have added, and their photos.

Everything on that page is anonymous. It never says whose photo is whose, or who owns how many. If you can click a photo, it's because you're allowed to open that piece: its owner listed it publicly, shared it with a group you're in, or it's your own. Everyone else sees the same photo without a link.

The manufacturer's page

Each piece of equipment can have an optional link to the manufacturer's own page for it. Links that people add for the same make and model are collected on that model's page, so one person's research into a recorder's specifications saves the next person from searching.

Photos

Each item can have as many photos as you like. The first one you add becomes the main photo — the one shown first — and you can promote any other photo to main, or remove any of them.

Photos load when you open your equipment list rather than as thumbnails in a long grid, so a list with many items stays quick.

You set **Hide from the model page** on each photo separately. A photo of the piece against a plain wall may be just right for the make and model page, while one taken in your living room may not be. A hidden photo stays on your item; it just isn't shown with everyone else's photos on the model page. Captions you write are shown publicly with the photo, so write them with strangers in mind.

Questions and FAQs

There are two related features: one public and one private.

Things worth knowing is the FAQ you write about your own piece — anything a borrower would want to know before asking for it. It appears on the item's page. Entries from publicly listed items also appear on the make

and model's page, alongside other owners' entries. FAQ entries never say who wrote them, anywhere — not even on your own item's page.

Questions are asked by someone thinking about borrowing. They arrive in **Gear Questions** in the main menu, where you can answer or decline, and then add a good answer to the FAQ.

The anonymity, exactly

A question is anonymous in **both** directions. You won't see who asked, and they won't see who answered. The notification only says that a question has arrived.

This lets people ask whether a piece has a quirk they should know about, without worrying that the question will affect whether they're lent the gear.

The anonymity covers questions and FAQs only. **Borrowing is not anonymous** — if that person goes on to ask to borrow the piece, you'll each see who the other is, so you know who's holding your recorder. A group's shared-gear list also names owners.

Publishing an answer to the FAQ **copies** the text; the conversation itself stays private. You can rewrite the answer first, since a reply to one person doesn't always work as a public answer. The original conversation stays as it was. Each answer can be published only once.

Feedback and moderation

After a loan comes back, both sides can leave feedback about the other. Neither side ever sees what was written about them, on any page, and nobody is notified when feedback is left about them. What lenders write is shown to future lenders deciding on that person's next request. What borrowers write is shown, without their name, to other borrowers thinking of asking that lender. The full rules are in Borrowing Equipment.

A group's **Administrators and Owner** get an **Equipment feedback** link on the group's Equipment tab. Nobody else sees the link, because nobody else can open the page. It lists all the feedback about the group's gear and its members' loans, with both people named, and anything inappropriate can be removed. It's the only place on the site where feedback shows both who wrote it and who it's about, so that complaints can be acted on.

Who is looking

Each piece keeps a count of how many times its page has been opened and how many times someone followed its manufacturer link. Those numbers are shown to the Administrators and Owner of the group that owns the equipment, and to site administrators. Nobody else sees them — not other members, and not the individual owner of a personal piece.

The counts are totals only. Nothing is recorded about who looked.

GETTING STARTED

The iPhone and iPad Apps

What the apps do, how to get signed in, and what still lives on the website.

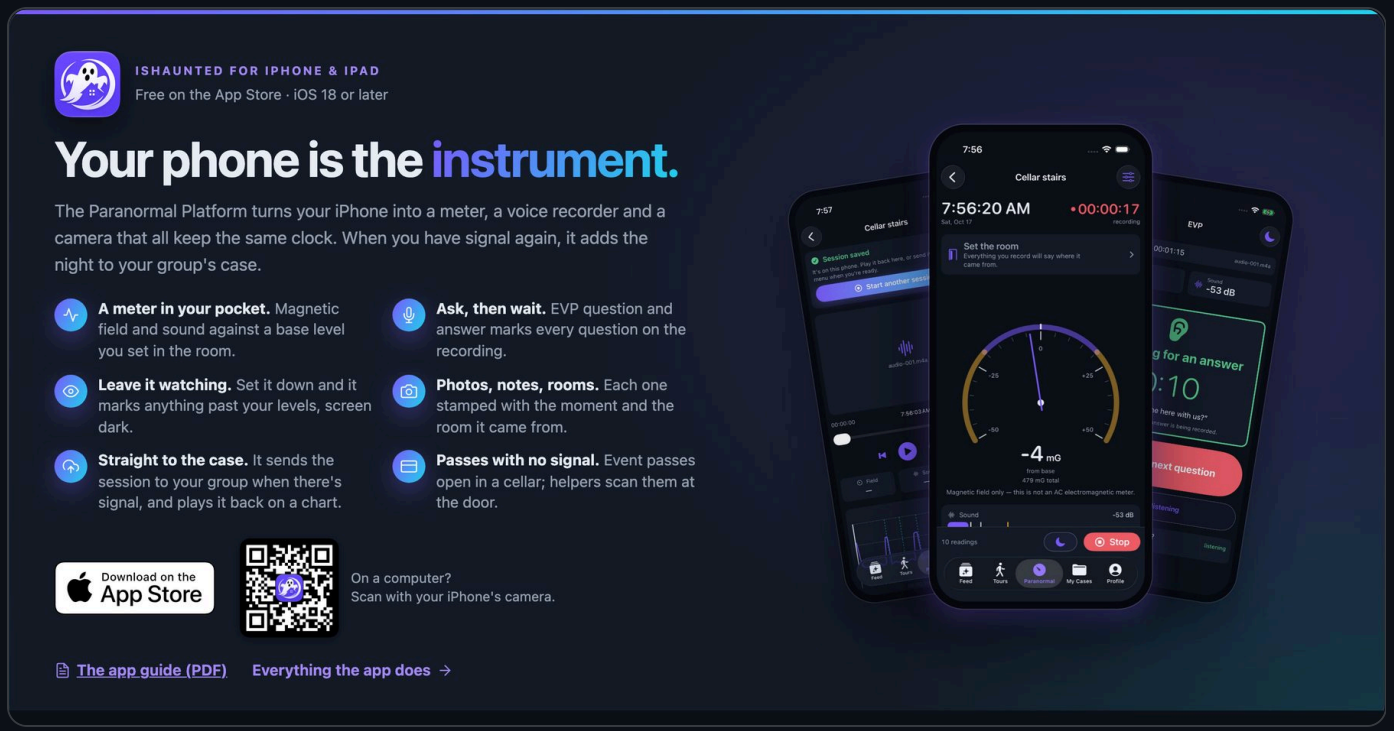
Written for: **Public — no account needed**

There are native apps for iPhone and iPad — really one app that runs on both, with a layout suited to each. It uses the same account and the same data as the website. Sign in on your phone and you'll see the same groups, cases and investigations you see in a browser.

The app is built for the part of this work that happens **away from a desk** — standing in a building at two in the morning with one hand free. Anything long or fiddly (writing a report, editing video, laying out a public page) works better on the website, and always will.

Getting the app

It's free on the App Store: **IsHaunted for iPhone and iPad**. The same link is at the bottom of every page on the website. If you open the website in Safari on an iPhone or iPad, a banner at the top offers to open the app — or to get it, if you don't have it yet. On a computer, the app's section near the bottom of the home page has a QR code you can scan with your iPhone's camera.



The app's section on the home page: Apple's badge opens the App Store, and scanning the QR code with your iPhone's camera does the same.

The app guide (PDF) shows what the app does in six pages, using screens from the app itself: the Paranormal Platform, marking and watching, playing a night back, and events and the door.

Is mine the newest? Profile shows which version you have, under **App**, and checks whether a newer one is in the App Store each time you open it. When there is, it says what changed and **Update in the App Store** takes you straight there. **Check for updates** asks again. If the new version needs a newer iOS than your phone has, it says so, so you know to update iOS first.

What you need an account for — and what you don't

Reading the feed and browsing public events need **no account at all**, just like on the website. Sign in when you want to take part.

Signing in works the same way as in a browser, including two-step codes if you've turned them on. You can also **sign in with your Apple Account**. If you already have an account here with the same email address, that signs you into it instead of creating a second one. If you don't, the app asks for the name people will see and your @name, and creates an account for you. Apple has already confirmed the email address, so there's no confirmation link to wait for. Choosing "Hide My Email" works too — Apple gives us a relay address that forwards to you. Once you're signed in, you stay signed in; the app won't ask again every time you open it.

Anywhere the app needs an account — My Cases, a case, Investigations, Notifications, asking for a place on a night — it says so **and offers a Sign in button right there**, so you can sign in on the spot instead of being sent off to Profile. The sign-in sheet has **Forgot your password?**, which opens the website's password reset (the email it sends links back to the website), and **Create an account**.

Setting **up** two-step sign-in works a little differently on the phone. On a phone, the app is itself the second device, so there's no QR code to scan. Instead, the app shows you the key to copy, and offers a link that passes it straight to your authenticator app. Your recovery codes are shown once, with a button to save or send them — the site can't show them to you again.

What's in the app today

The feed	Scroll it signed out or signed in, open a post and its replies, tap a hashtag or category to see everything like it, and open someone's profile. Photos and video play in the app.
Posting	Write a post, attach a photo or video from your library, or **take one with the camera right there** — something a phone genuinely does better than a laptop. Add a category so people can find your footage. Like, reply, follow and report — and **delete your own post** from its **…** menu.
Notifications	Everything waiting for you, in the same categories the website's bell uses. The color shows the *age* of the oldest item, not the count — fifty messages from this morning just means a busy day, but one from last week is the one worth chasing. Each row opens exactly what it counts: *You were mentioned* opens the posts that name you.
Your cases	Your cases and their timelines — what happened, what the group has written back, and photos attached to either. **Log something that happened** right from the case, with photos from your library or one you take on the spot. Say when it happened — or, if you don't know, say so rather than guessing. **Reports** your group has published are there to read in full, share or save, and you can **message your group** about the case, with everything you send and everything they send back in one conversation. Your contacts are listed, and the group's **visits** to your case show when each one is, where, and the latest you can cancel it.
Investigations	The ones you're on, split into upcoming and past, with your assigned role, any evidence deadline, and the group's case behind each one. **Where you've been** shows the places you've investigated on a map. On an iPhone the tab bar only has room for five tabs, so group members find Investigations under **Profile → Investigations**; on an iPad it's in the sidebar.
Haunted Tours	Ghost walks near you, or near a place you look up, with how far away they are and when they next run. No account needed. Tap one to open the walk — where you meet, how long it runs, who leads it and the upcoming nights — then tap a night to open it. That's where you ask for a place. **Location is asked for, never taken**: the tab opens on a list, and if you'd rather not share where you are, type a city instead.
Events	Public events, readable without an account, where you can reserve a place. A night that belongs to a **walking tour** shows the tour's name under its title, since a business running three walks would otherwise show three rows all called "Saturday walk". Times are shown **where you are**, with the time zone named beside them, and **Local time** switches to the time where the event takes place — for example, 3:08 PM CDT for a Nashville walk (see *Times and time zones*, below). If an event's organizer never set a time zone, it's shown in Central time and labeled that way. **Add to calendar** puts it straight into your own calendar. Tap a night to open it, with your seat, directions to the meeting point and who's guiding. A night that belongs to a **hosted event** — a weekend at a venue, a dinner and a show — shows your booking status and your pass instead; see below.
Paranormal Platform	Your phone as an instrument during an investigation, on the **Paranormal** tab — see below.
My evidence	What you've offered at other people's public events. You can always open it, whatever they decided, and you can add it to the archive of the place where it was taken.

Your account	Sign in and out, create an account, confirm your email, change your password, and turn two-step sign-in on or off.

On iPhone Duo, the app is a phone when folded. Open it and the inner screen gets the room it deserves: the menu becomes a ≡ button at the top of the right-hand column, and while a session runs, the rest of that column holds the investigation's own controls, top to bottom: **mark** the moment, **log what happened** (a cold spot, a touch, a voice, a sound, something seen or smelled, or feeling uneasy), **ask a question and listen**, a **note**, **change room**, **reset the base**, the **flashlight**, and the levels. **Stop** stays on its own at the bottom, away from the rest. Fold or unfold whenever you like: the session keeps recording.

If the app can't do something yet, it says so plainly instead of showing you an empty screen. A count with no screen behind it yet is still listed on Notifications — you just can't tap it, so it doesn't pretend to lead somewhere.

Times and time zones

Every date is stored in universal time and shown as a time you can read, with its time zone beside it — 7:00 PM CDT, never just 7:00.

The app shows the time where you are. It uses your phone's clock, and your phone sets that based on where it is — so if you land in Denver, the app shows Denver time with nothing to change. (That's the phone's **Settings → General → Date & Time → Set Automatically**, which is on unless someone turned it off.) The time zone on your website profile only affects the website, not the app.

The place's time. An event, a tour, an investigation and a visit to your case each have a time zone of their own: the time where they happen. Their screens have a **Local time · My time** switch. They start on **My time** — where you are — and **Local time** shows times the way people there will see them. The app remembers your choice. When the place's time zone is the same as yours, the app says so instead of showing a switch that wouldn't change anything.

7:35

#2026-003

Accepted

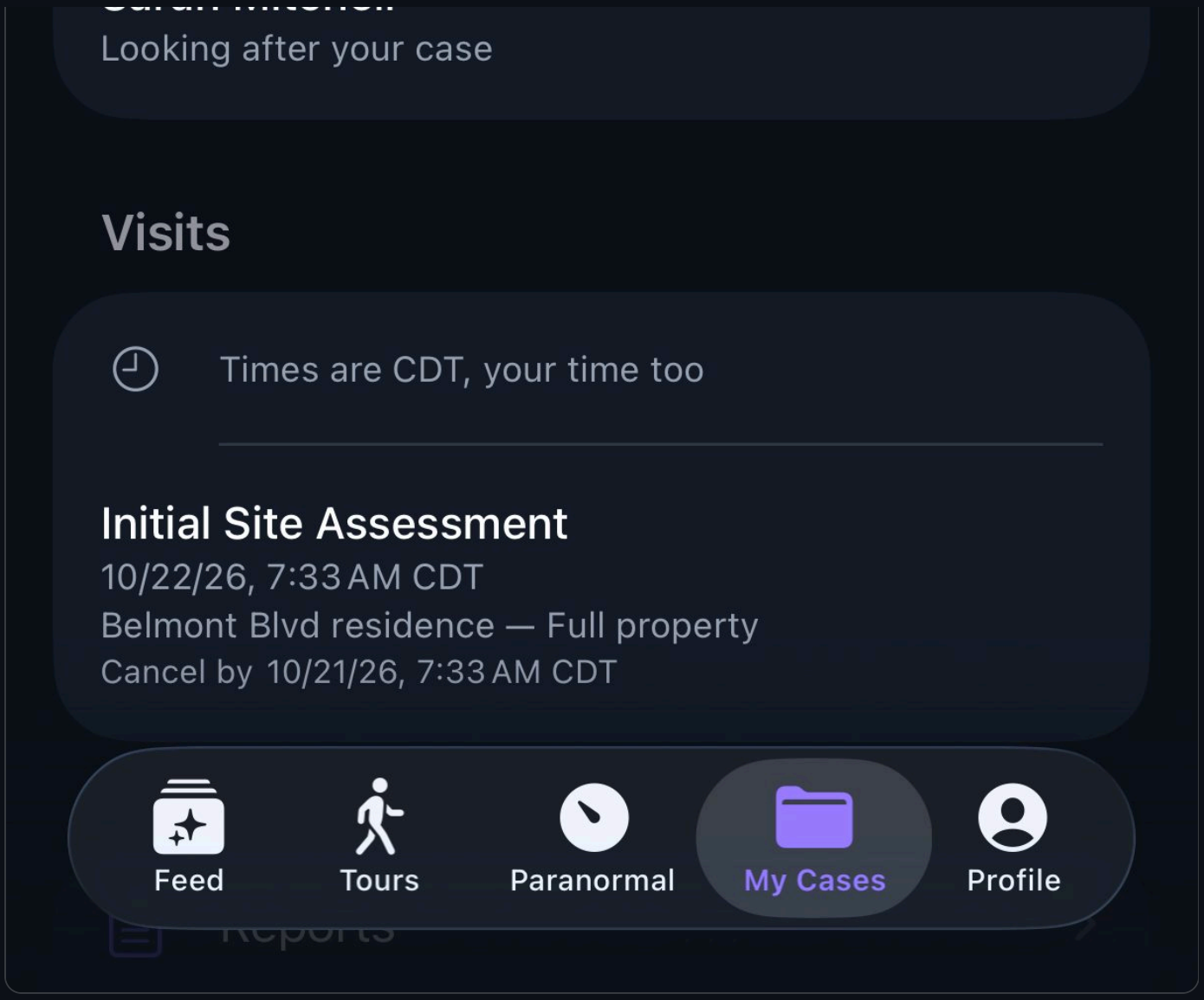
Belmont Boulevard Residence, Nashville TN

Client reports persistent activity over six months: footsteps on the second floor after midnight and objects found displaced. Initial evidence review underway.

Opened	Sep 22, 2026
Case manager	Sarah Mitchell

Who to contact

Sarah Mitchell



Paranormal Platform sessions are shown in the phone's time. A session file records universal time and the time zone the phone was in when it recorded, so it plays back at the right moments on any phone and on the website, wherever the person opening it is.

The Paranormal Platform — the phone as an instrument

The Paranormal Platform records an investigation on the device. It needs **no signal and no account**: a member standing in a cellar with no bars can start recording, and everything stays on the phone until they choose to send it. Signing in still matters, because a session records who was signed in when it was made. Staying signed in doesn't need a connection, so a member who signed in last week is still identified in that cellar.

7:44

Paranormal Platform

Start a session

Readings, photos and recordings stay on this device until you review them. No signal needed.

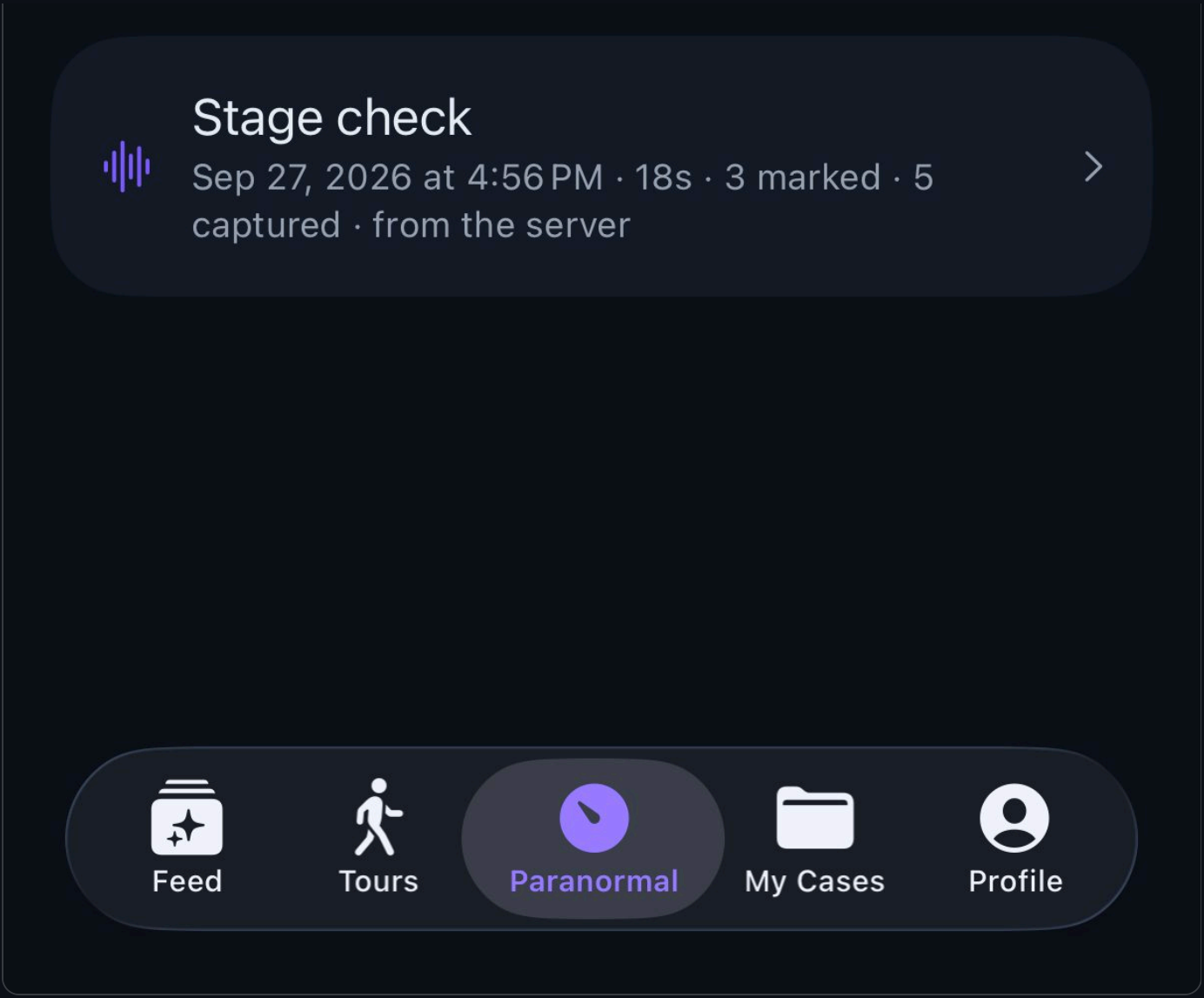
Open a .ben file

A session somebody sent you — by AirDrop, in a message, from Files — opens here and plays exactly as it did for them.

Find public sessions

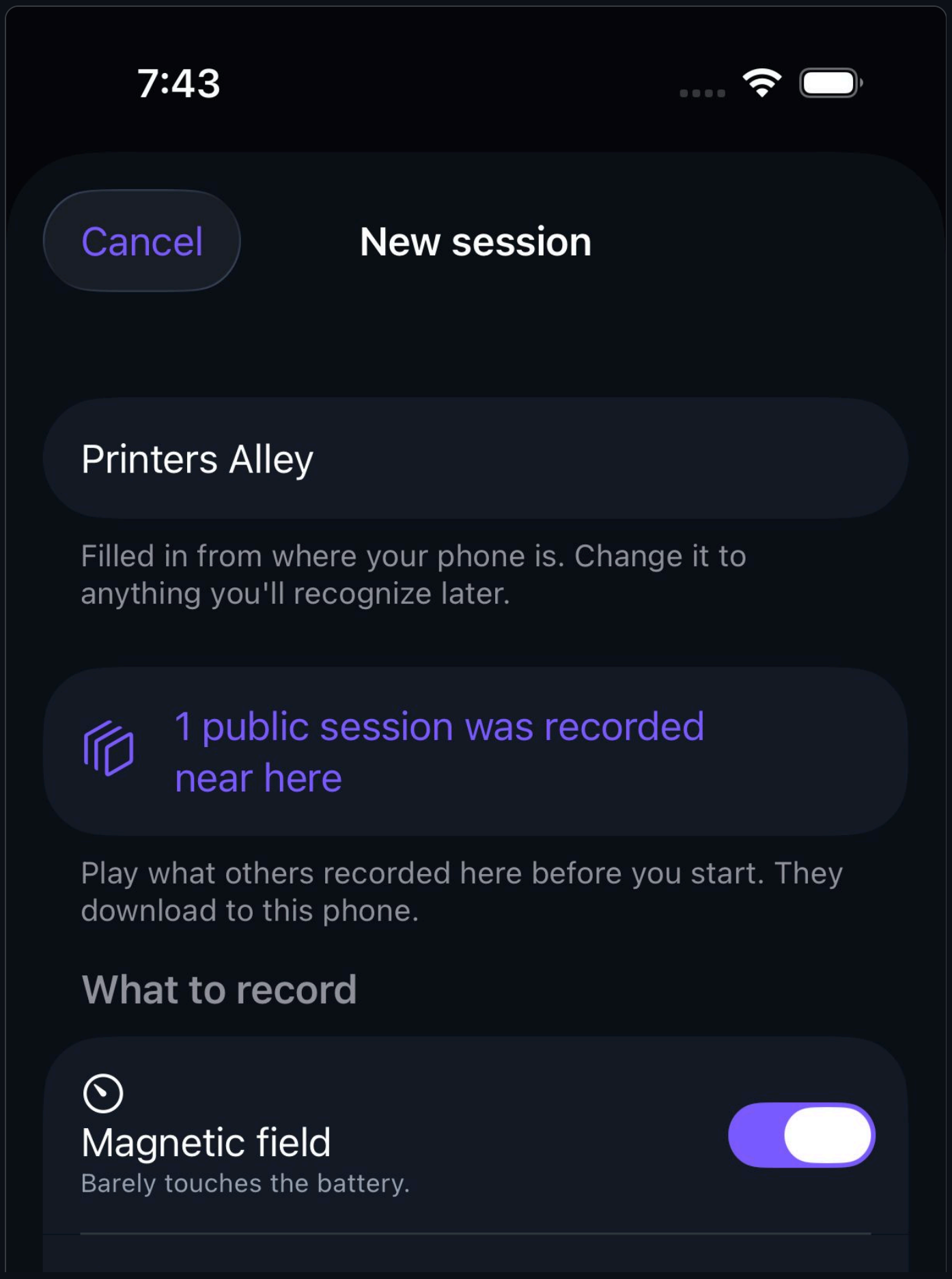
Sessions other people published at public places — near you, or by searching a place or a town.

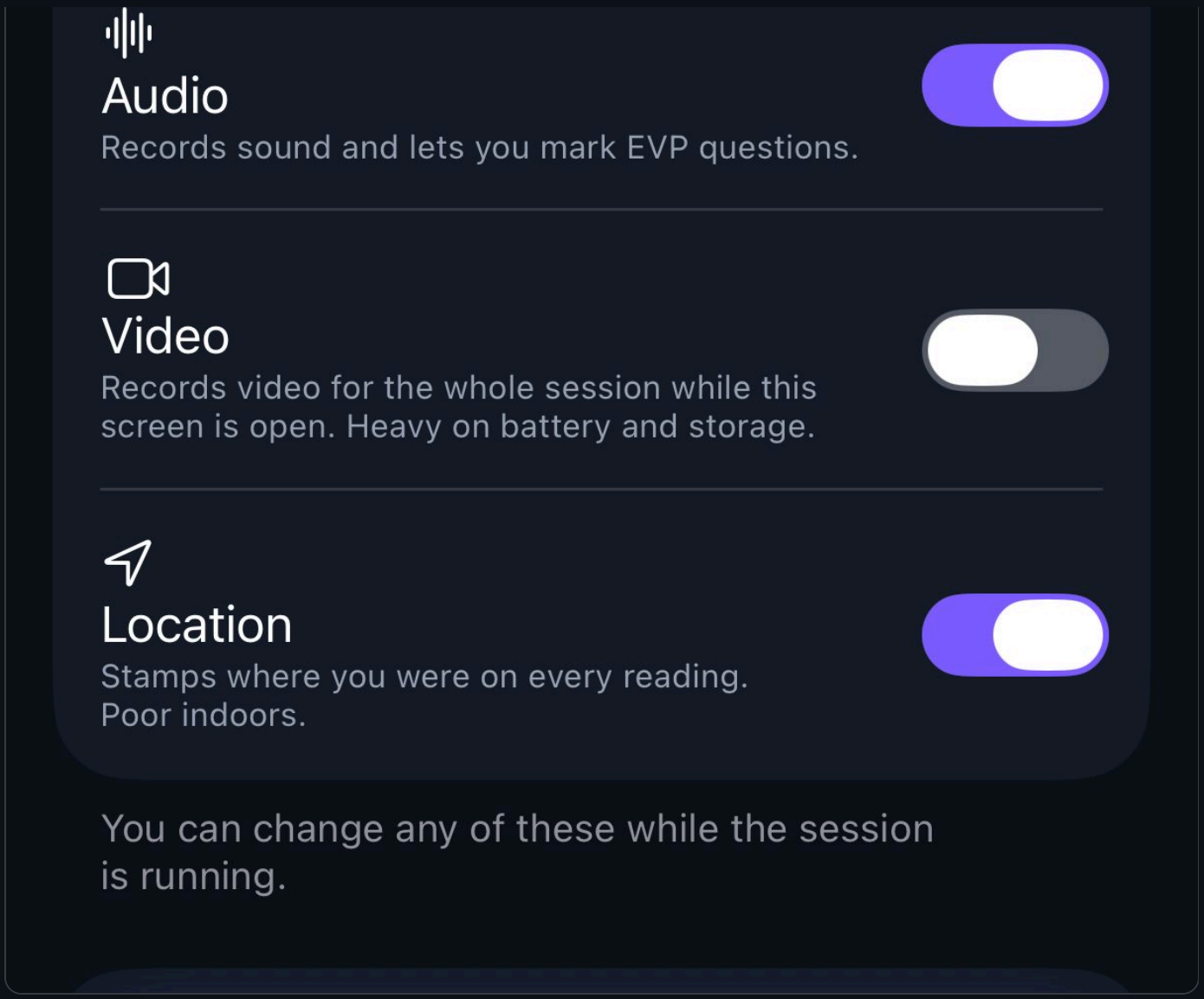
Sessions



Your first session, start to finish

1. Open the **Paranormal** tab and tap **Start a session**. If a session is still open, the app asks first. One that's recording is **saved** — stopped and kept with your other sessions. One that was set up but never started is replaced, since nothing was recorded in it.
2. **Where are you?** If the app can use your location, it fills this in for you: the name of a known place within a quarter of a mile, or otherwise the street address the phone reads. Other nearby places are listed underneath, one tap each. It's only a suggestion — change it to anything you'll recognize next week. If you've never allowed location, **Use my location** asks for it. If you turned location off, type where you are; **Open Settings** is right beside it. Indoors, the phone sometimes can't find a position at all. After a few seconds the sheet says so, and **Try again** asks once more.
3. If you're signed in and on an investigation, pick it. Investigations **here** and **today** are listed first and labeled that way, and if exactly one is both, it's already chosen for you. If you're not on one, leave this blank; you can attach the session to an investigation later. Once a session is sent to an investigation, it stays with it, even if you send it again. If other people have published sessions recorded nearby, the sheet says how many — tap it to play what they found before you start.


7:43
Cancel
New session
Printers Alley
Filled in from where your phone is. Change it to anything you'll recognize later.
1 public session was recorded near here
Play what others recorded here before you start. They download to this phone.
What to record
Magnetic field
Barely touches the battery.



4. Under **What to record**, choose the channels: magnetic field, sound, video and location, each showing how much battery it uses. Magnetic field, sound and location start on, and **video starts off**, because video is the one most likely to cut your night short. You can change all four later while the session is running.
5. Tap **Open the session**. The live screen opens, but **nothing is being recorded yet** — the gauge runs so you can check the room, and the bar says *not started*. Take your time here.
6. Set up. Name the room, switch channels on or off, and once the room has settled for a few seconds, tap **Set base**. Everything you record is measured against what this room reads when nothing is happening, so it's much better to set this before you start than after.
7. Tap **Start**. The clock starts, readings begin coming in, and the Mark, Note, EVP and capture buttons appear. They aren't shown before Start, because a mark needs a moment on the clock to belong to.
8. Work. Tap **Mark** whenever something happens, or **Note** to add a line about it.
9. Tap **Stop** when you're done. The session is saved and opens for review right away. **Start another session** at the top of the review begins the next one with the same settings — same place, same investigation, same channels. Going back from the review takes you to the Paranormal Platform, not to the instruments of a session that's over.

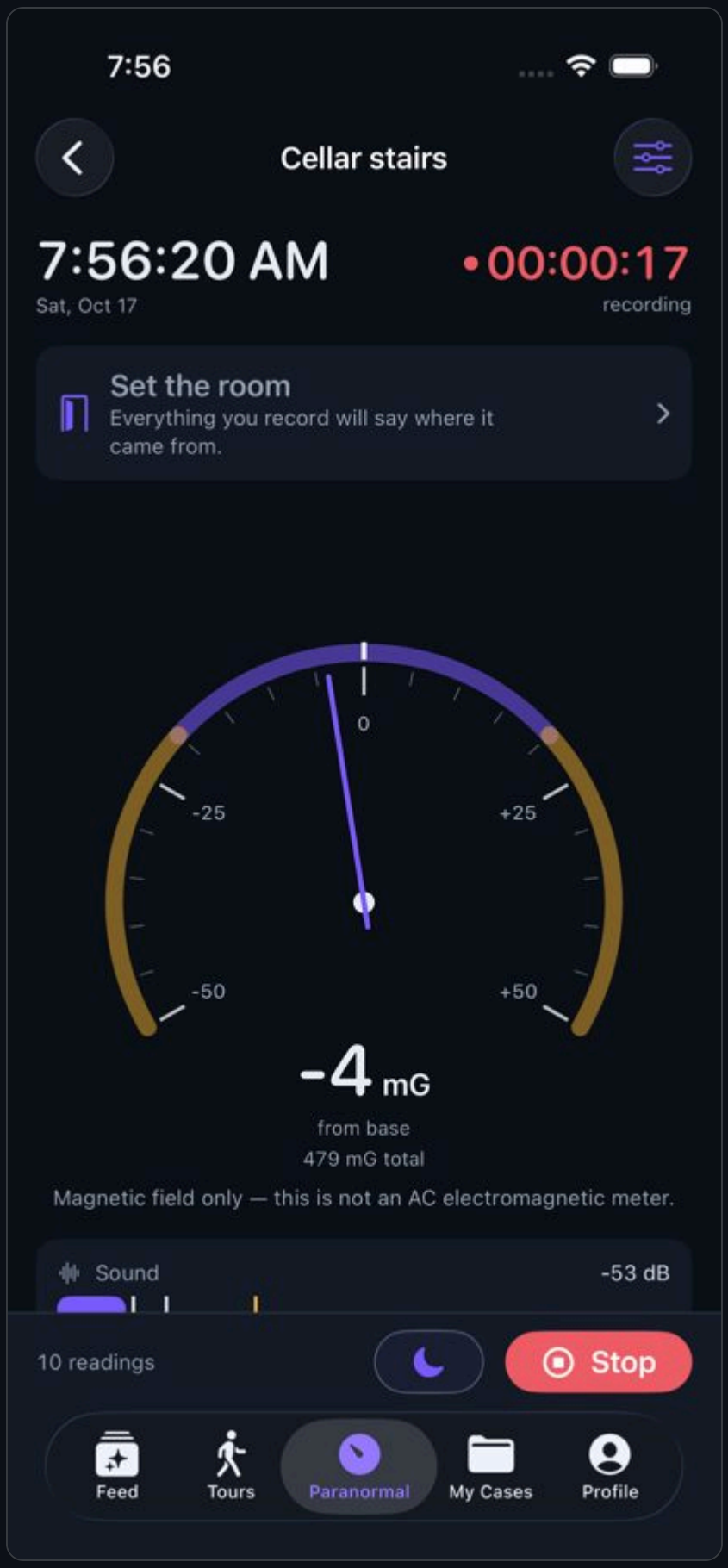
If the night turns out to be nothing before you ever press Start, tap **Discard** next to the Start button. The session is removed and its space is freed right away. A session that was set up but never started also survives the app being closed: it comes back exactly as it was, ready to start or discard. It isn't marked as interrupted, because nothing was lost.

Nothing you record needs a signal, and nothing leaves the phone until you send it.

What it measures, and what it does not

The dial is a **magnetic field meter**, not an EMF meter in the sense most detectors mean. The phone's magnetometer reads the DC magnetic field — the Earth's, plus whatever nearby wiring, iron and motors are doing to it. It can't detect the AC electromagnetic fields a K-II style detector responds to, and the app says so on screen so nobody assumes otherwise.

The needle shows **how far the field has moved from the base level you set**, not the absolute figure. An absolute reading means nothing on its own: the Earth's field alone is around 500 mG, and every building distorts it. Setting a base is what turns a number into a measurement, which is why several features won't work until you've set one.


7:56
Cellar stairs
7:56:20 AM
Sat, Oct 17
•00:00:17
recording
Set the room
Everything you record will say where it came from.
0
-25
+25
-50
+50
-4 mG
from base
479 mG total
Magnetic field only — this is not an AC electromagnetic meter.
Sound
-53 dB
10 readings
Stop
Feed
Tours
Paranormal
My Cases
Profile

The screen shows all of this at once: the time of day and how long the session has been running, the dial in milligauss, a sound meter in decibels with your base and report levels marked on it, and where you are — **with how accurate that position is**. Indoors, a phone's position is routinely 20 to 50 meters off, often the width of the whole building, so the accuracy is always shown. A reading taken without a position fix simply has no position, rather than a made-up one.

If the magnetometer reports that it isn't calibrated, nothing is recorded as an event, and the screen asks you to move the phone in a figure eight. A reading the instrument doesn't trust isn't evidence.

Choosing what a session records

There are four channels: **magnetic field**, **audio**, **video** and **location**. Each one shows what it costs. You choose them on the **New session** sheet before the session opens, and the same switches are on the running session's screen under *Recording*. Switching one off shuts it down completely rather than leaving it running quietly in the background — which is exactly why you'd switch video off at two in the morning.

Turning on a channel that needs permission asks for it right then. If iOS has never asked, turning on video, audio or location brings up its prompt straight away. If you said no — then or earlier — the switch stays off rather than turning on and recording nothing. The app tells you and offers to open **Settings**, where IsHaunted's camera, microphone and location switches are. iOS only ever asks once; after you say no, Settings is the only place to change your mind. The same applies to the **Sound** and **Movement in the camera's view** watches when you leave the device in a room.

The app asks for the microphone while the session is still waiting, not when you press Start, so your first session doesn't lose its opening seconds to the prompt.

Video starts **off**. When it's on, the camera **records the whole session** at 720p, from the moment you press Start until you press Stop, with a viewfinder on the running session's screen to aim with. It records picture only: the sound comes from the session's own audio recording, which keeps running alongside it, and the two play back together. Video is heavy — about **45 MB a minute**, so ten minutes is around 450 MB — and it's the channel most likely to cut your night short, which is why it starts off. It only records while the session's screen is open. If you leave the screen or put the app away, the video stops at that point and starts again when you come back.

The **Photo** button takes a photo of whatever the camera sees, without leaving the app. With video on, it captures what the viewfinder shows right then; with video off, a viewfinder opens so you can frame the shot, then closes itself afterward. You can always take photos, whichever channels are on.

Sound is recorded louder than the phone hears it. The sound meter reads the microphone as it is, so its numbers stay accurate. The recording, though, is saved with a steady boost — the same for the whole night — so you can hear a voice from across the room on playback. It's a fixed boost rather than the phone's automatic level control, which turns up the hiss during every quiet stretch, and that rising hiss is exactly the kind of sound that gets mistaken for a voice.

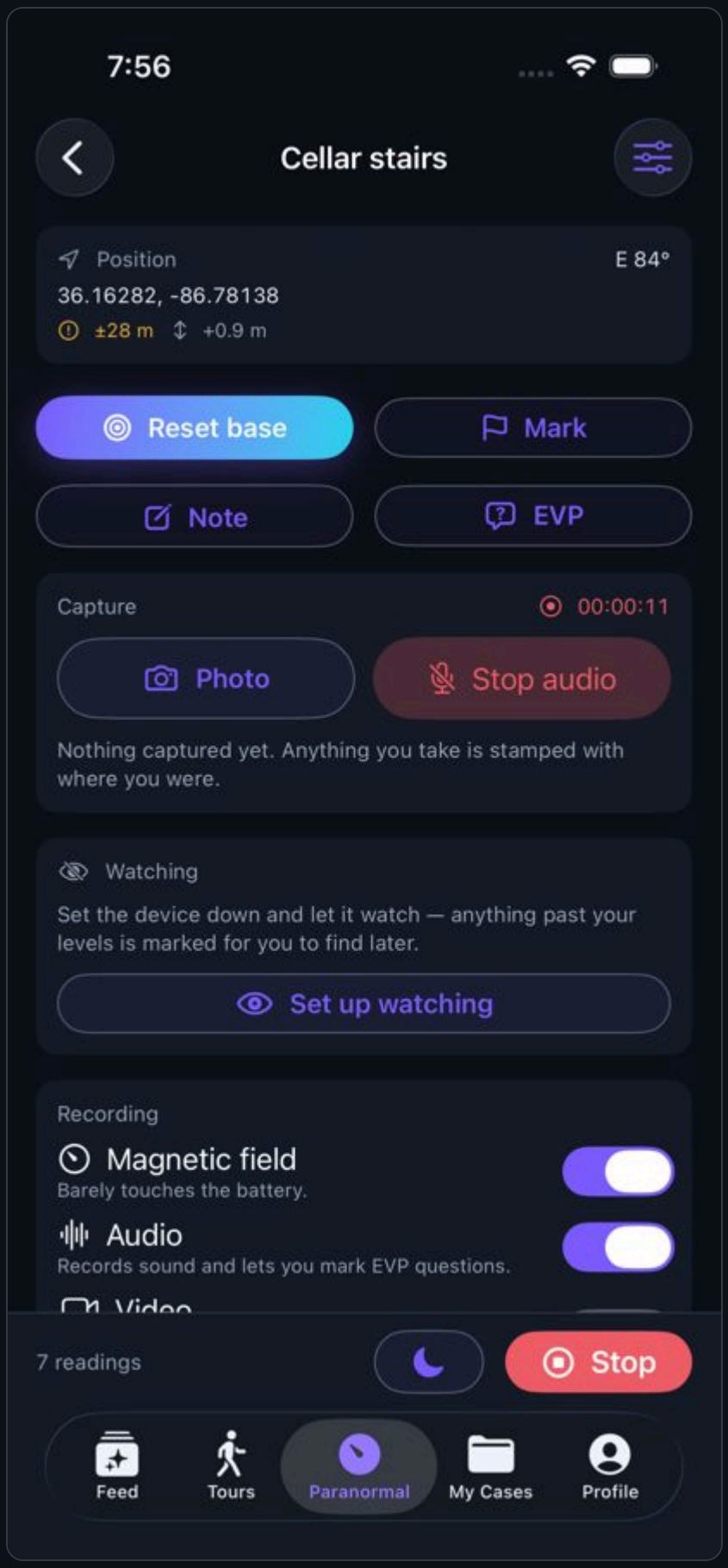
Watch for motion

With video on, **Watch for motion** (under the viewfinder) has the camera look for movement in the frame **whenever the phone is still** — set down on a table or propped in a doorway — while the video keeps recording. Anything moving in view is marked *Motion detected* and **photographed on the spot**, and the viewfinder shows the same sign for a few seconds. While the phone is being carried or turned, motion isn't checked at all: when the phone moves, everything it sees changes, and that's the phone, not the room. It's on by default, and the app remembers if you turn it off.

On the review screen, and in the website's player, the video is outlined and *Motion detected* appears for three seconds at each of those moments, and the photo taken then glows in the strip.

If you put the app away

A session **with sound on** keeps going when you switch to another app, go to the home screen or lock the phone. The sound and every reading keep recording while the phone is in your pocket, because recording sound is what keeps the app running. With sound off, nothing keeps going: iOS pauses the app a few seconds after it leaves the screen, and readings stop until you come back. The camera never keeps going — iOS takes it away from any app that isn't on screen — and it comes back as soon as you do. The video recorded up to that point is kept, and a new section begins when you're back. Either way, the time you were away is marked on the review, from *App put away* to *Back in the app*, with a line saying which of these happened, so nobody reviewing the session later mistakes a paused camera for a broken one. The session player on the website shades the same stretch.


7:56
Cellar stairs
Position
E 84°
36.16282, -86.78138
±28 m
+0.9 m
Reset base
Mark
Note
EVP
Capture
00:00:11
Photo
Stop audio
Nothing captured yet. Anything you take is stamped with where you were.
Watching
Set the device down and let it watch — anything past your levels is marked for you to find later.
Set up watching
Recording
Magnetic field
Barely touches the battery.
Audio
Records sound and lets you mark EVP questions.
7 readings
Stop
Feed
Tours
Paranormal
My Cases
Profile

Saying which room you're in

At the top of the session screen is the **room**. Tap it and pick one, and everything from that moment on — every reading, every mark, every photo — is recorded as having happened there. Changing rooms takes one tap and adds a mark of its own, so when you review a week later you can see when you went down to the cellar.

It's worth doing because **nothing else can tell rooms apart**. Indoors, a position is only accurate to within twenty to fifty meters — the width of the whole building — so the app can't work out which room you're in, and it doesn't pretend to. You telling it is the only reliable way.

Rooms you've already used in this session appear first in the list, so walking a loop through a house is one tap per room instead of typing names again in the dark. You can stop naming rooms at any time; readings keep their position and just stop being tied to a room.

Marking, and setting the level things get marked at

Mark adds a marker at this exact second; **Note** adds one with a line of explanation. Under *Levels* you set the base and the **report level** — how far the field or the sound has to change before the app marks it for you — along with a quiet period, so one slamming door creates one record instead of forty.

Notes you can speak

Writing in the dark with a glove off is the worst part of taking notes, so **Note** lets you speak instead. Your words are turned into text **on the phone itself** — nothing you say is sent anywhere, and it works with no signal, which is what makes it useful in a cellar.

You can correct the wording before saving. A transcription is only the phone's best guess, and you know best what you actually said.

If a device can't turn speech into text without a connection, **the option isn't offered at all**, because a button that works in the parking lot but fails inside the building would be worse than none. You can always type, or record the note **as audio** instead — sometimes how something was said matters more than what was said.

You get the same choice when messaging your group about a case: type it, or speak it on any device that can transcribe offline.

Photographs of the property

Photos you take during a session are kept with it. Under **Property photos**, you can choose one to represent the place — the front of the building, the room in question. It's used for the case and the investigation, so a list of cases shows something recognizable instead of a row of identical folders.

Choosing one is entirely optional and can be undone: tap the chosen photo again to unselect it. Most photos in a session are evidence, not pictures meant to represent the place, so nothing is chosen unless you choose it.

Each photo records the **room** you were in when you took it, so a month later, when it matters, "a doorway" reads as "Cellar — a doorway". That comes from the room you set on the session screen; there's nothing extra to type for each photo.

Leaving the device in a room

Watching sets up the session to record events while nobody is holding the phone. It can watch for changes in the magnetic field, sound, **the device itself being moved** (someone bumping the tripod) and **movement seen through the camera**. Those last two answer different questions, and the app explains which is which. Camera motion detection is deliberately simple — it can't tell a person from a curtain — so you can adjust its sensitivity, and every trigger records how much of the view changed. Like Watch for motion, it only checks the camera while the phone is still.

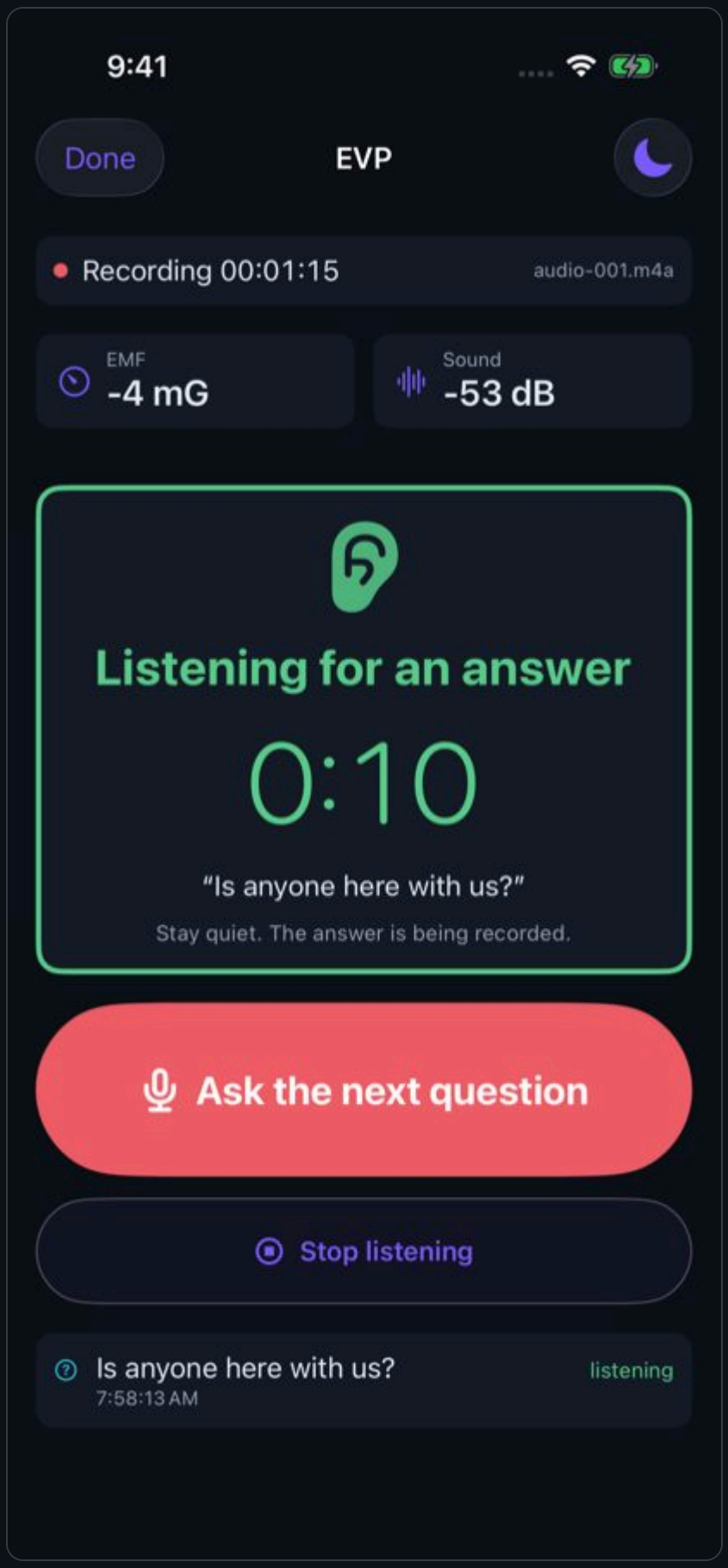
You can't start watching until the base levels the triggers measure against have been set. The screen stays awake while watching so you can read it from across the room.

EVP question and answer

EVP mode marks the **question and the silence after it**, not just the moment you spoke. Both marks point to the exact spot in the recording, so reviewing later means working through a list of places to listen instead of scrubbing through hours of audio. Asking the next question ends the previous wait. Recording keeps running when the screen locks.

One large button takes you through it, and always says what pressing it will do: **Ask a question**, then **Done asking — listening** when you've finished speaking, then **Ask the next question**. The screen shows red while you ask, with the question as it's written down, and green while you listen, with how long the room has had to answer. The magnetic field and sound readings stay on screen the whole time. You can type the question as you ask it, or cancel a question you didn't ask after all.

On iPhone Duo, the microphone in the side column takes the same three steps without leaving the session: press it when you start to ask, and the phone writes down what you say if typing is on (in the session's levels; it happens on the phone, and nothing is sent). Press it again to stop writing and start listening, and a strip across the top counts how long the room has had to answer. Press it again for the next question, or **Done listening** when you've finished. The strip names the next step on a button of its own and shows the readings too.


9:41
Done
EVP
Recording 00:01:15
audio-001.m4a
EMF
-4 mG
Sound
-53 dB
Listening for an answer
0:10
"Is anyone here with us?"
Stay quiet. The answer is being recorded.
Ask the next question
Stop listening
Is anyone here with us?
7:58:13 AM
listening

Blacking out the screen

A lit phone in a dark room affects the recording, the room and everyone in it. The moon button turns the screen black and keeps the phone awake; tap anywhere to bring it back. Your brightness goes back to exactly where it was.

Reviewing what you recorded

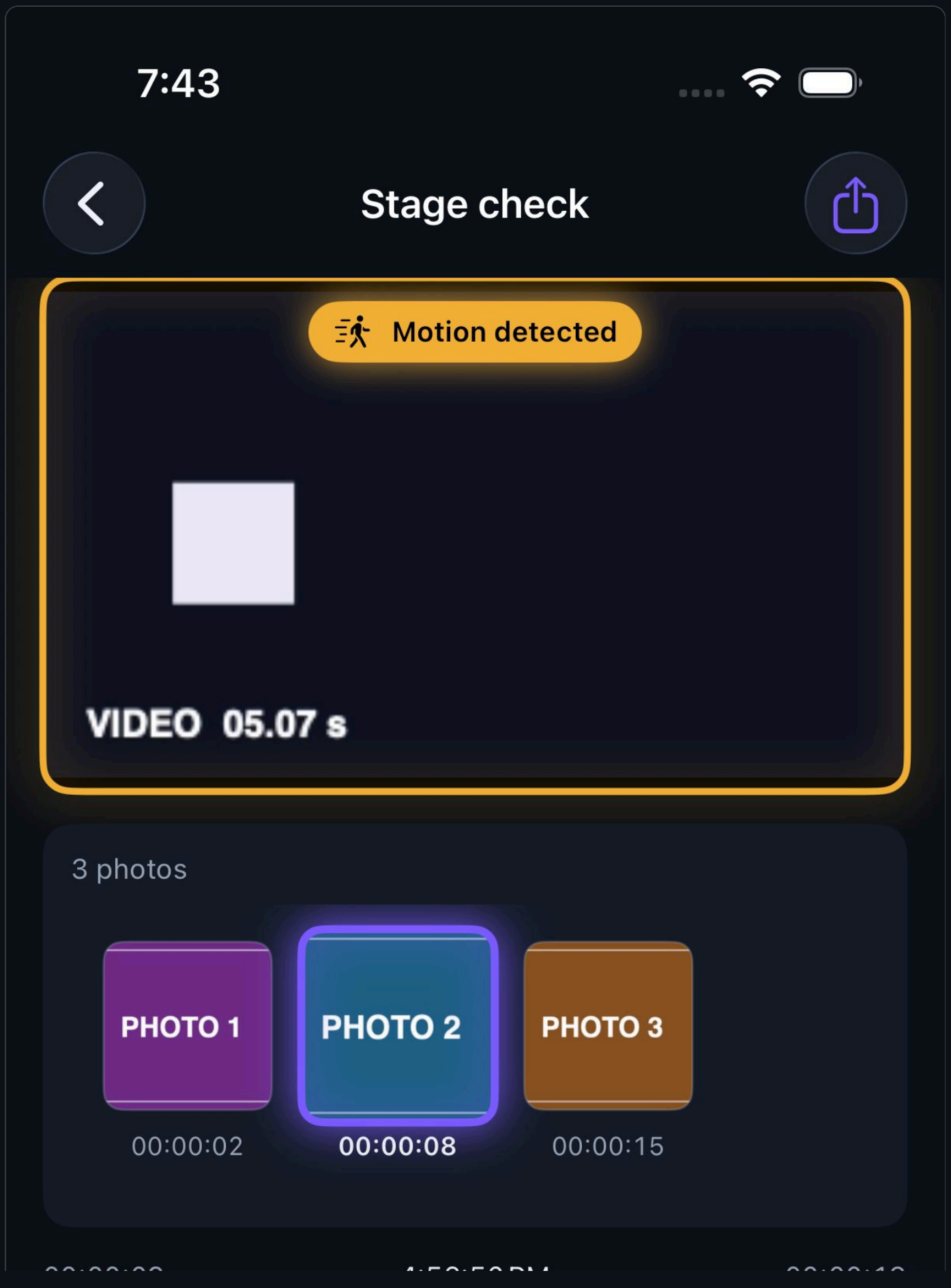
A finished session plays back on the phone: one playhead moves through the magnetic trace, the map, the compass and whatever was being recorded at that second, with every mark listed so you can jump to it. Jumping to a mark takes you a few seconds *before* the event, so you hear what led up to it, and the mark playback is passing lights up in the list. Press Play where nothing was recorded and playback starts at the next recording.

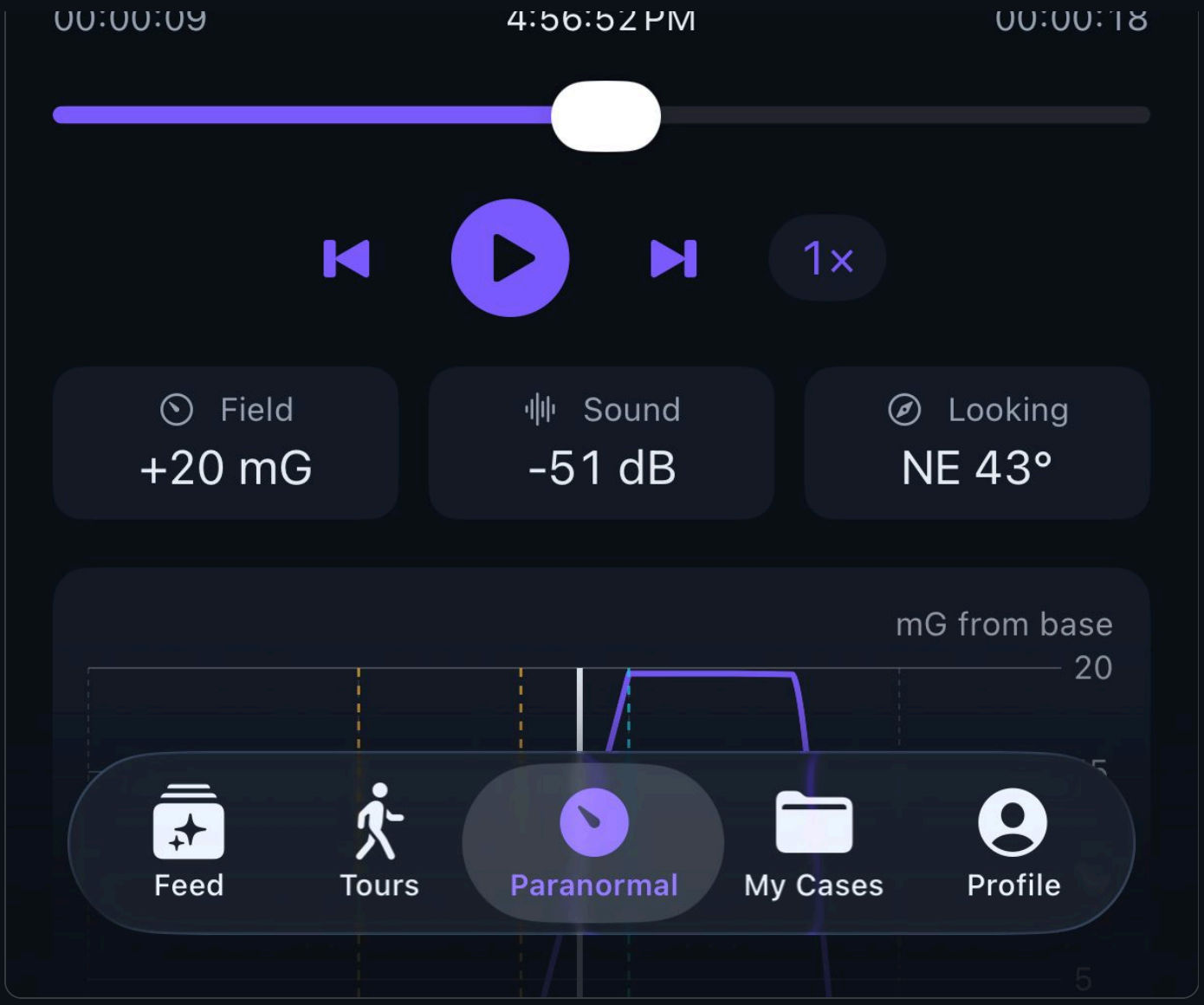
The video plays **with the session's sound**. Playback uses the phone's speaker at full volume, and it plays even when your phone is switched to silent.

Photos taken during the session appear in a **strip of thumbnails** under the player. As playback reaches the moment each one was taken, its border glows and it grows a little for three seconds. **Tap a thumbnail** to go to the moment it was taken and see the photo full size; tap it again to put it back in the strip, and playback carries on from there. Photos taken indoors without a position are in the strip too — the map only shows the ones that have one.

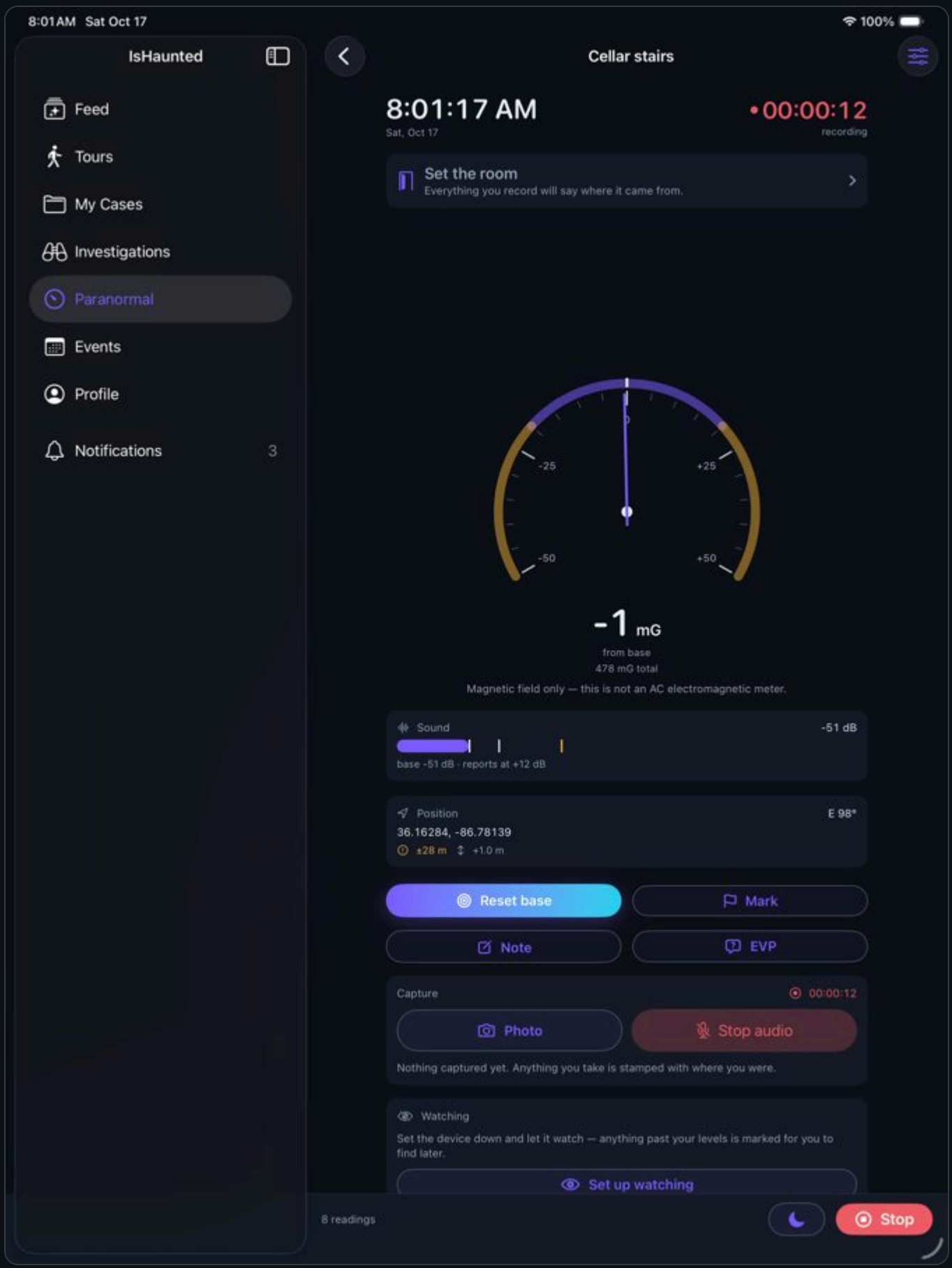
On the map, the arrow turns smoothly to show which way the phone was facing, and the map keeps the marker in view as it moves. If you move or zoom the map yourself, it stays where you put it until you tap **Recenter**.

Adding details to a mark. In the dark you tap "Cold spot" and keep going; afterwards you can say more. Until the session is sent, each mark in the review has **Add details**: write or say what happened, who else noticed, how long it lasted. What was recorded at the moment never changes: the time, the kind of mark and anything said then. Your details are kept beside it, marked as added after the session, and go with the session when you send it. Once it's sent, it can't be changed; the website shows the details under the mark and doesn't edit them. Only text can be added: no new marks, photos or recordings.

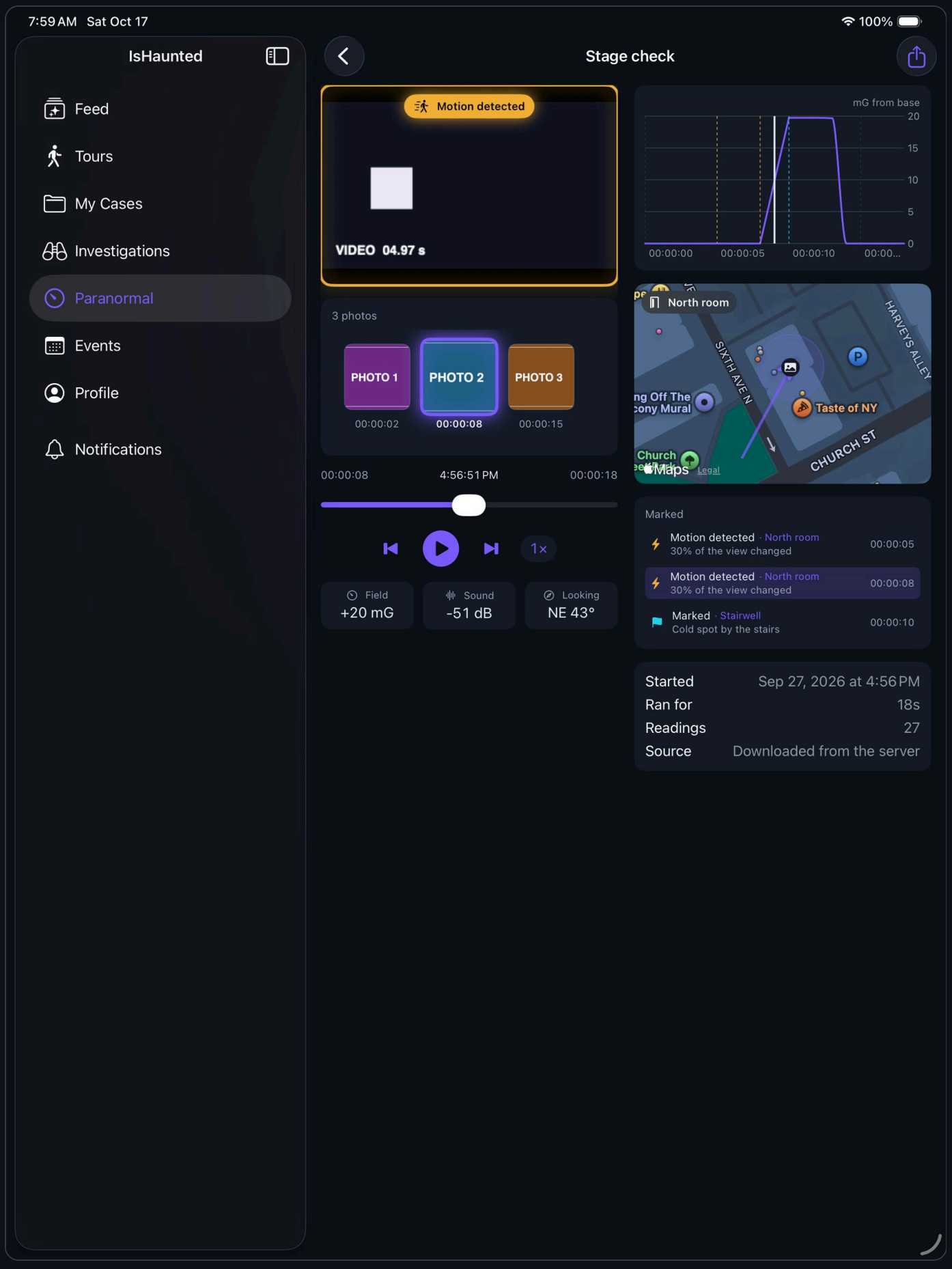

7:43
Stage check
Motion detected
VIDEO 05.07 s
3 photos
PHOTO 1
PHOTO 2
PHOTO 3
00:00:02
00:00:08
00:00:15



On an iPad, the same screens use the extra width. While you're recording, the instruments sit beside the log.


8:01 AM Sat Oct 17
100%
IsHaunted
Feed
Tours
My Cases
Investigations
Paranormal
Events
Profile
Notifications
3
Cellar stairs
8:01:17 AM
Sat, Oct 17
•00:00:12
recording
Set the room
Everything you record will say where it came from.
-25
+25
-50
+50
-1 mG
from base
478 mG total
Magnetic field only — this is not an AC electromagnetic meter.
Sound
-51 dB
base -51 dB · reports at +12 dB
Position
E 98°
36.16284, -86.78139
±28 m
+1.0 m
Reset base
Mark
Note
EVP
Capture
00:00:12
Photo
Stop audio
Nothing captured yet. Anything you take is stamped with where you were.
Watching
Set the device down and let it watch — anything past your levels is marked for you to find later.
Set up watching
8 readings
Stop

While you're reviewing, the trace sits beside the map, so you can see a spike and where it happened at the same time, without scrolling.


7:59 AM Sat Oct 17
100%
IsHaunted
Feed
Tours
My Cases
Investigations
Paranormal
Events
Profile
Notifications
Stage check
Motion detected
VIDEO 04.97 s
mG from base
20
15
10
5
0
00:00:00
00:00:05
00:00:10
00:00...
3 photos
PHOTO 1
PHOTO 2
PHOTO 3
00:00:02
00:00:08
00:00:15
00:00:08
4:56:51 PM
00:00:18
1×
Field
+20 mG
Sound
-51 dB
Looking
NE 43°
North room
SIXTH AVE N
HARVEYS ALLEY
Taste of NY
CHURCH ST
Maps
Legal
Marked
Motion detected · North room
30% of the view changed
00:00:05
Motion detected · North room
30% of the view changed
00:00:08
Marked · Stairwell
Cold spot by the stairs
00:00:10
Started
Sep 27, 2026 at 4:56 PM
Ran for
18s
Readings
27
Source
Downloaded from the server

Battery, storage and a long night

A session logging the magnetic field and position uses very little. Audio adds a steady trickle — about a megabyte a minute. Video is the one that can cut a night short: about 45 MB a minute of storage and a steady drain on the battery, which is why it's off unless you turn it on.

The readings themselves are tiny — a five-hour session is a few megabytes of numbers. It's the recordings that fill up a phone, and they're the only thing that clearing a session removes.

If something goes wrong

The dial says the magnetometer needs calibrating. Move the phone slowly in a figure eight. Nothing is recorded as an event until it settles, because a reading the instrument doesn't trust shouldn't set anything off.

Nothing is being marked. Check that you've set a base level, and that the session is *watching* if you've put the device down. Without a base, there's nothing to measure a change against.

The position never appears. Indoors, a phone often can't get a position at all. The session carries on without it; readings simply have no position instead of a guessed one.

A recording came back empty. The app tells you instead of listing it — usually because another app was using the microphone. Start it again.

Something you switched on says it isn't allowed. iOS asks once for the camera, the microphone, your location and speech recognition, and never asks again after you say no. When you turn on something that needs one of these, the app tells you which one is off and offers **Open Settings**, which goes straight to IsHaunted's page there. Turn it on and come back. The microphone in particular is checked before recording starts: without it, a recording would be silent, so the app won't start recording and tells you why.

The app closed mid-session. The session survives. It's listed as *interrupted*, with everything recorded up to that moment intact. Its end time is marked as unknown, since there's no way to know exactly when it stopped.

Sending a session to your group

Recording works offline, but **sending needs a connection**. Once you have one, choose the investigation the session belongs to — which also chooses its case — and pick which recordings to include.

Everything you check is uploaded together as **one `.ben` file** — the readings, the marks and the recordings, sealed with a checksum of every part. If the connection drops, press **Send** again: the server replaces its copy instead of making a second one, and a file that arrives damaged is rejected rather than quietly accepted. On the website, the session appears as that one file, not as a pile of separate uploads.

Who can send a recording to an investigation: anyone who was **on** it, any active **member of the group** running it, and — when the investigation or its case is **public** — anyone at all. An open investigation is an invitation, and a dozen visitors with phones is a big part of the value of running one.

A session doesn't need an investigation at all. Someone scouting a building, or a guide walking a route, can keep it on their own account and attach it to an investigation later.

Once everything is uploaded, the app offers to clear the recordings off the phone. It only offers when **every** file is confirmed on the server. Clearing removes the photos, video and audio but keeps the session, its readings and its marks — those are small, and losing the record of a night just to free up video space would be a poor trade. You can delete individual captures at any time if they're not worth keeping.

Uploaded sessions play back on the website too, with the same single playhead — and the case manager can **cite them in the final report**. A report section of type *Field Sessions* links to the sessions recorded for that case, and the PDF the client receives describes each one: where it was, when it ran, who recorded it, and how many readings and marks it has. Your work in the field ends up in the report itself, not just in the system.

You can also send a session to someone with **no account at all** — a client, or a producer — as a link that expires, can be withdrawn, and tells you whether it was opened. You do that from the session's playback page on the website; see *Working a case* for what the link does and doesn't include.

Sending only the part that mattered

In an hour of recording, often only ten seconds matter. On the **Send** screen, under **What to send**, the session appears on a track with a **green dot** at the start and a **red dot** at the end. Drag the green dot to move the in point (where the clip starts) and the red dot to move the out point (where it ends). The time under each dot updates as you drag, and the bolder green band between them is exactly what will be sent.

Below the track you can see what's happening at the handle's position — the field and sound at that moment. **Play what will be sent** plays from the in point to the out point with the recording following along, so what you hear is exactly what the group will get. The list underneath shows what happens to each recording: sent whole, cut to a shorter section, or not sent because it falls outside the window. Readings and marks outside the window aren't sent either.

The full recording stays on this phone. Nothing outside the window leaves the device, and a cut recording is a copy — the original on the phone is never changed. Clearing the phone afterward is a separate choice, offered only once everything has arrived, and it's the only thing that removes the original.

A trimmed session is named to show what it is — **back bedroom (20:00–30:00)**, with the in and out times after the session's own name — on the website's list, in the player and in any report that cites it. A session sent whole keeps its original name.

Send the whole session moves both dots back to the ends.

How much goes at once

There's no limit on your phone. It records for as long as the night needs, at whatever quality the camera gives, and keeps every second of it afterward. The limit is on the **upload**.

One upload can carry **10 minutes of video** and **600 MB in total**. Readings, marks, photos and sound have no time limit — a whole night of instrument readings and audio goes in one send. Only video is limited, because a minute of video takes up more space than an hour of everything else.

Above the Send button, the screen shows how big the selected window is and how much video is in it. If it's over the limit, there are two ways to deal with it, and the screen offers whichever one fits:

- **Too long?** Tap **Send without the video** to send everything else — the readings, marks, sound and photos — in one go, with the video staying on the phone. Or drag the handles in to make a shorter clip, send that, then move the window along and send the next part. You can send as many times as you need, and sending more never changes what you've already sent.
- **Too heavy?** Under **Send the video smaller**, you can send the footage at 1080p or 720p, and at 24 frames a second, with the resulting size shown beside each option. This only changes the copy that's sent; the recording on your phone stays exactly as it was filmed.

Sizes on that screen are estimates. A dark, still room compresses better than the estimate suggests, so the actual upload is usually smaller.

Exporting a session

From a session's review screen, **Export a bundle** saves the whole night as one `.ben` **file** and opens the share sheet, so you can send it to anyone by AirDrop, Messages, Mail or Files. It uses the published IsHaunted device data format — the same one any instrument maker can write — so it can be read outside this app too.

The file carries a **seal**: a checksum of every part, plus the ID of the phone and the account that recorded it. If a copy loses or changes any data along the way, it fails its seal and is refused when opened, instead of opening with pieces missing. The seal identifies which device made the recording; it isn't a signature, and it never includes anyone's name.

Opening a session somebody sent you — or pulling your own back down

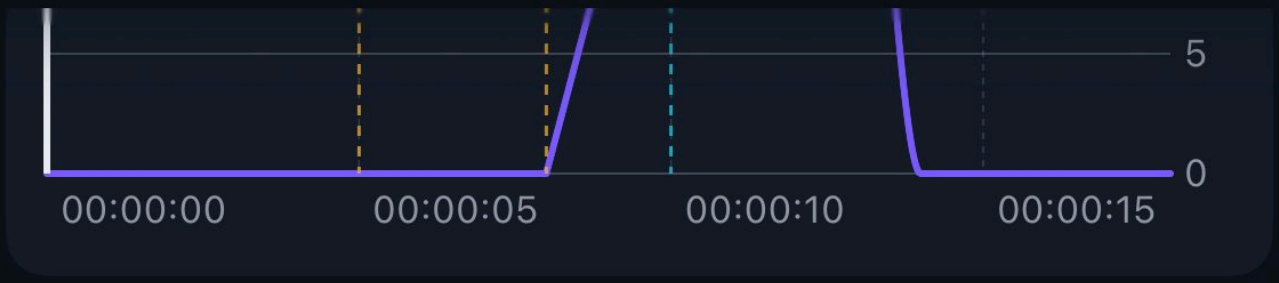
A `.ben` file that reaches your phone opens in the app and **plays exactly as it did for the person who recorded it**: the same trace, map, marks and recordings, with the review screen, replay, trimmer and export all working as if the night had been recorded on your phone. The only difference is a line on the review screen saying where it came from.

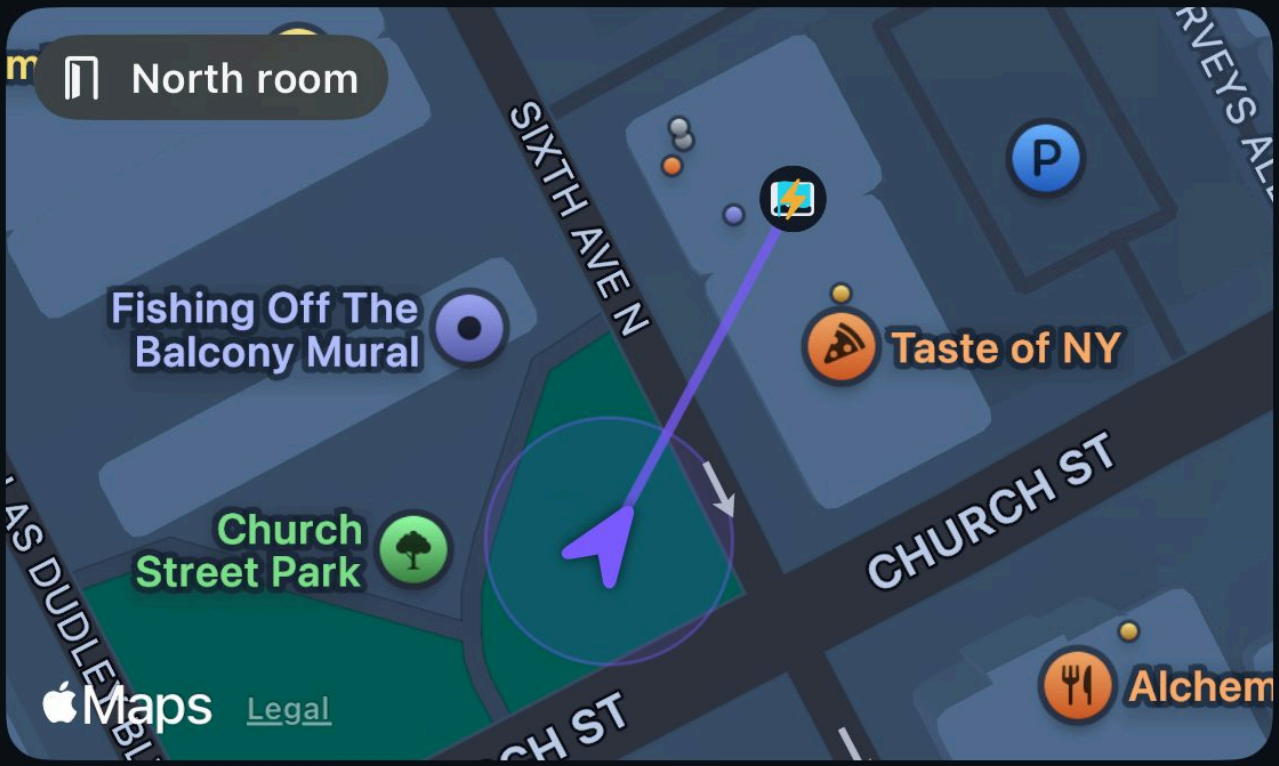
There are three ways to open one, and they all lead to the same place:

- **Tap the file** wherever it arrived — AirDrop, a message, an email attachment, Files — and IsHaunted is offered as the app to open it.
- **Open a .ben file** on the Paranormal Platform screen opens the Files browser, for a file you've already saved.
- **On the server, not on this phone**, further down the Paranormal Platform screen, lists sessions you've uploaded that aren't on this phone — sent from another device, or cleared from this one. **Download** brings the whole night back, and the app knows it's already on the server. Only sessions sent as a single file are offered; anything sent before session files existed is counted underneath and is still on the website.

7:37

Stage check

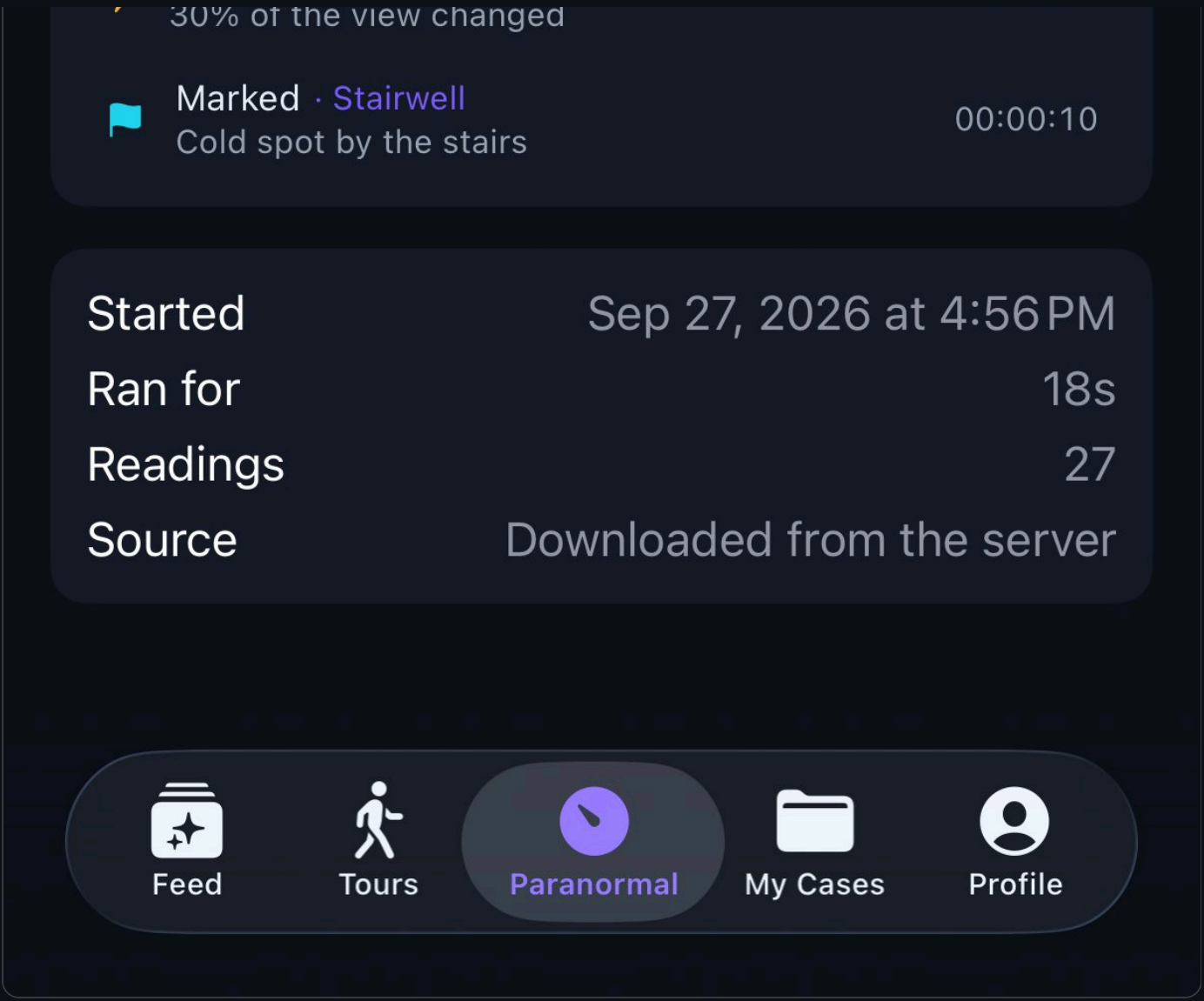




Marked

Motion detected · North room
30% of the view changed
00:00:05

Motion detected · North room
00:00:08



A session that's **already on this phone** isn't imported twice; the app tells you which one it is. Imported sessions show *shared with you*, *from the server*, *opened from a file* or *public archive* under their name in the list, and the review screen's details include a matching **Source** line — so a night someone else handed you is never mistakenly credited to you.

Finding sessions other people published

Find public sessions on the Paranormal Platform screen lists sessions other people have published to the public archive — **near you**, or at a place you **search for** by name or town ("waverly", "louisville"). Each row shows where and when it was recorded, who recorded it and what it contains. **Download** saves it to your phone, where it plays like any other session and is marked *public archive*. The New session sheet also tells you when public sessions have been recorded near where you're standing.

7:43

Public sessions

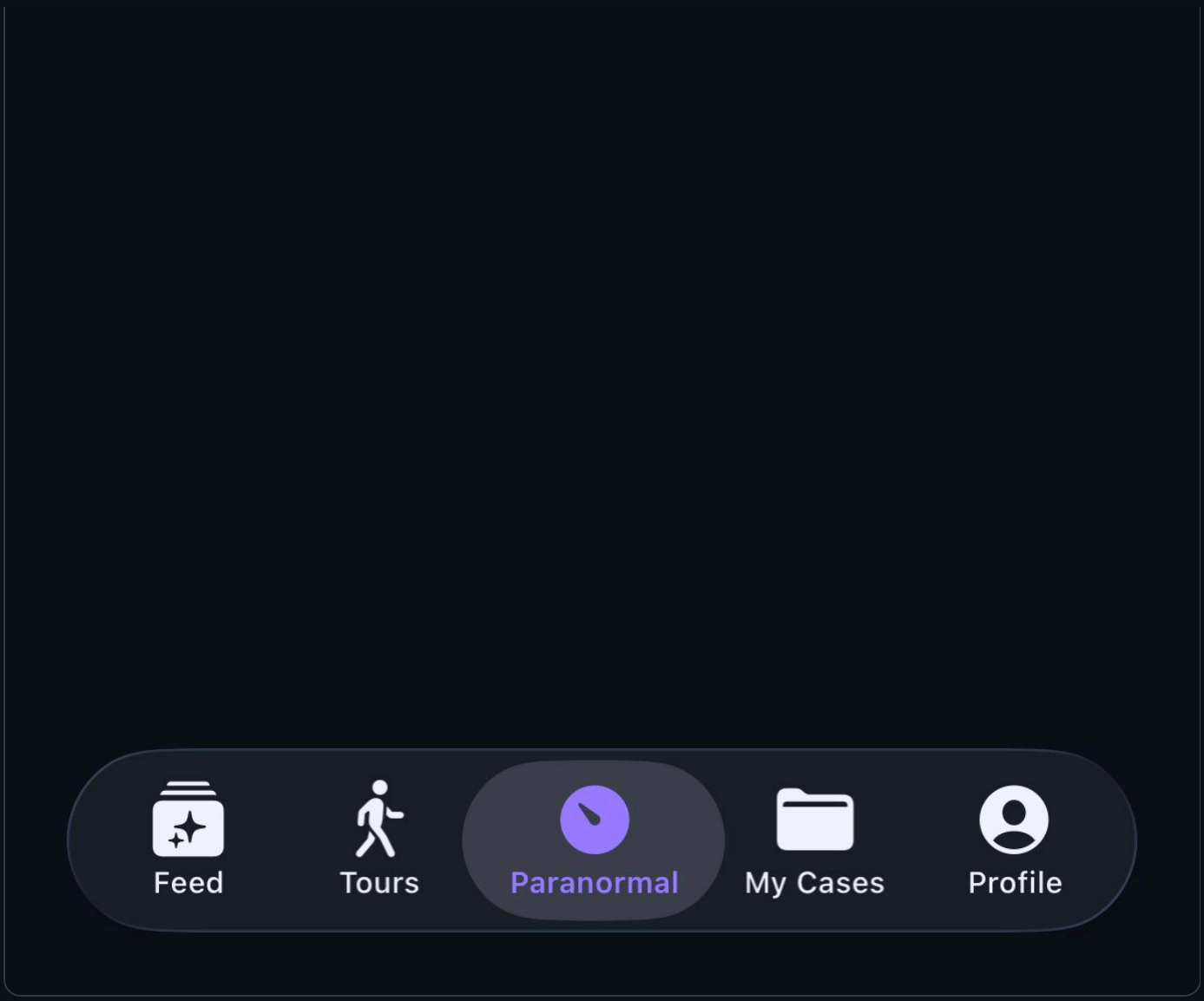
A place or a town

Recorded within 10 miles

Printers Alley

Nashville, TN · 1.9 mi
Sep 27, 2026 at 4:56 PM · by Sarah Mitchell
27 readings · 3 marked · no recordings

Public copies: every position is the place's public point, not where the recorder walked.



What you download is the archive's **public copy**. Its readings, marks, rooms and notes are the recorder's own, but every position is replaced with the place's **public point** — the same approximate location its page on the website shows — so the map shows the place rather than the path they walked. Photos and recordings are included only once they've been approved for the archive. Location is only needed for *near you*; searching by name works with location off.

When the group's session starts

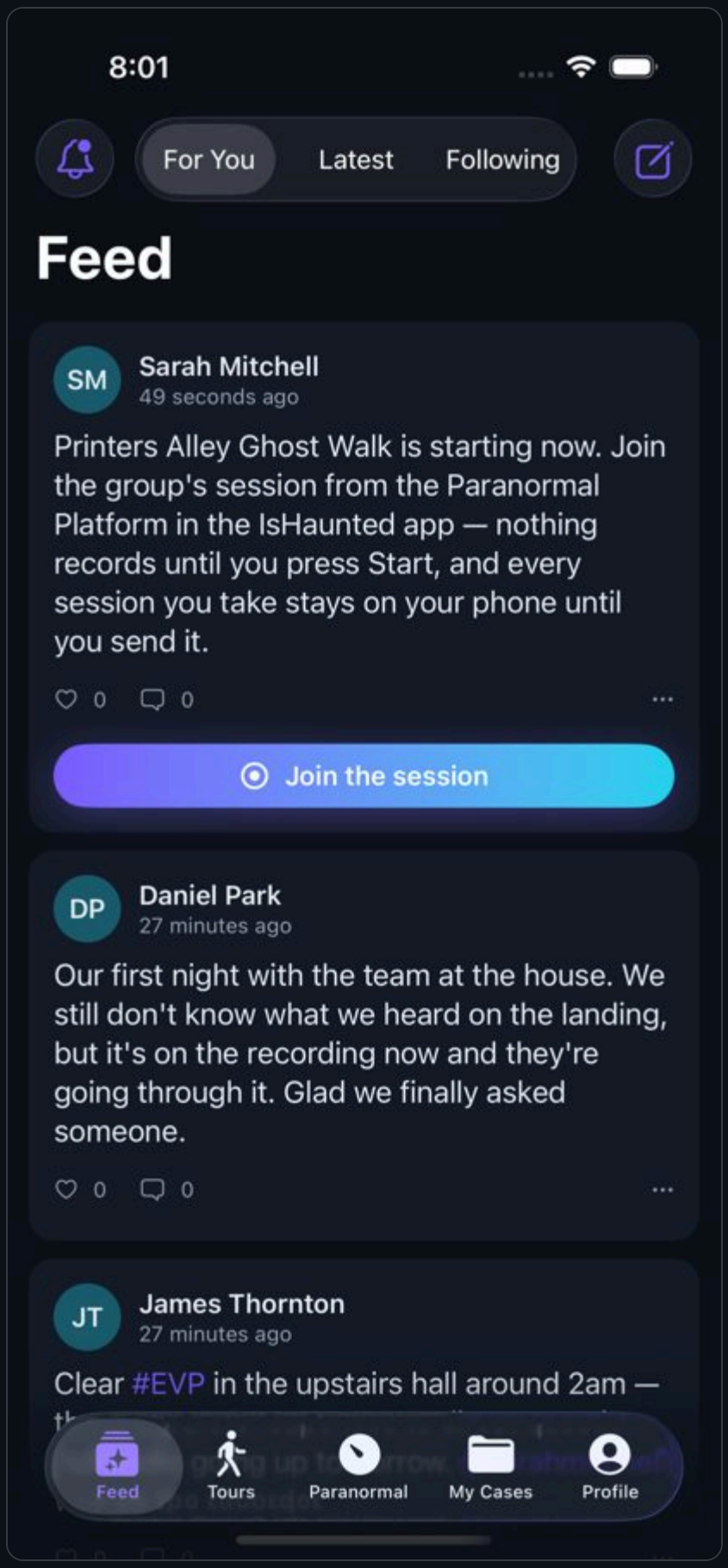
A guide, an event's organizer or the lead of an investigation can start the night for everyone at once from the app or the website. When they do, everyone registered gets a plain notice — *Sessions are now being accepted for this event* — and nobody's phone is taken over: you join when you're ready.

Joining

You'll hear about it in three ways, and each one does the same thing:

- **A notification** — "Printers Alley After Dark is starting". Tap it.
- **A card in your feed** with **Join the session**, in case you missed the notification or have notifications turned off.
- **Happening now**, at the top of the Paranormal Platform, for as long as the session is open.

8:00
Printers Alley Ghost Walk is starting
now
Sarah Mitchell started the group's session.
Tap to join it in the Paranormal Platform.
Fitness
Watch
Contacts
Files
Preview
Utilities
IsHaunted
Search

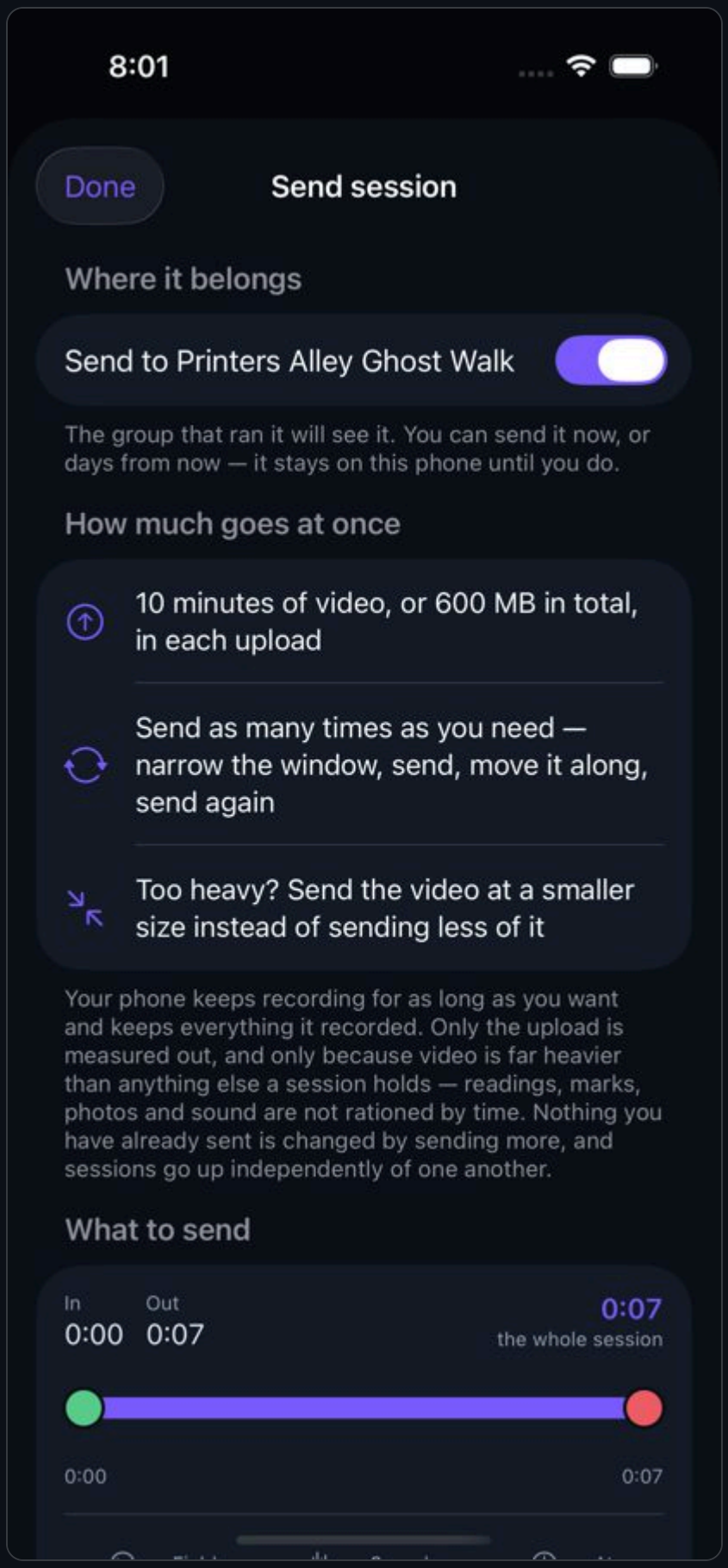

8:01
For You
Latest
Following
Feed
SM
Sarah Mitchell
49 seconds ago
Printers Alley Ghost Walk is starting now. Join the group's session from the Paranormal Platform in the IsHaunted app — nothing records until you press Start, and every session you take stays on your phone until you send it.
0
0
Join the session
DP
Daniel Park
27 minutes ago
Our first night with the team at the house. We still don't know what we heard on the landing, but it's on the recording now and they're going through it. Glad we finally asked someone.
0
0
JT
James Thornton
27 minutes ago
Clear #EVP in the upstairs hall around 2am —
Feed
Tours
Paranormal
My Cases
Profile

Join opens the Paranormal Platform straight into a session that's already set up for the tour, event or investigation and its location — there's nothing to choose. Nothing records until you press **Start**. You can stop and start another session as often as you like; every session stays on your phone.

The card leaves the feed, and the link stops working, six hours after the night ends.

Sending what you recorded — now, or days later

Your sessions build up on the phone, and each row in the Paranormal Platform says **Sent** or **Not sent**. Send them whenever you're ready — that night, or days later once you've been through them. When you do, the send screen already shows where they're going:


8:01
Done
Send session
Where it belongs
Send to Printers Alley Ghost Walk
The group that ran it will see it. You can send it now, or days from now — it stays on this phone until you do.
How much goes at once
10 minutes of video, or 600 MB in total, in each upload
Send as many times as you need — narrow the window, send, move it along, send again
Too heavy? Send the video at a smaller size instead of sending less of it
Your phone keeps recording for as long as you want and keeps everything it recorded. Only the upload is measured out, and only because video is far heavier than anything else a session holds — readings, marks, photos and sound are not rationed by time. Nothing you have already sent is changed by sending more, and sessions go up independently of one another.
What to send
In
0:00
Out
0:07
0:07
the whole session
0:00
0:07

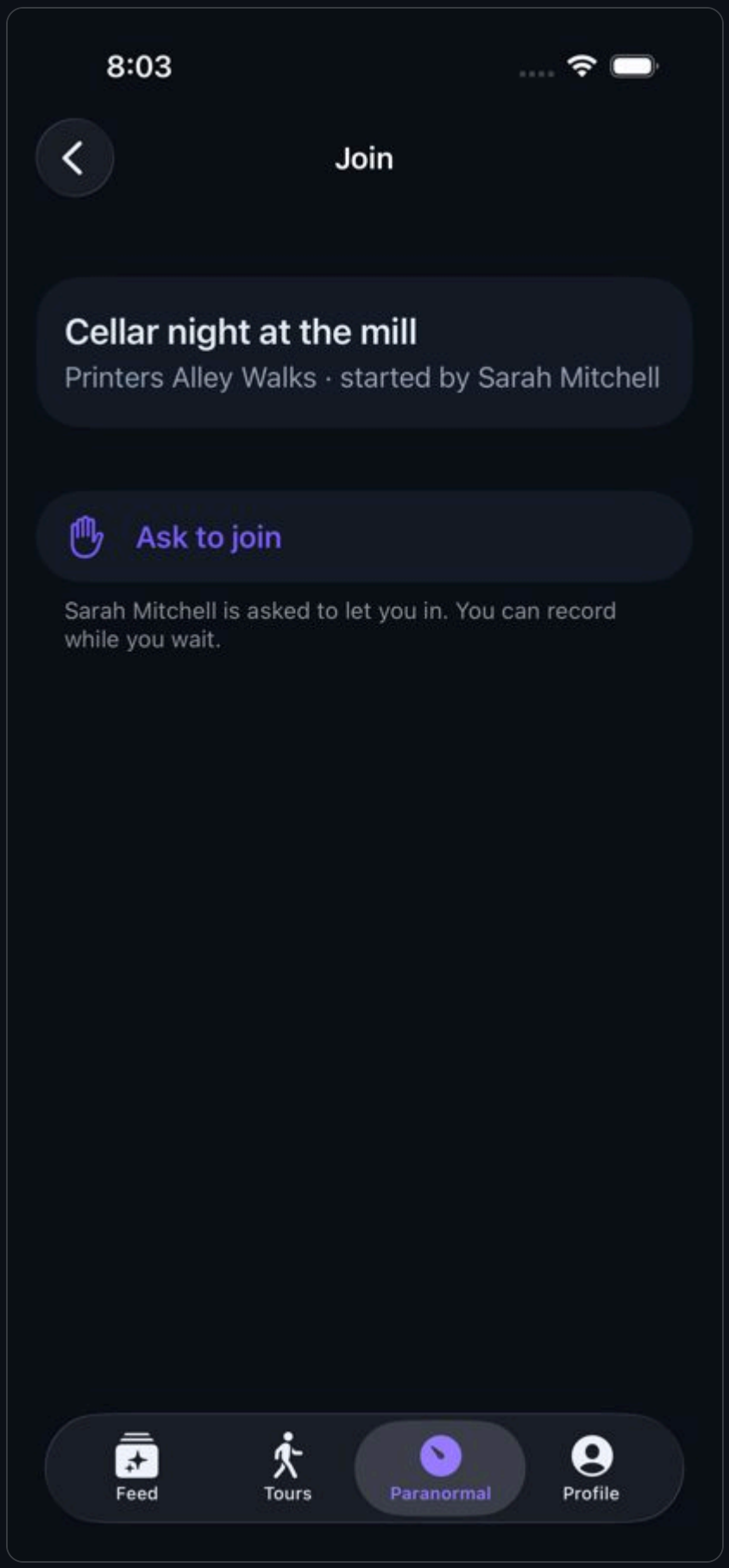
Leave **Send to …** on, and the group that ran it will see it on their page for that date or event. Turn it off to keep it as your own session instead. One upload carries ten minutes of video and 600 MB. A longer night goes in parts — narrow the window, send, move it along, send again — and each part arrives as its own session rather than replacing the last one.

What you send is for the group to see, not the other guests. At an event, **May be shown with the results** lets the organizers also show it on the event's page, where anybody can play it, credited to you. It's off unless you turn it on, and you can change your mind on the website.

Joining by scanning the lead's code

The lead can hold up a QR code. Scan it with your phone's camera:

- **Registered for it** — you're in straight away, as if you'd tapped the card.
- **A public walk or event** — anyone gets straight in; it's open to everyone.
- **A private night** — you sign in and tap **Ask to join**. The lead is notified on their phone and says yes or no. You don't have to wait to record: start a session while they decide. If they let you in, you'll be told, and what you recorded can go to the group. If they say no, it stays yours.


8:03
Join
Cellar night at the mill
Printers Alley Walks · started by Sarah Mitchell
Ask to join
Sarah Mitchell is asked to let you in. You can record while you wait.
Feed
Tours
Paranormal
Profile

A visit to someone's home, or a private client case, never has a code.

Starting it, if you lead

The Paranormal Platform shows **Launch a session for your group** whenever something you lead is on — a tour date you guide, an event you organize, run the door at or were asked to start the sessions for, an investigation you lead or manage. It appears three hours before the start and stays until the end. Tap **Launch** and confirm. The card goes into the feed — for anyone if it's public, or only for the people registered if it isn't — and everyone registered who has the app is notified. The next page tells you how many people that reached.

That page also shows the **QR code** to hold up, and anyone **asking to join**, with **Let in** and **No**. Letting someone in registers them properly — a seat on a walk, a place at an event, a guest pass for an investigation — and notifies their phone. A paid event is never booked this way.

8:03 AM Sat Oct 17

100%

IsHaunted

Feed

Tours

My Cases

Investigations

Paranormal

Events

Profile

Notifications 2

Group session

Cellar night at the mill

Printers Alley Walks

Started by	Sarah Mitchell
Started	8:02 AM
Open until	Oct 17, 2026 at 4:17 PM

Join the session

Opens the Paranormal Platform set up for this, with nothing to choose. Nothing records until you press Start, and every session you take stays on this phone until you send it.

Asking to join

Wren Ashby
Asked 8:03 AM — No — Let in

Hazel Marsh
Asked 8:03 AM — No — Let in

Letting somebody in registers them — a seat on a walk, a place at an event, a guest pass for an investigation — and tells their phone. A paid event is never booked this way.

Join by scanning

Hold this up. Somebody registered is straight in; anybody else signs in and asks, and you say yes or no here.

Launching again within ten minutes doesn't do anything more — everyone already has the card.

Sharing what you found — the field archive

A session normally belongs to you, or to the investigation you recorded it for. There's a third option, and it's what makes the app worth having even without a group.

After a session has been sent, the send screen offers **Add to the public archive**. That puts the session's readings on the page for the place you recorded at, alongside everyone else who has ever recorded there.

Why that is worth doing

One person's readings at a location are a story. The same location recorded by ten people, over years, is something anyone can check. If eleven out of twelve visits show a magnetic anomaly on the same staircase, that's a persistent feature of the building. If only one visit in twelve shows it, it was noise. Normally, everyone's recordings stay on the phone that made them, so there's no other way in this field to tell those two apart.

How it works

1. Send the session as usual.
2. Tap **Add to the public archive**.
3. The app suggests **public locations near where you recorded**, each showing how many sessions are already there. Picking one keeps each location on a single page — otherwise, two people typing the same cave's name slightly differently would create two.
4. Nothing nearby? Type the place's name, and it will still be checked against existing records before a new one is created.

What becomes public, and what does not

- **Your readings, your name, and when you recorded** appear on the location's page.
- **Photos, video and audio** are shared too, and any reader can flag them. A flagged session has its media hidden immediately until a moderator reviews it. The readings stay either way.
- **Public locations only.** A session recorded at someone's home can never be archived. That work stays with you and your group, which is what the paid plans are for. A session sent to a group's investigation can only go in the archive for the place that investigation was at, and never if it was a private engagement.
- **Taking it back requires a paid plan.** Anyone can publish, but only a paid plan lets you remove it afterward. A free account's contribution stays on the location's page — that's what makes the archive worth reading. What a paid plan gives you is the choice to keep your work to yourself in the first place. So think for a moment before you publish for the first time: once people have seen something, it can't be unseen either way.

On the website, the same place page offers more. A public location's page lets you schedule a visit there and post about it. If you don't have a group at all, it offers to set up a private space of your own in one step — free,

and yours. What you record there is public on a free account, exactly like a published session. See Investigating on your own.

How much you can keep

An account without a paid plan can store a limited amount of recorded material. **My field sessions** on the website shows how much you've used, with a bar that turns amber and then red as it fills, so you can see the limit coming instead of finding out when an upload is refused.

If you belong to a group on a paid plan, that covers your storage and the page says so — there's no personal limit to show you.

When you're nearly full, you have two options: remove sessions you no longer need, or join a group on a paid plan. Removing a session frees its space right away.

Deleting a session

My Field Sessions on the website lists everything the app has uploaded, and a session that's yours alone has a delete option beside **Play back**. It asks you to confirm first, and it removes the readings, the recordings and any share link you made for it. This can't be undone.

Three kinds of session can't be deleted there, and the page tells you which:

- **Recorded for an investigation.** It's the group's record of that night, not your personal history, so the row says *the group's* instead of showing a button. Ask the group.
- **Cited by a case report.** Deleting it would leave a finished report pointing at nothing, so the citation has to be removed first.
- **Published to a place's archive.** Deleting it removes it from the archive, which is the same as taking it back — and that requires a paid plan, as explained above. A session that hasn't been published can be deleted on any plan.

Deleting a session never affects the place itself. Where a session was recorded is a fact about the recording, not something that depends on whether you shared it.

Your seat on a walk

Asking for a place on a ghost walk is a **request** — the tour confirms it. Say how many of you are coming, and the night's page will say your seat is with the tour until someone there decides. Once it's approved, the page shows how many places are reserved, and **Got it** lets them know you've seen it. That's optional; your place is held either way.

The phone reminds you itself. Once a seat is reserved, the app sets two reminders — the night before, and an hour before — each with the meeting point, and both in the walk's own time zone. They're set on the phone rather than sent from the site, so they still arrive in a cellar with no signal. You're asked for permission when you first have a seat to be reminded about, and if you say no, everything else still works.

If a seat is turned down, or you cancel a walk, its reminders are removed too.

Payment is arranged with the business. Nothing is charged through the app.

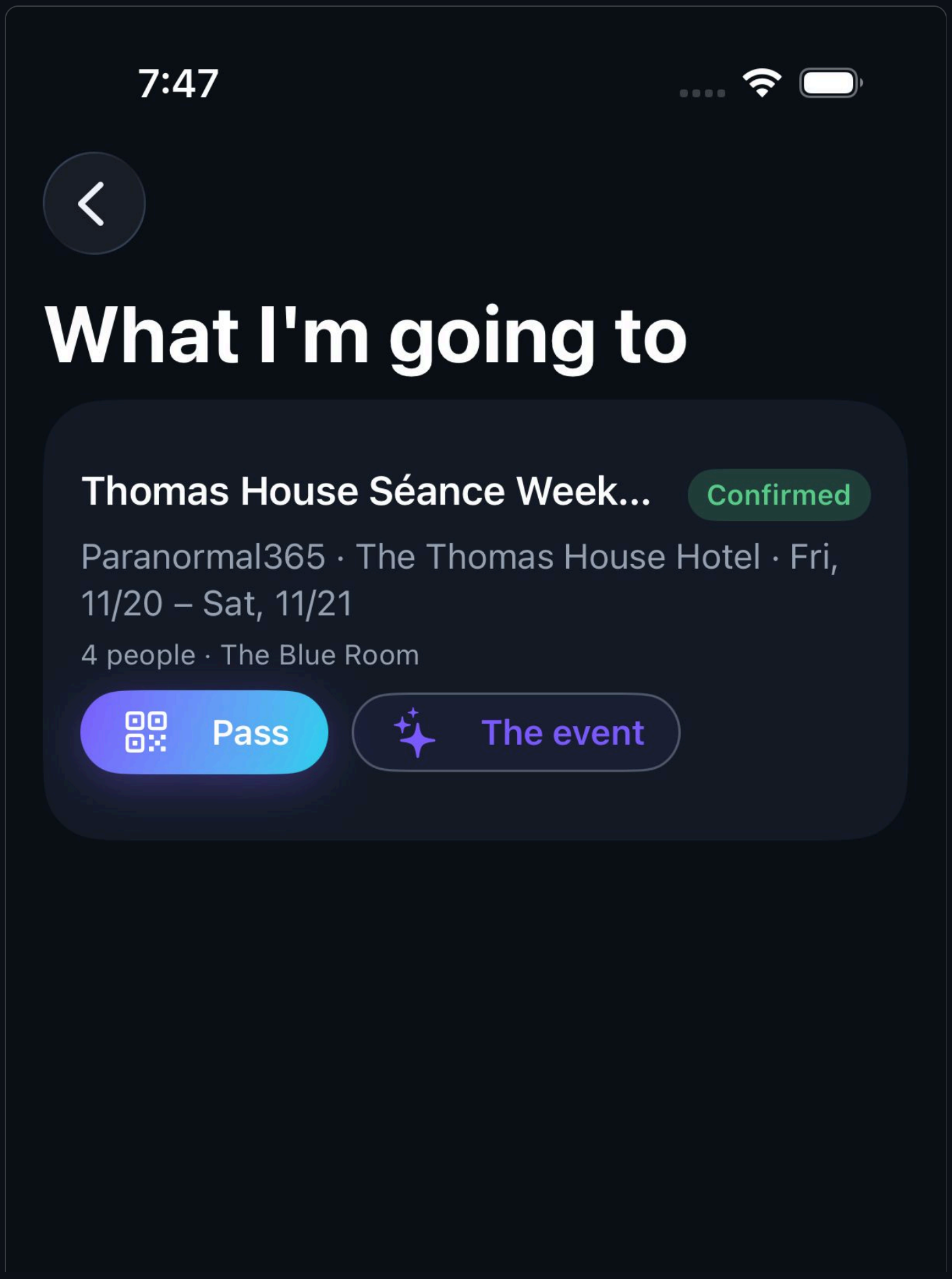
The walk's room. Once the guide has checked you in, the night's page shows **The walk's room**: the people on the walk and the guides, keeping in touch. Your guides' posts carry a *Guide* badge. Words only; it stays open for a week after the walk.

An event you've booked

Some events are run through this site by a venue or a group — a séance weekend at a hotel, a dinner and a play over three nights. You ask for places at those, or choose them on a seating plan, on the event's own page, and the app shows you where your booking stands.

On the event. Open the night from Events, and the booking panel shows the status at a glance — *Waiting for the venue*, *Held for you*, *Confirmed*, *Turned down* — with what you asked for underneath. You can let go of a request or a hold you no longer want from there. If you don't have a booking yet, **Ask for a place** (or **Choose your places**, if the venue uses a seating plan) opens the event's page inside the app; when you close it, the panel updates with your booking. Until the event starts, **Ask the organizers a question** is there too, so you can ask before you book. Their answer appears in the same conversation, and you can still read it after the event starts.

What I'm going to. Under **Profile**, this lists every hosted event you've asked for, one row each, with its dates, the venue, what you've booked and a link to your pass.


7:47
What I'm going to
Thomas House Séance Week...
Confirmed
Paranormal365 · The Thomas House Hotel · Fri, 11/20 – Sat, 11/21
4 people · The Blue Room
Pass
The event

Your pass. Once the venue confirms you and issues it, **Your pass** shows the code the door scans, a short code to read out if the camera won't focus, how many people it admits, and the nights and rooms or seats. The screen turns up to full brightness while it's open and goes back to normal when you leave.

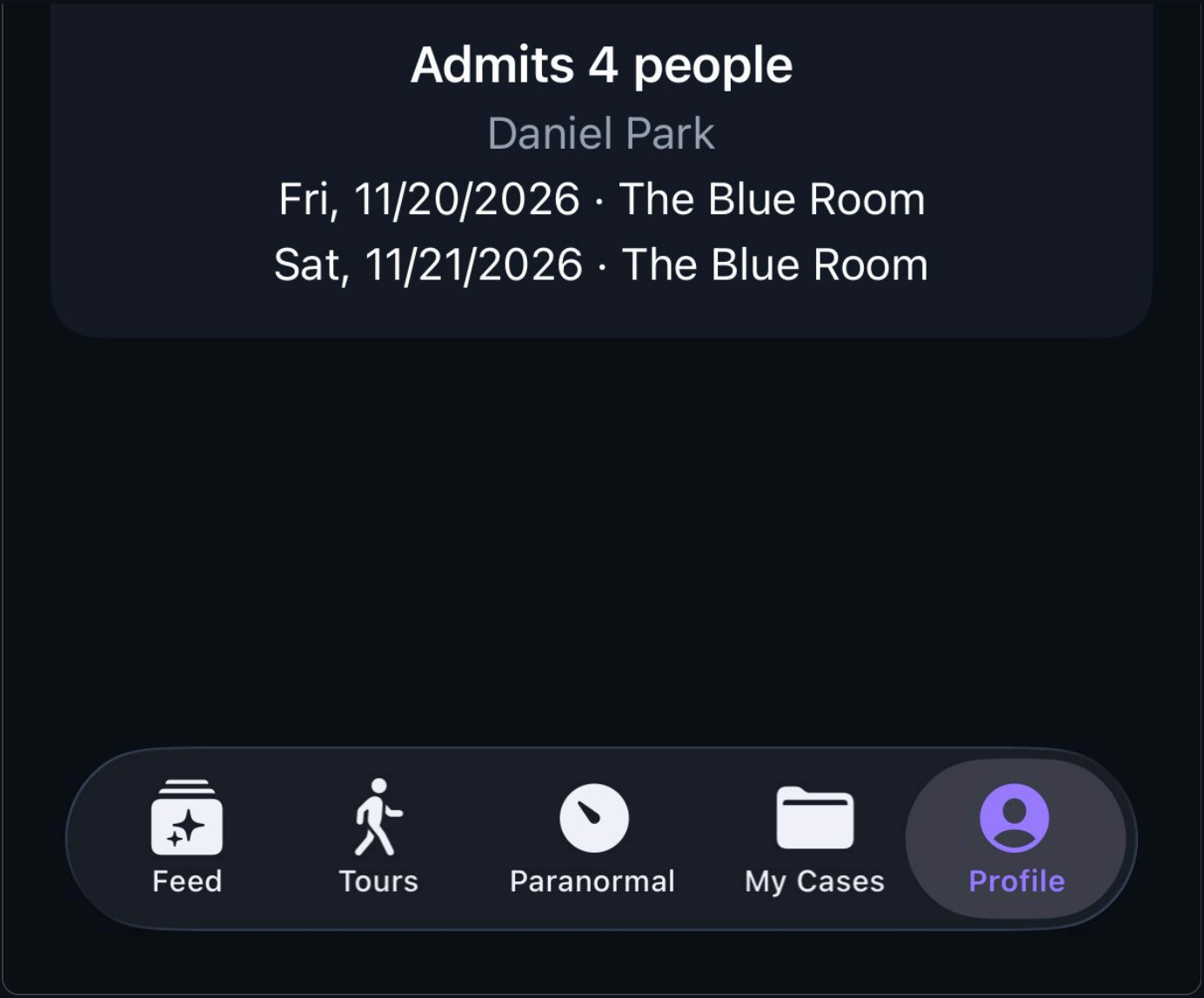
7:48

Your pass

Thomas House Séance Weekend

The Thomas House Hotel

E27AE2



- **It works with no signal.** The app keeps the last pass it saw on the phone, so you can still get in at a basement bar or a hotel with no reception. When it's showing the saved copy, it says so, and when it was saved.
- **A withdrawn pass is shown as withdrawn**, faded and marked with a band — never left looking valid. If the venue withdraws it while you're online, the saved copy is removed too.
- **Opening the app with no signal does not sign you out.** You stay signed in, and the app catches up when the phone is back online.
- **Signing out removes the kept passes**, so the next person to pick up the phone never sees yours.

Choosing seats on a plan is still done on the website for now; everything you choose there shows up here.

During the event

The event on What I'm going to (or **Program and room** on a confirmed booking) opens everything for that event in one place. A row only appears when there's something in it: if there's no program yet, or no menus are

published, they simply aren't listed. If the hosts have explained how to get in and get around — stairs, a step-free entrance, parking, low light — it's under **Getting in and getting around**.

7:46

Thomas House Séance Weekend

Thomas House Séance Weekend

Confirmed

Paranormal365 · The Thomas House Hotel

Fri, 11/20 – Sat, 11/21

4 people · The Blue Room

Your pass

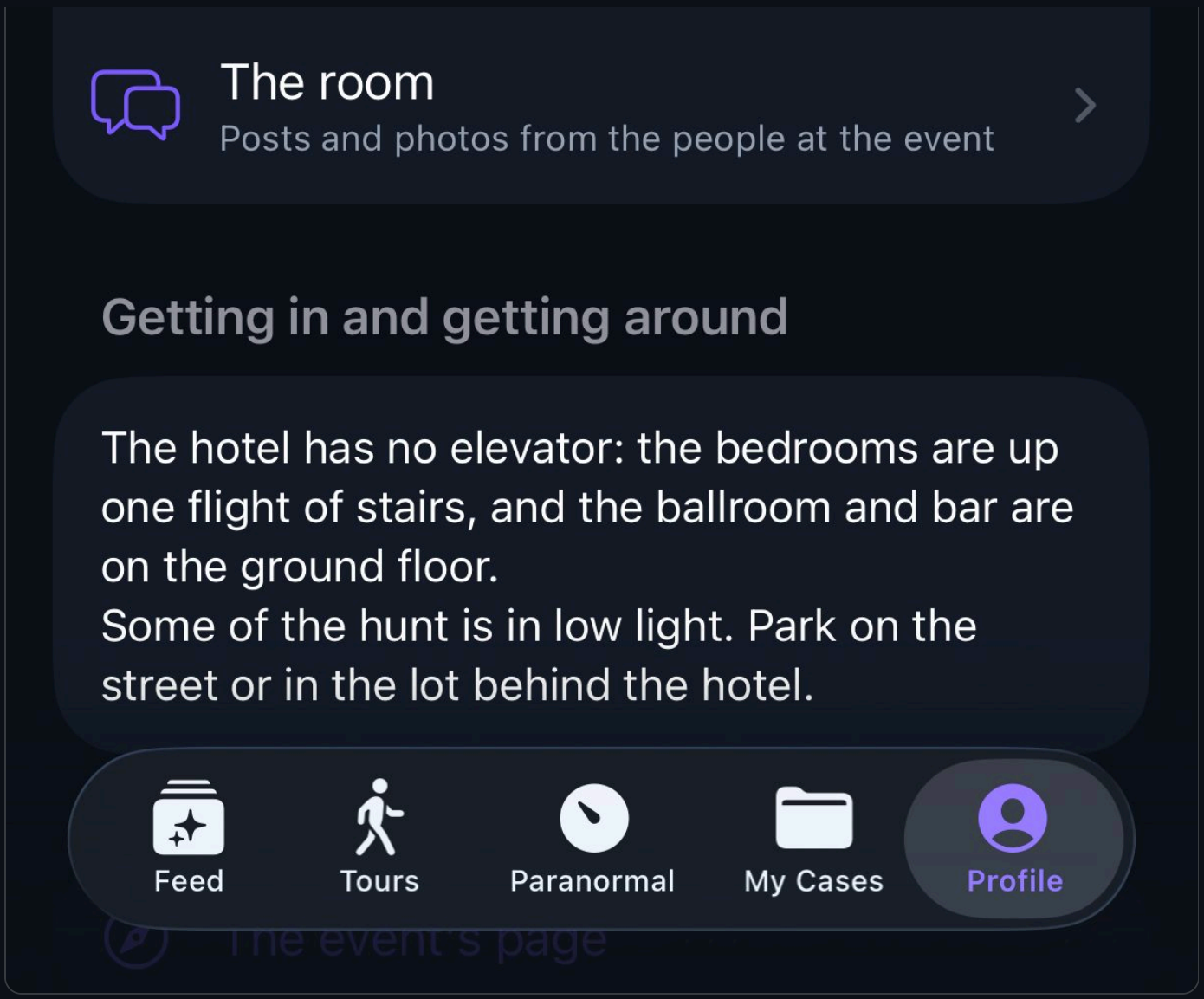
The code for the door — it opens with no signal

Program

3 sessions

Menus

5 menus

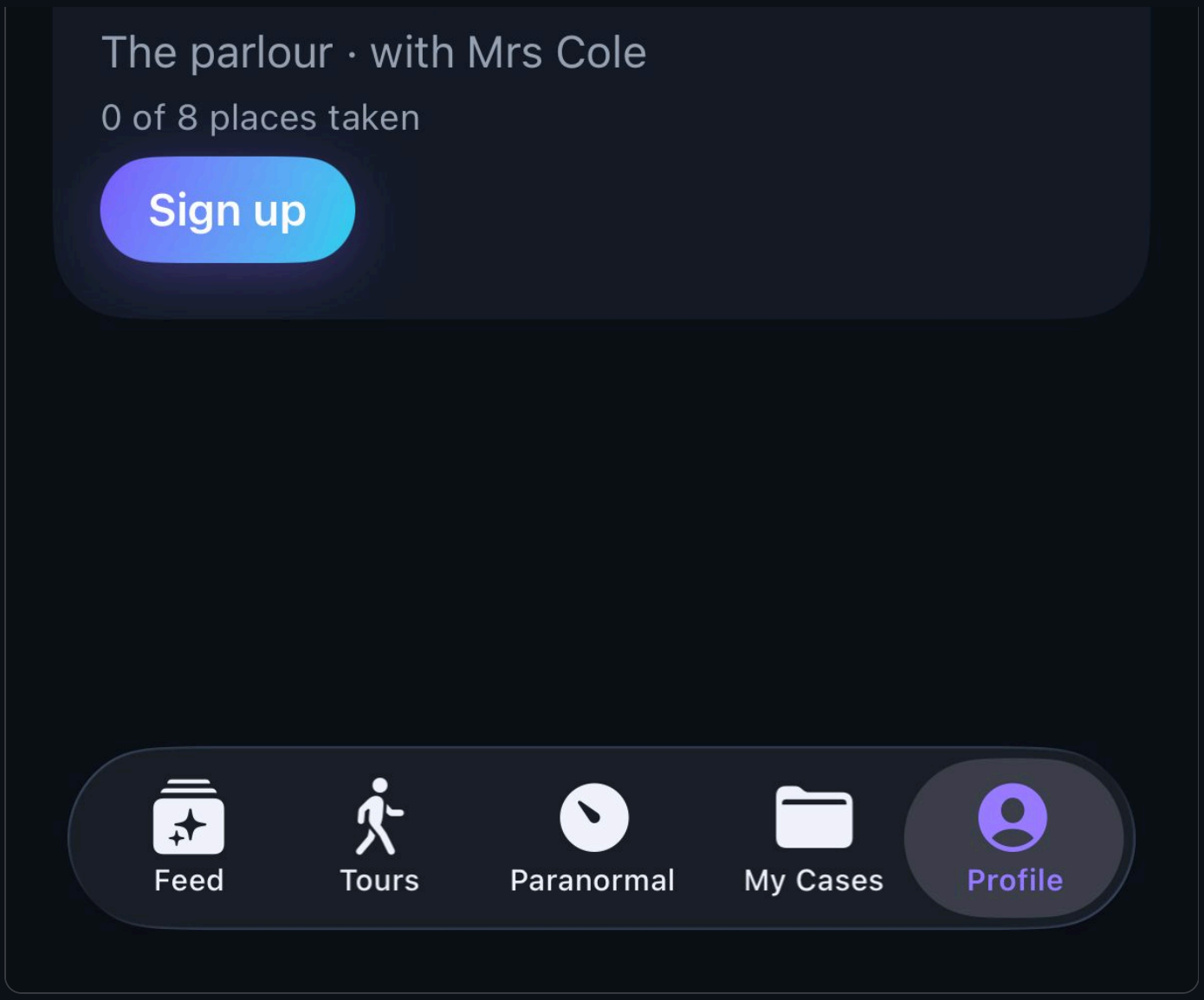


- **Program** — night by night, **in the venue's time zone** with the zone named, so 9:00 PM CDT means the same wherever you read it. **Sign up** asks how many of your party are coming. If a session is full, you go on its waiting list and it tells you your place in line; if there aren't enough places left for your whole party, it says that too. **Give up** or **Leave** passes your place to the next person. The calendar button at the top adds the whole program to your calendar.
- **Menus** — each menu looks the way the hosts designed it, just as on the website: when it's served, its price, what the event covers, and the marks on each dish. **PDF** opens the same PDF the website gives, to save or share. Anyone can see published menus, without signing in: they're also on the event's own page in the app, under **See the menus**, with what the event's price includes.
- **Downloads** — the files the organizers share with guests. Tap one to open it, and share it from there.
- **The room** — what people at the event are posting. Press the pencil to write a post, or to add photos and video from your library or the camera. If you add several at once, each becomes its own post, with your words on the first. The first photo you add at an event asks you to agree, in the organizers' words, to it being shown in the room and on their photo wall. **Also send to...** sends the organizers a copy. Press and hold your own post to send it on later or take it down; press and hold someone else's to report it. Your

photos stay yours whichever you choose. Posts from the people running the event carry a badge — *Organizer*, *Guide*, *Venue* — so they stand out.

- **Results** — once the organizers have accepted evidence from the night, the event shows what people caught, with the most *confirms* votes first, then in the order it was caught. Tap a piece to play or view it, or open the results page on the website.
- **Write to the organizers** — ask the people running the event anything. Their answers appear here, with a colored edge, and on the event's page on the website.

7:46
Program
Friday, 11/20
6:00 PM – 8:00 PM CST
Dinner in the dining room
The dining room
9:00 PM – 10:00 PM CST
Operating the Ovilus
The parlour · with Ben
0 of 15 places taken
Sign up
Saturday, 11/21
10:00 PM – 11:00 PM CST
Séance in the parlour


The parlour · with Mrs Cole
0 of 8 places taken
Sign up
Feed
Tours
Paranormal
My Cases
Profile

7:46

Menus

Included with the event: Friday breakfast, Friday dinner, Friday late supper, Saturday dinner and some of Snack table.

THOMAS HOUSE SÉANCE WEEKEND

Breakfast

Friday, November 20 · Breakfast, 8:00 AM

The morning after — yes, this is still Friday's night.

Included with the event

Dishes

Eggs, bacon and toast

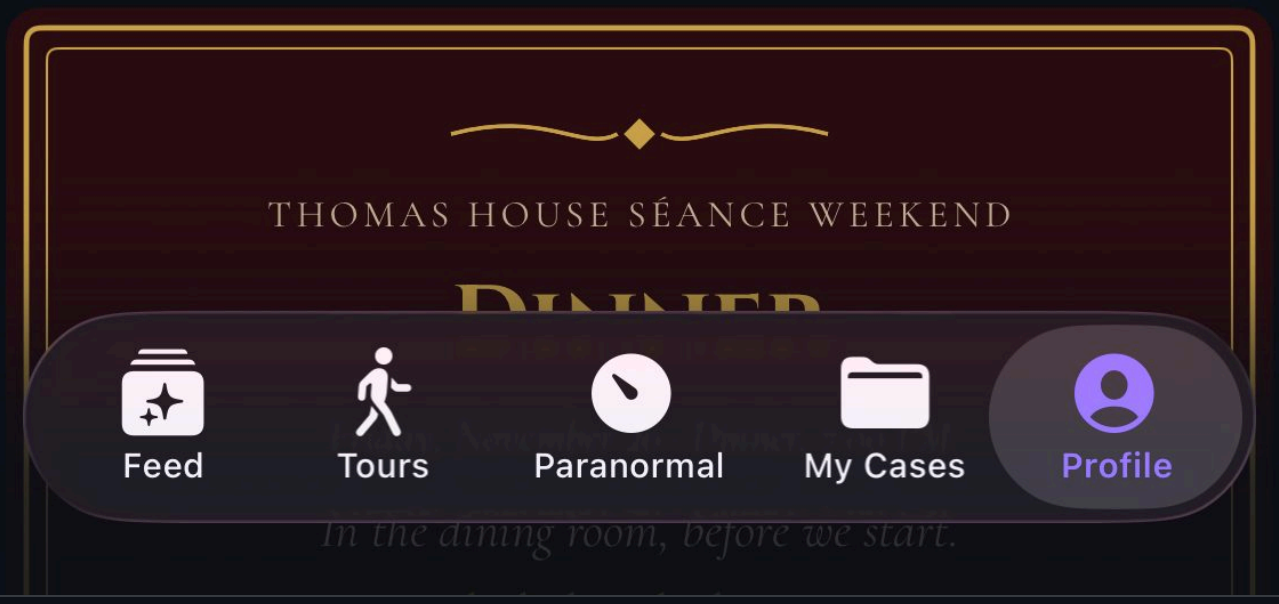
Fruit and yogurt

Fruit and yogurt V

V vegetarian

Menu made with IsHaunted.com · © 2026 ISHAUNTED LLC

PDF

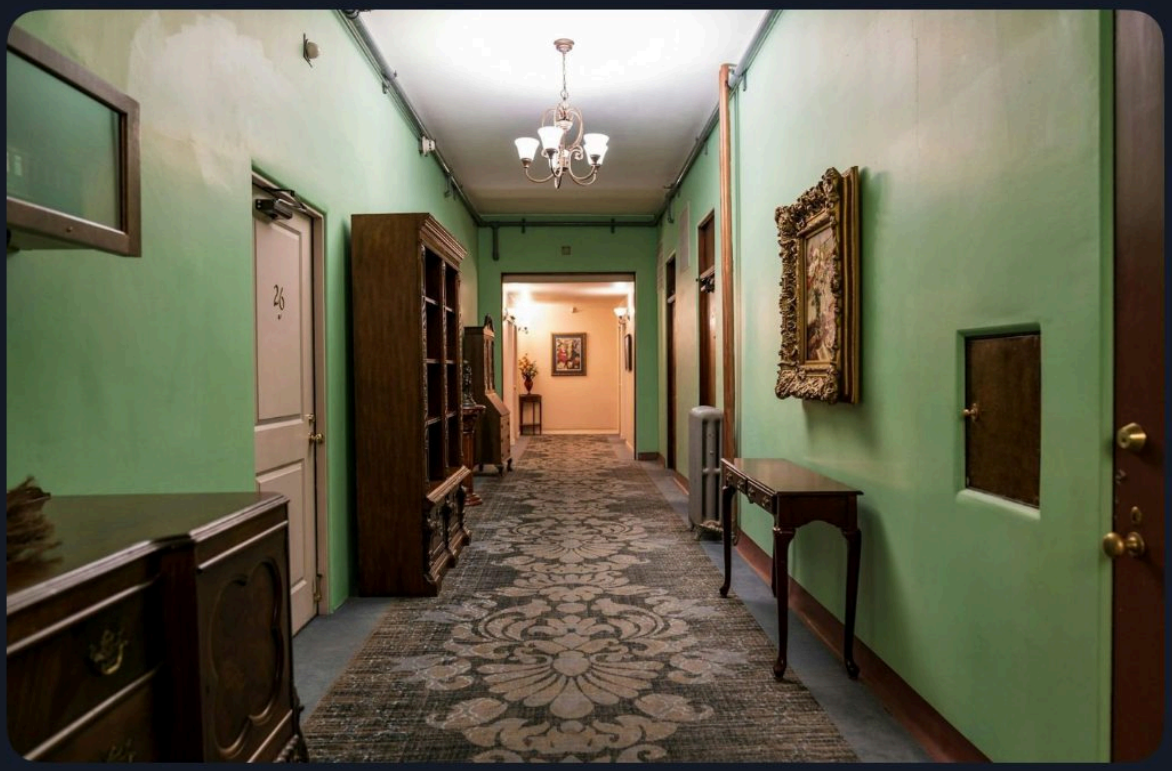


7:46

The room

You 1 minute ago

The hallway outside the Blue Room, just before midnight.



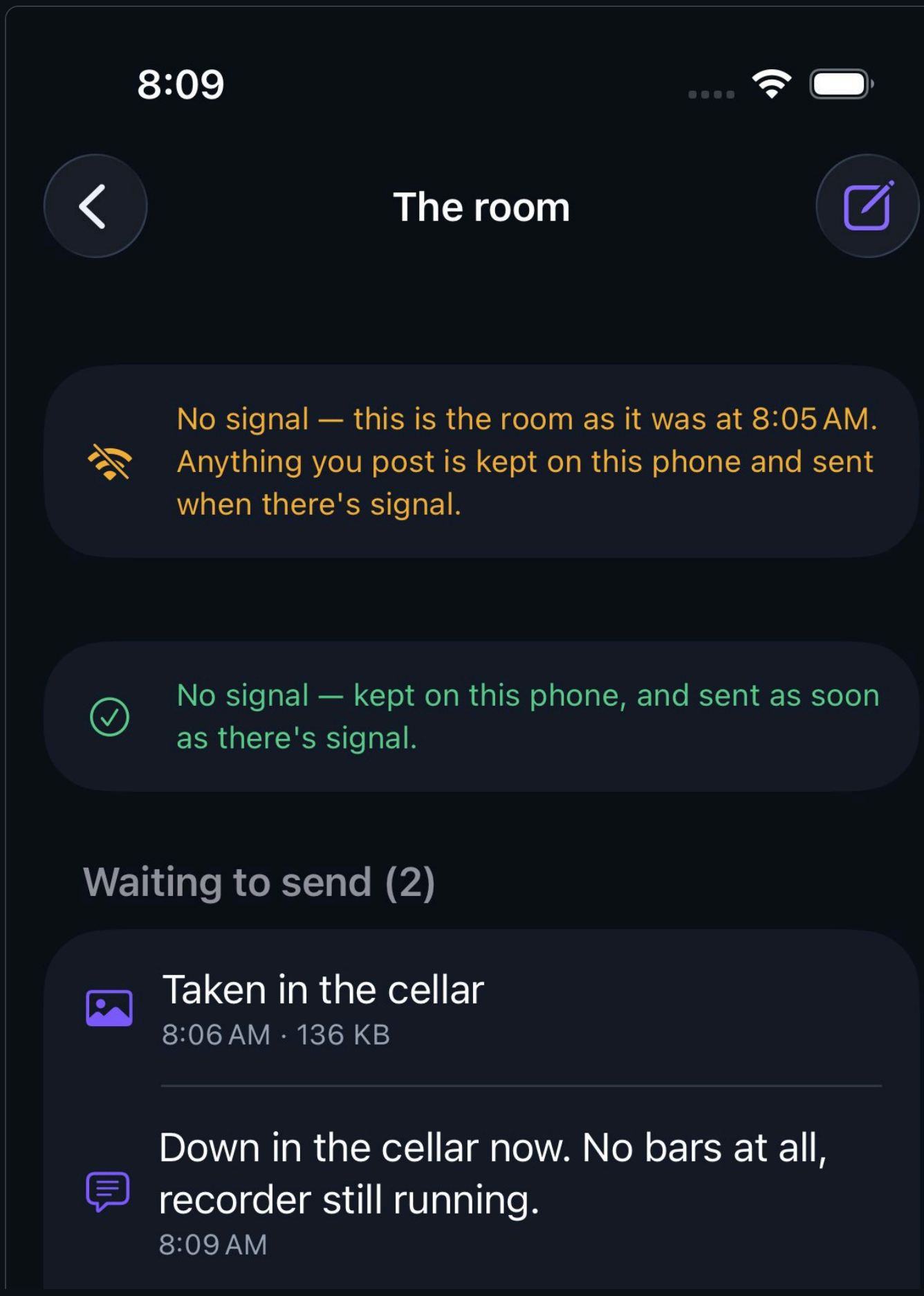
You 1 minute ago

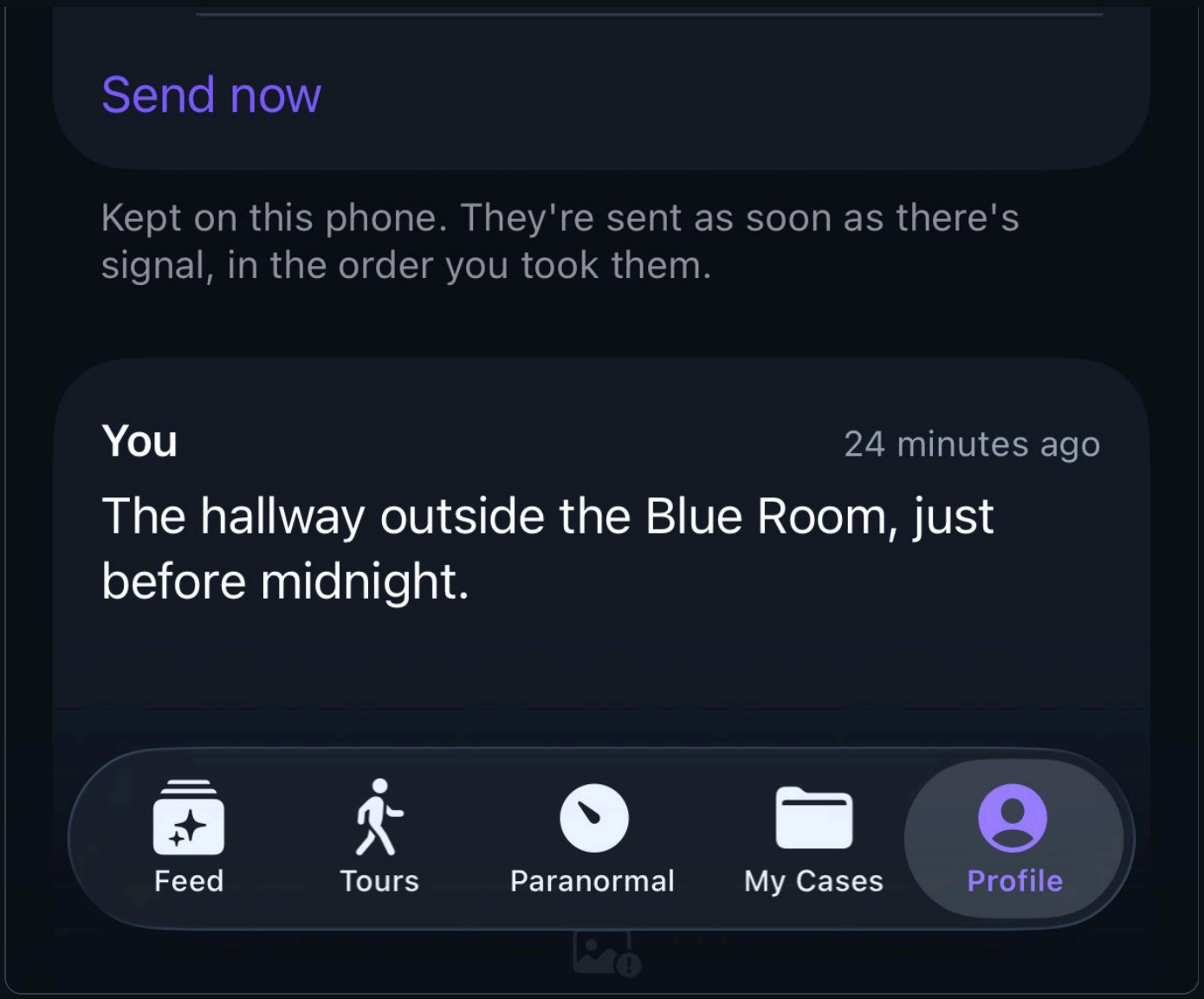
Made it in — the Blue Room is colder than

Hiding posts and closing the room are still done on the website, where an organizer can see the whole room.

Photos with no signal

In a cellar, a hotel with one bar of signal, or a field: post anyway. When the room can't be reached, what you wrote and any photos not yet sent are **kept on the phone** and sent as soon as there's signal — when you come back to the app, when the network returns while it's open, or when you open the room. The room also opens with no signal, showing it as it was last time, so you can still add to it.

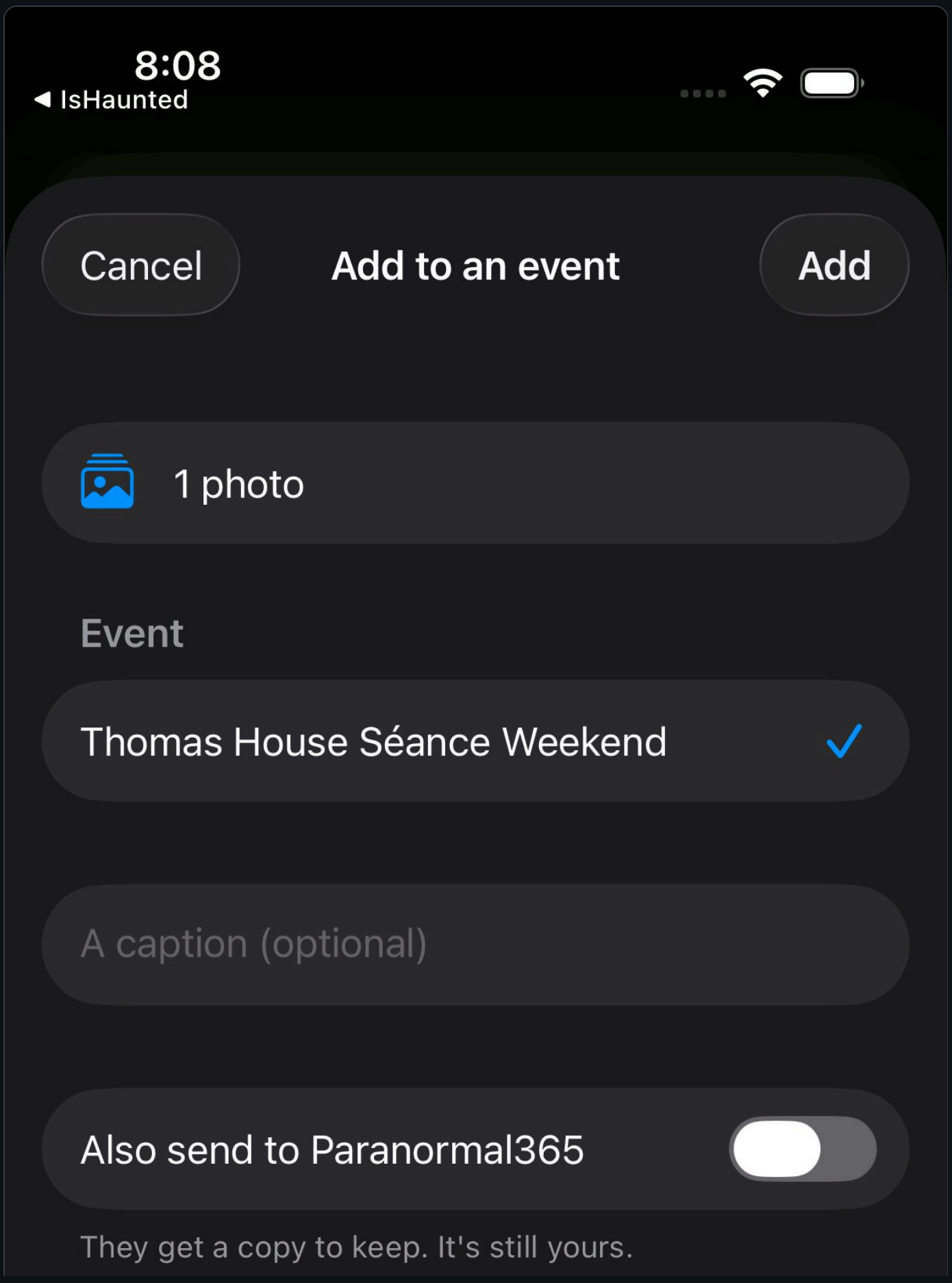

8:09
The room
No signal — this is the room as it was at 8:05 AM. Anything you post is kept on this phone and sent when there's signal.
No signal — kept on this phone, and sent as soon as there's signal.
Waiting to send (2)
Taken in the cellar
8:06 AM · 136 KB
Down in the cellar now. No bars at all, recorder still running.
8:09 AM

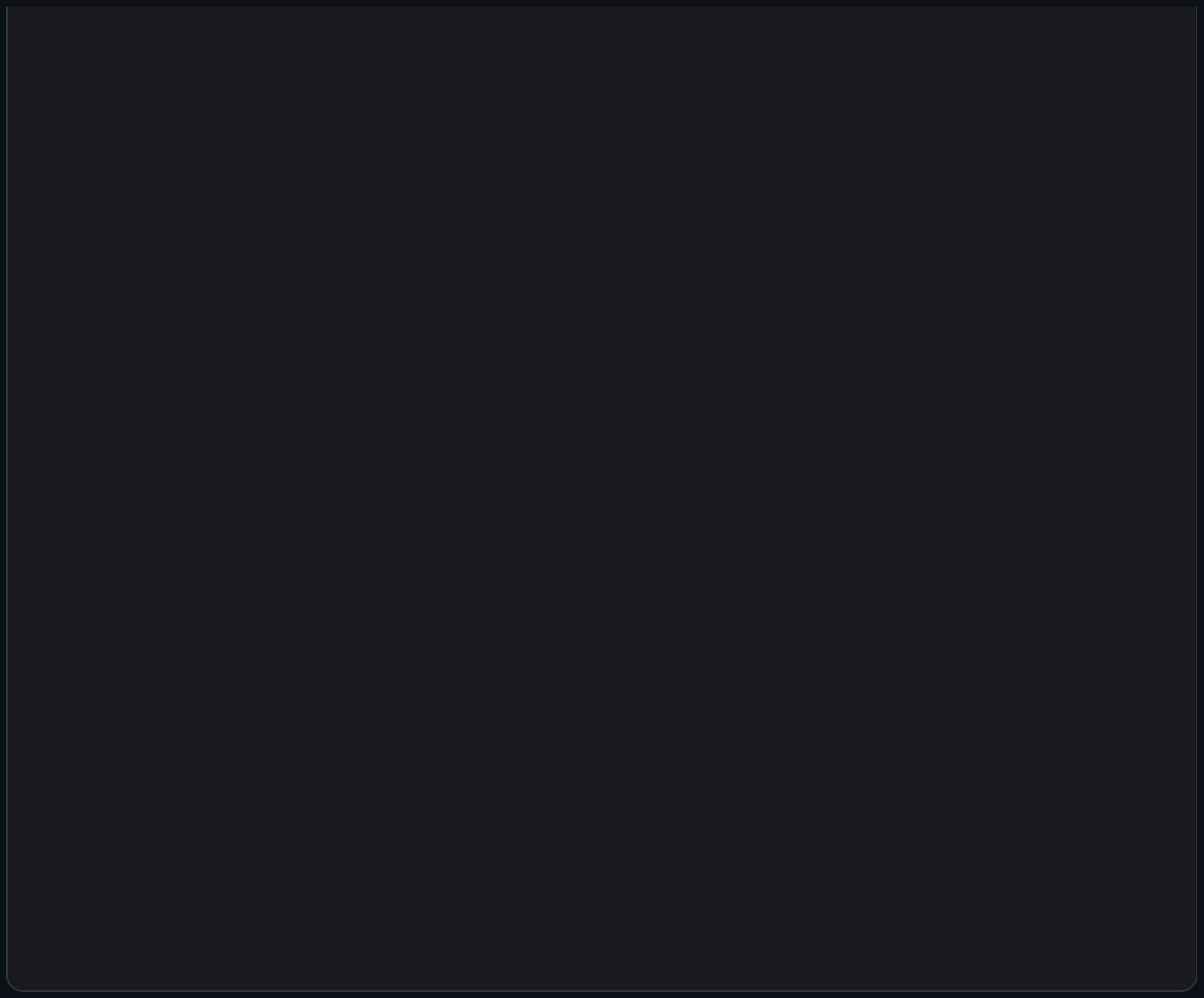


- **Waiting to send** lists them in the order you took them. **Send now** tries right away.
- If the room won't accept one when it gets there — because it has closed, or the organizers have limited photos to their team — it moves to **Couldn't be sent** with the reason. Swipe it to remove it from the phone.
- Photos are sent as JPEG, whatever format the camera saved them in. A video can be up to 95 MB in one post.
- Signing out removes anything still waiting.

Sharing photos from the Photos app

Choose photos or videos in the Photos app, press **Share**, and pick **IsHaunted**. Choose which of your events they're for, add a caption, agree to the photo notice if that event asks, and choose whether to send the organizers a copy. **Add** keeps them on the phone, and IsHaunted sends them the next time it's open with signal — open it right away to send them now.

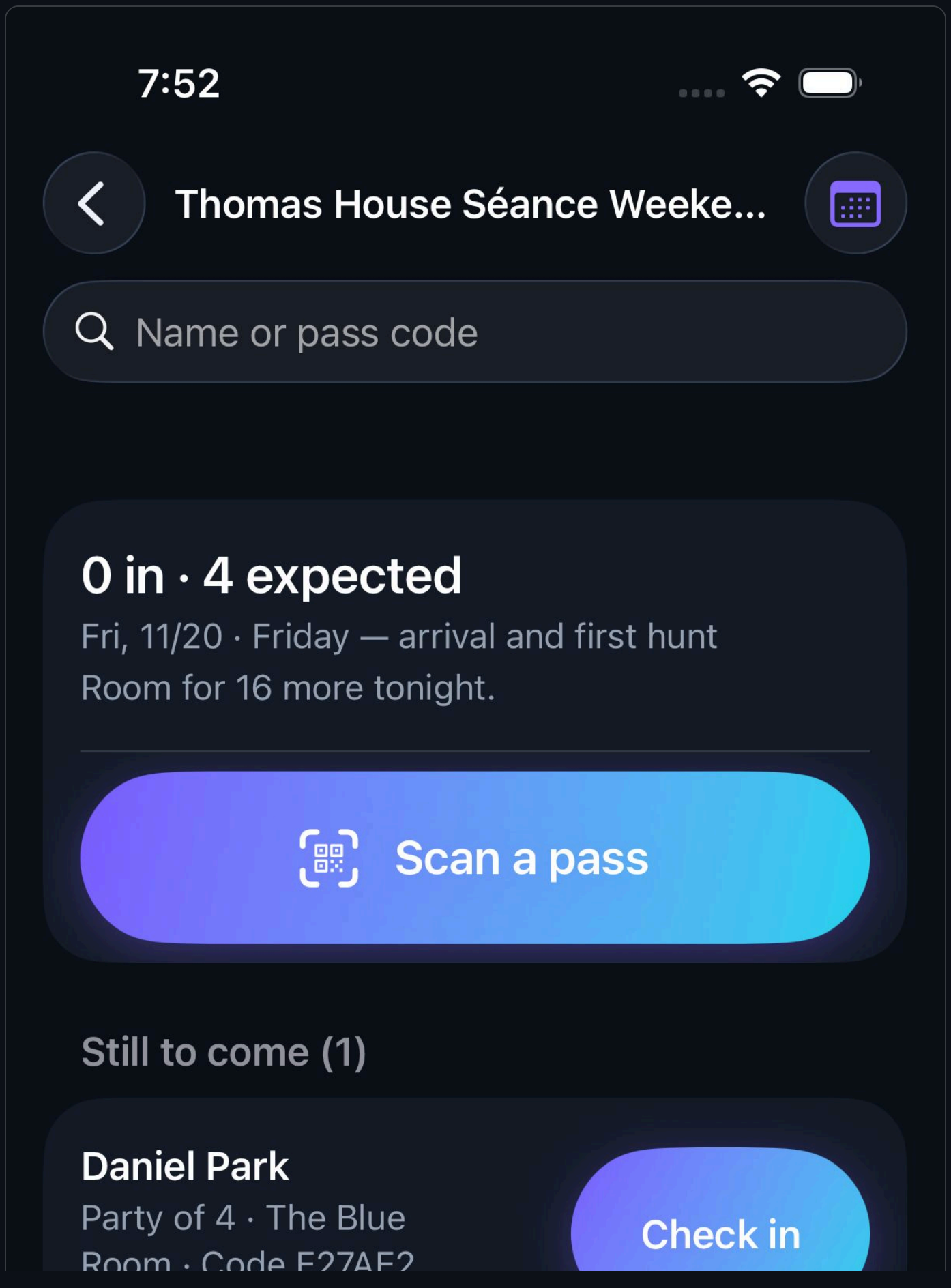

8:08
IsHaunted
Cancel
Add to an event
Add
1 photo
Event
Thomas House Séance Weekend
A caption (optional)
Also send to Paranormal365
They get a copy to keep. It's still yours.

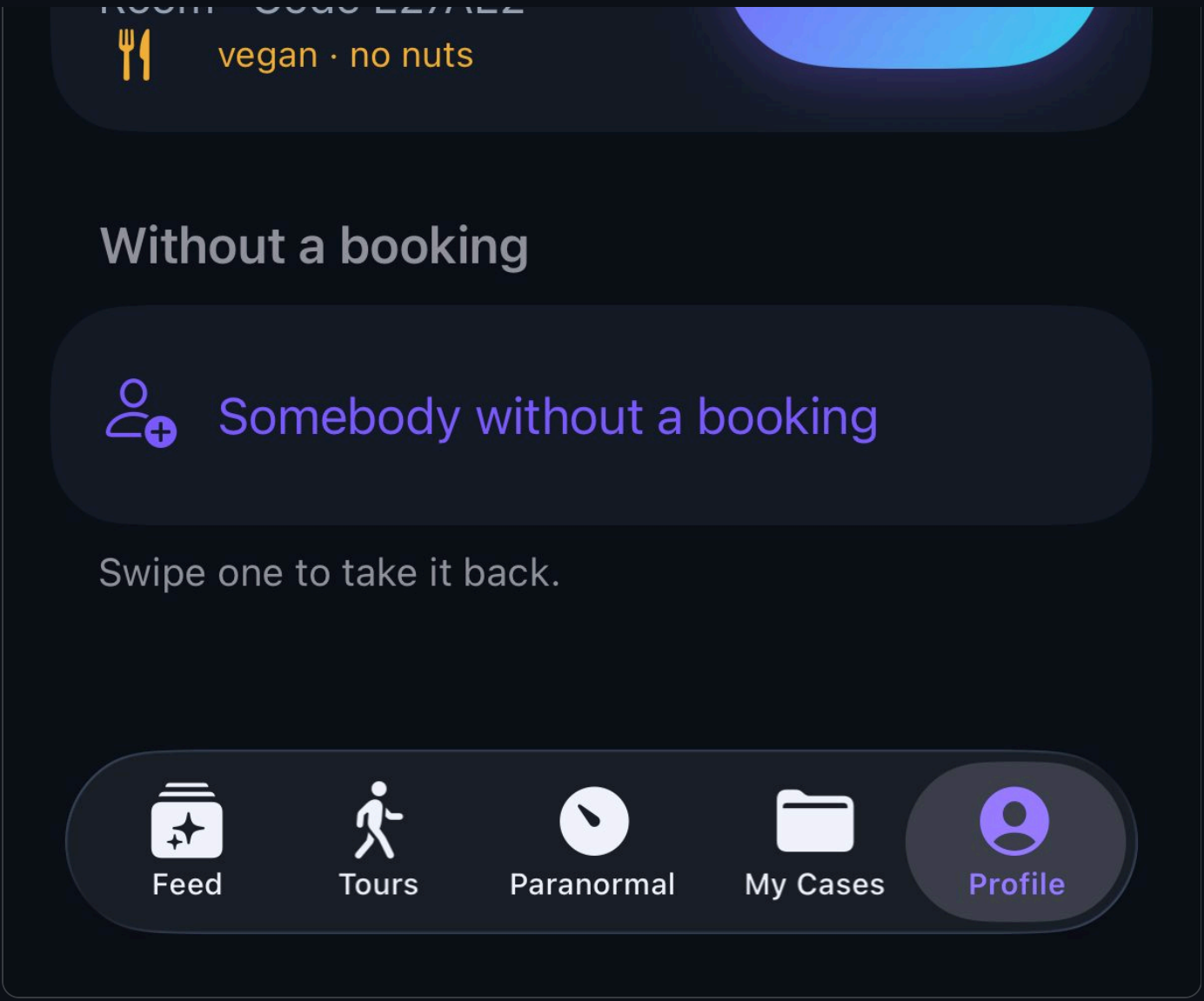


The events offered are the ones you're confirmed for and the ones you're helping at. Once you've opened an event's room in the app, the share sheet also knows that room's rules — whether it accepts your photos, and who gets a copy.

Running the door

If an event's organizers have asked you to help at the door — or you're in the group with that job — **Doors I'm running** appears under **Profile**. For everyone else, it simply isn't there.


7:52
Thomas House Séance Weeke...
Name or pass code
0 in · 4 expected
Fri, 11/20 · Friday — arrival and first hunt
Room for 16 more tonight.
Scan a pass
Still to come (1)
Daniel Park
Party of 4 · The Blue
Room · Code E27AF2
Check in



- **The count comes first**: how many people are in, how many are expected, and how many more could still come tonight.
- **Scan a pass** opens the camera. It reads the guest's code and closes, and the door screen shows the **reservation** that pass belongs to. Scanning alone doesn't check anyone in.
- **Tap the reservation** to open it: the name, how many are in the party, the nights and the room or seat, the color they wear, anyone with them, and anything the kitchen needs to know. **Check in as arrived** records them — if the whole party hasn't come, set how many are actually here first.
- If a pass isn't for this event, has been withdrawn, or isn't expected tonight, the door screen tells you in plain words instead.
- **Name or pass code** at the top finds a reservation by name, or by the six characters under the code when the camera won't focus. Tap a result to open it, or press **Check in** beside it.
- **Undo** reverses an arrival; **Somebody without a booking** records a walk-up — how many people, and a name if they give one.
- Nobody's address or phone number appears on these screens, and the screen stays awake while the door is open.

- **Who's at the classes**, at the top of the door, lists each class with a switch per person with a place, to mark who came.

7:52

Thomas House Séance Weeke...

Name or pass code

0 in · 4 expected

Fri, 11/20 · Friday — arrival and first hunt

Room for 16 more tonight.

Scan a pass

Scanned pass

Daniel Park

Party of 4 · The Blue Room · Code E27AE2

vegan · no nuts

Tap the reservation to check them in.

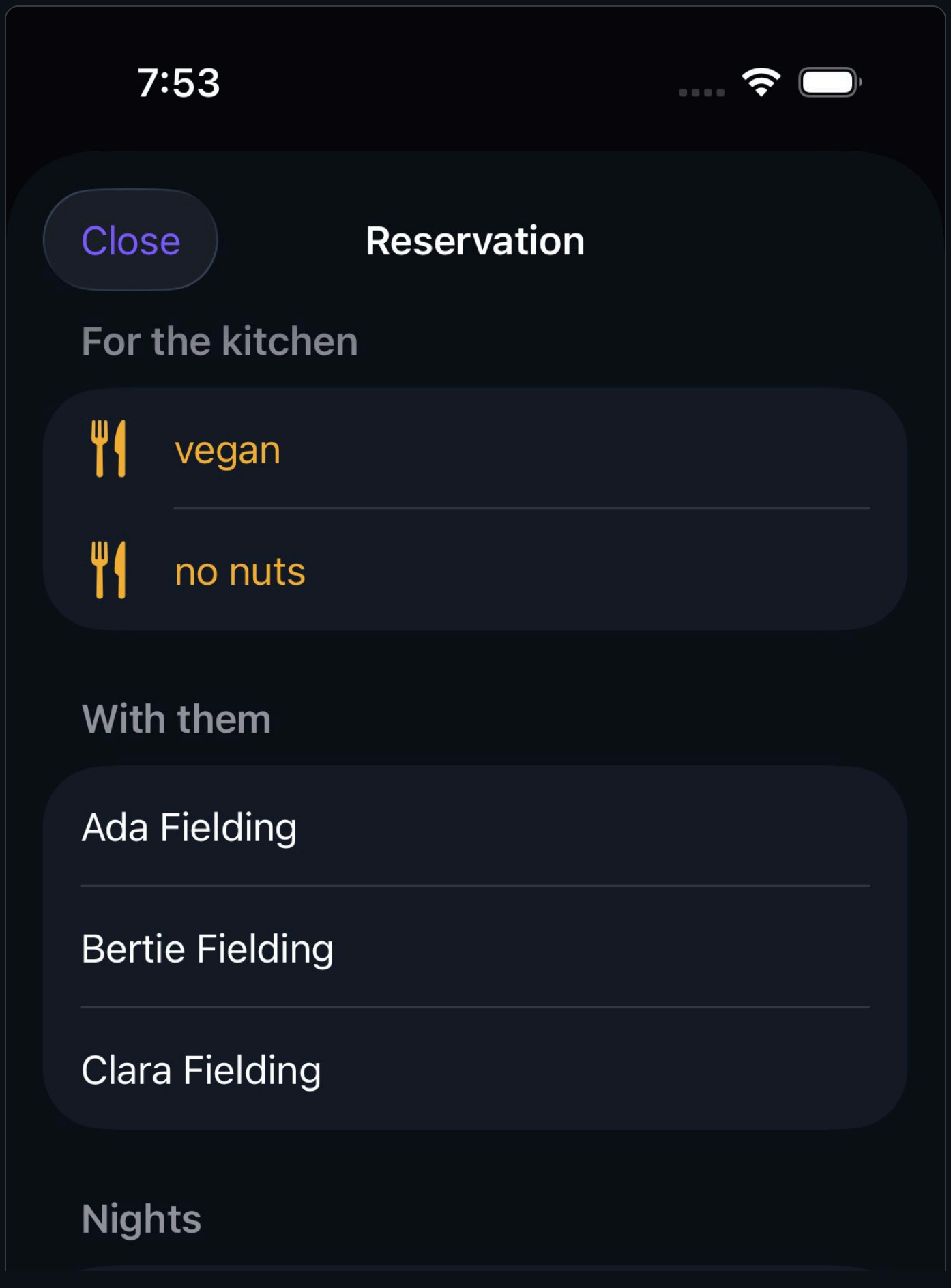
Still to come (1)

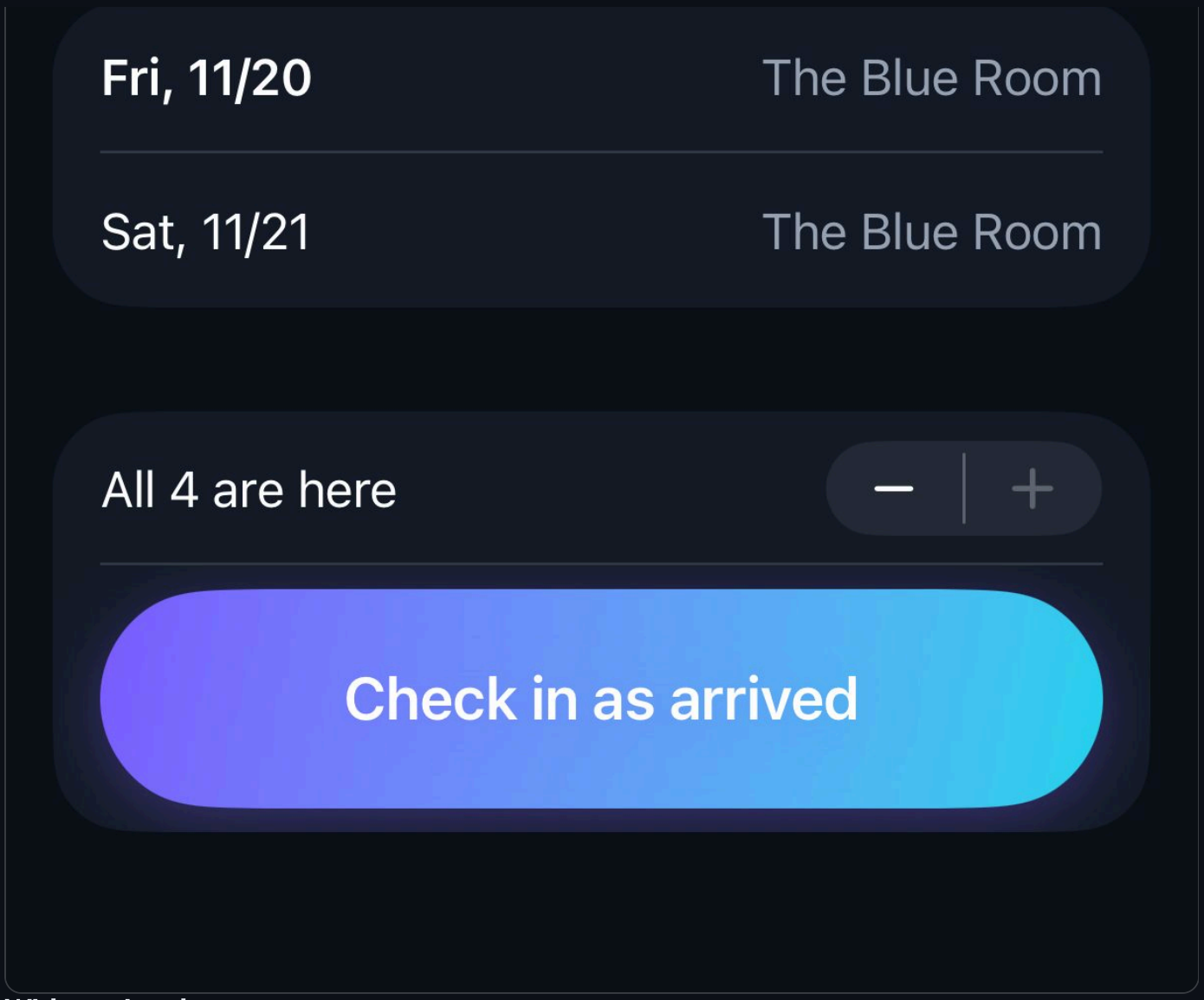
Daniel Park
Party of 4 · The Blue Room · Code E27AE2
vegan · no nuts

Check in

Without a booking

Feed | Tours | Paranormal | My Cases | Profile


7:53
Close
Reservation
For the kitchen
vegan
no nuts
With them
Ada Fielding
Bertie Fielding
Clara Fielding
Nights



With no signal

Open the door screen once while you have signal — ideally before the doors open — and tonight's list is saved on the phone.

- After that, the door screen opens even with **no signal** and shows when the list was saved. The camera still reads codes, and a scanned pass finds its reservation on the saved list.
- Everyone you check in is saved on the phone **with the time they arrived**, and **N arrivals waiting to send** goes as soon as there's signal (or press **Send now**). The server checks each pass again when it arrives.
- If the organizers withdrew a pass in the meantime, the phone tells you whose once it catches up.
- Recording a walk-up, or undoing an arrival that has already been sent, has to wait for a signal, because both need to be checked first.

Opening the app with no signal keeps you signed in, so your doors and passes are all there. Signing out removes the saved lists from the phone.

What you photographed on somebody else's event

If you go on a ghost walk or a paid event, you can offer what you captured to the group running it. **Settings → My evidence** is where everything you've offered is kept afterward.

There are two separate decisions here, and only one of them is the group's:

- **The group decides what their own event shows.** They either accept a photo for their event's record or they don't. It's their gallery.
- **You decide whether it joins the archive of the place.** That's your choice, whatever they decided. A photo they didn't use is still yours to contribute, and one they did use isn't published to the location just because they accepted it.

So the screen shows both side by side: the group's answer, and whether it's in the place's archive. A photo you offered is **always yours to open**, whether it's waiting, accepted or turned down — you never give up your only copy.

7:39

My evidence

Bell Witch Cave — Last Month's Open Night

cave-mouth-knocks.wav

Waiting · Not added

Add to place archive

If the event was held at a public location, each row offers **Add to place archive**. If it wasn't, the row says so instead of showing a button that would only be refused. This is what makes a tour worth more than a night out: a walk that visits the same building every week builds up that building's public record faster than anything else on the site.

The app only shows you what applies to you

The app is a **tool**, and a tool shouldn't be cluttered with parts that do nothing for you. What it shows depends on who you are:

IF YOU ARE	YOU SEE
Investigating on your own	The feed, the Paranormal Platform, and your profile. No case list and no investigations — you don't have either, and an empty screen is worse than no screen.
Somebody's client	Your case too, even though you don't belong to a group. You asked for the investigation, so it's yours to follow.
In a group	Cases, investigations and events, as your group's roles allow.
On a ghost walk	Events, and My evidence for what you photographed there.

Nothing you have permission to use is hidden. This is only about whether a section has anything in it for you today, not whether you're allowed in. Join a group and the sections appear; leave one and they disappear again.

A note on what the app shows you

The app follows exactly the same rules as the website about who can see what. A private engagement is redacted the same way, media waits for the same safety check before it appears, and a group's name only appears on footage it has claimed. Nothing is less private just because it's on a phone.

Links that open the app

Once the app is installed, tapping a link to this site in your email or messages opens it in the app instead of the browser — for the pages where the app has a matching screen: the feed and anything in it, your cases, your investigations, notifications, your profile, the events list, and email confirmation links.

Everything else opens in the browser on purpose. Some pages have no screen in the app — a group's public page, a shared session link, an individual event — and sending you to the app for those would take you away from the page that actually works. If a link doesn't open the app, that's expected, not a fault.

On a phone or computer without the app, nothing changes: every link opens the website as usual.

Installing the site itself

On Android, Windows or a Mac there's no native app, but you can install the website to your home screen or dock, and it will open in its own window without an address bar. Your browser offers this itself — **Install** in Chrome's address bar, or **Add to Home screen** in its menu.

It's the same site, so you can do everything there that you can do on the web. The one thing it doesn't have is the Paranormal Platform, which needs an iPhone's sensors.

GETTING STARTED

Going to an Event

Asking for a place, choosing your own seats, and what the venue's answer means.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

Some groups run whole events, not just single evenings — a weekend at a hotel, a night in a theater, an overnight lock-in with dinner partway through. Here's how to get a place at one.

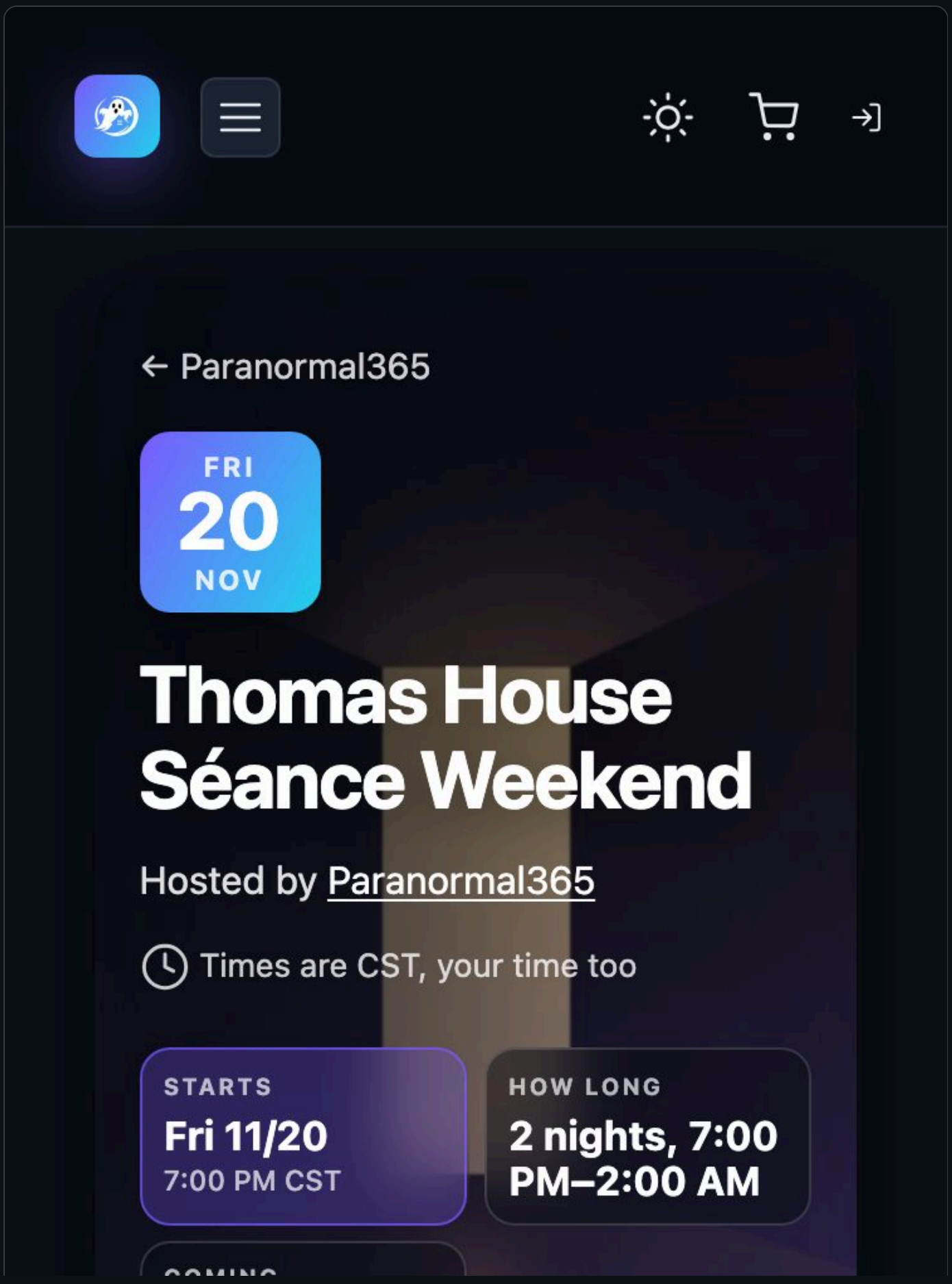
Nothing is ever paid here. Whatever a room or seat costs, you pay the venue directly. The site shows you the price so you know what you're agreeing to, but it isn't involved in the payment.

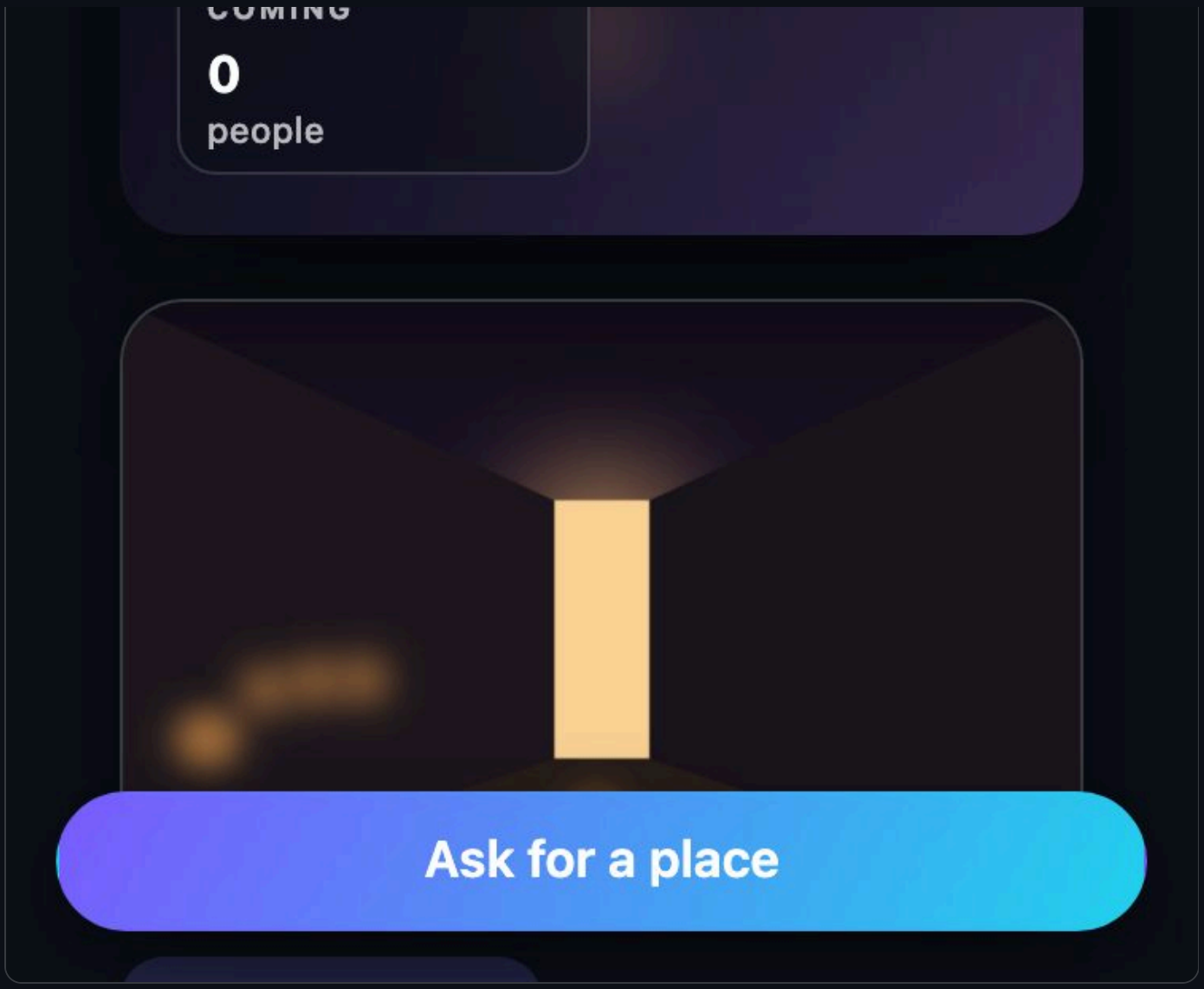
Looking before you decide

You don't need an account to look. Open an event's page and, if it has seating, you'll see the plan exactly as it stands right now — what's available, what someone is holding, and what the venue has set aside.

Every square is labeled in words as well as color, so the plan is clear to everyone.

The page opens with the hosts' own photos and a countdown to the first night. On a phone, an **Ask for a place** button stays at the bottom of the screen while you read, and takes you straight to the part of the page where you choose.


← Paranormal365
FRI
20
NOV
Thomas House Séance Weekend
Hosted by Paranormal365
Times are CST, your time too
STARTS
Fri 11/20
7:00 PM CST
HOW LONG
2 nights, 7:00 PM–2:00 AM



If the hosts have described how to get in and around — stairs, elevators, parking, low lighting — you'll find it on the page under **Getting in and getting around**, and again in your confirmation email.

You don't need an account to choose your places, either — see Choosing without an account.

Finding an event. Public events appear on the map on the home page, marked with a ticket, at an approximate spot near the venue rather than its exact address. Tap one to open its page. On **What's on** you can search by the event's name, the group running it, a tour, or a town.

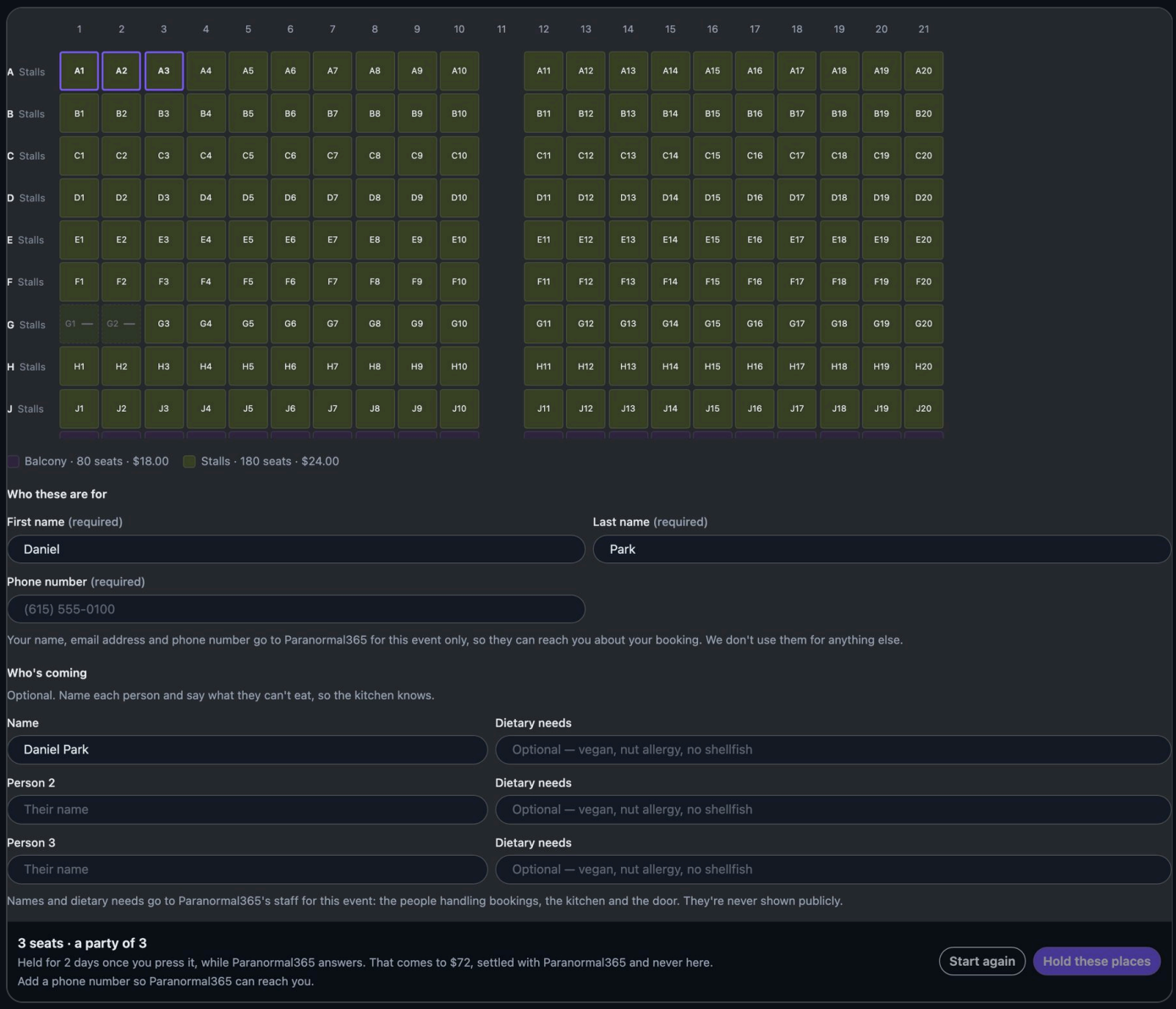
Add the dates to your calendar, on an event's page, saves every date to your calendar in one file, with the menus served on each date if the organizers have published them.

Two ways to get a place

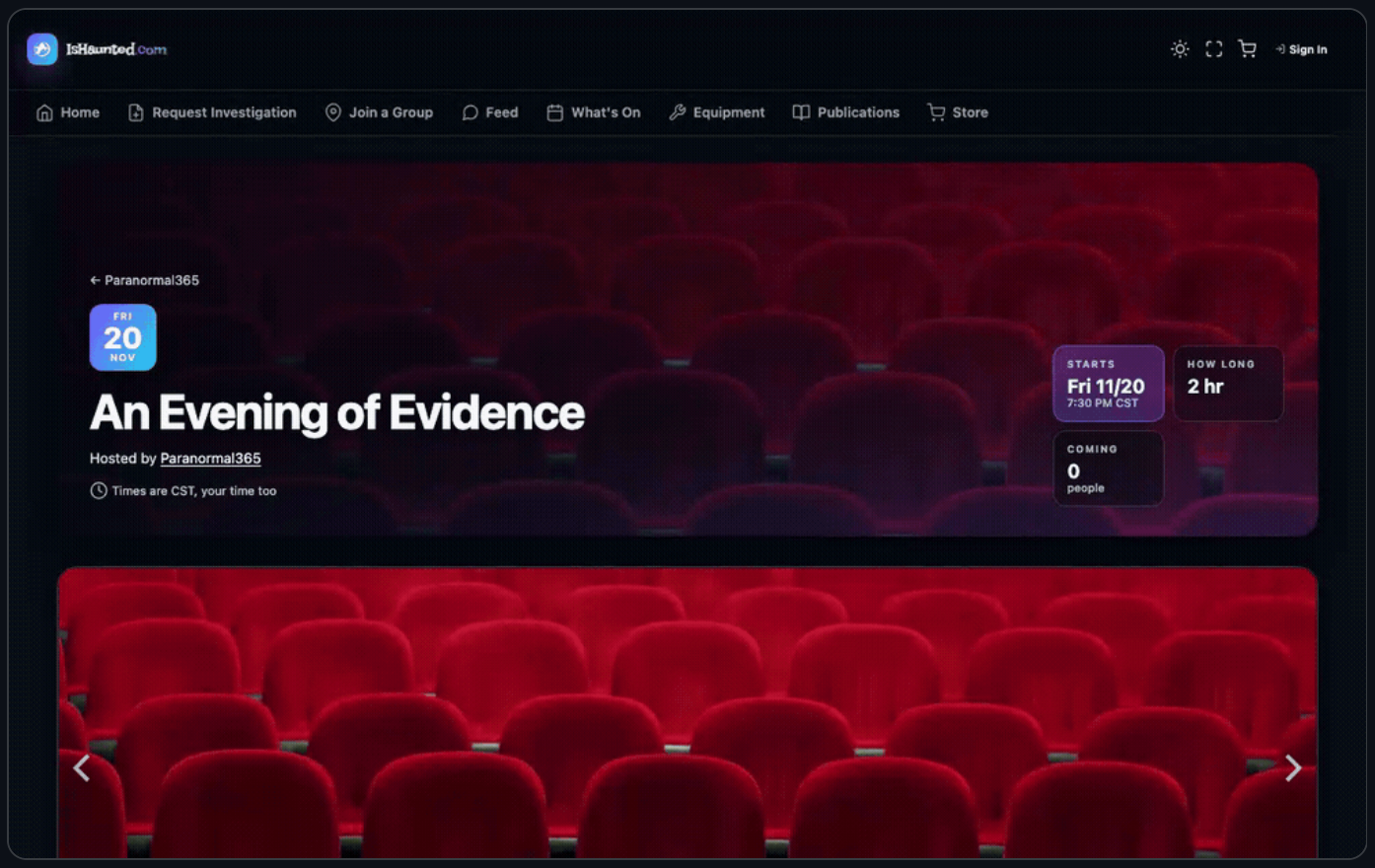
The venue decides which one an event uses, and the page shows you the one that applies.

Choosing your own places

For events where you pick specific seats or rooms, tap the ones you want and press **Hold these places**.



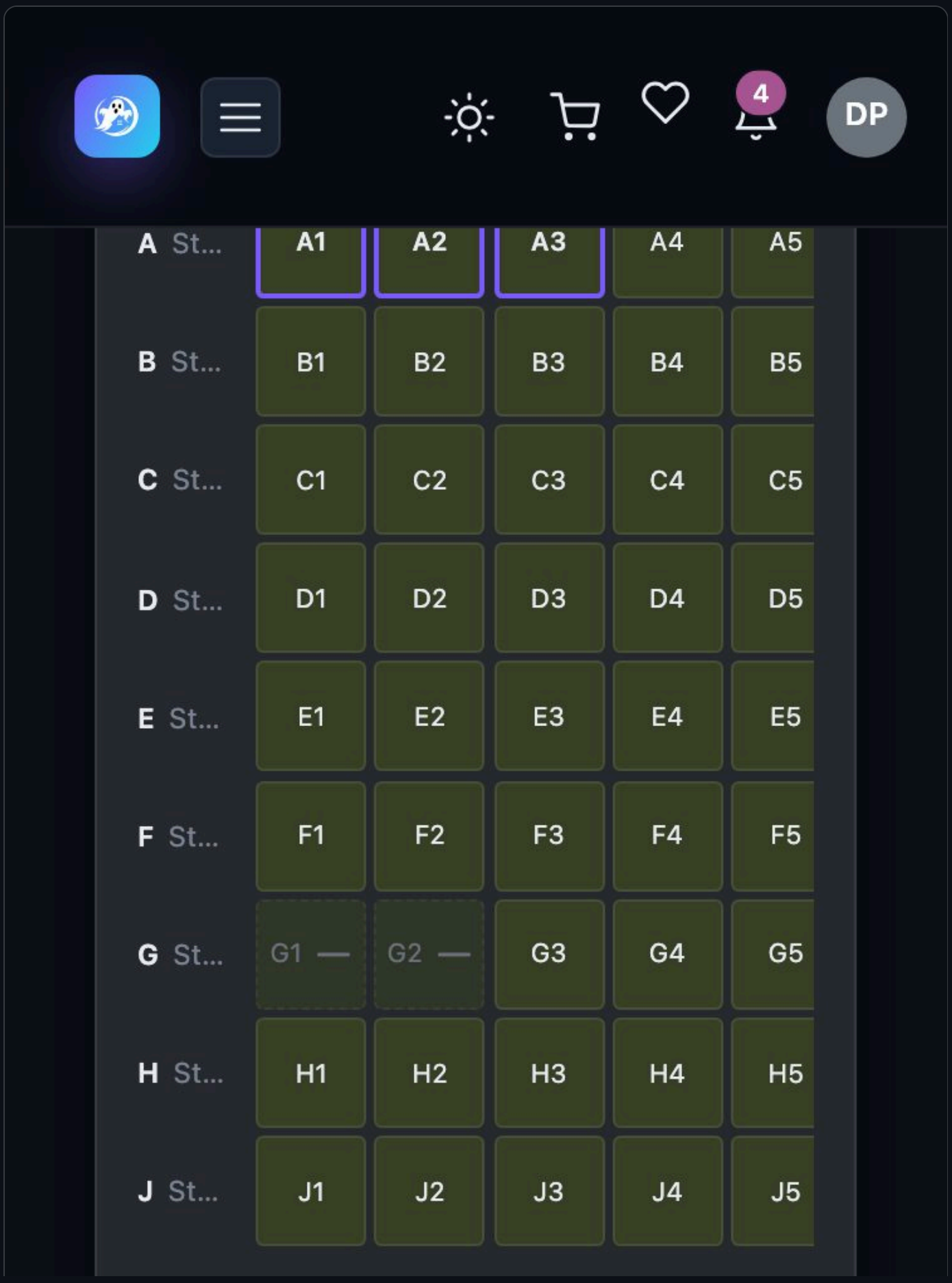
The summary adds up what you've chosen before you commit to any of it.

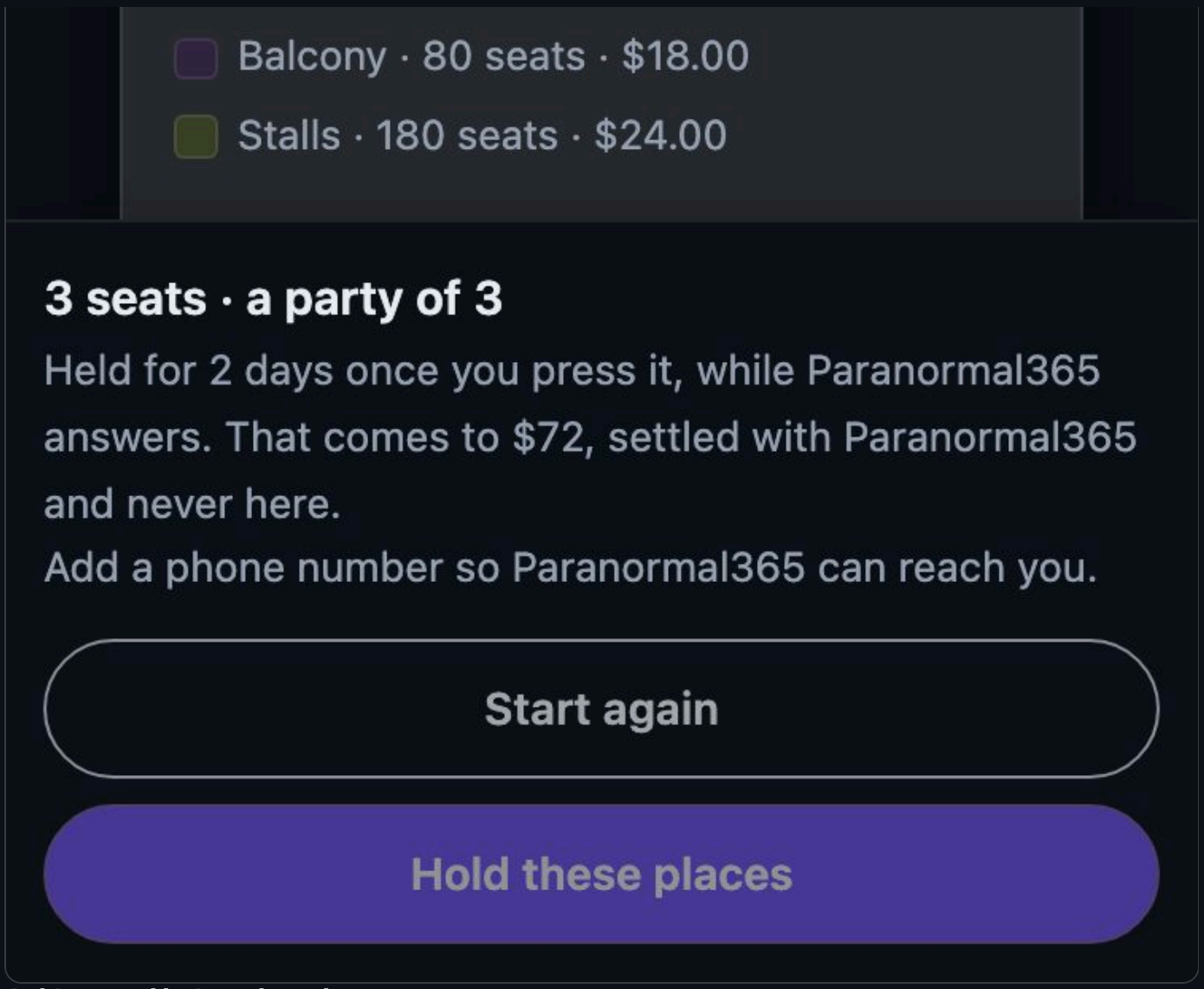


Tap a seat to choose it, and tap it again to unselect it. Nothing is held yet.

- **What you pick is the size of your party.** Three seats means three people. If there are four of you, pick four — the venue can't confirm a party that doesn't match its places.
- **Nothing is held until you press the button.** Until then you can change your mind, and *Start again* clears everything.
- **Once you press it, nobody else can take those places** while the venue considers your request. The page tells you how long that lasts before you commit — usually a couple of days.
- **If someone takes a seat a second before you do**, you're told which seat it was, and everything else you chose stays yours. Pick another one and carry on.
- **To change held places, let them go and pick again.** You can still change your note, and who's coming, while they're held. If a hold runs out, you can choose again straight away.

On a phone, the summary and the button stay at the bottom of the screen the whole time, so you never have to scroll back through two hundred squares to check what you've picked.


4
DP
A St...
A1
A2
A3
A4
A5
B St...
B1
B2
B3
B4
B5
C St...
C1
C2
C3
C4
C5
D St...
D1
D2
D3
D4
D5
E St...
E1
E2
E3
E4
E5
F St...
F1
F2
F3
F4
F5
G St...
G1 —
G2 —
G3
G4
G5
H St...
H1
H2
H3
H4
H5
J St...
J1
J2
J3
J4
J5



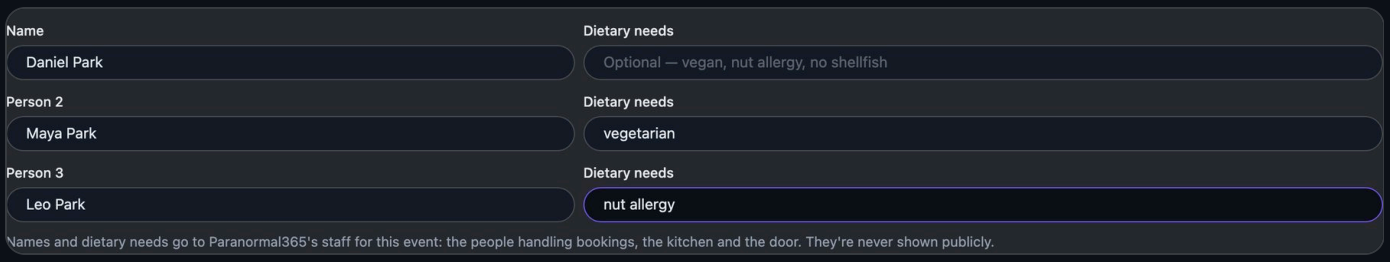
Asking, and being placed

Other events take written requests. You say which nights you're coming, how many of you there are, and which room you'd like if you have a preference. The venue assigns you a place when it answers.

- **A request holds nothing.** It goes into a queue, and the venue works through it.
- **The room you name is a preference, not a booking.** Venues move parties around all the time, and the most common outcome is being given something better than you asked for.
- **Two nights out of three is an ordinary booking.** Each night has its own checkbox, so if only Saturday suits you, just come for Saturday.
- **Just for the day** is the same form without a room, for venues that offer day passes.
- **Your first and last name and a phone number are required**, so the venue can reach you. Until they're filled in, the button stays grayed out, and the line beside it says what's still missing.

Who's coming

When you ask for a place or hold places, the form has a row for each person in your party. Give each person's name and anything they can't eat, such as *vegan* or *nut allergy*. The first row is you. It's all optional, but it helps the kitchen cook for everyone.



- **A dietary note needs a name beside it**, so the kitchen knows whose it is.
- **Who sees them:** the event's staff — the people handling bookings, the kitchen and the door. Names and dietary needs are never shown publicly.
- **To change them later**, open your booking on the event's page, on **What I'm going to**, or on your pass, and press **Add names and dietary needs** (or **Change names and dietary needs**). Change what you need to and press **Save**.
- **Changing names or dietary needs doesn't change your places.** If the venue has already confirmed you, you're still confirmed.
- If you chose your places without an account, you can add names once you've followed the link in the email and signed in.

What the answer means

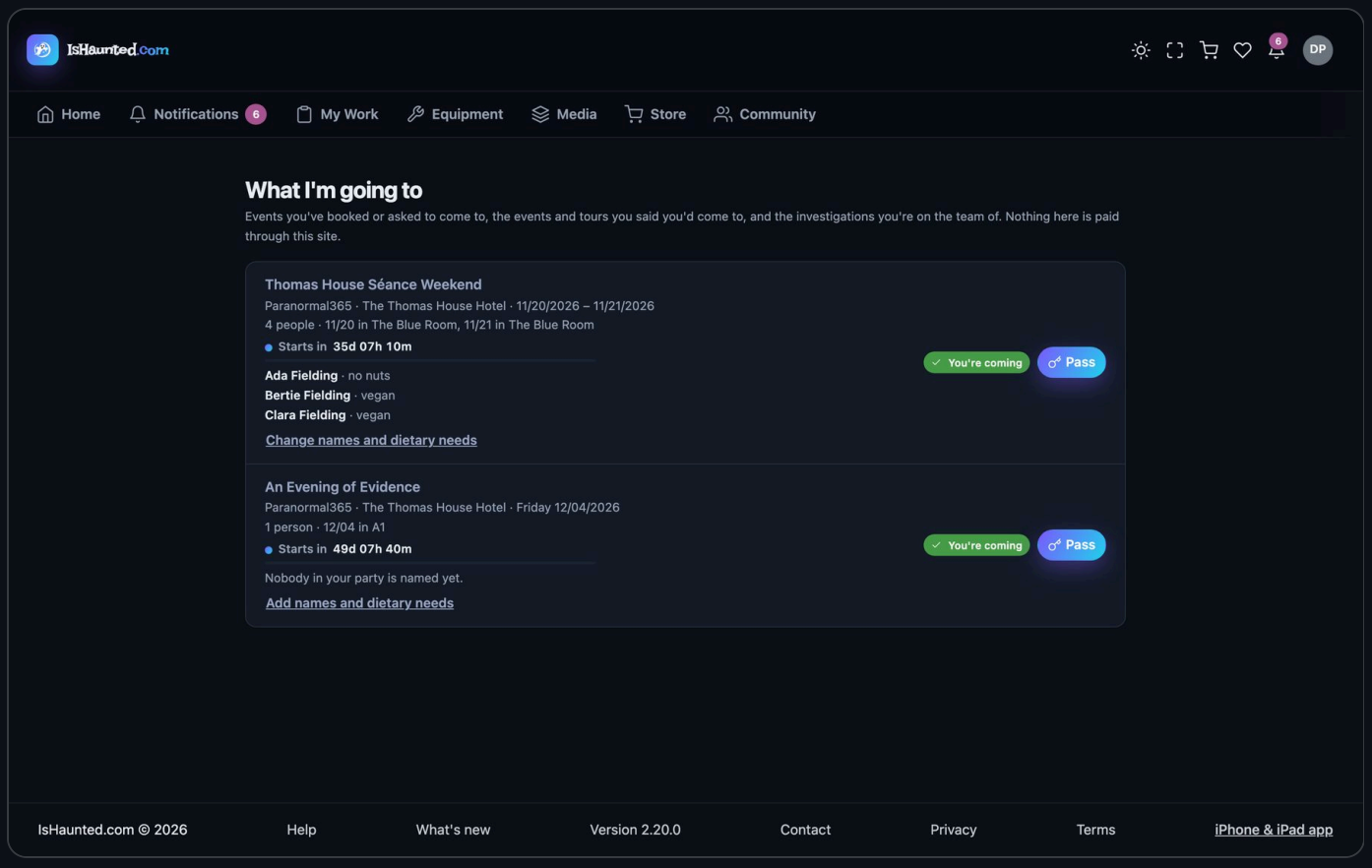
Your booking appears on the event's page and always shows one of these:

IT SAYS	WHAT IT MEANS
Asked for	The venue has your request and hasn't answered yet. Nothing is held.
Held for you	Nobody else can take your places until the time runs out.
You're coming	The venue has confirmed you, and your pass is on the page.
Not this time	The venue couldn't take this request. Another date may have room, and **Ask again** sends a new request.
Hold ran out	Nobody answered in time, so the places were released. You can choose again.

A hold that runs out is not a refusal. It just means time ran out before anyone looked at it. The places went back on offer, and you're welcome to choose again if they're still available.

Everything you're going to

What I'm going to (`/my-events`) lists every event you've asked to attend or been given a place at, whichever group is running it. When a venue answers you, the bell links here. Below your bookings are the other events and tours you said you'd come to and the investigations you're on the team of, soonest first, each counting down to its start. Anything that ended in the last 30 days is under **Recently**, which says what you had, such as "You had a place" or "You were on the team".

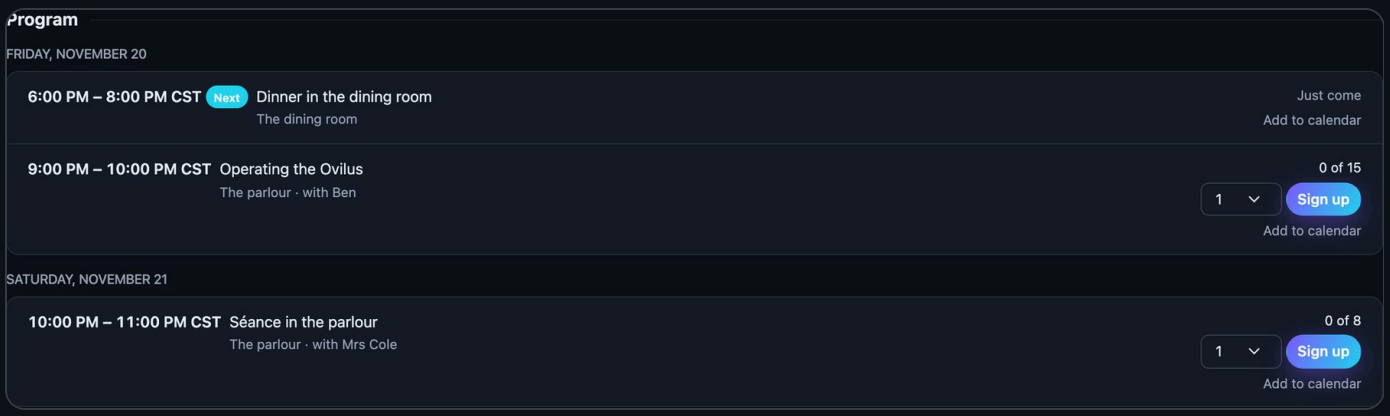


Places you have, or are waiting to hear about, come first. Below them are any requests that didn't work out. We keep these on purpose: if you were released from a weekend, you may still have that date free.

Under each event you'll see the sessions you signed up for, with their times. A session is marked if you're on its waiting list or if it has been canceled. You'll also see who's coming, and you can change their names and dietary needs there.

The program

Some events have a program: a class, a talk, a séance, dinner. It's on the event's page, night by night, **in the venue's local time** — 9 PM means 9 PM at the venue, wherever you're reading from. While the event is underway, **Now** and **Next** show what's happening.



- **Just come** means there's nothing to sign up for.
- **3 of 15** means the session has a limited number of places, and shows how many are taken. You see how many, never who.
- **Sign up** reserves a place once the venue has **confirmed** your place at the event, for as many people in your party as you choose. While your booking is still waiting on the venue, the page tells you that instead.
- **Join the queue** appears when a session is full. You're told your place in line, and if a spot opens up, places go to people in the order they asked — we'll write to let you know. A party waits until there are enough places for everyone, rather than being split up.
- **Leave** gives your place to whoever is next.
- **Add to calendar** adds the session to your calendar at the right time.

If a session moves or is canceled after you've planned around it, we'll write to let you know, the bell shows **The program changed**, and the session is marked **Changed** until you've looked at it.

Program

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 20

6:00 PM – 8:00 PM CST Next

Dinner in the dining room

The dining room

Just come

Add to calendar

9:00 PM – 10:00 PM CST

Operating the Ovilus

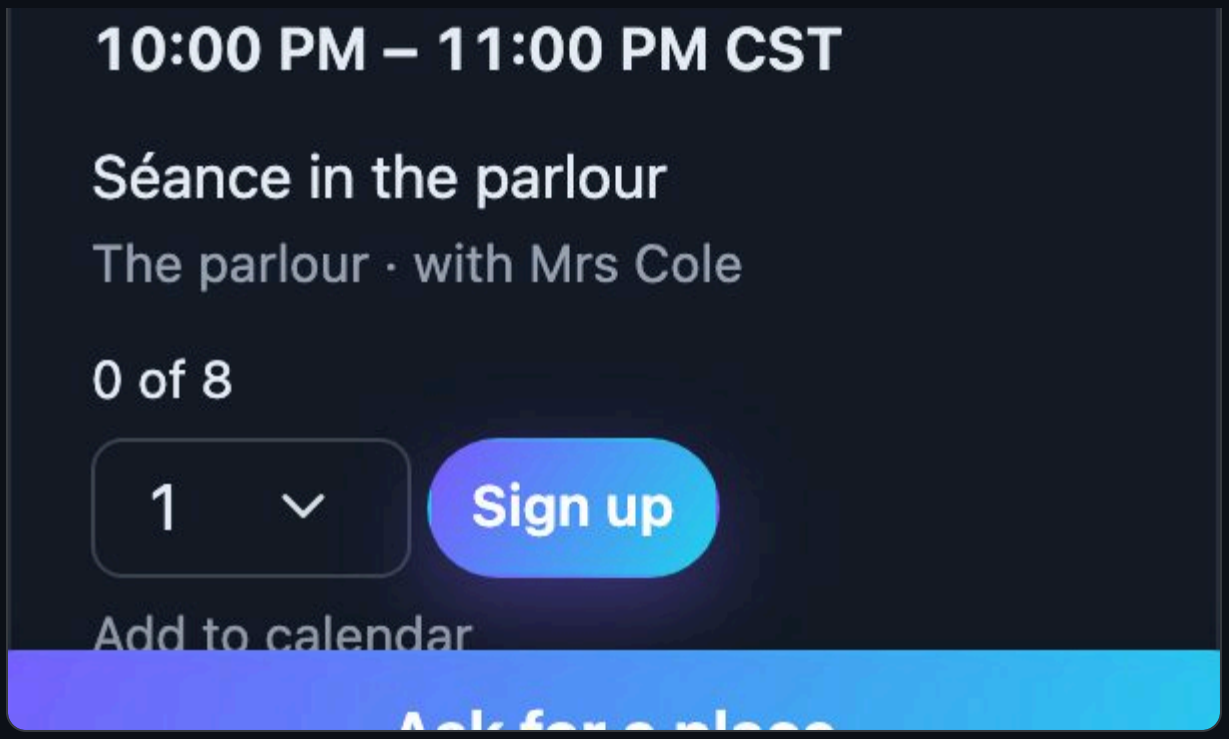
The parlour · with Ben

0 of 15

1 Sign up

Add to calendar

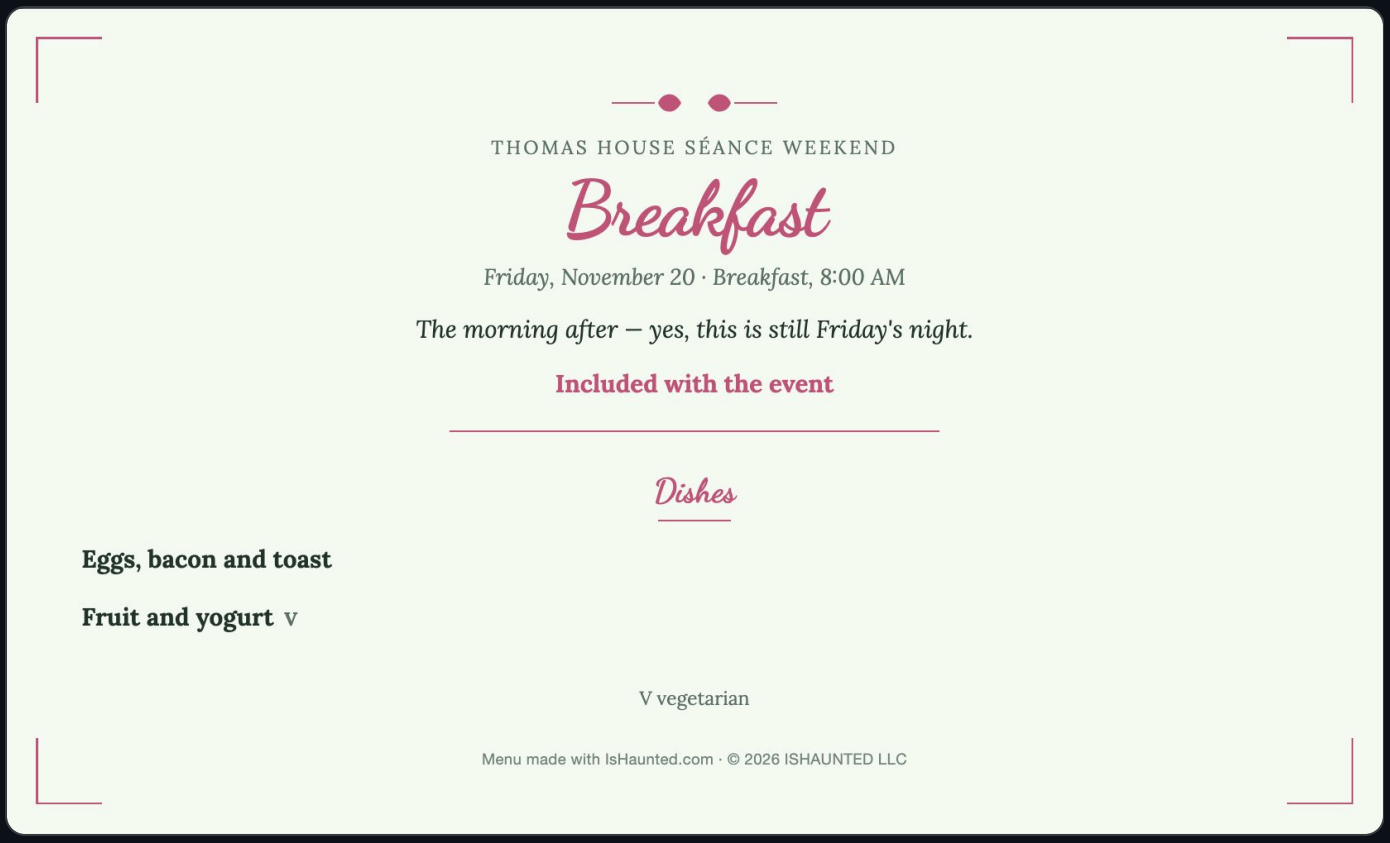
SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 21



The iPhone and iPad app has the same program, menus, downloads and room under **Profile → What I'm going to → The event**. See the mobile apps.

The menus

When the venue has published its menus, they're on the event's page, under **Menu**. Each date in the list of dates shows what's served that night, and each menu says when it's served, its price, and what each dish is: **V** vegetarian, **VG** vegan, **GF** gluten free and so on, with a key at the bottom, and what it contains, such as *Contains milk, eggs*. Anything on offer the whole time, like a snack table, is marked **Throughout the event**.



A menu says how each thing is paid for. A price beside a dish means it's paid for on its own, such as a drink from the bar. **Included** means the event's price covers it. A price at the top, such as *Adults $25*, is the price of the meal. Under the dates, **Included with the event** says which meals your place covers. **Download this menu as a PDF** saves a copy to print or keep. The iPhone and iPad app shows the same menus, in the same look, with the same PDF.

Alcohol is marked **21+**, and it is always priced on its own, never included in the meal's price or the event's. The menus also appear on the dates in your calendar file and on the group's calendar.

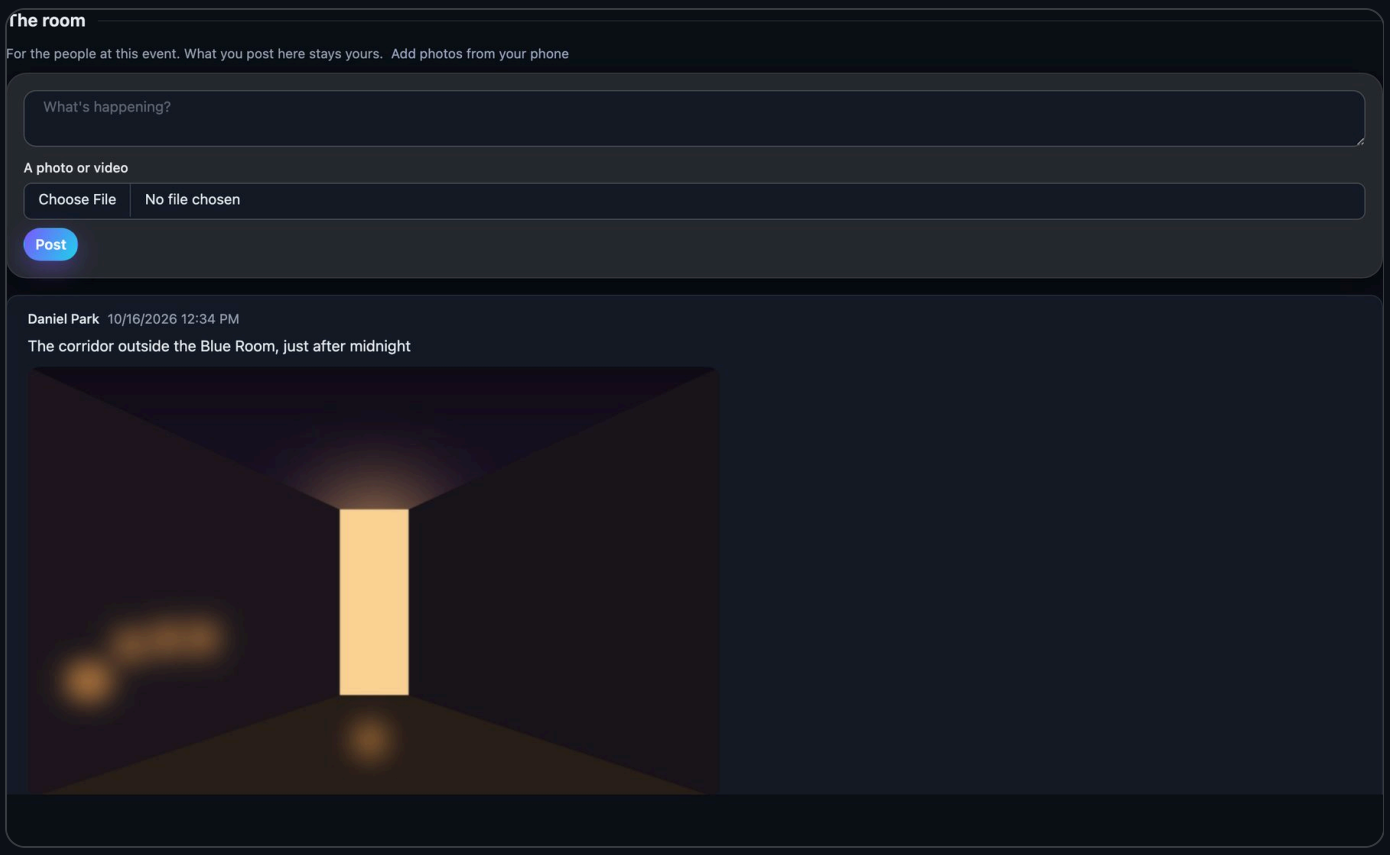
The marks on a menu describe the food. If there's something someone in your party can't eat, add it to your booking under Who's coming, and the kitchen will see it.

Downloads

An event can share files — for example, a poster anyone can download, and a guest pack with the practical details for people who are coming. The event's page lists the files you can download under **Downloads**. Files marked **For guests** appear once the venue has confirmed your place.

The room and the photo wall

Once the venue has confirmed your place, the event's page shows **The room**: a space where the people at the event — guests, organizers and anyone helping — can post what's happening. Nobody else can see it, and nothing in it appears on the public feed. You don't have to be checked in at the door: the room opens to you as soon as your place is confirmed, so you can talk to the others before the event as well as during it.



What you post stays yours. A photo you add is saved as your own file. You can choose to share it with the organizers, and with the venue if the venue is on the site — check the box when you post, or press **Send to…** under the post later. Sending a photo shares it with them; it doesn't give it away. **Take down** removes your post from the room but keeps the photo in your own files.

Add photos from your phone opens a page designed for phones: choose pictures from your camera roll or take new ones, add a caption, and send. They go into the room and onto the **photo wall** — a full-screen slideshow the organizers can show on a screen at the venue. Only the organizers and the venue can open the wall, so strangers can never browse the photos there.

Add photos

They go into the event's room, and onto the photo wall the organizers show at the venue. They stay yours.

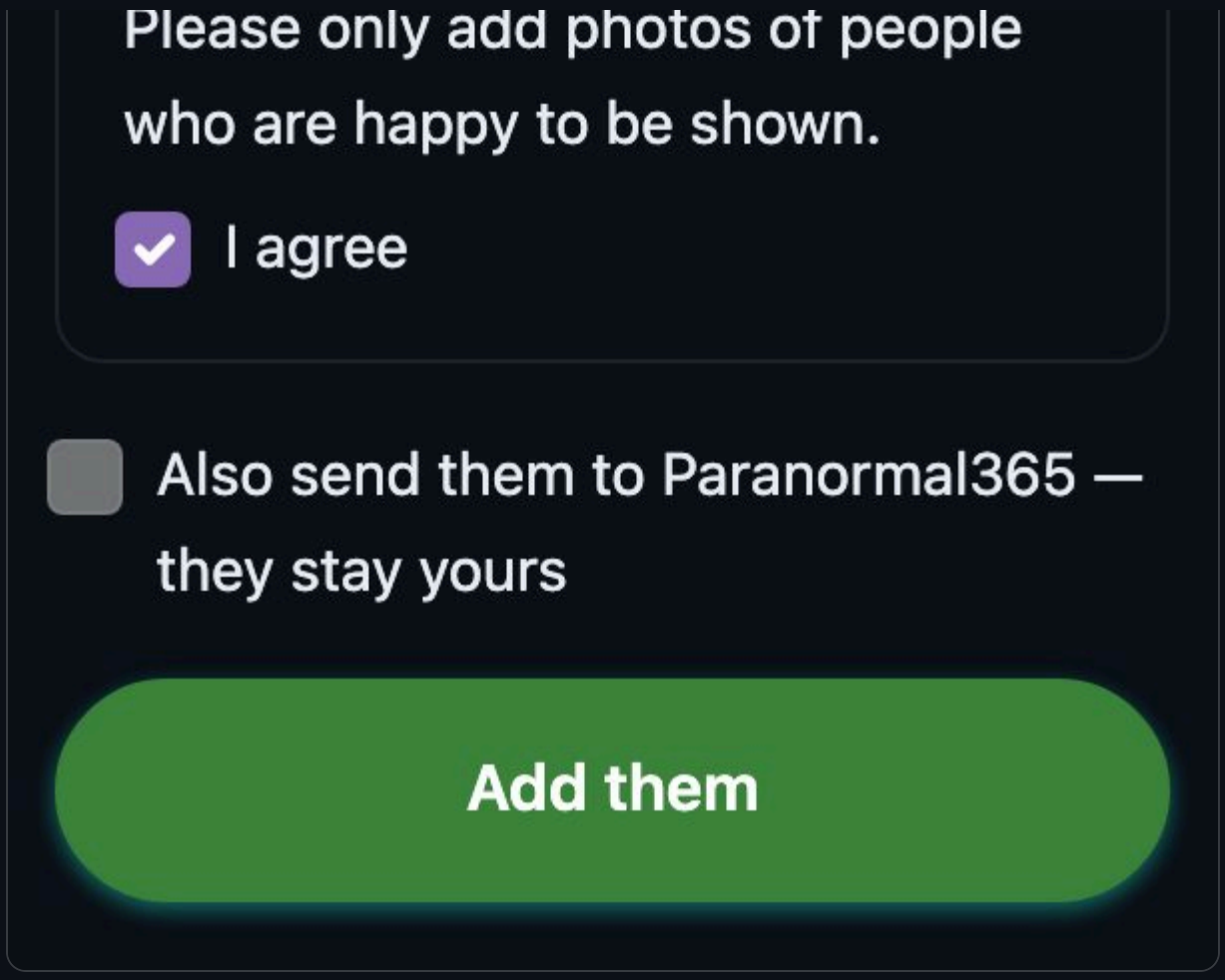
Choose photos or videos

1 chosen

Say something about them (optional)

The corridor outside the Blue Roc

Photos you add here are shown to the people at this event in its room, and the organizers may show them on a photo wall or slideshow at the venue. Your photos stay yours, and you can take one down at any time.



The first time you add a photo at an event, you're asked to agree that your photos may be shown to the people at the event in its room, and on a photo wall or slideshow the organizers display at the venue. You're asked once per event, and the photos still belong to you. Please only add photos of people who are happy to be shown.

The organizers can choose to allow photos only from the event's own team; you can still write in the room when they do. The room stops taking new posts a week after the last night, but stays available so you can look back through it.

Posts from the people running the event have a colored edge and a badge — *Organizer*, *Guide*, *Venue* — so you can tell them from other guests.

On a ghost walk it's different: the walk's room is only for people the guide has checked in. Once you're checked in, the walk's page and the app show **The walk's room**, where you and the others on the walk, and your guides, can keep in touch. It's words only, and it stays open for a week after the walk.

Writing to the organizers

If you have a booking at an event, whatever became of it, the event's page has **Write to the organizers**. Ask about parking, your booking, what to bring, or anything else. Before an event starts, you can ask its organizers

a question even without a booking. Sign in and it's on the event's page. Once the event starts, you can still read their answer, but only people with a booking can write. Only the group running the event, and the people they've asked to answer bookings, see what you write. Nobody else does, and it never appears on the feed or in the room.

Their answer appears in the same place, marked with a colored edge, and your bell tells you when it arrives. The iPhone and iPad app has the same conversation under **Profile → What I'm going to → The event → Write to the organizers**. It's words only, and it stays open until a month after the event ends.

When the organizer starts the group's session

When it's time to investigate, the organizer, a guide or whoever is running the door starts the sessions. Everyone with a place gets a plain notice: *Sessions are now being accepted for this event.* If you have the IsHaunted app, it arrives as a notification, and you can start yours from it, from the card in your feed, or from **Happening now** in the Paranormal Platform. Nothing records until you press Start, and you can send what you recorded that night or days later. See The iPhone and iPad Apps.

A ticket at the door

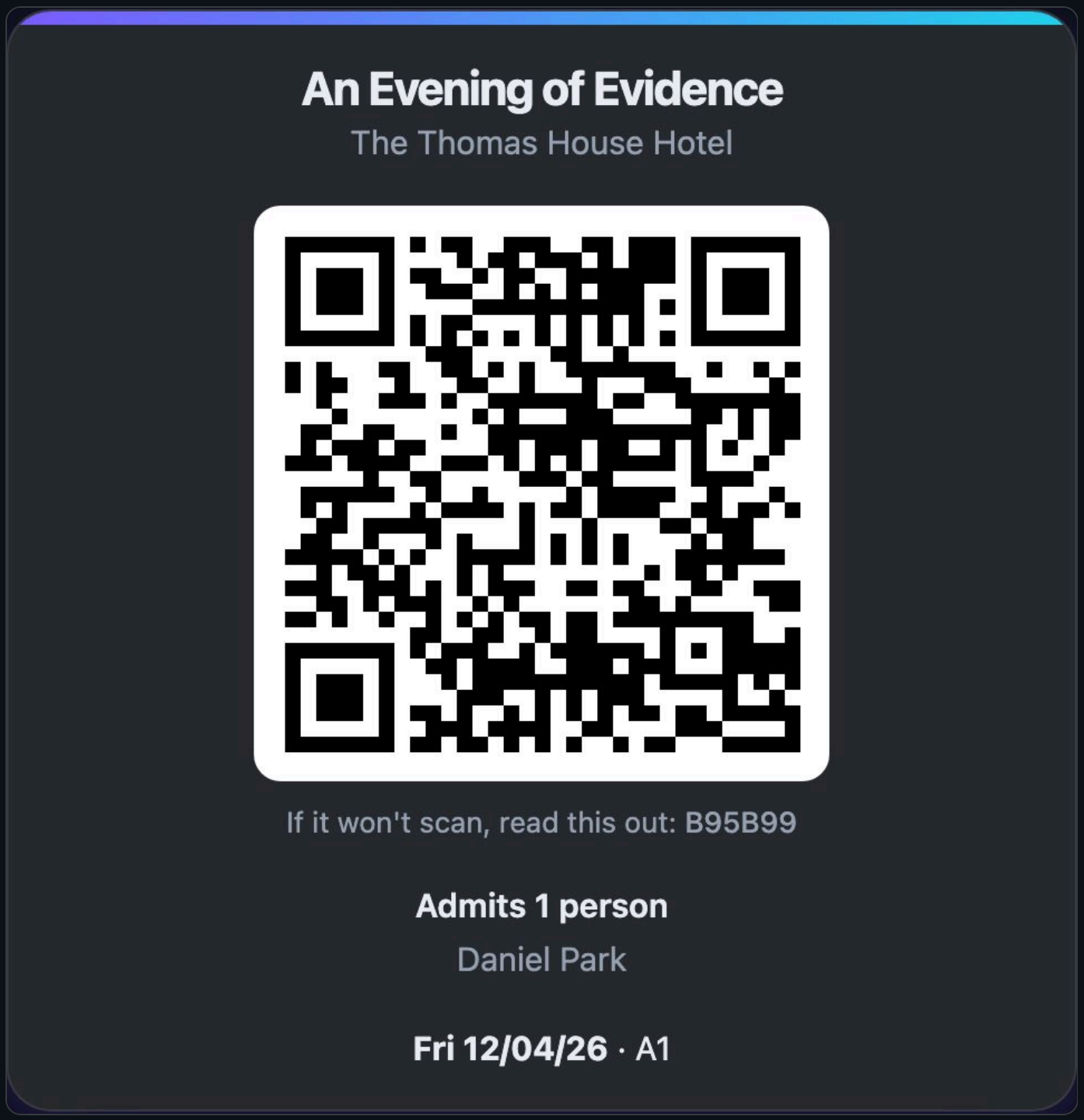
Some organizers sell places at the door. Scan the QR code by the door with your phone's camera, sign in or make an account, and ask for your place. Pay them however they take it — nothing is paid through this site. When they confirm you, your pass appears on the same screen, ready to scan in.

You need an account to ask at the door. It takes a minute with an email address, and it's what your pass, the room and the results letter are sent to. **If the event is full**, you can still ask: it goes to the organizers as a request, and they can let you in if a place opens up.

If an organizer has already been paid by you, they may send you a **ticket** by email instead. Opening its link confirms your place straight away and sends you your pass. If the event filled up before you opened it, it arrives as a request instead, and the organizers will sort it out with you.

Your pass

Once a venue confirms you, your pass appears on the event's page and on **What I'm going to**. **One pass admits the whole party**, not one pass each. Three of the four people arriving together may never have had an account here, and one person holding one pass is much quicker at the door than four people each hunting for their own code.



- **Everything the code says is also written out in words**: who the pass is for, how many people it admits, which nights, and which room or seat. A cracked screen, a camera that won't focus in the dark, or a phone at four percent battery is normal on a night like this, and the door staff can still work from what's written.
- **The short code underneath** is what someone at the door types in if the camera can't scan your pass. You can read it out loud; it isn't secret, and it only works at that event.
- **Email it to me** sends you the venue's confirmation email again, pass included, at the address on your account.
- **It prints.** Print it and you get just the pass, without the page's buttons.

- **A withdrawn pass is shown, not hidden.** It appears faded, with the venue's reason on it. A blank screen looks like an error and might send someone to the door anyway; the reason tells them what to do instead.

If the venue has seated you for dinner or another meal, your pass also shows your table for each sitting.

On an iPhone or iPad, the app shows the same pass under **Profile → What I'm going to**, and keeps a copy on the phone so it opens even with no signal. See the mobile apps.

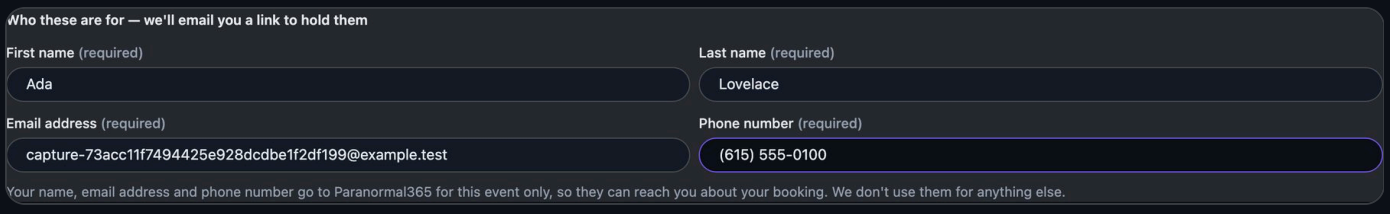
What we write to you

- **When you ask**, an email confirms your request arrived and that nothing is held yet.
- **When you hold places**, an email tells you how long they're held — in the venue's local time, since that's the time the deadline runs on.
- **When the venue answers**, an email gives you the decision. If the answer is yes, it includes your pass and a calendar entry for each night.
- **If your hold runs out**, an email tells you so, and that you're still on the venue's list. It's deliberately a different email from a refusal.
- **If the event is canceled, or gets the numbers it needs**, everyone with a place or waiting for one gets an email.
- **When the hosts need everyone to know something** — the parking has moved, doors open later — they can write to everyone with a place. The message comes from the event and arrives in your email and in your messages here, and replying reaches the hosts.

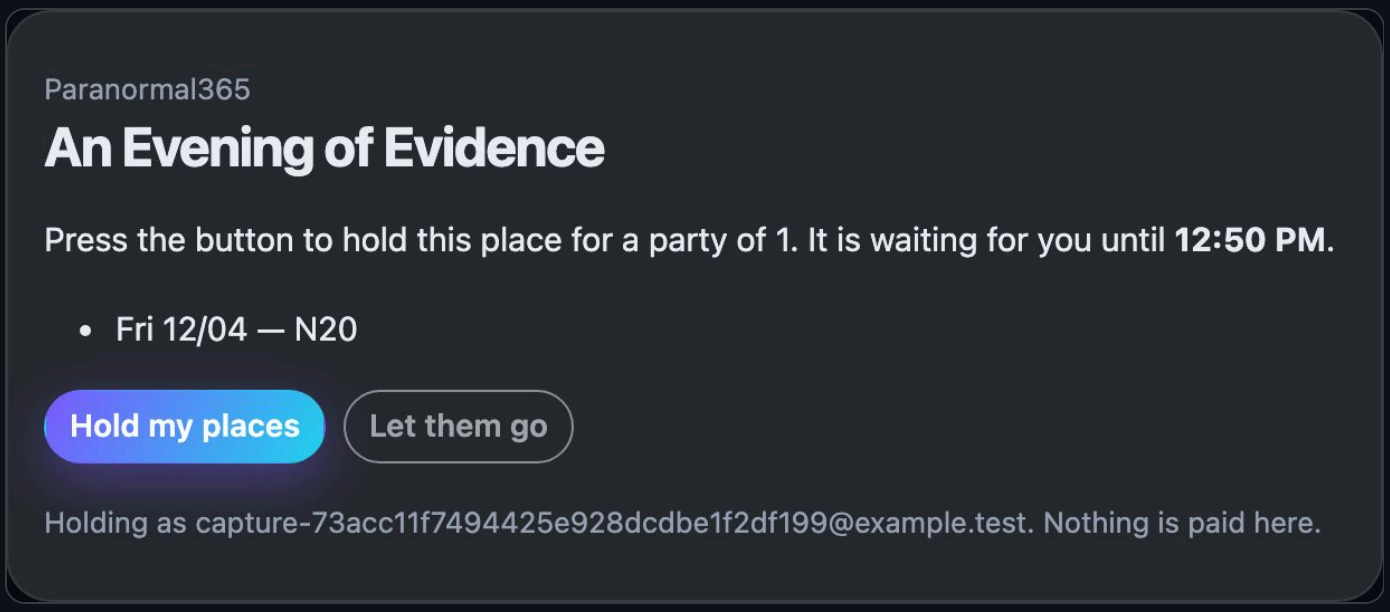
If the site has no outgoing email set up, nothing is sent, but everything still works — the pages show the same information.

Choosing without an account

You can pick seats or rooms without signing in. Tap what you want, then enter your **first and last name, your email address and a phone number** so the organizer can reach you about your booking. These details go to the organizer for this event only, and we don't use them for anything else.



Press **Email me a link to hold these**. For the next **fifteen minutes**, nobody else can take those places, and the email has a button that holds them properly:



- **Press the button in the email within fifteen minutes.** After that, the places are released and you can just pick again.
- **Once you press it, the places are held** just as if you'd signed in, for as long as the venue gives itself to answer.
- **The same link keeps working for a month.** It shows whether the venue has answered, and lets you release the places without a password.
- **If you pick again with the same email address**, your new choice replaces the old one.
- **If a lot of people are waiting to confirm at once**, you may be asked to sign in or try again in a few minutes. This stops anyone from tying up a whole night with email addresses that never confirm.
- Pressing the button creates an account for you with that email address and no password. You can set a password whenever you like, but you don't have to.

If you're signed in, you're asked for these three things only if your account doesn't already have them. A phone number you give for a booking stays with that booking; it isn't added to your profile.

Coming without an account

You can ask for a day pass with your name, email address and phone number. We email you a link, and clicking it confirms that **you've asked for a place** — not that you're coming, because the venue hasn't answered yet.

That link also creates an account for you with no password. Anything beyond a day pass — choosing your own seats, your pass, changing your mind — requires signing in, so the page offers to set a password right away instead of leaving you to find out later.

Changing your mind

- **Never mind** withdraws a request or releases a hold right away.
- **I can't make it** on a booking the venue has already confirmed *asks* the venue to release it, instead of releasing it yourself. They've planned food and staff around your places, and may have turned someone else away, so a person decides and will be in touch.

If the event changes

- **A minimum number.** Some events only go ahead if enough people come. When that's the case, the page shows the number and the date the venue will decide by, from the first time you look — so you never find out on the day.
- **New dates, times or a new venue.** We write to you saying what changed. Your booking still stands; if the change doesn't work for you, let your places go from the event's page. A date you're booked on can't be taken off until the organizers have moved or released your booking.
- **Called off.** You're told, and anything you were holding is released. The organizers may tell you the new date, or how to get your money back; it's in the letter and on the event's page. An event can't be called off once it has happened.
- **The venue withdraws.** This is rare, and it's handled the same way: everything is released and everyone is told.

After the event

The morning after the last night, the organizer may send a **thank-you** to everyone who was there: a personal note, a link to the photos if they've added any, a link to say how it was, and what they have coming up next. If you had a place but weren't checked in, you may get a **we missed you** letter instead.

Evidence. At an event that takes evidence, either letter may say how long the organizer is accepting it — for example, *for three days* — and when the results should be ready. Offer what you caught under **Were you there?** on the event's page before the deadline the page shows. When the results are ready, the organizer may email everyone who had a place, with a link and a QR code to the results page. The evidence they accepted is listed with the most *confirms* votes first, then in the order it was caught, and if they ask, you can vote for the best. With the IsHaunted app, the results are also under **Results** on the event.

- **Only *confirms* votes decide the order.** Other votes are counted but don't move a piece up. When two pieces have the same number of *confirms*, the one caught first comes first.
- **The deadline is for evidence you offer on the page.** Sessions you recorded with the IsHaunted app can still be sent to the event after it, because a long night can take days to go through.

Who sees the findings. What the organizers accept is seen first only by the people who were there: the organizers, the event's staff and guests with a confirmed place. Sign in to see it. The organizers may then

make the findings public, so anybody can see them. At someone's home, they always stay with the people who were there.

The place's page. At a public place, the organizers may also ask to show what you sent on the place's own page, credited to you. You get a message the day they choose it, and it appears a week later. If you'd rather it didn't, choose **Keep it off the place's page** beside it under **My evidence** or **My field sessions**, or turn on **Keep what I send off** the place's page on your booking to cover everything you send from that event. You can do that any time — before the event, during it, or after it appears — and it comes off at once.

Your sessions in the results. When you send a session from the app to an event, you can turn on **May be shown with the results**, or tick the same box later under **My field sessions** on the website. If you do, and the organizers choose to show it, it can be played from the event's page in the session player, with any EVPs marked, credited to you — by anybody once the findings are public. Your exact position is never shown. It's only possible at an event that takes evidence, at a public place. Turn the box off and it comes off the page at once.

Saying how it was is open to anyone who had a confirmed place — the person who booked, and any guests they named who have an account — for two months after the event ends. It's one to five stars plus a few words if you like, and you can change it or take it down. You can find it in the thank-you, on the event's page while it's still up, or from **Say how it was** on *What I'm going to*.

The organizer can hide a review from the event's page but can never change what it says. If yours is hidden, you can still see it, marked as hidden. On the page for a group's next event, a line sums up what guests thought of its earlier ones.

GETTING STARTED

Shopping at the Store

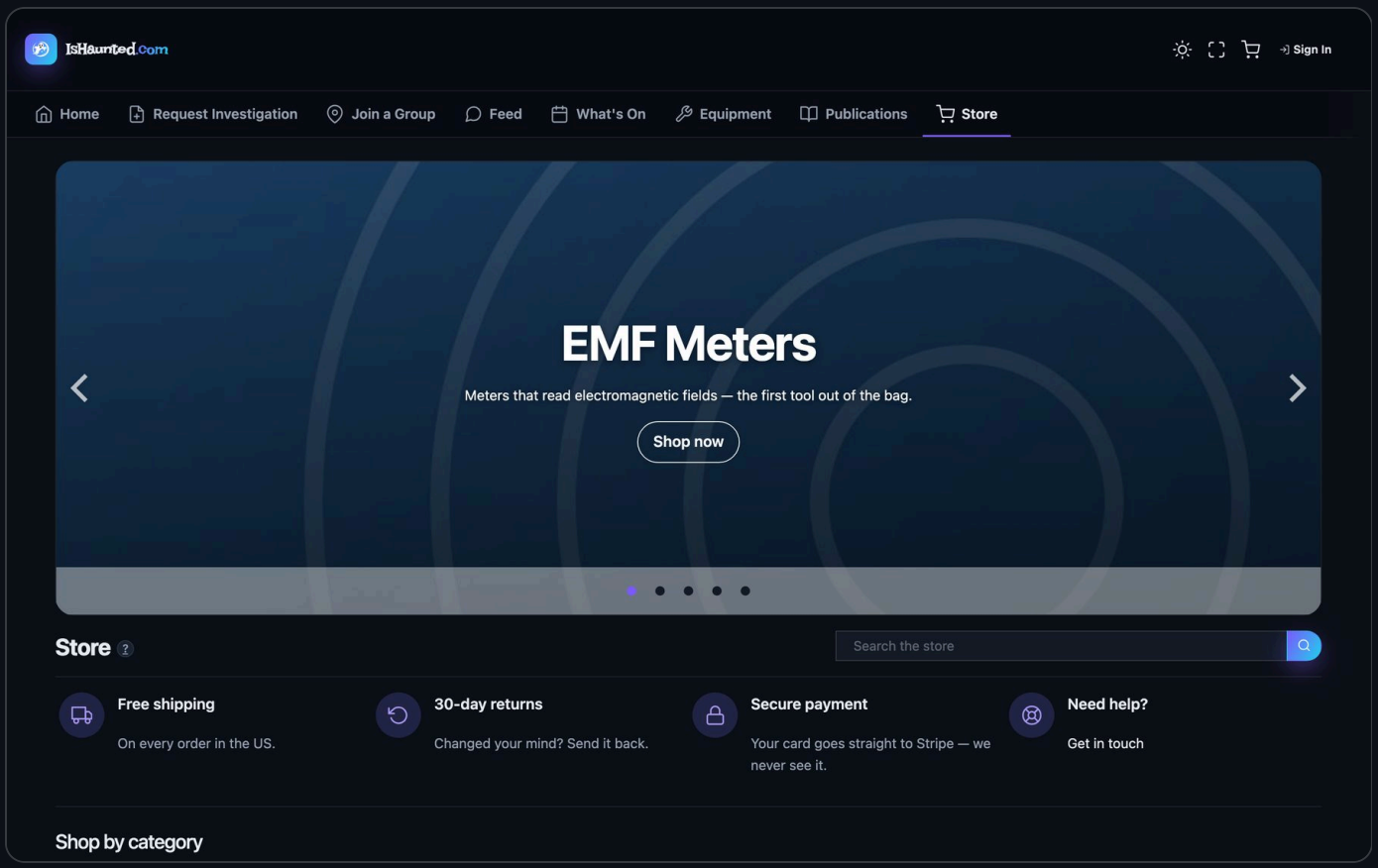
Finding gear, choosing options, your cart, placing an order, delivery, returns, favorites and reviews.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

The store sells scientific gear for investigations — EMF meters, spirit boxes, recorders and the things that go with them. Anyone can buy, with or without an account.

Finding something

Store in the menu opens the front of the store: its shelves — EMF meters, spirit boxes, recorders and so on — and rows of featured, new and popular gear. Pick a shelf to see everything on it, or **Browse everything** to see the whole store.

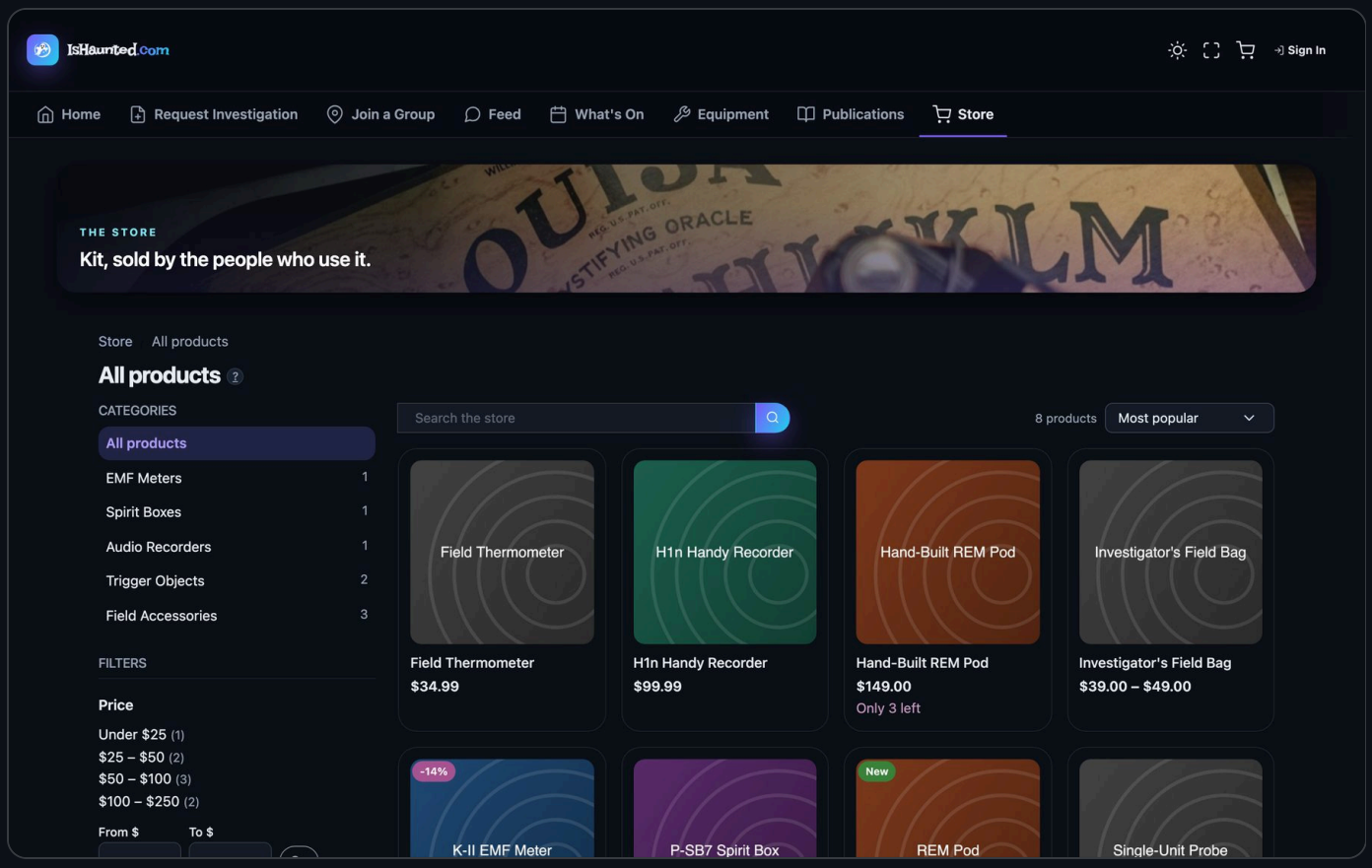


The search box finds gear by name, and by the code on its label (the SKU). Suggestions appear as you type two letters or more; press Enter to see every match.

You can narrow a list with the filters down the side of the page — or, on a phone or a tablet held upright, with the **Filters** button:

- **Price** — a band, or your own range with **Go**.
- **Color**, **Size** and the product's other options — check as many as you like. Two colors means either color; a color and a size means both.
- **Rating** — four stars and up, three and up, and so on.
- **In stock only** — hides what is sold out.

Each filter you choose shows as a chip above the list. Its ✕ removes that filter, and **Clear all** removes them all. **Sort** orders the list by popularity, newest, rating or price. Your choices are saved in the page address, so you can bookmark a filtered list or send it to a friend, and it opens the same way.



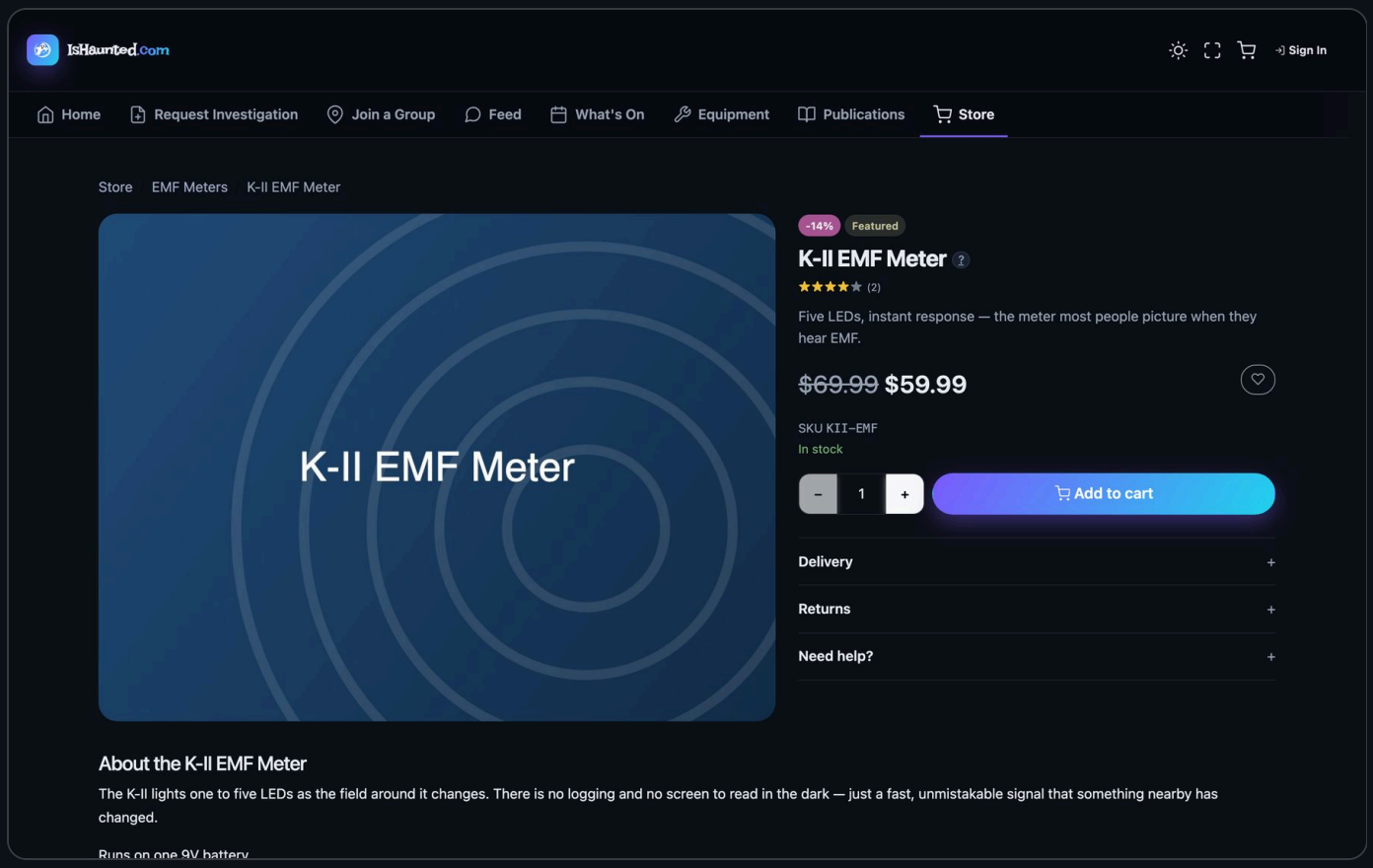
A card marked **Sold out** is still listed, so you can see what the store carries, but you can't buy it until it's back in stock. **Only 3 left** means only three are in stock.

Options and prices

Some gear comes in more than one version, such as a color or a size. Pick each option on the product page. The price, the stock line and the code under them change to match your choice, and so does the picture if that version has its own.

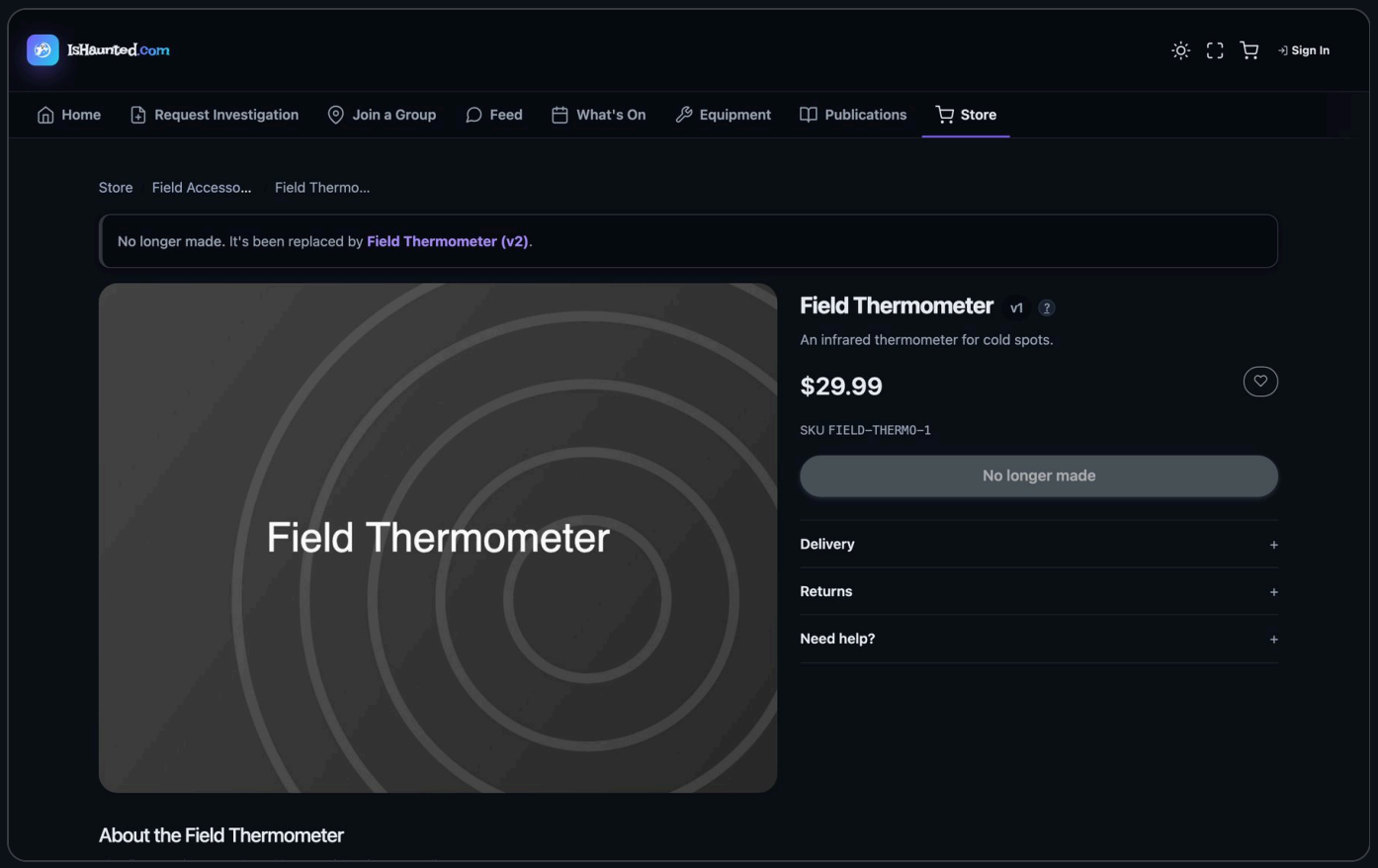
A choice with a dashed ring is **sold out** in that combination. You can still pick it, and the button will say **Sold out**. If you can't pick a choice at all, that version doesn't exist with what you've already chosen — Camo may come in only one size, for example.

If a price has another price struck through beside it, the item is on sale; the struck-through price is what it used to cost. Prices are in US dollars and do not include sales tax or delivery, which are added at checkout.



Newer versions

When an item is replaced by a better one, its page says so: **A newer version is available**, with a link. If the old one is no longer made, its page stays up — so a saved link still works — but says **No longer made** and points to the new one. A new version's page links back to the one before.



Your cart

You don't need an account to shop. Until you sign in, your cart is kept in your browser. When you sign in, it's added to your account's cart, so anything you picked out beforehand is still there. A cart saved on your account follows you to any device you sign in on.

Adding something. On a product's page, choose any options, set how many you want and press **Add to cart**. A product with only one version has a cart button on its card in the lists as well. The cart slides out from the side to show what you added. If fewer are left than you asked for, you get the ones that are left and a note saying how many that was.

My Cart

view cart page

K-II EMF Meter

− 1 +

$59.99

$59.99 / item

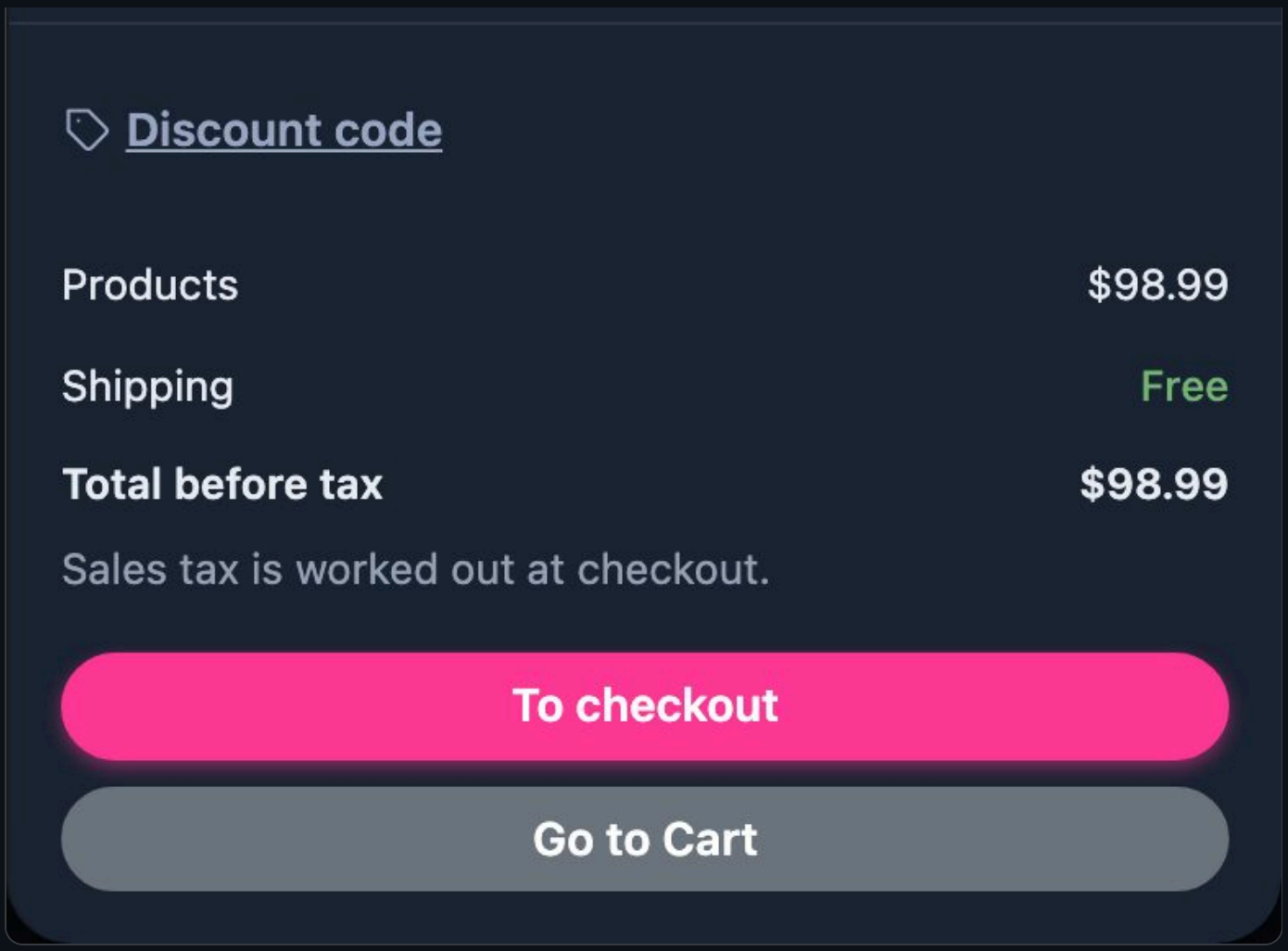
Investigator's Field Bag

Black / Standard

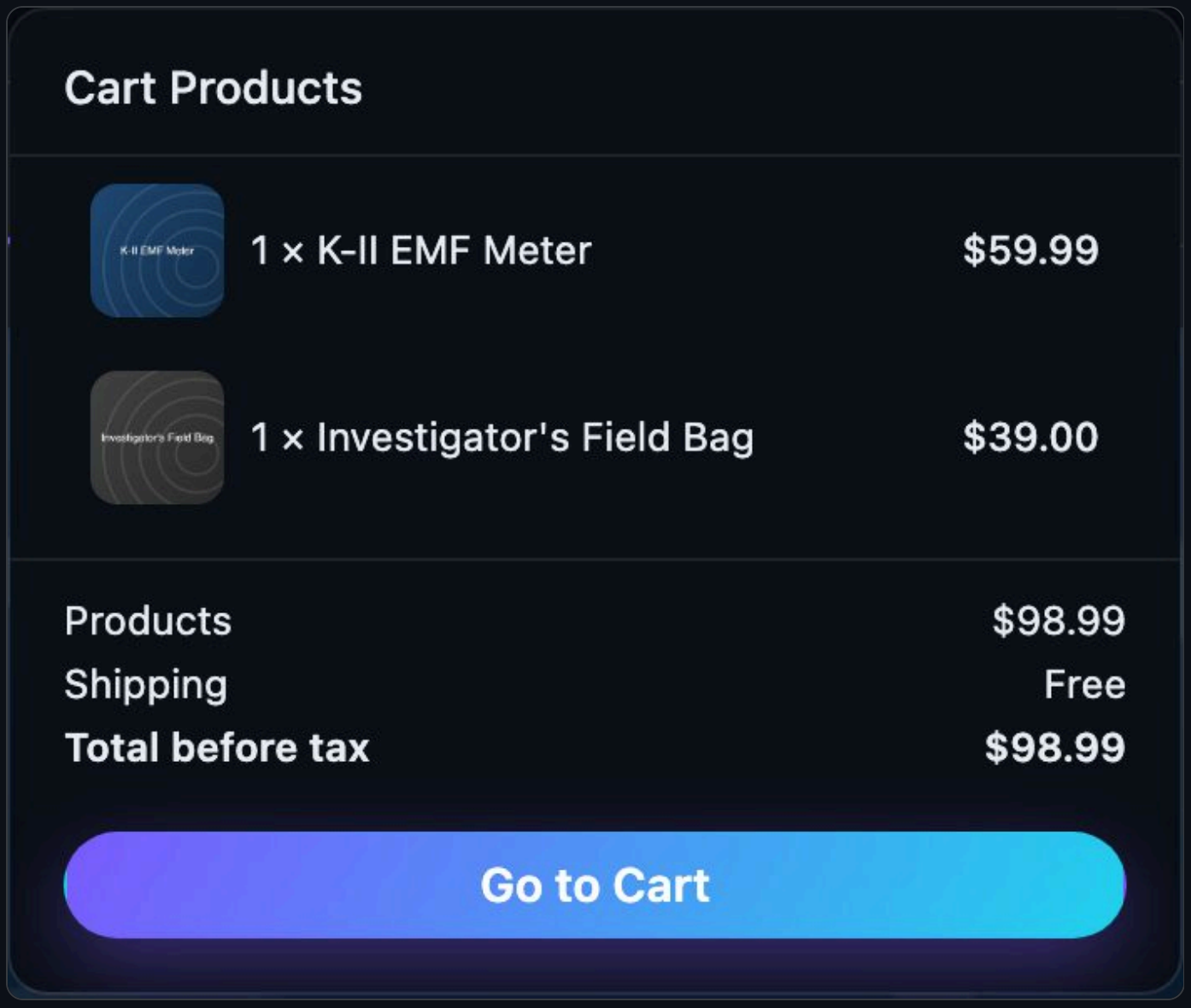
− 1 +

$39.00

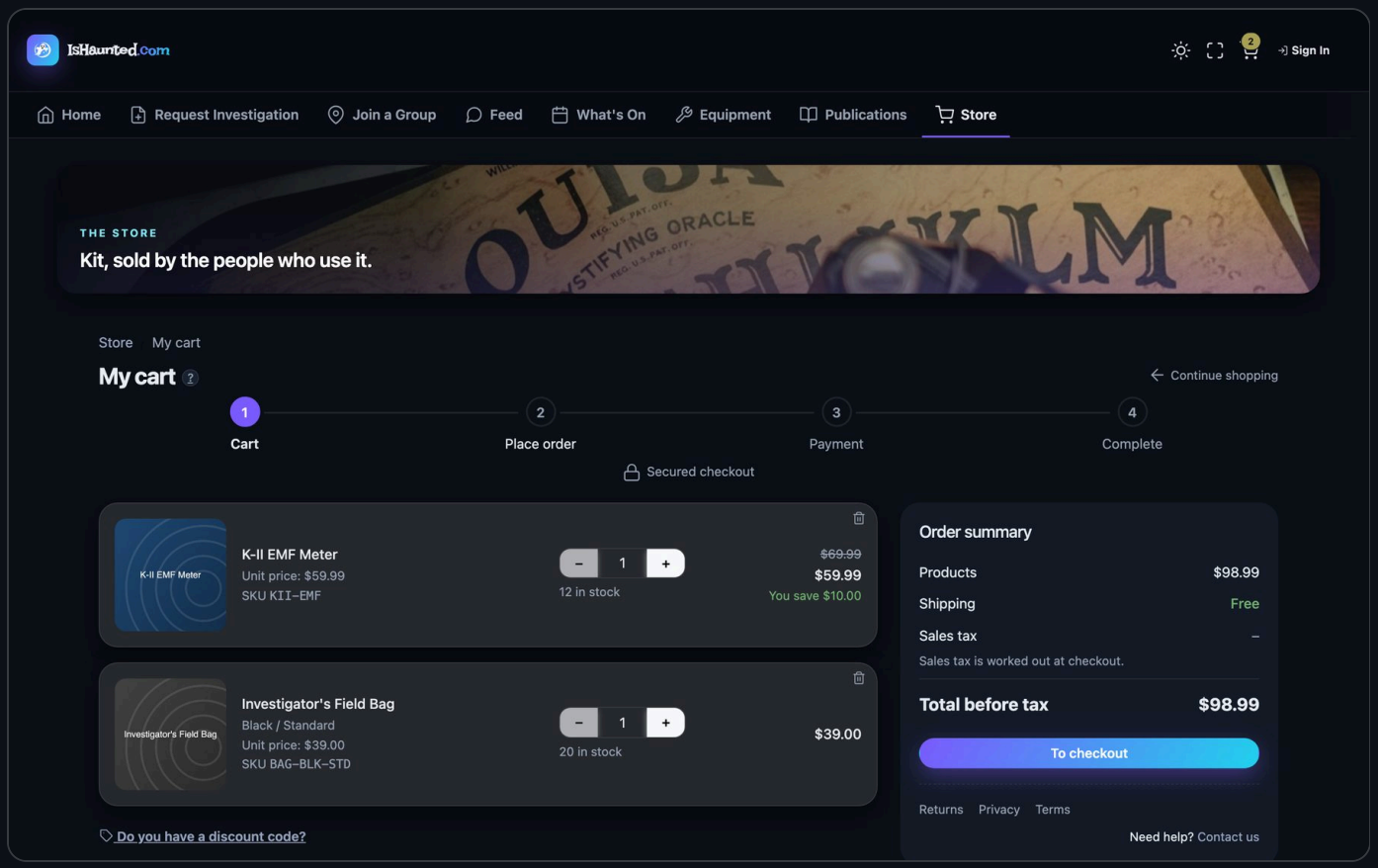
$39.00 / item



Seeing your cart. The cart icon at the top of every page shows how many things are in it. Tap it for a quick look — the items, the products total, shipping and the total before tax — or press **Go to Cart** for the full cart page.



Changing quantities. On the cart page or in the slide-out cart, use − and + to change how many. The totals update as you press — there's no "update cart" button to remember. The trash can icon removes an item. Each item says how many are in stock. An item that has sold out, or has been taken out of the store since you added it, is marked in red. Fix or remove it before checking out.



Discount codes. On the cart page, press **Do you have a discount code?**, type the code and press **Apply**. In the slide-out cart, open **Discount code**. A code comes off the products, never off shipping or tax, and if it can't be used the cart says why — for example "That code has expired." Once applied, a code shows in a green badge; the × beside it removes it.

The totals. - **Shipping** is a flat rate for each package, and a package is free once its own items, after any discount, reach the free-shipping amount. The cart tells you how much more you need to spend. Most orders are one package; see **Delivery** for when there's more than one. - **Sales tax** is worked out at checkout from your delivery address, so the cart shows the **total before tax**.

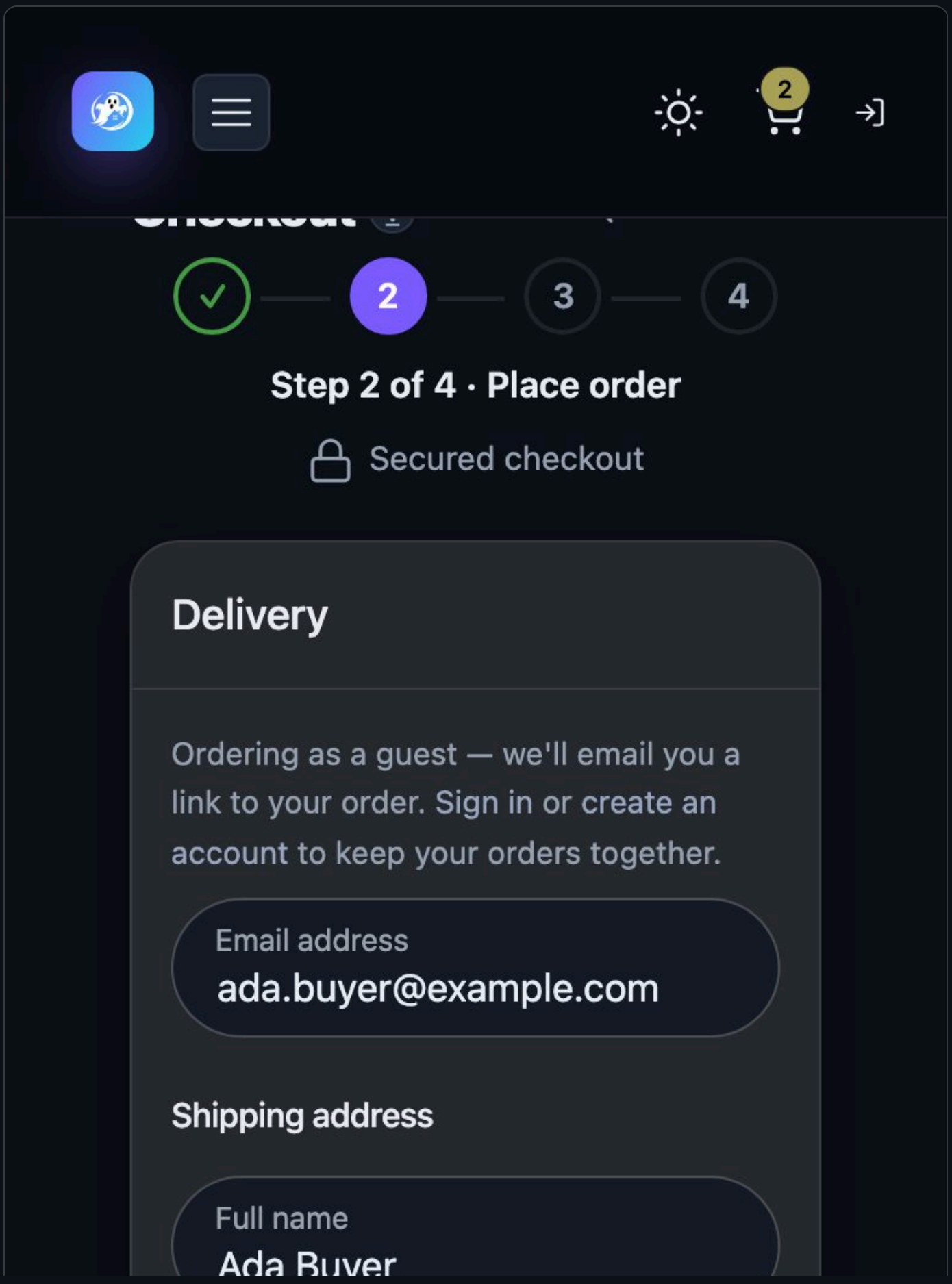
When the store isn't taking orders. Now and then orders are paused. You can still browse and keep things in your cart, and the cart says "The store isn't taking orders at the moment."

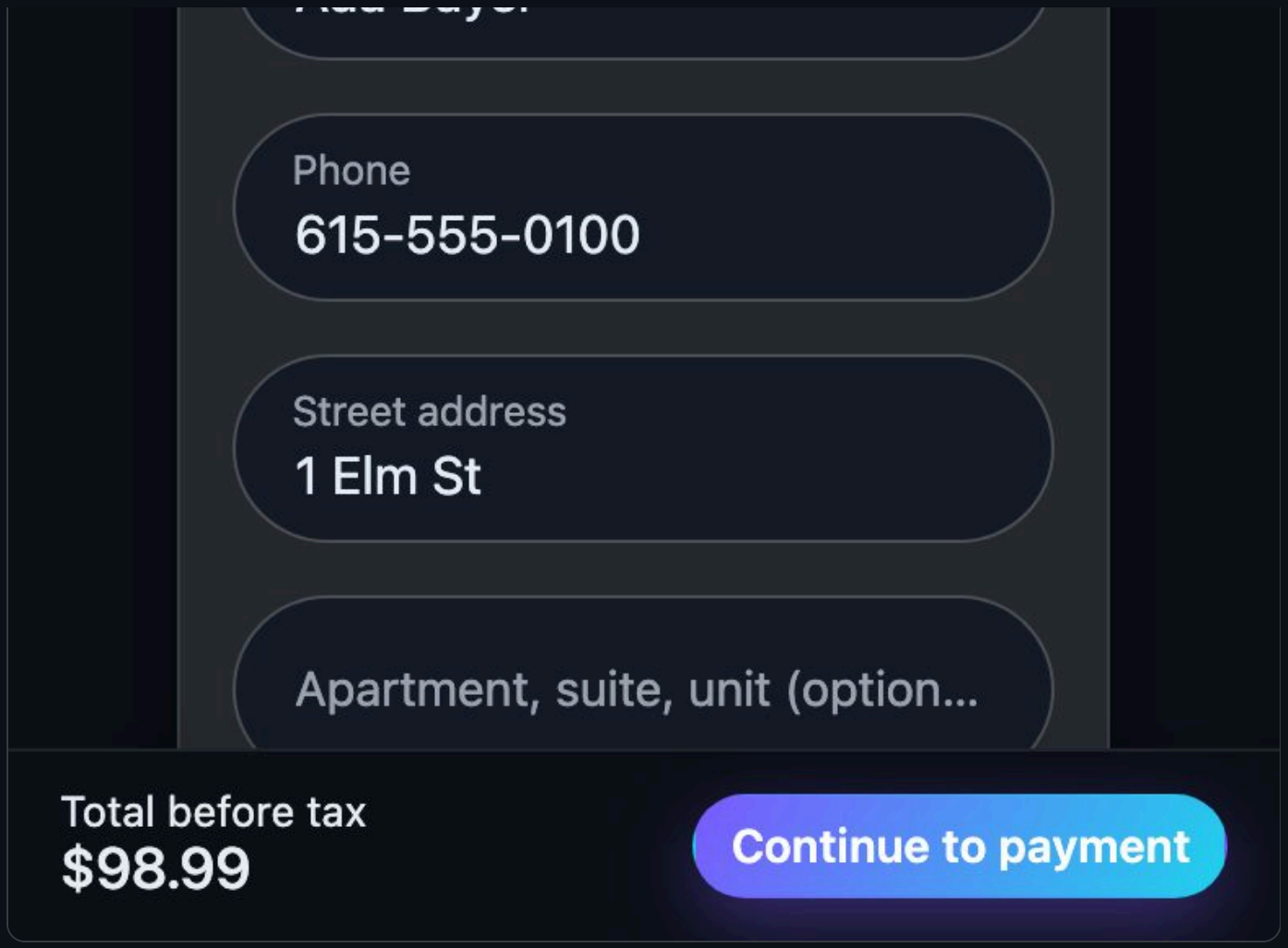
Placing an order

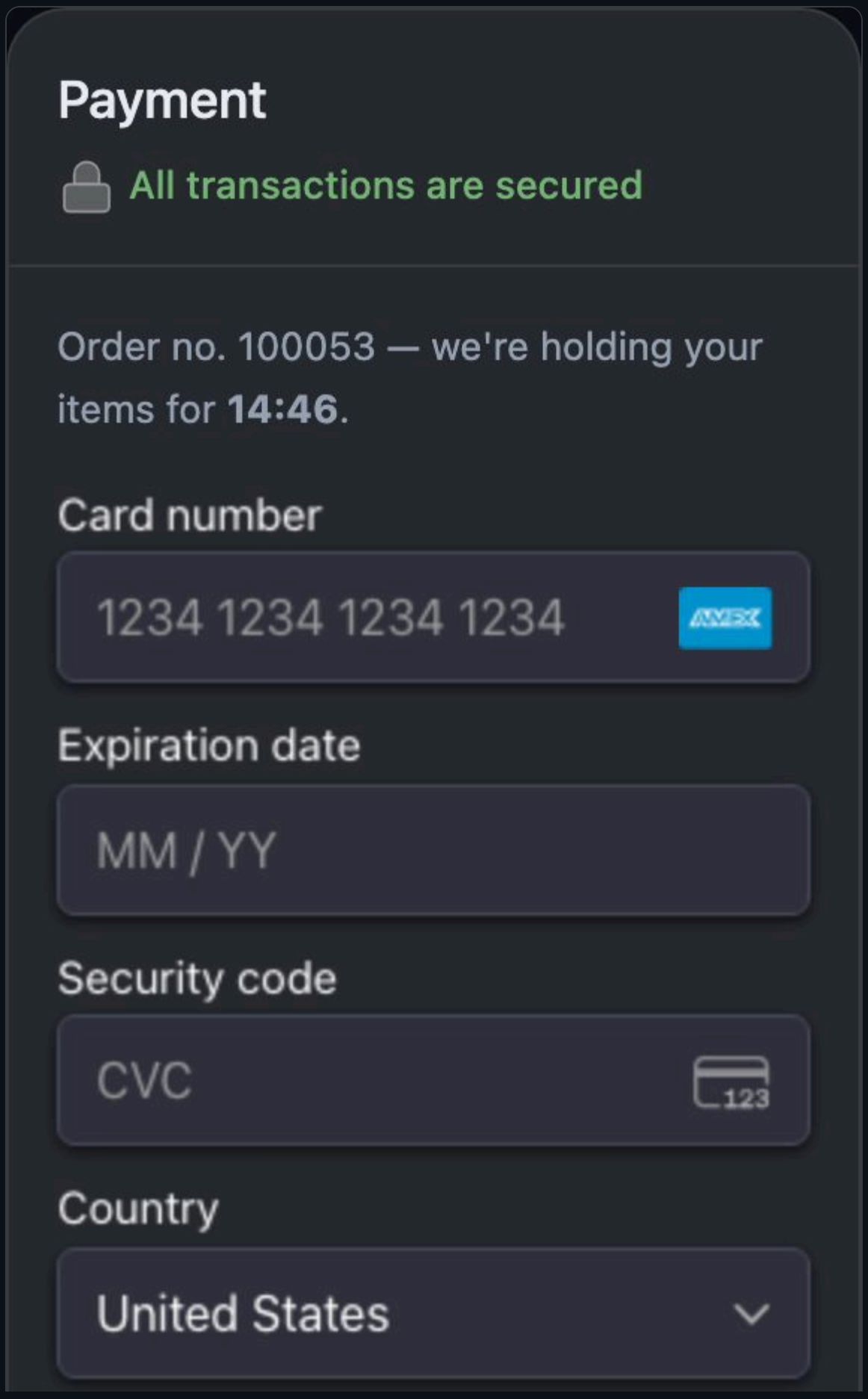
The steps across the top of the cart and checkout pages show where you are: **Cart**, **Place order**, **Payment**, **Complete**.

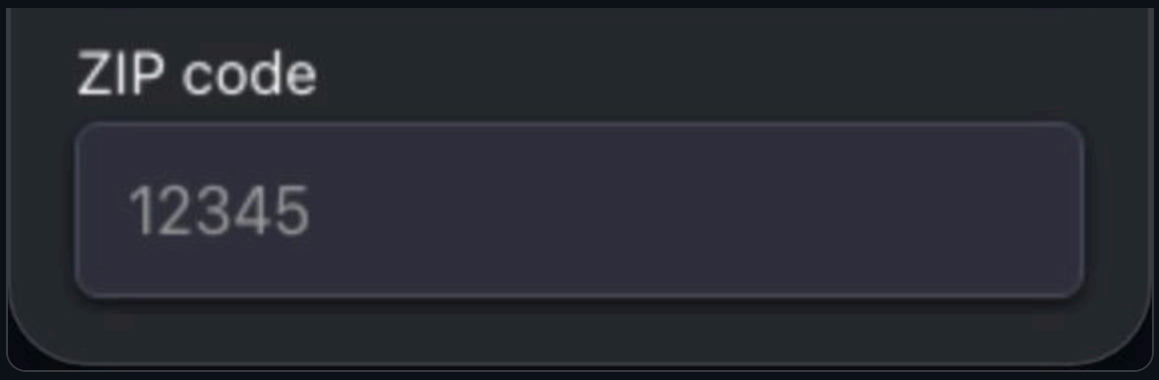
1. **From your cart**, press **To checkout** (on the cart page, or in the slide-out cart).
2. **Delivery.** Enter your email address and where the order should go: your name, phone, street, city, state and ZIP code. If your card's billing address is different, check **Billing address is different** and fill that in too. You can add a note for the person packing your order.

3. **A discount code**, if you have one, goes in the box under the order summary. The summary shows the discount right away.
4. **Agree to the terms** and press **Continue to payment**. Your items are now held for you, sales tax is worked out from your address, and the summary shows the total you'll pay.
5. **Payment.** Enter your card in the payment form. It belongs to Stripe, our payment company, so your card details go straight to them and never reach IsHaunted.com. Press **Place order**.
6. **Complete.** You'll see "Thank you for your order!" with your order number, and a receipt arrives by email.


2
2
3
4
Step 2 of 4 · Place order
Secured checkout
Delivery
Ordering as a guest — we'll email you a link to your order. Sign in or create an account to keep your orders together.
Email address
ada.buyer@example.com
Shipping address
Full name
Ada Buyer


Phone
615-555-0100
Street address
1 Elm St
Apartment, suite, unit (option...
Total before tax
$98.99
Continue to payment


Payment
All transactions are secured
Order no. 100053 — we're holding your items for 14:46.
Card number
1234 1234 1234 1234
AMEX
Expiration date
MM / YY
Security code
CVC
123
Country
United States



Changing something after you continue. Once you press Continue, your details are shown as a summary so the payment is for exactly what you see. To change the address, the email or the discount code, press **Edit**. When you continue again, the total is recalculated.

Your items are held for a short while — the payment step shows how long. If the time runs out before you pay, the page automatically checks stock again and says "Your reservation expired — we've checked stock again." Nothing is charged until you press Place order.

If something can't be bought, the checkout says so in a red box at the top: an item that sold out while you were typing, an address that doesn't look right, or a card the bank declined. Fix it and continue again. Nothing is charged when the checkout refuses.

With or without an account. As a guest, we email you a link to your order. If you have an account, **Sign in** on the checkout page first and the order is kept with your account.

Delivery

The store ships to addresses in the fifty United States and Washington, DC. It doesn't ship to US territories, military addresses or other countries yet.

One package or more. Most things come from the store's own shelves, but some are made and sent by members who sell through the store. Each sender's items travel as their own package, so an order can arrive in more than one — the cart and checkout say so, and list each package ("Package 2 · Ships from Hazel Marsh") with its shipping.

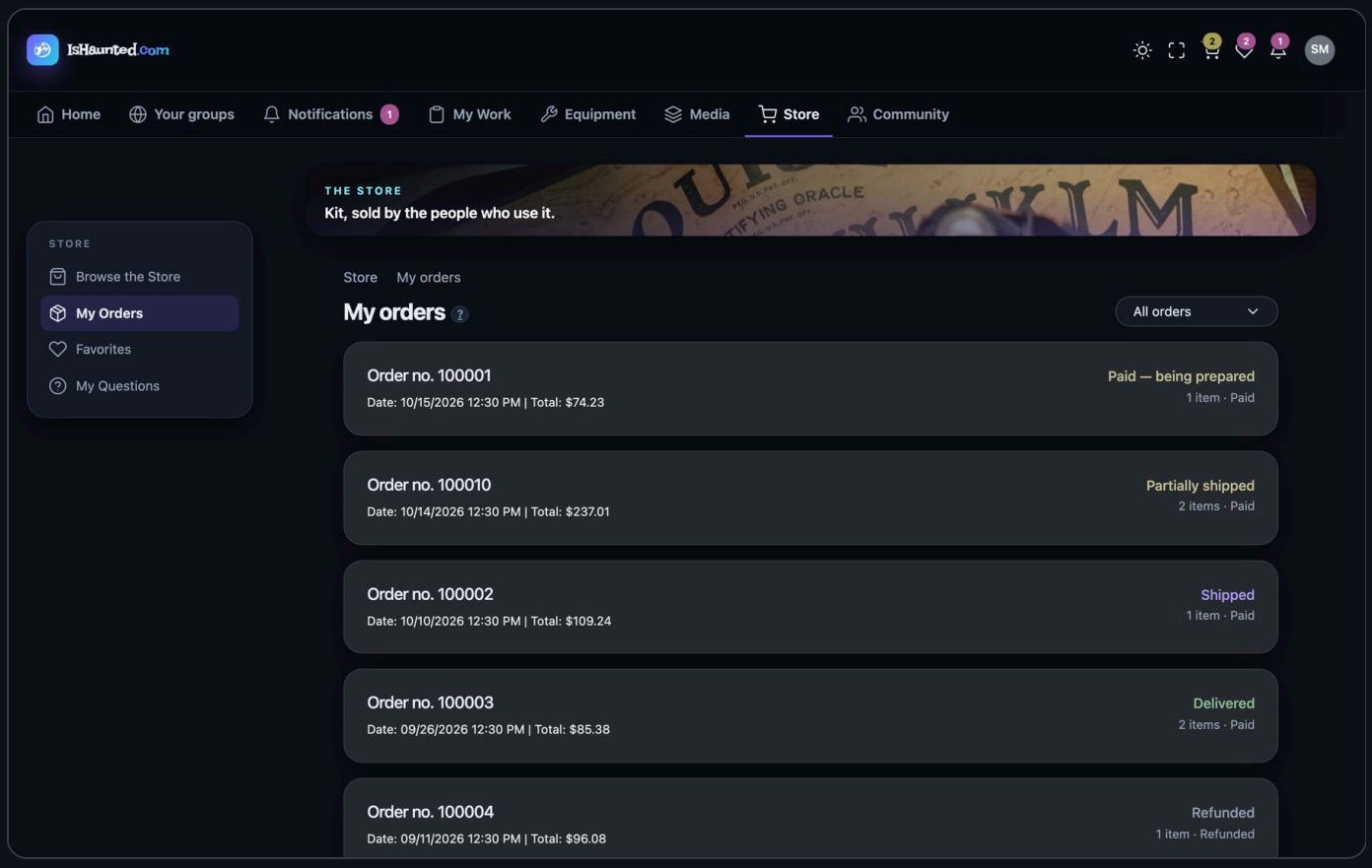
Shipping is a flat price for each package, however many things are in it, and a package ships free once its own items come to a set amount — the cart tells you how much more would make it free. The shipping lines in the cart and at checkout always show what you'll pay.

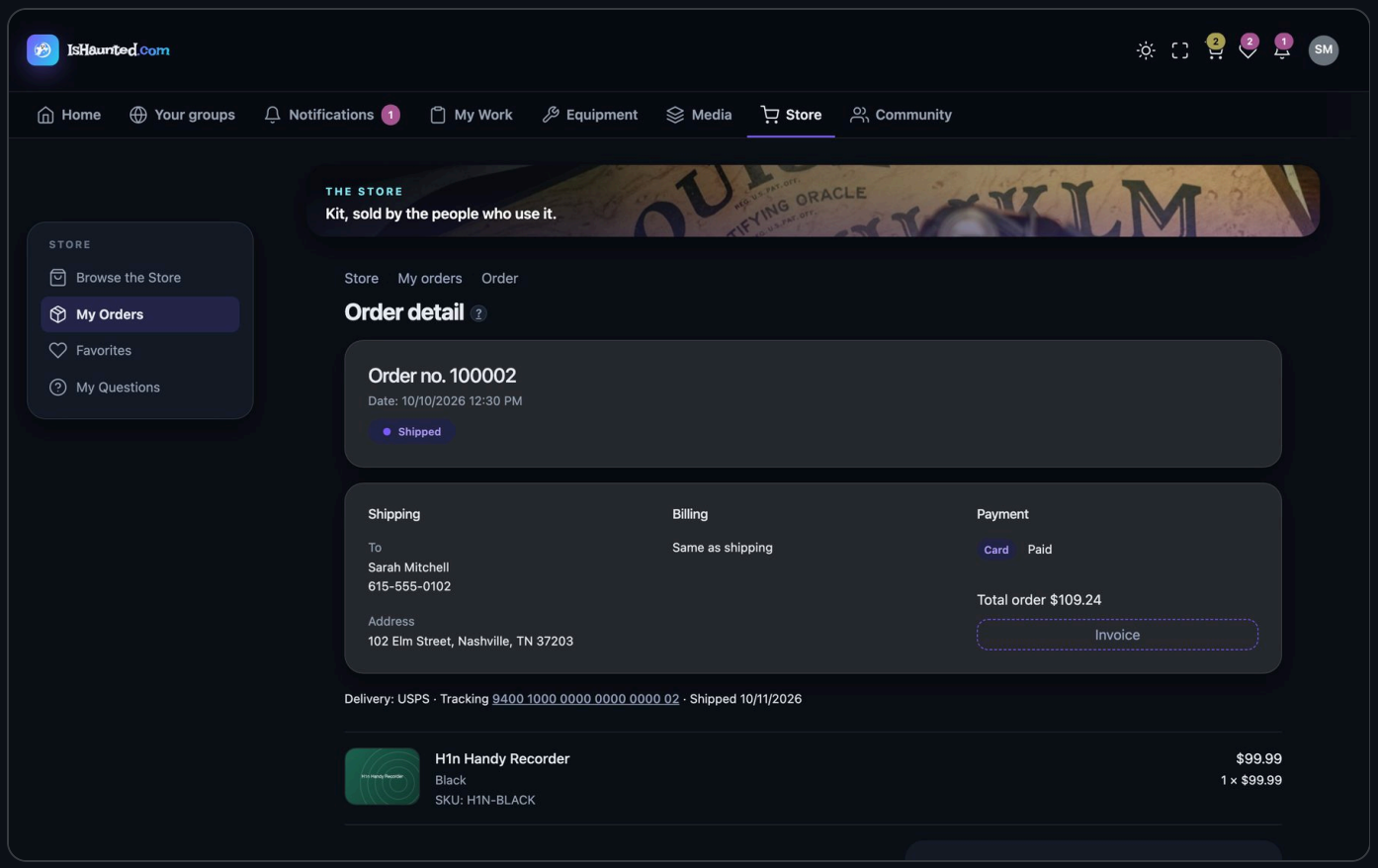
Sales tax

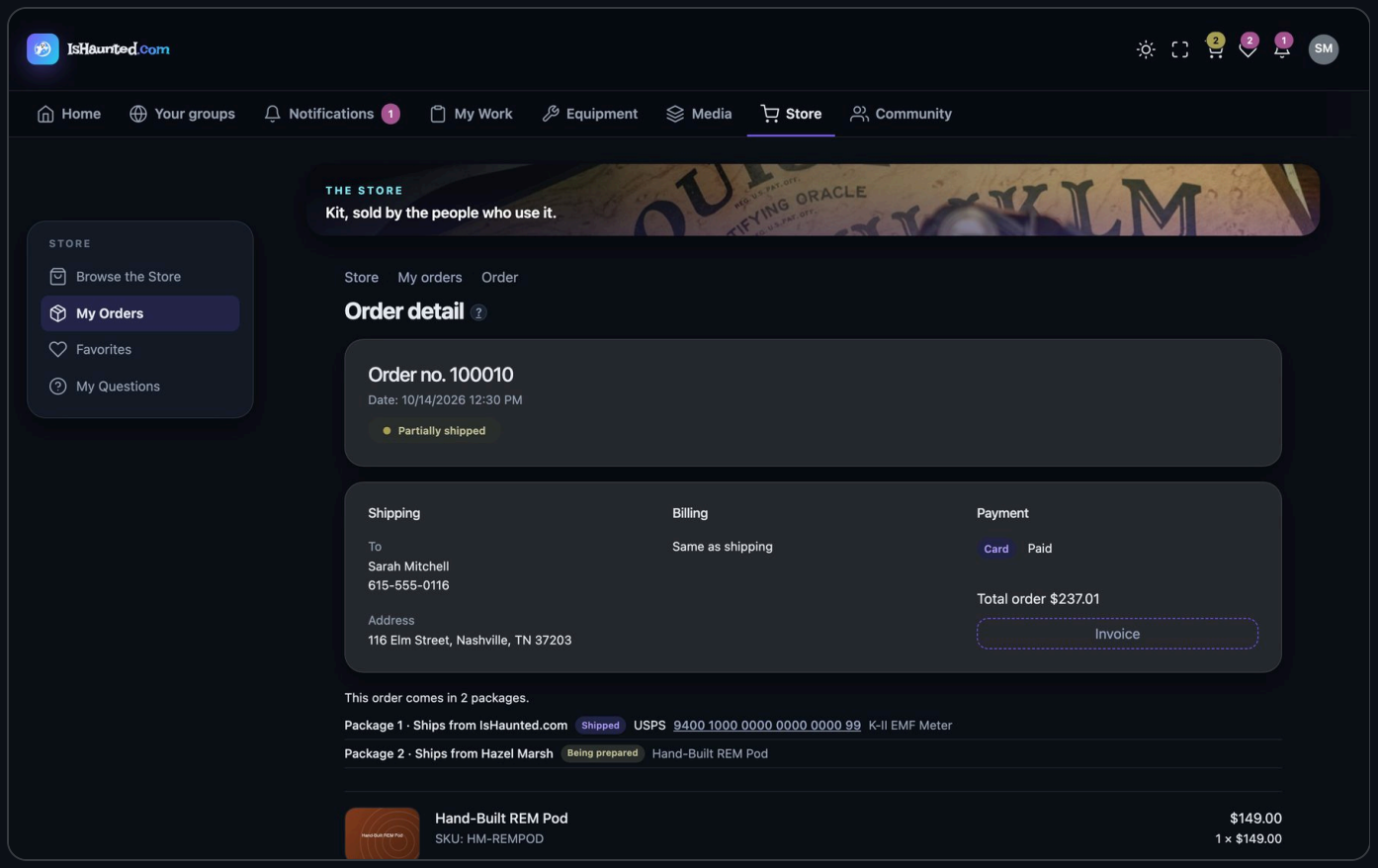
Sales tax depends on where the order is going, so the cart shows a **total before tax** and the tax is worked out at checkout, when you press **Continue to payment**. It appears on its own line in the order summary, never hidden inside a price. Some states tax shipping as well; where they do, that is included in the sales tax line.

Your orders

With an account. Orders you place while signed in are under **My Orders** in the menu (also linked at the bottom of the store's front page). Each one shows its number, date, total and status: *Paid — being prepared*, *Packed*, *Partially shipped* (some of its packages are on their way), *Shipped*, *Delivered*, *Canceled* or *Refunded*. If an order comes in more than one package, its page lists each package with its own status and tracking number. Open an order to see where it's going, what's in it, what it came to, and its tracking number once it ships. Checkouts you started but never paid for aren't orders, so they aren't listed.




IsHaunted.com
SM
Home
Your groups
Notifications 1
My Work
Equipment
Media
Store
Community
THE STORE
Kit, sold by the people who use it.
STORE
Browse the Store
My Orders
Favorites
My Questions
Store
My orders
Order
Order detail
Order no. 100002
Date: 10/10/2026 12:30 PM
Shipped
Shipping
To
Sarah Mitchell
615-555-0102
Address
102 Elm Street, Nashville, TN 37203
Billing
Same as shipping
Payment
Card
Paid
Total order $109.24
Invoice
Delivery: USPS · Tracking 9400 1000 0000 0000 0000 02 · Shipped 10/11/2026
H1n Handy Recorder
Black
SKU: H1N-BLACK
$99.99
1 × $99.99


IsHaunted.com
SM
Home
Your groups
Notifications 1
My Work
Equipment
Media
Store
Community
THE STORE
Kit, sold by the people who use it.
STORE
Browse the Store
My Orders
Favorites
My Questions
Store
My orders
Order
Order detail
Order no. 100010
Date: 10/14/2026 12:30 PM
Partially shipped
Shipping
To
Sarah Mitchell
615-555-0116
Address
116 Elm Street, Nashville, TN 37203
Billing
Same as shipping
Payment
Card
Paid
Total order $237.01
Invoice
This order comes in 2 packages.
Package 1 · Ships from IsHaunted.com
Shipped
USPS
9400 1000 0000 0000 0000 99
K-II EMF Meter
Package 2 · Ships from Hazel Marsh
Being prepared
Hand-Built REM Pod
Hand-Built REM Pod
SKU: HM-REMPOD
$149.00
1 × $149.00

As a guest. Your receipt email has a private link to your order. Keep that email, because it's how you get back to your order. If you've lost it, go to **Find my order** (at the bottom of the store's front page), enter the order number and the email address you used, and the link is sent again. The page shows the same message whether or not those details match an order, so nobody can use it to find out what someone else bought.

The invoice. Once an order is paid, its page has an **Invoice** link — a printable invoice showing who it's from and to, each item with its discount and tax, and any refund. Press **Print** to print it or save it as a PDF.

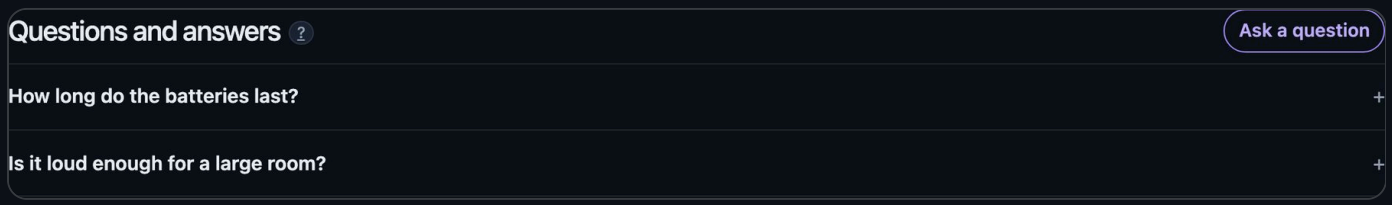
You can still see your orders even if the store is closed for a while.

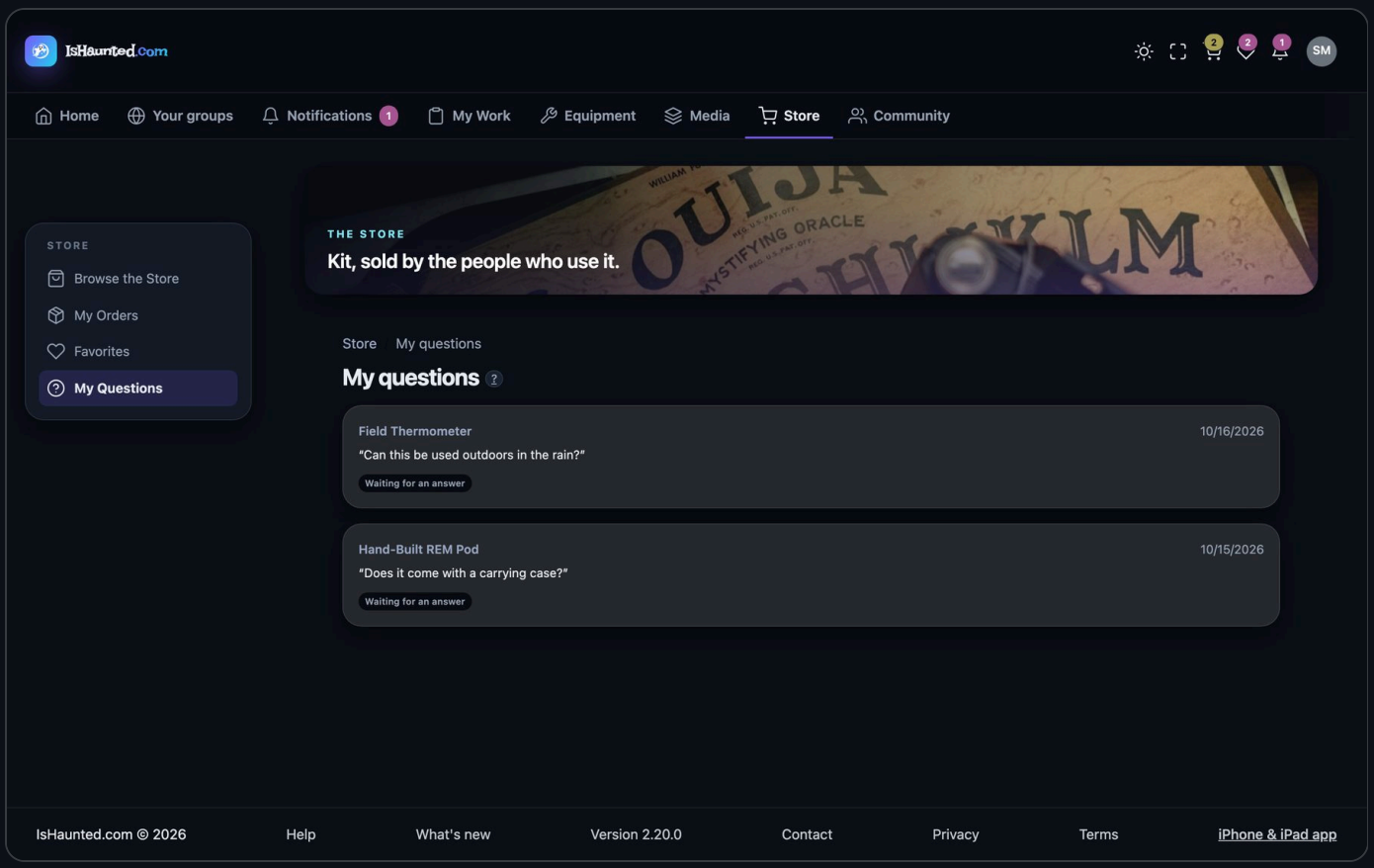
Downloads

Some items come with files — a manual, firmware, software. Once your order is paid, its page lists them under **Downloads**; they stay there for as long as you have the order. A manual written on the site opens as a page of its own, with a **Print** button. If an item is refunded in full, its downloads go with it.

Asking a question

Not sure an item is right? Its page has **Questions and answers** after the reviews — what other shoppers have asked — and **Ask a question** (sign in first). Your question goes privately to whoever sells the item: the store, or the member who makes it. You get a message when it's answered, and the answer is under **My Questions** in the menu. Only you see it — unless they add it to the item's questions and answers for everybody, which never shows your name.





Returns and refunds

Every order can be returned within the store's returns window — the **Returns** page (linked from every order summary) and your invoice say how many days, counted from delivery. Get in touch with your order number first and we'll tell you where to send it.

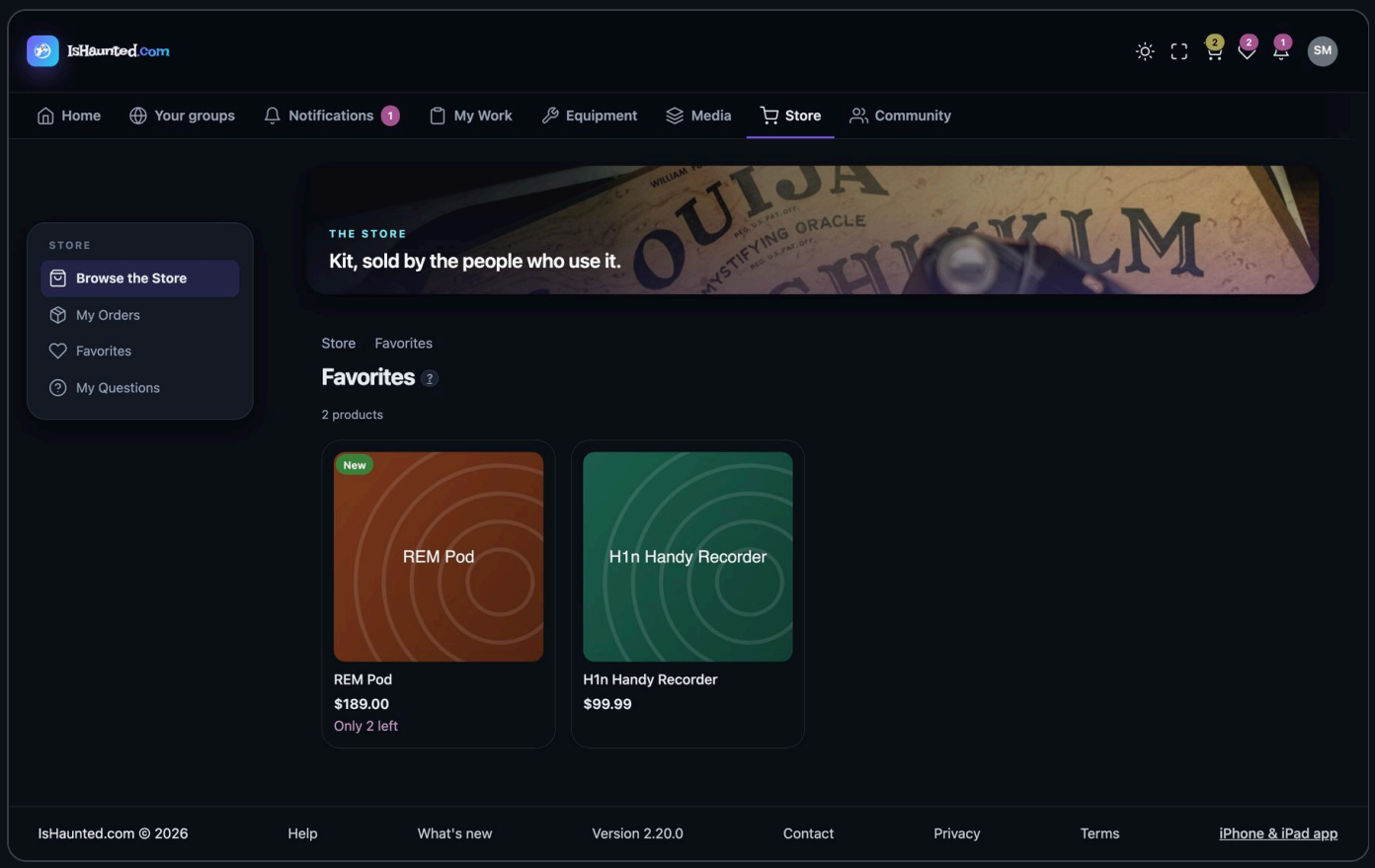
A refund goes back to the card you paid with; banks usually show it within 5–10 business days. It appears on your order page and your invoice as soon as it's made, and you're emailed when it is. A part refund shows what was refunded and what's left.

Favorites

Tap the **heart** on a product — on its page, or on its card anywhere in the store — to keep it in your **Favorites**. The heart fills in once it's saved; tap it again to remove it. The heart at the top of the screen, beside the cart, shows how many favorites you have and opens the list (it's also under **Store → Favorites** in the menu).

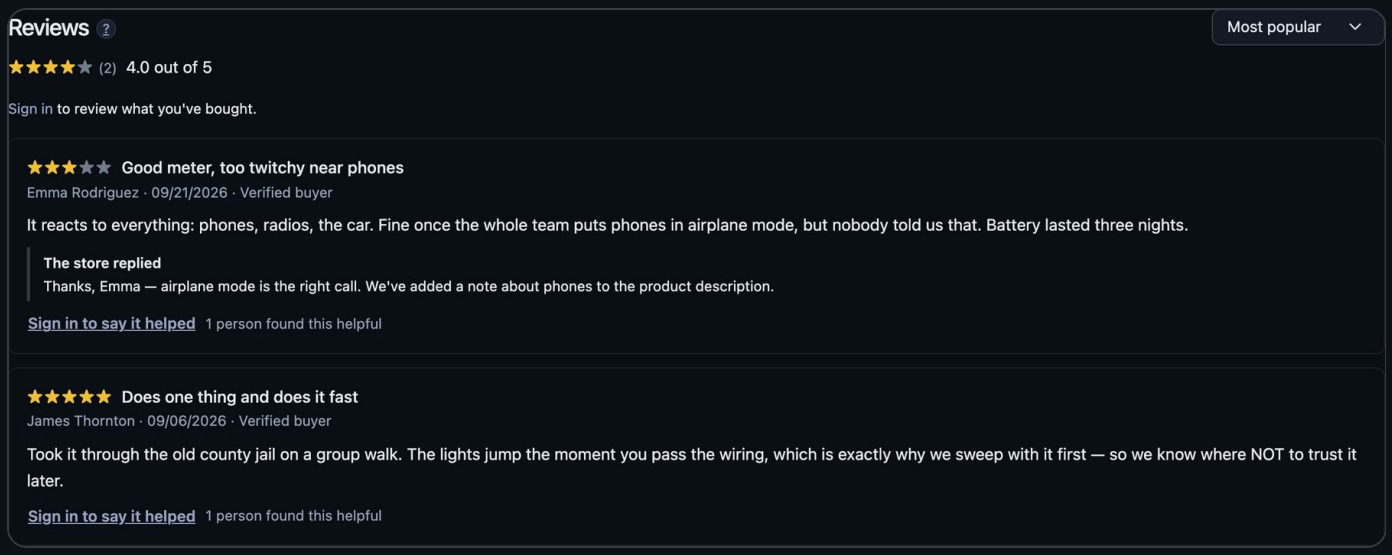
The Favorites page shows each product as it is today — its price, and whether it's in stock. **Remove** takes one off the list after asking you to confirm. A product that stops being sold drops off the list, and comes back if the store starts selling it again.

Favorites belong to your account, so you need to be signed in. If you tap a heart without signing in, you're asked to sign in first.



Reviews

Reading reviews. A product's reviews are at the bottom of its page, with its average stars at the top. Sort them by *Most popular*, *Newest*, *Highest rated*, *Lowest rated* or *Most helpful*. Every review is from somebody who bought that product here, and some have a reply from the store. When you're signed in, you can mark a review **Helpful**; the count under it shows how many people did.



Writing one. Only somebody who has bought a product can review it. Sign in, open the product, and press **Write a review**: pick one to five stars, give it a title and say a few words about how it worked for you. A moderator reads every review before it appears. Until then, yours shows on the product page to you only, marked **Waiting for approval**. If it isn't published you'll see why.

You can **Edit** or **Delete** your review from the same place. An edited review goes back to the moderator and is hidden until it's approved again. One review per product; a refunded item can't be reviewed.

Bought as a guest? Sign up with the email you ordered with — the order attaches to your account and you can review.

The store has turned off reviews for some items, so those items show none.

Selling your own gear

Some things in the store are made by members of the site. If you build equipment and would like to sell it here, get in touch through **Contact**. A site administrator lists it for you and sets its price; orders, payments and refunds go through the store, so buying it works exactly like buying anything else here. Shoppers don't see who made an item.

GETTING STARTED

Selling in the Store

Your items in the store — adding them, asking for them to go on sale, and where each one stands.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

If you make equipment and sell it through the store, you have a **Selling** section in the menu. It holds everything to do with your own items. You only ever see your own items, and running the store itself stays with the store's administrators.

The menu shows **Selling** once the store is open. Before then, the store may ask you to get your items ready early. In that case, go straight to `/store/selling` — the selling pages work there while the store stays hidden from everyone else.

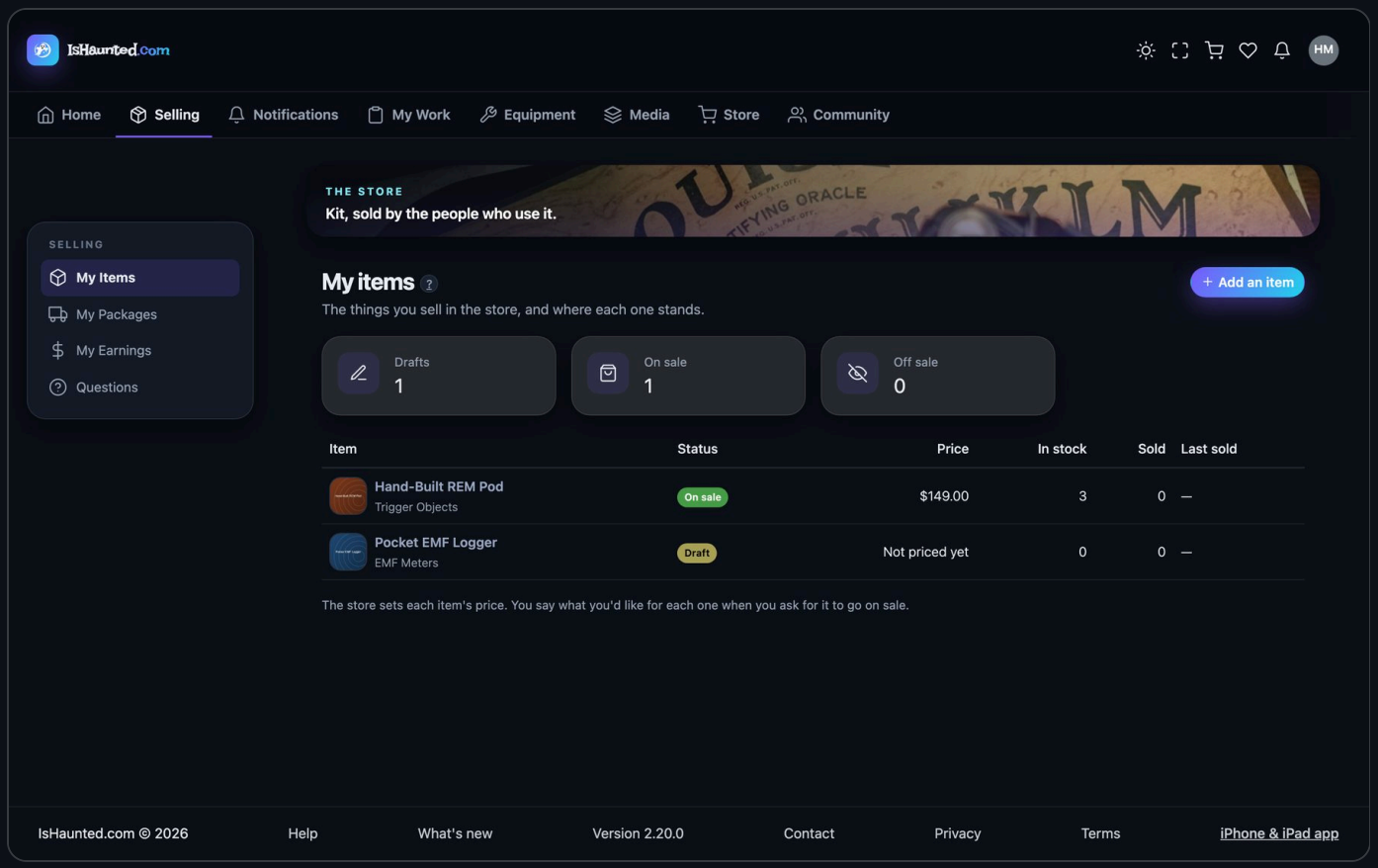
Your items

Selling → My Items lists every item you sell through the store, with:

- **Status** — *Draft* (not on sale yet), *On sale*, or *Off sale* (was on sale, but isn't now).
- **Price** — what shoppers pay. The store sets each item's price, so you can see it here but not change it. You say what *you* want to be paid when you ask for the item to go on sale.
- **In stock**, **Sold** and **Last sold** — how many are on the shelf, how many have sold, and when the last one sold.

The counts at the top show how many of your items are drafts, on sale and off sale.

Press **Add an item** to start a new one: a name and a shelf are enough. It starts as a draft, hidden from shoppers, and opens in its editor.



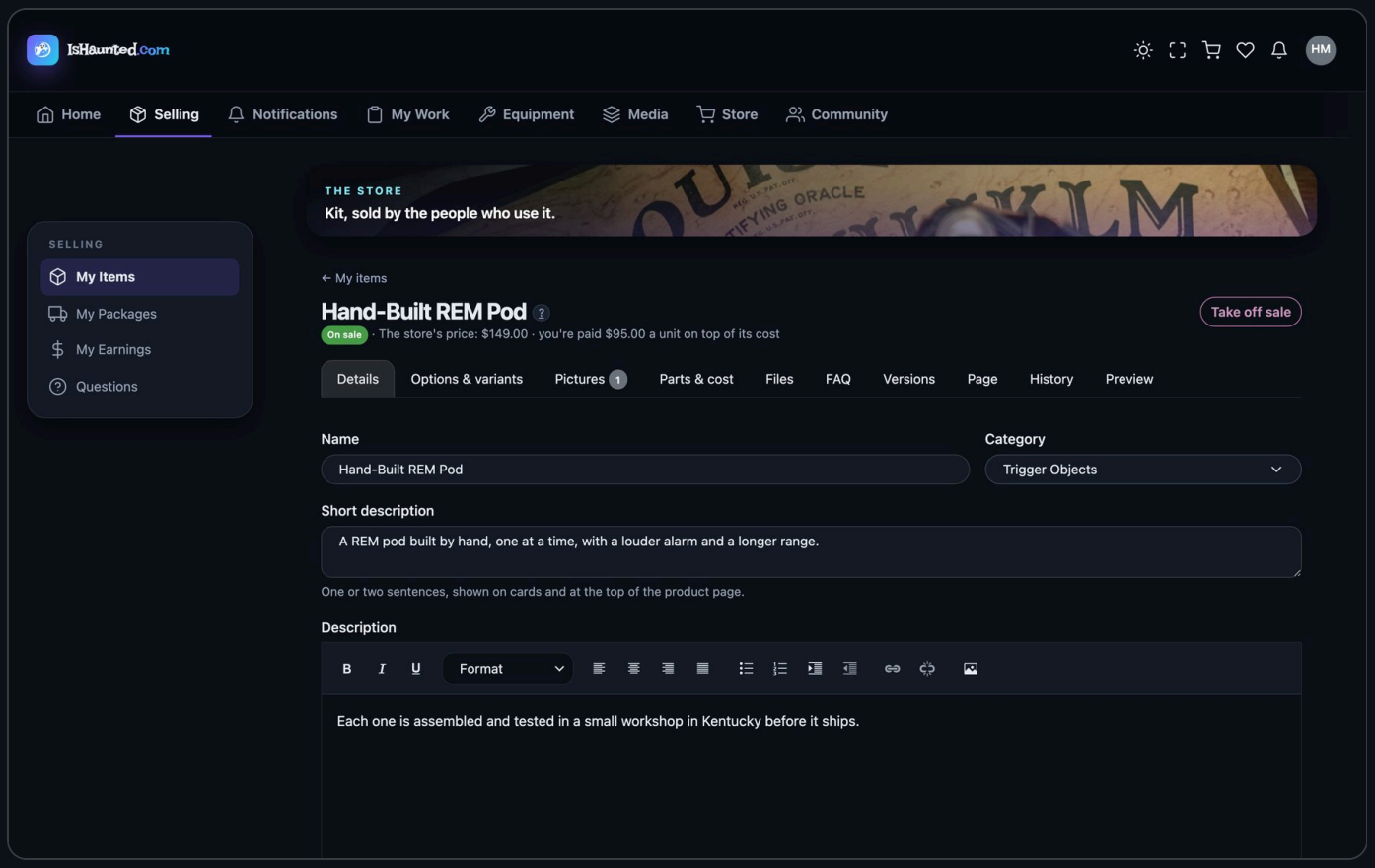
Editing an item

Open an item from My Items. Its editor has these tabs:

- **Details** — the name, the shelf, a short description, the full description and the specifications (grouped under headings like Detection and Power). Press **Save**. The shelves listed are the ones shoppers can see; if the store later hides the shelf an item is on, the editor says "(hidden by the store)" and you can move it.
- **Options & variants** — the choices a buyer makes, and a row for each combination.
- **Pictures** — up to twelve.
- **Parts & cost**, **Files**, **FAQ**, **Versions** and **Page** — each has its own section below.
- **History** — every change to the item, yours and the store's, newest first.
- **Preview** — the product page as a shopper will see it, including changes you haven't saved.

Changes to an item that's on sale show in the store right away.

If somebody at the store saved the item after you opened it, your save is refused with a message saying so, so you never overwrite their changes without knowing. Press **Reload**, then make your change again.



Options and variants

Options are what a buyer chooses — up to three, like Color and Size. Add them, press **Save options**, then **Generate variants** to make a row for each combination.

A new variant starts switched off, with no price. The store sets each variant's price, and until it does, the variant can't be switched on. You can change a variant's SKU, switch a priced one on or off, and choose which one is shown first. You can't generate variants for an item that's on sale, because the new ones wouldn't have prices — take it off sale first.

Stock is yours to keep up to date. Use the box on each row to adjust it for stock received, a correction after a count, or damaged items. Every change is recorded, with a reason.

Pictures

Add up to twelve. The first one is shown on cards and in the cart; move pictures earlier or later to change the order. You can tie a picture to one variant, so choosing that color shows that photo. The camera details and location are removed from every picture.

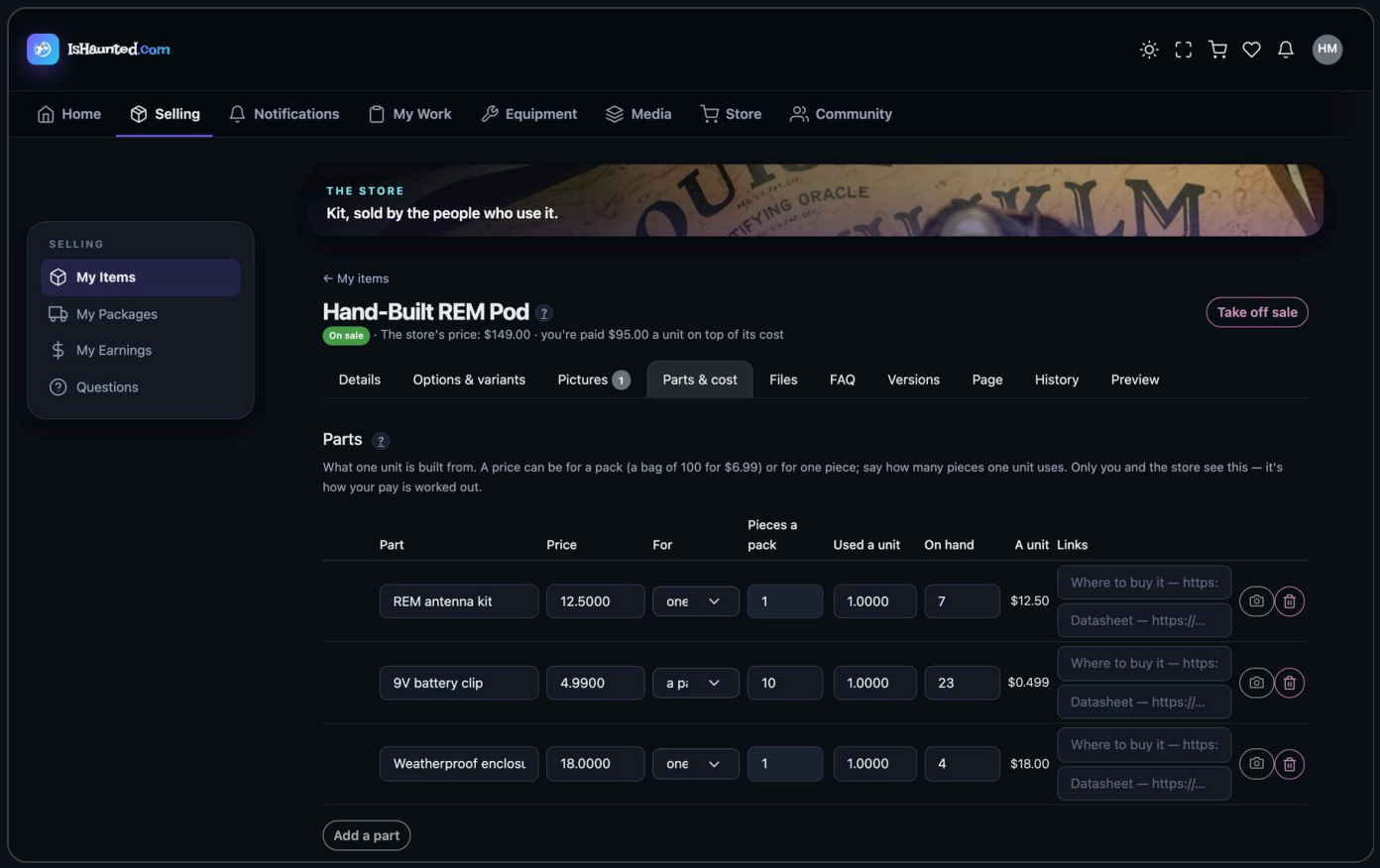
Parts and cost

The **Parts & cost** tab lists what one unit is built from. For each part, give its price — either for a whole pack (a bag of 100 resistors for $6.99) or for one piece — and how many pieces one unit uses (0.5 for half a sheet). You can also add where to buy it, a datasheet link, a picture, and how many you have on hand.

Other costs a unit covers things that aren't worth listing part by part: solder, glue, the box it ships in.

The total — **A unit costs to make** — is the item's cost basis. What you're paid for each one sold is its cost basis **plus** the asking price the store approved. Prices are kept to a hundredth of a cent and only the total is rounded, so small rounding errors don't add up over a long list. If you've counted the parts on hand, the tab also says how many units you could build from them.

Only you and the store see this tab; shoppers never do.



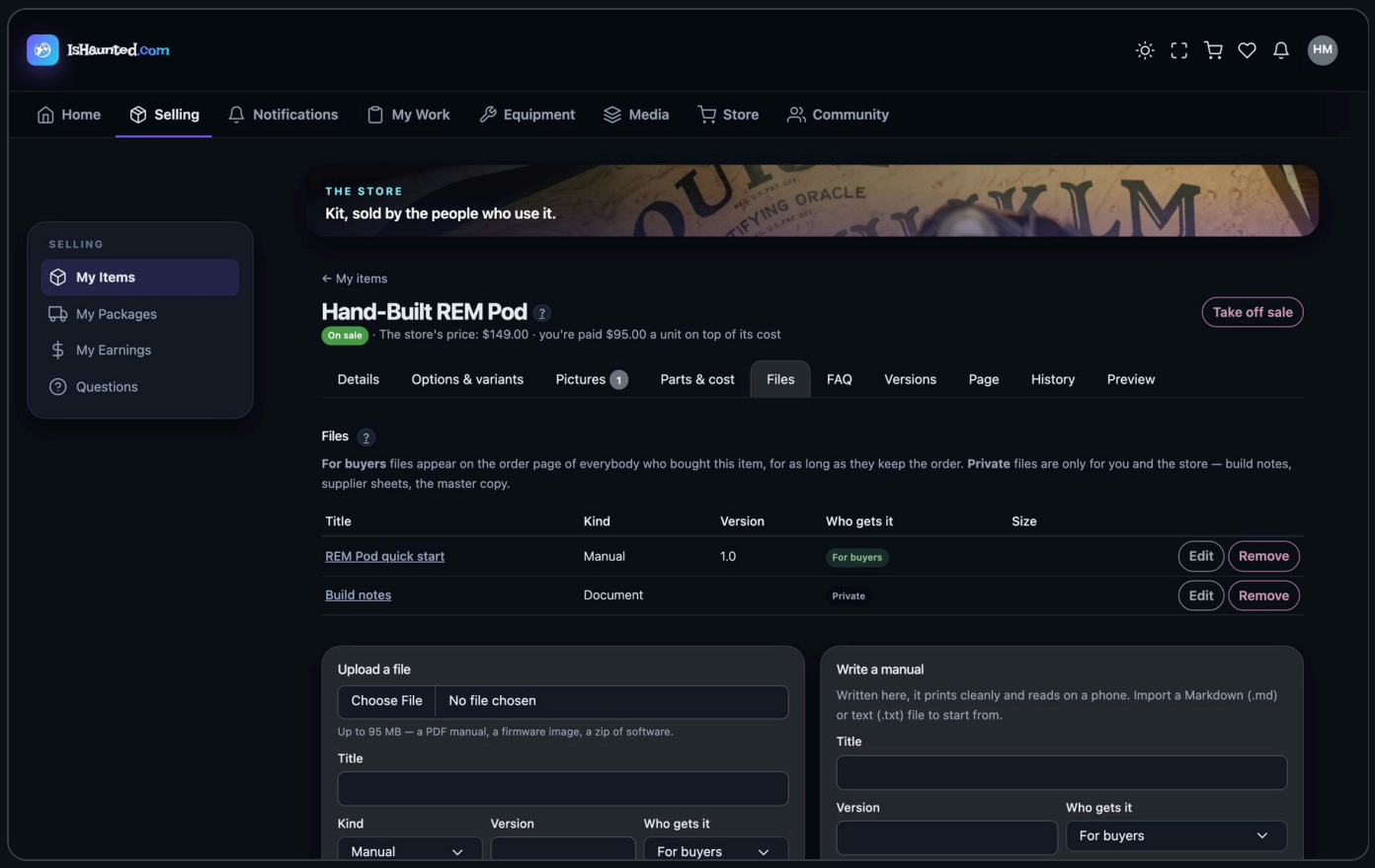
Files

The **Files** tab holds an item's manuals, firmware, software and documents. For each file, choose who gets it:

- **For buyers** — everybody who buys the item finds it under **Downloads** on their order page, once the order is paid. It stays there for as long as they keep the order, unless that item was refunded in full.
- **Private** — only you and the store. Use it for build notes, supplier sheets or the master copy of a manual.

Upload a file takes anything up to 95 MB: a PDF, a firmware image, a zip. Give it a title — it's what buyers see — and, if you like, a version. **Write a manual** lets you write one on the site instead; it reads well on a phone and prints cleanly. Type it with simple Markdown (`#` for a heading, `**bold**`, `-` for a list), or **Import from a file** to start from a `.md` or `.txt` file you already have. A Word document is best uploaded as a file.

Edit changes a file's title, kind, version or who gets it; **Remove** deletes it, and buyers who had it lose it too. Every change is in the item's **History**.

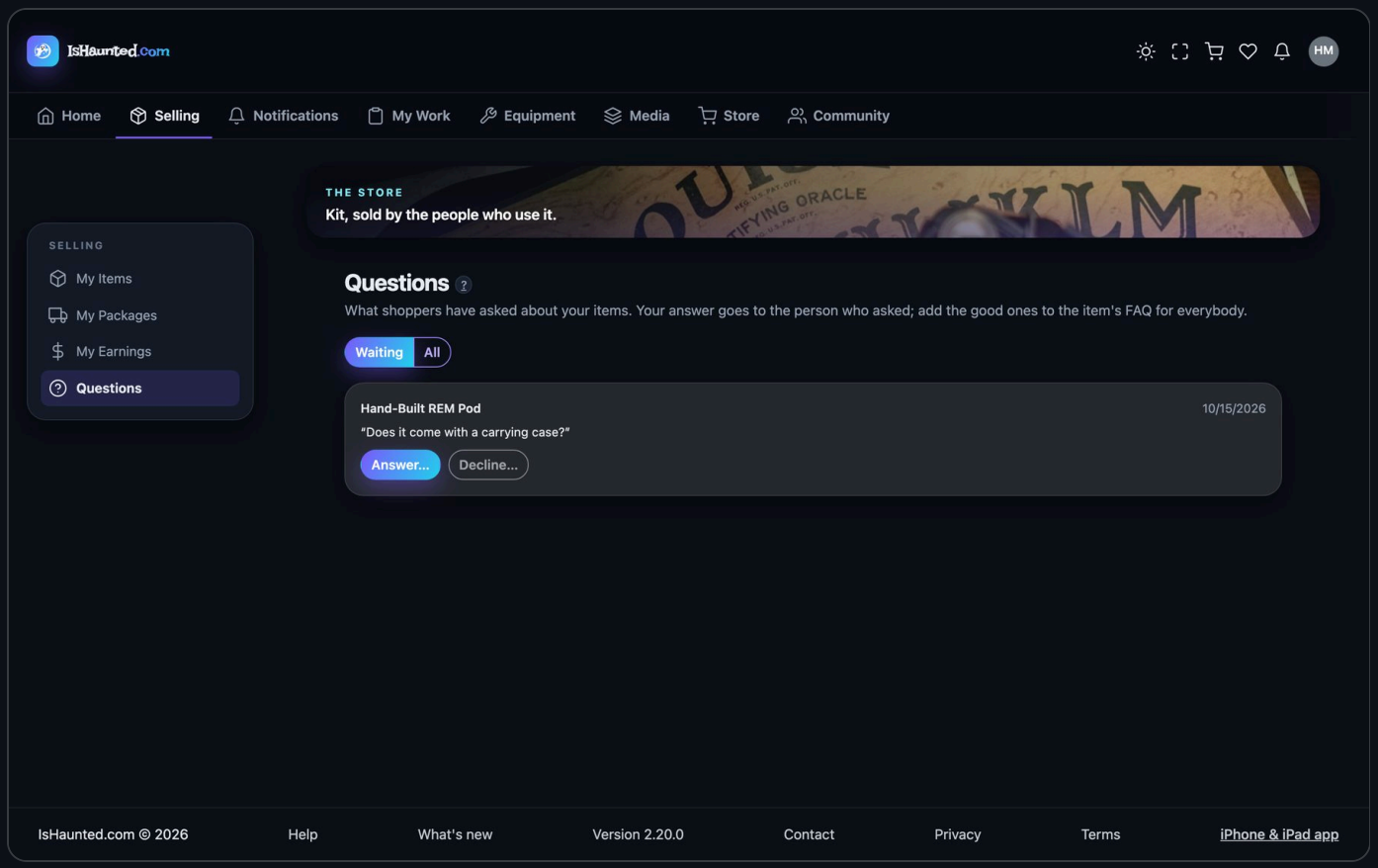


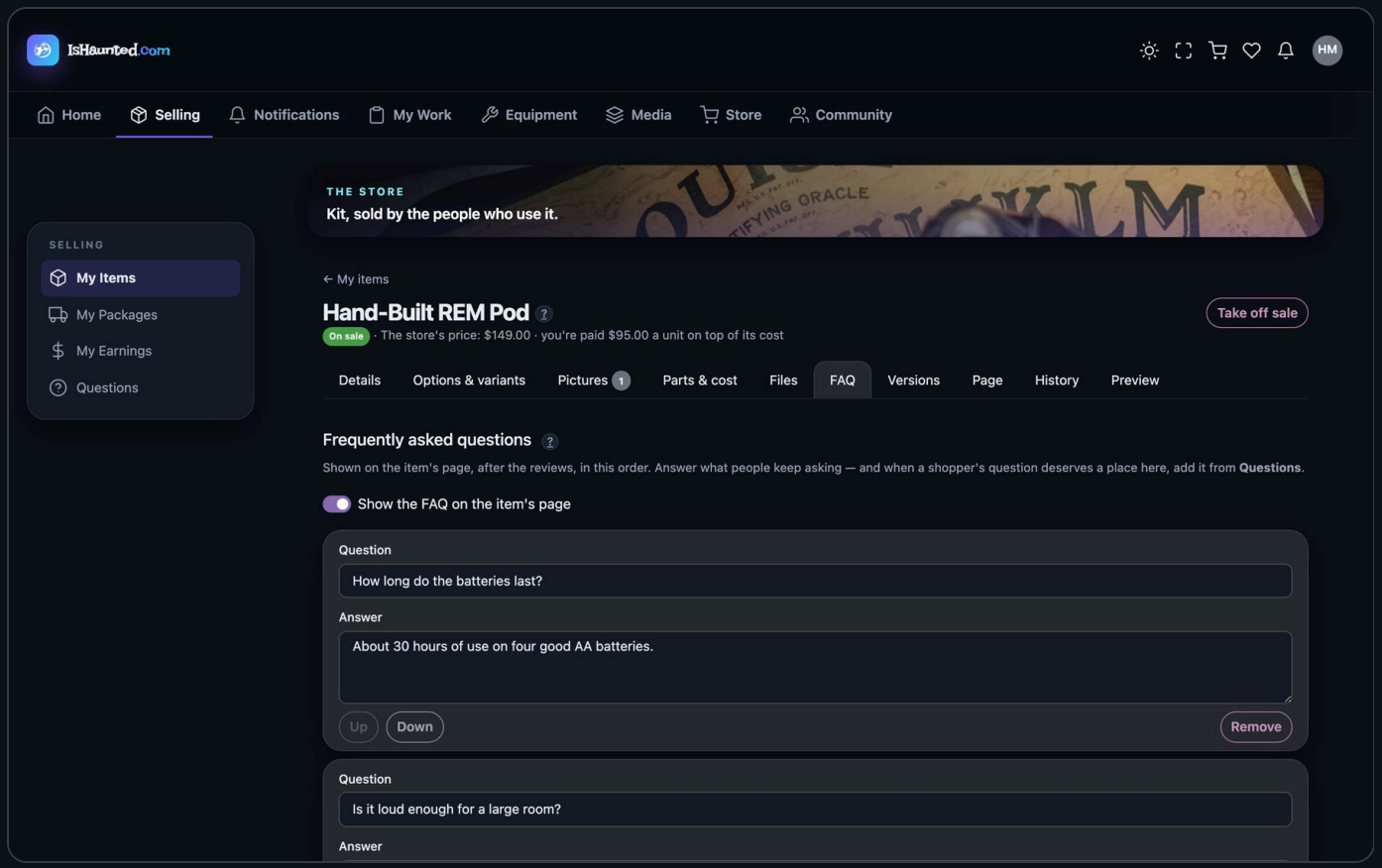
FAQ and questions

Shoppers can ask about your item from its page. A question comes to you privately: you get a message, and the question waits under **Selling → Questions**. The store passes questions and answers along, so you're never told who asked, and they aren't told who answered.

- **Answer…** sends your answer to the person who asked, and only to them.
- **Decline…** says you can't answer it, with a note if you like.
- **Add to the FAQ…** copies a good answer into the item's **FAQ**, where you can reword it for everybody if needed. The answer the shopper received stays as it was, and nobody is named.

The item's **FAQ** tab holds its common questions and answers, so you only have to answer them once. They show on the item's page after the reviews, in the order you set. Switch **Show the FAQ** off to hide them for a while without losing them.


IsHaunted.com
HM
Home
Selling
Notifications
My Work
Equipment
Media
Store
Community
THE STORE
Kit, sold by the people who use it.
SELLING
My Items
My Packages
My Earnings
Questions
Questions
What shoppers have asked about your items. Your answer goes to the person who asked; add the good ones to the item's FAQ for everybody.
Waiting
All
Hand-Built REM Pod
10/15/2026
"Does it come with a carrying case?"
Answer...
Decline...
IsHaunted.com © 2026
Help
What's new
Version 2.20.0
Contact
Privacy
Terms
iPhone & iPad app

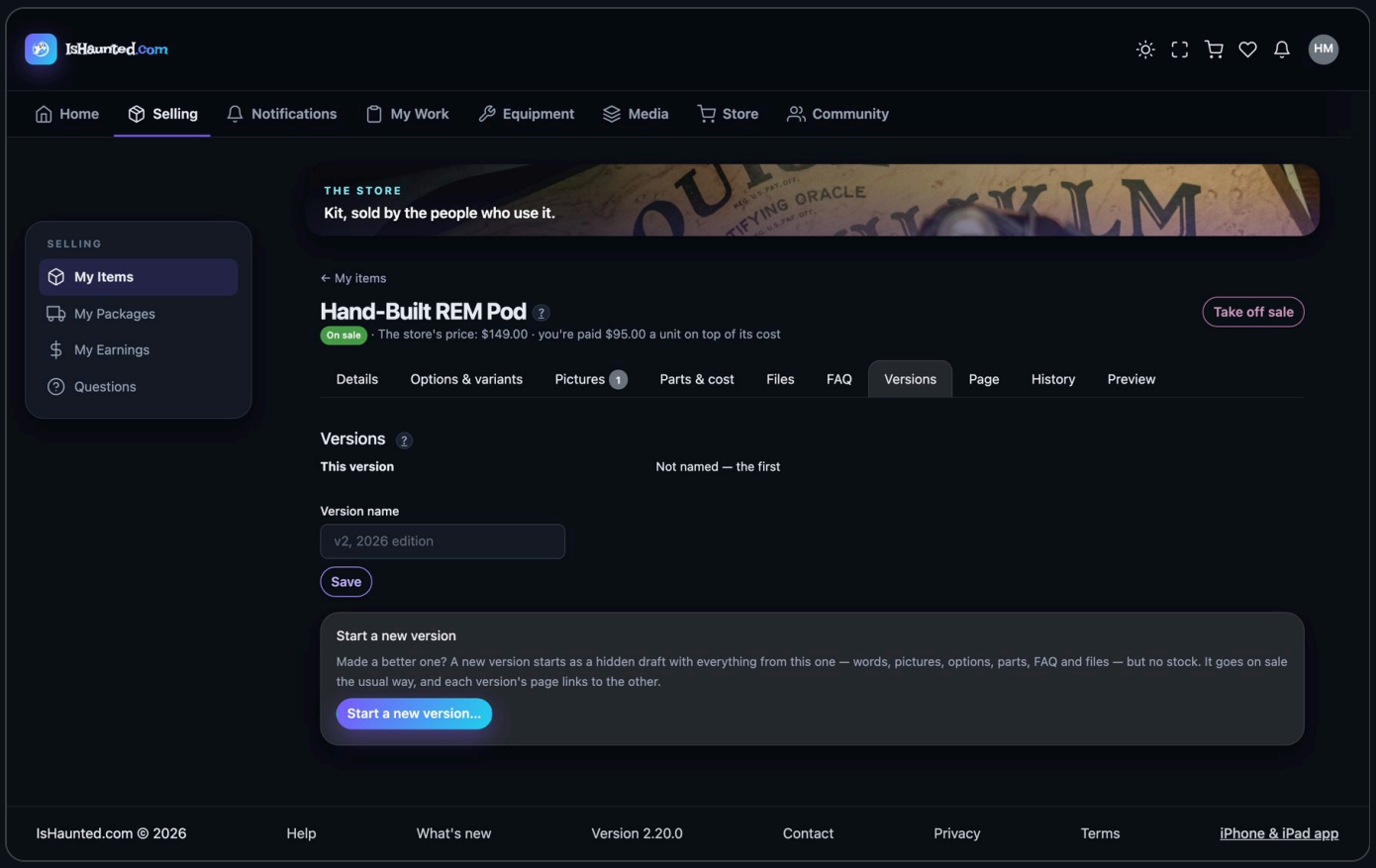

IsHaunted.com
HM
Home
Selling
Notifications
My Work
Equipment
Media
Store
Community
THE STORE
Kit, sold by the people who use it.
SELLING
My Items
My Packages
My Earnings
Questions
← My items
Hand-Built REM Pod
Take off sale
On sale
· The store's price: $149.00 · you're paid $95.00 a unit on top of its cost
Details
Options & variants
Pictures 1
Parts & cost
Files
FAQ
Versions
Page
History
Preview
Frequently asked questions
Shown on the item's page, after the reviews, in this order. Answer what people keep asking — and when a shopper's question deserves a place here, add it from Questions.
Show the FAQ on the item's page
Question
How long do the batteries last?
Answer
About 30 hours of use on four good AA batteries.
Up
Down
Remove
Question
Is it loud enough for a large room?
Answer

Versions

Made a better one? On an item that has been on sale, open **Versions** and **Start a new version…**. Name it (“v2”, “2026 edition”) and choose what happens to the old one when the new one goes on sale:

- **sells what's left, then comes off sale** — it stays on sale until its stock runs out;
- **stays on sale beside it** — both are sold, each page linking to the other;
- **comes off sale straight away**.

The new version starts as a hidden draft with everything from the old one — text, pictures, options, variants, parts, FAQ and files — but no stock. Change what's new, add its stock, and ask for it to go on sale as usual. Nothing happens to the old version until the new one goes on sale, and you can change your choice until then. After that, it can't be changed. An old version that comes off sale keeps its page, which says it's no longer made and links to the new one.



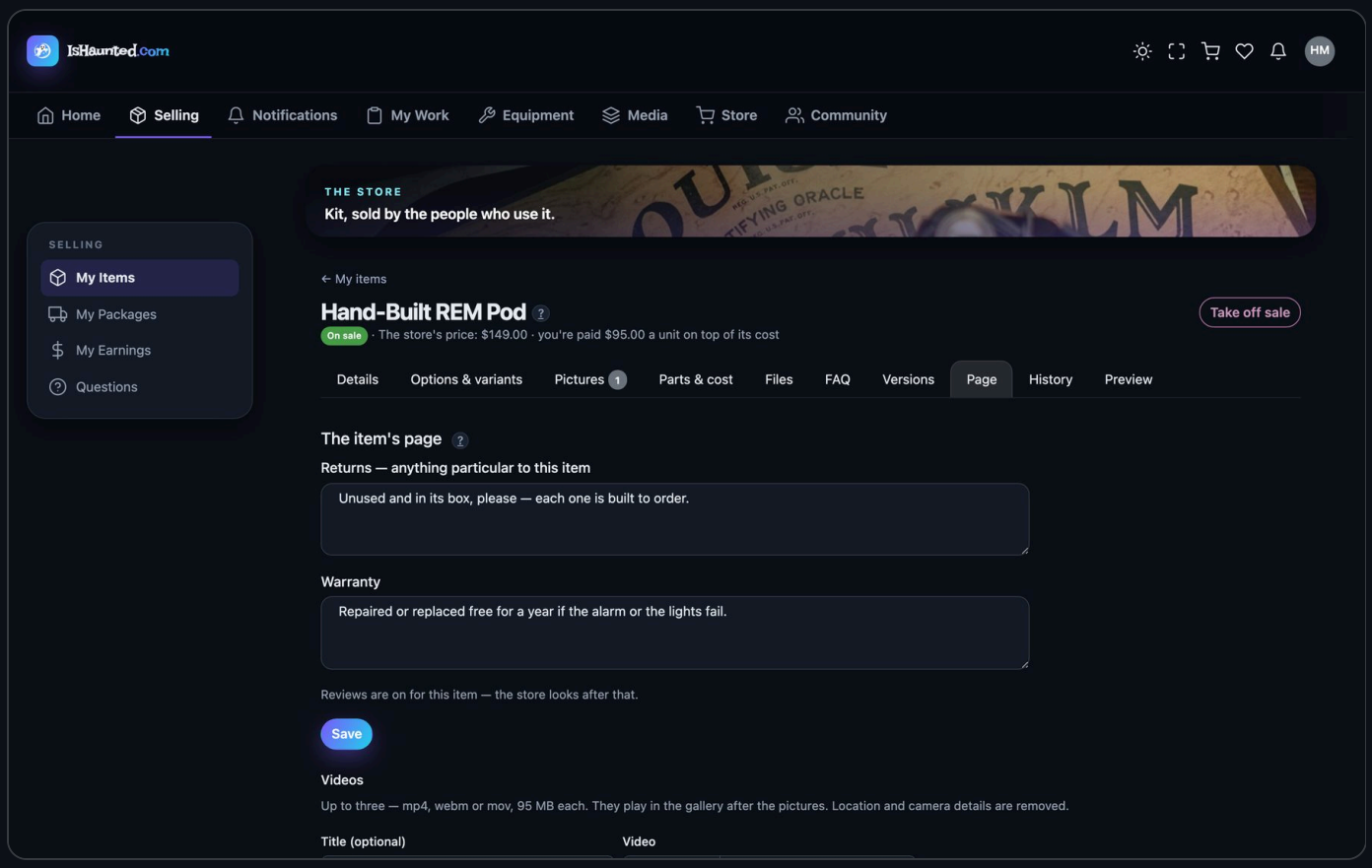
The item's page

The **Page** tab holds what the item's page says beyond its description:

- **Returns** — anything particular to this item, shown under the store's returns window ("Unused and in its box, please").
- **Warranty** — shown in its own section when you give one.

- **Videos** — up to three, mp4, webm or mov, 95 MB each. They play in the gallery after the pictures. The location and camera details are removed from the copy shoppers get.

The store decides whether an item accepts reviews; the tab tells you whether yours does.



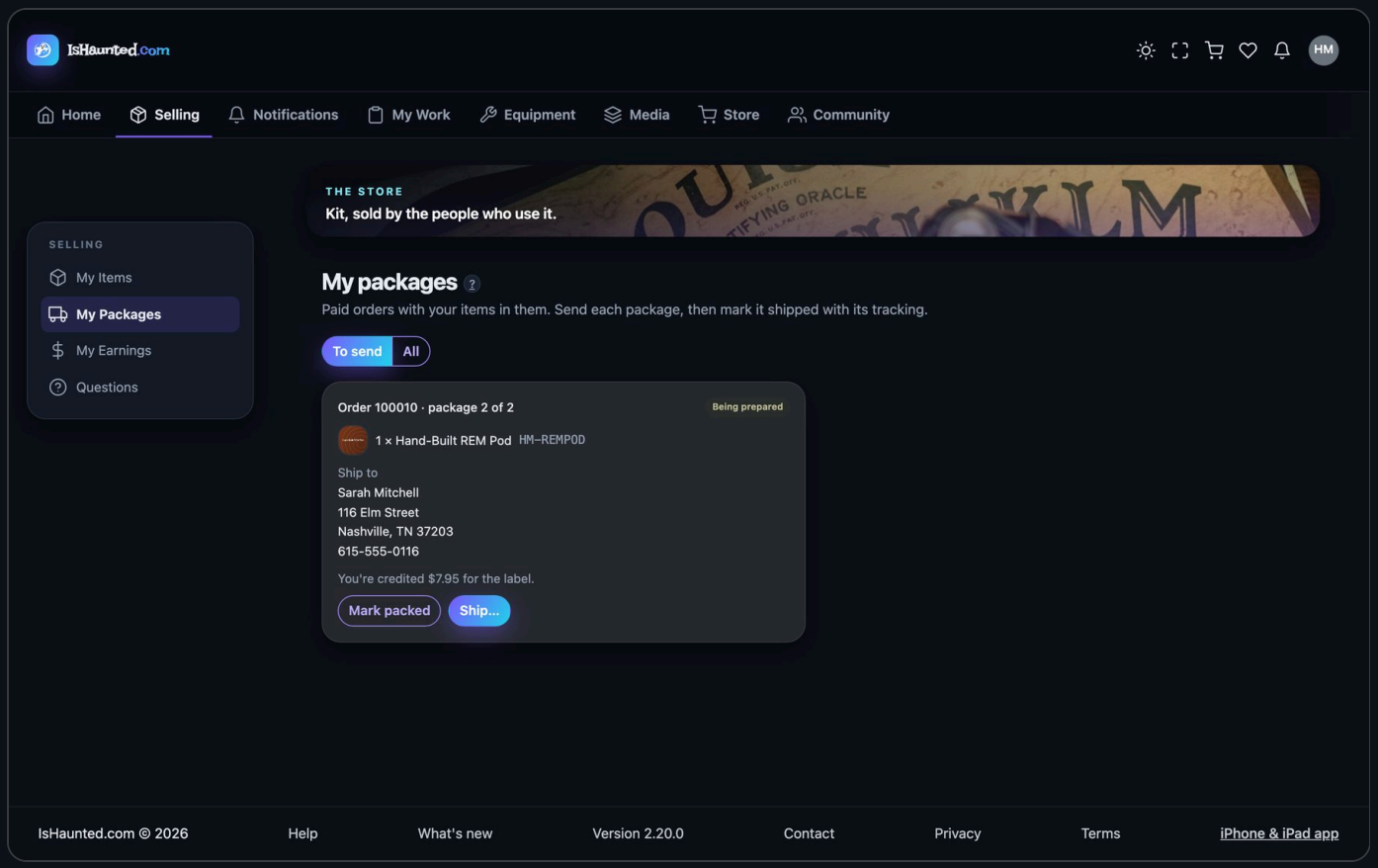
Sending packages

Each seller sends their own package. When a paid order has your items in it you get an email and a message, and it appears under **Selling → My Packages** with what goes in it and the buyer's name and address (shown until it's delivered).

1. Buy the label the way you usually do — Pirate Ship, the post office, your own account.
2. Optionally **Mark packed** while you get it ready.
3. **Ship…** — choose the carrier and type the tracking number, or check **No tracking provided**. The buyer is emailed right away, about your package only.
4. **Mark delivered** when it arrives, if the store hasn't already.

You're credited the store's flat shipping rate for every package you send — even when the buyer's shipping was free. If an order is on hold while the store reviews it, the package says so; wait until the hold is lifted.

When an order has packages from more than one seller, the buyer sees each package with its own tracking, and the order reads **Partially shipped** until every package has shipped.

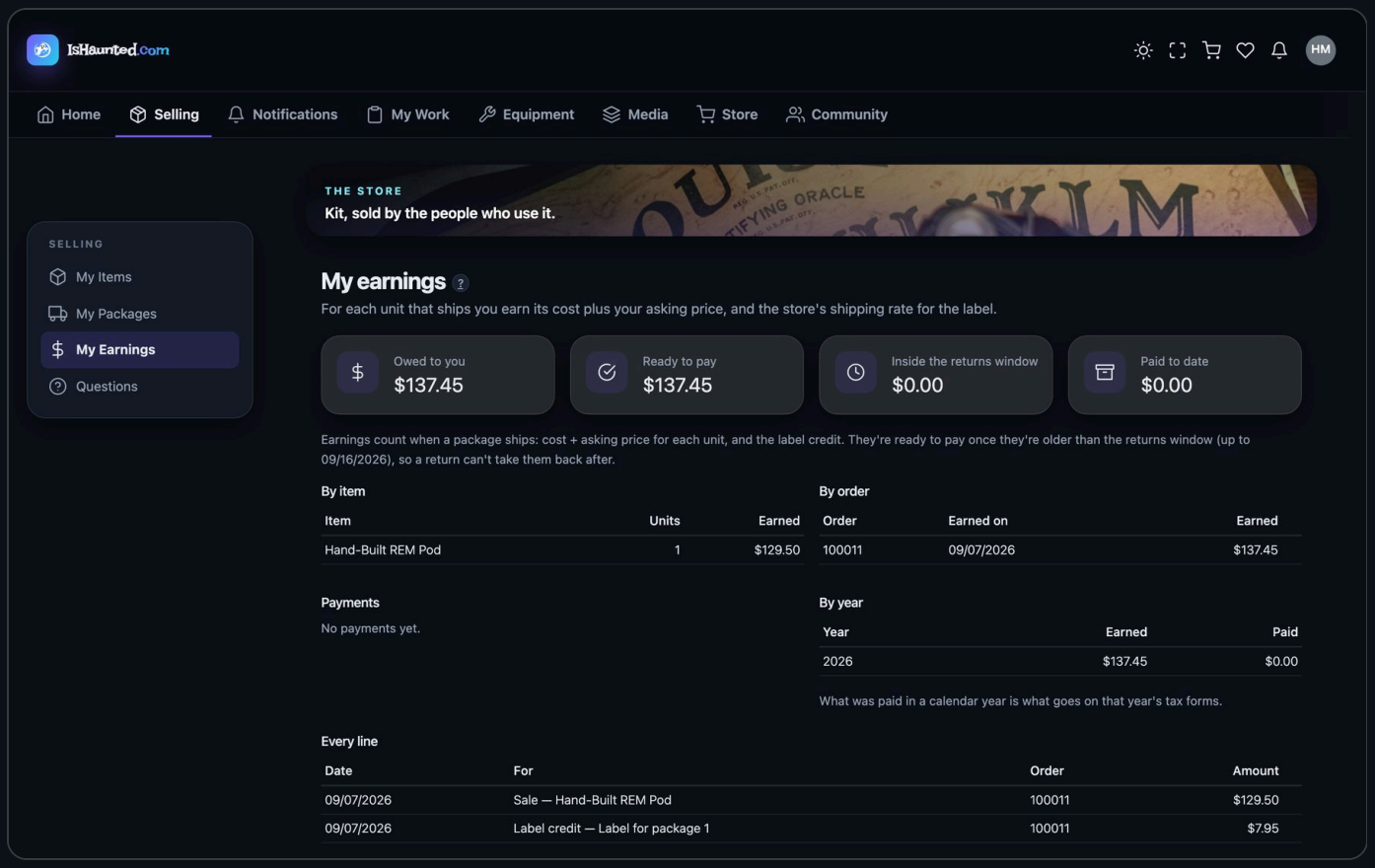


Your earnings

Selling → My Earnings shows what you've earned and been paid. You earn when a package **ships**. For each unit, you earn its cost to make (from your parts list) plus the asking price the store approved, both fixed when the order was placed. You also earn the store's shipping rate for the label.

- **Owed to you** — everything not yet paid.
- **Ready to pay** — earnings older than the returns window, which the store pays.
- **Inside the returns window** — still recent enough for a return.
- **Paid to date** — every payment the store has recorded.

If a unit is returned after your package shipped, what you earned for it is taken back. The store pays you outside the site — a transfer or a check — and records it here. The tables below break it down by item, by order and by year: the year's **Paid** column is what goes on that year's tax forms.



Going on sale

When an item is ready, press **Ask to put it on sale…** and say what you'd like to be paid for each one sold — on top of what its parts cost. Add a note for the store if it helps.

The store then sets the price shoppers pay, and either puts the item on sale — you get a message — or tells you what to change first. You can withdraw a request while it's waiting.

You can **take an item off sale** at any time; the store is notified. To put it back on sale, ask again. A **draft that has never been on sale** can be deleted. Anything that has been on sale can't be deleted, because orders and history refer to it.

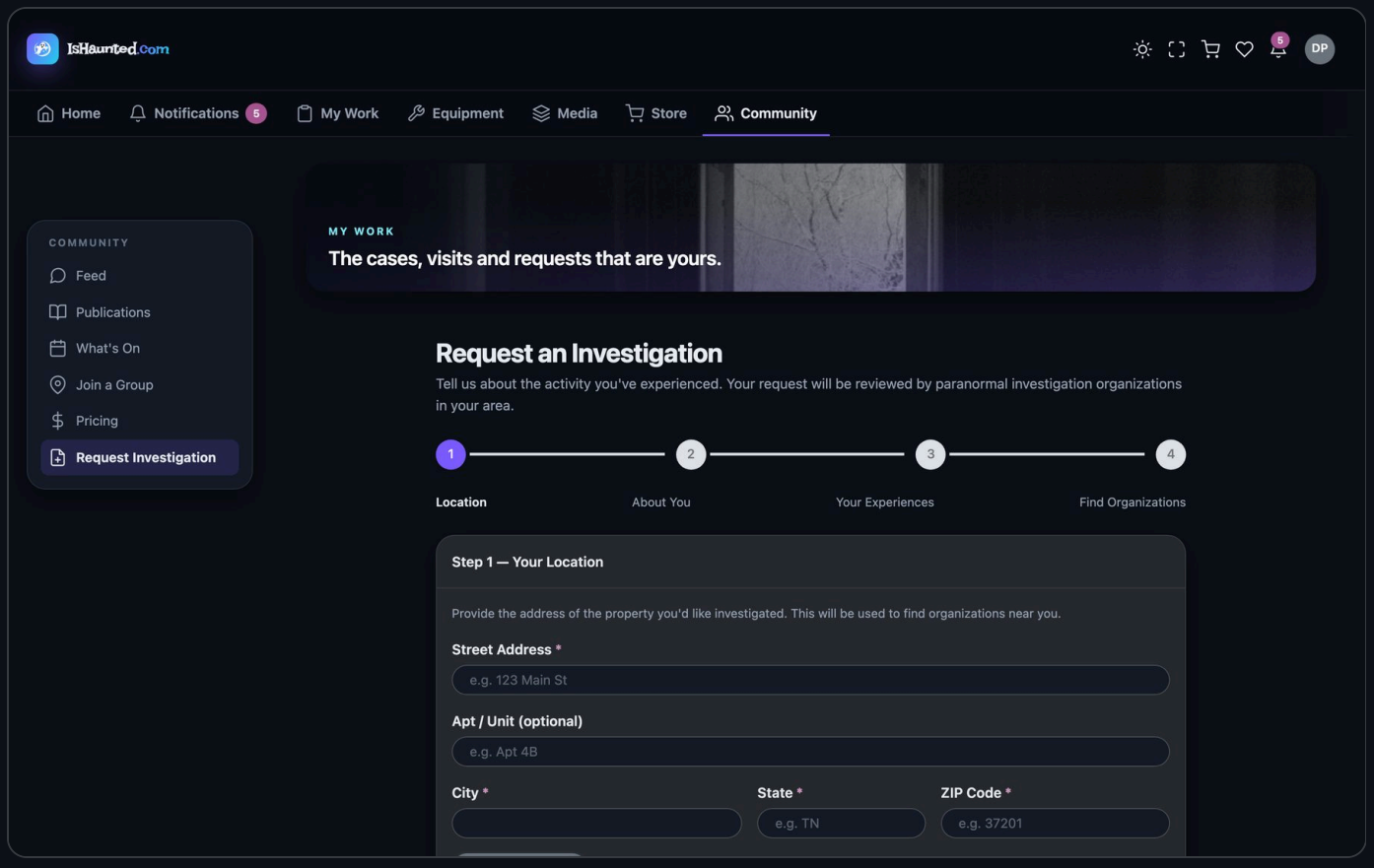
FOR CLIENTS

Requesting an Investigation

How to ask a group to look into what you have experienced.

Written for: **Public — no account needed**

Before you start



Describe what has been happening. Nothing is sent to a group until you choose one.

You do not need an account first. Anyone can use the form: start at **Request Investigation** and fill it in. The last step asks for your name, an email address and a password, and your account is created when you send the request. If you already have an account, sign in first and you won't be asked for any of that.

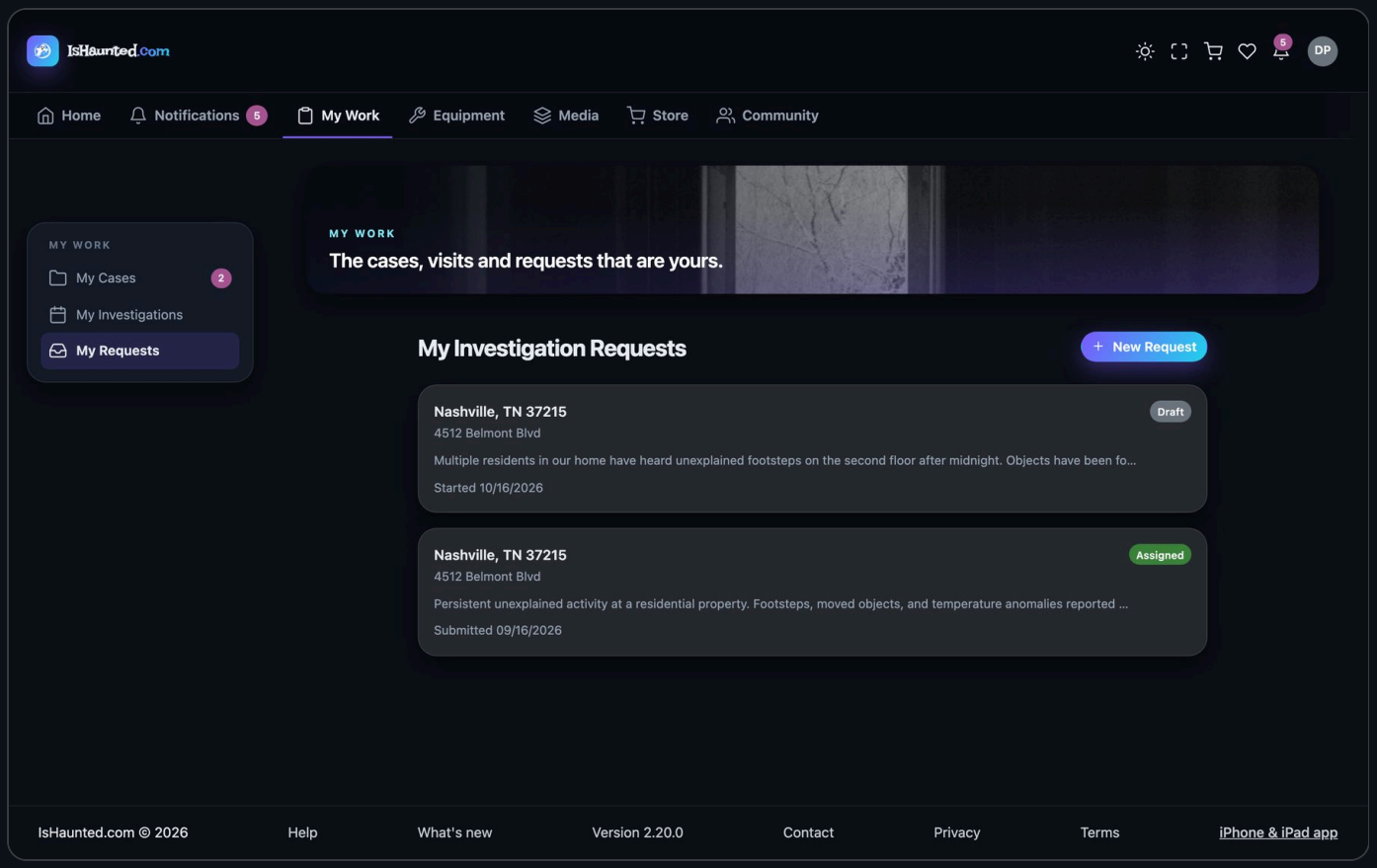
Everything you type is saved in this browser as you go, so closing the tab won't lose it.

You will be asked to describe what has happened. Write it as plainly as you can, in the order it happened. Investigators find dates, times and who was present far more useful than adjectives — "three knocks on the north wall, about 2am, twice last week" is worth more than "terrifying activity".

Choosing a group

Request Investigation is the quickest way to start a request. It's at the top of the menu before you sign in, and under **Community** once you have. If you'd like to see who is out there first, **Join a Group**, in the same place, lists the groups working in your area. You can send the same request to more than one group, and each one decides on its own whether to take it on.

What happens next



My Requests shows where each request stands with each group you sent it to.

1. The group reviews your request. **Under review** means their members are looking at what you submitted — including any photos or files you attached — and voting on whether to take it.
2. If you sent the request to several groups, they can all review it at the same time. **The first group to accept it takes the case**, and the others are told it is no longer available.
3. When a group accepts, you get a message telling you which group it is — and who your contact person is, once one has been chosen. Your **case** opens under **My Cases**, and from then on its **Messages** tab is where you talk to your group.
4. If a group declines, you are told, and you can send the request to a different group without writing it again.

Your address

Groups need your address to reach you — that's the point of the request. **Press Verify Address** on the first step. We place your address on the map to find the groups that work near you, and the form won't continue until that's done. Your address is never shown on public pages, and it isn't shared with any group you didn't send the request to.

What we do with what you tell us

> Your name, address and what you tell us are shared only with the group you send this to. None of it is public, and none of it is ever sold.

That's the whole rule. The group that accepts your case sees your details, and a group you didn't send the request to never does. Nothing here is published unless you and the group later agree to publish a case, and even then it can be published under a name you choose instead of your own.

Confirming your email

You can't use your account until you open the link we email you and press the button on the page it opens. Until you do, **the group cannot message you**. They can still see and accept your request, and they're told your email address isn't confirmed yet, so they know why you may be quiet. Open the link as soon as you can.

The page the link opens tells you where your request stands and shows your **@name** — the handle other people use to mention you. We create it from the name you gave, and it never changes.

If you already had an account

If the email address you typed already belongs to an account here, the request is **not** added to that account straight away, and the form doesn't tell you whether the address has an account. (If it did, anyone could use the form to find out who has one.) Instead, we email that address a note about the request with a link. Sign in to that account and open the link, and you can add the request to your account, or discard it if it wasn't you. The request is held for two weeks.

Drafts

A request you haven't sent yet is a **draft**. Only you can see it — no group can — and it shows as *Started* rather than *Submitted* on your list. You can pick it up later, or use **Delete draft** to remove it for good. Once a group

has received your request, don't delete it: use **Withdraw** instead, which tells the groups you've taken it back.

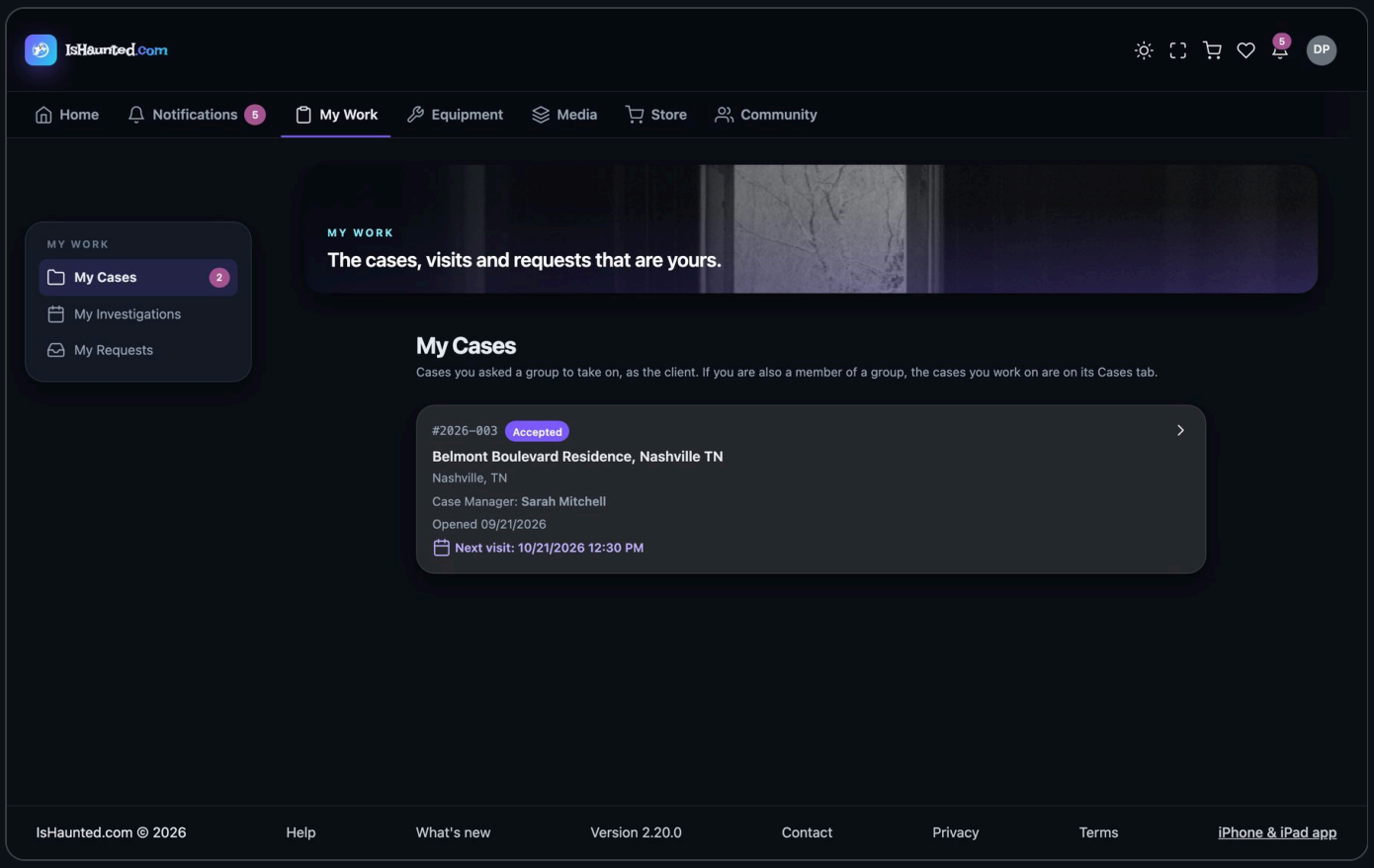
FOR CLIENTS

Following Your Case

The case page, logging occurrences, and who can see what.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

The case page



My Cases lists the cases a group has opened for you.

My Cases lists every case you are part of, whether you opened it yourself or someone invited you onto it. Open a case to see its calendar, everything logged so far, its files, and your message thread with the investigators. You can format messages with bold, italics, lists and links using the small toolbar above the message box, and the investigators' messages show the same formatting. In the iPhone app, messages show as plain text.

Logging an occurrence

Use **Log Occurrence** whenever something happens. Record it while it is fresh — getting the date and time right matters more than polished writing. You can attach photos, audio, or video, and you can tag what kind of experience it was so investigators can group similar reports.

Several people may report the same moment. That's expected, not a problem. The timeline groups entries that share a time and labels them, because two independent accounts of one event are more useful than one.

Who sees what

MARKED	SEEN BY
Internal	The investigators only.
Shared with you	The investigators and you.
Public	Anyone, if the case is ever published.

Your own reports are always visible to you and to the group working your case.

How you are named publicly

If a case is ever published, you choose the name shown — "A local family", "The homeowner", or anything you prefer. Set it on your case page under **How You're Named Publicly**.

Your investigators always see your real name, because they can't work a case without knowing who reported it. Your chosen name is used only on public pages and in shared documents.

Your case is private because it came from your request, and private cases protect you beyond the name you choose. If an investigator's written report or a timeline entry mentions you by name, the public copy automatically replaces it with your chosen name (or a neutral phrase like "the client"). The investigators keep their original wording for the investigation, but the public version never shows your name.

If your case is paused

A paused case simply means the organization's subscription has ended. **Nothing you reported or they collected has been lost**, and you can still read all of it. If the group renews, the case picks up exactly where it left off. If your case had a public page, that page is taken off the public site while the subscription is lapsed, so your privacy never depends on the group's billing.

You can also **move your case to a different organization** from the banner on the case page. This is for the person who asked for the investigation; anyone else they added to the case sees that a move was asked for, but can't ask for one. Pick a group, and choose what they will be able to see:

- the **history** collected so far — reports, notes, evidence
- the **investigations** the previous group ran

If your case is still paused after a month, we send you a reminder that you can move it. You never have to wait on a group that isn't coming back.

Anything you don't share stays with the original case: you can still see it, and the new group can't. Nothing is deleted either way. The findings belong to both the original group *and* you, so the choice is yours alone and the original group isn't asked. The new group then decides whether to take your request, and you hear their answer either way. Until they answer, you can withdraw the request.

You'll hear by email

When your case changes status — accepted, active, being written up, closed — or when the group schedules, moves or cancels a visit, we email your confirmed address with the same update your case page shows, plus a button that opens the case. Times in the email are local to the visit, with the time zone named, such as "8:00 PM CDT". On the case page, the **Local time · My time** switch beside the investigations shows those times on your own clock instead. If your email address isn't confirmed yet, no email is sent until it is.

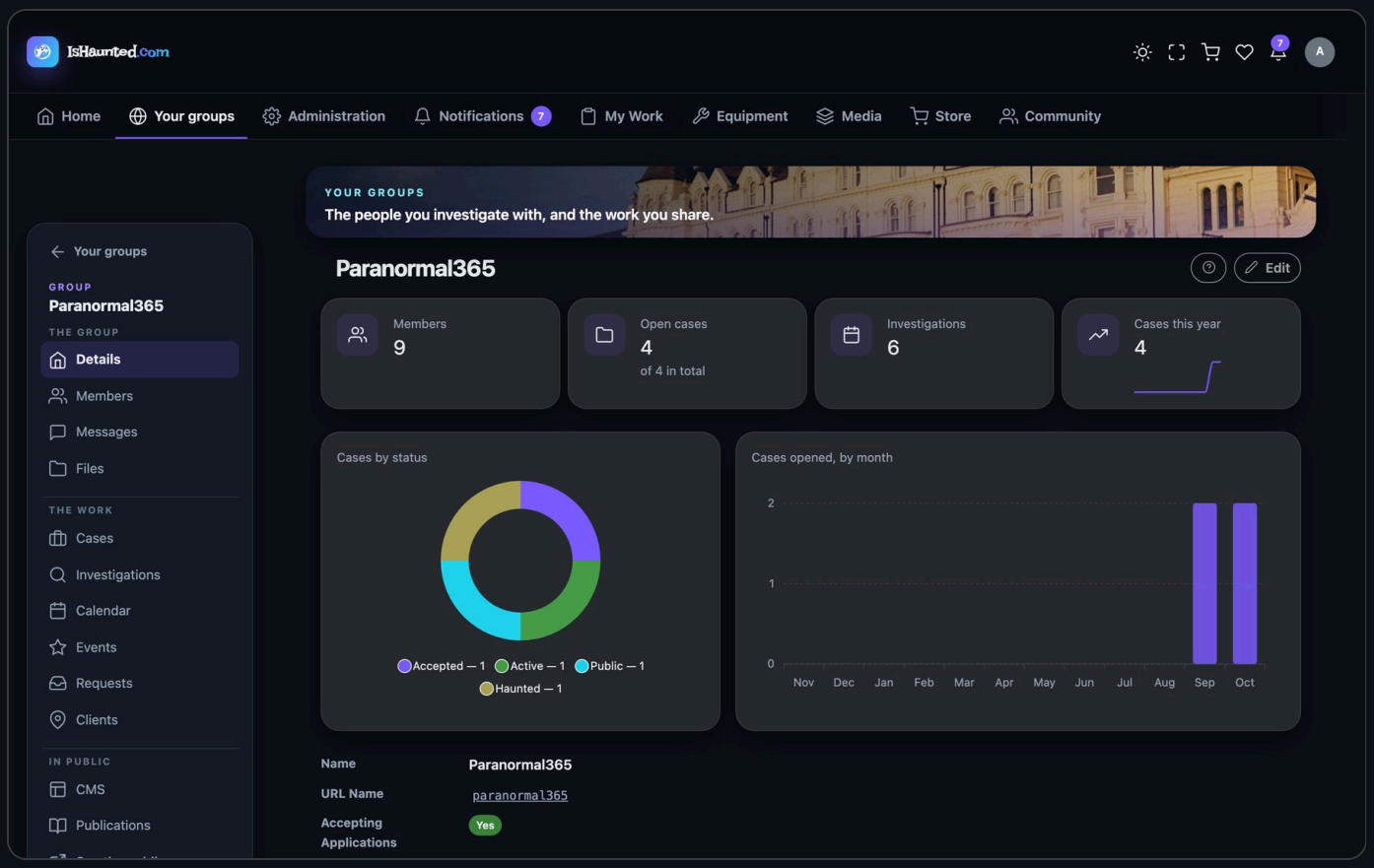
FOR GROUP MEMBERS

Working a Case

The case page from the investigator's side — timeline, files, investigations.

Written for: **Group members**

Every case belongs to a group, and the group's own page is where its cases are listed.



Open a group from Organizations, then its Cases tab, to reach any case it is working.

Taking on a request — reviewing and voting

Client requests arrive under **Pending Requests** on the group's Cases screen. When any are waiting, the button turns yellow and shows how many. The status buttons above the list work the same way: any status that has cases shows its count in that status's color, so new proposals and active cases stand out. Every request has a **Review & vote** button, which opens everything the client submitted — their description, the location, and any photos, recordings or documents they attached. Every group the client sent the request to sees the same materials while it decides.

When you mark a request **Under Review**, your group knows it's time to decide. Everyone who can read the group's cases gets an internal message with a link to the review page, where they vote **Take it** or **Pass** and can add a comment. The vote is advisory — it doesn't accept the case by itself. The person with permission to accept cases makes the decision, with the tally in front of them.

Review & vote stays on the card for as long as a request is open, including while it is Under Review, when voting is actually happening. If you reach the review page before anyone has opened voting, you'll find **Mark Under Review** right on the ballot.

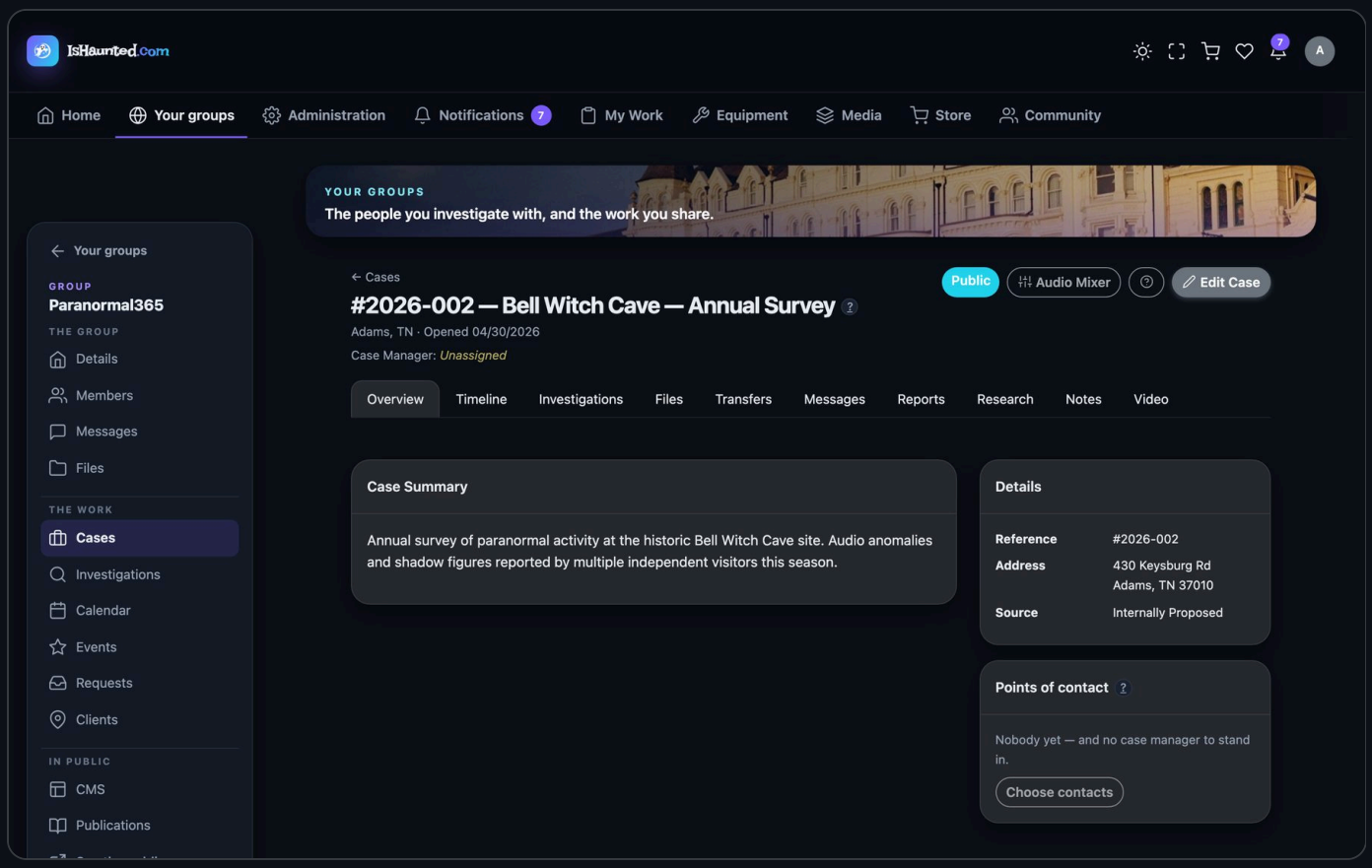
Who gets the message, and who can vote: everyone who can read the group's cases. That means anyone with the Investigator Role or a broader role — see *What new members start with* in Group administration. A member with no role isn't told about the request and can't open it.

The first group to accept wins. As soon as any group accepts, the other groups reviewing the same request get a message that it's no longer available, and their review pages close. The client is told which group has taken their case — and who their contact person is, if a case manager was chosen when the case was accepted.

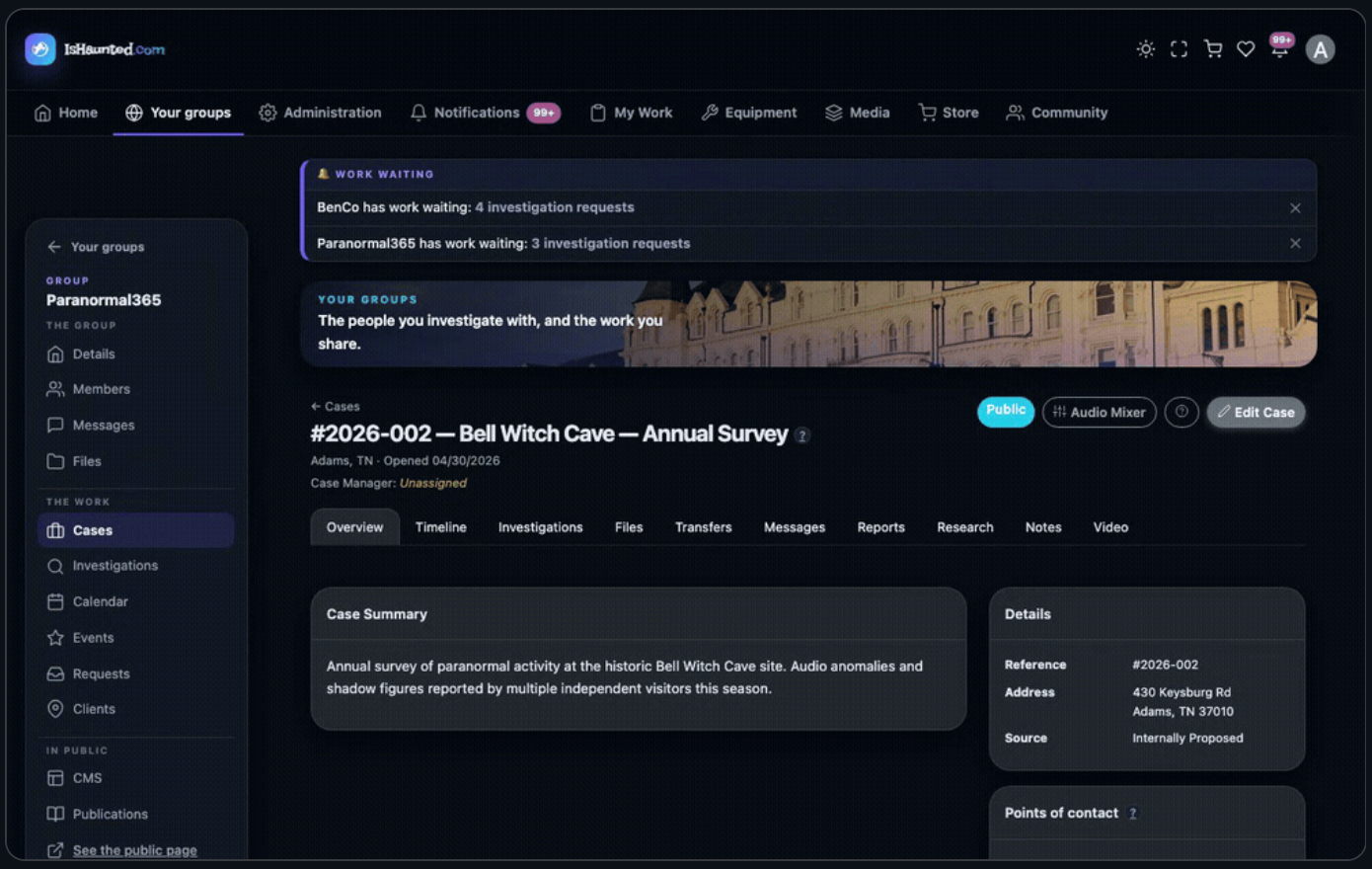
If your group isn't going to take a request, decline it promptly. The client is waiting, and once you decline they can send it to another group without rewriting it.

The case title suggested when you accept is the client's town — "Nashville, TN" — not their name. You can type any title your group wants instead. Just remember that the title becomes the heading on the case's public page if you ever publish it, so a real name belongs in the **pseudonym** field, not here.

The case tabs



A case opens on Overview. Every other part of the case is a tab along the top.



Timeline, Investigations, Files and Reports, each on the same case.

Overview shows the original request exactly as the client submitted it, kept separate from the case description so the two never get mixed up as the case is edited.

Edit Case, at the top of the case, opens its own page. The description fills the wide column, with room for anything from a single line to several paragraphs, and a small toolbar for bold, italics, lists and links. The status, the public pseudonym, **Make Public**, the private-engagement setting and the case manager sit beside it (below it, on a phone). If you have unsaved changes and try to leave the page, it asks you first; **Cancel** leaves without saving. **New Case** uses the same editor for its description.

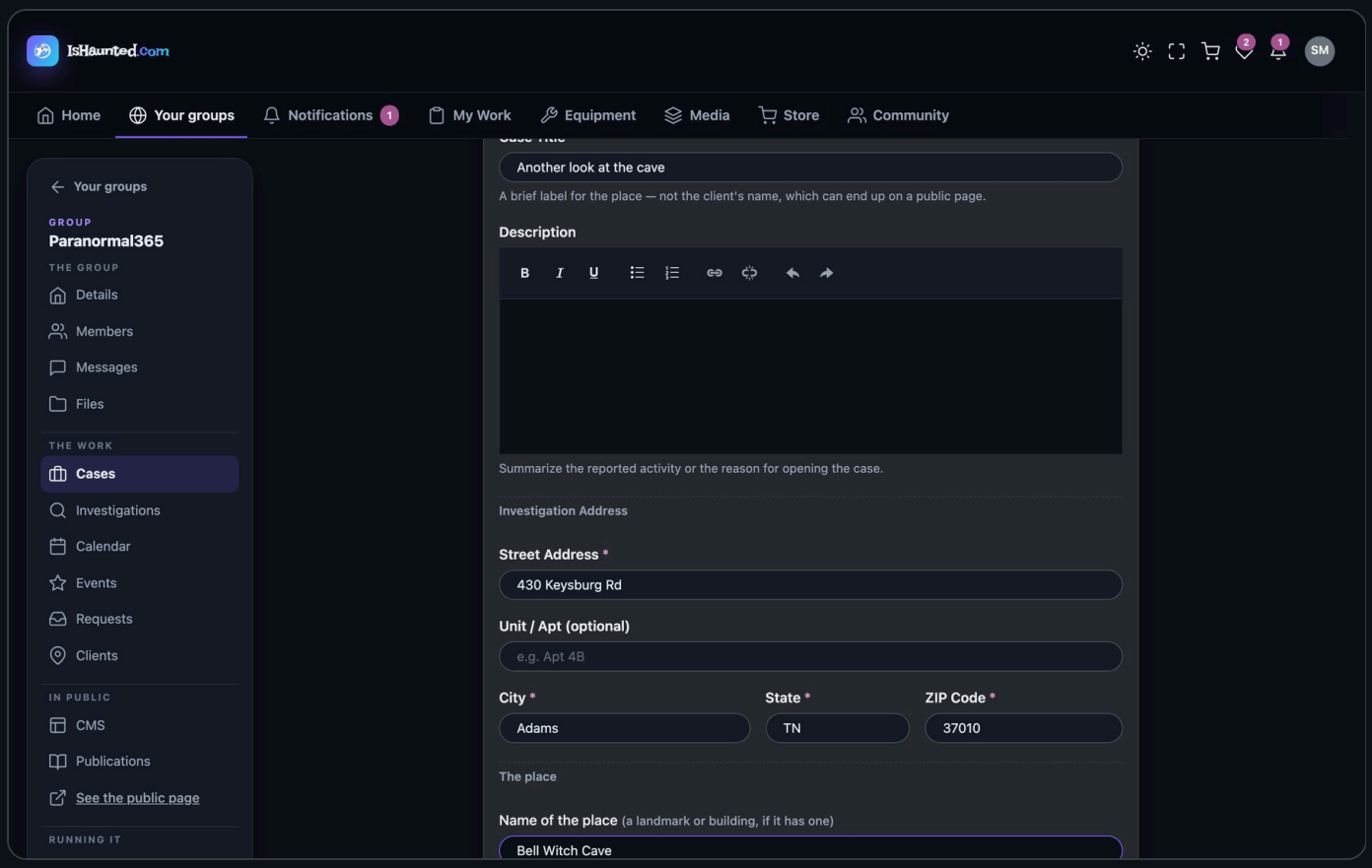
Which place the case is about

Every case names the **place** it concerns, which links it to every other group's work at the same location. As you type the address, any place already on file that looks like a match is suggested. Choose **Use this place** to attach the case to it, or keep typing to create a new place instead. The suggestion is only a suggestion — two apartments at one address are two different places, and only you know which one this is.

Then choose **what kind of place** it is. There is no default, because the answer matters either way:

- **Public location** — a landmark, a business, anywhere that is not somebody's home. Its page collects every group's work there, and anyone can add to it.
- **Private residence** — somebody's home. Findings stay with your group. This counts as private-engagement work, so your group needs a plan that covers it.

Open Case stays grayed out until you have chosen. Once the case is open, a line at the top names the place, says how many other groups have investigated there, and links to the place's page.



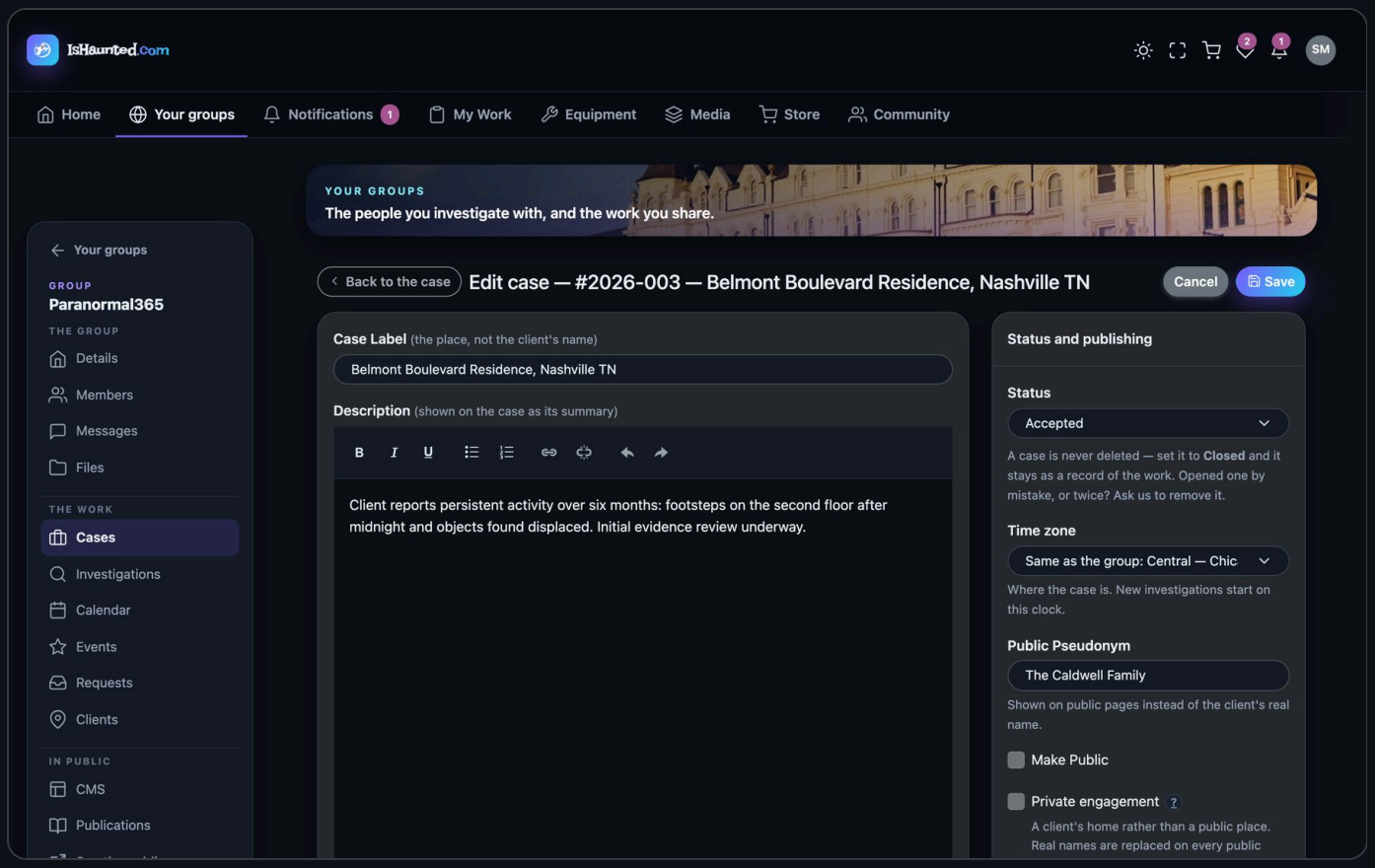
A matching place on file is suggested as you type;

Use this place attaches the case to it. There is no default for the kind of place.

You can also start from the place: a public place's own page has **Open a case here**, which brings you to this form with the place already filled in.

If your group has no plan, a case you open is **public from the start**, and you can't uncheck the **Make Public** box. On a free account, work at a public location is public, and the Edit Case page says so next to the box. This doesn't affect a case at somebody's home, or any case that was already private. See Having a plan, and not having one.

A case you open yourself is **accepted** right away. That's usually what you want when your group chose the place itself: nobody proposed it, and you're the person who would have accepted it anyway. If the group really should decide, check **Let the group decide whether to take this on**, and the case waits as **Proposed** until someone accepts it. You only see that box if you're allowed to change a case's status; anyone else always opens a case as a proposal. None of this applies to a case a client asked for — that arrives as a request and is accepted or declined in the usual way.



Edit Case: the description in the wide column, status and publishing beside it.

Timeline is the case's working record: client reports, investigator notes, evidence, instrument readings and research. Every entry has a visibility — internal to the group, shared with the client, or public. Choose carefully. "Internal" means the entry isn't shared any further; it doesn't hide the entry from the person who wrote it.

Investigations covers scheduled visits, attendees and RSVPs, and each visit's binder.

Notes are the group's own working notes, never shown to the client. You can format a note with bold, italics, lists and links, and pin it to the top. Older notes, written before formatting was available, keep their line breaks.

Files holds the case's evidence. **Upload File** accepts photographs, audio, video and documents, and you can choose several at once. Each file appears by name as soon as you pick it, with a progress bar that fills as it uploads. A night's worth of video can take a while on a home connection, so you can watch it progress instead of staring at a page that seems stuck. If a file is rejected, the reason appears next to it. **Attach from Library** adds a file the group already has, without making a second copy. Video and audio play right on the page, and you can drag to move through them.

Binders

A binder is the case timeline filtered to one investigation. Entries recorded during a visit also stay on the main case timeline, so nothing is kept in two places. Filter the timeline by investigation to see just that visit.

Instrument readings

Readings taken during a visit go in as **Instrument Reading** entries. Record the value, its unit, and the ambient baseline — without the baseline, nobody can judge the reading later.

Research boards

The case's **Research** tab lists its boards. A board is a space for working things out: cards, notes, pictures, files, recordings, links and maps, arranged and connected the way your thinking actually went. It's where you write up what you learned from a deed, an obituary, a newspaper archive or a walk around a cemetery.

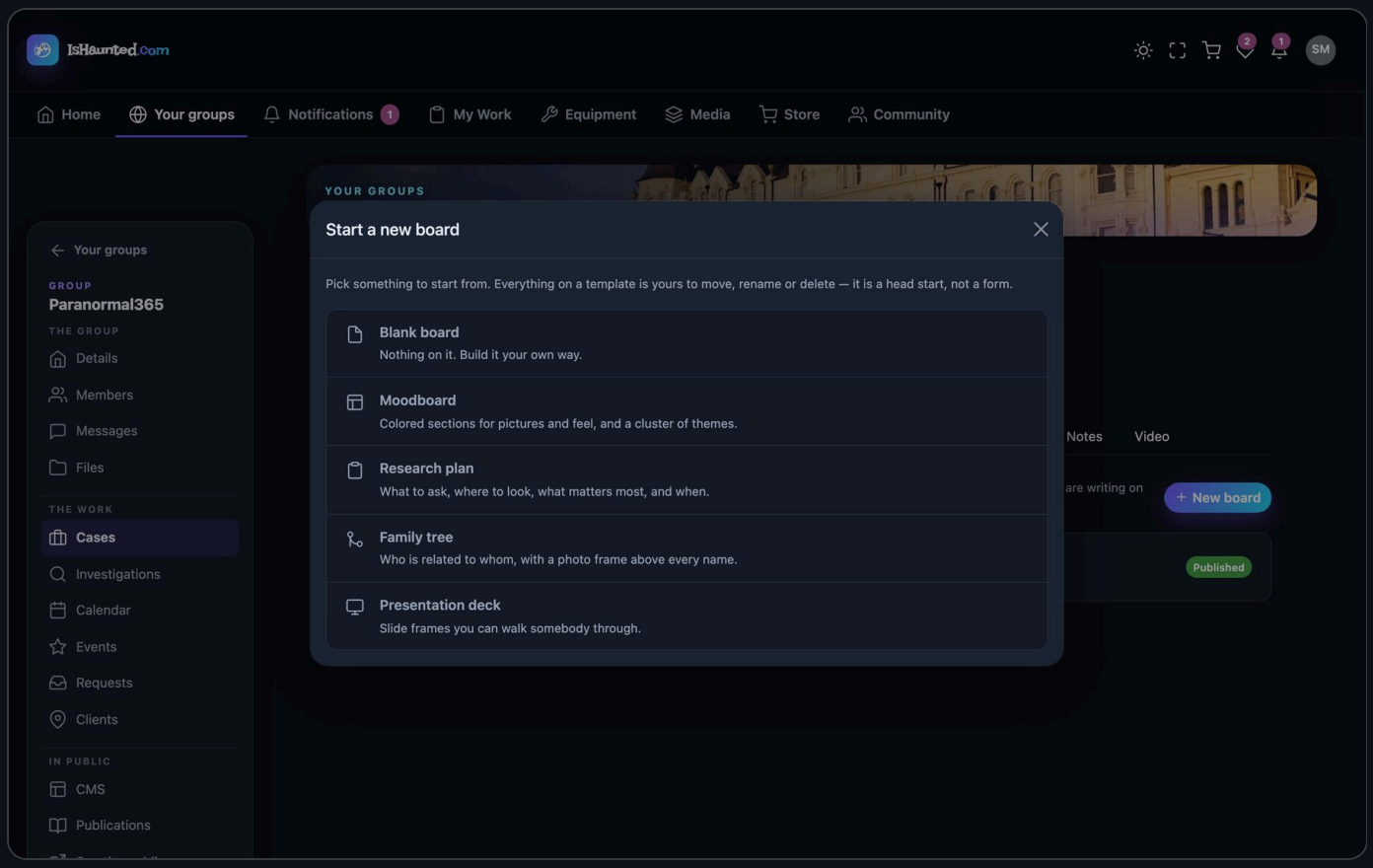
New board asks what you want to start from, then opens the board editor for this case, already signed in. **Open** takes you back to an existing board.

Something to start from

A blank board suits some work, but for other work it's hard to get going, so **New board** offers five starting points:

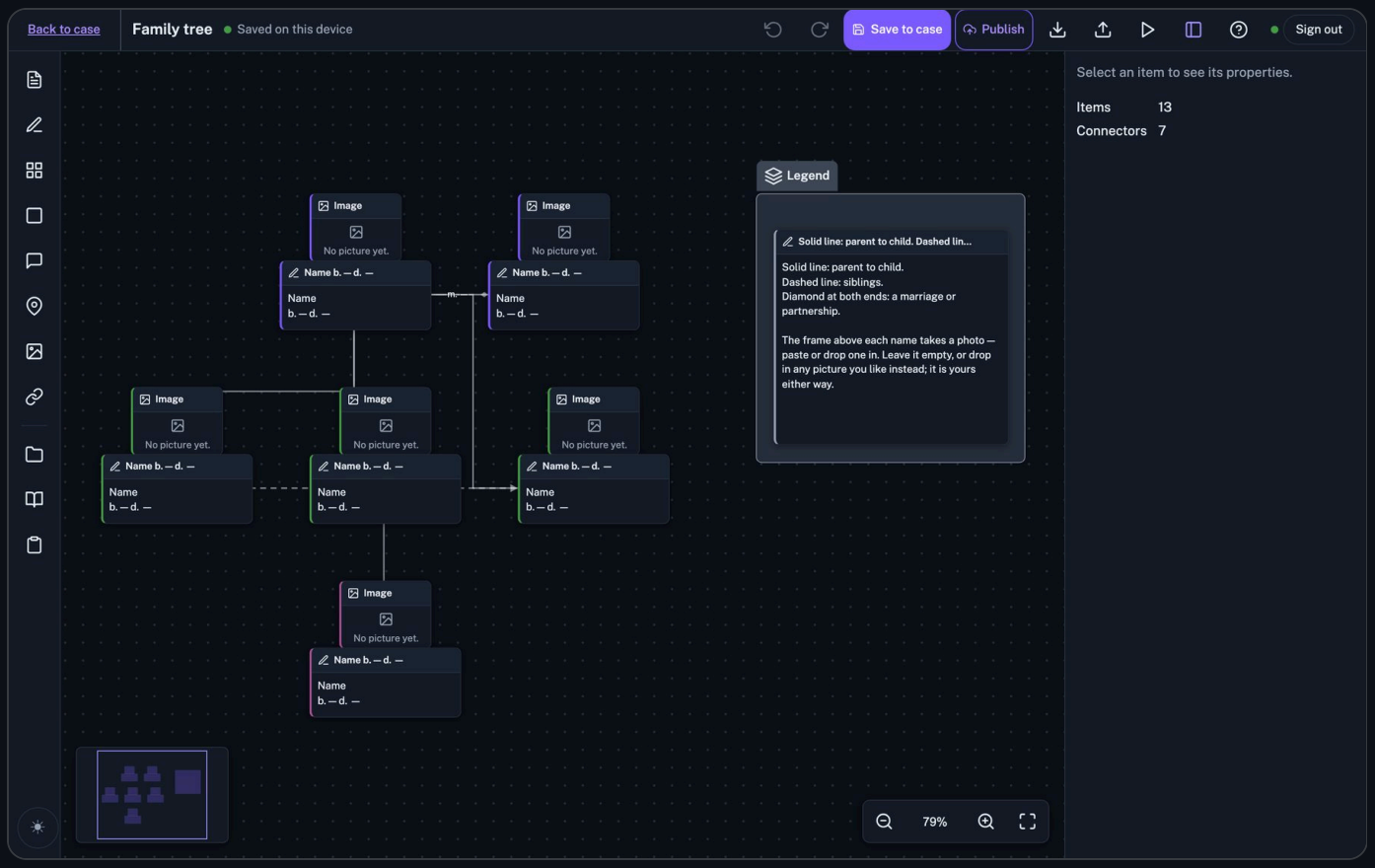
Blank board	an empty board.
Moodboard	four colored sections — feel, places, sound, references — and a cluster of themes connected to a central one. For capturing the atmosphere of a place before you get into the facts.
Research plan	what to ask, where to look, a four-square grid of what is worth doing, and a four-week calendar grid. For deciding what to do next.
Family tree	names in boxes joined by right-angled lines, with a photo frame above every name and a legend explaining what the lines mean.
Presentation deck	four slide frames with room for a heading and bullet points. You can present it right away; the frames are the slides.

Everything on a template is yours to change. Move it, rename it, recolor it, delete it. A template is a head start, not a form to fill in, and nothing on it is treated differently from anything you add yourself.

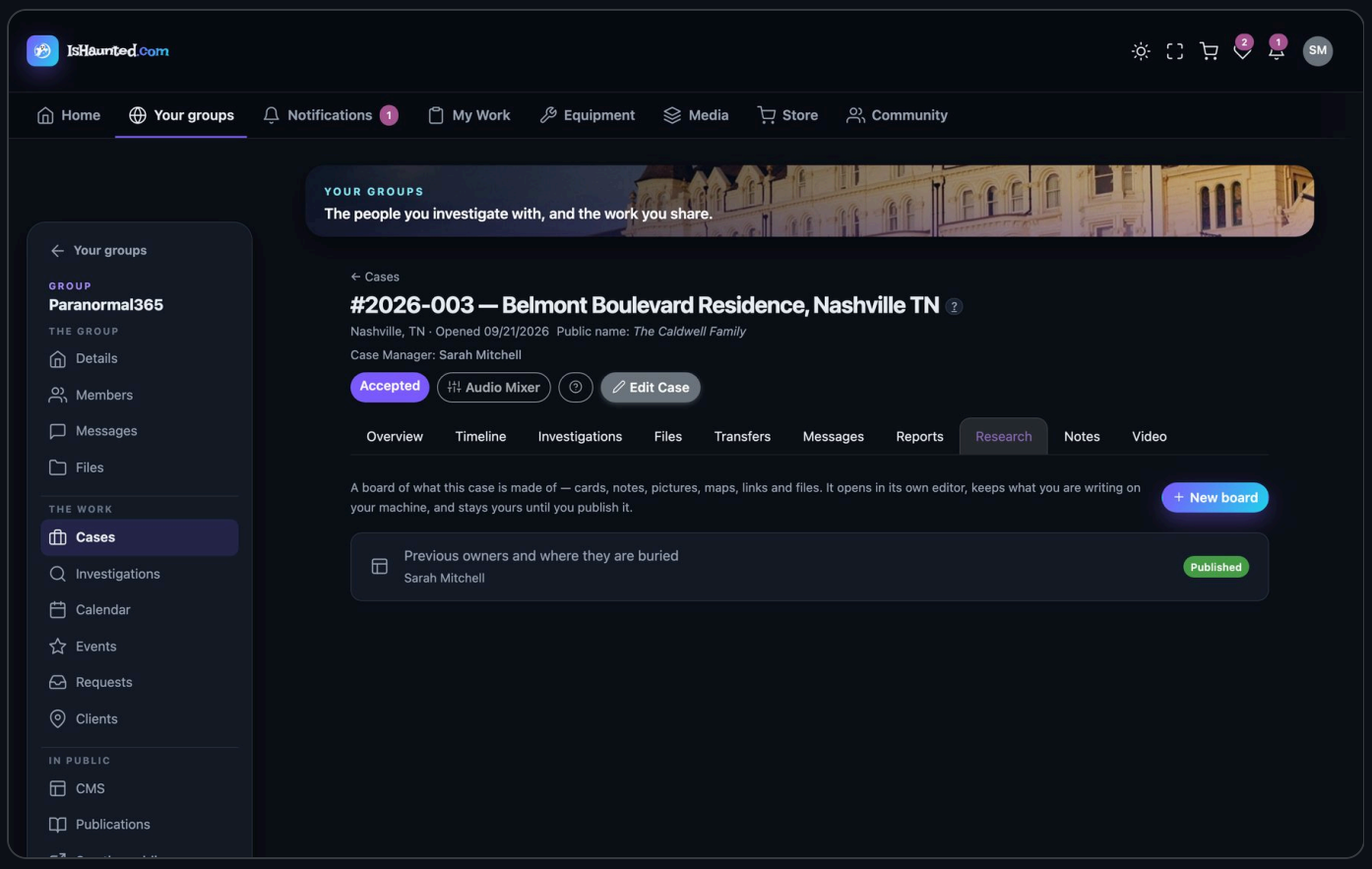


New board: five starting points, each with a one-line description of what you get.

The family tree's photo frames start empty, and it's fine to leave them that way. Paste or drop a photograph into a frame, use any other picture you like, or leave them all blank and let the names speak for themselves. The lines connect the **names**, not the frames, so a missing photograph doesn't move anything.



The family tree as it opens: names, right-angled lines, a small photo frame above each name, and a legend explaining what the lines mean.



The Research tab: the boards on this case, who wrote each one, and whether it has been published.

Putting things on a board

Add, on the left, offers a card, a note, a message, a map, a picture or a link. Double-click an empty part of the board to put a note right where you clicked.

Paste anywhere. The board looks at what you pasted and creates the right kind of item: a web address becomes a link card with the page's title and picture, a photo becomes a picture, a recording becomes a player right on the board, a document becomes a file, a street address becomes a map of that place, and anything else becomes a note. Whatever you paste goes in an empty spot instead of on top of something that's already there.

Drop files on the board and the same thing happens — and the files are added to the case's **Files** at the same time, so you never end up with two copies of a photograph. Files added this way are marked **Research** in the Files tab, so you can see which of the case's files the boards use. That's handy when a camera or scanner gave them meaningless names and you want to rename them later.

The case files button (the folder, on the left) works in the other direction. It opens **From the case**, which has two tabs:

- **Files** — what the case already holds, so you can put a photograph from last week's visit straight onto the board without finding it on your computer and uploading it again.
- **What the client wrote** — every message the client has sent on this case. Pick one and their words appear on the board with their name and the date they wrote them, so the reason you're researching the house sits right beside what you found. Only the client's messages are offered; the group's replies are its own thinking, and the board is where that thinking happens.

Kinds of card

Most research isn't evidence, so a card can be one of six kinds, each asking for the details that kind of thing needs:

KIND	WHAT IT IS FOR
Evidence	something recorded — a description, the date, what kind it is, and whether it is verified.
Historical note	what happened here before anybody was recording: what, when, where, and where you read it.
Article	a piece of writing — news, a book, a journal, a website or a broadcast — with its author and what it says.
Experience	what somebody felt, heard or saw with nothing recording: what, which sense, who, where in the place, and when.
Quote	somebody's words, who said them, when, and where the quote comes from.
Person	a witness, a client, a neighbor or an owner: their connection to the place and what they describe.

Choose the kind at the top of the card's form while you edit it. If you change your mind, nothing you've typed is lost: a field the new kind doesn't use is kept in the card and comes back if you switch back. **No card asks for a telephone number or an address for a person**, because a board can be published to the case. Contact details belong on the case itself.

On every kind except Evidence, you type **When** instead of picking a date from a calendar, so you can write "the 1920s", "before the fire" or "1887" just as you'd say it.

A card's heading shows its title. Until you give it one, the heading shows the kind of card — *Quote*, *Person* — instead of the generic word "Card".

Grids and shapes

Not everything worth putting on a board is a card.

A table is for anything you'd read across in rows: the owners of a house and the years each one held it, four weeks of who is doing what, a set of readings. A new table is two columns wide, with a header row and one row beneath it. Click a cell and type; **Tab** moves to the next cell, and from the last cell it adds a new row. While a table is selected, the buttons above it add and remove rows and columns, and you can turn off the header row if the table doesn't need headings.

A shape is a box, a circle or a diamond holding a word or two. Use one when a full card would be too much: a theme, a question, a step in a process, or a label for an area of the board. Choose the shape while it is selected.

Color, panels and fills

Every block can be one of six colors, chosen while it is selected. Two switches change how the color is used:

Filled with its color	the whole block is filled with the color, instead of just a stripe down its edge. Good for shapes and for the one card that matters most; harder to read on a card with a lot of text.
Draw as a panel	for a group: the area is filled in and given a title instead of just an outline, so it looks like a section of the board rather than a ring around some cards.

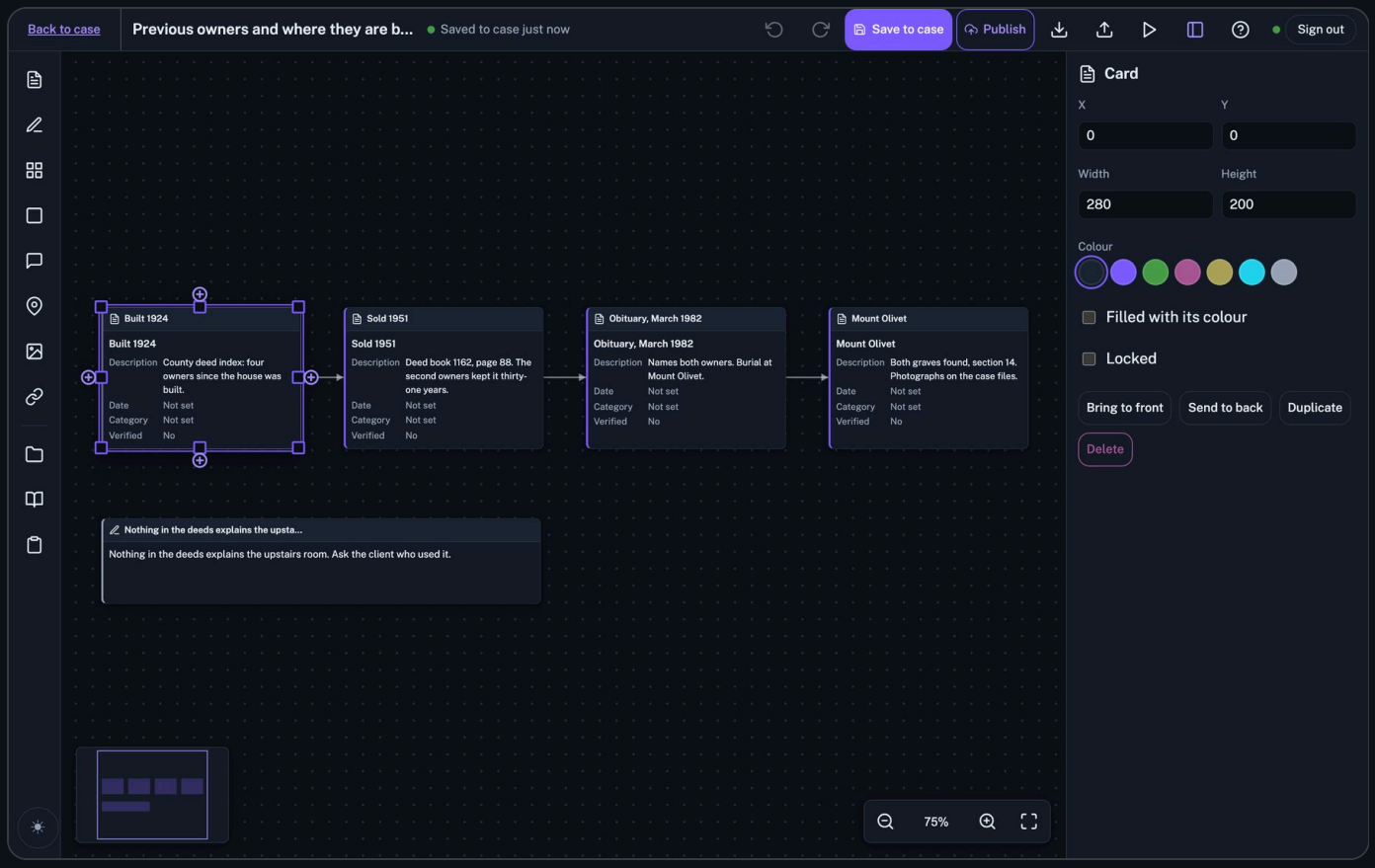
Both settings are kept when the board is published, so readers see the board exactly as you laid it out.

One card after another

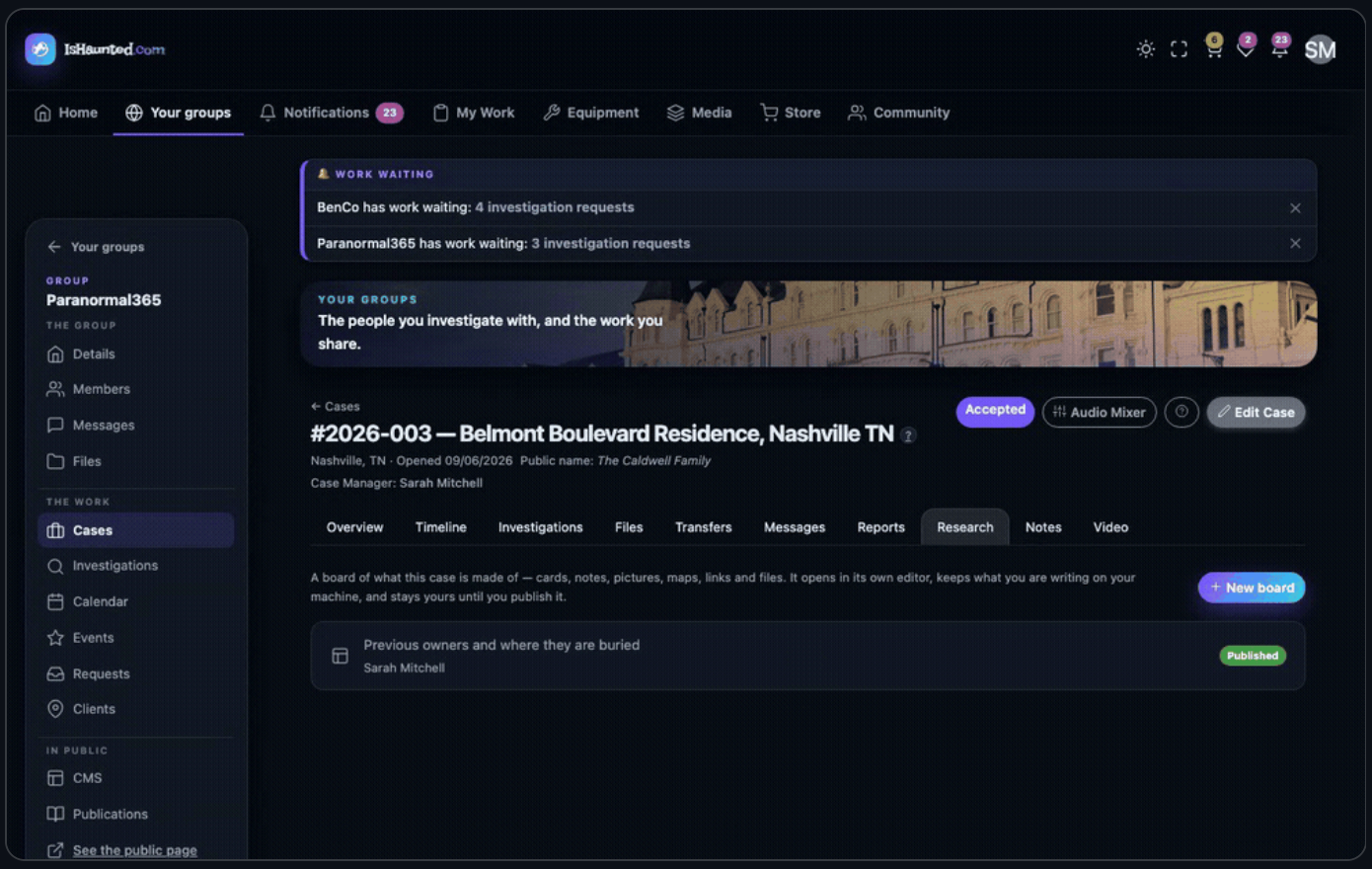
Select a card and four small **+** handles appear, one on each side. Use them to lay out a train of thought:

Click a handle	the next card appears on that side, already connected by an arrow and ready to type in.
Drag a handle onto empty board	the same, but the card appears where you let go.
Drag a handle onto another card	connects the two cards instead of making a new one.
Ctrl+Shift and an arrow key	the same as clicking the handle on that side.

The new card is the same kind, size and color as the one you started from, and a single **Undo** removes both the card and its arrow.



A card's four handles, and the new card one of them made — connected and ready for text.



A handle adds the next card, one Undo removes it, and the board is presented one card at a time.

What a line says

Select a line to set what it means:

Route	*Curve* is the default. *Straight* takes the shortest path between two blocks. *Elbow* uses right angles, which is what a family tree or an org chart needs.
Ends	an arrow, a diamond, a dot or nothing, chosen separately for each end. A diamond at both ends with no arrow means "these two are connected", with neither one coming first.
Line	solid or dashed. Use dashed for a weaker claim: a maybe, a sibling, a link nobody has confirmed yet.
Label	a few words along the middle of the line.
Icon	one or two characters in a small badge on the line, so you can mark several lines as the same kind at a glance.

The site doesn't attach any meaning to these choices — a dashed line isn't treated as a weaker record — so explain what your lines mean somewhere on the board. That's why the family tree template comes with a legend.

Drafts and publishing

A new board is yours alone. Nobody else on the case can see it, or even knows it exists, until you publish it, because research needs thinking through before it counts as evidence. The board saves itself on your own computer as you work, and **Save to case** saves it to the server.

Publish shows the board to everyone who can read the case and adds a picture of the whole board to the case's files. If you keep working afterward, your changes are private again until you publish once more. In the meantime the group still sees the published version, and the list shows *published, and written on since*.

A card that opens another board

Eventually a board fills up. The **book** button on the left adds a card that opens another board on this case — say, a family tree on one board and the newspaper articles on another, with a card on each that links to the other. Pick the board, and optionally a card on it to jump to.

The header shows how you got there. When you follow a link, the boards you came through appear before the title, oldest first: *Family tree* / *Newspapers* / *Deeds***. Click any of them to go straight back to that board, not just the previous one. The path always shows exactly where you've been, so following a link back to where you started adds a new step instead of removing one, and going back to a step clears everything after it.

Only published boards can be linked to, and the picker tells you so. Otherwise, a card linking to someone's draft would let people read that draft through a board that had been published. This has two consequences worth knowing:

- A board with a link on it **cannot be published** until the board it links to is published. You'll be told which board that is.
- If the board you linked to is **deleted or unpublished**, the card stays where it is and tells you so when clicked. Nothing on your board changes behind your back because of something that happened on someone else's.

If the card you linked to is gone but its board still exists, the link simply opens that board instead of failing. The card you picked is just where you'd like to land, not a guarantee.

Presenting a board

Present (the play button, top right) steps through the board one card at a time, full screen, with everything else dimmed. Use it when you meet to talk through the case.

There's nothing to prepare: **the cards are the slides**. The order comes from the board itself:

1. if you have drawn **groups** around parts of the board, those are the slides, in the order they appear;
2. otherwise **the arrows** set the order, and each chain of connected cards is shown from start to end;
3. anything left over is shown **down the page**, top to bottom.

So when you add cards with the side handles, you're building the presentation order as you think.

Right arrow, space, Page Down	next card
Left arrow, Page Up, backspace	previous card
Home / **End**	first / last card
Escape	stop presenting

Select a card before pressing Present to start from that card. Presenting doesn't change anything on the board, so someone who can only read the case can still run the meeting.

Presenting: one card at a time, everything else dimmed, and your place in the deck.

Link cards

A link card shows the page's title, description, site and picture. The picture is a small copy stored on our own servers, so viewing a card never sends anyone to the other site. We fetch the page once, when a signed-in person adds the link, and never for someone who is only viewing the board. Some addresses can't be fetched — a private network, something that isn't a web page, or a site that's too slow to respond — and those cards show the address instead.

Because the picture is **our own copy**, saved when the card was first made, a published board keeps its pictures and shows them to whoever reads it, and a card doesn't go blank if the other site moves its image. If

you're working on a board without signing in, link cards show only the address unless someone has used that link before, because the server only fetches outside pages for signed-in people.

The same cards appear under links in group messages, case messages and feed posts.

Map boxes

A map box starts empty and never fills in the case's address on its own — you choose the place. Type an address in the box and press **Find** (or just press Enter), and the map moves there. It can be a town, a street address, or a cemetery by name. Whatever you typed stays as the box's label, whether or not the address is found, and you can always type coordinates instead. Pasting an address straight onto the board makes a map the same way; if the place can't be found, your text becomes a note instead. On a published board, a map box shows its address instead of map tiles, because the map provider doesn't allow its imagery to be saved.

Any block with an address in it can become a map. Right-click a card, a note, a message or a picture's caption, and if it contains an address, the menu offers **Make a map**. The map appears next to the block, centered on that address and labeled with it, and the block itself stays as it is — you still want the Person card after the map exists. If the address can't be found, you're told, and nothing is added.

On a phone

The board works on a phone: **Add** and **Paste** are along the bottom, pinch to zoom, drag to move around, and press and hold a card for its other actions.

Showing your finding on your public page

A report is written for your client, and by default nobody else ever sees it. If you want the public to read what you concluded, check **Show this on our public case page** on the report, next to the summary and conclusion it publishes.

Only those two fields are published, and nothing else — not the sections, the evidence files, or the field sessions you cited. Those hold the working details of an investigation in somebody's home; the summary and conclusion are the parts you wrote for readers.

Three separate conditions must all be met before a visitor sees anything, and meeting one doesn't mean the others are met:

The report is **published**	Publishing delivers the report to your client. That's a separate decision from showing it to the public.
The case is **public**	Making a case public publishes the case itself. It doesn't publish a report written for the client.
This box is **checked**	Set for each report. You can uncheck it at any time, and the page stops showing the finding immediately.

Check for the client's details, next to the box, reads your summary and conclusion and warns you if they include the client's name or street — the same check used on the case title. It's a warning, not a block: a surname is often a place name too, and only you know which one you mean.

On a **private engagement**, names in the summary are replaced in the public copy, just as they are in the title and the timeline. You can write naturally, and the replacement happens automatically every time the public copy is read.

The finding appears on the case's own public page under *What we found*, directly below your client's account of what happened. It's also available to the **cases** block in the page builder, so you can show it on any page you build.

Correcting a report your client already has

You can still edit a published report, and sometimes you should — a date is wrong, a name is misspelled, a paragraph is unclear. What matters is that your client finds out.

Edit and save as usual. The report then shows **Edited since published** next to its status, and a **Re-publish** button appears beside it. Re-publishing posts a new note on the case message board saying the report has been *updated*, so your client knows the copy on their case page isn't the one they were first sent.

Until you re-publish, they aren't told anything. Your client reads the report on their case page, so they already see your edits — which is exactly why the note matters. Re-publish when you've changed something a reader would care about, and don't bother for a typo nobody would notice.

Putting field sessions in the final report

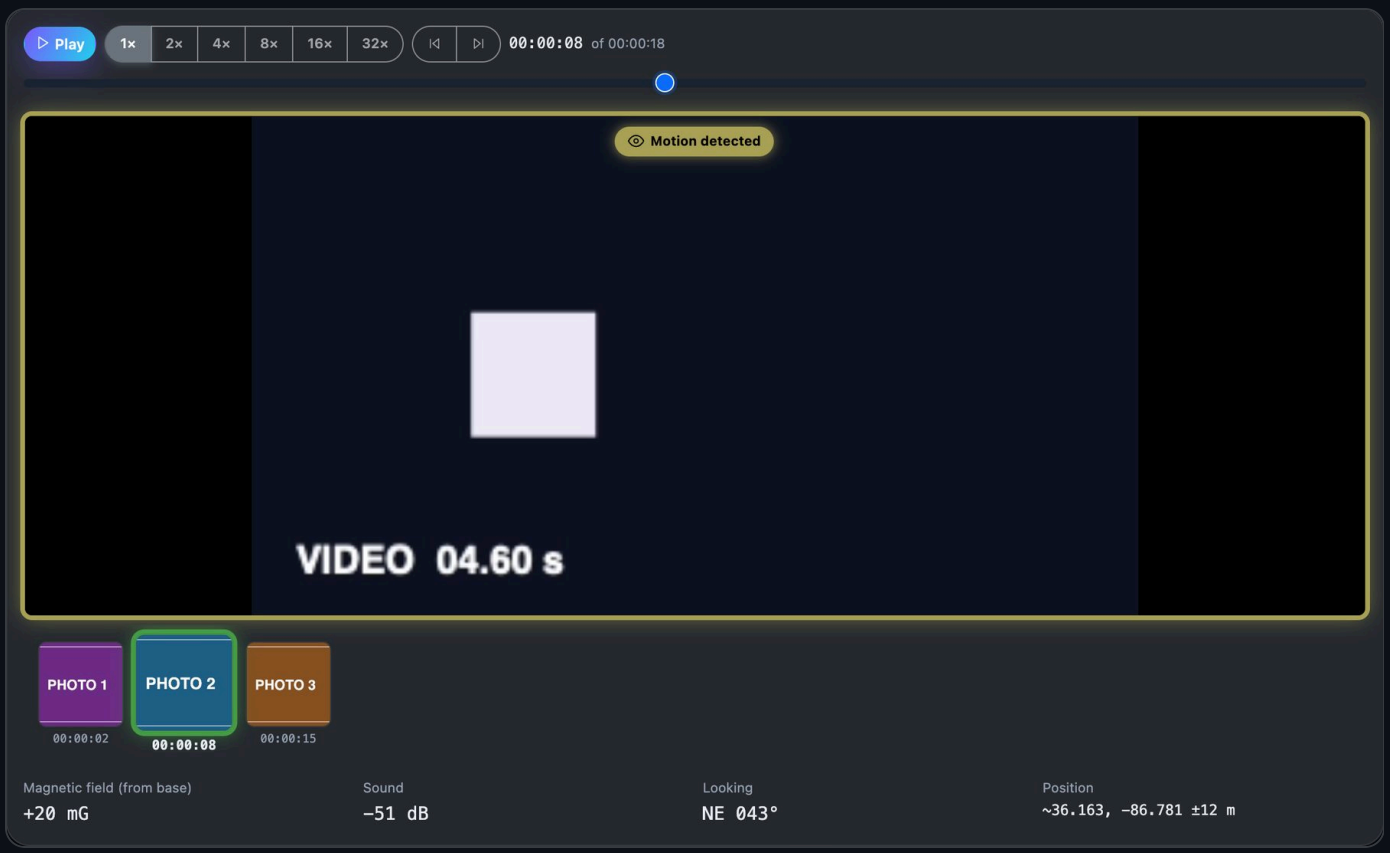
Sessions recorded in the iPhone and iPad app arrive on the site complete — the readings, the marks, the positions, the room labels and the recordings, exactly as the device saved them. The report is what you actually hand your client, so a report section can refer to those sessions.

On the case's **Reports** tab, open a report and add a section of type **Field Sessions**. Choose **Add field session** to see every session uploaded for this case's investigations, newest first, with where it was, who recorded it, how long it ran, and how much it contains. **Cite** adds a session to the report; **Play back** opens the session's playback page, where the trace, the map and the recordings all play in sync.

The playback page works just like the review screen in the app. Below the controls, the **video** at the playhead plays alongside the session's **sound**. The **photographs** taken during the night appear in a strip of thumbnails, and each one's border glows for three seconds as playback reaches the moment it was taken. Click a photograph to go to the moment it was taken and see it full size, and click again to carry on. When the camera saw movement while the phone was held still, the video is outlined and **Motion detected** appears for three seconds.

Drag the bar under the controls, or drag across the chart, to move through the night; playback carries on from wherever you let go. The speed buttons go up to 32×, and the two buttons beside them step to the previous or next mark, starting a few seconds before it so you hear what led up to it. The left and right arrow keys move five seconds, and the space bar plays and pauses.

On the map, the marker moves along the path that was walked and the arrow turns to show which way the phone was facing. The map keeps the marker in view as it goes. If you move or zoom the map yourself, it stays where you put it until you press **Recenter**. As playback passes a mark, its row in the **Marked** list lights up.



Citing a session adds a reference to it, never a copy. The session stays where it was uploaded and keeps its own checksum for each file, so what the client reads always matches what the instruments recorded. Removing a citation removes only the reference — nothing is deleted.

For each cited session, the PDF shows:

- Where it was, in the words the person recording used on the device
- When it started and ended — or that it was **interrupted**, if the phone died partway through and there is no reliable end time
- Who recorded it, or a clear note that nobody was signed in on the device
- The device model, the number of readings and the number of marks
- Every recording that belongs to it, flagged if its checksum didn't match when it was uploaded

If the list is empty, no sessions have been uploaded for this case's investigations yet. Sessions recorded without choosing an investigation belong to the account that recorded them, and they aren't part of any case

until someone attaches them.

Sending a session to somebody with no account

A client wants to see what was recorded in their house. A producer wants to decide whether a night is worth sending a crew for. Neither of them is going to create an account just to look at one thing once. And if you email the files, there's no expiry date, no way to take them back, and no way to know whether anyone opened them.

Instead, open the session with **Play back** and use **Share this session** on that page.

You choose four things:

- **The whole session, or one recording.** A link to a single recording shows that recording and nothing else — the rest of the night isn't even listed.
- **How long it lasts**, from one day to thirty. There's no "forever" option, because a link that never expires is effectively a public web page.
- **Who it's for** — a note only you can see, so if you make five links you can tell them apart instead of seeing five identical rows.
- **Whether to include where the readings were taken.** This is **off** unless you turn it on. A location recorded indoors is the building's street address, and a producer rarely needs that. When it's off, the recipient's page clearly says the locations weren't shared, so nobody mistakes an empty map for a night with no signal.

Copy the link and send it however you like. Whoever opens it sees the readings, the trace and the recordings, and nothing else — no case, no group, no other sessions, and no way to reach the rest of the site.

Withdrawing one, and seeing who looked

The same panel lists every link you have made. **Withdraw** stops a link working immediately, wherever it was sent — anyone who clicks it afterward gets nothing. Each row shows how many times the link was opened and when it was last opened, which is usually what you want to know.

Withdrawn and expired links stay in the list instead of disappearing, so later on you can still see whether something was shared and when the sharing stopped. That matters most if something turns up somewhere it shouldn't have.

Who can create a link: the person who uploaded the session, or an active member of the group running its investigation. Being able to *view* a session isn't the same as being allowed to share it with strangers, so someone who only attended a public investigation can't share other people's recordings.

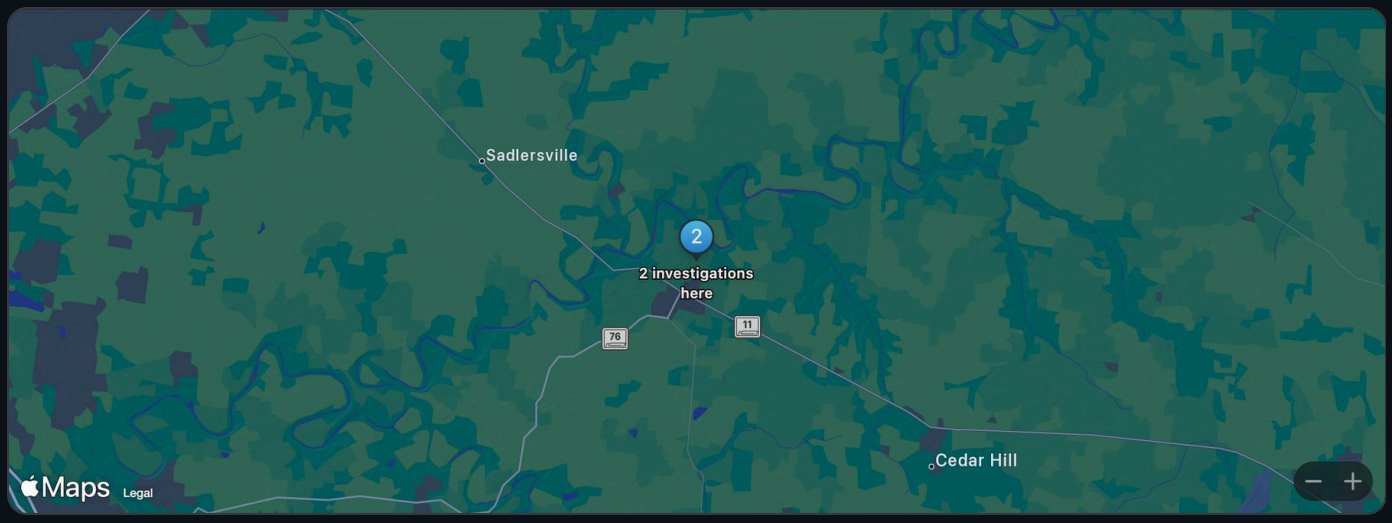
Entries at the same time

Two people often record the same moment, and unrelated things sometimes happen at the same time. Entries with the same event time are shown together and labeled "1 of 2 at this time". Their order never changes, so you can refer to an entry by its position and it will still be there tomorrow.

The investigations map

The group's **Investigations** tab shows every visit the group has made, on one map and in two lists: upcoming visits and past visits. Visits tied to a case and visits with no client case are shown together, because they're the same kind of work.

Visits at the same spot share a single marker showing how many there are — a place collecting visits over the years is normal, not unusual. Spots that only overlap at your current zoom level are grouped into a count too; zoom in and they separate. A landmark that anyone can visit is shown in blue and labeled as such when you select it; a visit that has already happened is dimmed.



Two visits to the Bell Witch Cave, on one pin.

If something is missing from the map, look just below it. Any investigation whose location couldn't be found is listed there with the reason, so a missing pin never goes unnoticed. Usually the address has a typo, and correcting it puts the pin back.

The **Edit** button appears only on visits you're allowed to change. That's decided for each investigation, not by rank: the person who scheduled it, the case manager, whoever is leading that particular visit, group owners and administrators, and anyone the group has specifically given the investigations permission. For a visit with a case, **Edit** opens it on the case's Investigations tab. For a visit with no case, it opens the visit right here (see Changing, canceling or deleting a visit with no case).

On a phone or a tablet held upright, each visit in the lists is a card of its own, with its team opening underneath it.

How long a visit runs

Every investigation has a start and, if you want, an end. **Starts** is a date and a time. **Ends** is just a time, because a typical visit is one arrival and one departure — and it can run past midnight. Arriving at 3:00 PM and leaving at 8:00 AM counts as a single-day investigation: an end time at or before the start time is treated as the next morning.

For anything longer — a weekend, a week — check **Runs over more than one day**, and the end gets its own date as well as a time. The visit then shows both dates wherever it appears, so nobody mistakes a week on site for an evening.

The end can't come before the start. If you enter an end that does, the form won't accept it, so you can't book a visit that finishes before anyone arrives.

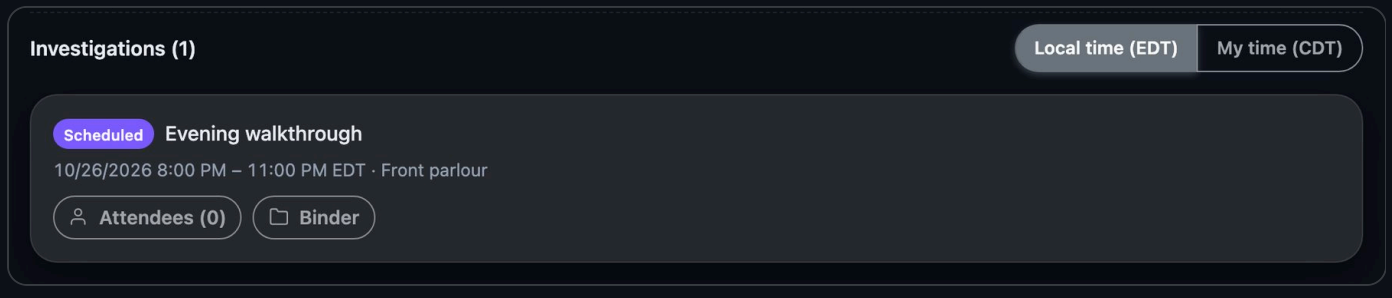
The same applies to **Propose Dates**, where you offer a client a choice of time windows.

Whose clock

A case happens in a particular place, and so does every visit to it. Each one has a **time zone**: you set the case's on its edit page, and a visit's in its schedule dialog. If you leave them alone, a visit uses its case's time zone, and a case uses your group's **home time zone** (set in the group's settings).

When you schedule a visit, the start and end times you type are in the visit's time zone, and the dialog tells you which zone that is. If you book "8:00 PM" for a house in New York, that's 8:00 PM in New York, even if you're in Chicago when you book it.

Local time · My time, next to the investigations, changes how times are shown. *Local time* shows each visit in its own time zone; *My time* shows everything in yours — the zone on your profile, or your device's if you haven't chosen one. Every time shows its zone's abbreviation, hovering over a time shows it in the other zone, and the site remembers which option you chose.



Clients see the same switch on their case, and the emails they get show the time where the visit takes place.

Scheduling a visit with no case

Schedule an investigation on the group's Investigations tab books a visit that isn't part of a client case — a landmark, a public building, or the group's own outing. Everything else works the same way: it appears on the map, the team can check in, and the findings are shared under the same rules.

Since there's no case, there's no case page either. Wherever you click one of these visits (your My Investigations list, your profile's map, the group's map), you come here, to the group's Investigations tab, with that visit highlighted and its team panel open.

The start is filled in as 7:00 PM tomorrow; change it to whenever you're going. The times you type are on your own clock, and the line under **Starts** names your time zone as it will be on that date: a visit in November reads CST even if you book it in October.

For a public location, typing part of a name is enough to find a place we already have. Type "Bell Witch" and the form lists Bell Witch Cave under **Places we already have**, with **Use this place**. A private residence is never listed to anybody.

When you enter the location, the form also tells you if the place is already on file:

> This place may already be on file.

Use this place attaches the visit to the existing place, so your visit appears on the same page as everyone else's work at that location. If it really is somewhere new — a different apartment in the same building, a different cabin on the same site — keep typing and a new place is created. It's only ever a suggestion; nothing is merged without your say-so.

A place is suggested only when the address matches **and** it's within about a tenth of a mile. Both have to match, because an address alone can't tell two apartments apart, and a map position alone would suggest the house next door.

Changing, canceling or deleting a visit with no case

Press **Edit** on the visit's row in the group's Investigations list. The same window opens, filled in, and you can change the title, the times, the description, the place and who can see the findings. **Save changes** saves it, and the visit's entry on the group's calendar moves with it.

Cancel this visit calls it off. It stays on record as canceled, and its calendar entry says "Canceled". It's offered only for a visit that hasn't happened yet.

Delete removes the visit for good, with its team and its calendar entry. Both ask you first. A visit that has recordings, written-up accounts, or anybody marked as there can't be deleted, because deleting it would lose them. The window says what it has and suggests canceling instead.

A visit that belongs to a case is changed from the case's Investigations tab. The same rule applies there: **Delete** asks first, a visit with recordings, written-up accounts or anybody marked as there can't be deleted, and the dialog says why. Cancel it instead.

Duties — who's doing what tonight

Every visit has jobs: somebody leads, somebody is in charge of the equipment, somebody collects the evidence at the end. The roster's **Who's doing what** panel spells those out — each duty is a row, each person holding it is a badge, and a duty nobody holds shows **Unfilled**, so you know what still needs covering before the night.

Duties apply to one visit only. They aren't titles (a junior investigator can lead a small visit), and they aren't roles (being on Equipment tonight doesn't give anyone a lasting permission). The only duty that comes with extra power is **Lead Investigator**: the visit's lead can edit the investigation, and giving someone that duty is the same as naming them lead.

Your group sets up its own list of duties under **Settings → Investigation duties**, and a duty can require a **minimum title** from your group's title ladder. That requirement isn't strict: if you assign someone below it, you see a warning with an **Assign anyway** button, because sometimes the senior member calls in sick and a capable junior steps up. The exception is recorded so it's clear it was a deliberate choice — the person's badge shows a small ⚠.

Who the client talks to

Every case gives the client a name to contact. In the case's **Details** column, **Points of contact** lists the members the client sees on their side of the case, and the client's messages show up in those members' notifications. Choose contacts with the button there; the case manager and group admins can save the choice.

You can format messages with the client, on the case's **Messages** tab, with bold, italics, lists and links. The client sees the formatting on the website; the iPhone app shows the same text without formatting.

If no contact has been chosen, the **case manager stands in** automatically and is marked that way. If you remove everyone, it goes back to the case manager, so the client always sees someone as long as the case has a manager.

Arriving on site

The investigation's **Team** panel shows who is expected and who has arrived. Open it from the attendees on a case's Investigations tab, or from **Team** on any row of the group's Investigations list. For visits with no case, that list is the only way to check in. A name turns green once that person's attendance is recorded, and the time next to it is when they say they arrived.

Only people on the team can check in, so put them on it first. On the group's Investigations list, whoever manages the visit opens **Team**, picks a member under **Add to the team** and presses **Add**. The ✕ at the end of their row takes them off again; it asks first, and says what goes with them, such as "Take James off the team? Their duty (Lead) goes too." Somebody who has been recorded as there, or has written up what they saw, stays on the team. On a case's Investigations tab, add people with **Add member** under the visit's attendees; the same rules apply there. Only active members can be put on a team, not viewers, and each person only once. When something can't be done, the page says why.

Press **I've arrived** to check yourself in. You can edit the time, and that's intentional: most sites have no signal, so it's normal to check in the next morning and set the time to when you actually arrived. Times in the future aren't accepted, since they can only be a typo. If a check-in or an **Attended** box can't be saved, the panel says why.

Whoever manages the investigation can also record attendance for someone who forgot. The two are kept separate: the panel marks a row **Recorded** when someone else entered it, so "checked in on site" and "marked present afterward" never look the same.

Your attendance is what puts a visit on your own map under **My Investigations**.

Writing up what you saw

Everyone on the team writes their own account in the **What people saw** section of the investigation's Team panel — one each, in their own words.

The accounts are kept separate on purpose, instead of being combined into one write-up. Four people in a building at night experience four different nights, and the places where accounts disagree are often the most useful part of the record. A single summary written by one person would lose them.

Only you can write your account, and only you can withdraw it. Unlike arrival, where someone else can record that you turned up, nobody can override this. Another person can vouch that you were there, but not for what you experienced, and an account with your name on it that you didn't write would be worse than none at all.

You can revise your account later — most people write it up the next morning and keep correcting it for days. A revised account is marked as revised, so anyone comparing accounts knows whether they're reading what you wrote on the night or your later version.

Everyone in the group can read all the accounts. That's why they're kept.

Tagging what kind of experience it was

You can tag timeline entries with experience types — knocking, cold spots, shadow figures — organized into categories. Tags make it possible to spot patterns later, across cases and across groups, so they're worth adding even when the write-up already describes the experience.

If nothing in the list fits, group owners and administrators can **add a type inline**. It can be used right away, so nobody has to wait for approval to record what happened tonight. Site administrators are notified, and they confirm or remove it later.

Two things keep the list from filling up with near-duplicates:

- **We ask before creating a type spelled very much like an existing one.** Pick the existing type if that's what you meant, or tell us yours is different and we add it as you typed it. It's a question, not a refusal.
- **A type you added is removed again if you untag the last entry that uses it**, as long as no site administrator has confirmed it yet. That way a word made up for one occurrence doesn't stick around once it's no longer used. Confirmed types stay, and so do the built-in ones.

Leading a visit

The **Lead** column on the team list shows who is running this particular investigation. It isn't a promotion: it applies to this visit only, and ends when the visit does.

The lead can edit the investigation — the schedule, the team, the details — for as long as they're lead, and can hand the role to someone else. Only people who can already change the investigation can name a lead, so nobody can take the role for themselves; it can only be given.

Who can see the findings

Each investigation has its own sharing setting, on the investigation's edit form.

SETTING	WHO READS IT
Just this group	Only your own group. The default for anywhere somebody lives.
Groups who have also investigated this place	Any group with a visit recorded at the same place.
Anyone	Everybody, including visitors who are not signed in.

Note the middle option carefully: the audience is **every group that has investigated the place**, and that list keeps growing. A group that visits next year will be able to read what you shared this year. The form reminds you of this when you choose it.

You don't have to share your own findings to read what others have shared. Comparing notes on the same building is useful, and requiring people to contribute first would mostly put off the cautious ones.

Investigations at a **private residence cannot be made public**. Publishing what happened inside someone's home needs their agreement, and there's no way to ask for it yet, so the option isn't offered.

Private engagements

Some cases are about someone's home. These are called **private engagements**, and they're handled differently everywhere the public can see. A case becomes a private engagement in one of three ways:

- it came from a **client request** — a family asked for help, so the case is private from the start;
- an investigation on it is placed at a **private residence** — as soon as that place is attached, the case becomes a private engagement;
- someone checks **Private engagement** in Edit Case.

A case never stops being a private engagement on its own. You can clear the setting deliberately in Edit Case, for the rare case that was marked private by mistake.

Write real names freely — the public copy substitutes

Within your group, write about the case naturally: reports, timeline entries and notes can name the client and the household just as people talk about them. On a private engagement, those names are replaced **when a public page is displayed**. Your saved text is never changed, so nothing you wrote is altered and nothing needs editing before you publish.

What each name becomes:

- **The client** is replaced by the alias they chose themselves, or your group's pseudonym for the case, or — if neither is set — "the family" (if two or more people live at the property) or "the client".
- **Each person on the case's People list** is replaced by their **Public label** if you set one ("the lady of the house"), or a label based on their relationship ("a family member", "a neighbor", "the homeowner"), or simply "a resident" or "a witness".

You'll find the Public label field in the person's entry on the case. A short noun phrase works best, since it's dropped into the middle of sentences.

What the substitution does not do

It replaces **the names on the case** — the client's, and those of the people you listed. It can't catch a nickname nobody recorded, a name visible in a photograph, or a voice on a recording. It also matches whole words only: "the Parkers" doesn't match "Park", so a family nickname based on the name still shows unless you add that person. The check before publishing still reads your case label and pseudonym and warns you if either contains the client's name.

Private engagements and your plan

Taking on private-residence work — accepting a client request, placing an investigation at a residence, or accepting a private case transferred from another group — requires a plan that includes private-residence cases, and so does **publishing** a private case. The Pricing page shows which plans include them. Two things are never restricted: work you already have (a case your group already holds keeps working, whatever your plan), and a client moving their own case — that move depends only on the receiving group's plan, not yours.

If your subscription lapses

When a paid period ends without renewal, open work is paused and published private engagements are taken off the public site. If the renewal payment simply didn't go through, the plan keeps going for two weeks first while the card is tried again (once a year). Nothing is deleted: the case remembers it was public, and once the plan is renewed, its page shows a **Republish** banner that puts it back in one click. Cases at public places — landmarks, businesses — aren't affected by billing and stay published. Both renewal warnings explain all of this before it happens.

Applying privacy protections to an older case

If your group took on a case before you had these protections — or before your plan included them — **Apply privacy protections** in Edit Case brings that case up to date in one step. It:

- makes the case private, if it wasn't already;
- removes the property's exact coordinates, but keeps the address in your own records, where your investigators still need it;
- removes the location data from every file on the case that hasn't already been cleaned, rebuilding each file from its untouched original.

Then it tells you about two things it did **not** do.

It doesn't rewrite anyone's words. If your client's name appears in a report, a timeline entry or the case label, it lists every place it appears and leaves the text exactly as written. An account of a night belongs to the person who wrote it, and a blanket find-and-replace can change what a sentence means or break a quotation. Edit the ones that should use the pseudonym instead.

It can't undo publication. If the case was public, it tells you so clearly. Anything a visitor already read, a search engine already indexed, or someone already saved is out there. Making the case private now stops it spreading further, but it can't take it back. Keep that in mind before you tell a client the problem is solved.

The case label when a case goes public

You make a case public in **Edit Case** — set the status and check **Make Public** — and from then on the pseudonym replaces the client's name everywhere the site shows it. There's one exception: the **case label**. That's free text your group typed, often in a "surname, city" style that works well for private files but is wrong for a public page.

So the page checks as you work. When you check **Make Public**, or finish editing the label or the pseudonym, and the text about to go public contains the client's name or street address, you're told right away — next to the checkbox, before you save. The warning names exactly what would be revealed and suggests naming the place instead: "The Hargrove Farmhouse", not "Hargrove, Franklin TN".

It's a warning, not a block. A surname is sometimes also a street or a town, and only you know which one your label means. So the first time you press Save, it stops and shows you the warning again; the second time, it publishes the label as written.

The same save also checks the pseudonym itself. Using "The Park Family" as the pseudonym for the Parks hides nothing — so if the pseudonym contains the client's real name, you'll be told before it's published.

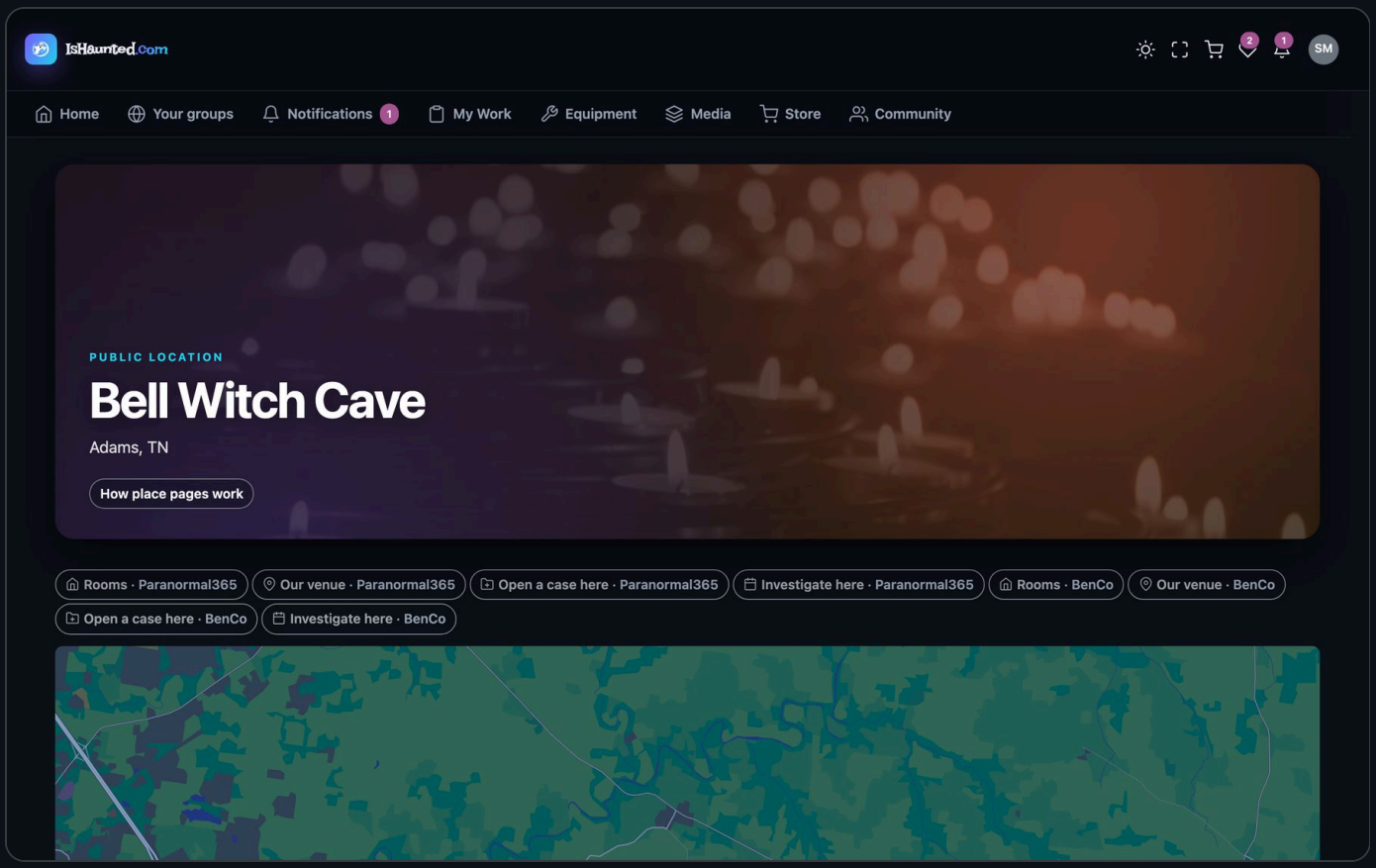
Place pages

Click the location on the Investigations tab to open that **place**, showing every visit recorded there, by every group, that you're allowed to see.

The line at the top counts only what you can see. It never says how much is hidden, because that would itself reveal something you aren't meant to see.

Your own group's visits are listed separately from what other groups have shared, and only your own rows show their sharing setting — how another group chose to share its work is up to them.

Place pages work for visitors too. Someone who isn't signed in sees only published investigations, and nothing else.



One location, and every group's work at it: your visits, what others shared, the cases published here, the posts, and the field archive.

How a public location's page is laid out

When the people who run the place have written about it (see **Your venue** in the group administration help), their words come first, under the place's cover photo, with the map right below. Then come the place's **photos**, in a slideshow that turns by itself with small thumbnails under it (click one to stop on it), then its **videos**, then its **recordings**, which open the waveform player when you click them. Each one says what it is: a picture of the place, evidence someone added, or something from an event held there. People's **posts** about their visits come after that.

Your groups' cases here

When you're signed in, a place also shows **your groups' cases here** — every case any of your groups has at this location, whatever its status, published or not. It answers the first question worth asking when you arrive: do we already have a case here? The published list below can't answer that, because the answer is usually a case nobody published. Other groups' unpublished cases aren't shown, because even the fact that they have one is something they haven't shared.

Cases written up here

A place also lists the **cases** groups have published about it, with the year each was opened and which group's case it was. Only published cases appear — a case has to be marked public and have a published status — and a client's real name is never shown, just as on the case's own public page. Visitors see this list too.

This is the other benefit of naming the place on a case: your case appears on the place's page when you publish it, and everyone else's published cases are already there for you to read before you start.

Posts about this place

A public location also shows **posts** — short notes and photographs from anyone who is signed in, not just from groups. They are feed posts that name the place, so they're screened, can be reported and can be hidden just like anything else on the feed. They also appear on the feed, with a link back here. See Posting about a place. A private residence has no posts and no box for writing one.

The field archive

Below the investigations, a place shows its **field archive** — sessions that individual people recorded there with the phone app and chose to publish. These aren't your group's work and aren't tied to any case: someone went somewhere public, recorded, and decided to share the readings.

Each row shows who recorded the session, when, roughly where they stood, how many readings it contains, and how many moments they flagged. **Play it back** opens the session in the same player as above, with its readings, sound and marks on one timeline. The map shows the place itself rather than where the phone was, and recordings appear once they've been approved. That last number is the one to compare across rows. A spike that eleven out of twelve visitors flagged on the same stairs tells you something about the building; one that appears only once is probably noise. Comparing visits is the only way to tell the difference, and this is the only place on the site — or anywhere else we know of — where you can do it.

Phones differ, and so do their magnetometers, so the device is listed too. Keep that in mind when comparing, and remember that the reading is a DC magnetic field, not the AC field that a K-II style meter responds to.

Anyone can flag a session whose photos or audio shouldn't be public. Flagging hides that media immediately until a moderator has reviewed it. The readings stay visible, because a magnetic-field number can't be offensive.

Group messages

The **Messages** tab on your group is the group's internal mail. It's separate from the message board on a case, which the client can read — nothing here is visible outside the group.

Messages are sorted into folders down the left side, each showing how many unread messages it has:

FOLDER	WHAT IS IN IT
Inbox	Everything addressed to you, of any kind.
Sent	What you have written.
Broadcasts	Announcements to the whole group.
Direct	Messages to named people.
Case teams	Messages tied to a particular case.
Public	Messages anyone in the group can read.

Unread messages are shown in bold. Click one to open it below the list and mark it as read.

Writing one

Compose first asks who the message is for. Broadcast and Public messages go to the whole group, so you don't need to address them. **Direct message** and **Case team** ask you to check the people you want from the group's member list — and you must check at least one, because a direct message with nobody on it goes nowhere.

The subject is optional. The message body is required.

Mark as encrypted / private flags a message as sensitive. It's a label for the people reading it — it doesn't add a password, and it doesn't hide the message from anyone who could otherwise open it.

Closing a case, and why you cannot delete one

When the work is finished, set the status to **Closed** in **Edit Case**. The case stays right where it is, in your case list and your history, and you can reopen it by changing the status again. Closing a case ends the work, not the

record.

There's no Delete button, and that's on purpose. A case is the record of real work, usually done for a client who asked for it and sometimes paid for it, and a record that anyone looking at it could erase wouldn't be much of a record. You can remove individual timeline entries, files and notes, but not the case they belong to.

Opened a case by mistake, or opened the same one twice? Closing it won't fix that, so ask us to remove it. A site administrator can delete a case completely, and will see exactly what would be deleted before doing it — including a warning if the case has a client. Anything anyone recorded on their phone is kept either way: a field session belongs to the person who recorded it and goes back to them.

Incoming cases

When another group — or a client moving their own paused case — asks your group to take over a case, it appears at the top of your **Cases** page under *Incoming cases*, with Accept and Decline buttons right there. If the client is the one moving the case, the card shows what you'll be able to see of the previous group's work: the client decides whether their collected history and past investigations come with the case, and that's their choice, not the previous group's. Accepting gives the case a new number in your group and makes it active again. The client is told whether you accept or decline.

Case transfers depend on your plan. A group whose plan doesn't include case transfers can't send a case to another group or accept one — both sides are checked, so nobody can transfer a case *to* that group either. When this applies, the message says so clearly. Existing cases are never affected, and you can always decline an incoming transfer. A client moving their own paused case is never blocked by their current group's plan — only the receiving group's plan matters. The Pricing page shows what each plan includes.

Evidence from people who attended a public event

Anyone who attended one of your public events can offer what they captured — audio, photos, video — from the event's own page. Nothing they send is added to your record automatically: submissions wait in **Evidence from your public events** on your group's Calendar tab until a member accepts or declines them. Declining asks you for a reason, and the person who sent it is told either way.

Accepting adds the file to that event's **public** record, credited to the attendee. That's the deal with a public investigation, and people are told so before they send anything. Anything you decline stays private to the person who sent it.

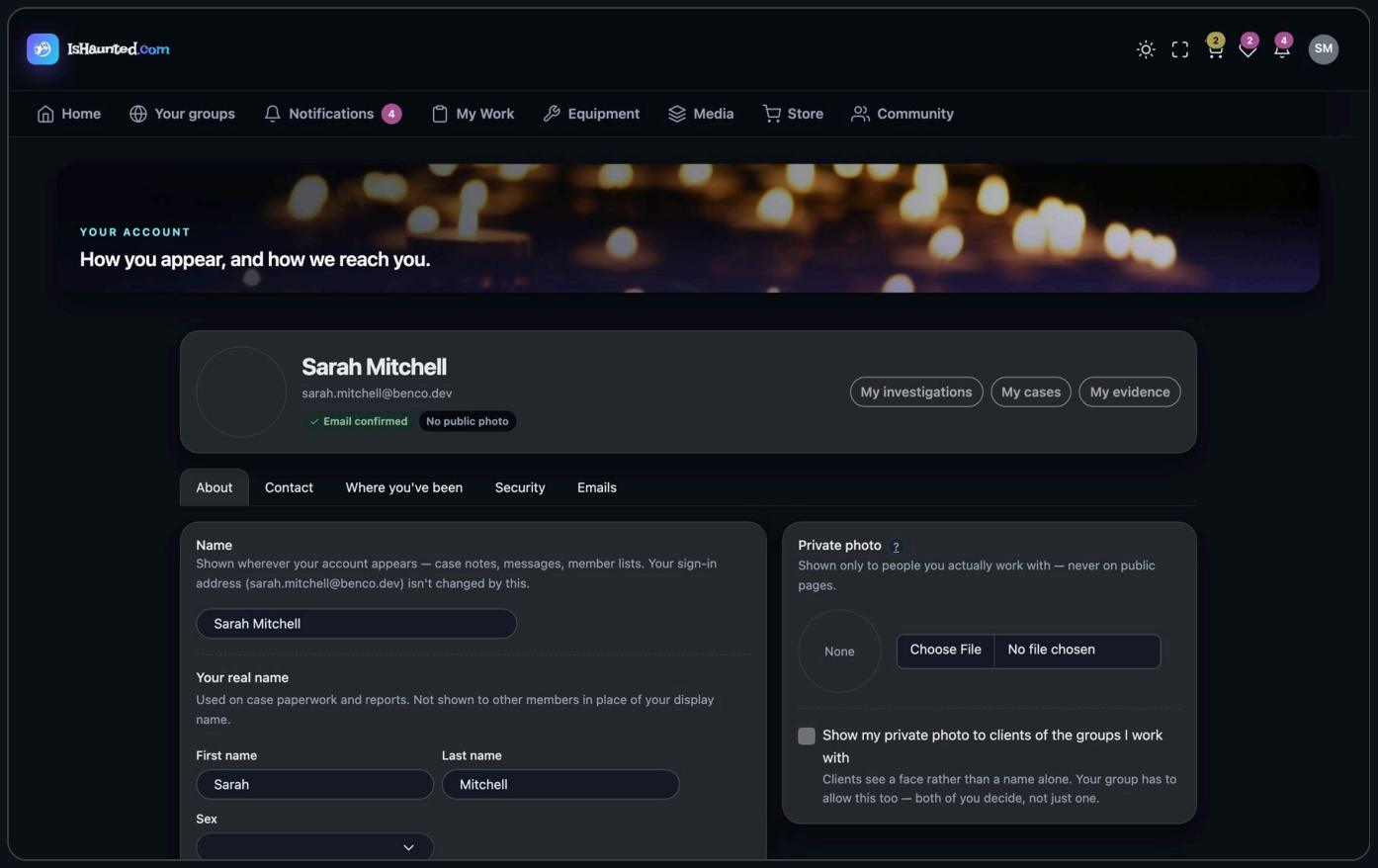
YOUR ACCOUNT

Your Profile and Photos

Display name, contact details, public and private photos, and who can see them.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

Your profile



Your profile. Everything here is yours to change, and most of it is private by default.

My Profile, in the menu under your avatar, is where you set your display name and photos. Your sign-in address is not changed here and is never shown publicly.

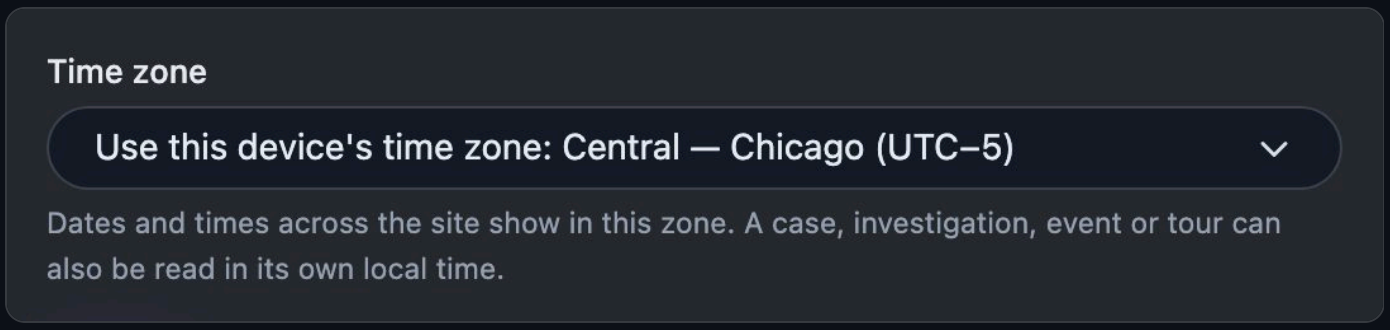
The page opens with your name and picture, then three tabs:

- **About** — your display name and both photos, with the consent switch for the private one.
- **Contact** — email addresses, phone numbers, postal addresses and web links.
- **Where you've been** — the map of investigations you have attended.

The map only loads when you open its tab.

Your time zone

Time zone, on the About tab, sets the time zone the whole site uses to show you dates and times. It was set when you signed up. To change it, choose another from the list — the US zones come first, then every zone in the world by region — and press **Save**. Pages use the new time zone from then on.



Choose **Use this device's time zone** to go back to using whatever time zone your phone or computer is set to. This is useful if you travel and want the site's times to follow you.

This setting is for the website only. The iPhone and iPad app always shows the time where the phone is; see The iPhone and iPad Apps.

Cases, investigations, events and tours also have their own time zone: the one where they take place. Those pages have a **Local time · My time** switch, so you can see times either way; see Working a Case and Getting Started.

Sex

Under your name is an optional **Sex** field: Male, Female or Unspecified. It starts blank. It's used for only one thing: when you have no photo, the site shows a placeholder icon, and this choice decides which of the three placeholders you get. It's never shown to anyone, never shared, and never guessed from your name. If it's blank or Unspecified, you get the generic placeholder.

Two photos

You can set two pictures, and they are treated very differently.

- **Public photo** — anyone can see it, including visitors to published case pages.
- **Private photo** — shown only to people you actually work with.

Who sees your private photo

THEY ARE	THEY SEE IT
You	Always.
Someone in a group with you	Yes — group members see each other's private photos.
A client of a case you are working	Only if your group allows it **and** you opted in.
Someone on the same case as you, as a client	Yes.
Anyone else	No — they see your public photo, or your initials.

For clients, two things must both be true. Your group has to allow member photos to be shown to clients, **and** you have to switch it on for yourself. If only one is on, clients don't see your private photo. The profile page tells you if you've opted in but none of your groups allows it yet.

Your groups' public pages

A group can list its members on its public website, with their name, public photo and title. It can only list you if you say yes. On **Profile** → **About**, **Your groups' public pages** has a switch for each of your groups. It's off until you turn it on, and you can turn it off again at any time; the group's page changes straight away.

Your contact information

Below the photos you can record as many email addresses, phone numbers, postal addresses and web links as you like. This list is yours alone: nobody else can add to it or edit it. If an administrator updates the details they keep about you, your own list isn't changed.

Mark one email and one phone as **Primary** to show the best way to reach you. You can have only one primary of each, so marking a new one primary automatically clears the old one.

An email address has to be confirmed before it can be primary, just as it must be confirmed before it can be public. So add the new address, confirm it, and then make it primary.

As you type a postal address, the site looks it up on a map. If it finds the place, the location is saved with the address. If not, the address still saves; it just won't have a pin on the map.

What public means

Everything you add starts **private**. Private means only you and the site's administrators can see it; it is never shown on a case page, in a group directory, or to anyone you work with.

Checking **Public** on an entry makes only that entry public. Someone can invite you to a calendar event by typing your email address only if that address is public. Your sign-in address never works for this, so nobody can find your account by guessing it.

The tick

A **green tick** (a check mark) next to something means it has been verified, not just typed in. It appears next to a confirmed email address, next to two-factor sign-in when it's on, and on your account address in the band at the top of the page. Hover over it to see what was verified and when.

An **amber mark** means something hasn't been verified, and it always tells you what to do about it. You won't see one next to something you can't fix: if there's no way to verify something, it gets no mark at all.

Confirming an email address

An email address can't be made **public** or **primary** until you've confirmed it. This stops people from adding someone else's address to their own profile and receiving that person's invitations, or appearing under an address that isn't theirs.

Adding an address sends its confirmation link right away. You don't have to ask for it, and the card tells you the link has been sent. If the site isn't set up to send email — which is normal on a test system — the page shows you the link instead so you can copy it.

To get another link, press **Send confirmation link** next to an unconfirmed address.

Opening the link shows the address, partly hidden, and a **Confirm** button. You don't have to be signed in, and you can open it on any device. The address is only confirmed when you press the button, so an email scanner that follows links can't confirm it for you.

Links last seven days, and you can ask for a new one only once a minute. Asking for a new link cancels the old one. If you later edit the address, it's no longer confirmed and goes back to private, because the new address hasn't been confirmed.

Your investigation map

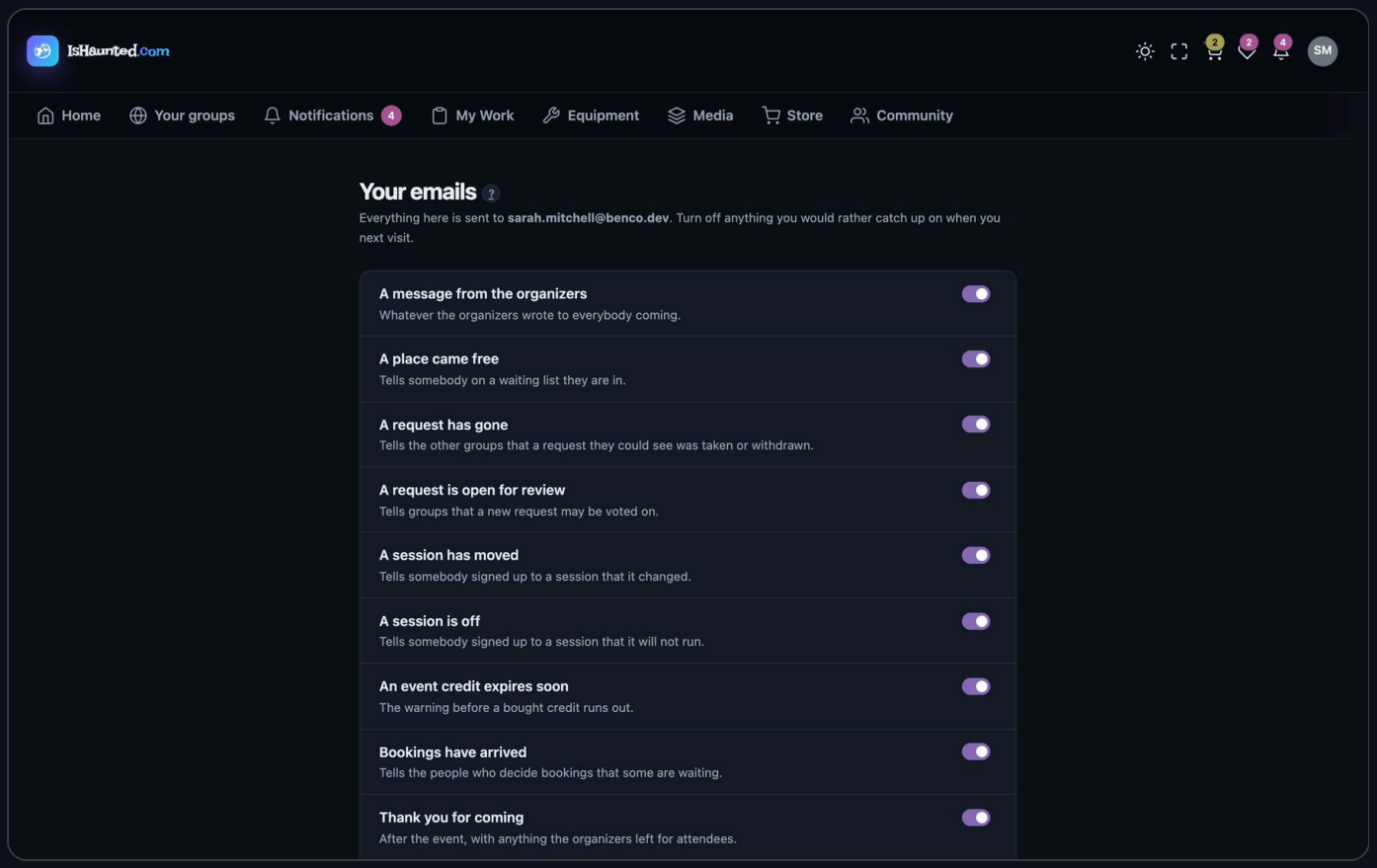
Your profile's **Where you've been** tab keeps a map of the places you have actually been; the same map appears on **My Investigations**. Clicking a pin opens the case that visit belonged to. Visits to the same spot share one pin, with a count. Nearby spots that overlap when you're zoomed out are grouped into a count too; zoom in to separate them.

It shows only visits you **attended** — not ones you were invited to or said yes to.

So the map starts empty and fills up over time. Attendance is recorded after the visit, so a scheduled investigation appears in your list right away, but it shows on the map only once someone has confirmed you were there.

Your emails

The site emails you when something happens that you'd want to know about while you're away — a session you signed up for is canceled or moved, a spot opens up and is now yours, an investigation request your group was reviewing went elsewhere, or your plan is about to run out.



Choose your emails, on your profile or linked at the bottom of any of those emails, lists every email you can turn off. They all start on. Turning one off takes effect from the next email. There's no Save button — each switch saves as soon as you change it.

Some emails are always sent and aren't on that list:

- confirming your email address
- resetting your password
- a warning that somebody used your address to try to sign up
- a receipt for something you paid for

You can't turn these off, because they're how you get back into your account or what you keep for your own records. Turning off everything else doesn't affect them.

Security — your password and two-step sign-in

The profile's **Security** tab holds your sign-in settings.

Password. Change it here whenever you like. If you created your account by signing in with Microsoft, it has *no* password yet. The panel says so and offers **Add password** instead. You won't be asked for a current password, since you're already signed in. Once you add one, you can sign in either way; Microsoft sign-in keeps working.

Locked out entirely? **Forgot your password?** on the sign-in page emails you a link. If your account only uses Microsoft sign-in, that same link lets you set your first password.

That link can only go to a **confirmed** address. An account created through Microsoft starts with the email address Microsoft gives us, but Microsoft doesn't confirm it for us. So we send a confirmation link when the account is created, and your profile shows a notice until you follow it, with a **Send the link again** button in case it never arrived. You can keep signing in with Microsoft in the meantime, but we won't email you anything — including a password-reset link — until the address is confirmed.

Signed in with Apple. The same applies: there's no password until you add one. If you chose Hide My Email, the profile says "Signed in with Apple, using Hide My Email" where an address would be. If you didn't share an address, it warns you and offers to add one, because until you do, Apple is your only way in and we have nowhere to send a reset link.

Two-step sign-in. This is optional and off until you turn it on, but it's worth turning on. Scan the code with any authenticator app — Duo, Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, 1Password and Okta Verify all work — and keep the recovery codes somewhere safe. They're how you get in when you don't have your phone, and each one works once.

Deleting your account

In the iPhone and iPad app, **Profile → Delete account**.

What's deleted: everything about you. Your name, email address, password, phone number, addresses, photos and any sign-in methods you connected — Microsoft, Apple — are permanently deleted, and nobody can ever sign in to the account again, by any method. If you signed in with Apple, we also notify Apple, so IsHaunted disappears from the list of apps using your Apple ID. There's no undo, no grace period and no reactivation, and your email address becomes free for somebody to register with again.

What stays: anything you wrote for a group. A case note, a report, a timeline entry or a message on a group's board belongs to that group, and often to a client who paid for the work, and the group may be required to

keep some of those records. They stay, credited to a former member rather than to you. Field sessions you recorded on your own, not for an investigation, are deleted with your account.

If you own a group, you'll be asked to hand it over first, and told which groups. Each group has exactly one owner, so if you left, nobody could manage the group or reach its billing. Make somebody else the owner, or close the group, and then you can delete your account.

YOUR ACCOUNT

Your Files

The files you upload, what sharing them means, and what happens when you delete one a group is using.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

Your files

Media → Upload Files shows every file you own: files you uploaded on the site, photos and videos you posted to the feed, evidence you attached to a case, equipment photos, and the recordings and documents your Paranormal Platform sessions uploaded. A file is yours from the moment it arrives until you delete it.

From each row you can download, share, replace or delete the file.

Audio files also have a player. Right-click one and choose **Open Full View** to open the editor, where you can mark regions, view a spectrogram, scan for EVPs, and save clips of what you find. See Using the Audio Editor.

Sharing

Share offers a file to a group at one of three levels: the group's administrators only, every member, or public. Sharing lends the file to the group; it doesn't give it away. The group can attach it to a case, which makes a **copy** for that case, or copy it into its own Files. Those copies keep the file's location and camera details, marked as inherited.

A member of a group can also **ask** to use one of your files for their group. The request waits in your notifications, and only you decide it. Approving shares the file with that group: with its members, or publicly if they asked to show it in public.

Replacing

Replace swaps in a new version of the file and updates every copy of it on a case. The dialog lists the cases that hold a copy and how many comments and votes each one has, so you can see what you are about to change before you do it.

Deleting

Press the trash button on a row of **Your Files** or on a card in the **Media Library**. Both do exactly the same thing. The Media Library only shows the button on files that are yours, because a file you have handed to a group can only be deleted by someone with permission in that group.

What happens next depends on whether anyone else is using the file.

Nobody else is using it. You confirm once, and it's gone — the file, its details, and any shares with individual people.

A group is using it. The dialog lists each group and what it holds: shares, copies on cases, copies in its files, and places that refer to the file itself. Then you are asked two questions.

1. **Do you want it removed everywhere it is shared?** If you say yes, every share ends, every copy the groups took is removed — including comments and votes on those copies — the file is unlinked from everywhere it's referenced, and then it is destroyed. There is no undo.
2. If you said no: **do you still want it out of your files?** If so, the file and its details are **handed to the group** using it. If more than one group is using it, you choose which one. From then on the file belongs to that group: it leaves your files, the group's copies and shares keep working, the group's administrators manage it, and only that group's members can see it. You cannot get it back.

Say no to both and nothing changes. A file is only handed over when you choose that answer yourself; it never happens automatically.

Paranormal Platform recordings

A recording made during a field session belongs to that session: the session's document names the file, and its readings are linked to moments in it. You can still hand the recording to a group, and "remove everywhere" still ends its shares and copies, but the file itself isn't destroyed while the session exists. The page tells you this. To remove the recording, delete the whole session from **My Field Sessions** — see *The iPhone and iPad Apps* for when you can and can't do that.

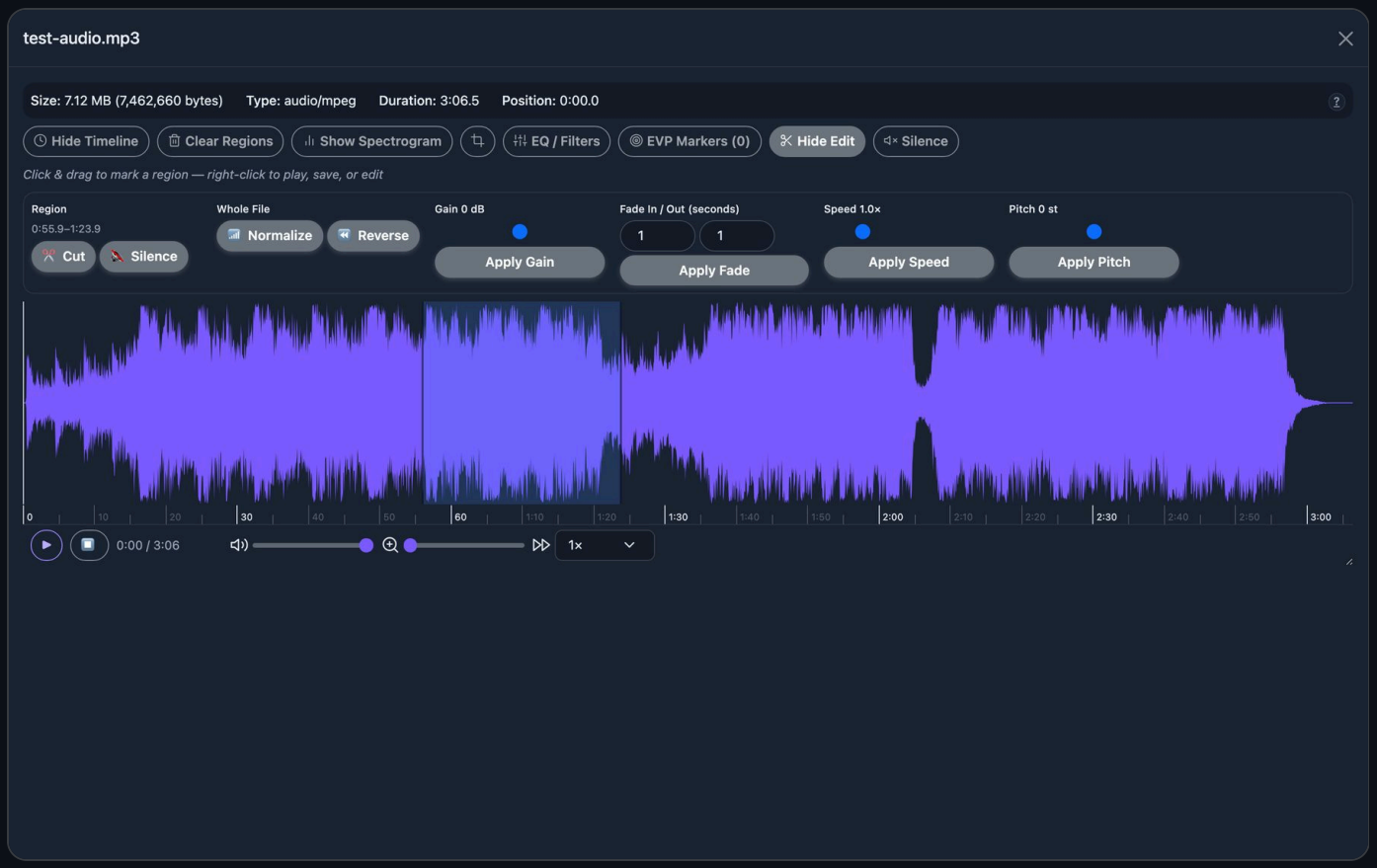
YOUR ACCOUNT

Using the Audio Editor

Listening closely to a recording — regions, the spectrogram, EVP scanning, clips and the case mixer.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

Every audio file on the site comes with a player. Click the waveform to play it — often that's all you need. When you want to listen closely — to find the three seconds that matter in a two-hour recording, and keep them — right-click the player and choose **Open Full View**.



The full view: the waveform in the middle, the toolbar above it, and the panels you open from the toolbar stacked below.

The two things to know first

Nothing you do here changes the recording. Every edit creates a *new* file and leaves the original untouched. This is deliberate: a recording is evidence, and altered evidence is worth less than untouched evidence. Everything you create is listed under Saved Clips, and each one shows which part of the original it came from.

The listening tools change what you hear, not the file. The equalizer, the high-pass and low-pass filters, the compressor and the noise gate only affect the sound playing through your speakers right now. Turn them on to hear a whisper more clearly; the recording itself isn't changed. Edits are in a separate panel, and those are the ones that create a file.

Your listening-tool settings *are* remembered for each recording. If you find a filter that lifts a voice out of the hiss, it will still be on when you come back to that file. That also means that when you reopen a file, you aren't hearing the recording exactly as it was captured. The panel shows which tools are on.

Selecting a stretch

Drag across the waveform to draw a region. The edit panel shows its range, and Cut and Silence act on it.

You can have only one drawn region at a time, so drawing a second one replaces the first. Everything else on the waveform stays put: markers, clips you've already saved, and any silence the detector has shaded. None of those are selections, and an edit will never act on them.

Right-click a region to open its menu: play just that part, explore it in its own window, save it as a file, rename it, or remove it.

The spectrogram

Show Spectrogram draws the recording's frequencies over time, above the waveform. It's the most useful tool for finding a voice: speech has a recognizable shape, and once you've seen a few, you'll spot them in the hiss much faster than you can hear them.

The same recording shown as frequencies, using the mel scale and the Viridis colors. Most of this recording's energy is low; a voice shows up as brighter marks in the band from a few hundred hertz upward.

Three controls sit next to it:

- **Resolution** trades detail in time for detail in frequency. A low number gives a blurrier picture that shows exactly *when* something happened; a high number shows exactly *what pitch* it was, but blurs the timing.

512 or 1024 works well for most speech.

- **The color ramp** only changes how easy the picture is to read. Try Viridis if Jet's blues and reds are hard on your eyes.
- **Mel** compresses the high frequencies and spreads out the low ones, which is roughly how human hearing works. With it on, speech fills much more of the picture.

Right-click the spectrogram to show or hide the frequency labels.

The site remembers all of this for each recording — the spectrogram, its resolution, its colors, the mel scale, the timeline, and all the listening tools. Open the file again next week and it looks and sounds the way you left it. Settings are only saved for your own recordings. On someone else's file you can set things up however you like, but the editor will tell you that it isn't saving them.

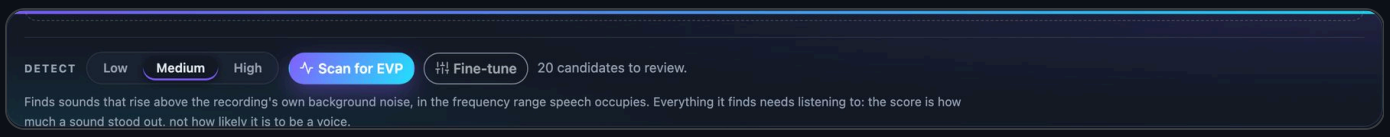
Silence detection

Silence shades the parts of the recording that are close to silent, so you can see where nothing is happening and skip it. The shading isn't a selection, and no edit will act on it. Adjust the threshold if a room's background noise is being counted as sound.

Scanning for EVP

The **EVP Markers** panel scans the recording for short bursts of speech-like sound and suggests them as candidates. It looks for energy in the voice range that stands out from the sound around it, at three sensitivity levels:

- **Low** — only the obvious ones. Use it on a long recording to get a short list.
- **Medium** — the usual choice.
- **High** — suggests many more, and most will be knocks and rustles. Worth it when you're fairly sure something is there.



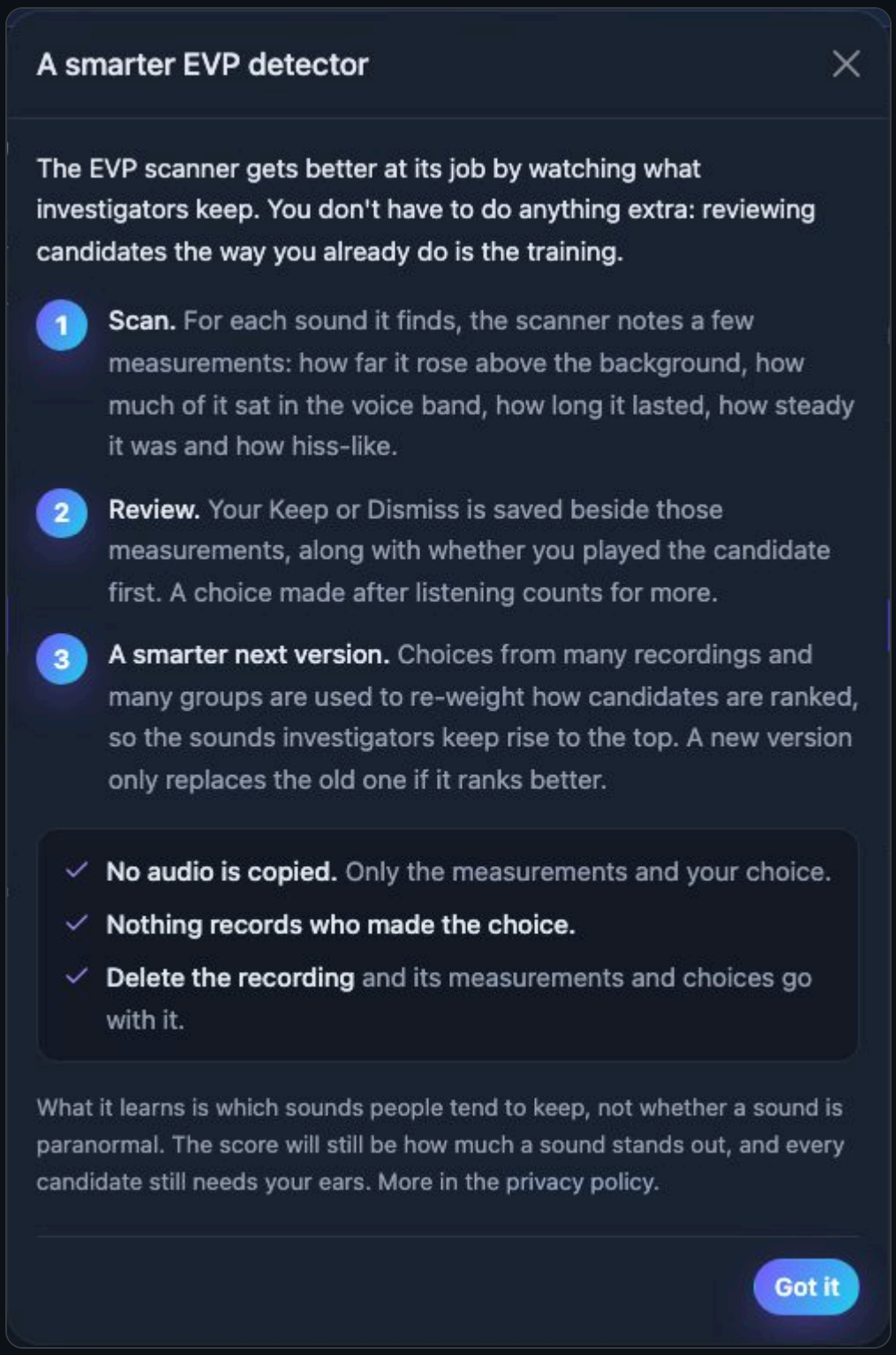
Each candidate shows its score (with a bar for easy comparison), when it happens and how long it lasts. The four round buttons play it, adjust where it starts and ends, keep it, or dismiss it.

A scan only makes suggestions; you make the decisions. Each candidate waits for you to **keep** it or **dismiss** it. Keeping one asks you for a label, because an unnamed marker isn't a finding anyone can use. Dismissed candidates are remembered, so a later scan won't suggest them again, and later scans never touch the markers you've kept.

Press ▶ on a kept marker to play it. If the marker is a single moment rather than a stretch, you hear a couple of seconds on either side, which is usually what you need to tell a voice from a bump.

A smarter EVP detector

Your choices also help the scanner improve, and **How it works** on the panel's banner explains how. Each scan saves a few measurements of every sound it finds, such as how far it rose above the background and how much of it was in the voice range. Each keep or dismiss is saved alongside those measurements, along with whether you played the candidate first. No audio is copied, and nothing records who made the choice. A future version will use this to rank candidates more the way investigators do. It will learn which sounds people tend to keep, not whether a sound is paranormal. If you delete the recording, its measurements and choices are deleted with it.



What a scan and a review save, and what they don't.

Making a clip

Once you've found something, you'll want to share it. There are two ways to make a clip:

- Right-click a region and choose **Create Audio File from Region**.

- From a marker, use the scissors on its row.

Either way, you name the clip, pick a file type, and choose whether to boost the volume. **Leave the boost on** unless you have a reason not to: an EVP is usually much quieter than everything around it, and a clip at the recording's original level can be almost impossible to hear.

A clip can't be made public if the recording it came from is private. If you want to share the clip, publish the original first. Otherwise, clipping would be a way around the recording's own privacy setting, so the site tells you instead of quietly doing it.

Editing

The **Edit** panel makes new files from the recording:

EDIT	WHAT IT DOES
Cut	Removes the selected region and joins the parts on either side
Silence	Replaces the selected region with silence, keeping the length
Normalize	Raises the whole file so its loudest point is just under maximum
Gain	Makes the whole file louder or quieter by a set amount
Fade	Fades the start in and the end out
Reverse	Plays the whole file backwards
Speed	Changes the speed without changing the pitch
Pitch	Changes the pitch without changing the speed

Cut and Silence use the region you drew. The other six apply to the whole file, whatever is selected.

Edits work on recordings up to about half an hour long. For anything longer, you'll see a message instead, because the whole file has to be held in memory while it's edited. Cut out the part you want first — a clip saved from a region can be edited like any other file. The EVP scan has no such limit; long recordings are exactly what it's for.

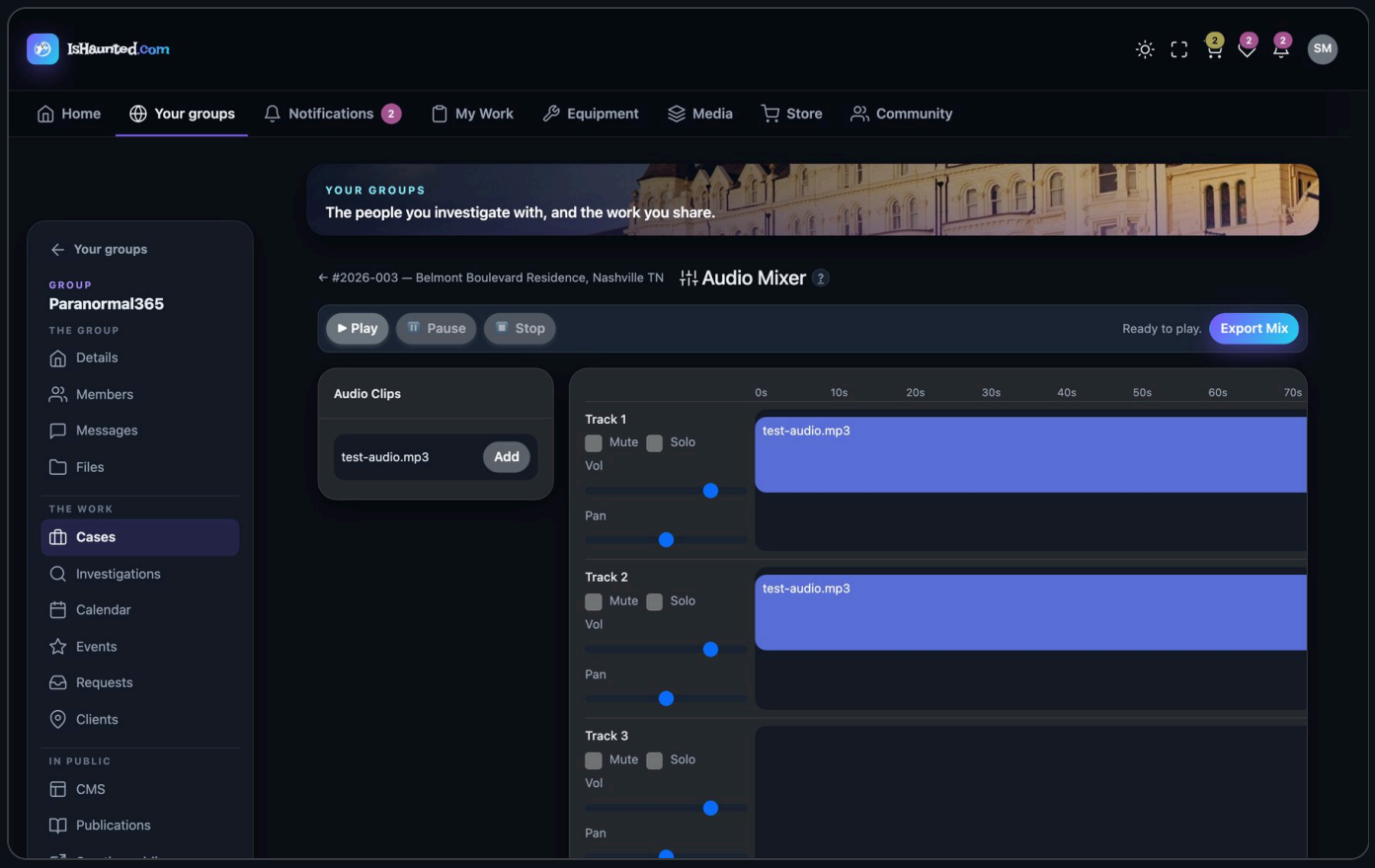
Exploring a region

Explore Region opens a single stretch on its own, loading only that audio. Everything inside is measured from the start of the region: the position readout, any note you add, and any smaller regions you draw. It's the best place to work on a few seconds without a two-hour waveform in the way.

Notes you write here are attached to that part of the recording, and appear on the clip if you save one from it.

The case mixer

A case with several recordings has an **Audio Mixer** on its page: eight tracks, each with volume, pan, mute and solo controls. Add clips from the case's files, drag them along their tracks to line them up, and press Play to hear the result.



Two copies of the same recording on the first two tracks, each shown at its real length. A clip whose length has never been measured is drawn with a dashed outline at a placeholder width.

Play is only a preview and doesn't change anything on the server. **Export Mix** renders the arrangement and adds it to the case as a new file. You need permission to add files to the case to do this, and the Mixer button only appears if you have it.

What is stored, and where

- **Everything you make is a new file.** It appears in Saved Clips and in your own files, with its own visibility setting.
- **Markers, notes and the list of what you dismissed** belong to the recording, so anyone who can see the recording sees them too.
- **Your editor setup** belongs to the recording as well — the spectrogram, its settings, and all the listening tools — and is saved only if the recording is yours.

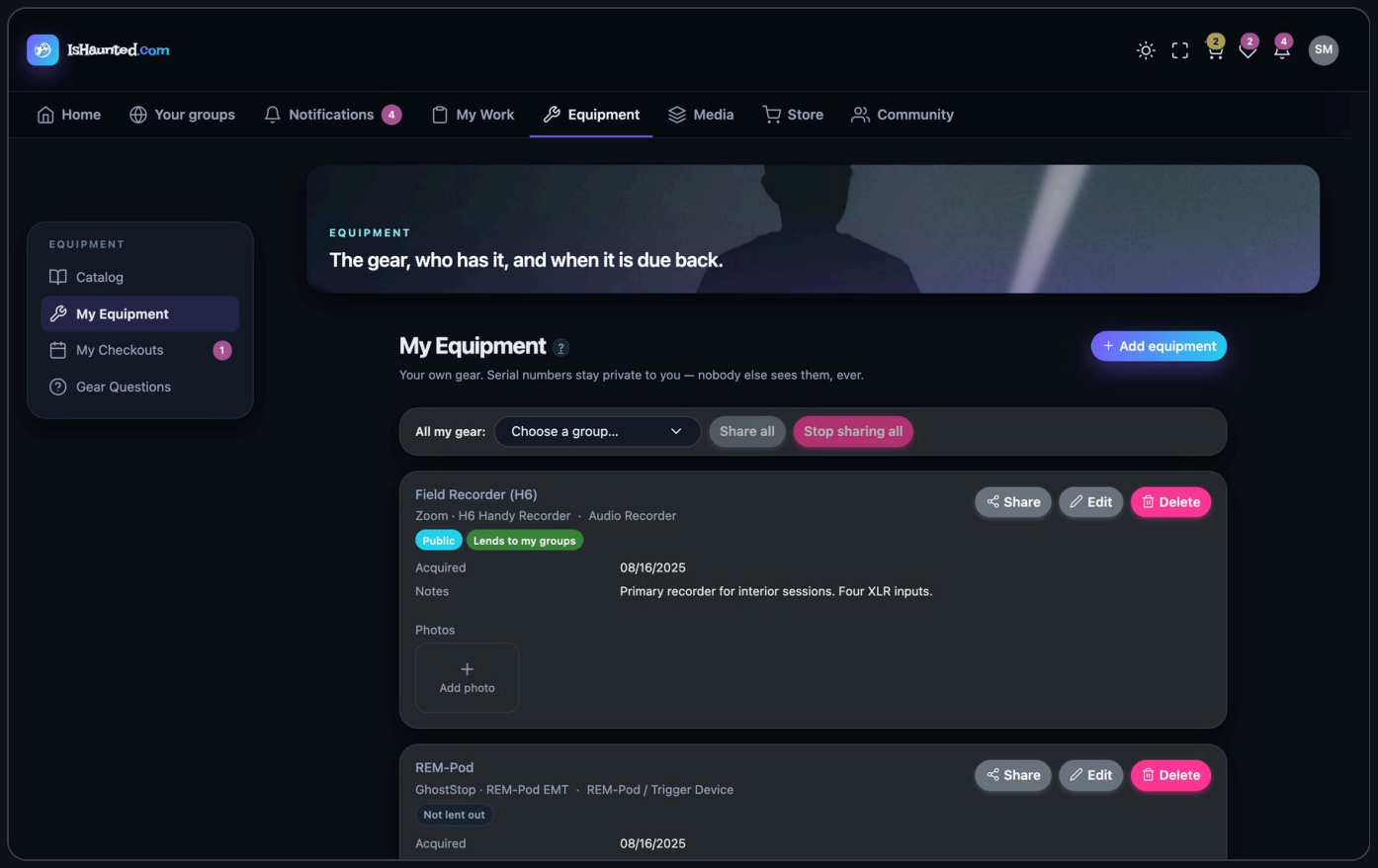
YOUR ACCOUNT

Your Equipment

Logging the gear you own, adding photos, and what stays private.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

Your equipment list



My Equipment: everything you own, whether or not anyone else can see or borrow it.

My Equipment, in the main menu, is where you record the gear you own — recorders, cameras, meters, lights, anything you take on an investigation. Each piece gets a make and model from the shared catalog, a name you choose, and optionally a serial number, an acquisition date, notes and photos.

Everything starts private to you. Listing a piece publicly, sharing it with a group, and offering it for loan are all separate choices you make piece by piece.

Clicking a piece's name, wherever it appears, opens its own page. Each person sees only what they're allowed to: you see its serial number and condition, a member of a group you shared it with sees that it's yours and how to ask for it, and a visitor from the public catalog sees the piece with no mention of you at all.

What stays private

Two things about a piece of equipment are **never** shown to anyone but you:

- **Who owns it, outside your groups.** The public catalog never links your name to a piece — a piece you chose to list appears without an owner. In a group you've shared with, your name does appear beside your gear, so members know whose gear is whose.
- **The serial number.** It stays private even when you share gear with a group or lend it out. Somebody borrowing your recorder doesn't need its serial number, and neither does the person approving the loan.

Site administrators can see equipment records, as they can everything else on the site.

Adding a piece of equipment

Choose a category first, then the make, then the model, then give it a name you will recognize in a list, like "my backup recorder".

Choosing a category changes the order of the makes, not which ones are listed. Makes that already have something in that category come first. The rest follow, each with a note — *FLIR (no models in this category yet)*. Every make stays on the list so you can always add a new model, even if you're the first person to own, say, a FLIR audio recorder. If you pick one of those makes, the model list tells you it's empty and points you to the box for adding one.

When you don't know the make or model

Not everything has a manufacturer and a product name, and you shouldn't have to make one up.

- **No brand at all** — a homemade trigger device, an unbranded flashlight: choose the make **Generic / Unbranded**. Every category has a generic model waiting under it.
- **A known brand with no particular model** — an Eveready flashlight, say: choose the make normally, then use **I don't know the exact model**. That adds one shared "generic" entry under that make, so everyone in the same situation picks the same entry instead of typing their own guesses.

When we ask "did you mean…?"

If you add a make spelled very much like one already in the catalog — **Sansung** when **Samsung** is there — we ask you to check before adding it. Everyone shares the catalog, and a misspelled make looks just as real as the correct one to the next person.

You always have both answers:

- **Pick the suggested make** if that's what you meant, and it's selected for you.
- **Say yours is different**, and we add it exactly as you typed it. Plenty of real makes are one letter apart — Ring and Ping are two different companies — so we only ask; we never refuse.

We only suggest makes an administrator has already confirmed, so we'll never point you to somebody else's typo.

Linking to a make or model

Every make and model has a readable address — `/equipment/zoom/h1n` — so a link you paste into a message shows what it's for. If you follow an older link, the address bar switches to the readable one.

When a name is corrected, its address changes too, so once "Sansung" is fixed to "Samsung", the misspelled address no longer works. This means a catalog link shared before a correction may stop working.

Tidying up after yourself

A make or model you added is removed automatically once no equipment uses it, as long as no administrator has confirmed it yet. So if you misspell a make and then delete the item, the misspelled make goes too. You don't need to ask anyone to clean it up.

Confirmed makes and models stay, whether or not anyone currently owns one.

Who can see a piece, and who can borrow it

These are two separate choices, set for each piece of equipment, and both start switched off. Letting people know you own something isn't the same as offering to lend it.

Who can see it. By default, only you. There are two ways to widen that, and you can use either or both:

- **Share it with a group** — use the **Share** button on the piece and check the groups that should see it. They see the make, model, photos and what you call it, alongside your name. They never see the serial number.
- **List it in the public catalog** — shows the piece under *Gear people own*, visible to anyone, signed in or not. Even then it never carries your name or its serial number.

Sharing with your groups

Sharing is set for each piece and each group, so you can share most of your gear with a group and keep one piece back. You can only share with groups you're a member of.

If you have a lot of gear, the **All my gear** row at the top of My Equipment shares or unshares everything with one group at once. It sets the same choice on each piece, so you can then uncheck any piece you'd rather keep back.

A share lasts as long as your membership. If you leave a group, it stops seeing your gear right away. Your choices are remembered, so they apply again if you rejoin.

Who can borrow it. Three options, and you can pick any combination:

OPTION	WHO CAN ASK	RECORDED AS
Groups I've shared it with	A group you've shared the piece with can borrow it for the group's own use	Borrowed for that group, and optionally tied to an investigation
People in my groups	Someone you share a group with, borrowing as themselves	A personal loan
Anyone with an account	Any signed-in user	A personal loan

If all three are unchecked, nobody can borrow the piece, however many people can see it. You approve or deny every request either way, and you set how long the loan runs — or leave the due date empty if you don't need it back by a particular day.

If you allow anyone to borrow a piece but don't list it publicly, the form warns you. People outside your groups can't find it, so the offer does nothing until you list it.

Retiring a piece

When you stop using something, **retire** it rather than deleting it. Retired gear disappears from borrowing and from the public catalog, but its loans and service history stay readable — and you can put it back in service whenever you like.

Once a piece has been lent or serviced, you can't delete it, because that would also delete its history, including loans other people were part of.

What we keep about your photos

A photo holds more than the picture: most phones record where and when it was taken, and which device took it. When you upload a photo, that information is removed and stored separately with the record, so the copy people see doesn't include it. A photo of gear at your home won't reveal your address.

Your original file is kept exactly as you sent it and never shown to anyone. The removed details can be seen only by group Administrators and site administrators.

The public catalog, and asking about a model

Browsing the catalog, the make and model pages, photos, questions and feedback are covered in The Equipment Catalog — a guide anyone can read, signed in or not.

YOUR ACCOUNT

Borrowing Equipment

Asking to borrow gear, handing it over, and getting it back.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

You can borrow two kinds of equipment: gear a group owns, and gear a member owns personally and has offered to lend. The steps are the same either way. What differs is who decides.

Who decides

WHOSE GEAR	WHO APPROVES
The group's own	Anyone with the group's **Equipment Checkouts** permission
A member's own	That member, always

No group permission lets anyone lend out somebody else's personal equipment. If it's yours, the decision is yours.

Asking to borrow

Find the piece and choose **Ask to borrow**. You'll find gear in two places: your group's **Equipment** tab, and the public equipment catalog — **Equipment → Catalog** in the menu — under *Gear people own*.

If the owner lends the piece to more than one group you're in, you'll be asked **who you are borrowing it for**. This matters: a loan for a group is recorded under that group and can be tied to a particular visit. A loan you take out personally is just yours.

If the owner only lends the piece personally, there's nothing to choose and no group is recorded.

You can add when you need it and a note about why. Neither is required, but a note helps the owner say yes without having to come back to you with questions first.

You can only have one open request per piece at a time, so asking again won't act as a reminder.

Asking a question first

Every piece has its own page, reached by clicking its name. On it you'll find **Things worth knowing** — an FAQ the owner has written — and an **Ask a question** button if there's something they haven't covered.

Questions are **anonymous in both directions**. Whoever looks after the piece sees your question but not your name, and their answer comes back without theirs. So ask whatever you need to know — asking about a temperamental battery door won't count against you when you ask to borrow it.

Only questions are anonymous. If you go on to **ask to borrow**, that request includes your name, since you're asking someone to hand you their equipment.

Your questions and their answers are in **Gear Questions** in the main menu.

Being turned down

Whoever declines your request has to give a reason, and you'll see it, so you know whether it's worth asking again later.

A declined request is final, and it stays on record. If things change, send a new request.

Handing over and getting back

Each side confirms when the equipment reaches them.

- **You confirm you have it.** Once your request is approved, the loan isn't "out" until you press **I've got it**, because only the person holding the equipment can say for sure they have it.
- **The lender confirms it came back.** When you return it, they press **Got it back**, optionally noting the condition. This is the lender's job, not yours, so a loan can't be closed just by saying you returned something.

Until you confirm the hand-off, you can still **cancel** if your plans change, so an approved request you never picked up doesn't turn into a loan.

Due dates and overdue

Whoever approves the loan can set a date it's due back, or leave it open if there's no rush.

A loan is **overdue** once it's out and past that date. This is always up to date, and an overdue loan shows as a red badge on **My Checkouts** and a count on your notification bell.

Photos of its condition

Either side can attach photos to a loan — as the gear goes out, and as it comes back. They appear side by side on the loan's **Details** view, so "was that scratch already there?" is easy to answer without relying on memory.

You can add a hand-off photo only after the loan is approved and before it ends, and a return photo only while the gear is out or just after it comes back.

Condition photos are private to the two sides of that loan. They never appear in the public catalog.

Asking for more time

If you need a piece for longer, open the loan's **Details** and ask to keep it until a later date. You can only ask while you have the gear, and only one request can be waiting at a time.

The lender can grant or refuse it. Granting moves the due date. Refusing keeps the original date and requires a reason. Either way, you get a notification, and the request and its answer stay on the loan, so you can always look back and see what was asked and what was agreed — for example, "asked for another week, was given three days."

Feedback after a loan

Once a piece is back, both sides can leave feedback on the loan's page. It is optional, and you can leave a comment, a rating out of five, or both.

Neither side ever sees what was written about them, and nobody is notified when feedback is left about them. Here's who sees each kind:

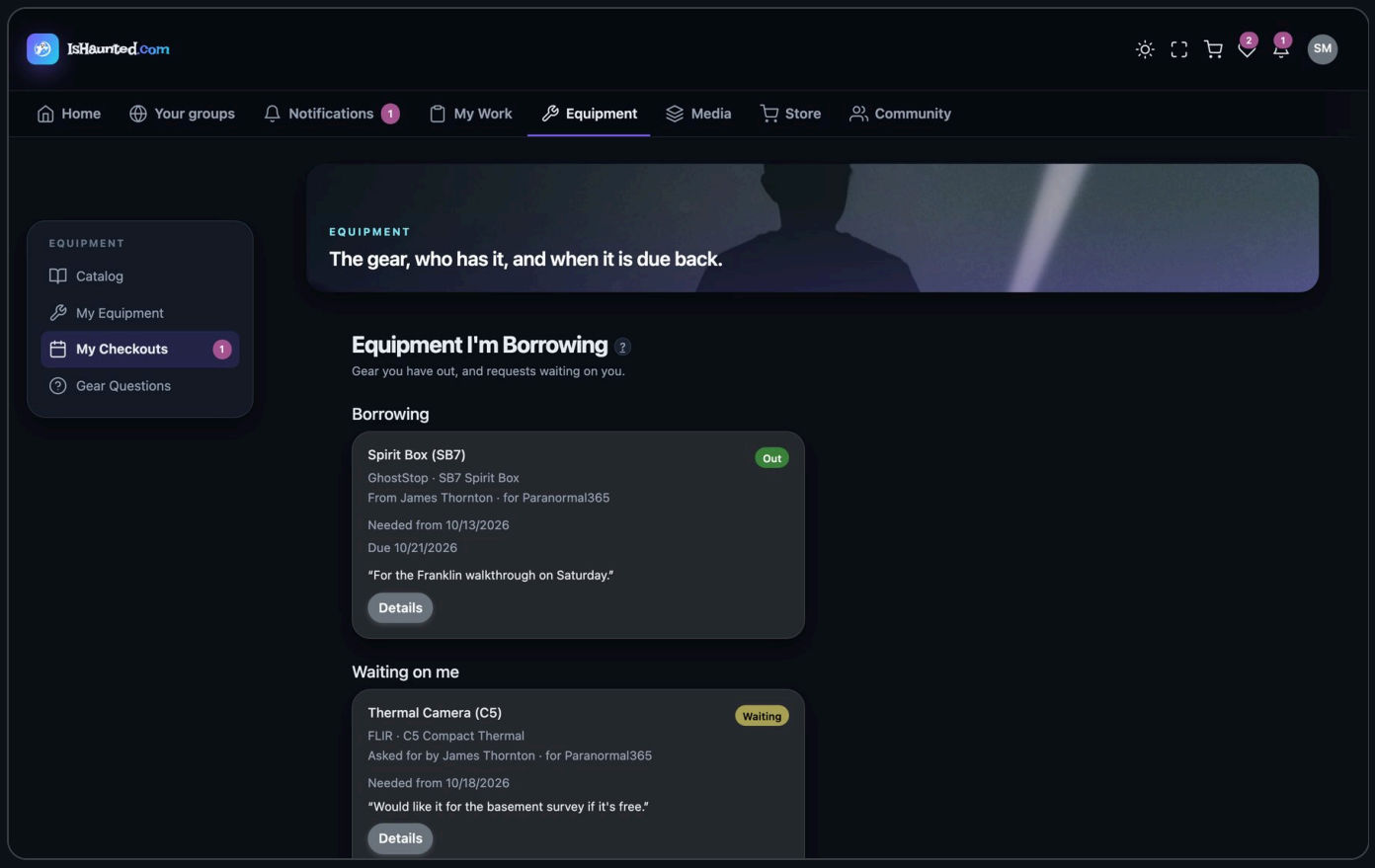
- **What a lender writes about a borrower** is shown to *future lenders* deciding on that person's next request. So somebody thinking about lending an expensive recorder can see whether the last few lenders got their gear back on time and in one piece. It includes the lender's name.
- **What a borrower writes about a lender** is shown to *other borrowers* thinking of asking that lender, **without your name**.

Borrowers can also review **the equipment itself**, separately. That review is public: it appears on the make and model's catalog page, still without your name, and helps people decide whether the item is worth buying or borrowing at all.

An average rating is only shown once there are at least three ratings, and it always shows how many ratings it's based on.

A group's Administrators and Owner can see all the feedback left about their group's gear and loans, and remove anything inappropriate.

My Checkouts



Both directions in one place: what you have out, and what someone has asked you for.

My Checkouts shows both sides of borrowing in one place:

- **Borrowing** — what you have out, and what you have asked for
- **Waiting on me** — requests for your gear needing a decision, and your gear currently out with somebody

Members with a group's **Equipment Checkouts** permission also see a list of every loan of the group's gear, on the group's own Equipment tab.

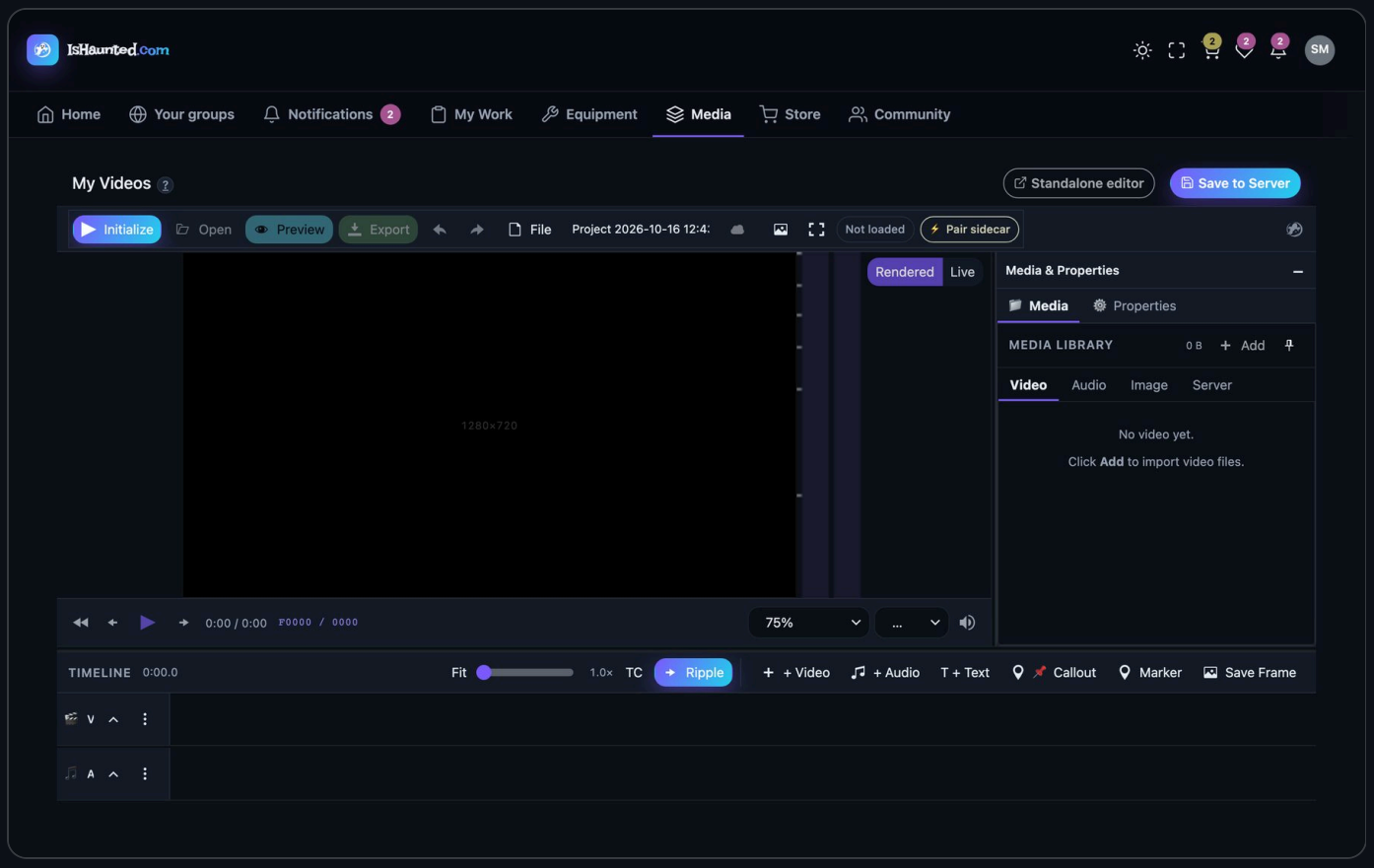
YOUR ACCOUNT

Using the Video Editor

Turning raw footage into something worth watching — import, trim, title, and export.

Written for: **Signed-in users**

The video editor gives you a full editing suite in your browser. Nothing is uploaded while you work: your footage is downloaded to your own computer, then edited and rendered there. Only the finished video goes back to the server, and only if you choose to send it.



The editor: the picture at the top, the timeline below it, and the media and properties panel on the right.

You can resize all three parts. Drag the divider above the timeline to give the timeline more or less room; drag the panel's left edge to widen it; collapse the panel with the button in its header, and bring it back from the toolbar. The editor remembers your layout for next time.

Where to find it

- **My Videos** — your own workspace, for anything not tied to a case.

- **A case's Video tab** — the same editor, opened for that case, for work your group will attach to it. Projects saved there belong to the case: everyone who can open the case sees the full list and can open any project in it. Only the person who saved a project can overwrite, publish or delete it, so the list shows who made each one.

There's also a standalone version of the editor at ishaunted.com/editors/video. It's the same editor with the same features — multiple tracks, titles, transitions, effects, saved projects and more — and it keeps your footage even further from the server: media goes straight from the site to your computer without passing through the web server at all. Sign in there with the button in its toolbar, and it lists your uploaded media, saves projects to the server and publishes finished videos just like the site does. The main difference is what happens before you sign in: see Working signed out below.

The **Standalone editor** link on the My Videos page takes you there without signing in again. The link carries a one-time pass that's valid for one minute and never leaves your browser's address bar, and the editor uses it up as it opens. If the project you had open was saved to the server, it opens there too. Nothing else is carried over: the standalone editor gets its own sign-in rather than a copy of the one you're using here.

Start the engine

The first thing to press is **Initialize**. The editor does its video work with a copy of ffmpeg that runs inside your browser. That engine is a large download, so it isn't fetched until you ask for it. You can open a project just to look at it without the engine, but editing needs it.

The chip next to the toolbar shows its progress: *Not loaded*, then *Loading ffmpeg…*, then **Ready**. Importing, previewing and exporting all wait until it's Ready.

Once it's Ready, the **Initialize** button disappears to make room for the tools you'll actually use. It comes back only if the engine fails — and that's the one time you should press it again.

Bringing in footage

Everything you bring in goes into the **Media** panel first. That's your source material for this project, which isn't the same thing as your edit. A clip stays there whether or not it's on the timeline, and its card tells you which: *on timeline*, or *on timeline ×2* if you've used it twice. A card that says **media missing** means its file is no longer in this browser's storage; see *Where your footage lives*.

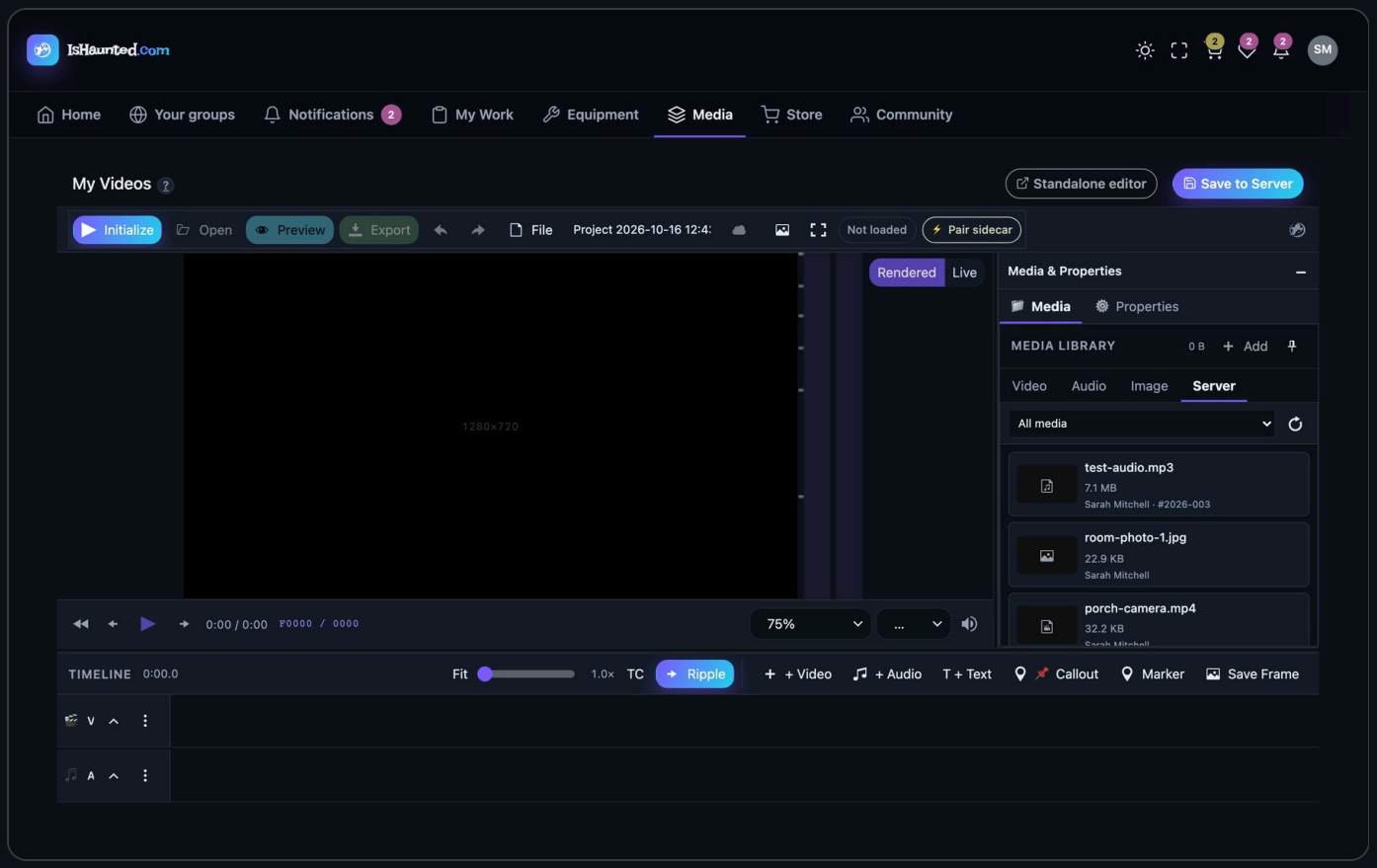
Press **+** on a card to place it at the playhead. You can place the same source as many times as you like, and trimming one copy doesn't affect the others. **Remove from media** removes the card; anything already on the timeline stays exactly as it is.

One shortcut: the first thing you bring into an empty project is placed on the timeline for you, since that's almost always what you want.

There are two ways to bring footage in.

From your machine — the **Open** button picks files straight from your disk. They never touch the server.

From the server — the **Server** tab lists media you already have on the site: your own uploads, and anything shared with you through a group or a case.



Everything you have access to, with its size. Clicking a file downloads it to this browser.

Importing shows one row per file, and you can cancel any row while it's still working.

Finding the right file

The list above the files narrows down what the tab shows:

	WHAT YOU GET
All media	Everything you have access to — your uploads, and anything shared with you.
My files	Only what you uploaded yourself.
By case	One case's media. A second list appears so you can pick the case.

Each row shows **whose file it is**, and which case it belongs to, if any. Two people can easily upload recordings with the same name, and **All media** shows everyone's files together.

If you pick a case that had more than one visit, a third list appears so you can narrow it down to a single night's footage instead of everything from the case. Leave it on **The whole case** to see it all.

These filters only narrow what you could already see. They can't give you access to someone else's footage, and choosing a case you're not part of simply shows nothing.

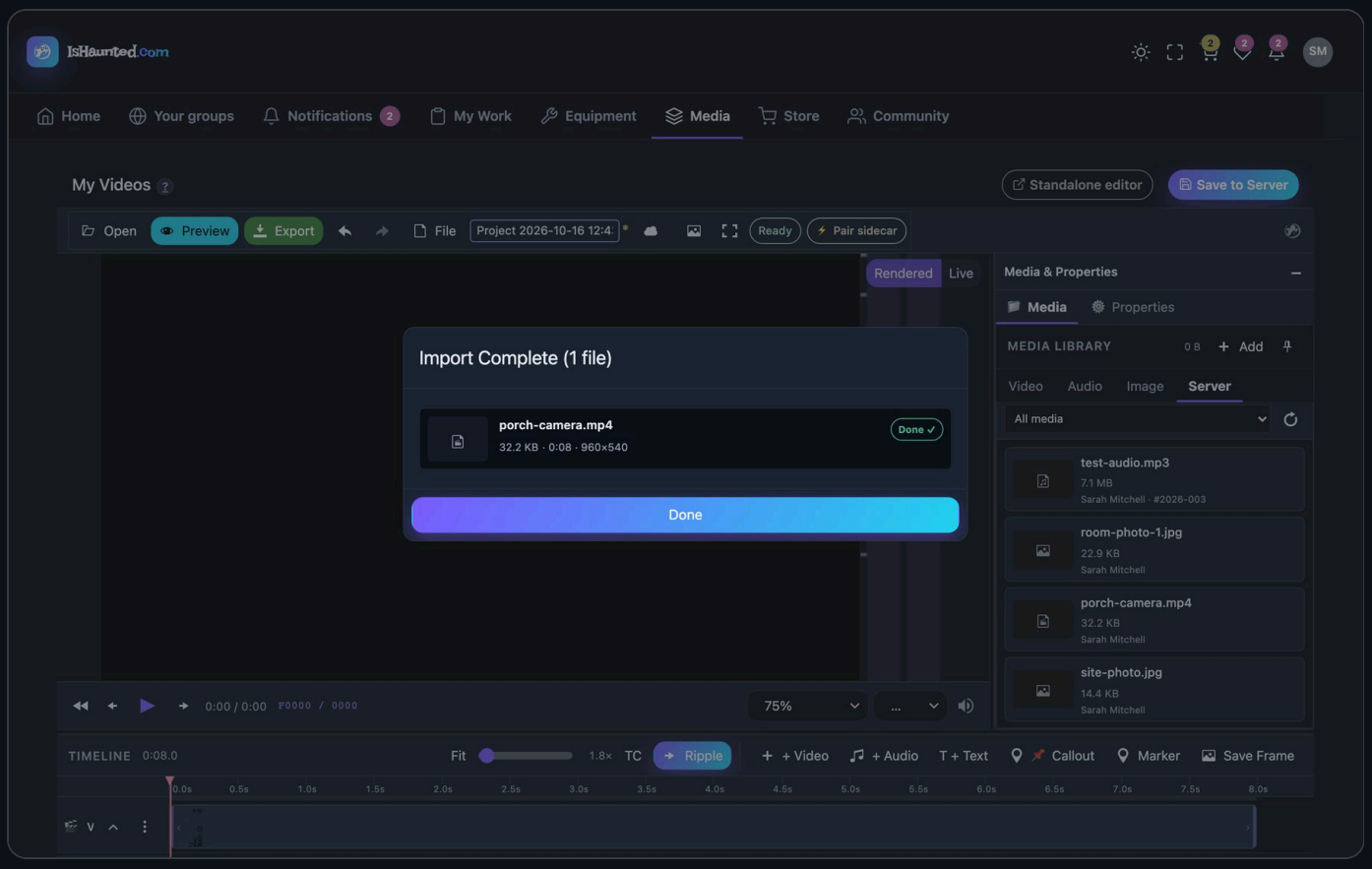
The list is loaded once. If you upload something somewhere else while the editor is open, press the **refresh** button next to the filter lists to load it again. A video you publish from the editor refreshes the list automatically.

Bringing a file over takes **two clicks**, on purpose:

1. **Click the file once.** It downloads to your browser and is stored there. The card then says **Click to add**. Nothing has been added to your video yet — this step only downloads the file, and it doesn't need the engine.
2. **Click it again.** Now it's decoded, put in the matching bin — Video, Audio or Images — and placed on the timeline. This step does need the engine, so start it first.

Downloading a large file and adding it to your edit are separate decisions. This way you can download several files while you think, and place them later.

If audio tracks are turned off in your editor, an audio file still goes into the **Audio** bin, and the import row explains why it wasn't placed. It's there whenever you want it.



Each import reports what it found — length and frame size — and stays until you dismiss it.

How much footage the editor can take

The editor keeps your footage in the browser's own storage, and does all its work on your own computer. Both have limits, and it's worth knowing them before you plan a long edit.

Measured on a 2026 MacBook Pro in Chrome, with a few clips on the timeline:

	WHAT HAPPENED
Storage the browser offered	About 6 GB
A 284 MB clip	Imported in about 50 seconds, stored at its original size
A 348 MB clip	Imported in about a minute, stored at its original size
Rebuilding the preview after adding one	About a minute
Switching that timeline to **Live**	About 3 seconds

What this means for you:

Footage is stored at full size. An imported file takes up as much space as the file itself, so 6 GB is roughly how much footage a project can hold before the browser runs out of room. The Media panel shows how much you've used.

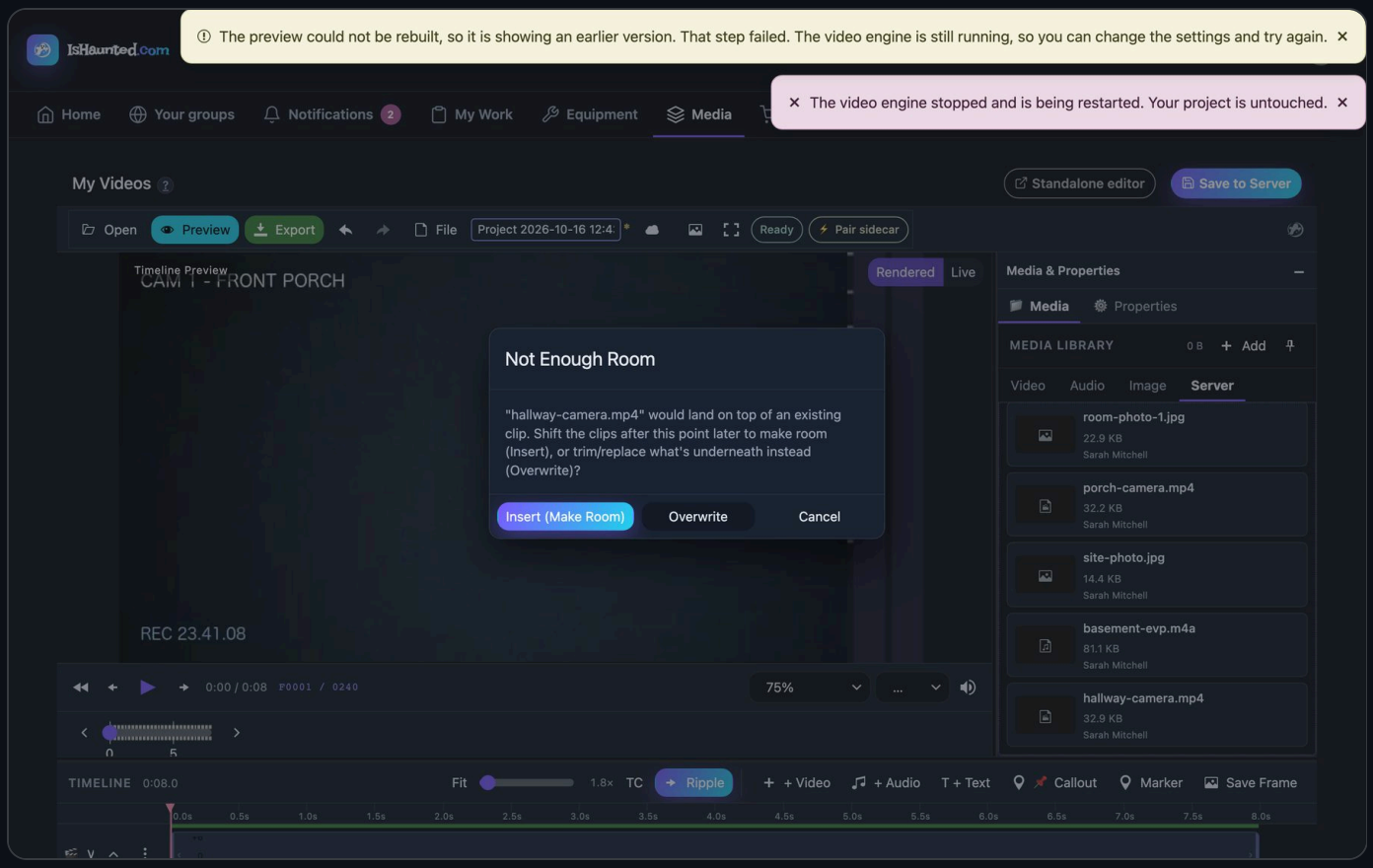
The bigger the footage, the longer you wait. Each edit rebuilds the rendered preview, and with a few hundred megabytes of footage that takes about a minute. That's what **Live** is for while you're cutting: it plays your footage directly and is ready in seconds, whatever the file size.

For anything bigger, use the Sidecar. The browser's video engine has its own limited memory, and very large or very long footage is where it runs out. The native helper does the same work outside the browser, using your computer's full memory and all of its processor cores.

If a file is simply too big to import, trim it first in any tool that can cut without re-encoding. That gets you the part you want at a fraction of the size.

Landing on an occupied spot

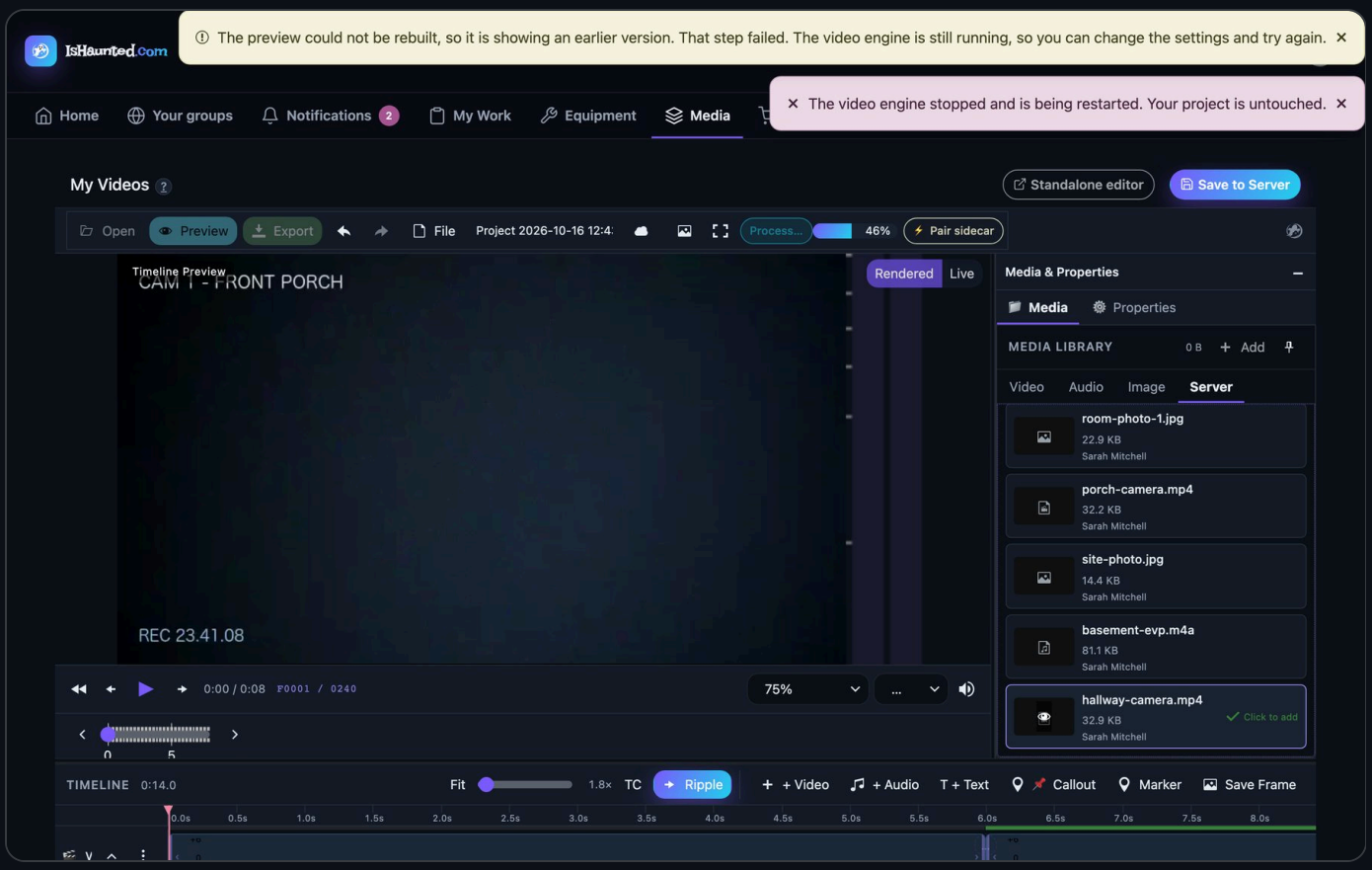
If a clip would land where something already is, the editor asks you what to do instead of guessing:



Insert pushes what's already there further along. Overwrite replaces the part that overlaps.

Insert (Make Room) is the safe choice: nothing is lost, and everything after the insertion point moves later. **Overwrite** is what you want when you're deliberately replacing a section.

The timeline



Two camera angles, one after the other. The pink line is the playhead.

- **Tracks** stack: video tracks on top of each other, audio below. A clip on a higher track covers the one beneath it at the same moment.
- **Drag a clip** to move it. Drag its **edges** to trim it — this moves where the clip starts and ends; the file itself isn't changed.
- **Fit** zooms out to show the whole project across the window; the zoom slider next to it lets you zoom in for frame-accurate work.
- **TC** switches the ruler between timecode and frame numbers.
- **Ripple** decides what happens to everything after a trim or delete: when it's on, the gap closes and later clips move back; when it's off, the gap stays.

Keyboard

You can control most of the timeline from the keyboard. The full list is in the editor itself: **File → Keyboard shortcuts**, or press ?.

The ones to learn first:

KEY	DOES
`Space`	Play or pause
`←` / `→`	Step one frame back or forward
`Home` / `End`	Jump to the start or the end
`S`	Split the selected clip at the playhead
`M`	Drop a marker at the playhead
`Ctrl`/`⌘` + `D`	Duplicate whatever is selected, clips and annotations alike
`Delete`	Remove whatever is selected
`Ctrl`/`⌘` + `Z`	Undo (add `Shift` to redo)
`Escape`	Clear the selection

On a Mac, `⌘` works everywhere `Ctrl` does.

When a title, callout or piece of clip art is selected, the arrow keys nudge it around the frame instead of stepping through frames.

Marking a moment

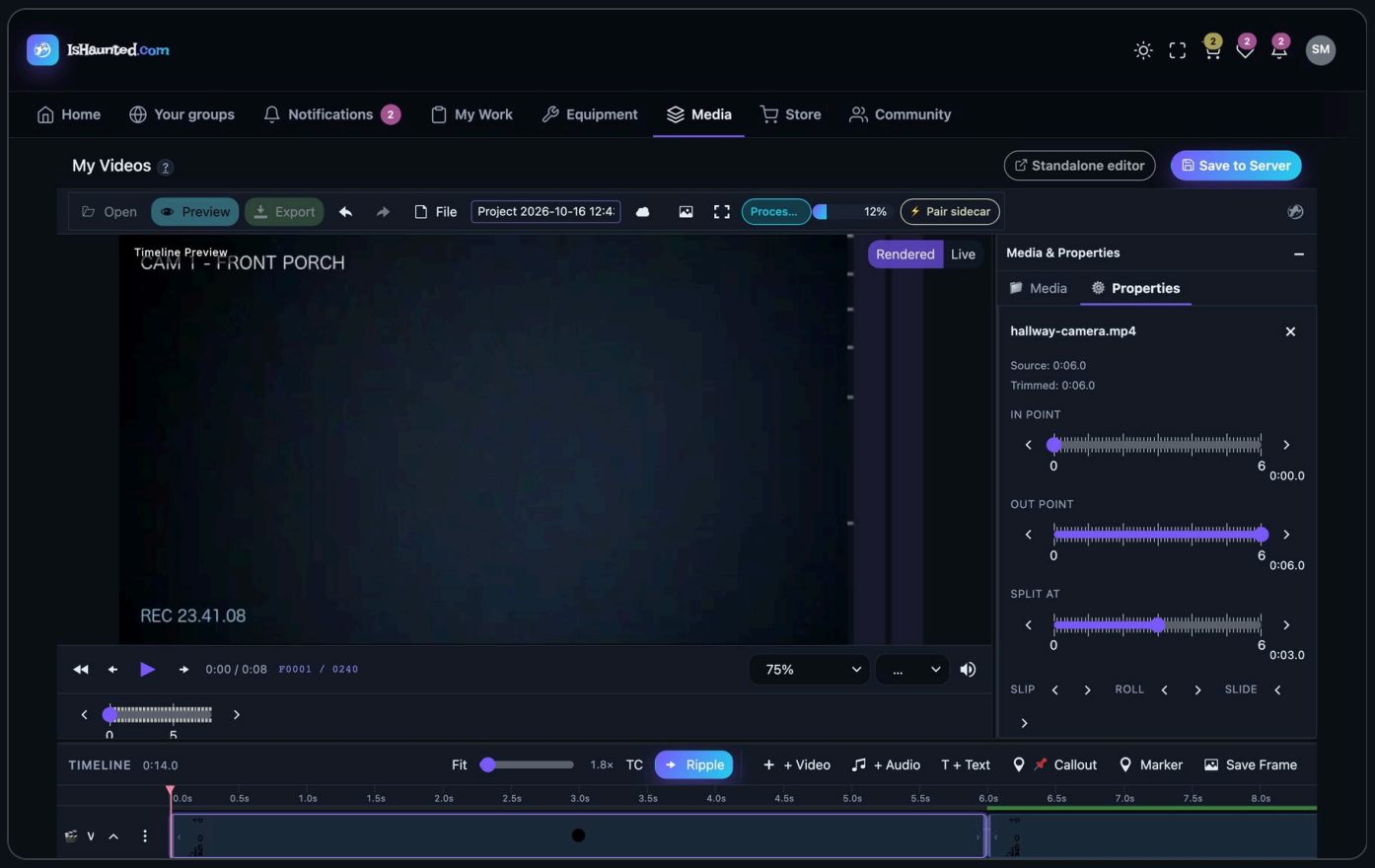
Marker adds a labeled point at the playhead. Markers are for you and anyone reviewing with you — a way to say "here" without cutting anything. They're saved with the project.

Saving a single frame

Save Frame saves the picture at the playhead to your computer as a PNG. It's taken from the clip's own footage at full resolution, not from the preview, so it's as sharp as the source allows. It doesn't include your titles or callouts, which is usually what you want for a frame you're sharing as evidence.

Working on a clip

Select a clip, and the panel's **Properties** tab shows its settings.



Trim, speed, volume, split and delete, all for the selected clip.

- **Apply Trim** sets exactly where the clip starts and ends, for when dragging its edge isn't precise enough.
- **Apply Speed** slows a moment down or speeds a long stretch up. Speed changes how much of the timeline the clip takes up — at double speed it becomes half as long — so the timeline always shows how long the finished video will really be. Speeding up a clip leaves a gap after it; close the gap by dragging the next clip back, or leave it and the export fills it with black.
- **Apply Volume** sets the clip's level. Audio clips also have a volume envelope you can drag on the timeline itself, for fading within a single clip.
- **Set In** and **Set Out** trim the clip to the playhead's position, so you can trim to what you're actually watching instead of typing a timecode. Both are available while the playhead is over the clip.
- **Split** cuts the clip in two at the playhead.
- **Link Nearby Audio** links a separately recorded sound file to the picture it goes with, so moving one moves the other.
- **Mute** on the right-click menu silences a clip's own sound without changing its volume setting.

Hiding part of the picture

A clip often has one thing in it that can't be shown: a face, a license plate, the house number by the door. **Hide an area** covers a rectangle of the picture with a blur or a mosaic, so you can still use the rest of the clip.

Areas are drawn on the clip, so they move with it if you move or trim it, and the preview shows each one where the finished video will cover it. In the preview, the area has a dashed outline to show that it's only an editing marker: the browser's blur isn't the one used in the final render, and the render's blur is stronger.

An area's size and position are measured as a proportion of the frame rather than in pixels, so it still covers the same thing if you export at a different resolution. If an area is too small to render, the export lists it in its warnings rather than quietly leaving it out — check the picture before you share it.

Putting a clip somewhere other than the whole frame

By default, a clip fills the whole frame. **Place this clip** lets you change that:

- **Two cameras at once.** Put a clip on a second video track and place it in a corner, or place both clips at half width to show them side by side.
- **Footage shot sideways. Turn upright** rotates a phone clip a quarter turn.
- **Something at the edge you don't want. Cut off the edges** trims a portion off any side — handy for removing a recorder's timestamp bar or a neighbor's window. Unlike hiding an area, which covers something up, cutting removes it from the video completely.

The picture keeps its own proportions inside whatever box you give it, so placing a clip never stretches it.

Sound

Audio clips sit on their own tracks below the picture and work like everything else on the timeline: drag one to move it, and drag its edges to trim it. The waveform drawn on the clip shows the part of the recording that the clip actually plays.

Select a sound clip, and the **Properties** tab offers:

- **Volume**, plus an envelope you can drag on the clip itself for fading within a single clip.
- **Left** and **Right** separately, for a recording where one channel is louder than the other.
- **Fade in** and **fade out**, limited to half the clip. Both are also on the clip's right-click menu on the timeline, where they set a one-second fade without opening the panel.
- **Mute this clip**, which silences it but keeps its volume setting.

Cleaning up a recording

A recording made in a house at two in the morning is mostly room tone, refrigerator hum and the recorder's own background hiss.

- **Reduce hiss** helps a voice stand out from all that. The higher you set it, the more it removes, but past about three-quarters it starts to make speech sound watery. Turn it up until the noise stops bothering you, and no further.

- **Even out the level** brings the clip to a standard loudness. Turn it on for every clip in a reel made from several recordings, so nobody has to adjust the volume between them.

Both are applied when the video is rendered, not to the file you imported, so nothing is lost and you can change your mind.

Music under a voice

Music and room tone are usually set at a level that suits the parts where nobody is talking, so they're too loud the moment a voice comes in.

Open an audio track's menu and choose **Duck others under this**. Everything else — including the video's own sound — gets quieter whenever that track is playing, and comes back up when it stops. It saves you from drawing a volume envelope around every line by hand, and redrawing it every time the timing changes.

Separating a clip's own sound

Right-click a video clip and choose **Separate Audio** to put its sound on its own track, where you can trim and move it separately. The new audio clip keeps the trim, speed and volume the video had, so it starts out lined up exactly as before.

Joining two clips

Where one clip meets the next, the cut is instant unless you add a transition.

- Hover over the join between two clips and a small dashed circle appears on it. Click it and pick a style — **Fade**, **Dissolve**, **Wipe left**, **Circle open**, **Fade through black** and a dozen more.
- You can also drag a style straight from the **Transitions** tab of the Assets panel onto the join.
- A transition overlaps the two clips: they play at the same time for the length of the transition, so the finished video is shorter than the two clips added together. The timeline shows this — the second clip moves back to meet the first.
- Drag either end of a transition on the timeline to make it longer or shorter. Right-click it to change the style or remove it.
- Removing a transition gives the overlapping time back to both clips.

A transition belongs to the two clips it joins. If you delete, trim or move either clip, the join is gone, so the transition is removed too — and **Undo** brings it back along with your edit.

Layers above the picture

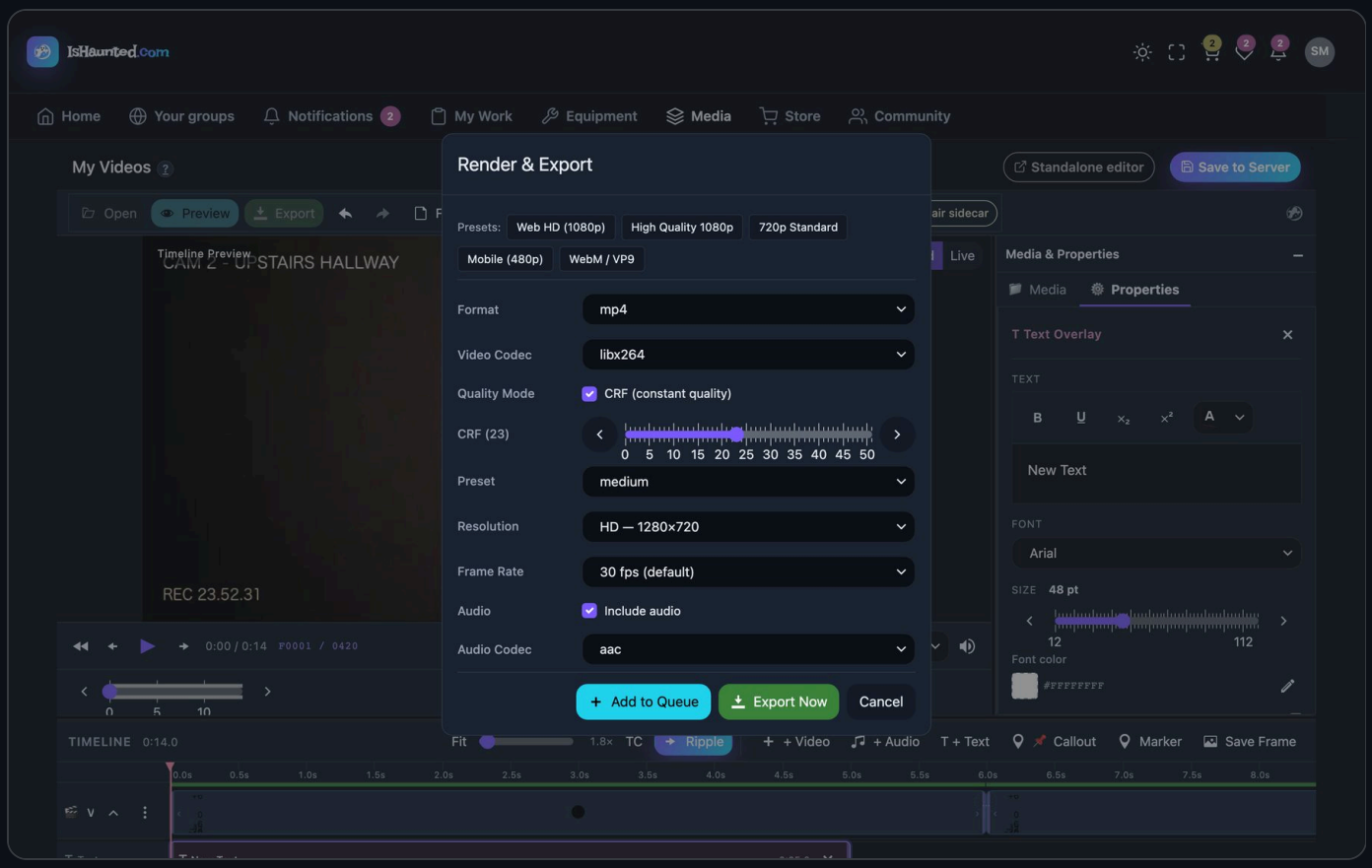
The timeline can have more than one video track. A clip on a higher track plays over the one beneath it for as long as it runs. Everything on the timeline keeps its place in the finished video, gaps included: if you leave a

gap between two clips, the export shows black for exactly that long, just as the timeline does.

Titles, callouts and clip art are stacked in the order you added them, whatever kind each one is. The newest is on top, and that's how it renders.

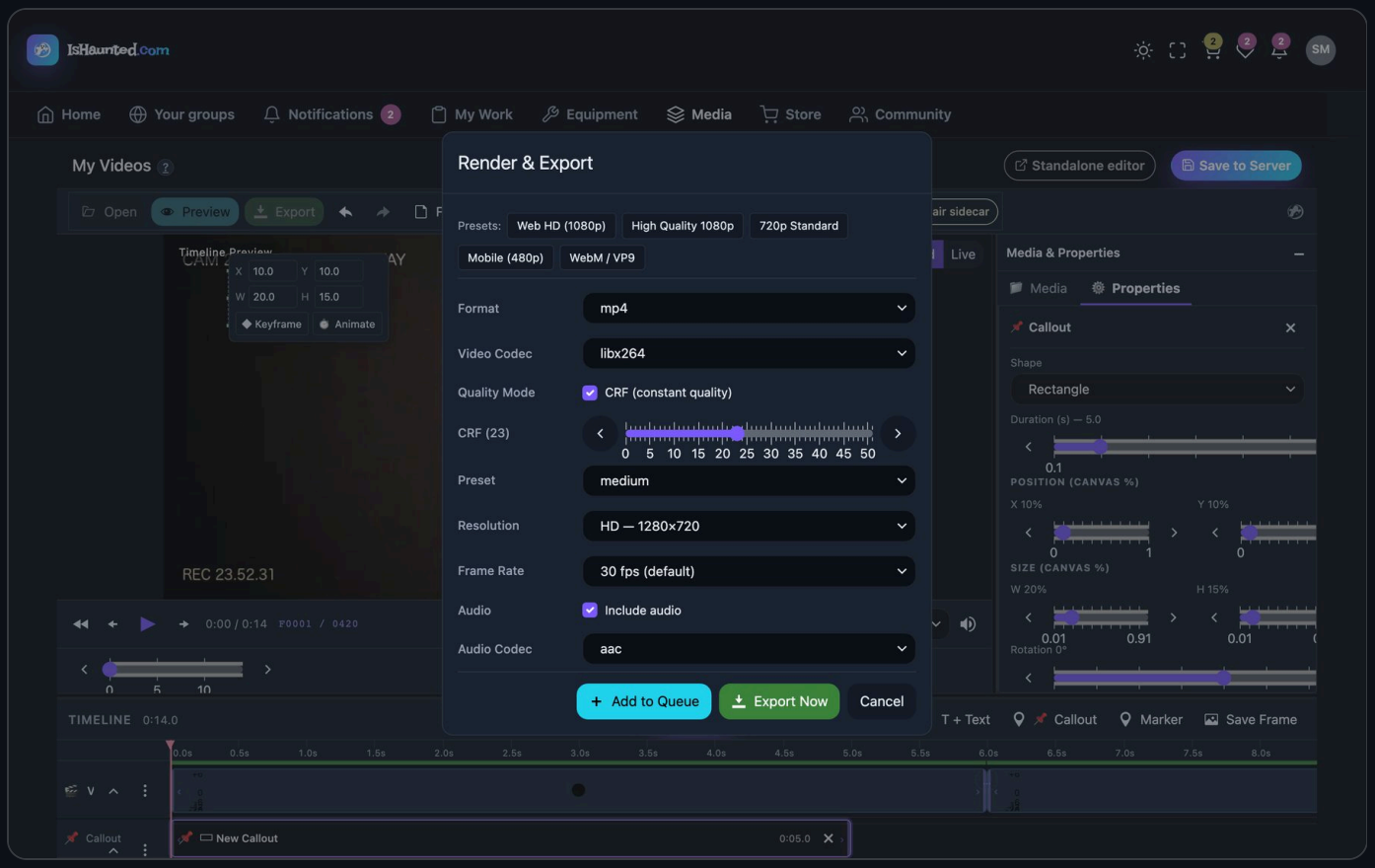
Titles and callouts

+ Text adds a title. It gets its own block on the timeline, so you edit its timing just like a clip's — drag it to move it, and drag its edges to change how long it's on screen.



A title works like any other clip: it starts and ends where you put it.

Callout adds a shape — rectangle, ellipse, arrow — for pointing at something in the frame. Callouts can be moved, resized and rotated, and their movement can be animated over time.



Callouts are for drawing attention to a spot in the picture.

Both get their color, font and border settings from the properties panel, and both can move across the frame while they're on screen. Every change takes effect immediately and can be undone, including changes to the text — there's no separate Apply step.

A title stays on one line unless you tell it otherwise. **Wrap long lines** breaks it at a width you choose, which is easier than typing the line breaks yourself and still works if you change the font size.

Right-click any clip, title, callout or piece of artwork and choose **Duplicate**, or press `Ctrl`/`⌘` + `D`, to make an identical copy. The copy is placed just after the original and is completely separate, so editing one doesn't change the other. It's an easy way to make three matching callouts without building each one from scratch.

Preview and export

Preview renders the real, full-quality video in its own window on the page, so you can check the finished result before you commit to it. You can stop it at any point, and if it stops showing progress, the window tells you and offers to restart the video engine.

Meanwhile, the editor keeps its own rough preview up to date in the background as you work — which is why the status chip sometimes says it's busy just after an edit. That preview keeps your place: it continues from where you were instead of jumping back to the start after every change. It also plays your audio tracks, so you can hear how the music sits against the picture while you're still editing.

Live and Rendered

Above the picture you can choose between two ways of watching your timeline. Each one is good for a different job.

Rendered is the background preview described above: the editor makes a small video of your whole timeline and plays it. It shows everything — transitions, effects, titles, callouts — because it's made the same way as the export. It takes a moment to catch up after each edit, and the longer the timeline, the longer that takes.

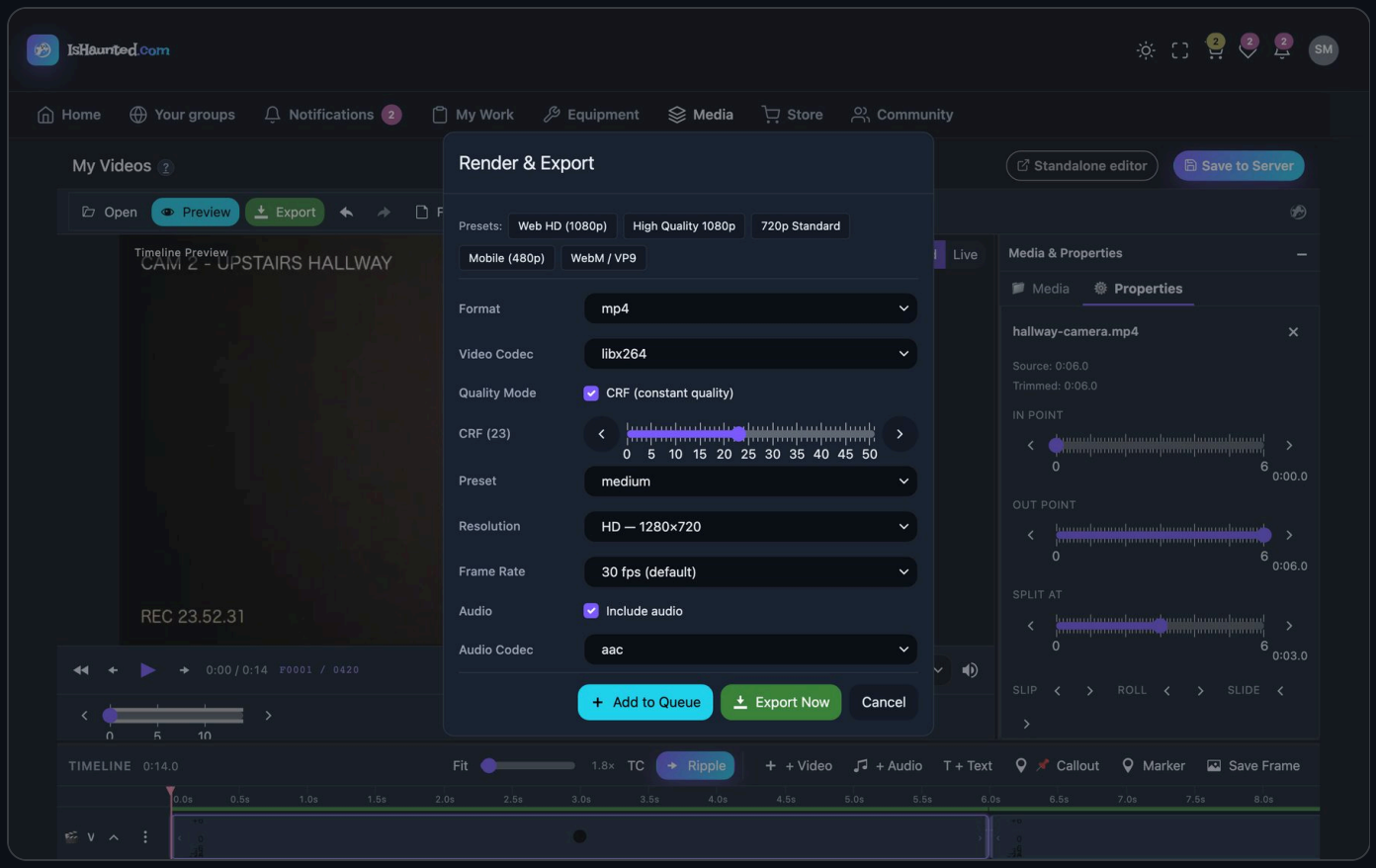
Live plays your original footage directly, switching between files as the playhead moves across them. A cut you've just made shows up immediately, with no waiting, which is what you want while you're cutting. It plays only the picture and the sound: transitions appear as plain cuts, and effects, titles and callouts aren't shown. A clip whose media isn't on this computer plays as black, and the player tells you how many clips that affects.

Use Live for cutting, and Rendered for checking. The export always matches Rendered.

If the engine stops

The video engine runs inside your browser and can occasionally stop — usually on a very large file. When that happens, the status chip says so and a **Restart engine** button appears next to it. Your project is safe; only the step that was in progress is lost. Usually the editor restarts the engine for you.

If the message says the file is more than the browser can handle, restarting won't help: that's a limit of the browser itself. Use a shorter selection, a smaller export resolution, or the native helper described below, which doesn't have that limit.



Presets for common uses, with every setting available underneath if you want it.

Export renders the final video. Start from a preset — Web HD, High Quality, 720p, Mobile or WebM — and change only what you care about: format, codec, quality, resolution and frame rate. **Export Now** renders right away; **Add to Queue** lines it up so you can keep working, even while another export is already running.

A few settings are worth knowing about:

- **Source resolution** keeps the size of your first clip instead of resizing anything. Choose it when you're editing 4K or phone footage and want the export to match what the camera recorded.
- **Frame rate** is 30 by default. Lower it only if you need a smaller file.
- The available codecs depend on the format, because not every codec works with every file type. Pick the format first.

If something on the timeline couldn't be included — a clip whose media isn't loaded, or a piece of artwork that couldn't be read — the export still finishes and lists what it left out. Check that list before you share the file.

You choose where the finished video goes:

- **To your machine** — the file is saved on your computer and never leaves it.
- **To the server** — the finished video is uploaded and becomes a regular file in your media library, ready to attach to a case or publish. Publishing a render from a case project also adds it to that case's Files tab, so the rest of the group can find it without opening the editor. Publishing again replaces the earlier version instead of keeping both.

If you close that question without choosing, you're asked whether you meant to throw the video away. Nothing is deleted unless you say so.

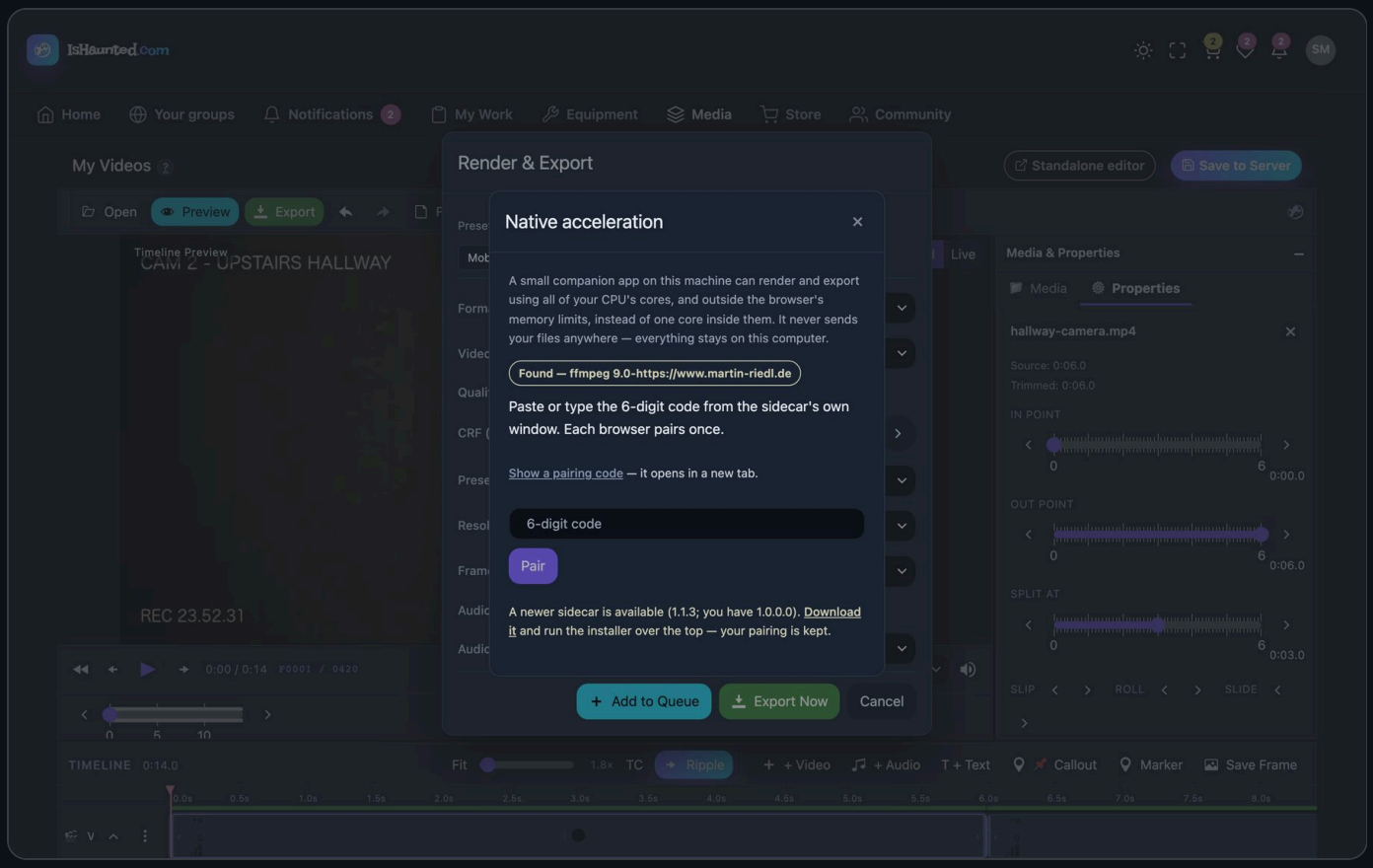
Rendering is hard work for your computer. A short project finishes quickly; a long one with overlays takes minutes. Both are faster with the native helper below.

The native helper (Sidecar)

Everything above runs inside the browser's sandbox, which is safe but slow. It renders using one processor core, within a memory limit set by the browser, which is why a long project can crawl.

The **Sidecar** is a small app you install on your own computer to remove both limits. While it's running, the editor hands the heavy work — decoding, rendering, exporting — to the Sidecar instead of doing it in the browser tab. The Sidecar can use all of your processor's cores and isn't held back by the browser's memory limit. You get the same video, much faster.

Titles, callouts, artwork, transitions and hidden areas are still drawn in the browser even when the Sidecar is running. Those parts are quick; it's the decoding and encoding that's slow, and that's what the Sidecar takes over.



The panel that opens from the toolbar chip: whether a helper is installed, and whether this browser is paired with it.

It's completely optional. Without the Sidecar, everything still works — the editor simply uses the in-browser engine.

Installing and pairing

1. **Install it** on the computer you edit on. On Windows, it's in the **Microsoft Store** as *IsHaunted.com SideCar*. It's free and signed by Microsoft, so there are no warnings to click through. For a Mac, or for Windows without the Store, the sidecar downloads page has the installers and instructions.
2. **Turn it on**, if it isn't already running. On Windows, the chip's panel has a **Turn on** button. When your browser asks whether to open the sidecar, allow it.
3. **Pair this browser with it.** On Windows, the first time the sidecar starts, it opens a small window with a **six-digit code**: press **Copy code** and paste it into the panel. If you've closed that window, or you're on a Mac, click **Show a pairing code** in the panel instead. That's it: after that, the sidecar has no window, and you turn it on and off from the chip.

The chip on the toolbar shows the status at a glance: *No sidecar* (none found), *Pair sidecar* (found, but not paired yet) or *Native* (paired and in use).

Why a code? The Sidecar only accepts connections from your own computer, and it won't take work from a web page until that page proves you're actually using it. The code is how you prove it. Each code works once and expires after ten minutes, and pairing one browser doesn't unpair another.

Pairing is per browser and per site address. If you edit in a different browser, or reach the site at a different address, you'll need to pair again.

Saving your work

The editor saves your project automatically, a couple of seconds after you stop editing. The project name at the top of the toolbar shows a `*` while there are unsaved changes. If you try to close the tab with unsaved work, or while a render is still running, the browser asks you to confirm first.

Save to Server stores the project — the arrangement, the trims, the titles and everything else — in your account, so you can pick it up on another computer. **Saved Projects** lists your saved projects.

A project isn't the video itself. It's the recipe: which clips, in what order, cut where. The video only exists once you export it.

Where your footage lives

Everything you import is copied into the browser's own storage, which is why your clips are still there when you reopen a project. The media panel shows how much of that storage is in use.

When the editor starts, it clears out any footage that no project uses anymore, so deleting a project eventually frees up the space. It only does this once it has the full list of projects, so it never removes anything based on a guess.

Opening a project somewhere else

A clip you brought in from the **Server** tab remembers which file it came from, so if you open the project on another computer or in another browser, the footage is downloaded again automatically. Small files just download. For anything larger than about 50 MB, you're asked first, and choosing **Later** is fine: the project still opens, and those clips wait until you're ready.

There are two things it can't do. A clip you imported directly from your own computer can't be downloaded again, because that file only exists where you put it. And if the file on the server has been replaced since you saved the project, the clip stays missing rather than being quietly linked to different footage — editing against the wrong footage is worse than a clip that's clearly missing.

In either case, right-click the clip and choose **Replace Media…** to pick the file yourself. Your choice is saved, so it's still there the next time you open the project.

A clip with missing footage stays on the timeline with all its trims, titles and edits intact, marked with a warning triangle.

It also stops the export, and tells you so. When you open the export window, the first thing you see is the reason, with the names of the affected clips. The editor won't render a video with a hole where that footage should be, so Export Now and Add to Queue stay turned off until you reconnect the clip or remove it. Otherwise the export would reach the missing clip partway through and stall there.

Working signed out

You can use the standalone editor without signing in, and quite a lot works that way: open files from your computer, edit them, render the result and save it back to your computer. All of that happens locally.

Signing in connects it to the site. The sign-in button is at the right-hand end of the toolbar. Until you sign in:

- the **Server** tab tells you to sign in and offers the same button, instead of showing an empty list (which would wrongly suggest you hadn't uploaded anything);
- **Save to Server** isn't available, because there's nowhere to save to;
- after an export, the destination choice still shows the server option, grayed out, so you can see it's there and what it needs.

So you can edit locally as much as you like, and sign in when you want to use your own uploaded footage or keep the result somewhere other than this computer. If your sign-in expires partway through, the editor tells you and keeps the rendered video — just sign in again and upload it again.

When something looks wrong

- **The editor says "Not loaded" and nothing imports.** Press **Initialize** and wait for *Ready*.
- **Export is grayed out.** It needs the engine to be Ready and at least one clip on the timeline. If the chip says it's busy, a background render is running; Export becomes available when that finishes.
- **A file downloaded but did not appear.** Downloading and placing are two separate clicks — click the card a second time.
- **Nothing is listed on the Server tab.** In the standalone editor, sign in first. On the site, the tab lists files you own or have been given access to; a file someone else hasn't shared with you won't be there.

GROUP ADMINISTRATION

Administering a Group

Settings, members, requests, and the decisions only owners and administrators make.

Written for: **Group owners & administrators**

This page is for owners and administrators of a group. Managers and members work on cases, but they don't configure the group itself.

Where the tabs are. On a computer, a group's sections — Details, Members, Cases, Settings and the rest — appear in the **menu card on the left** whenever you are inside the group, with **← Your groups** at the top. On a phone they are **tabs** along the top of the group's page. The sections and who can see them are the same either way, and this guide calls them tabs. When you open one of the group's events, the card switches to that event's own menu, with the group's name at the top to take you back.

Group settings

Everything a group can configure is on the **Settings** tab, and there is a lot of it: billing, hosted events, your venue, promotion, feed attribution, address display, media privacy, the kind of group you are, walking tours, the role new members start with, calendar event types, member titles, investigation duties and the duty eligibility matrix.

The row of buttons at the top of the tab jumps to each of those sections. They don't hide anything — it is still one page you can read from top to bottom — but they let you see at a glance whether the setting you want is on this screen, and jump straight to it.

The group's **Edit** screen — the button beside the group's name, not the Settings tab — holds its public identity: name, web address, contact details, and two switches worth understanding.

Accepting membership applications controls whether people can apply to join.

Your web address

Your group lives at `/o/your-address` — the link you put on a card, in a post, or in an email to a client. It can use lowercase letters, numbers and hyphens, like `ghost-squad`. Spaces, slashes and punctuation are refused, and a handful of words the site uses itself are reserved.

No two groups can share an address, and **you can change yours whenever you like**. When you do:

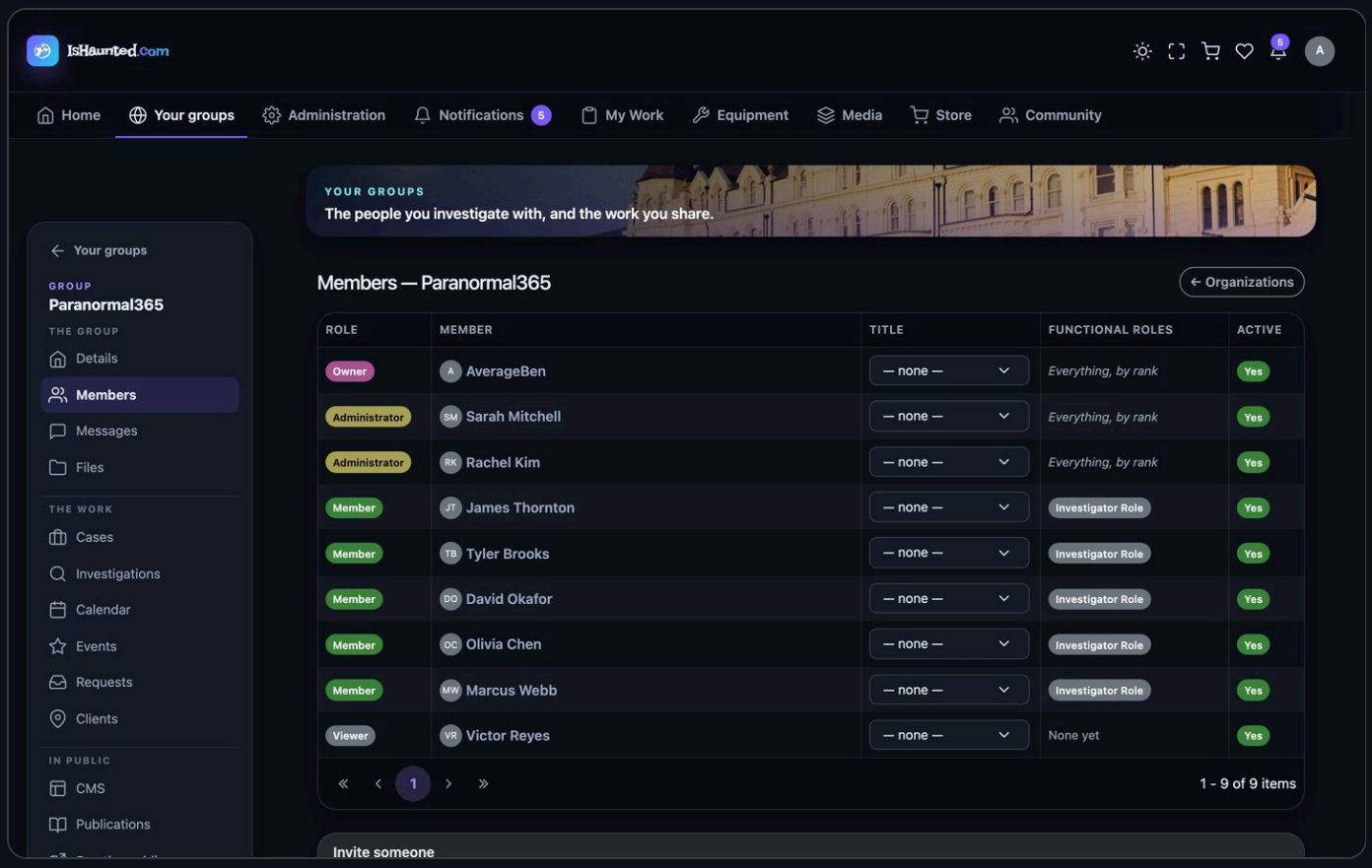
- **The old address keeps working.** Any link people have already shared still opens your pages. Visitors are sent on to the new address, so the next link they copy is the current one.

- **The old address stays yours.** No other group can ever take it, so a saved link will never lead someone to a different group.

So changing your address is safe. Still, try not to change it often, because the address is what people remember.

Let clients see members' private photos needs agreement from both sides. Turning it on doesn't share anything by itself; it only allows photos from members who have *also* opted in on their own profile. A group can't share its members' faces without their say, and a member can't override a group that has decided to keep its people anonymous to clients.

Members and roles



Members and their roles. Roles decide what each person may do inside the group.

People who have left do not appear here. When somebody closes their account, or has it closed for them, they drop off this list right away, since a closed account can't be given a role, invited, or asked to do anything. Everything they recorded for the group stays where it was, signed "A former member", so your group's records stay complete.

ROLE	TYPICALLY
Owner	Created the group. Full control.
Administrator	Configures the group and manages members.
Manager	Runs cases day to day.
Member	Works cases and attends investigations.
Viewer	Reads without changing anything.

A **Viewer** can read but never change anything, whatever roles or permissions they are given: roles can widen what they can *see*, never what they can do. They can read the calendar and the group's messages, but they can't add, move or delete an event, send a message, schedule or change an investigation, add to a timeline, or vote on a request. To let somebody contribute, make them a Member.

The roles every group starts with

Every group begins with seven ready-made roles — **Case Manager Role, Equipment Manager Role, CMS Manager Role, Client Manager Role, Content Manager Role, Historian Role, Secretary Role**. Each is a starting point you can edit, rename, or delete, just like a role you build yourself. Their names end in "Role" so they are never confused with member *titles* (the ladder below): a title says how senior somebody is, and a role says what they can do.

Every group also has an **Investigator Role**, which lets a member read the group's cases and investigations. An ordinary member needs it to do anything at all.

What new members start with

Settings → New members start as decides which role somebody gets the moment they join, whether you added them yourself or accepted their application. A new group starts with **Investigator Role**, which is what lets a member open the cases they are assigned to.

This matters more than it sounds. Below Administrator, a membership rank on its own opens nothing. A Manager, Member or Viewer with no role can be named on a visit roster and see the group's cases listed on their desk, but every one of those links will turn them away. Owners and administrators aren't affected, because their rank already opens everything.

You can set it to **Nothing** and hand out roles yourself. Groups created before this setting was added have it set to nothing, so nothing changed for them.

A change applies only to people who join **from then on**. It never changes the roles of people already in your group. To change what an existing member has, use their entry on the Members screen.

What role grants open today

Reading the group's cases and investigations depends on role grants, not just membership. Existing ordinary members were given the Investigator Role, so nothing changed for them. A member without any role that lets them read cases doesn't see the Cases and Investigations tabs at all. Owners and administrators always see everything.

Three sections of the role editor are now in effect: **Cases** (creating a case, and editing one you don't manage), **Client Requests** (accepting or declining what clients send in), and **Calendar** (event types, and managing other people's attendance). These grants only add access: owners and administrators keep everything they had, and members who hold the grant can now do the same things.

Only the group's owners and administrators can create roles, change what a role allows, and choose who holds it. In the role editor, each area has four columns: **Add**, **See**, **Change** and **Remove**.

Banners for work that blocks other people

When a client's investigation request or a membership application is waiting on your group, a banner appears under the site-wide announcement on every page. Only you and others whose permissions let them open that queue see it. Each banner names the group, shows how many items are waiting, and links straight to the tab where you deal with them. If you dismiss a banner, it stays hidden for the rest of your session, but it comes back when something new arrives.

Having a plan, and not having one

A group is free by **having no plan at all**, not by being on a free plan. There is no free group plan: an individual can be free, but a group can't.

With no plan, a group can do public work — public cases, public investigations, and results anyone can read. A plan lets it work with other people, take private-residence and client cases, and keep its own sessions private.

The price depends on how many members the group has. The **Billing** screen under Settings shows which band you are in and what it costs. If the price list has no charge for a group your size, that screen tells you there is nothing to buy, rather than offering you a plan for nothing.

After you pay on Stripe's page, or start a plan that a coupon fully covers, you see a short page saying your subscription went through. It takes you on to your group's **Billing** screen, where the receipt is, after a few seconds, or straight away with **Go to your group's billing**.

With no plan, work at a public place is public

This is the trade-off, and it matches how the field archive has always worked: what a free account records at a public location appears on that location's own page, where anyone can read it. One group's night at a landmark

is a single story. Records from eleven groups at the same landmark are worth having, and free accounts are what build them.

So for a group with no plan:

- A case you open is **public from the start**. The **Make Public** box on the Edit Case page is checked and can't be unchecked, and a note beside the box explains why.
- A visit to a public location is shared with **everyone**, and the narrower sharing choices are not offered.
- A session you publish to a place's archive can't be removed later.

None of this ever applies to a private residence. Somebody's home is client work, which belongs to paid plans, and only the client can agree to publishing what happens there. Not having a plan doesn't count as their consent.

A plan gives you control of your work: you choose what to publish, you can narrow a visit's audience later, and you can remove a published session from the archive. **Nothing that is already private changes.** A case that was private before your plan lapsed stays private, and you can keep saving it. The rule applies only to new work, just as the member limit never removes anyone already in your group.

Custom-role permissions and your plan

Each subscription plan includes custom-role permissions for a set of areas — cases, calendar, files, and so on. The **Pricing** page lists exactly which areas each plan includes, so you know what an upgrade gets you. Most plans include everything. When yours leaves an area out, the role editor shows it rather than hiding it:

- Sections your plan doesn't include are **grayed out with their toggles disabled**, under a note naming the areas and the plan.
- **Nothing is deleted.** Grants you set up in an excluded area are kept exactly as they were — the note shows how many — and they apply again as soon as a plan change includes that area. A downgrade pauses them; it never erases them.
- Saving works the same way: a save can change only the sections your plan includes, and everything else is kept as it was.

When a site administrator changes what a plan includes, groups on that plan are told. Newly included areas are announced right away. Removals arrive as a notice, and for paid groups that notice comes before the renewal that applies them. Area exclusions never affect owners and group administrators, just as role grants don't: they always hold every permission.

Member titles — the ladder

Titles are separate from roles. A **title** says how senior somebody is in the group; a **role** says what they can do. The two never mix. Giving somebody a grander title doesn't change what they can access, and a brand-new

member with the right role can do things a ten-year veteran without it can't.

Every group starts with the same five-rung ladder — **Probationary, Junior Investigator, Investigator, Senior Investigator, Lead Investigator** — and it is entirely yours to change: rename rungs, reorder them, add your own, or delete the ones you will never use, all under **Settings → Member titles**. Deleting a title simply clears it from anyone holding it; nobody loses any access, because titles never granted any.

Assign titles from the **Members** tab — each row has a title dropdown if you administer the group. A member's title shows as a badge beside their name on the roster. Someone who belongs to two groups holds a separate title in each, which is exactly how it should be: seniority is earned per group.

Investigation duties

Settings → Investigation duties holds the list of jobs your group hands out for each visit. Every group starts with Lead Investigator, Equipment, Equipment Assist, Evidence Collection and Documentation, and you can rename them, add your own, or retire any of them. A duty marked **one holder** (like the lead) can be held by only one person per visit; assigning it to someone takes it away from the previous holder.

Equipment is split into two jobs because a newer member can help with the gear long before they are ready to run it.

Who may hold which duty

Below the duty list is a grid, with your titles across the top and your duties down the side. Check the titles each duty is open to. A new group starts with this filled in: an Associate can handle documentation and assist with equipment, a Junior Investigator can also collect evidence, an Investigator can run the equipment, and the Lead Investigator duty is open to your two most senior titles.

The grid is a guideline, not a hard rule. Whoever manages a visit can override it by choosing *Assign anyway*, and the assignment is marked as an exception. If a senior member calls in sick, a capable junior can step up without the group falling back to organizing by text message.

There are two exceptions.

Only an owner or administrator can override the grid for a duty that has something checked under *On the night*. Making somebody the point of contact, or letting them hand out the other duties, gives them real authority, including the power to make exceptions of their own. Whoever is running the visit can still assign the duty to anyone the grid already allows; only overriding the grid needs an owner or administrator.

Check *no exceptions* on the few duties where the title is a real qualification rather than a preference — certified equipment, or being the client's point of contact inside their home. Then nobody can override the grid during the visit, not even an owner. To change it, you change this grid, so the decision is deliberate and visible rather than made on the spot at a site.

A duty whose row you haven't filled in says so, and uses the older **minimum title** setting on the duty itself instead — for example, "asks for Investigator or above". That setting works the same way with a single threshold, and it still works as before for groups already using it.

On the night

Two of the columns aren't about who can hold the duty, but about what holding it lets somebody do, **for that one visit only**:

- **Point of contact** — the person to call about this visit. It shows on the roster so the group and the client can see who is responsible that night.
- **Hands out duties** — can assign and remove the other duties on this visit, but can't change anything else about it.

Both end when the visit does. Duties never grant lasting permissions: what somebody can do in the group as a whole is decided by roles, under **Roles & permissions**. A duty can only add access the person's roles don't already give them, and only for that one visit. It can never take access away.

The Investigations tab

This tab maps and lists every visit the group has run, including ones that aren't part of a client case. Every member can see it, not only administrators, because knowing where the group has worked is ordinary team knowledge.

Schedule an investigation books a visit with no case behind it. What the group finds there is shared under the same rules as any other investigation.

Who can change an investigation

Any member can *read* an investigation and respond for themselves — their own RSVP and their own arrival. Fewer people can change the investigation itself. Any one of these is enough:

- whoever scheduled it
- the case manager, for a visit attached to a case
- whoever is leading that particular visit
- group owners and administrators
- anyone the group has granted the **Investigation** permission under **Roles**

That last option is the one you control as an administrator. Give a role the *Update* action on **Investigation**, assign somebody that role, and they can edit any of the group's investigations without becoming an administrator of everything else.

Leading a visit is not a rank. It is set for each investigation, in the **Lead** column of the investigation's team list, and it ends with that visit. Only one person leads at a time — naming a new lead takes it from the old one — and the current lead can hand it over, for example when they have to leave partway through the night. For somebody senior enough to lead every visit, use the permission above. For somebody leading just one Saturday, use the lead flag, which no longer matters by Sunday.

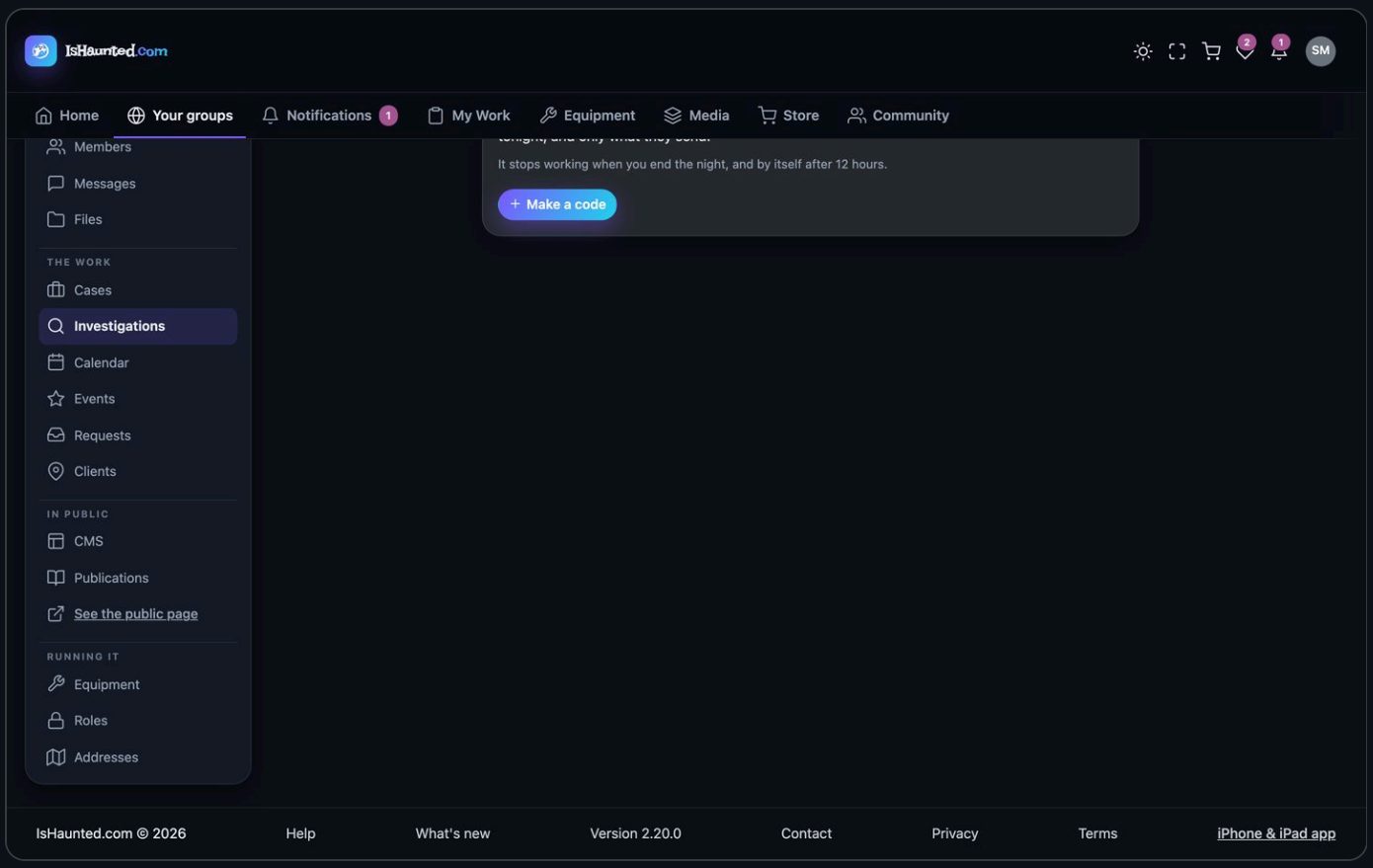
Guest codes

A phone on the night that isn't yours. Some nights, the people with useful phones aren't in your group: someone who walks up during a tour, a homeowner's relative who came along, a volunteer somebody brought, a class on an open night. Without a guest code, getting their photos and recordings means inviting them, waiting for an email, and adding them to something.

A **guest code** replaces all of that with a sheet you hold up.

Open **Investigations**, find the visit, and press **Guest code**. You get a square code to scan, with a short code — something like `H4KP–9RQT` — printed beside it. Show it on a tablet, hold up a phone, or print it and pin it to the gate.

Anyone who scans it is asked to sign in, and then they are part of tonight's investigation.



What a guest can and cannot do

A guest code is not a way into your group. Somebody holding one can:

- send you photographs, audio, video and readings against **this one investigation**
- see what **they** sent

They can't see the case, the client, the address, or what anyone else recorded, and they can't see anything at all once the night is over. A guest code never turns into membership: when the code stops working, so does everything it gave them.

Ending the night, and stopping one person

These are two different buttons.

New code prints a fresh sheet and retires the old one — use it when a sheet was left behind on a bar table. Everyone who already scanned the old code *keeps working*, because they are still there with you, and cutting them off isn't the fix.

End the night stops the code and every pass it gave out, all at once.

To stop **one** phone, use the cross beside that person in **Working tonight**. Everyone else carries on, and you don't have to reprint anything. What they already sent stays — this stops them adding more, but it doesn't erase anything.

If the code has run out

A code stops working on its own after about half a day, and never lasts more than a day, whatever you set. That way an old sheet can't open anything months later. Press **New code** and show the new one.

Somebody who has just installed the app

This is what the short code is for. If someone scans the square code without the app installed, their phone goes to the App Store, and the newly installed app can't tell what was scanned. So ask them to open the app, or go to the address on the sheet, and type the short code instead.

Being found by clients

A client looking for help searches by where they are. Your group appears in that search only when all three of these are true. You'll find the first two on the **Clients** tab beside Requests.

- **You are taking client cases.** New groups set this when they are created. A group that isn't taking cases is left out of client search entirely, which is what you want if you only work on your own investigations.
- **You have an operating area.** This is a town or city and a radius. Without it, the site can't tell whether you are near anybody, so it can't suggest you to anyone.

- **The group is listed.** The Unlisted setting is on the **Edit** screen. It keeps you out of search, browse and nearby results — including client search.

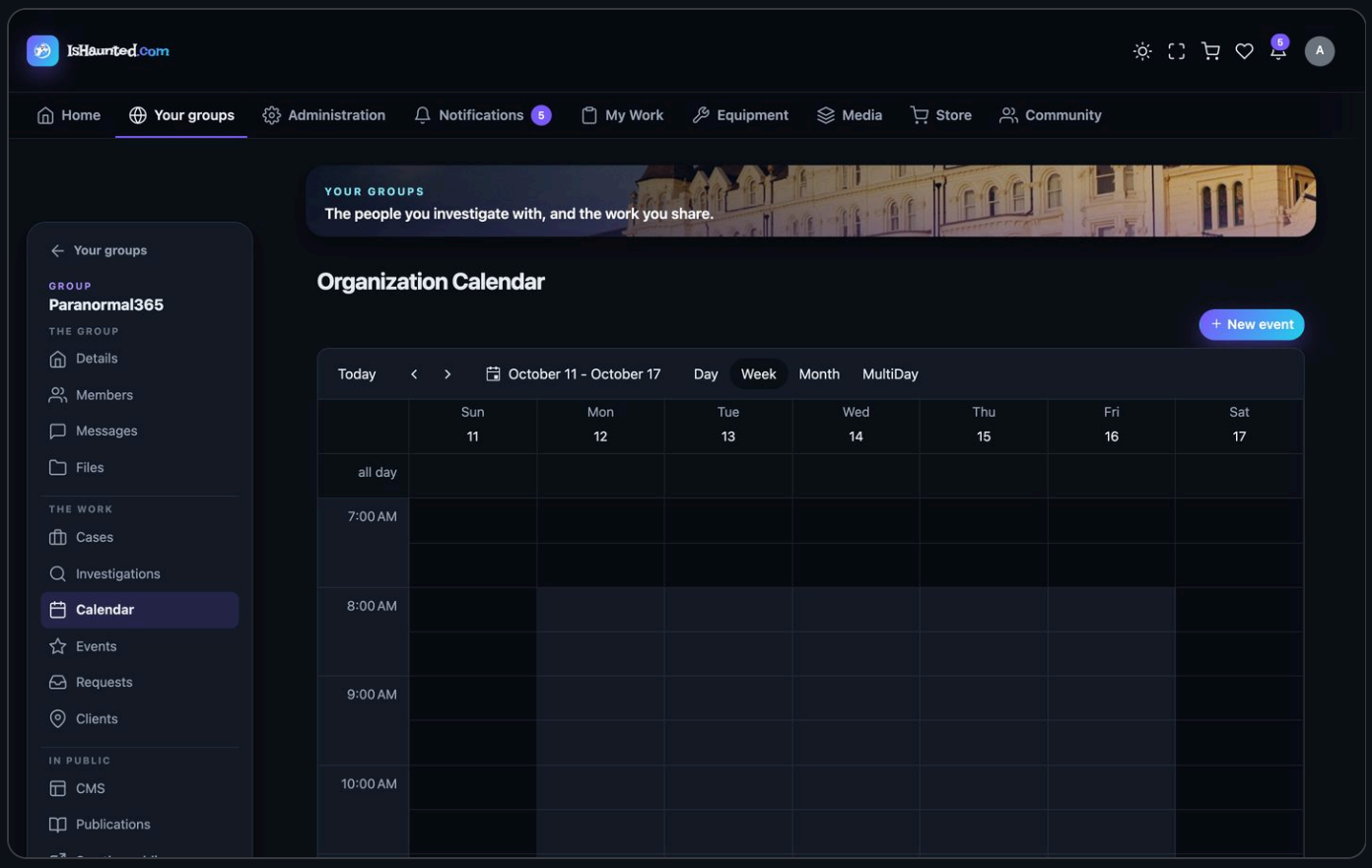
You can also choose whether to **accept clients outside your area**. Those clients still see you, listed below the groups whose area covers them.

If you are taking cases but one of the other two is missing, a notice at the top of the group page tells you. That is the most common reason a group waits a long time for its first request.

Incoming requests

Client requests arrive under the group's **Requests**. Mark one as under review while you decide. If you decline, the client is told, and they can send the request to another group without rewriting it.

The group calendar



The calendar shows investigations and the group's own events.

The group's **Calendar** holds meetings, training, and anything else with a time attached. Investigations are scheduled from the case they belong to, not here.

Moving an event. Drag an event to another day or time, or drag its end to make it longer or shorter. A line above the calendar tells you where it moved, with an **Undo** button. To move a repeating event, use its editor instead, because dragging one date would move every date in the series. Deleting an event — with the ✕ on it or **Delete** in its editor — asks you to confirm first.

Where it happens. Type a location, or pick one of the group's saved addresses. A saved address is better: if you correct it once, every event held there is corrected too. You can also add a **meeting link** — paste a Zoom, Teams or Meet join link. A short link like `zoom.us/j/123` works just as well as the full URL.

Repeating events. The **Repeats** list covers the usual patterns — daily, weekly, monthly, and so on. For a pattern the list doesn't cover, **Custom** accepts an iCal rule directly (`FREQ=WEEKLY;BYDAY=TU`).

Invites. A public event is already open to the whole group, so invites appear only on events that aren't public. Check members from the list, or type an email address to invite somebody outside the group. The lookup only finds addresses that people have published *and confirmed* on their own profile — never the private address they sign in with. If an address isn't found, the person either has no account or hasn't published that address. Ask them for the right one rather than guessing at another spelling.

Invites are just invitations. To assign work, use investigations.

To take a member off a private event's list, untick their name and press **Save**.

Who's coming. When you open an event that has people on its list, the editor shows each of them and their answer. If somebody tells you their answer, record it with the buttons beside their name: **Mark as coming**, **Mark as not coming**, or **Mark as not answered**. You're offered the ones that change something; a guest who said maybe can be marked as coming or as not coming. **Remove** takes somebody off the list, after asking you first; use it for a guest invited by email, who has no box to untick. These save straight away. People marked as coming get a reminder before the event starts. Anyone who can change the group's calendar can do this; for a tour date, places are approved on the date's sign-ups page instead. If something can't be changed, the reason shows under the list.

A place for a public event. Under **Where (a place)**, type part of the place's name or its town and press Enter or **Search**. Only public places are listed, because a public event can't be held at somebody's home.

Calendar event types

Under **Settings**, *Calendar Event Types* is the list of choices in the calendar's **Type** dropdown — Investigation, Meeting, Training, or whatever your group actually does. A group with no types can still create events; they just won't have a type.

Each type has a name, an optional color and icon, and a sort order that sets its place in the dropdown. Only owners and administrators can change the list.

Clear **Active** to retire a type. It disappears from the dropdown for new events but stays on events that already use it, which is almost always what you want. Deleting a type removes it from those events as well, but leaves their date and title as they are.

The Equipment tab

There are two lists, because a group deals with two kinds of gear.

The group's gear is equipment the group itself owns. Every member can see the list, but adding, editing and deleting items needs the **Equipment** permission, and so does seeing serial numbers.

Each piece tracks who has it, when it was last serviced, whether it is currently faulty, and its photos. **Held by** can be set by hand, because gear often changes hands in a parking lot without anyone opening the app. The holder must be an active member.

History on a piece opens two things: a full record of everything that has happened to it — loans, requests for more time, service and faults, newest first — and the service log, where you add new entries.

Anyone can read the service log; adding an entry needs the Equipment permission. The entry type you choose also updates the item:

ENTRY	WHAT IT DOES TO THE ITEM
Serviced	Moves its last-serviced date
Fault reported	Marks the piece faulty, and the note becomes the reason
Fault fixed	Clears the fault

The entry and its consequence are saved together, so the log never disagrees with the piece it describes. Entries are kept — fixing a fault does not erase the report of it.

Once a piece has any loan or service history, you can't delete it; you are asked to **retire** it instead, using the button in the item editor. Retired gear is removed from borrowing, from the public catalog and from the group list, but its full history stays readable. You can put it back in service the same way. This keeps the record of a serial-numbered item from being lost.

Members' shared gear is the second list: equipment members own personally and have chosen to show this group. It is read-only here, because it belongs to its owner. No permission is needed to see it, since sharing it was the owner's choice. Serial numbers stay private to their owners, even here.

The **Borrowing** column says whether a piece can be borrowed at all. That is a separate choice from sharing it — a member can let the group know they own something without offering to lend it. Whether a piece is lent to the group or only to individuals is shown when you ask to borrow it.

A shared piece disappears from this tab if its owner leaves the group. Their sharing choice is saved, so it comes back if they rejoin.

The two equipment permissions

Under **Roles**, equipment has two entries. The second is listed under the first because it covers less:

- **Equipment** — manage what the group owns: add and edit gear, upload its photos, keep its service log, set who is holding a piece, and see serial numbers. Any member can view the list without it.
- **Equipment Checkouts** — run the loans desk: approve and deny borrowing requests, hand gear over and check it back in.

They are separate so you can put someone in charge of loans without also putting them in charge of the catalog. Deciding what the group buys and owns, and lending out what it already has, are different jobs, often done by different people. Granting **Equipment** does not grant **Equipment Checkouts**.

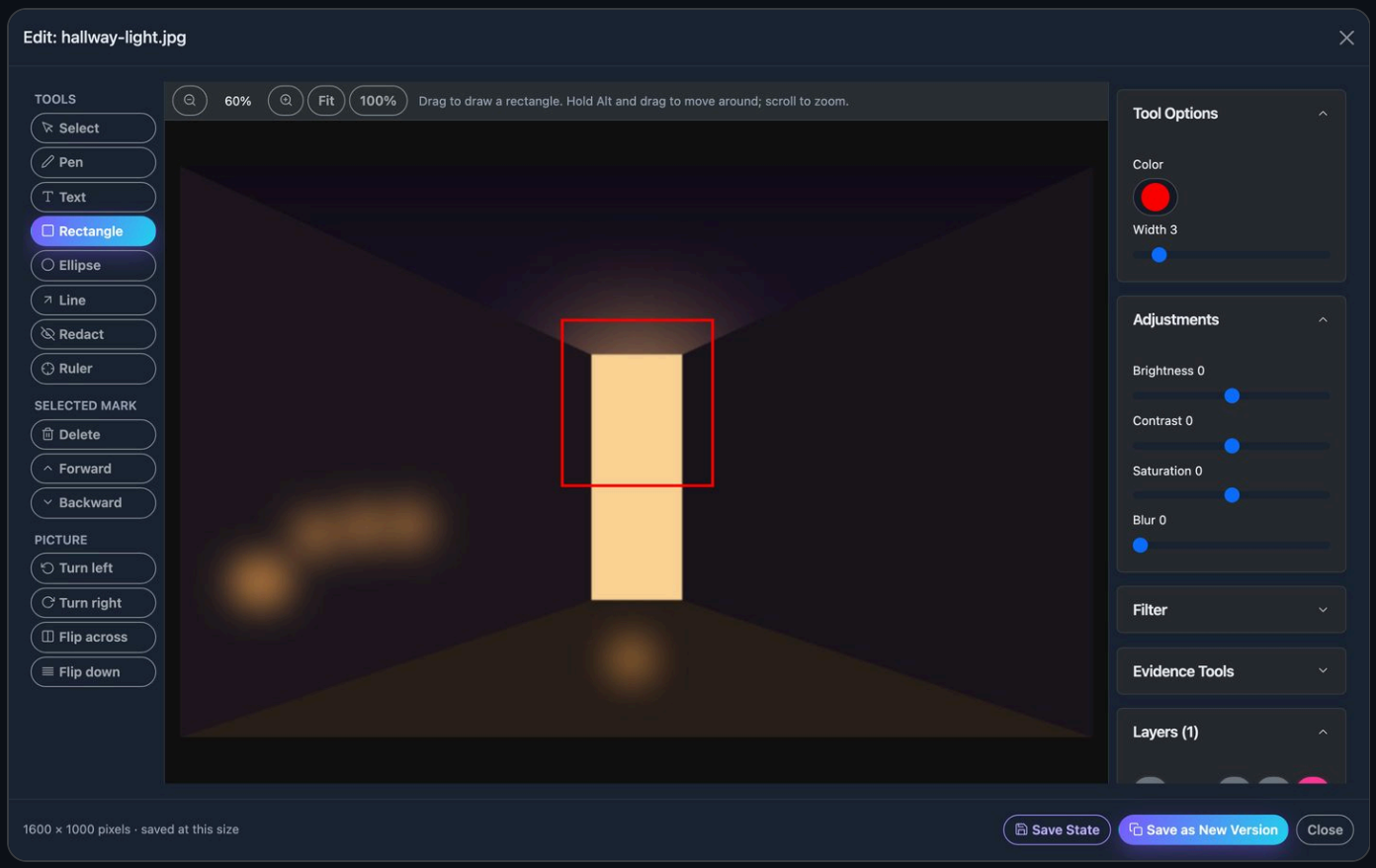
Neither permission covers a member's personal gear. A loan of somebody's own equipment is always approved by its owner.

The Files tab

This is the group's file library. Upload files directly, or bring in a member's own file with **Share from User**. That button opens a picker listing every file the group can copy — first the files their owners have shared with your group, then public files — with search, a type filter, and thumbnail or list views. Choosing one copies it into the group's library. Shared files arrive **private by default**, and someone with publish permission has to approve them before they appear publicly. The original still belongs to its owner: only the owner can delete it, and removing the group's copy never affects the member's own file.

Editing a photo

A photo in the Files tab has an **Edit image** button. It opens the photo editor across the whole screen, with the photo fitted to the space and its real size shown at the bottom.



- **Zoom** with the buttons above the photo or by scrolling over it. **Fit** shows the whole photo again, and **100%** shows it pixel for pixel.
- **Move around** a zoomed photo by dragging it with **Select**. With any other tool chosen, hold **Alt** and drag.
- **Tools** each say what they do. The line above the photo explains how to use the selected tool, and it stays selected until you pick another. **Ruler** measures in the photo's own pixels, and **Redact** blacks out anything you drag over.
- **Turn left** and **Turn right** turn the whole photo, along with anything you have drawn on it.
- **Adjustments**, **Filter** and **Evidence Tools** are on the right. Everything you add is listed under **Layers**, where you can hide it, fade it or delete it.

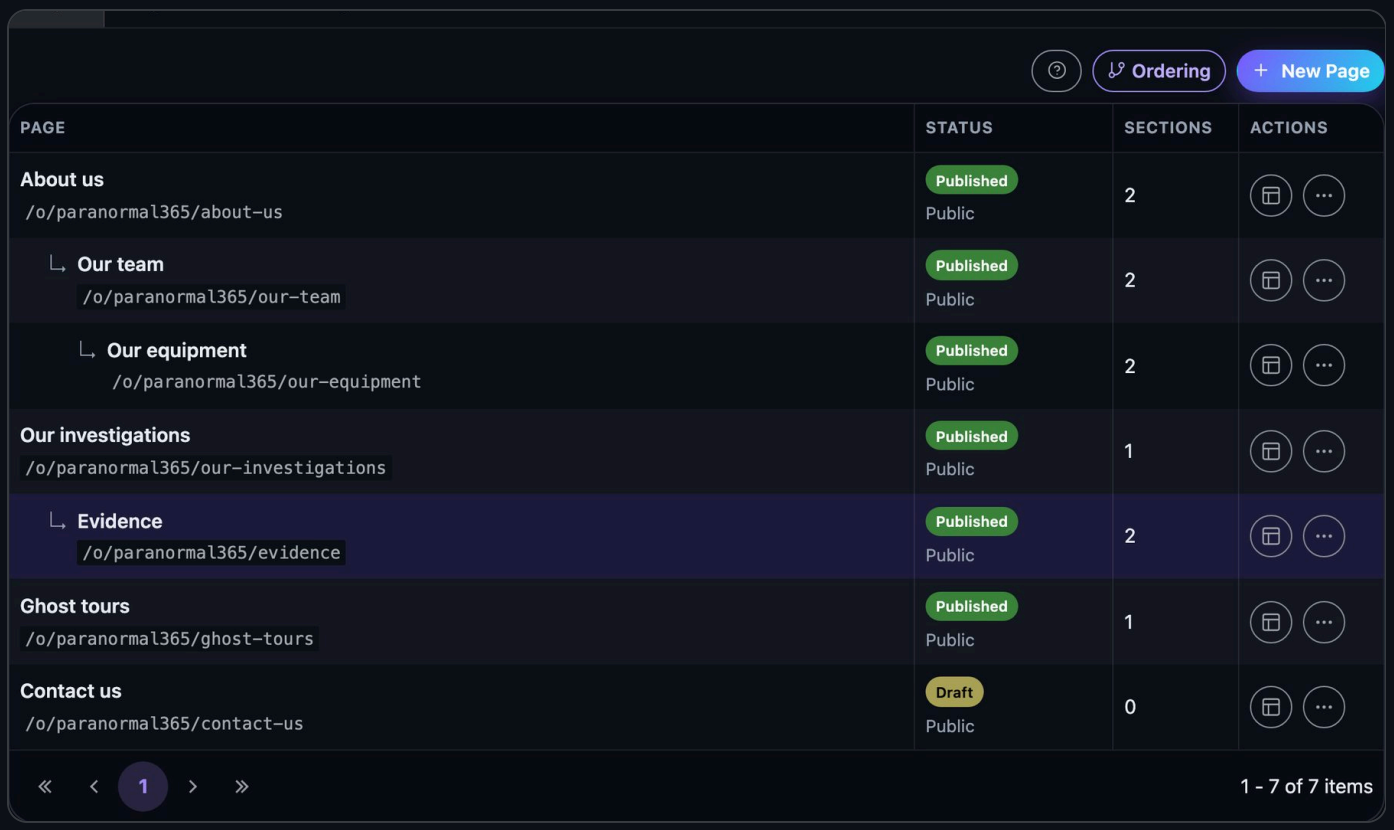
Save as New Version keeps the original untouched and saves the edited photo beside it at the photo's full size. A JPEG stays a JPEG.

Save State keeps your work without making a new photo: your marks, the last adjustment or filter, and how the photo was turned. The next time you open that photo in the editor, it comes back as you left it. The photo itself is not changed.

Only the person who owns a photo can save work on it or save a new version. For a photo that belongs to a group, that is the group's owners and administrators. Site administrators can too. Anyone else who opens the editor is told the edit wasn't saved.

Editing your public pages

The CMS editor has a built-in walkthrough. The ? button beside New Page runs it at any time, and it runs on its own the first time you edit.



Your public pages, listed in the same order as your menu, with each page indented under the page it belongs to. Nobody can see a page until you publish it.

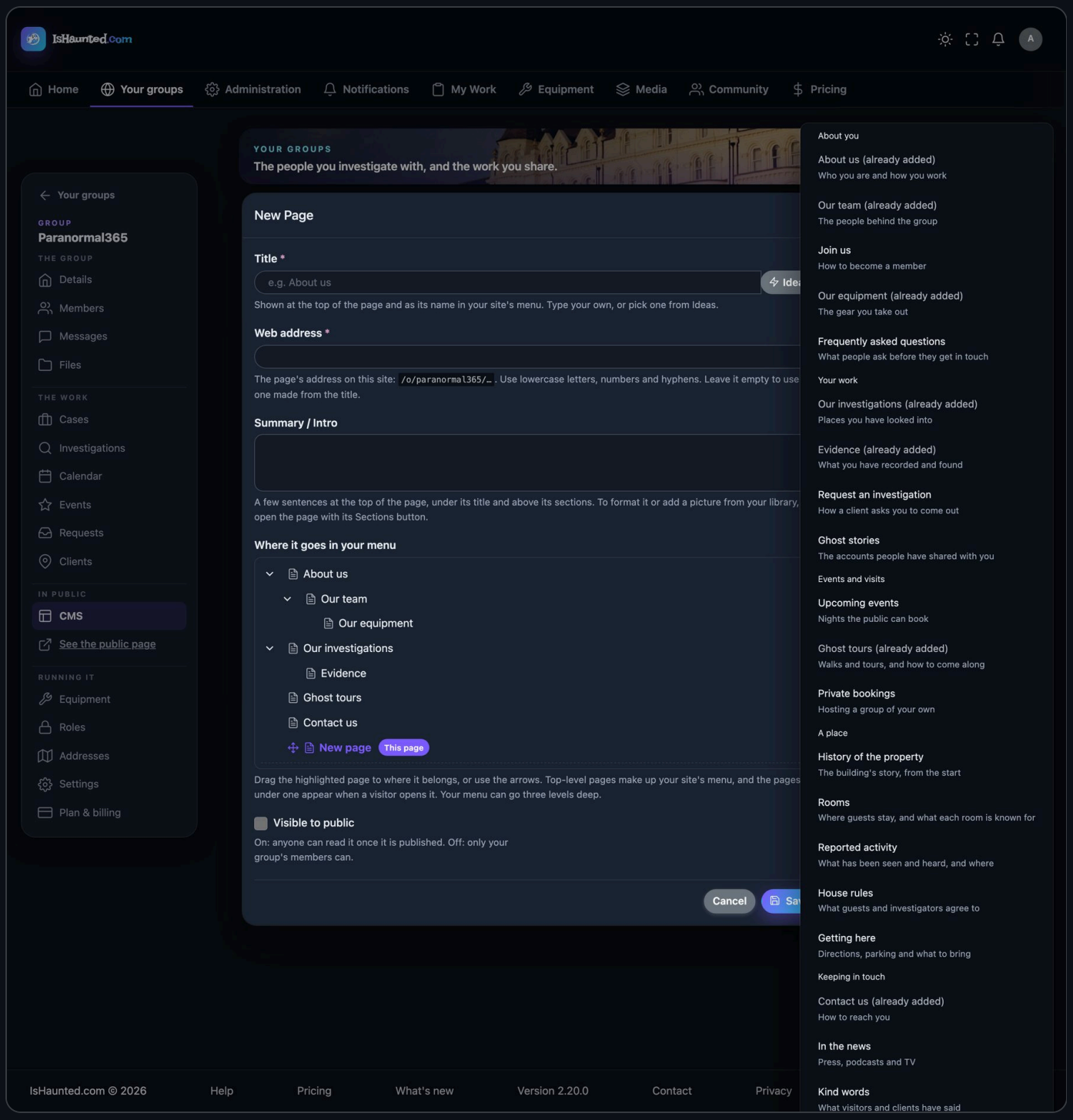
Pages you build under **CMS** appear on your group's public site. Two separate things control what visitors see.

Published decides whether visitors can see the page at all. **Drafts** decide whether visitors see your edits while you are still making them.

Every box in the editor has a short note under it explaining what it does: what the title is used for, where the address leads, or who a switch lets in.

Making a page

New Page asks for a title. The title is used twice: as the heading at the top of the page and as the page's name in your site's menu. Type your own, or press **Ideas** for a list of pages groups like yours usually have — *About us*, *Our investigations*, *Ghost tours*, *History of the property*, *House rules* and more. An idea you already have a page for is grayed out.



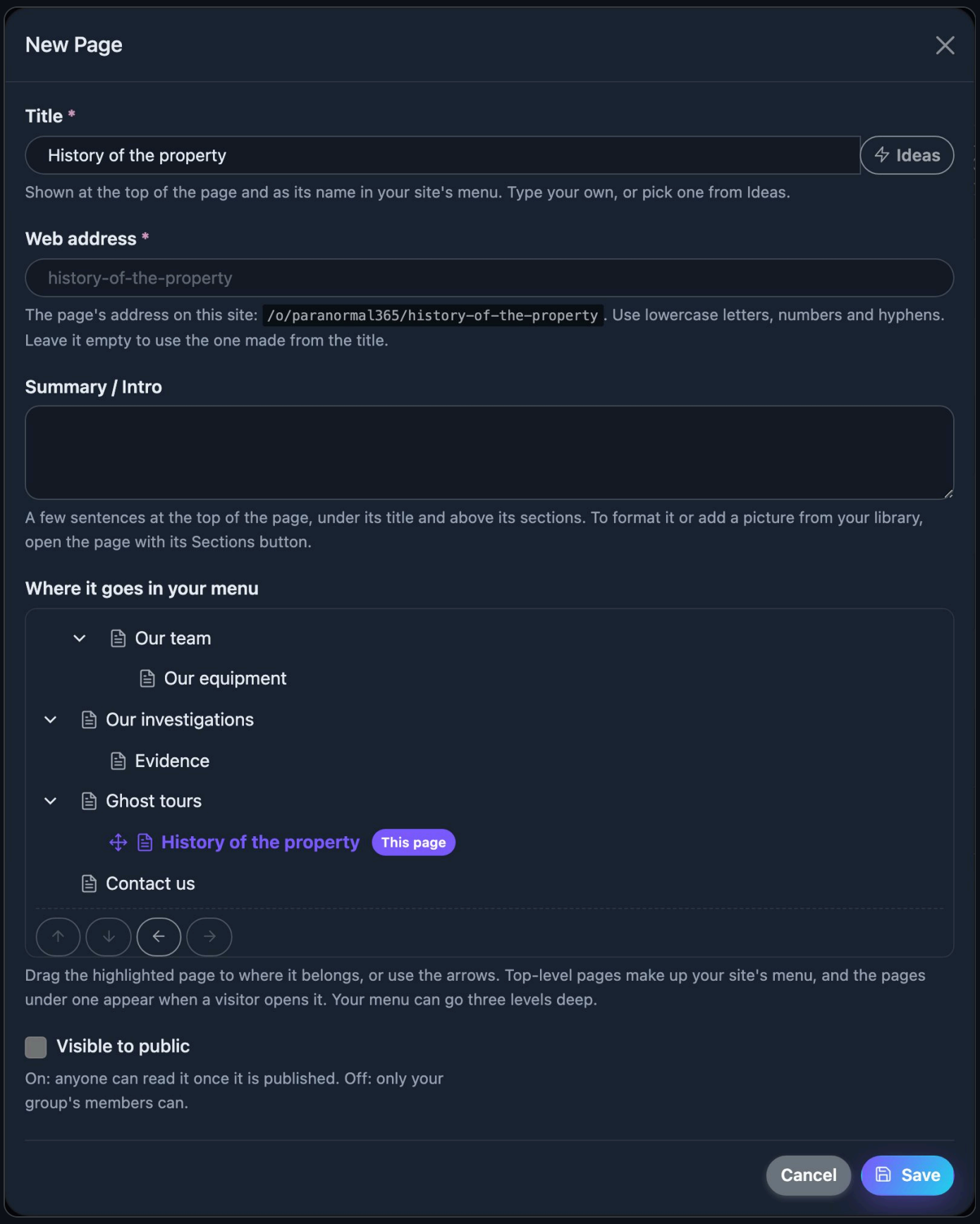
Ideas, grouped by what the page is about. Picking one fills in the title; you can still change it.

The address box suggests one made from the title as you type (*Our Team* becomes `our-team`). Leave it empty to use that, or type your own. Once a page exists, renaming it doesn't change its address, so links people have saved keep working.

Summary / Intro is a few sentences shown at the top of the page, under its title and above its sections.

Where it goes in your menu shows all your pages as a tree, with the new one highlighted. Drag it where you want it, or use the arrows under the tree: up and down move it among the pages beside it, left takes it up a

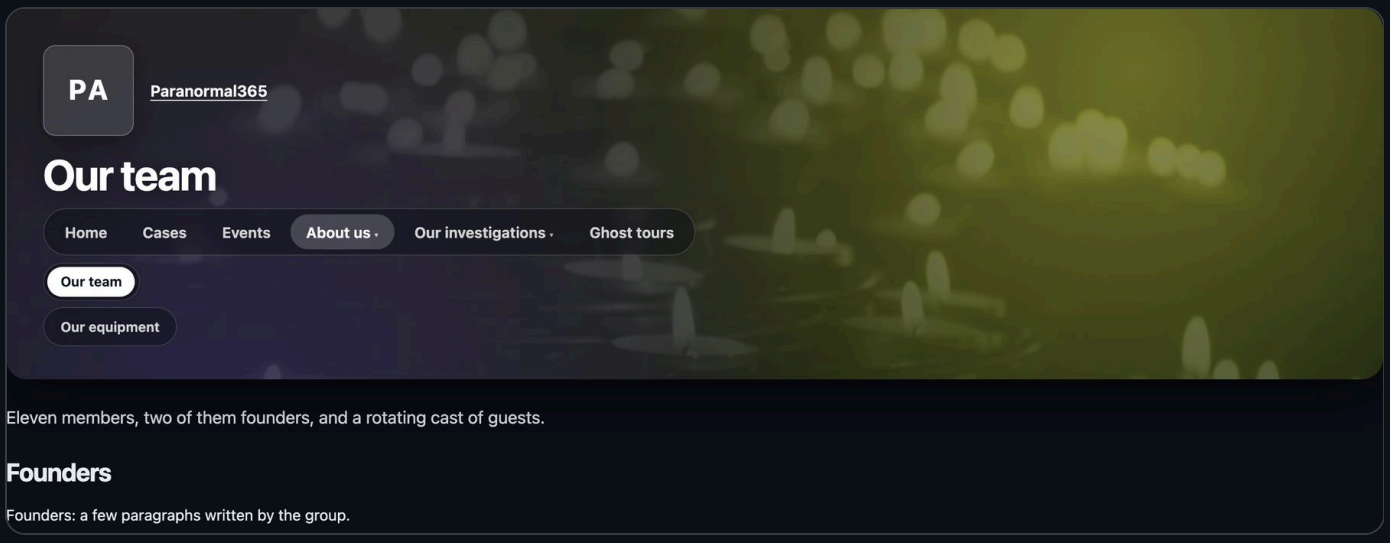
level, and right puts it under the page just above it.



The new page placed under Ghost tours. Nothing moves until you press Save.

How deep your menu goes

Your menu has **three levels and no more**: a top-level page, a page under it, and a page under that. Top-level pages are the links across your site's menu. Open one that has pages under it, and those appear as a second row of links beneath the menu. Open one of those, and any pages under it appear in a third row. If a move would create a fourth level, it isn't allowed, and a message explains why — both in the tree and when you save.



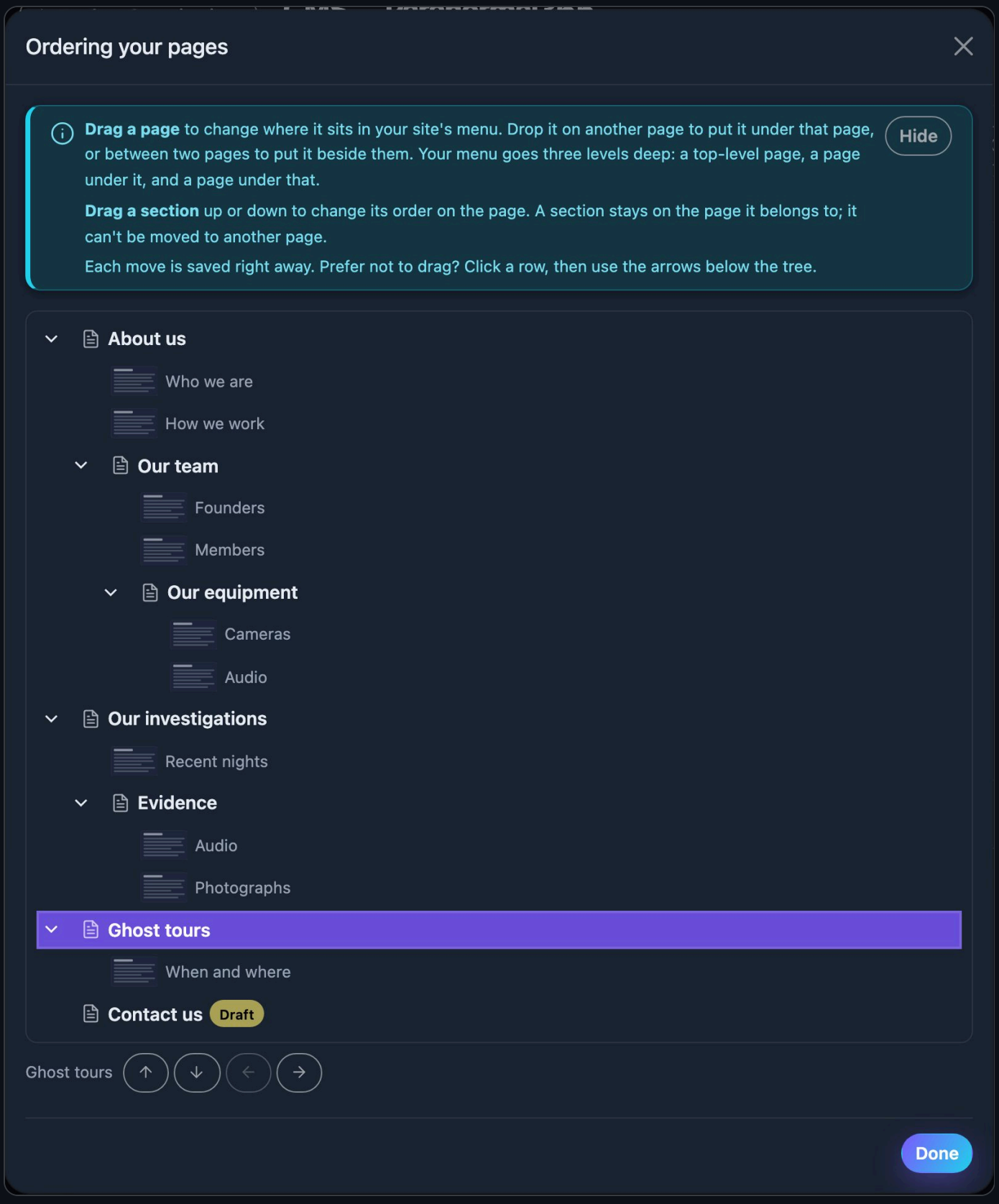
Our team sits under About us, and Our equipment under Our team. The page's intro comes first, then its sections.

Ordering your whole site

Ordering, beside **New Page**, opens your whole site as one tree: every page, and each page's sections under it.

- **Drag a page** onto another page to put it under that page, or between two pages to put it beside them. Pages can go anywhere the three-level limit allows.
- **Drag a section** up or down to change its order on the page. A section can't be moved to another page, because what it shows (a case's photos, an event) belongs to its page.
- **Can't drag?** Click a row and use the arrows under the tree.

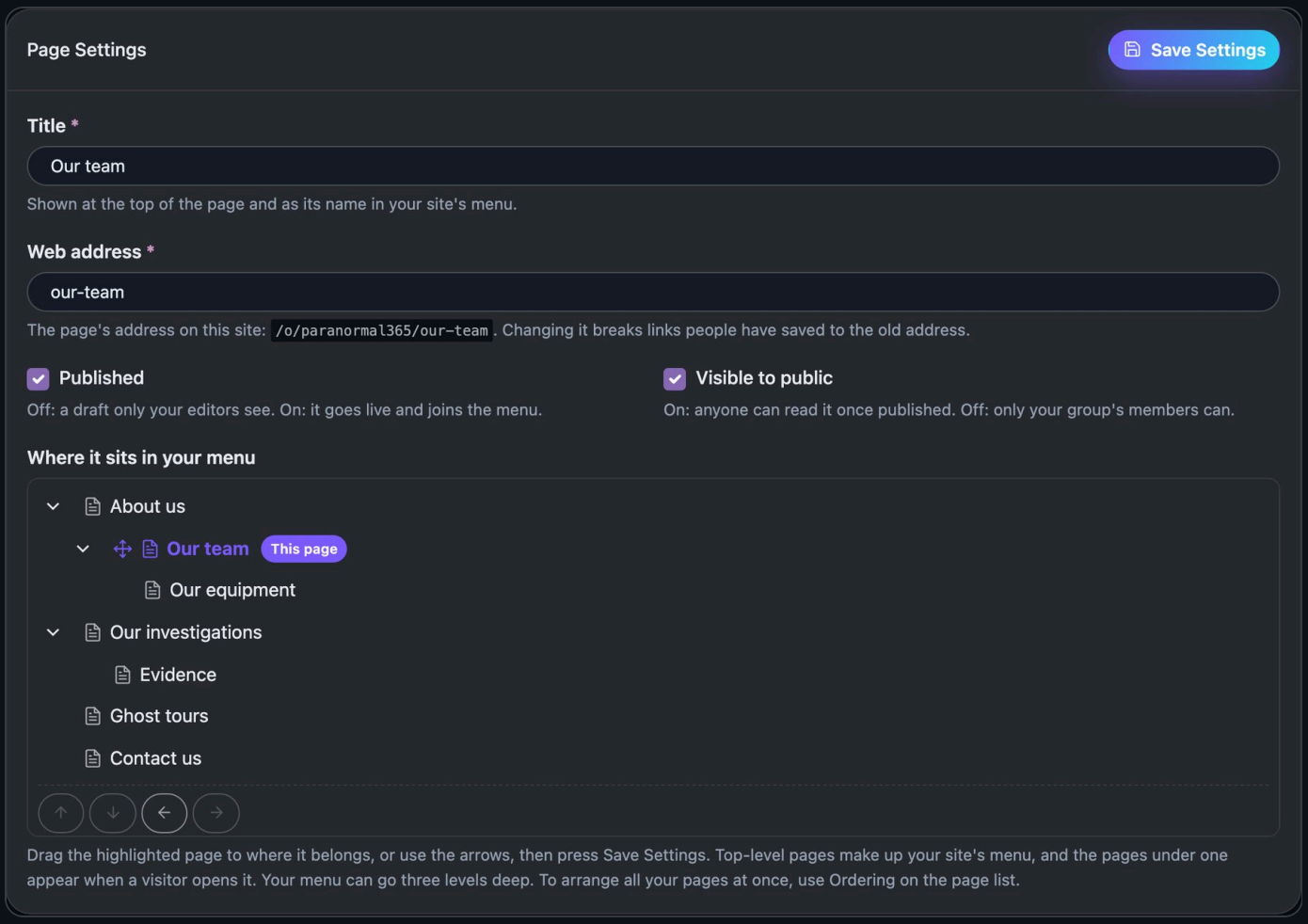
Each move is saved as soon as you make it, and the line at the bottom confirms it. There is no Save button, only **Done**. You can hide the tips at the top with **Hide** and bring them back with **How this works**.



Ordering: pages and their sections. Ghost tours is selected. It is already at the top level, so the arrow that would move it up a level is grayed out.

Editing a page

The **Sections** button on a page's row opens its editor. **Page Settings** holds the title, address, the two switches, and the same menu tree as the New Page window. Drag the page where you want it, then press **Save Settings**. To arrange everything at once, use **Ordering** instead.

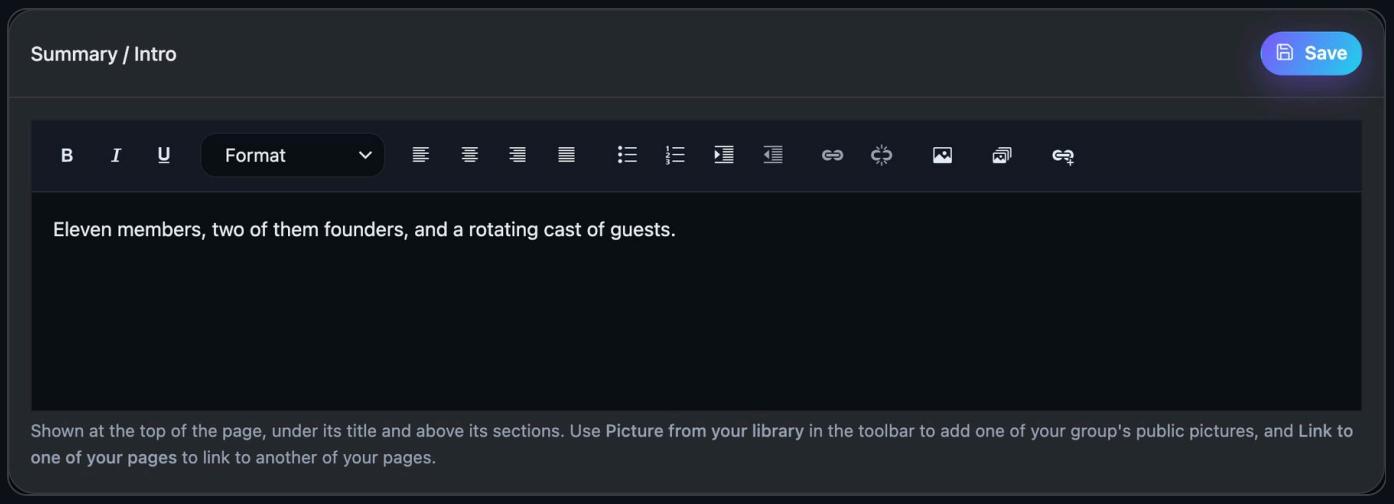


A page's settings, with this page highlighted in the menu tree.

Summary / Intro is a full editor. Two buttons at the end of its toolbar save you from hunting for things:

- **Picture from your library** adds one of your group's pictures where the cursor is. Only public pictures are offered, because a members-only picture would show up for you but appear broken to every visitor.
- **Link to one of your pages** lists your other pages. Select some words first to turn them into the link, or just pick a page and its title is inserted as the link.

The ordinary link button is still there for addresses on other sites. The same two buttons are on every **Text** section.



The last two toolbar buttons: a picture from your library, and a link to one of your pages.

Adding a section

Add Section opens the section form and scrolls it into view. Each kind of section is shown as a small picture of its layout, with a sentence on what it is for, so you can choose by how you want the page to look rather than by name.

New section

Close

What kind of section? *

Text
Words, headings, lists and pictures, written in the editor. Ready-made blocks give you a start.

Image or banner
One wide picture from your library, with words for screen readers and an optional link.

Contact details
Your group's public emails, phone numbers, websites and addresses, kept up to date for you.

File gallery
Public pictures, videos and recordings from your files, as a slideshow, plus files to download.

Our members
The members who agreed to be listed, with their photos and titles.

Our cases
Cards for the cases you choose. A client appears only by the alias they chose, never their name.

Our investigations
Cards for the investigations you choose, with what you found. Exact addresses are never shown.

Photos from a case
Pictures from a case's public timeline. If an entry is made private later, its picture comes off the page automatically.

An event: dates and ask for a place
The card visitors use to ask for a place at one of your published events.

An event's program
An event's sessions by night, with rooms and places left, kept up to date for you.

An event's pictures
The photo wall from one of your events.

An event's evidence
The evidence you accepted from one of your events, with the most positive votes first, kept up to date for you.

An event's venue
Where the event is held: the place on a map, the building's story and its rooms.

Custom HTML
Your own HTML, for anything the other kinds can't do. Forms, scripts and styles are removed when you save.

Each picture shows roughly how that kind of section is laid out. You can't change the kind later, so pick the one you want.

Section title (optional)

Who comes out with us

A heading shown above the section on the page. Leave it empty for none.

Visible

Off hides it from visitors without deleting it.

Content

+ Add a block | No saved blocks | Save as ours

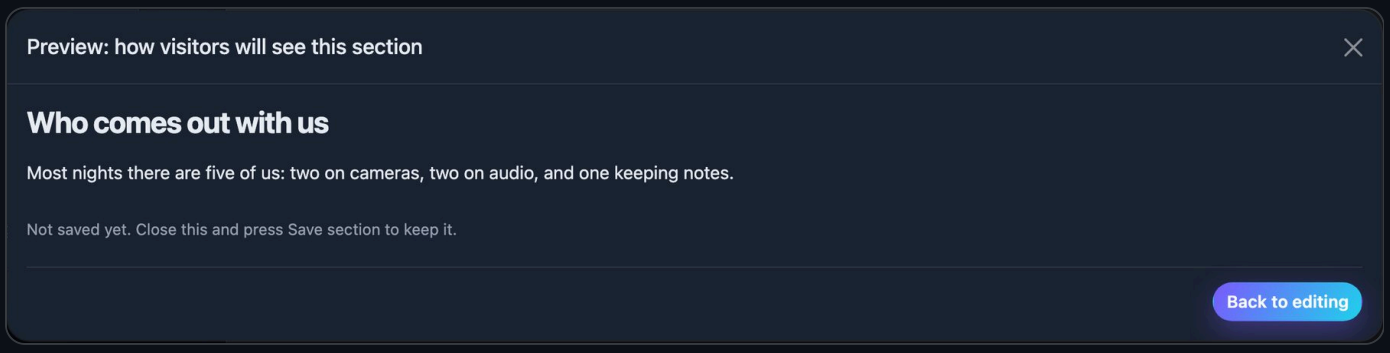
B I U Paragraph

Most nights there are five of us: two on cameras, two on audio, and one keeping notes.

This is what visitors read. Blocks from **Add a block** go at the end; move them where you want them and replace the placeholder text. Use **Picture from your library** and **Link to one of your pages** in the toolbar to add your group's public pictures and links to your other pages.

The kinds of section as pictures. Below them: the section's heading, whether visitors see it, and its content.

When you have filled it in, **Preview** (just before **Cancel**) shows the section exactly as a visitor will see it, drawn the same way the public page draws it. Previewing doesn't save anything; close the preview and press **Save section** to keep it.



The preview of a Text section, before it is saved.

Contact details, files and members

Three kinds of section fill themselves in from what your group already keeps, and keep up with it:

- **Contact details** shows the emails, phone numbers, websites and addresses your group marked public in its settings. Check the kinds you want. Anything private never shows, and an address shows only as much as its own setting allows: the street only when you chose to show the full address, otherwise just the town.
- **File gallery** shows public files you choose from your group's files. Pictures go in a slideshow, videos and recordings in their own rows, and anything else as a file to download. Use the arrows to put them in order.
- **Our members** lists members with their public photo and, if you like, their title. It can only list people who agreed: each member decides for themselves, from **Profile** → **About** → **Your groups' public pages**. Choose **Everyone who has agreed to be listed** and people who agree later appear by themselves, or pick the people to show. The list shows who hasn't agreed, so you can see why someone is missing.

Drafts

When you edit a page that is **not** published, your changes apply directly. Nobody else can see it yet, so there is nothing to protect.

A page that **is** published works differently. When you open it, you will be offered **Work on a draft instead**. If you accept, your changes go into a copy, and the live page stays exactly as it was until you press **Publish changes**. Until then, visitors see the old version, and you can press **Discard draft** to throw your changes away and leave the live page as it is.

A page has only one draft at a time. If a colleague has already started one, you'll see a note with a link to open it, so you don't end up with a second copy nobody knows about.

Publishing keeps the page's address and its permissions. The live page is updated rather than replaced, so links to it keep working.

Page addresses

A page's address is the last part of its web address — `/o/your-group/about`. Keep it short and lowercase, since it is what people copy and share.

A few words are reserved by the site itself — **cases** and **events** for now, plus some saved for future features. A page can't use one of them, because the site would show its own page at that address instead of yours. If you try, you'll be told which word is reserved and offered an alternative — "our-cases" rather than "cases".

If an older page is marked **Unreachable** in the list, it was made before the site checked for these words. Rename it and it will start working.

Pictures on a page

You can put a picture in a page's intro or in a Text section, using **Picture from your library** in the editor's toolbar, or across the full width of the page as an **Image or banner** section. A banner can also link somewhere: type an address, or pick one of your own pages from **Your pages** beside the box.

An **Image or banner** section uses a picture from your group's files. **Choose an image** opens the picker with everything shared with the group, which you can search or filter by visibility. If the image you pick is **members only**, the editor warns you right away: you would see the picture on the page, but visitors would see a broken frame, because a public page can't show a file its owner has kept private. Pick a public image, or make that one public on its file page first.

Seeing a page before it goes live

View as visitor in the editor opens the saved page exactly as the public sees it, whether it is published or not. This is the reliable check. The side-by-side panel next to the editor updates as you type, but it is only an approximation drawn in half the width, so a page can look right there and still look wrong on the real site.

The preview also tells you if the page isn't in the menu yet, which is the most common reason a newly published page seems to have disappeared.

Reusing a page layout

Built a write-up you want to reuse? On the page's editing screen, **Save as a layout** saves its sections — their types, titles and current wording — as a named layout, for example *Investigation Results*.

The next time you add a page, pick that layout under **Start from one of our layouts**, and the new page starts with those sections ready to fill in.

Two things worth knowing:

- **The layout belongs to the group**, not to whoever saved it, so it stays when people come and go.
- **Each copy is separate.** Editing the layout later doesn't change pages already made from it, and editing one of those pages doesn't change the layout.

Sections that point to a case or an investigation keep their layout, but you'll want to choose the right case or investigation again in their pickers, so a layout reused for a different night shows that night's work.

Putting your cases and investigations on a page

Two section types — **Our investigations** and **Our cases** — let you show your own work on a public page. Pick which records to show, and answer two questions about each section.

Where it happened. You can show the rough area, or nothing at all. There is no way to publish the exact address: the point shown on the map is the center of an area several miles across, and it can't be traced back to a building. This protects the people involved — a case is often somebody's home, and a shared link can stay around long after the page changes.

Who it was for. Cases can show the client's chosen name — either the alias the client picked, or the one your group set for them. A real name is never published here. If neither is set, the case appears with no name.

Work that isn't public yet is flagged in the picker, and adding it asks you to confirm. Until you confirm, those records are left off the page entirely. Publishing a private investigation lets anyone who visits read it, including the person it is about.

You can only show your own group's work. The page is rebuilt from current records each time somebody views it, so if a client later asks not to be named, their name disappears from pages you published months ago — you don't have to remember which ones.

On any case page, the ? button beside Edit Case walks you through exactly how a case goes public — the pseudonym, generalized addresses, and which media may appear.

Putting a case's photos on a page

Photos from a case shows pictures and files from one of your own cases. Choose the case, then check the files you want.

Only some of a case's files can be published, and you can't change that here. A file appears in the picker only when it is attached to a timeline entry marked **Public**, on a case that is itself public. Files on the case's **Files** tab never appear, whatever they are.

Putting a file on a public timeline entry is the only way to publish it. That gives you one place to check what is visible, and one place to change your mind. If a photo you want is missing from the picker, add it to a public timeline entry on the case first.

Captions are off unless you turn them on. A caption is the timeline entry's title, which is your group's own working description of what happened. That is useful to you, but it may say more than you want visitors to see.

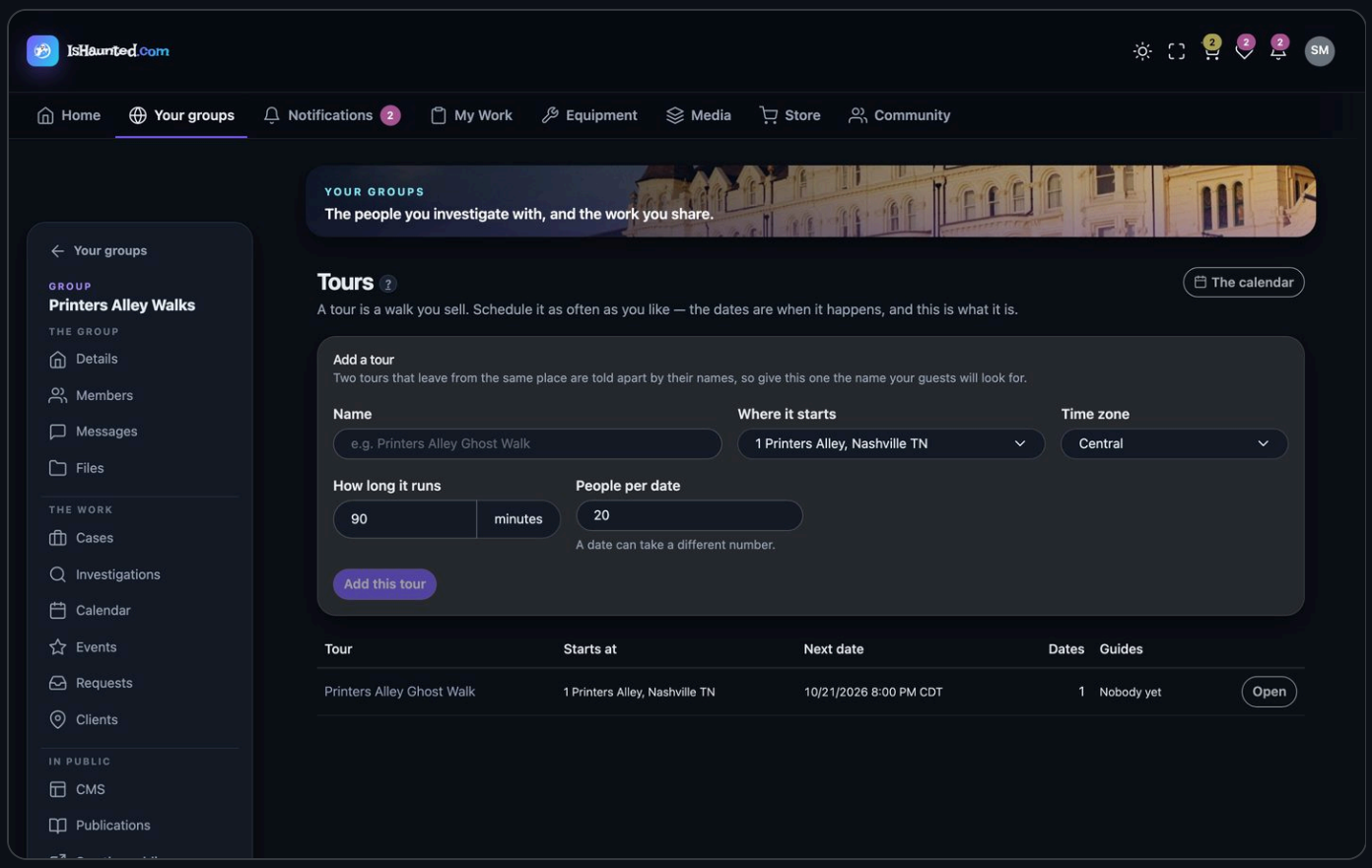
The photos stay linked to the case rather than being copied onto the page. If somebody later makes that timeline entry private, or the case is unpublished, the photos are removed from every page that used them automatically. You don't have to remember which pages they were on. Direct image links work the same way — a link copied from the page stops working at the same moment.

Tours

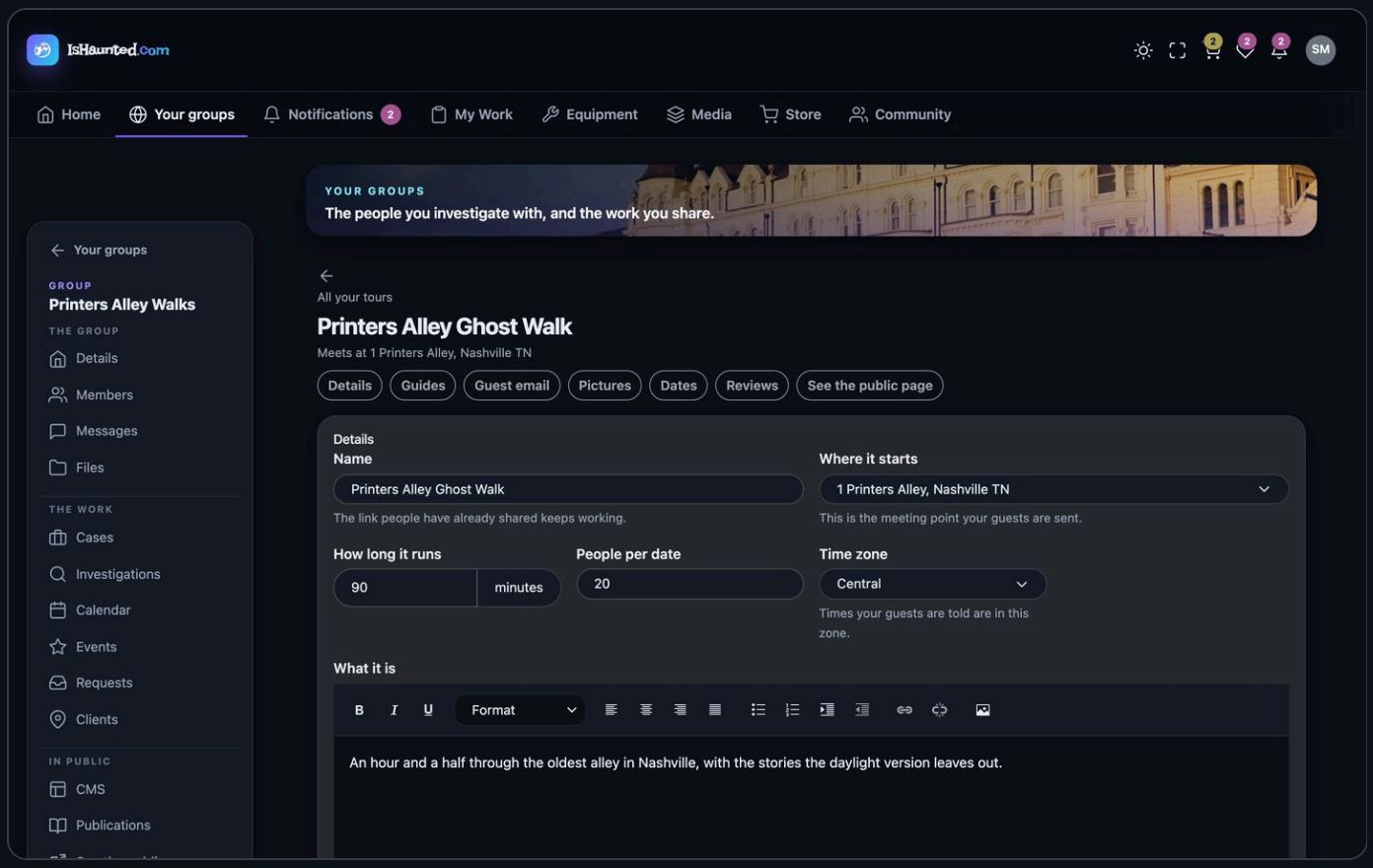
If you run ghost walks, a **tour** is what you sell. The walk down Printers Alley is one tour whether you run it twice a year or four nights a week; a walk down a different street is a second tour. You'll find them under **Administration → Tours**, and each one has its own page.

Two things tell your tours apart. The **meeting point** is required and must be one of your own addresses, so you can correct it in one place and every date updates. The **name** tells apart two tours that start from the same corner, so it must be different from your other tours. It is also what guests will look for, so use the name on your flyer.

A tour also has a length, how many people each date can take, a time zone, a line about how to reach you and how to pay, and a description. No money passes through this site, so use that line to tell guests what to bring and what it costs.



Opening a tour shows everything about it on its own page, with a picker at the top to switch between tours if you run more than one.



Adding a tour, and what it costs

Running tours takes a **Ghost Walk Tour subscription**: $29 a month per tour route, with unlimited walks and guests on each. A **tour route** is one tour on this page: the walk down Printers Alley is one route however often you run it, and a walk down a different street is a second. The subscription is separate from your group's plan, and any group can take it, on your group's **Billing** page under **Ghost Walk Tour subscription**, or from the **Pricing** page. When you subscribe, it pays for every route you already run.

Without it you can't add a route, bring a retired one back, or put a new date on the calendar. With it, dates are unlimited. Adding a route when every route you pay for is already running asks you to add one to your subscription: tick **Add a route to my Ghost Walk Tour subscription**, and the route is added. You can also add routes on the Billing page.

What you see on your bill. Each route is $29 a month. When you add a route part-way through a month, you aren't charged that day: the days left in the month for the new route go on your next monthly bill, along with the next month itself. When you retire a route, it comes off your subscription and the unused days in the month come off your next bill. Your Billing page shows what is waiting for the next bill. You can stop renewing at any time; the month you paid for runs out first.

If your group was on the per-tour business plan, it was moved onto the Ghost Walk Tour subscription for the time it had already paid for, with the same number of routes, at no charge. The plan isn't renewed, and your next bill is the subscription's.

Retiring a tour stops new dates from being added, and leaves the tour's past dates exactly as they are. With a Ghost Walk Tour subscription the route comes off your subscription, as above; on the per-tour business plan it drops from your next renewal, and nothing is refunded for the period already paid for. **Pausing** — turning off *Taking sign-ups* — is the lighter option for an off-season.

Guides

You don't have to be a guide yourself. Choose the members who actually lead the tour, and each date starts with those guides assigned. You can then change them for each date, since a tour with two guides won't always have the same person every night.

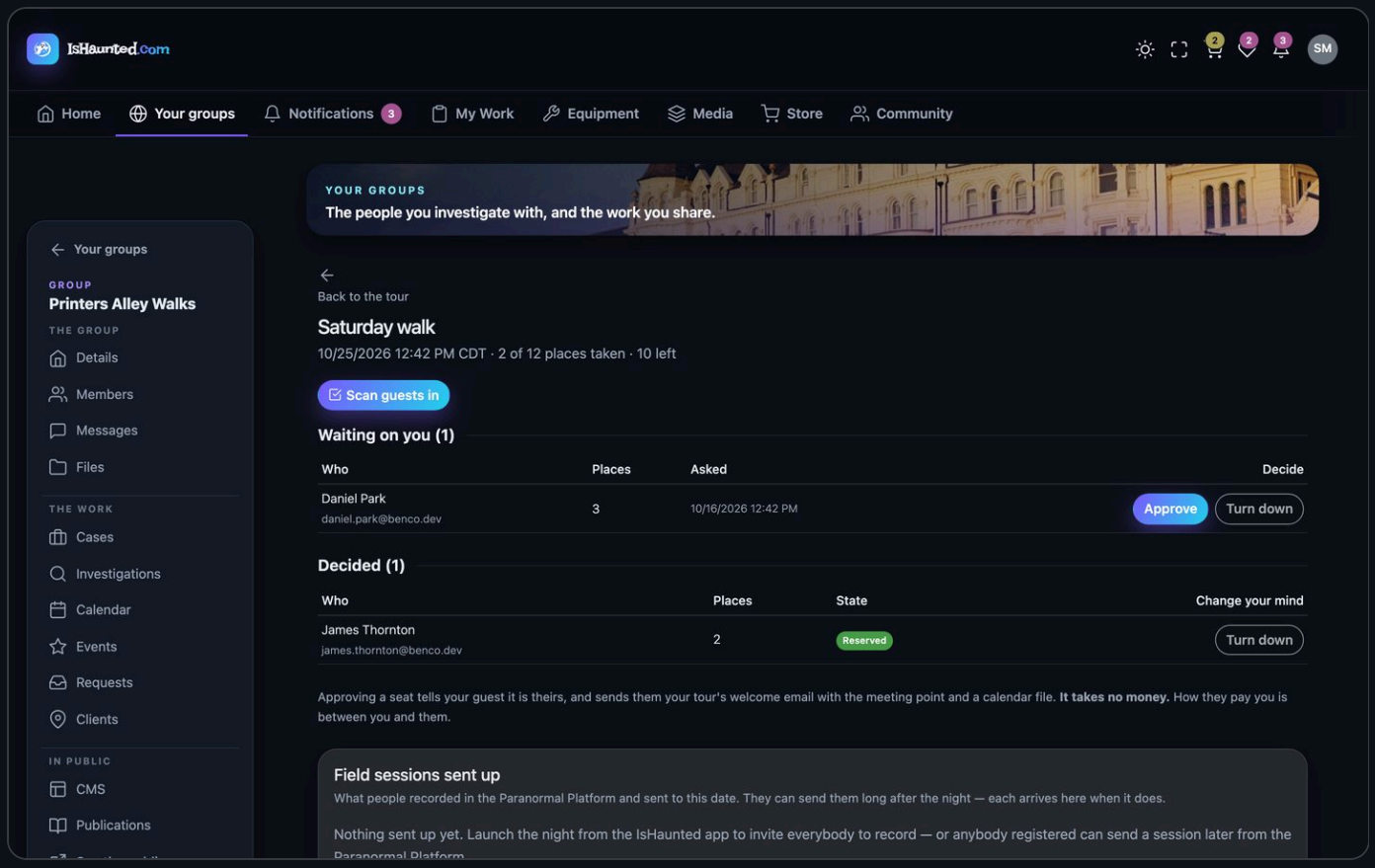
Every guest who signs up is told who is leading their walk, by name, along with the guide's photo if they have made one public on their profile. This is for safety: someone meeting a stranger after dark should know who to look for. The photo is optional, and it is always the guide's choice whether to publish one. A guide without a public photo is just named.

Dates

A date is one run of the tour, and it goes on the **calendar** like any other event. Pick the tour and set the time; the meeting point, length and group size come from the tour unless you change them. Scheduling more dates costs nothing extra: tours are counted, not nights.

For a tour business, every public date must be linked to a tour. Without one, there is nothing to tell guests where to meet or who they are meeting, so the calendar won't save it and explains why. A private date — a guides' meeting or a rehearsal — doesn't need a tour.

Sign-ups: nobody has a place until you say so



Sign-ups waiting for you are shown first, because that is the part of this page that needs action.

A sign-up for a walk is a **request**. It doesn't hold a place until a guide or manager approves it, and approving it is how you confirm that payment is settled between you and your guest. **IsHaunted never takes payment.** Approving records that the two of you have agreed; how they pay you is up to you.

Open a date's **Sign-ups** from the tour's Dates list. The list shows a "waiting" count for each date, so you can see which ones need attention without opening every one.

- **Approve** reserves the places and sends your guest the tour's welcome email, with the meeting point and the calendar file. Nothing is sent to them before this, so nobody is told where to meet for a walk you haven't confirmed.
- **Turn down** tells the guest clearly. The sign-up is kept rather than deleted, so the guest can see that they don't have a place.

A sign-up can ask for **more than one place**, and a date's capacity counts places rather than people. If a party doesn't fit, the message says how many places are left, so you can offer them a smaller group instead of guessing.

A full walk keeps taking requests. Extra requests form a waiting list you work through, and the decision is always yours. If somebody gives up a place, it is there for the next party on the list.

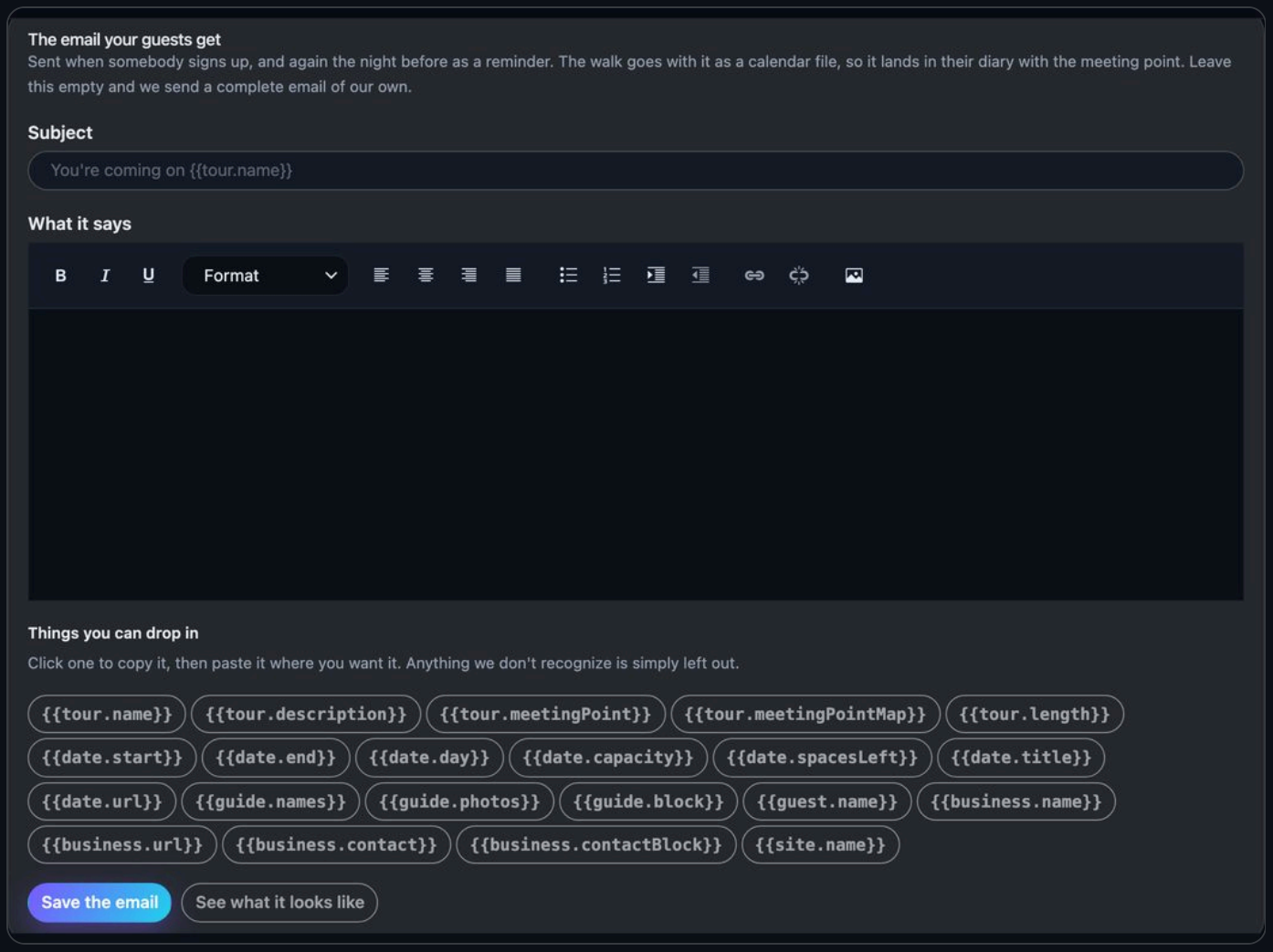
Once you have approved a place, your guest can tap **Got it** to show they have seen it. This is entirely optional and nothing depends on it — it just tells you they are planning to come. Group owners and administrators also see sign-ups in their bell, under **Sign-ups waiting on you**.

The email your guests get

When somebody's place is approved, and again the night before the tour, they get an email about the walk with a **calendar file** attached. That puts it in their calendar with the meeting point, and their phone reminds them.

You can write that email yourself under **Tours → the tour → Guest email**, or leave it empty and we send a complete one for you. To add details that change for each date, click a placeholder and paste it in: the tour's name and meeting point, the date and time in your tour's own time zone, who is guiding that night and their photo, how many places are left, and your own contact line. Anything we don't recognize is left out. **The meeting point is always included**, whether or not you add it, because guests need to know where to go.

See what it looks like shows the email for your next scheduled date, with your times, your guides and your wording, along with the calendar file that comes with it. Nothing is sent.



If you have set a public email address for your group, replies go there, so a guest who hits reply reaches you rather than us.

Pictures and the slideshow

Each tour can hold up to 50 pictures. Add your own from **Tours → the tour → Pictures**. The first one is used on the tour's card and at the top of its page. Every picture you add is resized to fit within 1920 by 1080 and re-saved, which removes the camera data — including where the photo was taken — before it is published.

The tour's page shows a slideshow of those pictures **and** of the guest photos you accepted, each credited to whoever took it. Accepting a guest's photo is also how you keep it, because it stops the retention clock. So if a photo is worth keeping, put it on the page.

Guests who came on the tour can see their own uploads on the tour's page, whatever you decided about them — accepted, waiting, or not published. It is still their photo; your decision only affects what the tour publishes.

What people say about it

Guests who came on a date that has finished can leave a rating out of five and a short comment. Reviews are on by default, and you can turn them on or off for each tour under **Details**. Turning them off stops new reviews but keeps the ones already there.

You can **hide** a review you think is unfair. You can't change what somebody wrote, because their name is on it. Hiding can be undone, so nothing is lost. The person who wrote the review still sees it on the page, marked as hidden, so they know what happened to it. If they rewrite it, it shows again, because the new version hasn't been reviewed yet.

How long things stay

On the tour plan, a photo a guest sends in is kept for **a month** and a recording for **a week**, unless somebody chooses to keep it. Recordings are limited to **five minutes** each. A longer one is turned down when it is sent, with a clear message about the length. The phone can trim a recording before uploading, and only the person who was there knows which five minutes matter.

Keep it on the submission stops the clock on anything — a recording you want to hold on to, or a photo you aren't going to publish. **Put it on a tour** does the same for a picture and also publishes it. Your business gets its own copy, resized to fit within 1920 by 1080 with the camera data removed, while the guest's original keeps its own clock and stays theirs. Both buttons are on the evidence queue, beside Accept and Decline, along with the date each file will be removed.

If you stop keeping something, its clock starts again from that day, not from when it was uploaded, and the person who sent it is warned again.

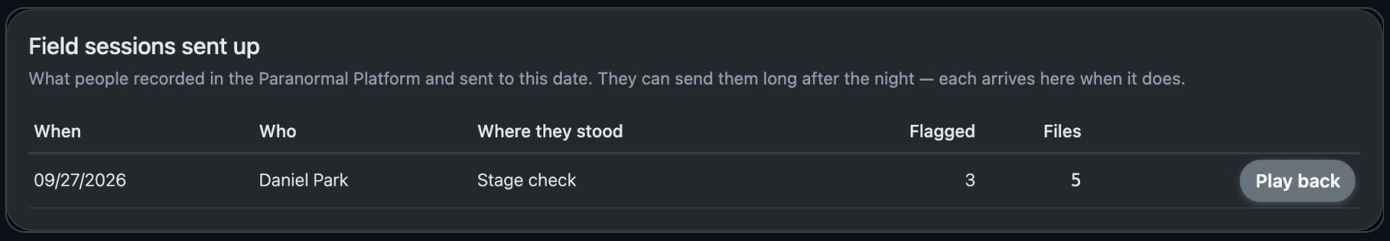
Everyone who sends something in gets an email before it is removed — a week ahead and again the day before — so they can download it. Nothing is ever deleted without a warning first.

Groups that aren't on a tour plan have no clock at all: their files stay, as they always have.

Starting the night, and what your guests send back

On the night, a date's guide — or anyone who can edit your calendar — can start the Paranormal Platform for everyone from the IsHaunted app, using **Launch a session for your group** in the Paranormal Platform. Everyone with a reserved place is notified, and the card appears in the feed. Guests who never signed up can scan the guide's code. At a public date they join right away; at a private one they ask, and the guide lets them in. See The iPhone and iPad Apps.

Whatever they record and send — that night or days later — appears on the date's page, under **Field sessions sent up**, with **Play back**. Your group and the date's guides can see it; the other guests can't.



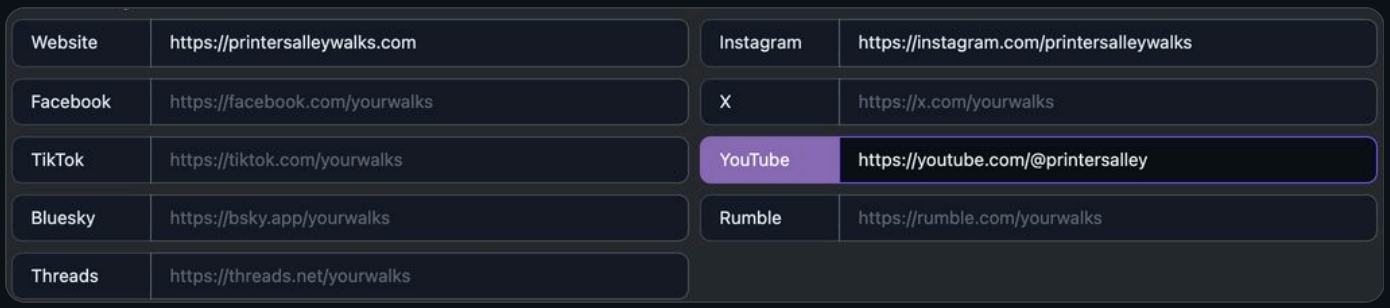
A session sent to one of your dates is your group's record of that night: the guest who sent it cannot delete it.

Where your tours show up

Tours are public. They appear on your own public page, on the map on the front page, and in the nearby search, with the full meeting point. The tour's page shows it on its own map, with directions and a link that opens it in Maps, because people deciding whether to come need to know where it is. Each tour also has its own page at `/o/your-group/tours/the-tour-name`, which is the best link to share.

Where else you are

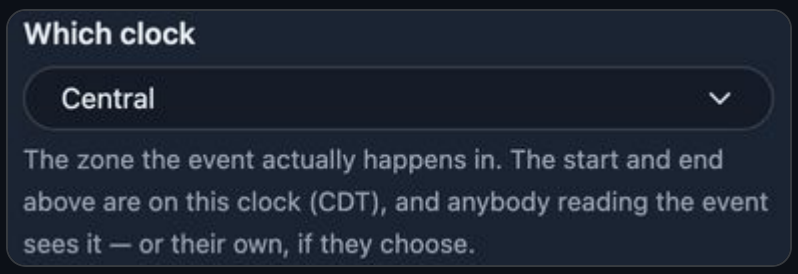
Under **Where else you are** on a tour's page, you can add the accounts that go with that tour: your own website, Instagram, Facebook, X, TikTok, YouTube, Bluesky, Rumble and Threads. They appear as a simple row at the **bottom** of the tour's public page, under the dates, so visitors see when the tour runs before being sent anywhere else.



You can add one account per service. To remove one, just leave its box empty; there is nothing to confirm. Each link must point to that service's own site — for example, an Instagram link that leads somewhere else isn't accepted, because people click the name without checking the address.

Which clock an event runs on

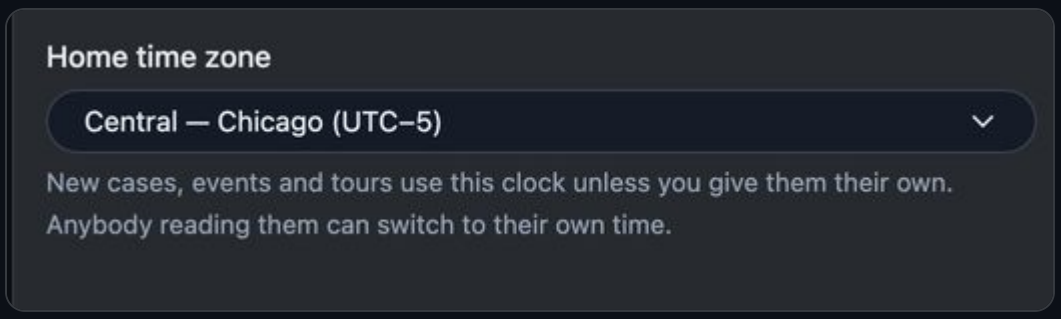
Every event has the time zone where it actually happens, chosen on the scheduler under **Which clock**. It starts out as your group's **home time zone** (see below), and the start and end times you type are in that zone. The form tells you which zone it is, so 8 p.m. means 8 p.m. where the event is, wherever you are when you schedule it.



The public sees the event in that time zone, wherever in the world they are — an event at 8 p.m. in Nashville shows as 8 p.m. even to someone reading in Tokyo, with the zone named beside it. That way the listing, the event's page and the reminder email all agree. A tour date uses the tour's time zone unless you choose another. Readers can switch **Local time · My time** to see the time in their own zone instead.

Your group's home time zone

Settings → Home time zone is your group's usual time zone. New cases, events and tours start with it, and anything without its own zone uses it. It starts as Central time (Chicago).



A case or an investigation can have its own zone, for when your group works away from home. Set it on the case's edit page or in the investigation's schedule dialog; see Working a Case.

Hosted events

An **event** is something you put on over one or more dates: a weekend at a hotel, a run of performances, an evening with a talk and dinner. It doesn't have to be a ghost hunt — a retreat, a dinner theater and a lock-in all work the same way, just with different descriptions.

An event relates to a calendar date the way a tour relates to a single walk. The calendar holds the dates; the event holds everything that makes those dates worth coming to. You'll find events under **Events** in your group's menu.

Building one costs nothing

Give it a name, a venue and the dates it runs. That creates a **draft**: only your own people can see it, it has no public page, it takes no bookings, and it sends nothing. Build everything — the dates, the program, the rooms, the files, the page — and change your mind as often as you like. Nothing is charged and nothing is announced until you press **Publish**.

Who can build and change one

Only people who can manage your group's settings can add or change an event — the owner, administrators, and anyone whose role includes the group's settings. Every other member can still open **Events**, read each event and browse its pages. The page tells them who can make changes, and its controls are shown but disabled.

A venue we haven't listed

Search for the venue by part of its name or its town (press Enter or **Search**), and if it is already listed, use that one. Only public places are listed; a private home can't be a venue. Venues are shared across the whole site, so a building's map pin, its history and everything anyone has recorded there stay together on one record.

If it isn't listed, choose **The venue isn't listed** and enter its name and address. We look up its location so it shows on the map. If we can't find it, the event still works fine — it just won't have a map pin yet. If the venue you enter turns out to be listed already, the existing one is used instead of creating a duplicate.

A venue must be a public place. A private residence isn't allowed, because an event is always public, and publishing somebody's home isn't your decision or ours. If a venue you type in turns out to be a home that's already on file, the event isn't saved and the page says why.

One stay, or a run of dates

When you add the event, a switch lets you choose one of two kinds.

One stay is days in a row, like a weekend of ghost hunting or a weekend of seminars. Every day between the first and last date becomes a night of the same event, and a guest can book several of them. Another weekend is another event.

Separate dates is a show's run, like a play or a musical. The event is the show, each date is one performance, and each date is booked separately. The dates don't need to be evenly spaced, but they must all fall within a month of the first performance. Performances after that are their own event.

One credit covers either. A weekend is one event, and so is a show's run of up to a month.

Running a show longer than a month

Once a show is published, its page has **How long the run can go**. Each **extra month** lets the run go a month longer, and costs half what you pay for a credit: $49.50, or $9.90 for a group with a paid plan. You can add up to 11, a run of a year in all. Choose how many, then pay as the group or yourself; the dates can then reach that far.

- **Extra months only lengthen a show's run.** They can't publish an event; only a credit does that.
- **If the show is called off,** its extra months come back to whoever paid, whatever the timing, and can lengthen another show's run. **Use the group's** or **Use yours** on that show's page applies them, free.
- **Held months lapse a year after they were bought.** We write to you a month before.
- **Removing dates later doesn't refund months.** They stay with the show.
- **Planning a long run before it's published?** Publish it with the first month's dates, then add months and the later dates.

Each date can say its own thing

You can give any date its own title, its own start and end time, and a note — for example, if opening night starts earlier than the rest. Dates you don't customize use the event's own times.

If you move an event's dates, anything you wrote about days that are still included is kept. Extend a weekend by a day and your Saturday keeps its title and notes.

What publishing does

Publishing puts the event on your public page, on the site-wide **What's on** list and in the phone apps, and opens it for bookings. This is when any charge applies, and the page tells you what it will be before you press the button.

Publishing uses one **event credit**. No plan includes events, the largest included: every event is bought on its own. One credit covers one event, however many days in a row it runs, or a show's run of performances within a month. A credit is **the price shown on the Pricing page**, and a group with a paid plan pays the percentage shown on the Pricing page of that: **a share of that price**. Before you press the button, you can see how many credits you have and what the button will do.

Your group's own credits are used first. If the group has none, publishing uses one of **your own** credits, if you hold any (see Buying event credits).

An event is only ever charged once. You can unpublish it and publish it again as often as you need. The first publish pays for it, and there is no second charge for the life of that event.

Buying event credits

Anyone can buy event credits: a group for itself, or a person for the events they organize.

- **For your group:** on your group's **Billing** page, under **Event credits**. When the Events page tells you that you need one, that message links straight there. A group with a paid plan pays the percentage shown on the Pricing page of the price, and the card shows the lower price.
- **For yourself:** on **My event credits** (there's a link on the Events page and the Pricing page). Credits you hold are yours, and you pay the full price.

Buy one or several at a time, or a **bundle** when the Pricing page offers one — several credits for one price. Payment happens on Stripe's secure page, and the receipt appears in the billing history (or, for your own

credits, under **Payments** on My event credits).

Your guests never pay through the site. If you charge for your event, you collect that money yourself.

A credit lasts **a year from the day you buy it**. When you use it, two things must be true: the credit hasn't expired, and the event's first date falls within that year. So you can't use a credit bought today on an event three years away — if that's your plan, buy the credit closer to the time. If a credit can't cover an event, the message shows both dates so you can see exactly why.

Credits are used **oldest first**, so the one closest to expiring is always used first.

The card lists all your credits: which are available, what each one cost, when it expires, and — for the ones already used — which event it went on. That last column answers questions like "did we pay for the October weekend?" a year later.

We email you thirty days before a credit expires, so it never disappears without warning. An unused credit that has expired is gone; we don't extend it, and it isn't refunded automatically. If something went wrong — you bought two by mistake, or never got to use one — contact us, and someone here can issue a refund by hand.

A credit marked **Given to you** instead of a price is one we gave you, for example after a payment that didn't go through, or to make up for something we owed you. It works exactly like one you bought.

Changing the dates, times or venue

You can change a published event's dates, usual times or venue at any time. Everybody holding a place, or still waiting for an answer, gets a letter saying what changed. A date somebody is booked on can't be taken off until you've moved or released their booking on the booking board; the page names the date and how many parties are on it. A date with people checked in on it stays, because that's the record of who came.

Taking it down, archiving it, calling it off

Un-publish removes the event from the public site. Nothing is deleted and nothing is refunded.

Archive removes the event from your list and closes its page, its results, its reviews and the evidence guests send. Everything about it stays exactly as it is. Events are archived automatically two months after their last date, once the time for reviews and evidence has run out, so a guest following the thank-you letter's link still finds the page.

Cancel is for an event that was going to happen and now won't. When you call it off you can also tell everybody with a place **It's moving to** a new date, or **How to get their money back**, in your own words. Both go in the letter they get and on the event's page. The listing adds CANCELED to its title — the one line everyone actually reads, whether on your page, a shared link or a phone — and the reason you give is shown to people who had places. The event is kept rather than deleted, so anyone who was planning to come can see that it is off. Once the event has happened, it can't be called off, and whether it goes ahead can only be decided before it starts.

If the event is called off, your credit

If the event used one of your plan's slots rather than a credit, canceling it frees the slot right away.

For an event published with a credit: cancel 48 hours or more before its first night and you get the credit back — as a credit for your next event, never as money. Cancel later than that and the credit is used up, because by then the venue, the caterers and the guests have all made their plans.

The date on your calendar

Every event adds one entry to your group's calendar, spanning from the start of the first date to the end of the last. The public list, the reminder email, the calendar file and the phone apps all read from that entry, so it is kept in sync with the event automatically.

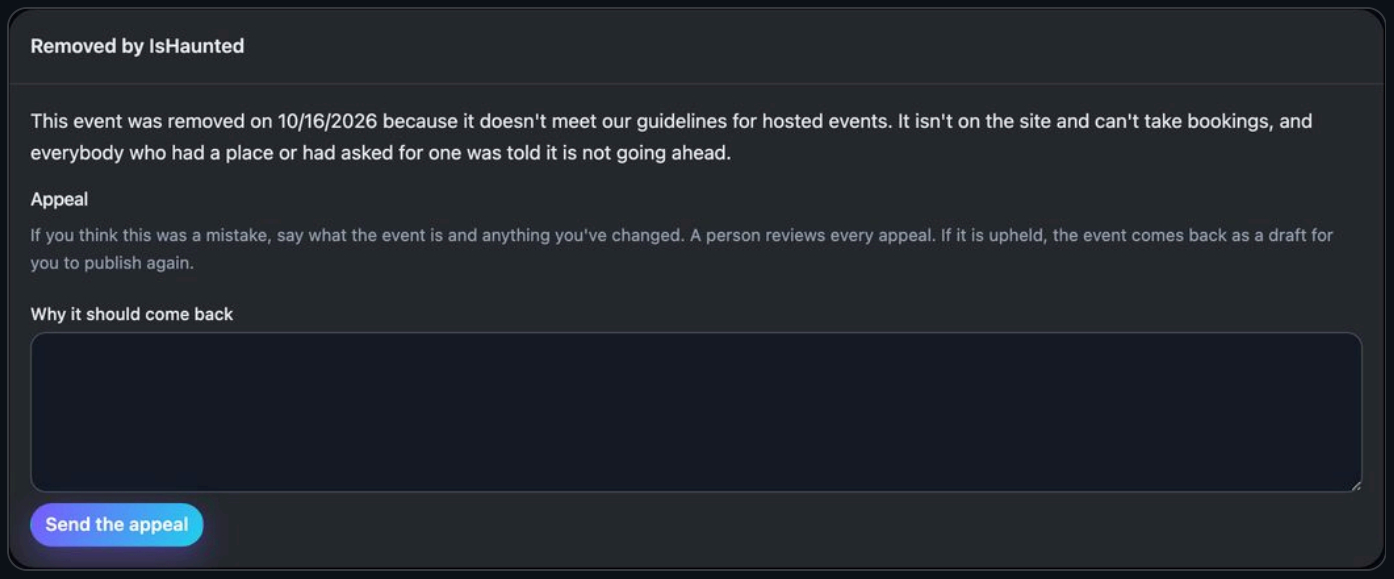
You can't edit that entry from the calendar. The calendar tells you this and links you to the event, where its dates, venue and description are set. That way, two screens can never show different details for the same evening.

If IsHaunted removes your event

Hosted events must follow the site's guidelines. If one doesn't, IsHaunted can remove it. When that happens:

- it comes off the site and stops taking bookings;
- everyone with a place is told it isn't going ahead;
- the event credit used on it is returned to you, whatever the timing.

The people who manage the group's billing, and whoever created the event, get an email with a link to appeal.



The event's page then shows **Removed by IsHaunted** at the top. If you think it was a mistake, explain why it should come back and what you've changed, and send the appeal. A person reads every appeal, and you hear back by email and in your messages: - **Upheld** — the event comes back as a draft. Publishing it again uses a credit or a slot, just as it did the first time. - **Declined** — the event stays removed, and the reply explains why.

Each removal can be appealed once. A removed event can't be un-canceled, restored or published from its page, but you can still edit it before you appeal.

Rooms and bookings

Under **Rooms offered**, check which of your venue's rooms this event is using. These are the rooms you have described for the place (see *Rooms* on the venue), and each one already says how many it sleeps — but you can change that for an event. A double room with two extra cots for a séance weekend sleeps four for that weekend and goes back to two afterward.

You can't uncheck a room that has confirmed bookings. Move those guests to another room first; otherwise they would be booked into a room your event says it isn't using.

The **plan** lays out the rooms — or the seats, for an event sold by the seat — so everyone can see what is where. It has its own page, listed as *Plan* down the side of the event page. The **board**, where requests wait for your decision, is *Bookings* in the same list.

Getting in and getting around

Use **Access and what to know** on the event page to tell guests what they need to know before they come: *no elevator — the bedrooms are up one flight*, *the ballroom is step-free from the side door*, *some of the hunt is in low light*, *a hearing loop in the bar*, or where to park. It shows on the public event page under *Getting in and getting around*, on the event's page in the iPhone app, and in every confirmation letter, just before the pass.

Describe the building as it is, rather than guessing what someone can manage. A guest who uses a wheelchair can decide for themselves whether a flight of stairs to the bedrooms is a problem.

Before you publish

A draft costs nothing and isn't visible to anyone outside your group. Publishing puts the event on your public page, opens it for bookings, and uses an event credit. So the page shows a checklist of anything that still needs doing, and each item links to where you fix it.

There are four items. **At least one date**, because nobody can come to an event without a date. **The venue's say-so**, explained below. **Somewhere to book** — a room or a seat on the plan, or a number of day passes; an event where everyone just shows up is fine, but one with no way to book at all is not. And **a contact line**, because this site never takes a guest's money, and that line is the only place on the page that tells people how to pay you.

If the publish button won't publish, it uses exactly the same wording as the checklist, so you can match its message to the item on the list.

Who confirms the event is happening

Under **The venue's say-so**, you record who gave permission for this event to take place at this venue. There are three options, and they really are different.

It's our own venue is, for example, a hotel running its own weekend. Publishing counts as your confirmation, and nothing more is needed, since a hotel doesn't need to prove it can use its own building.

Somebody else's, arranged directly with them is, for example, a hall you rented or a house whose owner agreed by phone. Record who agreed and when, and their reference if there is one. We can't check any of it. Recording it means everyone knows what was arranged, and the question reminds you to get permission if you haven't yet.

Somebody else's, and they're on this site is a place another group has been confirmed as running — a hotel on IsHaunted, for example. In that case the decision isn't yours: the card shows who runs the place, and **their yes is what lets you publish**, whichever option you picked. See Venues on this site.

Pick or ask, and how long a hold lasts

Under **Your guests**, choose how people get a place.

They ask, you place them. A request doesn't hold anything until you confirm it, so the event keeps taking requests after it is full, and the extra requests form a waiting list. This suits a hotel fitting families into the right rooms.

They pick on the plan. A guest clicks or drags across the seats they want, and those seats are held for them until you confirm or the hold expires. Meanwhile, everyone else sees them as pending and can't take them. This suits an evening sold by the seat, where you need to stop two people from choosing the same seats.

You choose how long a hold lasts, from an hour to two weeks; the default is two days. When a hold expires, the seats are released and the guest is told. They stay on your list as a request, so nobody is dropped without notice.

You can't switch between the two once anyone is booked or waiting. Switching would change what their existing booking means — a hold would become nothing, and a request would become a place they never chose — and you might not find out until the night. Deal with everyone waiting first, and you can switch again.

The booking board

The **Bookings** page is where you actually run a weekend, and it opens on what matters most: **Waiting on you**. Everything that hasn't been answered is at the top, soonest deadline first, and everything else is below it, so you can start working right away.

Each row shows who it is, how many people, what they asked for, and anything they wrote. **Confirm…** opens the party. **Turn down** tells them no. On an event where guests pick their own places, there is a third button, **Give them longer**, and a line showing how much time is left on their hold.

Why the hold matters. If a hold expires, the clock has made the decision instead of you. So the row tells you "their hold runs out in about four hours" while there is still time to answer, and the button gives them a full new hold starting from the moment you press it — not from a deadline that has already passed.

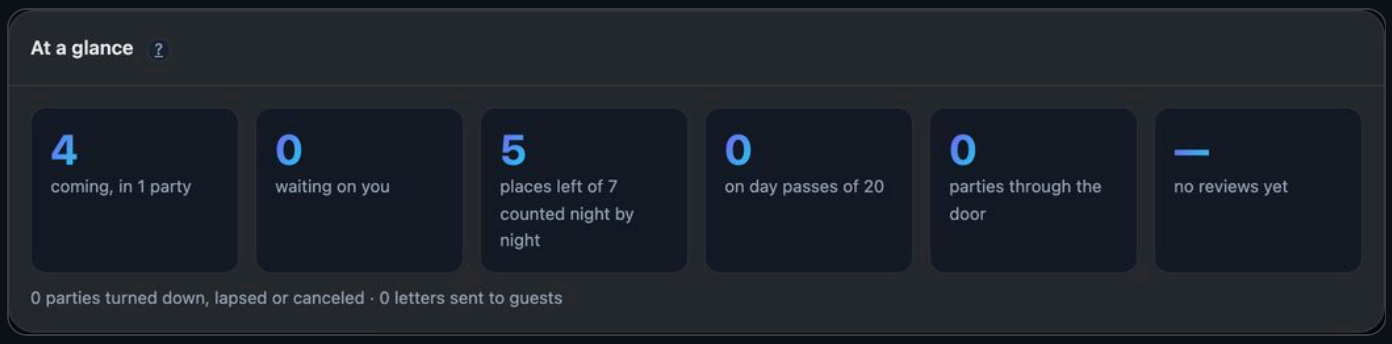
If holds have already expired, the header offers to **give them back now**. The site does this on its own within five minutes anyway; the button is there because five minutes is a long time when someone is standing at the

desk asking whether the Blue Room is free.

The house, below, shows one night at a time, with that night's buttons at the top. A confirmed square is solid, one somebody is still holding is striped, and one you have held back is marked as not available. Underneath is the number of day guests coming that night.

At a glance

Once an event is published, its page opens with **At a glance**: how many people are coming and in how many parties, how many are waiting on you, places left, day passes, who has checked in, and the reviews. Click any number to open the screen with the details.



Places are counted night by night. A room on a two-night plan is two places to sell, and a party staying both nights has taken both. A place somebody is holding counts as taken, just as it does on the plan, and a place you have held back isn't counted as for sale.

If the event has a minimum number, the card shows how far above it you are, or how many you are short.

Deciding about one party

Opening a party shows you everything about it in one place, without losing your place in the queue.

When you confirm, you choose **where they are actually staying**. The pickers start with what the guest asked for, and you can change them to whatever suits you. Moving a party of three from a double into the suite is perfectly normal, and you don't need to turn them down and make them ask again. Each choice shows how many the room sleeps and whether anyone is in it.

If they don't fit, the message names the room and the numbers — "The Blue Room sleeps 2 more on 10/30, and this is a party of 4" — so you can tell whether a smaller party would fit, rather than just seeing "full".

The line for the guest is optional, and the guest will read it. It is sent with the confirmation or the refusal.

Confirming also sends their pass. Without a pass, a confirmed guest would have to be looked up by name at the door, which is exactly the line this is meant to avoid.

A guest asking to get out of a confirmed booking shows on the row and in the sheet. Releasing them frees their places and tells them, and their pass stops working. Keeping the booking changes nothing, and their request stays on record.

Holding a room or a seat back

Not everything on a plan has to be for sale. Open a room or a seat and you can hold it back, either **for one night** or **for the whole run**, and say which of two reasons applies: **out of use** — behind a pillar, out of order, kept for the crew — or **the venue is using it**.

Guests see which of those two reasons applies, but never see your note. You can write "Mrs. Cole's family is in it on Friday" if that is the reason; a guest is only told that the venue is using that room that night.

A held-back place can't be picked or booked, and it becomes available again as soon as you remove the hold.

When two guests want the same seat

On an event where guests pick their own places, two people can try to take the same seat at the same moment. Only one gets it. The other is told which seat was taken, by name, and keeps everything else they had chosen — so a party of four who lost one seat only has to pick one seat again, rather than starting over.

The site guarantees that only one of them can ever be told yes.

A hold lasts as long as you set under *Your guests*. When it expires, the places are released and the guest is told what happened — that the hold expired, not that you turned them down — and they stay on your list. You can still offer them a place.

Who can see what

These are separate permissions, on purpose:

- **Seeing the event and its plan** is open to any member. Most of what an event offers is on the public page anyway.
- **Changing the event** — its dates, its plan, its blocks, its menus — is arranging it.
- **Seeing the bookings** means seeing guests' names, email addresses and dietary notes. A dietary note is health information someone shared with you so they can eat safely, and not everyone in the group needs to see it.
- **Deciding the bookings** means confirming, turning down, releasing, editing and issuing passes.
- **Running the door** means scanning passes and checking people in. Somebody on the door sees tonight's dietary flags and nothing else — not addresses, not phone numbers.

Publishing is separate again. It needs someone who can change the group's settings, because it is the one action that costs money.

The group's session on the night

When it's time to investigate, press **Start the sessions**. It's on the event page and on the door, on the website, and in the Paranormal Platform in the IsHaunted app. Everybody with a place, and the guests they named, gets a plain notice: *Sessions are now being accepted for this event.* It arrives as a notification for people with the app and as a card in everyone's feed. Nobody's phone starts recording; each person presses Start on their own. You can send it from three hours before the event starts until it ends.

The organizer can press it, and so can anyone running the door. To let a guide or a lead do it without handing them the door, tick **Start the sessions ("time to investigate")** when you add them on the staff list.

What people send appears on the event's page under **Field sessions sent up**, visible to your group and the event's staff. Letting in someone who scanned the code and asked to join never creates a booking: it only lets them record along with everyone else.

Minimum numbers

Some events are only worth running if enough people come. Enter the minimum number and the date by which you will decide, and we will remind you a week before and again the day before. Leave both empty and the event goes ahead regardless of numbers.

Once the date is set, **Is it going ahead?** appears on the same card with two buttons. Saying yes records your decision and nothing else changes. Saying no cancels the event, just like canceling it for any other reason: the people who had places are told, and the listing shows it is canceled.

Calling it off, and your credit

The rule is simple: **cancel more than 48 hours before the event starts, and the event credit you used comes back.** Within those 48 hours, it doesn't. By then the event has been advertised, taken bookings, and people have planned around it, so you have had what you paid for.

The card tells you which will happen *before* you press the button, in the same words the site uses afterward.

If the credit comes back, the event needs a credit again, so publishing it again uses a credit, just like the first time. You can't keep both the credit and the published event. If the credit doesn't come back, the event stays paid for, and publishing it again costs nothing.

A returned credit keeps its original expiry date. One bought last October still expires next October, whatever happened to the event it was used on. If it has already expired, the card says so rather than suggesting you have a credit available.

An event that has already happened can't be turned back into a draft. It stays on the record. Archive it if you want it off your list, or create a new event for next time.

What happens without you

An event moves through these stages on its own, using your venue's time zone:

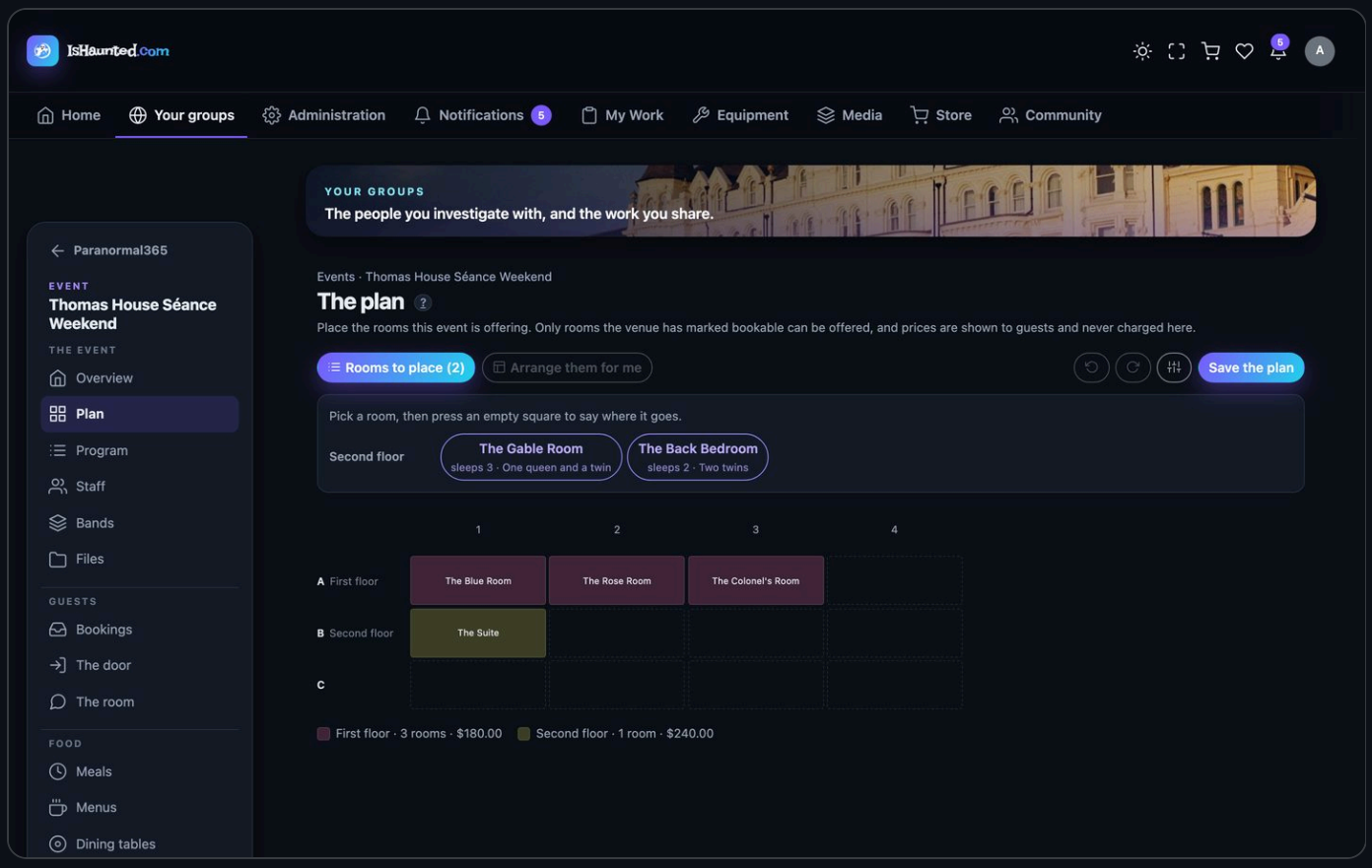
- **On the site** once you publish it.
- **On now** when the first night starts.
- **Over** when the last night ends. It stays readable but stops taking bookings, since any request after that would be from someone who misread the date.
- **Filed away** two weeks later. It comes off your list and out of the counts; nothing is deleted.

When it is filed away, anyone still waiting for an answer is told the event has passed, rather than being left waiting forever, and you are told what was closed for you. This is the only step that acts on your behalf, and

only once the event is two weeks past.

The plan: rooms or seats

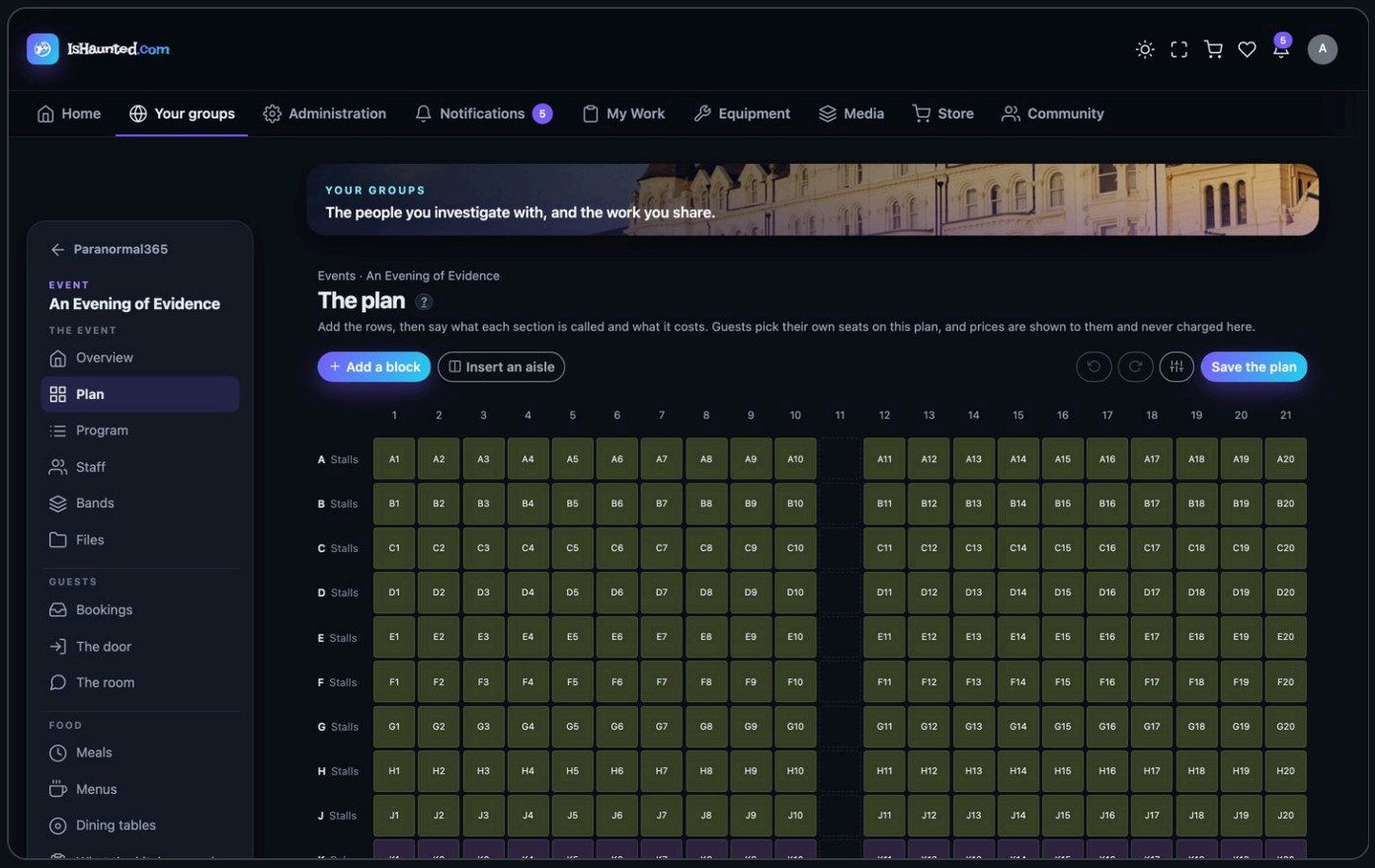
An event's plan holds either rooms or seats, and you choose which while it is still empty: **Rooms** for a venue where people stay the night, **Seats** for an evening where they sit down. Once anything is on the plan, the choice is locked and the buttons disappear, because switching would throw away everything arranged so far, along with every booking made on it.



On a **Rooms** plan, the list on the left shows every room the venue has marked bookable that isn't on the plan yet. Pick one, then press an empty square to place it. *Arrange them for me* lays out all the remaining rooms, one floor per row, which is usually close enough that you only need to adjust a couple. A room doesn't have to go on the plan at all — a cellar you describe but never rent out can just stay in the list.

Rooms keep the venue's own names, so renaming a room on the venue's Rooms page renames it here and on every guest's booking at once. If all the rooms in a row are on the same floor, that floor's name appears in the margin, so a hotel's floors are labeled without taking up a column.

Laying out a theatre quickly



Use **Add a block** to build a seating layout: how many rows, how many seats in each, which letter the rows start at, which direction the numbers run, and the section's name and price. A line under the form shows the first and last seat before you commit — *13 rows × 20 = 260 seats, A1 … N20* — so you can catch a backwards row before naming two hundred and sixty seats. Use it twice for an orchestra section and a balcony.

Rows skip I and O, because on a printed ticket or a seat plate, I looks like 1 and O looks like 0. So the rows run A to H, then J, K, L, M, N.

Insert an aisle adds an aisle to the left of whatever you have selected, moving everything to its right over by one place. The gap is truly empty — it is a walkway, not a row of seats nobody can sit in — and the seats keep their numbers, so you can relabel them afterward if the venue numbers seats across the aisle rather than continuing through it.

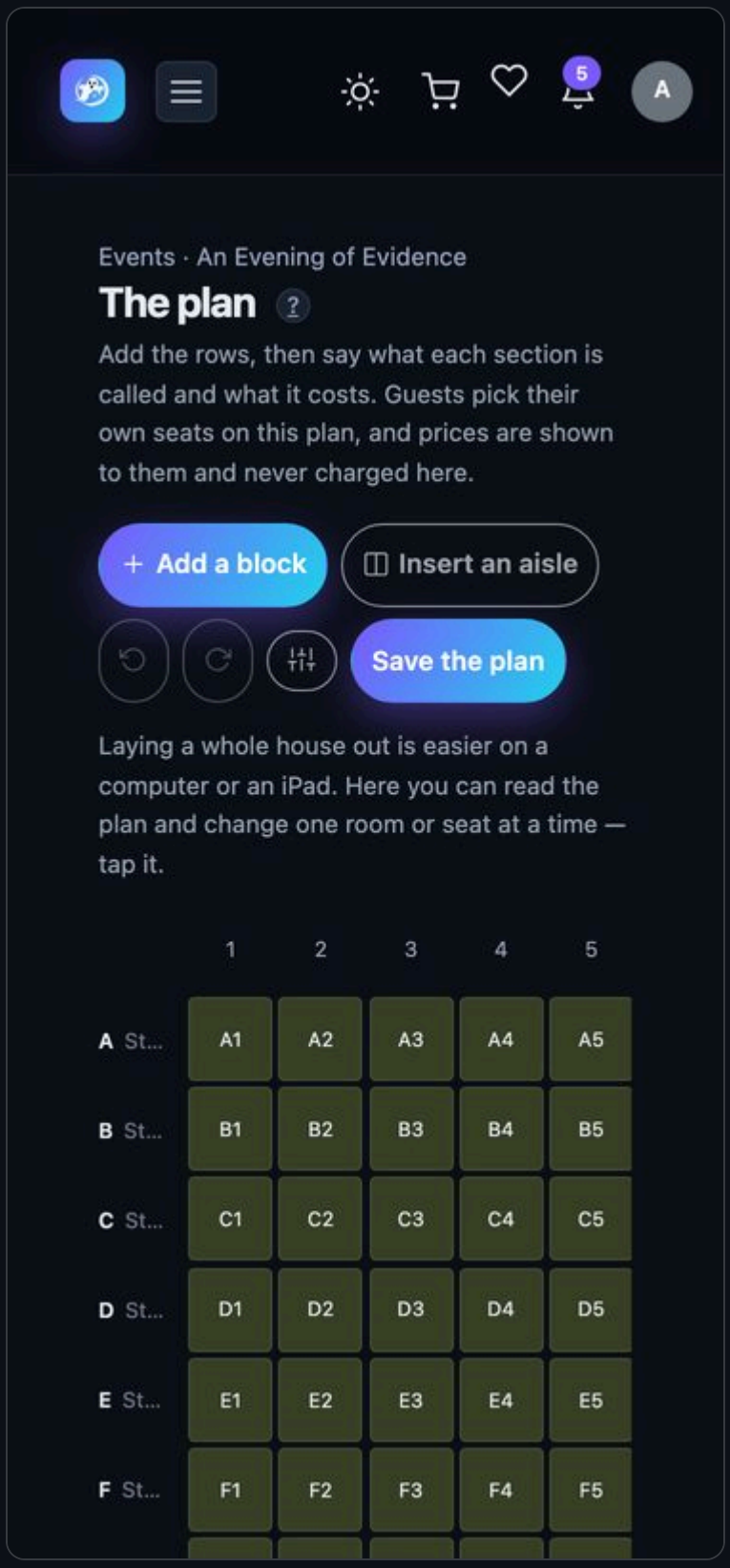
Select seats by clicking them, or by dragging across a run of seats with a mouse. Each one you click is added to the selection, and clicking it again removes it, so there is no modifier key to remember. Press **Clear** on the bar to start over. With seats selected, you can set a section, a price or a note on all of them at once, relabel a whole block by row, move them with the arrows, or remove them from the plan.

Prices are shown to guests but never charged here. A blank price means "ask us", and zero means the seat is included. You and your guests settle payment between yourselves.

Starting from a plan used here before

If an event's plan is empty and the venue has been laid out for an earlier event, the plan page offers **Start from a plan used at this venue before**. It lists the venue's own plan first, then your group's, then other groups' published events there. Pressing *Start from this plan* fills the page with its rooms or seats, sections and positions. Nothing is saved until you press Save, so you can change anything first. Your own group's prices and notes are copied, but another group's never are. Any room this event can't offer is left out, and the page tells you.

The plan on a phone



Laying out a whole venue is a job for a computer or an iPad, and the page tells you so. On a phone, you can read the plan and adjust one square at a time: tap a room or a seat to open it, fix its price or note, and save.

The squares stay big enough to tap, and the plan scrolls sideways inside its own box, so the rest of the page stays put.

If you want to see more of a large plan at once, use *Fit the whole plan* under the tools button to shrink the squares. The page only does this when you ask.

Nothing is saved until you press **Save the plan**, and the page shows *Not saved yet* while you have unsaved changes. If you try to leave with unsaved changes, you are asked first.

Sleeps, bookable and beds

The rooms themselves are set up on the venue's own **Rooms** page, which the event's Details card links to as *Describe the venue's rooms*. Each room can say how many it sleeps, whether it can be booked, and what beds it has.

A blank **Sleeps** means nobody has entered a number yet. Ask the venue, and any event that offers the room will need to enter its own number. **Zero** is a deliberate choice — a room nobody sleeps in, such as a parlor or a séance room that guests visit and leave. Blank and zero look similar on a form but mean opposite things for a booking, so a blank is never treated as zero.

Bookable is separate from **Public**. Public controls whether visitors can read about the room on the venue's page; bookable controls whether a party can book it for the night. A famous room can be public but never booked — the owner sleeps in it — and a plain twin room can be bookable without a description on the page. Checking one doesn't affect the other.

Beds is a description in your own words — "one king", "two twins and a cot", "four bunks". It answers a question a number can't: *will the two of us have to share a bed?* It isn't a count, and bookings don't use it; **Sleeps** is the number bookings are checked against. If you rent out a room bed by bed, describe it as several rooms — "Bunk 1" through "Bunk 6", each sleeping one — because a party books a whole room.

How a booking works

A **booking is a party**, not a person: one lead contact, a party size, and a named guest for each person. Guests don't need accounts — someone might bring a partner who has never heard of us — and each guest can have their own dietary note.

There are two kinds. An **overnight** party books a room on specific nights. A **day pass** is for someone coming without staying, counted against a single limit for the whole event.

A guest asks, and you decide. Until you confirm it, a request **holds nothing** — no room, no day pass. So your event keeps taking requests after it is full, and the extra requests form a waiting list you can work through. The board shows both numbers: how many are in a room on a given night, and how many have *asked* for it.

Confirming, and moving people about

Confirming means the place is theirs and that the two of you have settled how they will pay. **This site never takes a guest's money.** When you confirm, you choose which room they are actually in each night, and it

doesn't have to be the room they asked for. Moving a party of three from a double into the suite is perfectly normal, and there's no need to make them start over.

If they don't fit, the message tells you exactly why: which room, which night, and how many more it sleeps, so you can tell whether a smaller party would fit.

Confirming also adds them to the event's calendar entry, which the reminder email, the calendar file, the public count and the phone apps all read from.

Changing and canceling

You can edit bookings after they are confirmed, because in real life someone always drops out on Thursday. Change the party size, the rooms, the nights or the guests. The room is checked again, so an edit can't do anything a new booking couldn't, and a party moving rooms is never blocked by the beds it is leaving.

Guests can change their own bookings too. If they change something you agreed to — the party size or the nights — it comes back to you as a request, because it is no longer what you said yes to.

A guest can't free up a confirmed room on their own. They ask, and you release it. You may have planned food and staff around that room, or turned someone else away, and a room freed without your knowledge would just sit empty. Their reason comes with the request.

Turning a booking down and canceling one both notify the guest, and both free up the room.

Bookings close

You can set a date when the event stops taking new requests, so you know your numbers for catering and staffing. It only stops *new* requests — any request already waiting when bookings close is still yours to decide, so nobody who asked in time is turned away automatically.

Inviting people, and sending somebody a ticket

Most guests ask through the event's page, which needs an account. For the people you mean to ask yourself, there is **Invite people by email** on the bookings board. Paste one address or your whole list, one a line or separated by commas, and add a message of your own: the price and how to pay you, for example. Each person gets their own link. Clicking it confirms their email address, creates a passwordless account for them, and puts a **day-pass request** on your board, which you then confirm like any other. Anything in your list that isn't an email address is handed back to you, so you can fix the typo and send it again.

Send somebody a ticket is for someone who has already paid you, by phone, at your own door or any other way, or who comes free. We email them a link, and opening it confirms their place straight away and sends them their ticket, with the code to show at the door. They appear on your board as confirmed when they open it. The site never takes the money; you settle it with them yourself.

Two things are worth knowing before you use either.

Nothing is held until they click. Neither an invitation nor a ticket reserves a room or a day pass until the link is opened, and the screen says so clearly. If the day passes have run out by the time a ticket is opened, it arrives

on your board as a request instead, for you to sort out.

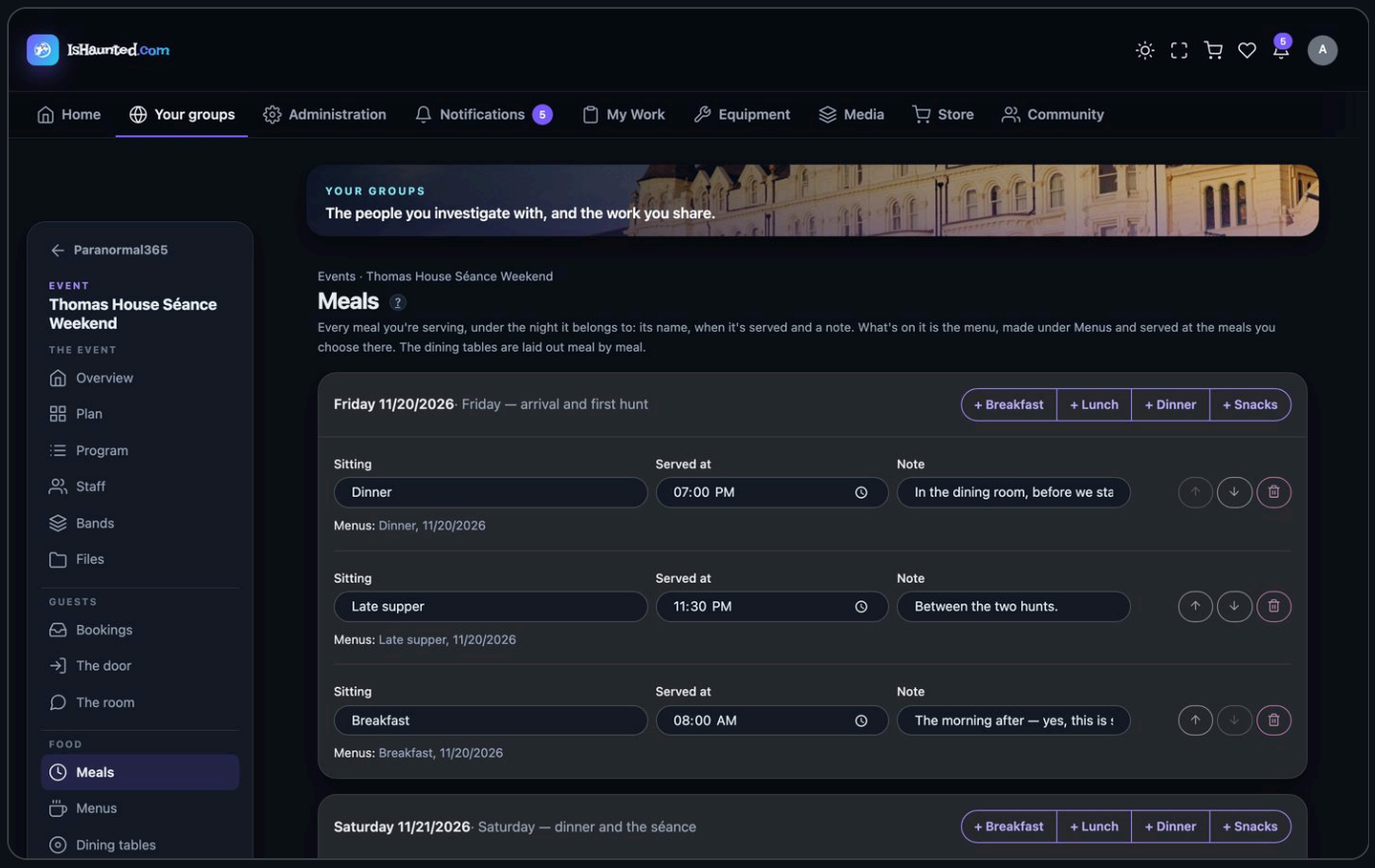
It only ever requests a day pass. Staying overnight means choosing rooms night by night, which a link can't do. So if they are staying over, move them into a room when you confirm, just as you assign every other room.

The link is valid for two weeks and works once. Sending it again to the same address replaces the old one instead of adding a second guest, and if they had already asked for a place themselves, they are combined into one party. If your site has no email set up, we tell you the message wasn't sent, so you aren't left waiting.

If an event isn't published yet, has been canceled, or doesn't sell day passes, the invitation is refused and the message says which — much better than thirty people finding out two weeks later.

Meals

Meals, from the event page, is the event's schedule of food: every night, and under each night, every meal you serve, with its time and a note. What's on a meal is its **menu**, which you make under **Menus** (below) and attach to the meals it's served at. The dining tables are laid out meal by meal.

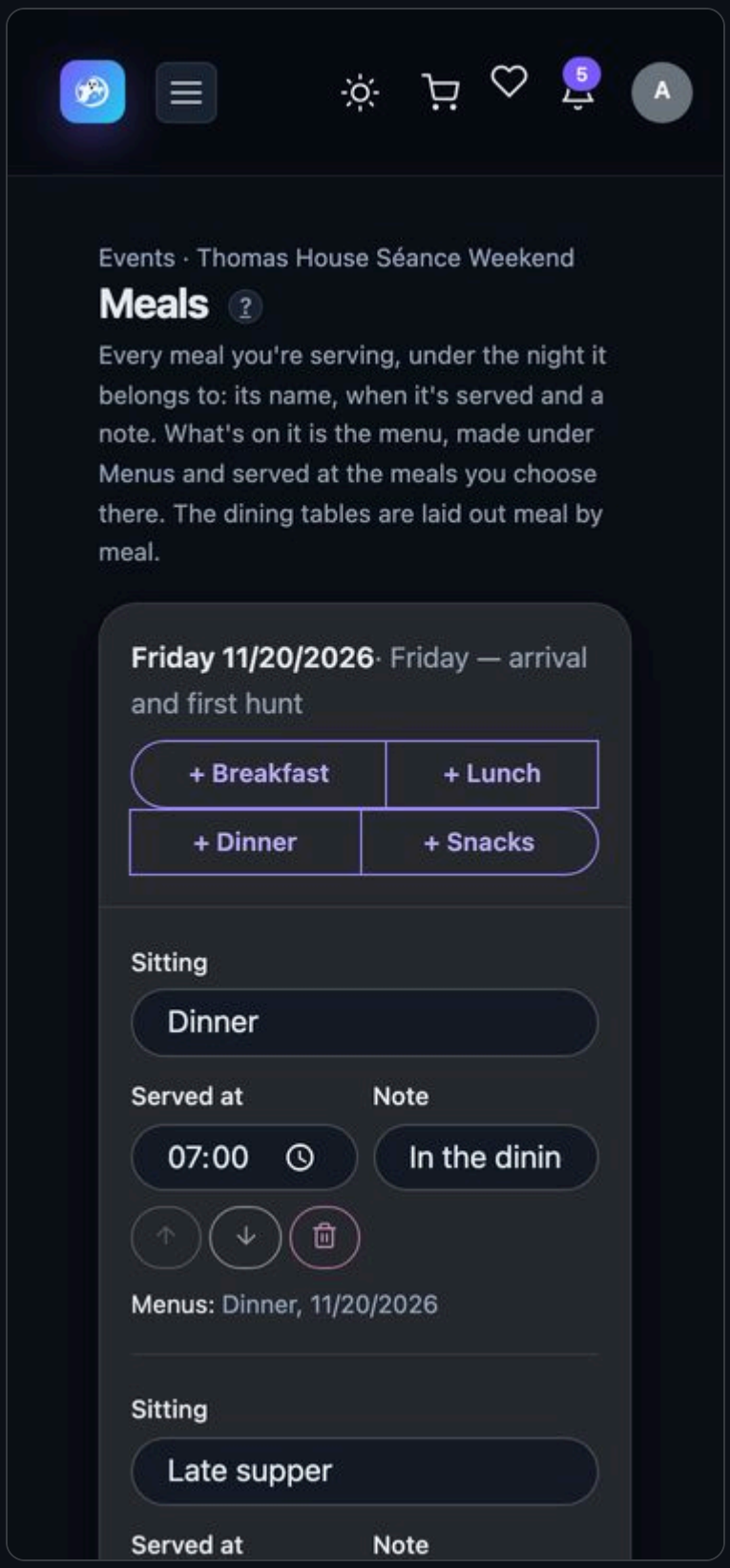


Each night's heading has four buttons, **+ Breakfast**, **+ Lunch**, **+ Dinner** and **+ Snacks**, and each one adds a meal under that night. They're only a starting point: once added, the name is an ordinary text box, so a midnight vigil supper can be called whatever you like. Add a time if it has one and a note if it needs one. Under each meal, the page lists the menus served at it.

The arrows beside a meal move it **within its night**, and the order in the list is the order it's served. The trash can removes it. Nothing is saved until you press **Save the meals**, which saves the whole weekend at once.

A night runs from the evening people arrive to the next morning. So Friday night's meals include Saturday's breakfast, and the last night of a weekend still includes breakfast on the day everyone leaves. Meals appear in the order you arrange them, not by time, because an 8 a.m. breakfast comes *after* the 7 p.m. dinner the night before.

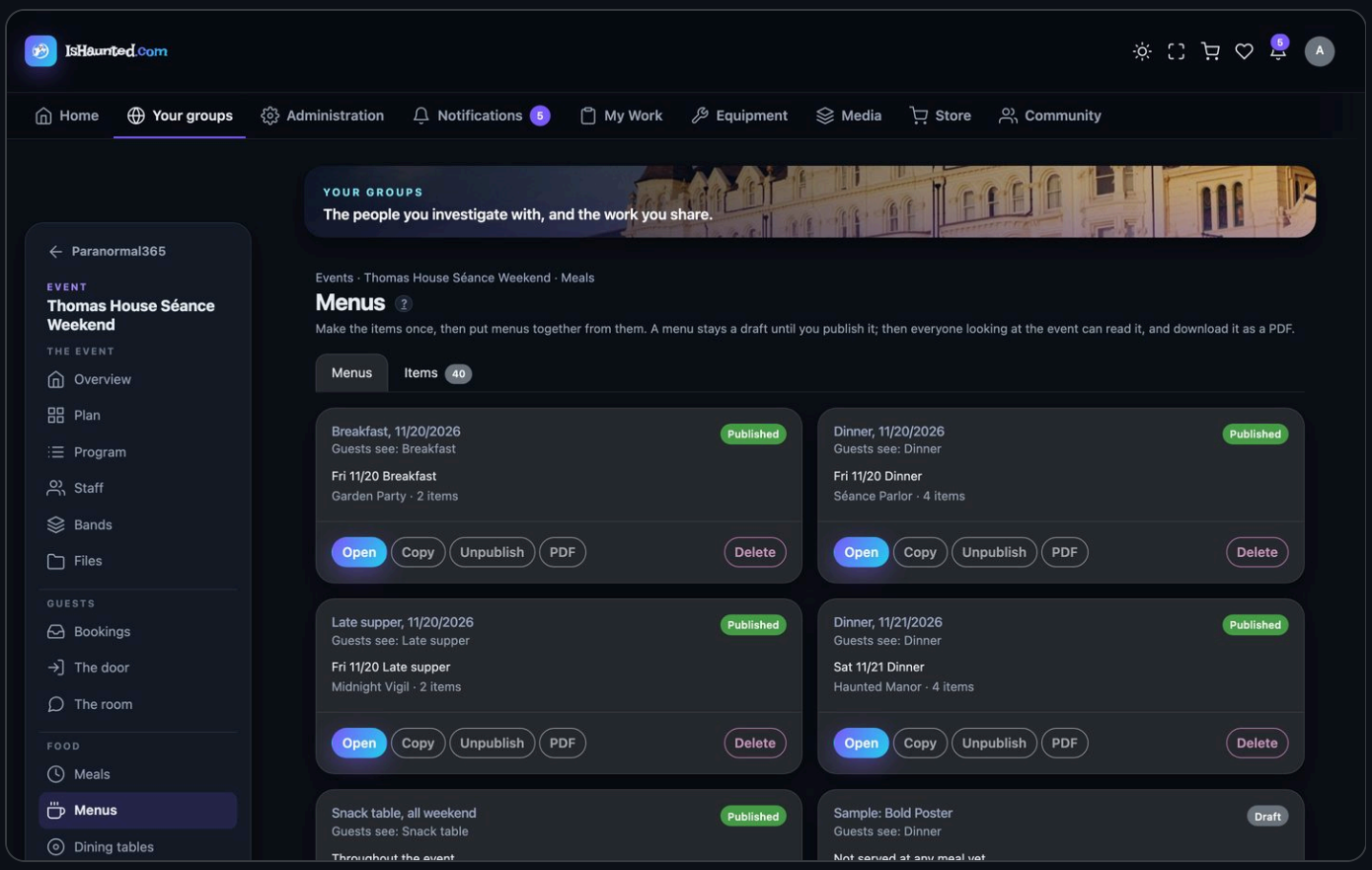
The page works on a phone too, if you need to add a meal on the go.



Menus

Menus, from the event page, is where you make the food guests read about: the items, then menus put together from them, each in a look of its own. A menu stays a **draft** until you publish it. Then everyone looking

at the event can read it on the event's page, beside the dates it's served on, and download it as a PDF.



Items, and where they're kept

The **Items** tab lists everything this event's menus can use. Each item has a name, an optional description and picture, a **category** (Appetizers, Sandwiches, Snacks, Drinks…), what it is (vegan, vegetarian, gluten free…) and what it contains (milk, eggs, tree nuts and the other major allergens). The categories are one list for the whole site. If yours isn't there, add it from the item's form and every event after can use it too. A name the list already has, however it's capitalized, isn't added twice.

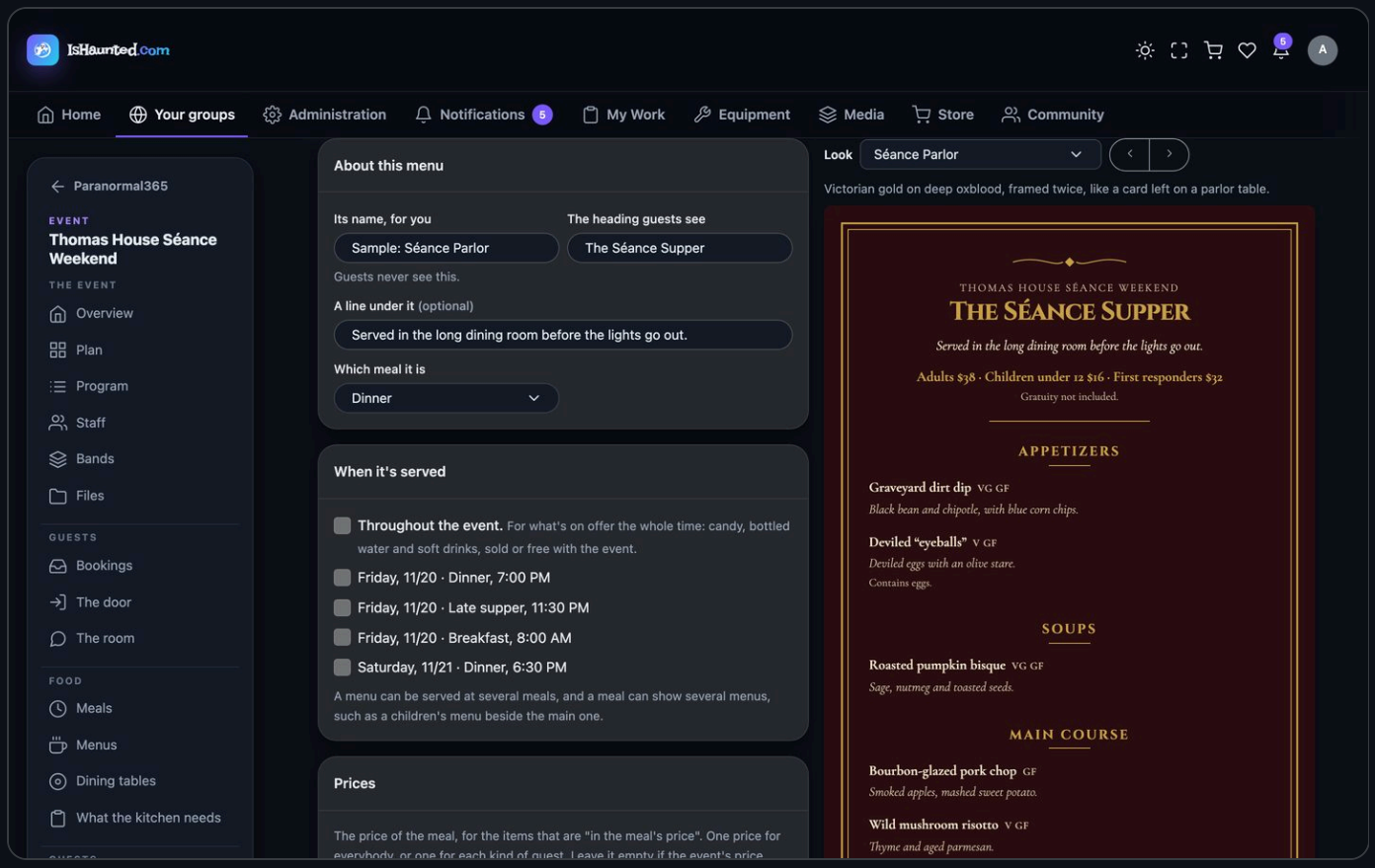
When you make an item, you choose where to keep it:

- **Just this event.** Only this event's menus can use it.
- **Your group.** Every event your group holds can use it, wherever it is. Good for what you always bring, like the pizza order your group gets every time.
- **This venue.** Every event held at this venue can use it, whichever group holds it. Good for what the venue's own kitchen serves; the Thomas House's own menus, for example, belong here. The venue can change these items too.

Changing an item changes it on every menu that has it. **Remove** stops offering it for new menus; menus that already have it keep it.

Putting a menu together

Start a menu with a name for yourself, such as *Friday dinner, adults*, and a look. Guests never see that name; they see the **heading** you give the menu, or the meal's name if you don't.



On the menu:

- **Which meal it is**: breakfast, brunch, lunch, supper, dinner, snacks, drinks or dessert. It can stay unchosen while you work.
- **When it's served**: tick the meals it's served at. A menu can be served at several meals, and a meal can show several menus, such as a children's menu or a vegan menu beside the main one. Or choose **Throughout the event** for what's on offer the whole time: candy at $2, bottled water and soft drinks, sold or free with the event.
- **Sections**: add a section for each category, then add items to it from that category. The arrows move sections and items; the order on the screen is the order on the menu. A section can have a heading of its own, such as *From the grill*.
- **How each item is paid for**:
- **In the meal's price.** Covered by the menu's price. A menu with any of these needs that price.
- **Covered by the event.** Part of what guests paid for the event. The event's page says what the event's price includes, under the dates.
- **Priced on its own.** An extra or an add-on, such as alcohol, or blue cheese on a steak. Give its price.

- **Alcohol** has its own mark, **21+**. Anything marked as alcohol is always priced on its own; the menu won't save if it's in the meal's price or covered by the event.
- **Prices**: the meal's price, as one amount for everybody or one for each kind of guest. The buttons **+ Adults**, **+ Children**, **+ Seniors**, **+ First responders** and **+ Military** add a row with its name filled in, and you can type any other. A note under them can say *Gratuity not included*.
- **A logo or picture** at the top of the menu.

The look, and the preview

The preview beside the form shows the menu as it looks with what's typed now, saved or not, so you can check it at any time. **Look** changes the design, and the arrows step through them, so you can try each one against your own menu before you decide. There are twenty-five:

- **Thirteen for ghost hunting:** Séance Parlor, Haunted Manor, Spirit Board, Midnight Vigil, Case File, EVP Static, Witching Hour, Graveyard Shift, Victorian Mourning, Hallowed Ground, Lantern Light, Ectoplasm and Asylum Records.
- **Twelve for anything:** Classic Bistro, Elegant Evening, Garden Party, Chalkboard Café, Rustic Farmhouse, Modern Minimal, Art Deco, Retro Diner, Harvest Table, Bold Poster, Coastal Breeze and Handwritten Notes.

Each is set in its own typefaces, such as Séance Parlor's engraved capitals, Haunted Manor's blackletter and Case File's typewriter, and the PDF uses the same ones.

Séance Parlor

Victorian gold on deep oxblood, framed twice, like a card left on a parlor table.

Haunted Manor

Gothic black and crimson in a blackletter hand, for a house with a reputation.

Spirit Board

Aged sepia, old print and a planchette, in the style of a talking board.

Midnight Vigil

Candlelight on a midnight sky, for the meal before the lights go out.

Case File

Typed on a manila folder and stamped, like the investigation's own paperwork.

EVP Static

A recorder's waveform on a dark screen: modern, spare and a little uneasy.

Witching Hour

Lavender on deep violet in ornate capitals, for the meal at midnight.

Graveyard Shift

Dripping letters in moss green on charcoal, for a night that doesn't take itself too seriously.

Victorian Mourning

Black-edged white card and an engraved italic, as a house in mourning would set its table.

Hallowed Ground

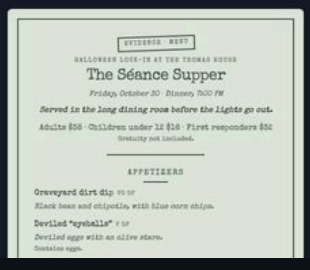
Weathered stone and an old uncial hand, like the lettering on a churchyard gate.

Lantern Light

Amber paper and a calligraphic hand, read by the light of a lantern on a ghost walk.

Ectoplasm

Glowing green on black and a rounded display face: a spirit caught on a night-vision camera.



The design picker shows each one as a finished sample menu, and a new menu starts in Séance Parlor.

Every menu ends with a very small line: *IsHaunted.com © 2026 ISHAUNTED LLC*, with the current year.

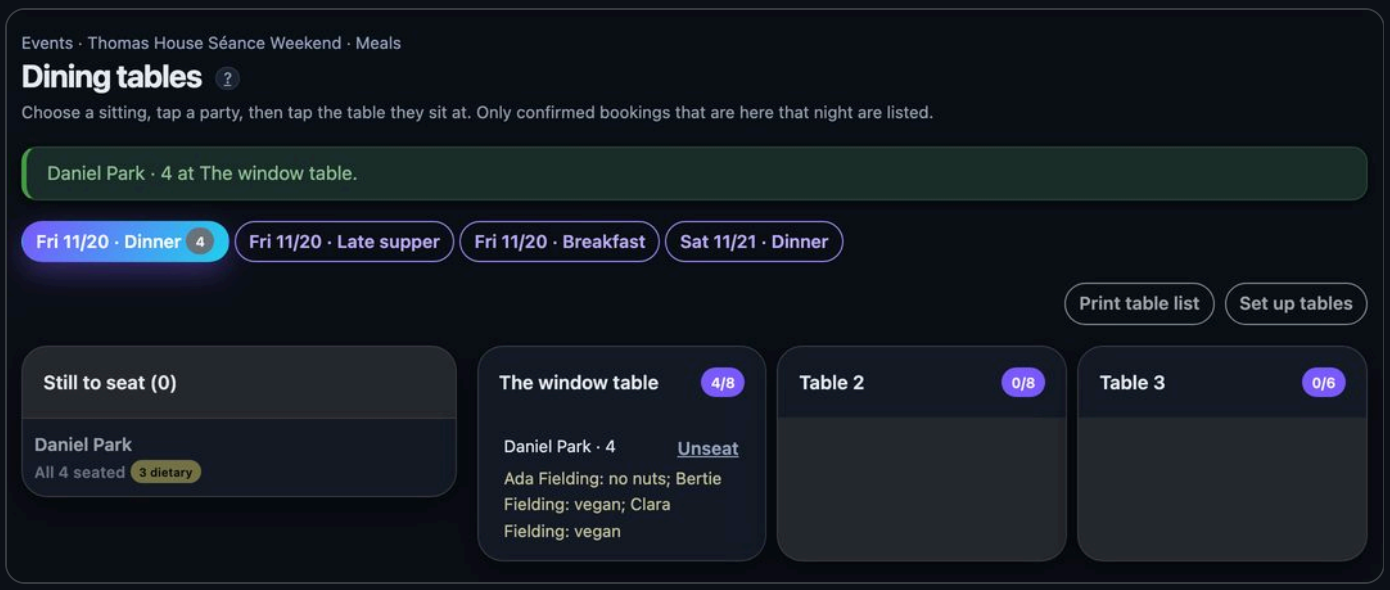
Published menus also appear on your group's calendar, on the event's entry for each date they're served, and in the calendar file guests download from the event's page.

Publishing, copies and the PDF

- **Save and publish** shows the menu to everyone looking at the event. It needs at least one item, the meals it's served at (or *Throughout the event*), and a price if any item is in the meal's price. **Unpublish** makes it a draft again.
- **Make a copy** makes *Friday dinner Copy 1* (then *Copy 2*, and so on) with everything but its meals and its publishing. Change the copy and the original stays as it was.
- **Download the PDF** gives you the menu, in its look, ready to print or send. Guests can download each published menu as a PDF from the event's page too.

Dining tables

Dining tables, from the event page, decides who sits where at each meal.



1. **Set up the tables** once for the event — a name and how many it seats, or *Add 6 tables of 8* to start. The same tables are used at every sitting.
2. **Choose a sitting** from the buttons at the top. Each sitting is a meal from the Meals page.

3. **Tap a party, then tap a table.** The party is seated there. To split a big party, change how many to seat before you tap the table, then seat the rest at another.

Only confirmed bookings staying that night are listed, showing how many in each party still need a seat, and a badge if anyone in the party has dietary notes. A table never seats more people than it has chairs; if a party doesn't fit, the page tells you how many chairs are left. If a booking is canceled, it is removed from its table automatically.

Seat the same way copies the seating from another meal, so everyone who is at both meals sits at the same table again. **Print table list** prints each table with who sits there and their dietary notes, for the kitchen and the dining room. Guests see their table on their pass.

Changing a meal's name or its menus keeps its seating. Removing a meal or a table removes its seating.

The confirmation email and the pass

Confirming a booking sends the guest an email, and the email includes their pass. You don't have to remember to send anything. Without a pass, a confirmed guest would have to be looked up by name at the door, which is exactly the line this is meant to avoid.

The email lists their nights and their room, repeats anything you typed in the decision note, and includes a **QR code**. Turning a booking down or releasing one sends an email too, the same way, so guests who *aren't* coming are told just as reliably as those who are. A refusal includes your reason, because a refusal without one feels arbitrary, and the most common reasons are ones the guest can do something about.

A confirmation also includes a **calendar file with one entry per night**, each naming the room. A single entry for the whole weekend wouldn't tell them where they are sleeping on Saturday.

If your site has no email set up, nothing is sent, but the decision still stands. A confirmed guest whose email bounced is still confirmed.

The pass, and the door

One pass admits the whole party. There isn't one per person: three of four people arriving together may never have given us an email address, and one person holding one code is easier than four people at the door each looking for their own.

Scan it at the door and you see who they are, how many, which nights and which room. If the code won't scan — a dead battery, or a camera that won't focus in the dark — everything the scan would have shown is also written out on the guest's own pass screen, so you can still let them in.

Every refusal at the door is a sentence you can read aloud. You never just see "invalid", which doesn't tell you whether to send someone to the desk, ask them to wait, or turn them away:

- a code from another event names that event, because someone showing last month's pass is the most common case, and naming it settles things quickly;
- a withdrawn pass shows the reason you gave when you withdrew it;
- a booking that isn't confirmed yet says so, rather than suggesting the code is fake.

Scanning the same party twice isn't refused. You are told when they first arrived and can decide for yourself, so nobody is turned away for coming back in from the parking lot.

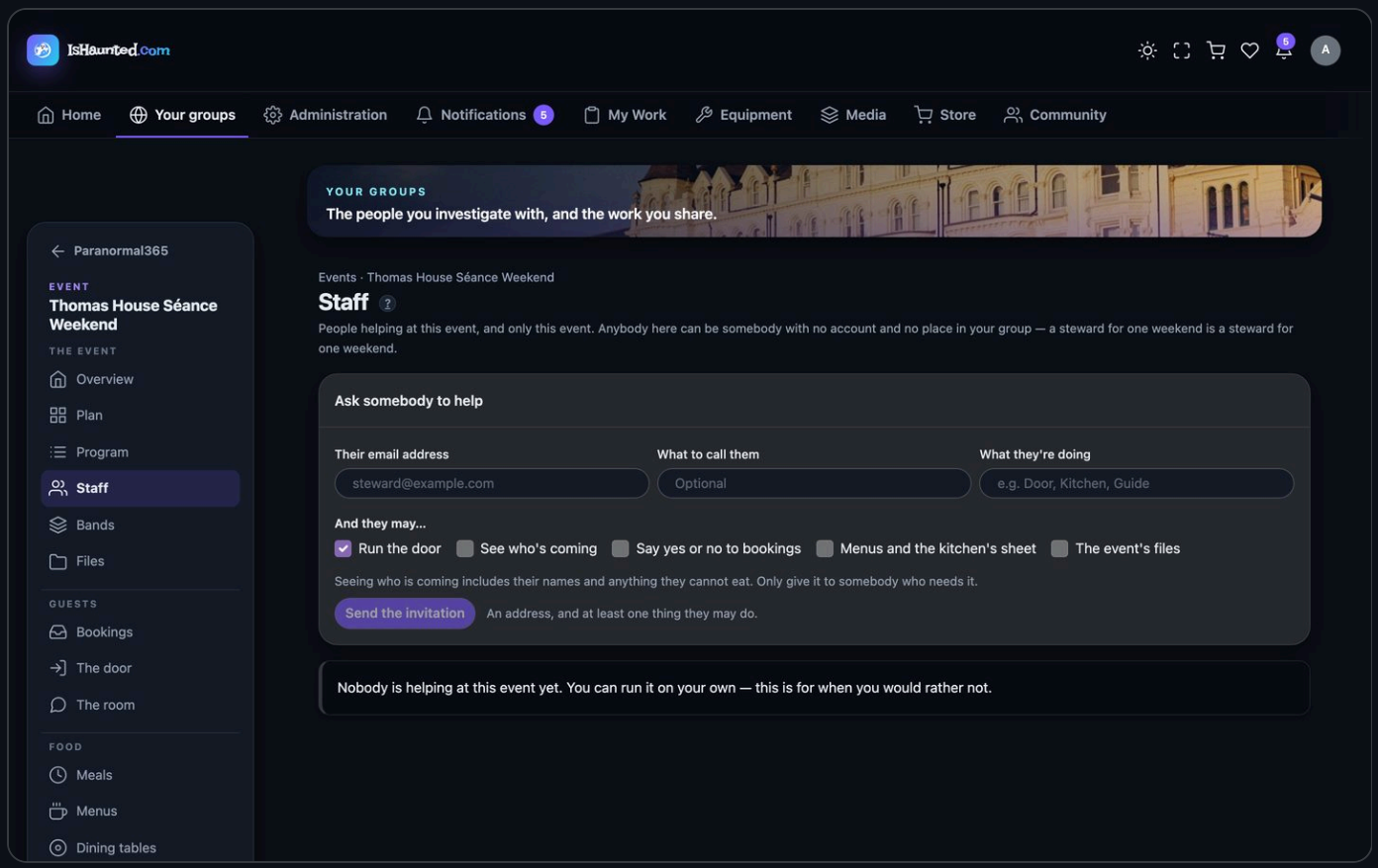
Replacing a pass

A pass is never edited, only replaced. If you change a booking's party size or nights, the old pass is withdrawn automatically and a new one is issued, so the code someone is carrying can never show the wrong details. **Reissue** does the same thing on demand, for a guest who lost the email. **Revoke** withdraws a pass without replacing it, and asks you for a reason, because that reason is what the door shows.

A withdrawn pass is kept rather than deleted. Someone showing an old code is told it was replaced, which is different from being told it was never valid.

Who is helping, and the door

The person on the door doesn't need billing rights. A hotel might put a weekend helper on the door who isn't in your group and never will be. Event staff let you give that helper exactly what they need, without giving them access to your billing.



Staff on the event page invites someone by email and sets what they can do. There are five switches, and each one is independent:

- **Run the door** — scan passes and check people in. Most helpers only need this one.
- **See who's coming** — the board, with guests' names and anything they can't eat.

- **Say yes or no to bookings** — making decisions, which includes seeing the board.
- **Menus and the kitchen's sheet** — making and publishing the menus, and reading what the kitchen needs.
- **The event's files.**

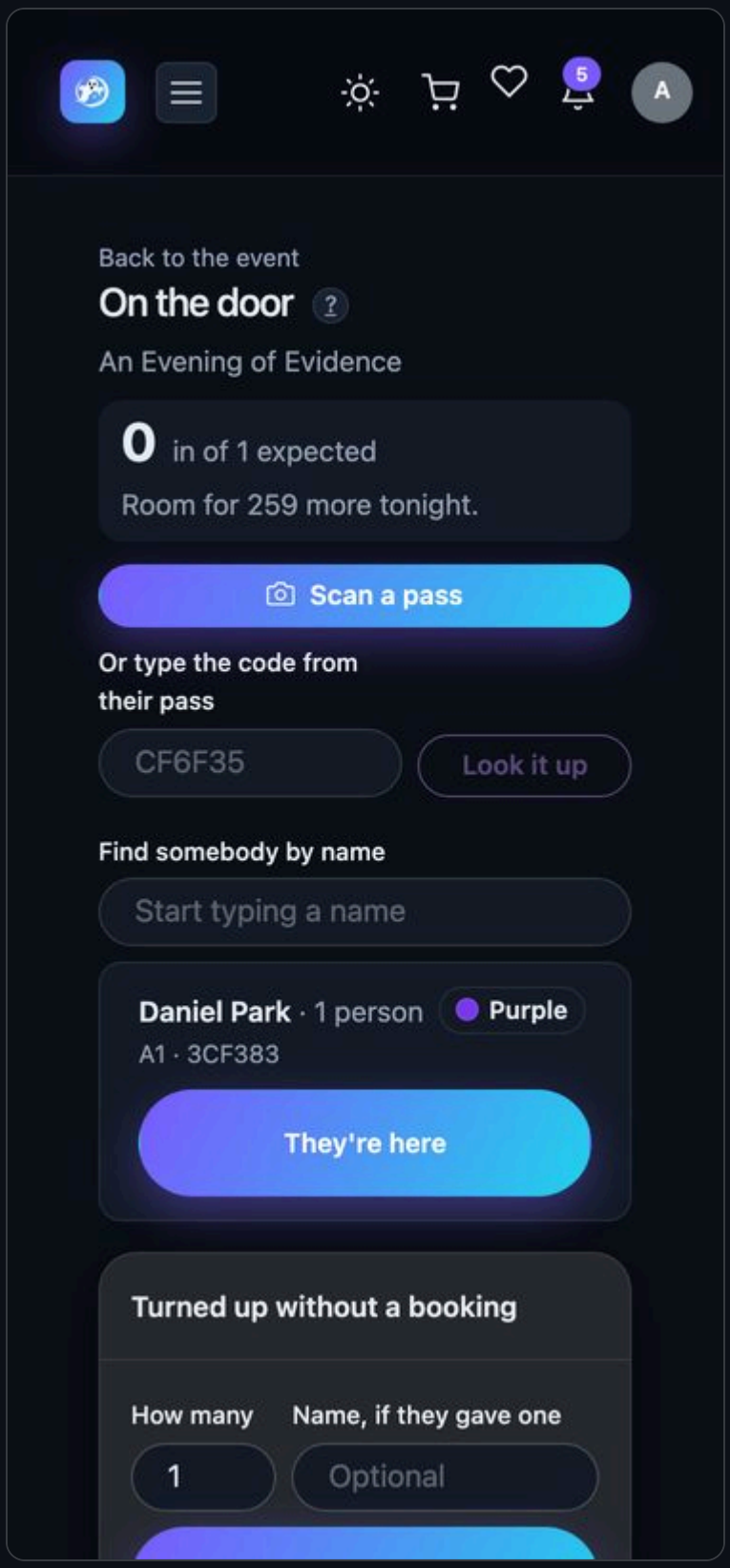
The role — *Door*, *Kitchen*, *Guide* — is just a label for your own schedule. It doesn't grant anything.

An invitation grants nothing until it is accepted, and the list clearly marks anyone who hasn't accepted yet. Before they press the button, the email tells them which event, which venue and exactly what they are being trusted with. If they don't have an account, accepting creates one.

It applies to this event only. A helper for Saturday has no access on Sunday, and is not a member of your group. **Remove** takes effect the next time they tap anything.

On the door

The door screen is designed for phones, because that's where it gets used — one thumb, in the dark, with someone standing in front of you.



- **The count comes first**: how many are in, out of how many are expected, and **how many more could come in tonight**. That last number is usually what people ask you.
- **Scan a pass** with the camera. If the browser can't read QR codes — mostly Safari — we load a reader the first time, and nothing else changes. If the camera won't start, a message tells you what to do instead,

including when a venue is testing on its own network over `http`.

- **Type the code** from the guest's pass when the camera won't work. It is the six characters printed under their QR code.
- **Find somebody by name** if they have lost the email entirely.
- **They're here** checks them in, **Left** checks them out again, and **Not them** undoes it — since it is easy to tap the wrong row at a busy door.

Arrivals are counted per night. Somebody checked in on Friday isn't checked in on Saturday, so the Saturday count is accurate, and afterward you can see exactly who was there on Saturday.

Somebody who just shows up is recorded as a walk-up: how many, and a name if they gave one. No account is created for them and they don't get a pass — the goal is an accurate count, for the kitchen and for fire safety. If letting them in would go over the limit, the door won't allow it, because the number at the top only matters if it is enforced.

If you don't expect a signal, print the page before the doors open, since a browser can't scan a code without a connection. Or run the door from the iPhone or iPad app, which can.

Selling tickets at the door. Turn on **Sell tickets at the door** on the door page and you get a QR code. Print the poster, or leave it on a tablet by the door. Somebody who scans it with their phone sees the event and the day-pass price, signs in or makes an account, and asks for a place. They pay you however you take money; the site never handles it. Then whoever is on the door presses **Paid — confirm** beside their name, and their pass is on their phone, ready to scan in. The door may confirm only the places asked for at the door; every other booking stays with whoever decides bookings. Only the organizer turns door sales on or off, and turning them off stops the printed code working.

- **An account is needed at the door.** A guest makes one with an email address before asking, so their pass, the room and the results letter have somewhere to go.
- **A sold-out event still takes requests at the door.** What somebody asks for becomes a request on the booking board, and you or the door can confirm it if a place opens up.

Who's at the classes, linked from the door, lists each class with a switch per person with a place, so a helper running the door can mark who came without opening the program, which is your group's. The app has the same screen under the door.

On the iPhone or iPad app. Anyone who can run an event's door — a group member with door access, a helper who accepted an invitation, or the venue's own staff if the venue granted it — will find **Doors I'm running** under **Profile**. The door there works the same way, with two differences that matter in a cellar with no signal:

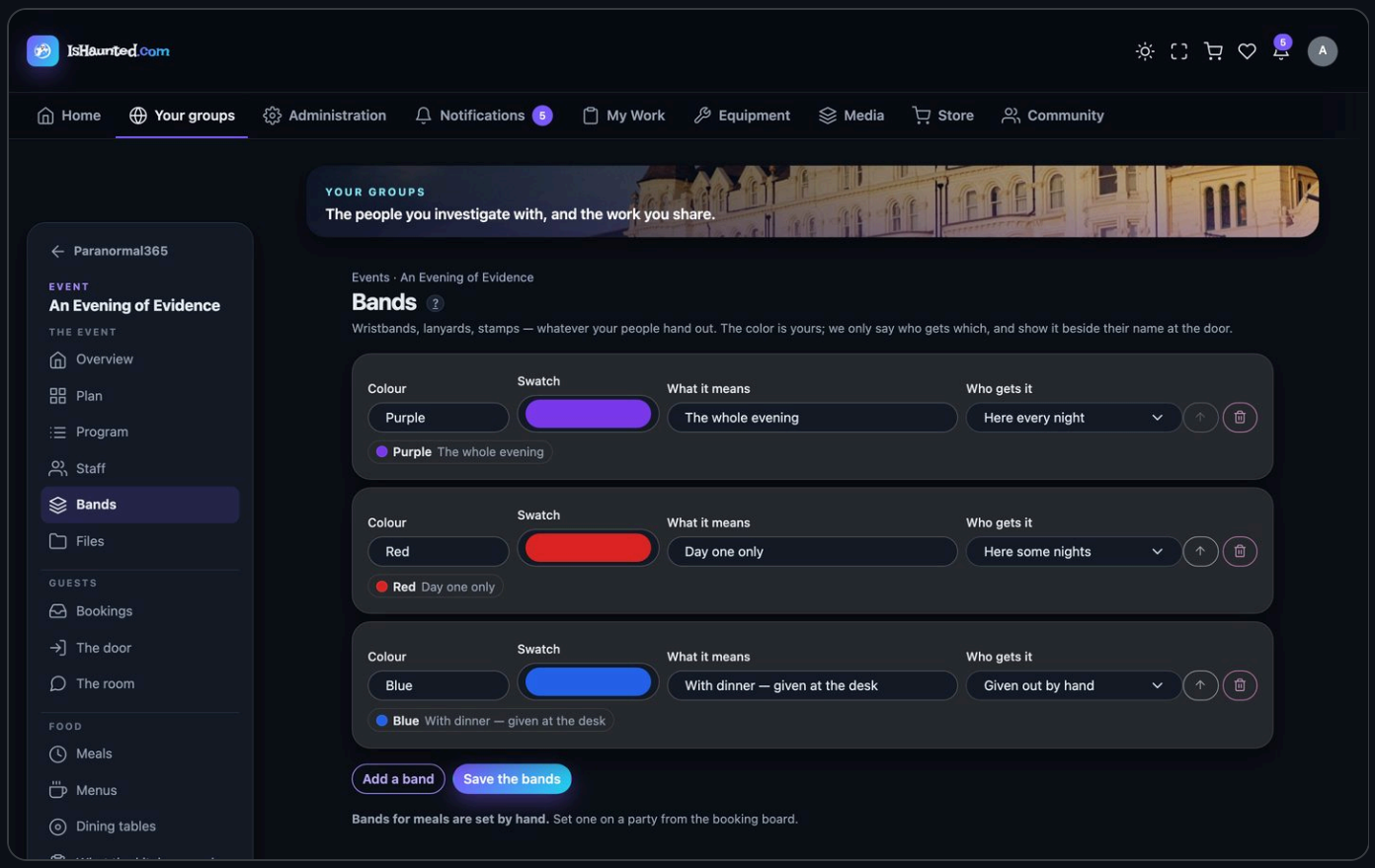
- **Scanning finds the reservation; it doesn't check anyone in.** The camera reads the code and the app shows the matching reservation. The person on the door taps it, sees who it is, and checks them in — the whole party, or however many are actually there. The code is read on the phone itself, so this works with no signal.
- **Tonight's list is saved on the phone** once it has been opened. With no signal, a scanned pass is matched to its reservation on that list by its code, and each check-in is saved on the phone **with the time they came in**,

then sent as soon as there is a signal. Your list and count on the website then show when they actually arrived, not when the phone got a signal back.

A pass you withdrew while the phone was offline is still refused once the phone reconnects, and the app lists that person by name so someone can find them. Recording a walk-up, or undoing a check-in that has already been recorded, needs a signal, because it has to be checked against the count first.

Bands

Wristbands, lanyards, a stamp on the hand — whatever your team gives out so a steward can tell **at a glance** what someone is here for. *Blue is the whole weekend with dinner, purple is the whole weekend, red is Saturday only.*



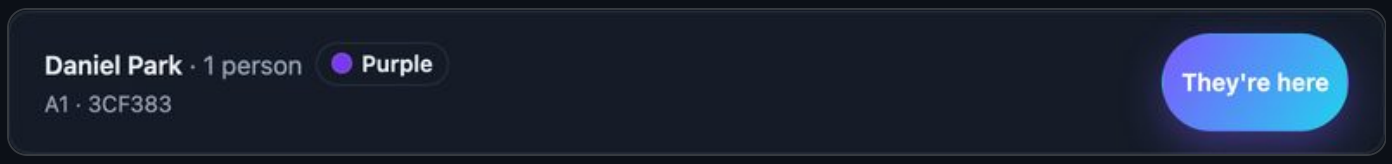
Bands on the event page lists them. Each one has a color — in **your** words, so if the wristbands in your drawer are labeled orange, the screen says orange too — plus an optional swatch, what it means, and who gets it:

- **Here every night** — the whole run.
- **Here some nights** — for example, the Saturday-only guest, who is the one stewards most often get wrong.
- **Day pass** — here for the day, not staying.
- **Given out by hand** — you choose, party by party.

Most parties never need a band assigned by hand. Their band is worked out from what they booked, so two hundred guests don't mean two hundred decisions. **The first rule that matches wins**, in the order shown on the page, so put *every night* above *some nights* if that's what you want.

Bands for meals have to be given out by hand. Nothing on a booking says whether a party is eating, so the site can't work it out. Open the party on the booking board and choose the band under **What they wear**; *Worked out from the rules* switches them back to automatic.

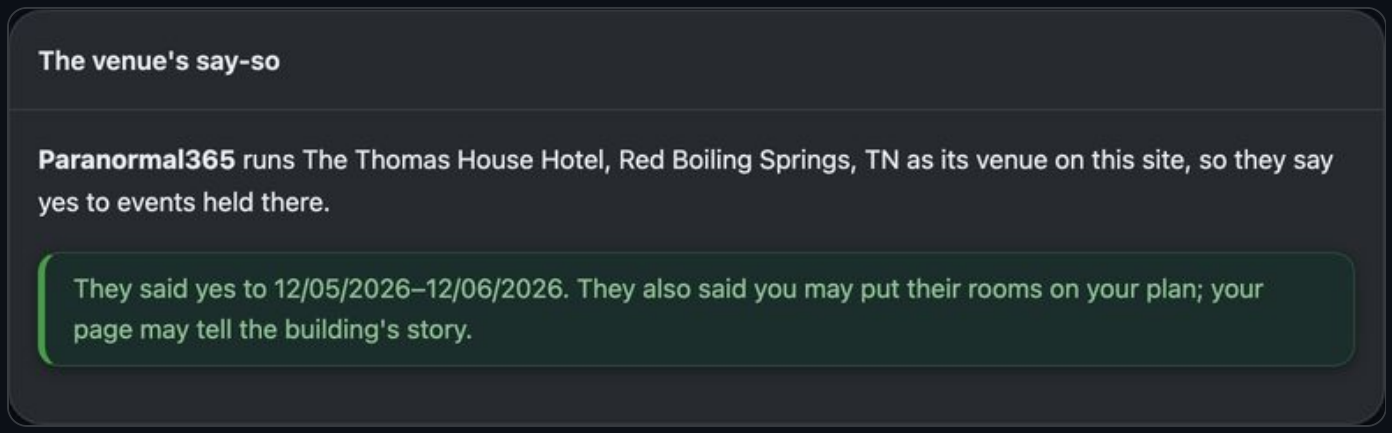
The band then appears **beside their name at the door**, on the booking board, and on the guest's own pass — so guests already know they are blue without being told.



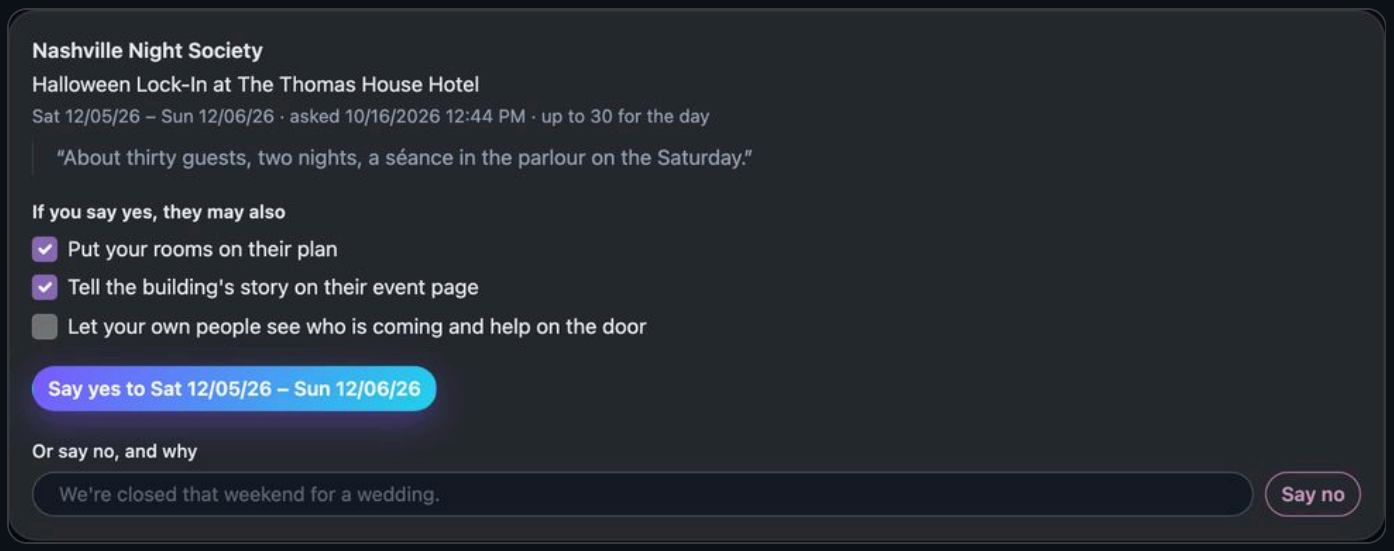
Venues on this site

No group owns a place, and several groups can hold events or investigate at the same building. But a group can be **confirmed as the venue** for a place — the hotel itself, or the people who run it — and from then on, other groups must ask that venue before they publish an event there.

Asking. On your event's page, **The venue's say-so** shows who runs the place. Write anything they should know and press **Ask**. They are notified right away, and they are asked about your event's exact nights: if you add a night afterward, their yes doesn't cover it, and the checklist tells you. Until they answer, you can withdraw the request.



Answering, as the venue. Hosting requests — from **Your venue** in your group's settings, or from the bell — lists every group waiting for your answer, oldest first, with their event, their nights and their message. **Say yes**, or say no with a reason they will see.



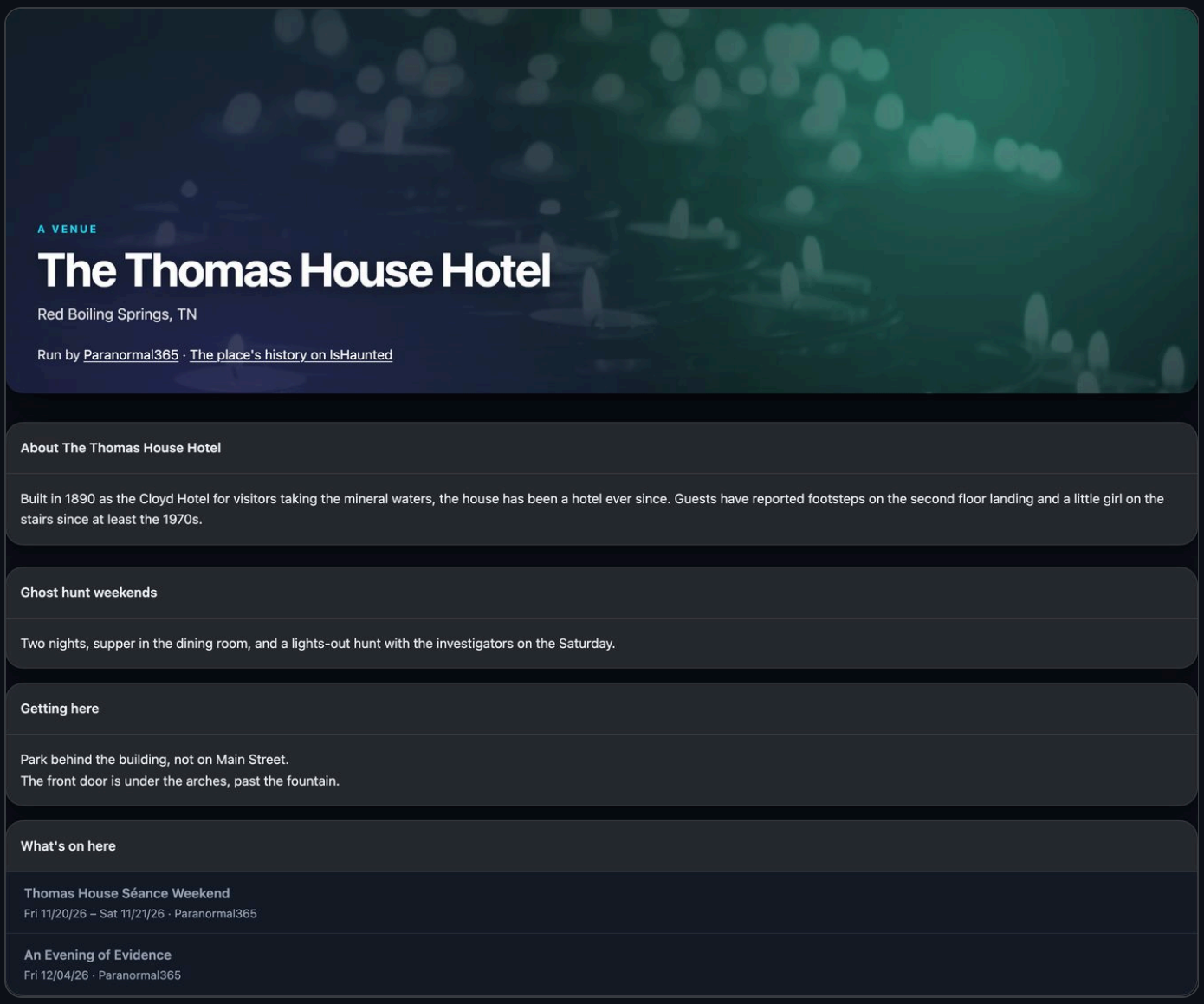
When you say yes, you can also share three things, each one optional:

- **Your rooms**, so their plan can use the rooms you have already described, instead of them entering your building all over again.
- **The building's story**, shown on their public event page.
- **Your own staff**, who can then see who is coming and help on the door. They never decide who comes — that stays with the organizer.

Taking a yes back. Withdraw… asks for a reason and tells you exactly what will happen first. Every published event that depends on that yes is stopped: its page says the venue withdrew, everyone with a place is emailed with your reason, their passes stop working, and the organizer gets back any credit they spent, however close to the date it is — since it isn't their fault. Events that have already happened aren't affected.

Your venue page. Under **Your venue**, describe each place you run — its story, house rules, how many people it can sleep — and, once you are confirmed as the venue, make the page public. It lists your public rooms and every event at the place, whoever is running it, and the place's own page links to it.

Write as much as you like, and add your own sections. There is no length limit on the story or the house rules. Below them, **Add a section** gives you a heading and as much text as you need — ghost hunt weekends, dining, shows, the chapel, directions. Add as many as you want, reorder them with the arrows, and remove one with the trash can. They appear on your venue page under their own headings, in that order, after the building's story. Each section needs a heading; empty sections are dropped when you save.



Describing a place doesn't make you its venue. Any group can write about a hall it rents every October, and it doesn't affect anyone else. Being confirmed as the venue is a separate step, explained below. Until then, the page stays private, because a public venue page would suggest you run the building.

The Thomas House Hotel

Confirmed as the venue 10/16/2026

The building's story

Built in 1890 as the Cloyd Hotel for visitors taking the mineral waters, the house has been a hotel ever since. Guests have reported footsteps on the second floor landing and a little girl on the stairs since at least the 1970s.

Shown on your venue page, and on events you let tell it.

House rules

No open flames upstairs.
Quiet on the second floor after midnight.
Park behind the building, not on Main Street.

Your own sections

+ Add a section

Anything else visitors should know — ghost hunt weekends, dining, shows, the chapel, how to find you. Each one appears on your venue page under its own heading, in this order.

Ghost hunt weekends

Two nights, supper in the dining room, and a lights-out hunt with the investigators on the Saturday.

Getting here

Park behind the building, not on Main Street.
The front door is under the arches, past the fountain.

Most who may stay overnight

22

Show the venue page to everybody

Open the venue page

Save

Photos of the venue

Add a picture

Choose File | No file chosen

Caption

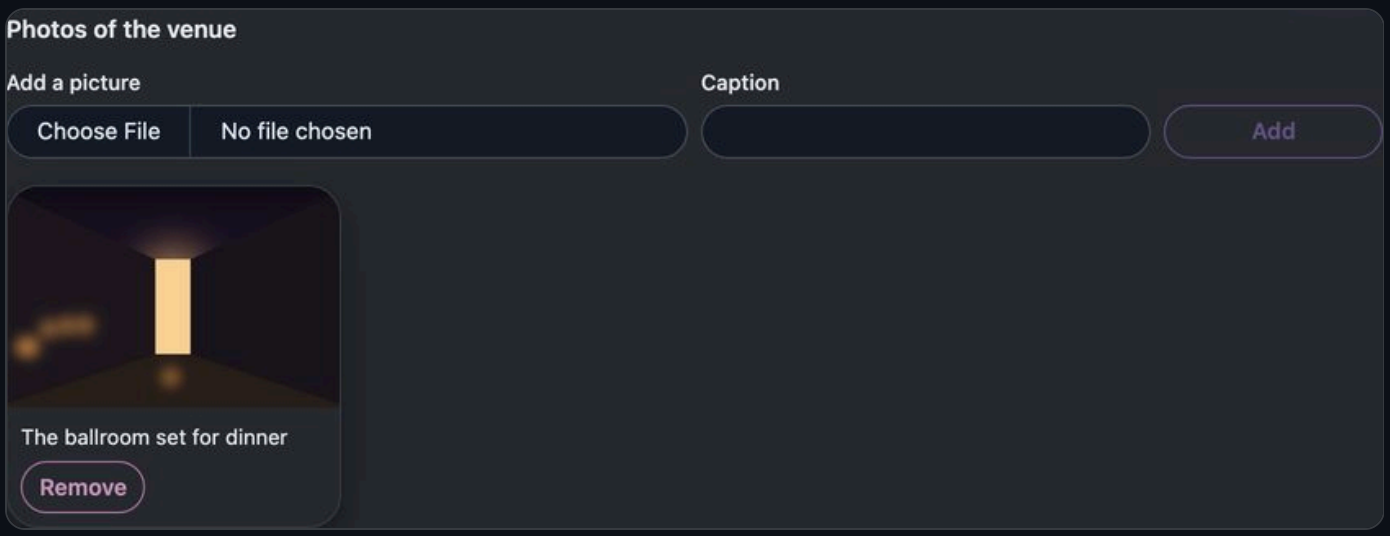
Add

No pictures yet. Organizers who hold events here can offer theirs too.

Files people added to this place (0)

Show held files too

Photos of the venue. Under each place you run, *Photos of the venue* holds pictures of the building — as many as you want; there is no limit. Pictures you add are saved right away. Organizers holding events at your venue can offer pictures from their event's gallery with **Offer to venue**; each offer waits until you press *Keep it* or *No thanks*. Pictures you keep appear on your published venue page, resized and with their location data removed. Declining an offer never removes the picture from the organizer's gallery, and a picture you keep stays in your library even after the organizer's event files are removed.

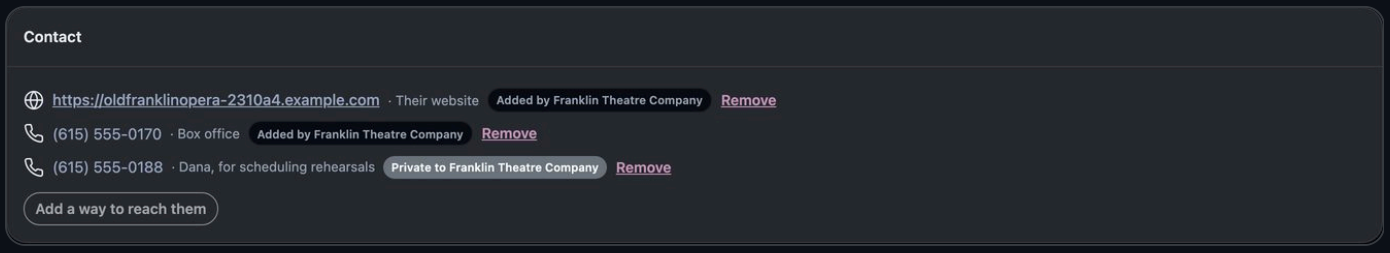


A place's contact details

Every place's page has a **Contact** card: its website, phone numbers and email addresses.

- **Public** details are for anyone — the website, the box office, the front desk.
- **Private** details are your group's own notes — for example, the cell number of the events coordinator you work with. Nobody outside your group sees them.

Until someone is confirmed as running a place, any group can add its public details, and each one shows who added it. **Once a venue is confirmed, it controls the public details.** The venue can press **That's right** on details others added, or remove them, and other groups can only add private notes — the card explains why, rather than showing a switch that does nothing.



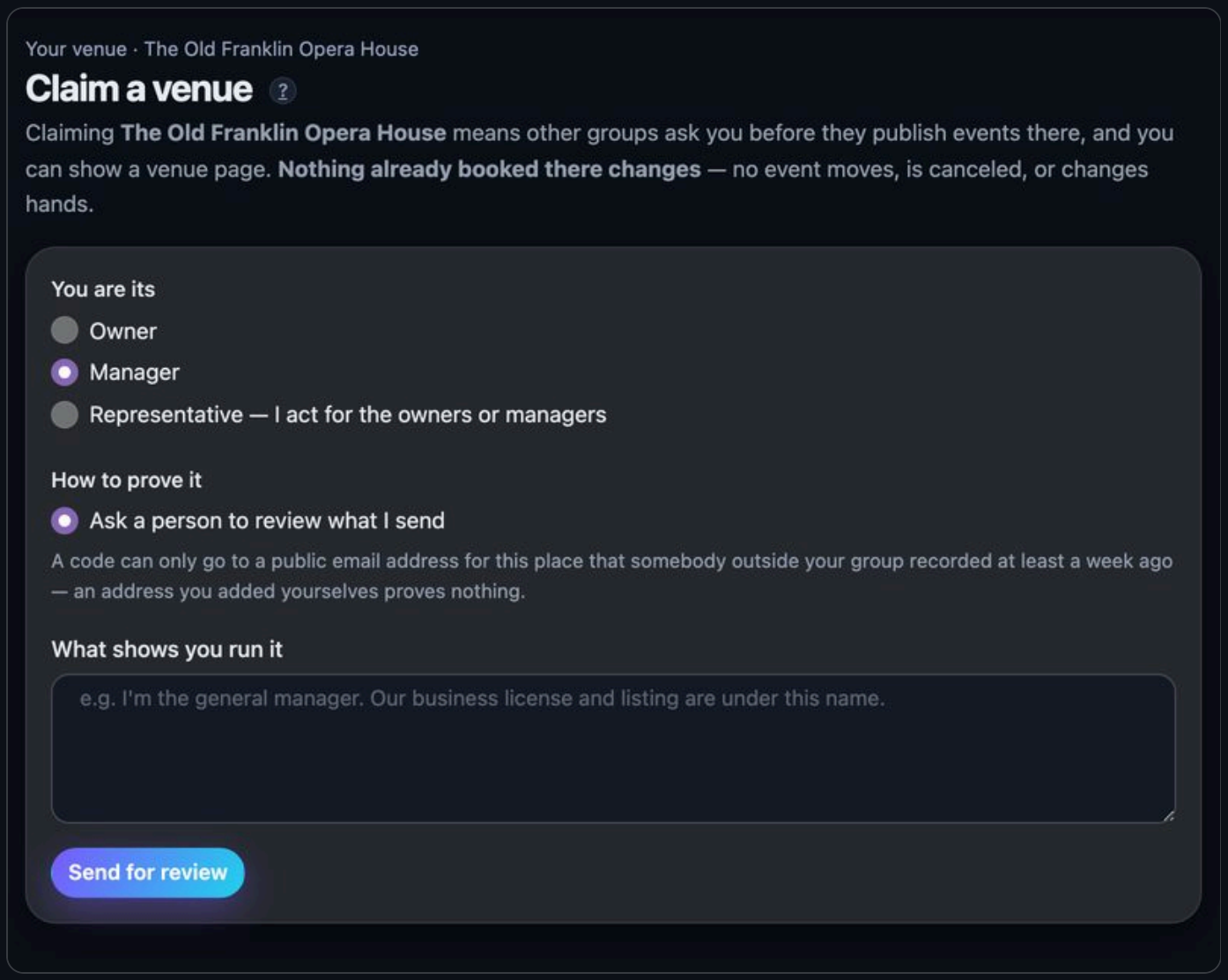
Claiming a venue that is already on the site

Most venues are added to the site by someone else — usually the organizer of an event held there, often months before the venue hears of us. If your group runs a place, open its page and choose **Is this your venue? Claim it**, or **Claim it** beside a place on **Your venue**. Say whether you are its owner, its manager, or a representative acting for them.

A claim applies to the place, never to an event. It decides who future organizers must ask. Nothing already booked there is moved, canceled or transferred, and you can't see who came to events you weren't part of.

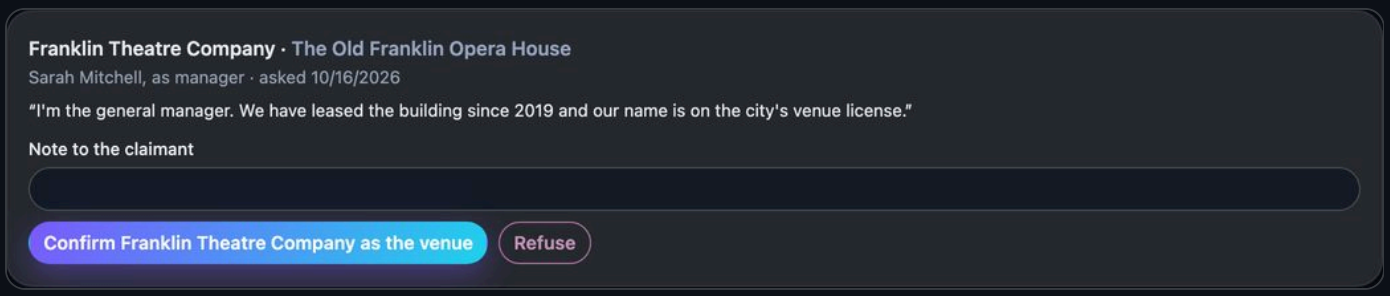
There are two ways to prove your claim:

- **A code sent to the venue's own email.** If a public email address for the place was added by someone **outside** your group at least a week ago, we can send a code there. The address is partly hidden, but you should recognize it as your front desk. Whoever reads that inbox gives you the code. An address your own group added only proves you can read your own email, so it is never offered.
- **A review by a person**, if there is no such address. Tell them what shows you run the place — a license, a listing, your role — and they may contact you.



A proven claim waits a week. Every group connected with the place — that has held events, named rooms, added details, or investigated there — is notified, and any of them can press **This claim is wrong** and give a reason. If anyone objects, the claim goes to a person for review instead. If nobody objects, you are confirmed as the venue when the week is up.

Reviewing claims (site staff) happens at **Venue Claims** in the admin menu. Claims with no proof, and claims someone objected to, are listed first. A confirmed venue that turns out to be wrong can be undone. That takes its page down and means new events there no longer need its approval, but any yes it already gave still stands.



Files people add to your place

Once your group is confirmed as a place's venue, you decide about the photos, videos and recordings people add to that place's public page. Anything the screener doesn't clear waits for you under **Files people added to this place** on **Your venue**, and your owners and administrators get a message when one arrives. Look at it in the card, then press **Approve** to put it on the page or **Hold** to keep it off. Site moderators can decide too, so whoever gets there first settles it.

What visitors see first

What you write about the building on **Your venue** becomes the first thing on the place's public page, under your first photo as the cover, with the map right below it. Your venue page is laid out the same way: your words, the map, then your photos as a slideshow, then your own sections, what's on, the rooms and the house rules. Nothing shows until you publish your venue page.

The program

Program on the event page is where you add the classes, talks and meals — the parts of the weekend guests sign up for one at a time. Add each session with its night, its times **in the venue's time zone** (an end time earlier than the start means the next morning), its location — one of the venue's rooms, or something like "meet at reception" — and who leads it.

- **Guests sign up for a place**, with an optional limit. Leave the limit empty for no limit, or turn sign-ups off for something anyone can just attend.
- Only guests the venue has **confirmed** can sign up, for up to their party's size, along with anyone helping at the event.
- When a session is full, people join a **queue**. When somebody drops out or you raise the limit, the queue moves up in order, a party is never skipped in favor of one person behind it, and whoever gets in is emailed.

- **Who's coming** lists the people with places and the queue, and lets you remove someone.
- **Who was there**: tick **There** beside each person with a place as they arrive at a class, and the list counts how many came. Whoever runs the door can mark it too. Someone still in the queue can't be marked, because they were never let in.

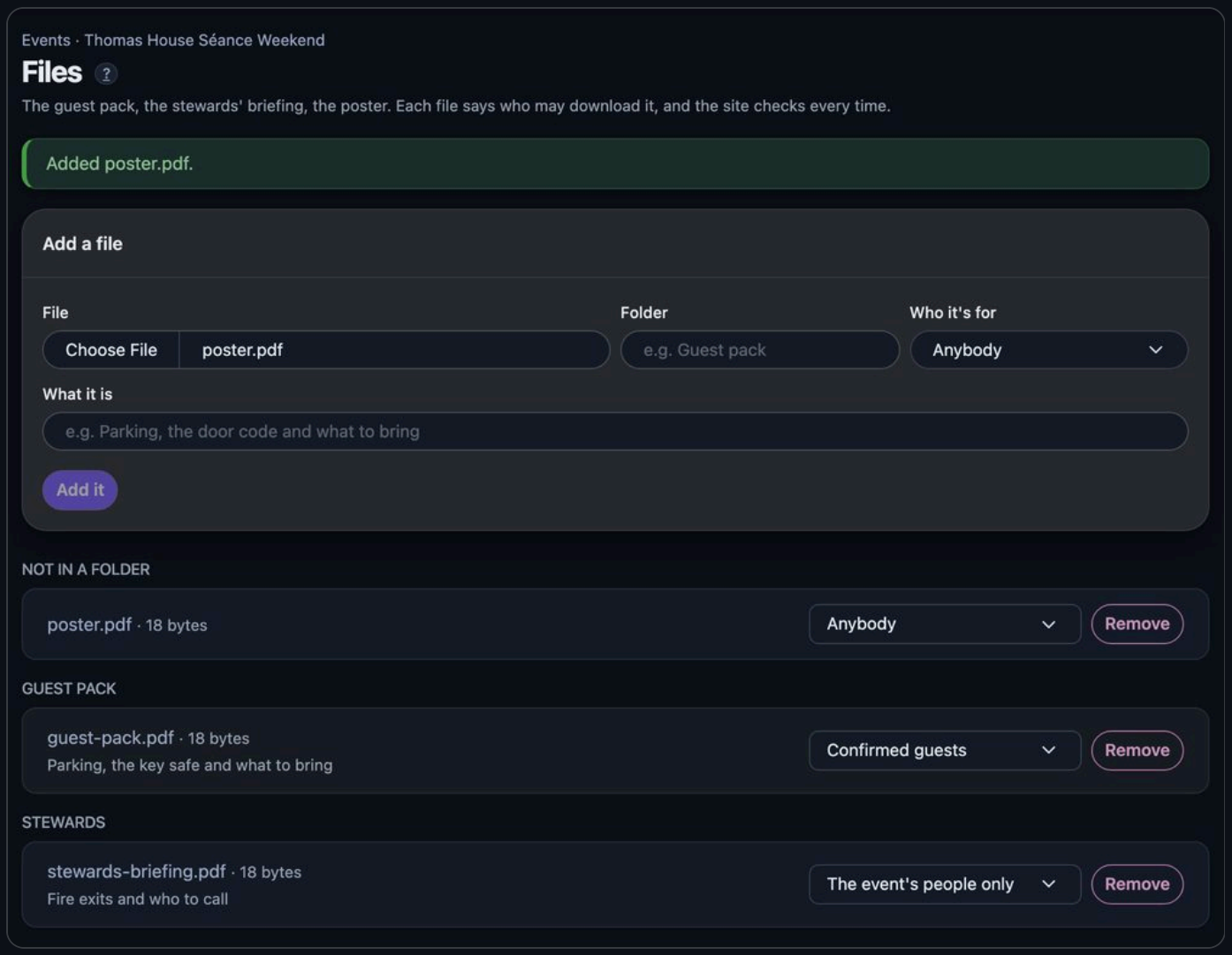
Nothing is shown to guests until you press Publish the program. After that, every change tells you what it will do: **moving** a session emails everyone with a place and notifies them in their bell; **canceling** emails everyone signed up or queued, with your reason. A session someone has signed up for can't simply be removed — cancel it, so they are told.

Files for the event

Files on the event page holds the documents that go with a weekend: the guest pack, the stewards' briefing, the poster. Each file has a **folder** — just a word, like *Guest pack* — and a setting for **who it is for**:

- **The event's people only** — your group, and anyone helping at the event. New files start here.
- **Confirmed guests** — people the venue has said yes to. Someone still waiting for an answer can't see these, since the guest pack might include the lockbox code.
- **Anybody** — shown under *Downloads* on the public event page.

The site checks every time a file is downloaded, so a link pasted into a group chat won't work for someone the file isn't meant for. Changing who a file is for takes effect right away. A helper can add and change files if you check **The event's files** on the staff list. Photos have their location data removed when they are added, like every upload on the site.



The room and the photo wall

Every published event has a **room** on its public page, for the people attending: confirmed guests, your group, anyone helping, and the venue's own staff if the venue shared them. It never appears on the public feed.

- **Photos belong to the guest.** A guest's photo is their own file. They choose whether to share it with your group and, if the venue is on the site, with the venue — sharing it, not giving it away.
- **A guest agrees before their first photo.** The first time a guest adds a photo at your event, they are told it may be shown in the room and on a photo wall or slideshow at the venue, and they check a box to agree. The site keeps a record of that agreement and the exact wording they saw. Your group and your helpers aren't asked.
- **Each event has 2,000 MB** for its files, gallery and room photos combined. An upload over that limit is refused, with a message showing how much space is left; remove files you no longer need to make room.
- **Who can add photos** is up to you, set from the room: *the team and confirmed guests*, or *the event's team only* for an event with a no-cameras rule. Guests can still post messages either way.
- **Hide** removes a post from the room for everyone but you. Members can **Report** a post, and you see how many have. **Close the room** stops new posts early; otherwise it closes a week after the last night.

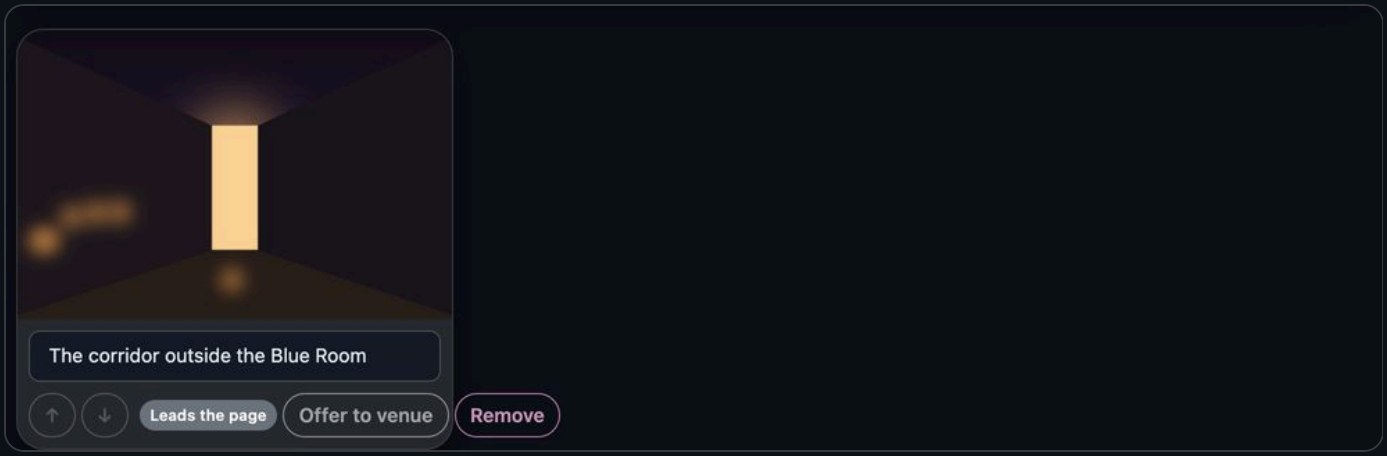
- **Posts from the people running the event stand out**, with a colored edge and a badge: *Organizer* for your group, the role you gave a helper (such as *Guide* or *Door*), or *Venue*.

A ghost walk has a room too. On a tour date, the people the guide checked in and the walk's guides can stay in touch on the date's page and in the app. Somebody with a seat who never turned up isn't in it. It's words only, the guides' posts carry their role, and it closes a week after the walk.

The photo wall (*Photo wall* on the event page) shows the room's photos full screen, one at a time, newest first, checking for new ones every 30 seconds. **It only opens for your group, the event's helpers and the venue's staff** — never for guests, and never for anyone outside the event — because a slideshow goes on a screen people walk past, and some people in the photos don't want their faces shown in public. To show it on a TV at the venue, use a computer signed in with one of those accounts. If there are no photos yet, it shows a code guests can scan to **add photos from their phone**.

The event's page, gallery and advert

Gallery on the event page adds your own pictures to the event's public page — last year's weekend, the building, the ballroom set for dinner. The first picture appears at the top of the page, and the arrows change the order. Each picture is resized and has its location data removed. Guests' photos from the room are never added automatically: they belong to the guests, and some of the people in them didn't agree to appear on a public page.



The public event page opens with the pictures, shows how long until the first night, and on a phone keeps an **Ask for a place** button at the bottom of the screen as people scroll.

Where people find it. Once published, the event appears on the map on the home page, at an approximate spot near the venue rather than its exact address, until the day after it ends. It can be found on **What's on** by its name, your group's name, a tour or the town.

Putting an event on your group's own pages. When you edit one of your public pages, four section types show one of your published events and stay up to date automatically: *An event: dates and ask for a place*, *An event's program*, *An event's pictures* and *An event's venue*. If a section points to an event that is no longer on the public site, it says so instead of showing it.

Advertise this event on the event page creates an ad for your group that points to the event. It is reviewed like any other ad, shows the event's name and date on the card, links straight to the event's page, and stops showing automatically once the event is over.

Letters about bookings

Requests get answered because someone is notified. Everyone who can say yes or no to bookings — you, anyone your roles allow to decide, and any helper you gave **Say yes or no to bookings** — gets an email when requests arrive.

- **The first request in a while** is emailed within about five minutes.
- **A rush becomes one email.** If forty people ask within an hour, you get the first one right away and one more saying *40 more bookings* once things quiet down — never more than an hour later.
- **A daily email** shows where each event stands: who has waited longest for an answer, which holds expire in the next day, what is left for the next night, and — while the event is running — how many people checked in last night. It becomes weekly once bookings have closed, and **it is never sent when nothing is waiting**, because an empty email every morning teaches people to ignore the one that matters.

An email never names a guest, or includes their email address or what they can't eat. It says *a party of 4 has asked for the Blue Room on Fri 10/30* and links to the booking board, where you can see the details if you have permission. Emails get forwarded and left open on shared desks in a way the website doesn't.

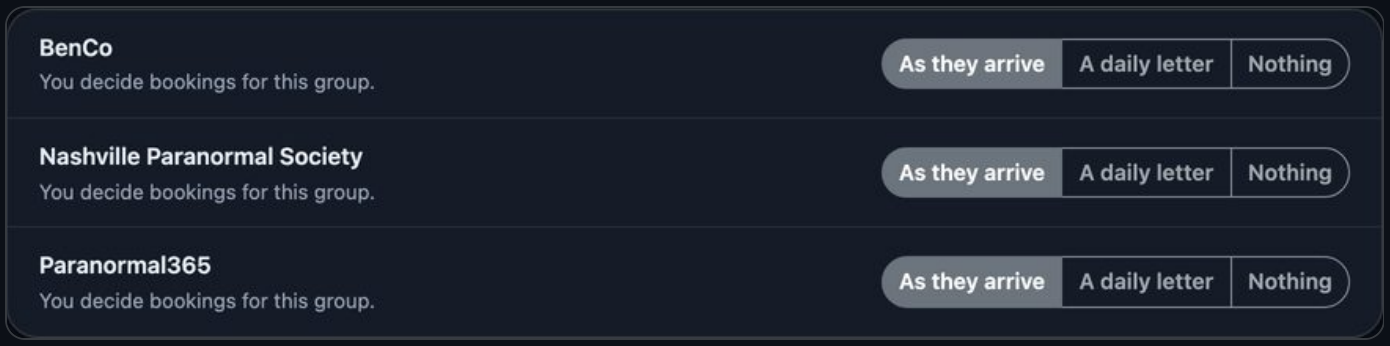
You aren't notified about your own bookings.

The event's staff room

New requests are also posted to a thread for the event, in your group's **Messages**, so you can discuss a request right where it appears. You'll see it there as *Event Staff*, named after the event — *Bookings — Halloween Lock-In*.

- **There is one thread for the whole event**, not one per booking, so a sold-out weekend doesn't bury every other conversation in your group.
- **A new request brings the thread back to your bell** instead of adding another row to your messages. Reply to it just as you would any message.
- **Everyone who can decide bookings is in it** — including anyone who set their emails to *Nothing*. That setting only turns off emails, and the thread is especially useful for people who never read email.
- **It says no more than an email does**: what was asked for and when, never who. The names are on the booking board.

You don't need to turn this on or set anything up: the thread is created the first time a booking request arrives. An event with no requests never gets one.



You choose **how often** you hear from each group on the **Notifications** page, under *Letters about bookings*: **As they arrive** (the default, which includes the daily email), **A daily letter** only, or **Nothing**. Whichever you pick, the bell still counts what is waiting, and a hold that is about to expire gets its own row there.

The color's name is always shown along with the color itself, because about one in twelve men can't tell red from green.

When a guest writes to you

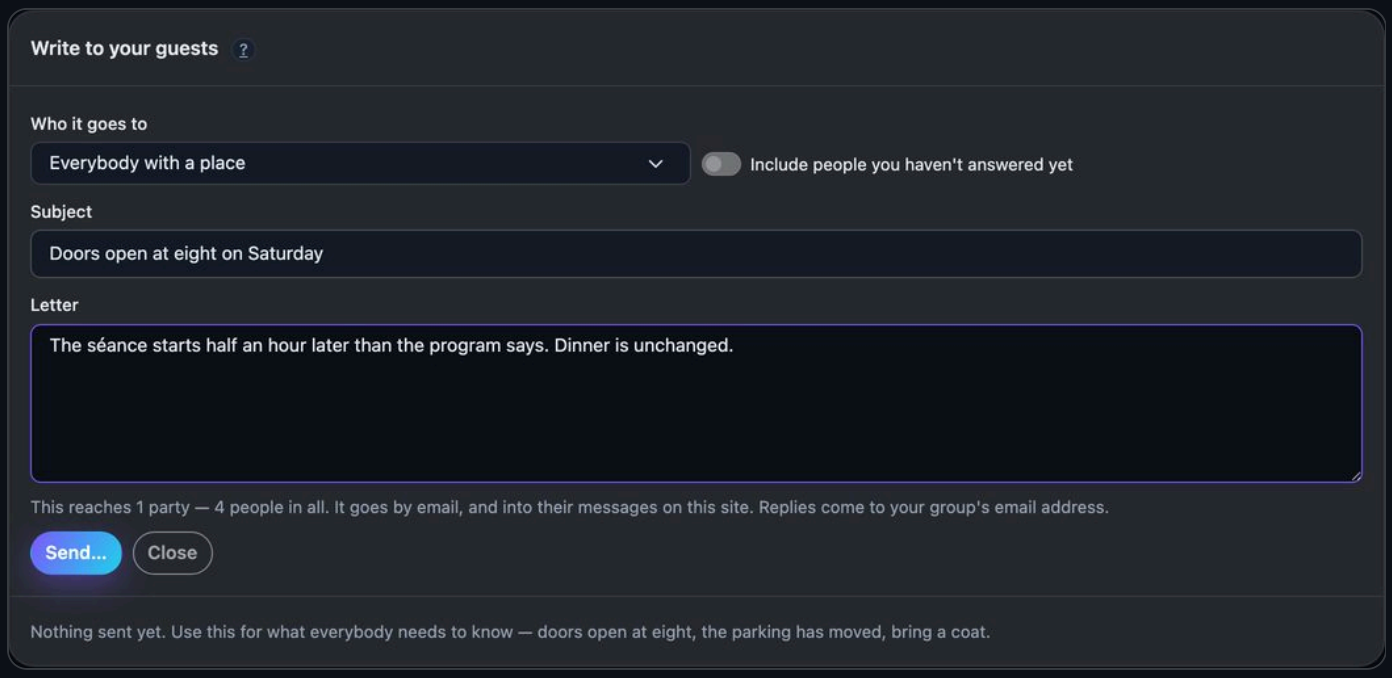
Anybody with a booking at the event can **write to the organizers** from the event's page or the app. Until the event starts, so can anybody signed in who has a question before deciding to come; once it starts, they can still read your answer but can't write again. Their message arrives in your group's **Messages** as *Guest Message*, one thread per guest, addressed to everyone who can say yes or no to bookings, and your bell counts it.

Guest messages, on the event page, lists every guest who has written, the newest first, with *Waiting on you* beside the ones you haven't answered. Each one says where that person stands: *Confirmed*, *Signed up, not confirmed yet*, *Not signed up*, and so on, so you know who you're answering. Choose one to read it and answer.

The guest sees your answer on the event's page and in the app, and their bell tells them. Messages are words only, and the event stops taking them a month after it ends.

Writing to your guests

Write to your guests, at the bottom of the booking board, sends one message to everyone with a place: *the parking lot is closed, use the church lot*, *doors open at eight, not seven*, *bring a coat*. Use it for things everyone needs to know. Anything about a single party belongs on that party's booking.

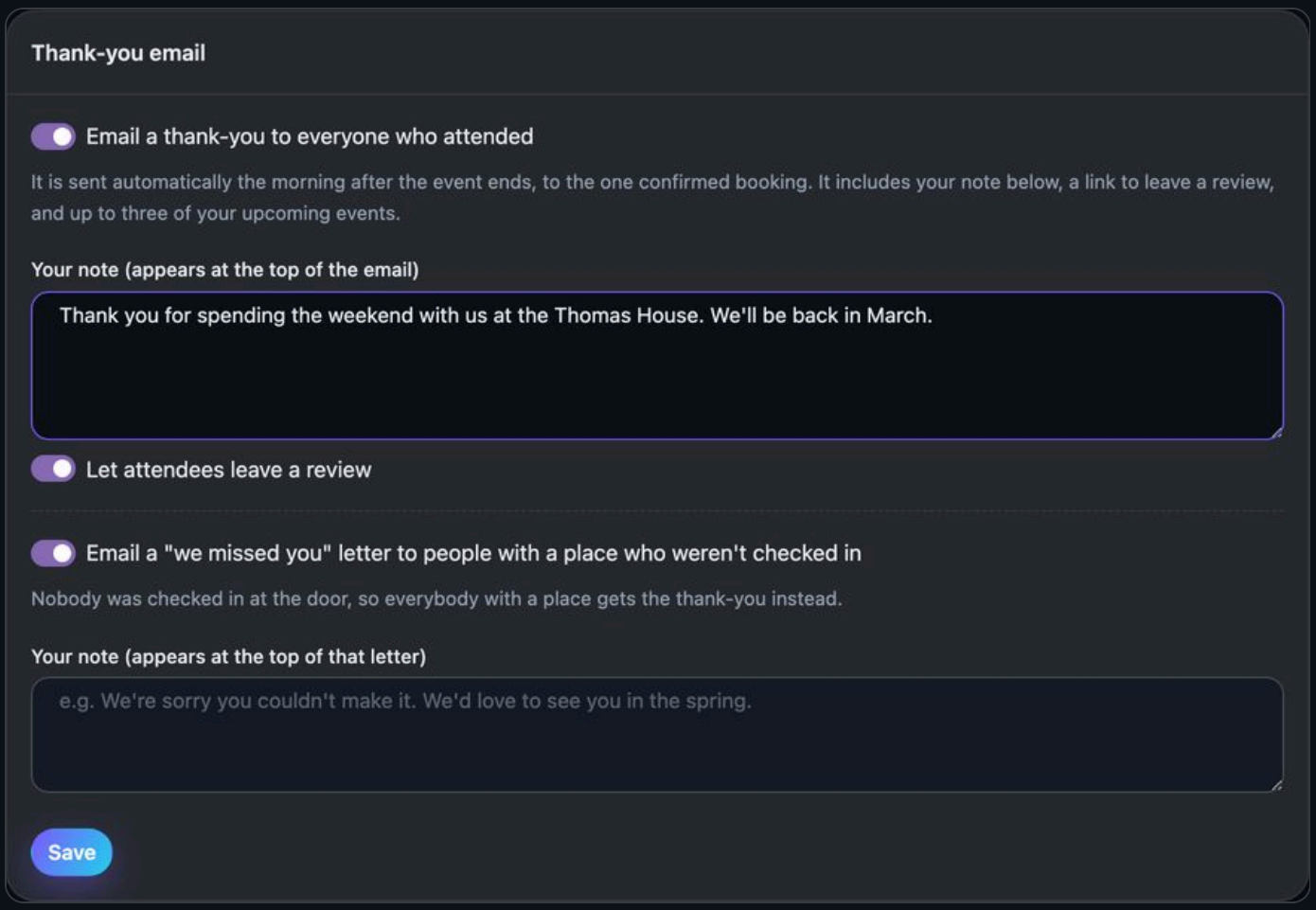


- **Who it goes to.** Everyone with a confirmed place, or only the people attending on one date. A pass for the whole event counts as attending every date. Turn on **Include people you haven't answered yet** to also reach people who have asked or are holding places.
- **The count comes first.** As you choose, the card shows how many parties and people the message will reach. Sending takes a second click that repeats the number, because a message can't be unsent.
- **How it arrives.** One message per party, to the person who booked, by email and in their messages on this site. The subject starts with the event's name, and replies go to your group's email address.
- **What is kept.** Every message sent is listed under the card: when, who sent it, how many it went to, and how many of those were emailed.

Only people who can say yes or no to bookings can write to guests. You can't write to guests of an unpublished or canceled event from here, and each event is limited to **ten letters in a day**. The limit keeps a stuck button or a bad morning from turning into forty emails, so put everything into one message.

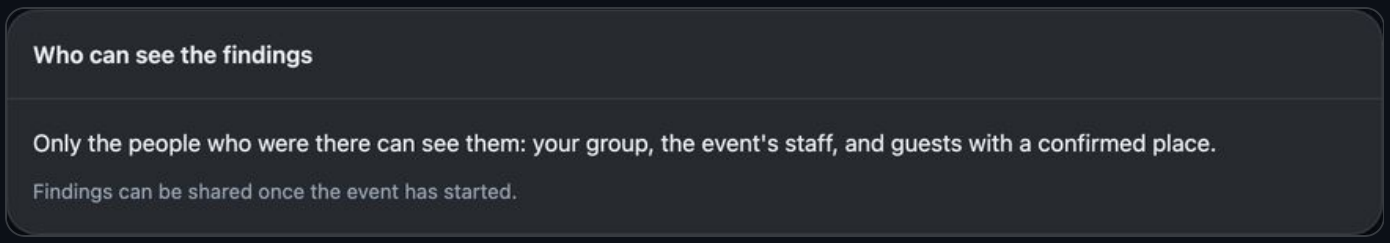
After the event: the next one, and the list of who came

After the event, on the event page, collects everything you need once it is over.



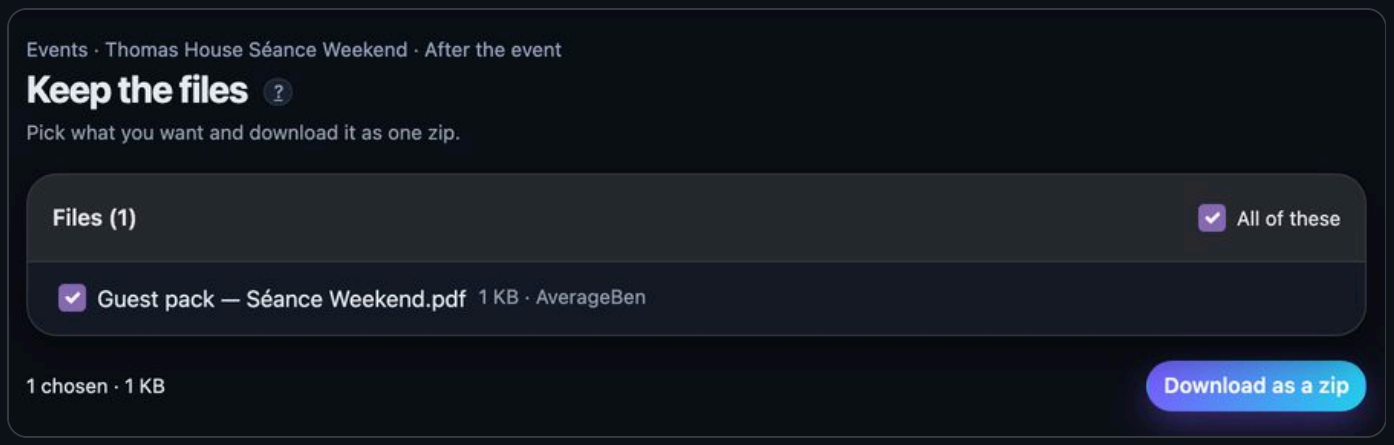
- **Thank-you email** is sent automatically the morning after the event ends, once to each confirmed booking that was checked in at the door. It includes your note, a link to leave a review, a link to the gallery if you added pictures, and up to three of your upcoming events. It is on unless you turn it off, and it is never sent for an event that ended more than a week earlier.
- **We missed you** goes instead to anyone with a confirmed place who was never checked in, with a note of its own. If the door didn't check anybody in at all, the site can't tell who came, so everybody gets the thank-you.
- **Who came.** Before the letters go, the *Who came* card lists each confirmed party, with a **Here** switch that starts from the door's scans. Change any that are wrong, for example somebody who came in by the side door: the thank-you goes to everyone marked here and *we missed you* to the rest. Once a party's letter has gone, its switch can't change.
- **The evidence window.** On an event that takes evidence, say how many days after the event you'll accept evidence, and roughly how many days until the results are ready. Both letters say it — for example, *We're accepting evidence for three days … ready to see in about a week* — and the event's page shows the deadline. After it, the page stops taking evidence and says so.
- **Votes.** Tick **Ask people to vote for the best evidence** and the evidence you accept is shown with a vote beside each piece. Accepted evidence is always listed with the most *confirms* votes first, then in the order it was caught. Only *confirms* votes count toward the order, and a tie goes to the piece caught first.

- **Sessions from the app aren't held to the window.** The deadline closes the event's page to new evidence; a guest can still send a session they recorded in the app afterward.
- **Sessions in the results.** Under the sessions sent to the event, **Show with the results** puts a session on the event's page, where it can be played in the session player with its EVPs marked — by anybody once the findings are public. It needs the sender's yes first: they give it when they send it from the app, or later on the website, and the button says *Waiting for the sender's OK* until they do. It's only offered at an event that takes evidence, at a public place. **Stop showing** takes it off, and so does the sender changing their mind.
- **Who can see the findings.** At first, the evidence you accept and the sessions you show are seen only by the people who were there: your group, the event's staff, and guests with a confirmed place. Once the event has started, **Make the findings public** opens them to anybody; **Share only with the people who were there** takes them back. An event at a private home always keeps its findings with the people who were there.
- **On the place's page.** Once the findings are public, at a public place, you can show them on the place's page too: **Show the pieces I choose**, with a **Show** switch beside each piece, or **Show everything that's public**, which also takes in anything you accept later. Each guest gets a message the day their piece is chosen, and it appears a week later. A guest can say **Keep it off** at any time, before or after it appears, for one piece or for everything from their booking, and the piece is marked so you can see why it isn't there.
- **The results.** When the evidence is ready, **Send the results letter** emails everybody who had a place, including those who missed it, with a link and a QR code to the results. The link goes to the event's page, or to a page you built: add the section **An event's evidence** to one of your group's pages and paste its address under **Results page**. Pressing it again only reaches people who haven't had it. Guests with the IsHaunted app also see the results on the event in the app.
- **Reviews** can only come from people who had a confirmed place, for two months after the event. You can hide a review from the page, but you can't change what it says, and the person who wrote it still sees it, marked as hidden. Turning reviews off stops new ones.

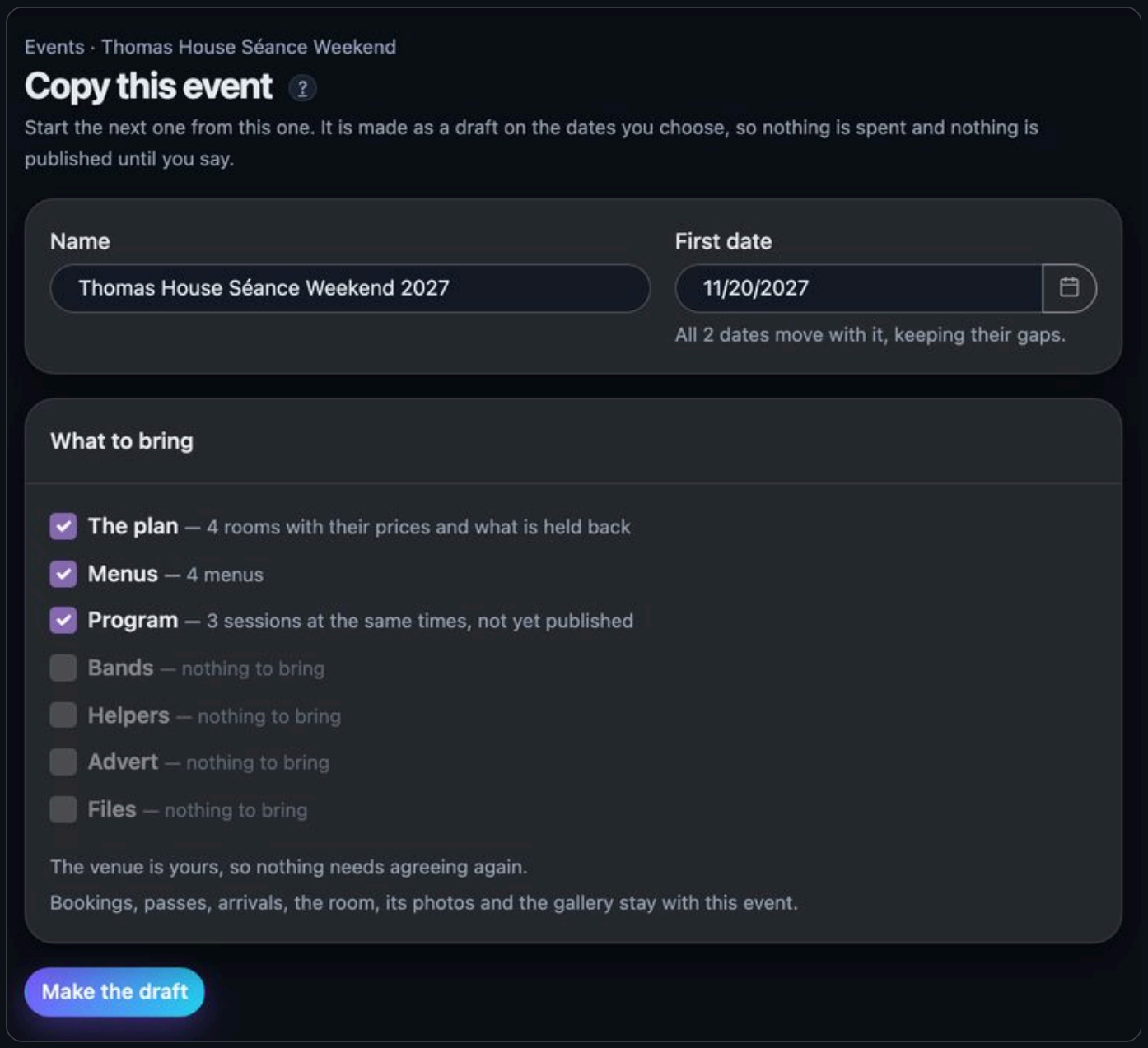


Files are kept for 90 days after the last date. After that, the event's files, its gallery pictures and the links to photos in its room are removed. The event itself stays, with its bookings, program and reviews, and guests keep their own photos — a photo a guest shared with you stays shared with you. You get an email a month before and a week before, and nothing is removed within a week of the last email.

Keep the files, under *After the event*, lists everything you can download: the event's files, its gallery, photos your own team posted in the room, and photos guests shared with you. Check what you want and press **Download as a zip** — up to 100 at a time, each in its own folder. A guest's photo that was never shared with you isn't listed, because it belongs to them.



Copy this event, on the event page, starts your next event from this one. Choose a name and the first date. Every other date moves along with it, keeping the same gaps, and a session at 7 PM stays at 7 PM even if daylight saving time has changed in between.



Each part you made is listed with its size, already checked:

- **the plan** — rooms or seats, sections, prices, and what the venue held back on which night,
- **meals**, on the same night of the run, and the **menus**, as drafts served at the same meals,
- **the program**, at the same times, not yet published,
- **bands**, and **helpers** with what they can do (unanswered invitations aren't copied),
- **the advert**, as a draft that is reviewed again before it shows,
- **files**, copied into the new event's own storage (unchecked at first, because they count against its storage limit).

Nothing that happened is copied: bookings, passes, check-ins, the room, its photos and the gallery all stay with the old event. The copy is a **draft**, so nothing is charged and nothing is published until you choose. **The venue's approval isn't copied** either — a yes for October isn't a yes for March. A venue you entered by hand

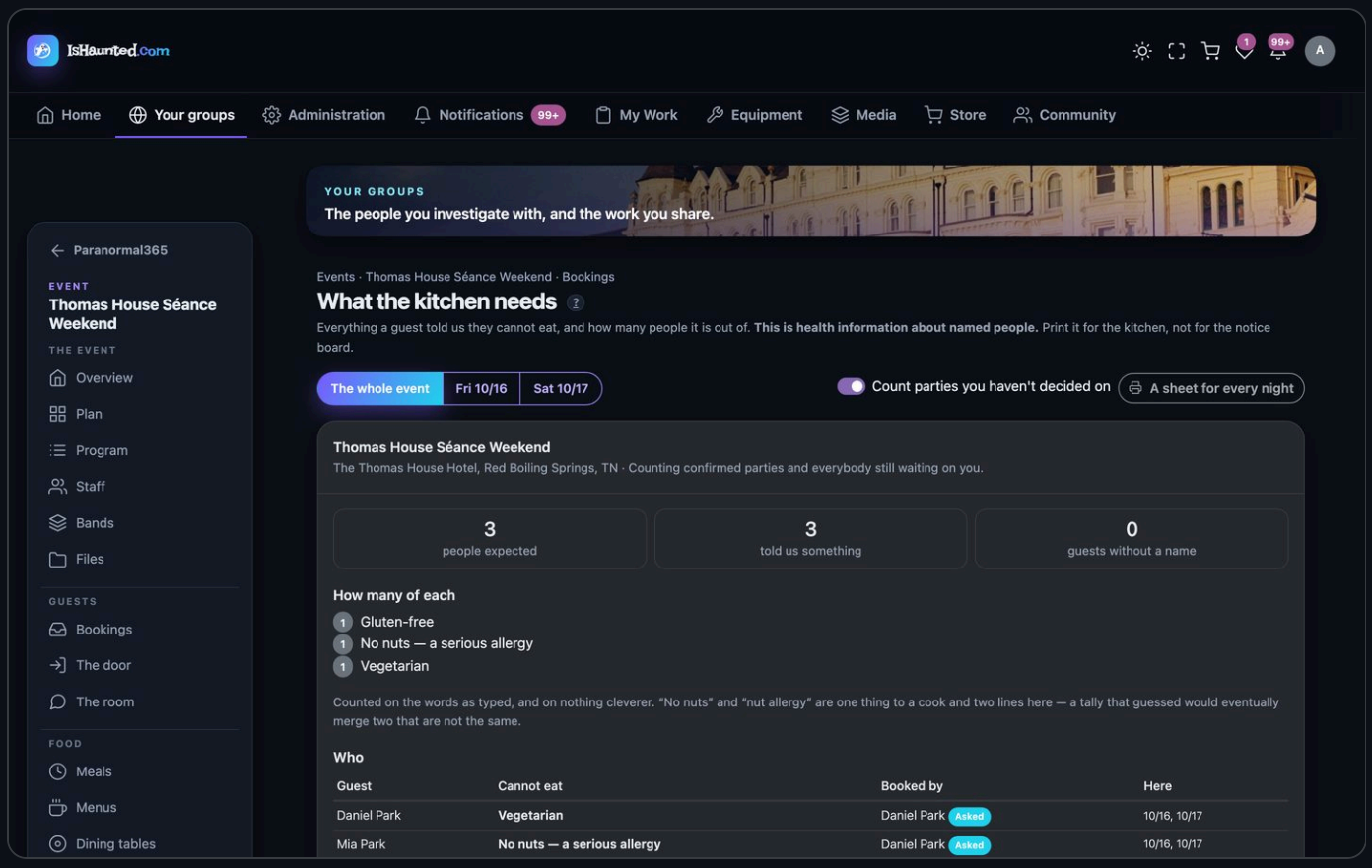
keeps its contact and asks you when they agreed, and a venue on this site has to be asked again. The *Ready to publish* list reminds you.

Download as a spreadsheet, on the booking board, gives you every booking: status, name, email, the phone number the guest gave, party size, which nights and places, the guests and their dietary notes, their note, when they asked, when you decided, and which nights they checked in. It opens in Excel, Numbers or Google Sheets. Anything a guest typed that looks like a formula is saved as plain text, so it can't run in your spreadsheet.

The dietary sheet

What the kitchen needs, on the event page or the booking board, turns every guest's dietary note into a sheet the kitchen can actually work from.

Guests give these notes themselves. When they ask for a place or hold places, they can name each person in their party and say what each one can't eat, and they can change it later from their booking. A change shows up on the sheet straight away, and it doesn't change their places or send a confirmed booking back to you.



By default it counts **confirmed** parties, because those are the people you are buying food for. **Count parties you haven't decided on** adds everyone still waiting — people who asked and people holding places they picked — so you can order ahead before the weekend is settled. The sheet shows which view you are looking at, so nobody mistakes an estimate for a final number.

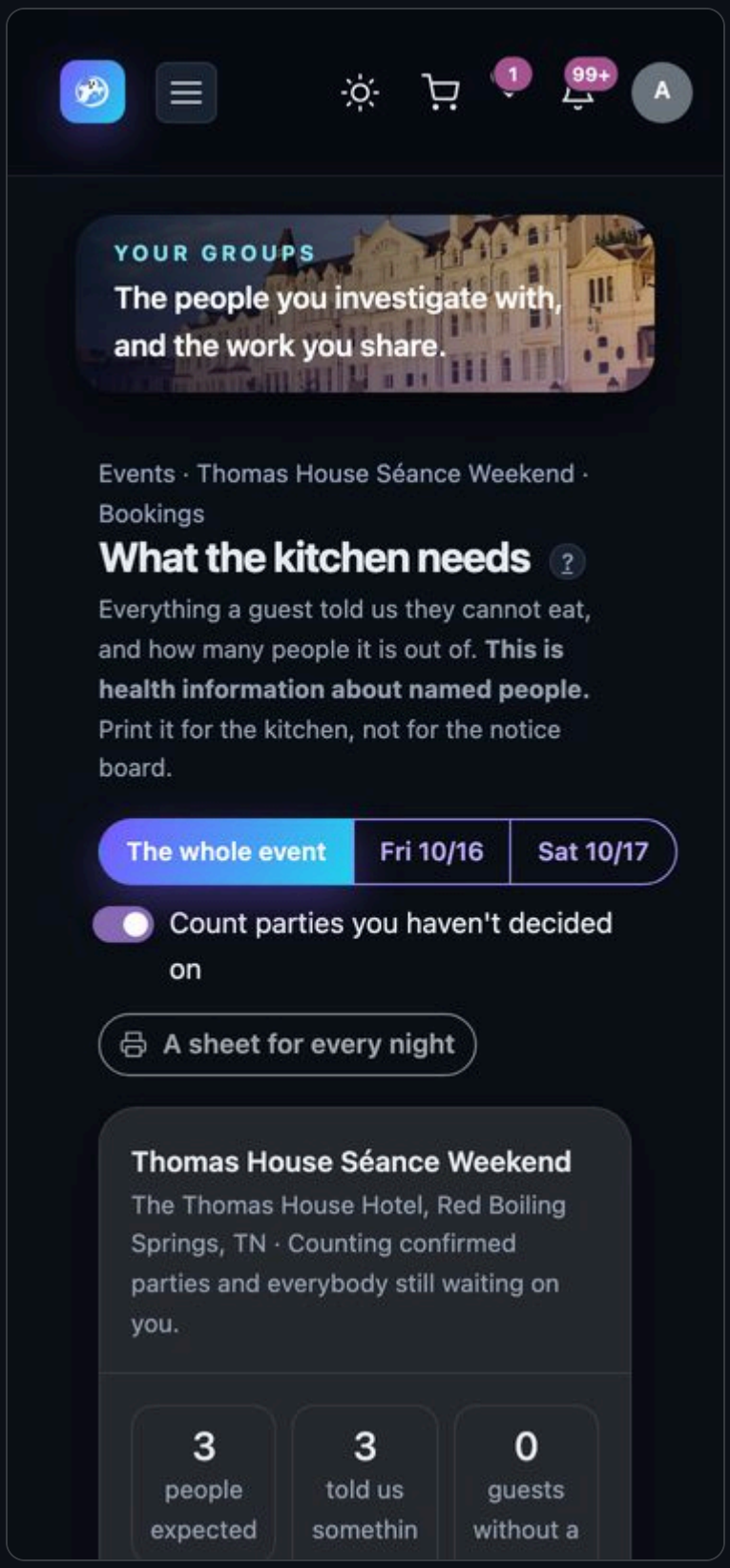
Three numbers appear at the top, and the third matters most:

- how many people you are expecting in total,
- how many of them gave you a dietary note,
- and **how many haven't been named**. A party of four who listed only two names leaves two people you know nothing about. Without this number, a sheet showing only the notes could look complete when it covers only half your guests.

Below that, identical notes are grouped with a count, so "vegan × 6" is one line. **Notes are grouped by their exact wording, never by guesswork.** "No nuts" and "nut allergy" mean the same to a cook but appear as two lines here. Merging them automatically would eventually merge two notes that aren't the same, and that is how someone ends up served the wrong food. Each line names the guest, their party and which nights they are staying, so Saturday's cook can see whose meal is whose.

One night at a time. The buttons at the top narrow the sheet to a single night, because Saturday's cook needs the numbers for the people there on Saturday, not the weekend's total. A party with no specific night — a pass for the whole event — counts on every night. **A sheet for every night** builds them all at once, each printed on its own page for the kitchen to pin up.

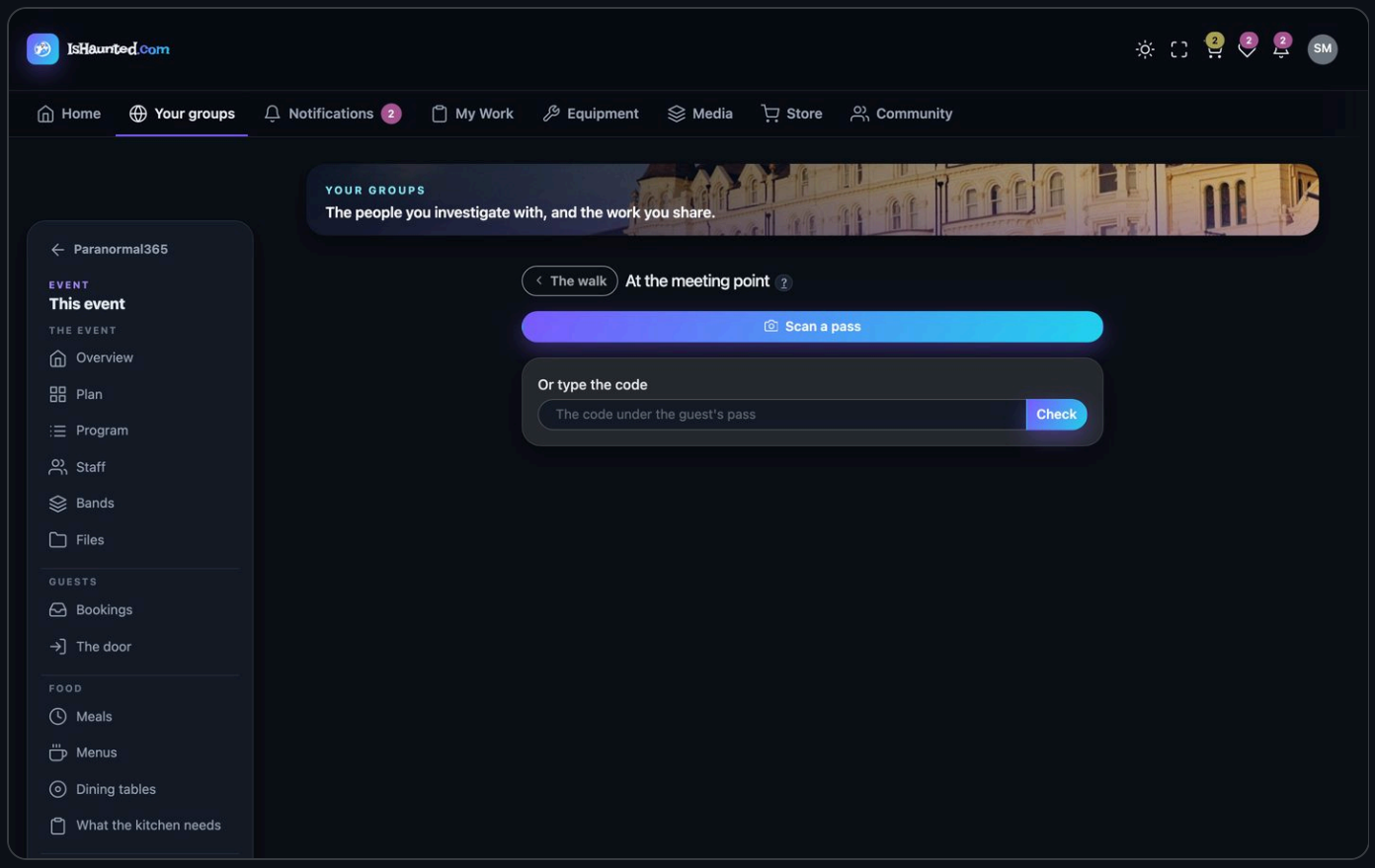
The page is easy to read in the kitchen, not just at a desk.



Dietary notes are health information about named people. They are shown to staff who can decide bookings, and hidden from members who can't — an ordinary member of your group has no reason to see a stranger's allergies. They never appear on a public page, and the printed sheet is meant for the kitchen, not the bulletin board.

Tour passes

When you approve someone's place on a walk, they are sent a pass — a square code in their confirmation email. The code is built into the email itself, so it still shows if their email program blocks pictures. If their program removes the code anyway, there is a link under it.



On the night, open the date from your tour and press **Scan guests in**. Point the camera at a guest's pass and the screen answers in one line:

- **"Casey Hollow. Let them in."** — they have a place on tonight's walk.
- **"Casey Hollow — 3 places. Let them in."** — they booked for more than one person.
- **"Casey Hollow is already in — scanned at 7.42."** — this pass has already been scanned. It isn't a refusal; it lets you tell someone trying to sneak in from a guest whose friend scanned their code a minute ago.
- **"That pass is for Friday Night Ghost Walk, not tonight's walk."** — a real booking, but for the wrong night. This is the most common honest mistake at a meeting point, so the screen names the walk instead of saying the code isn't recognized.
- **"We don't recognize that code. Ask them to check the email, or look them up by name."**

If the camera won't start — an old phone, a browser that won't allow camera access, or not enough light — type the code from the guest's screen into the box underneath instead. It works exactly the same way.

A pass only exists for a confirmed place. A place that has only been requested, or one you turned down, has no pass, so nobody can show up with proof of a booking you never approved.

Public events

You can open an event on your calendar to anyone. Check **Public** and it appears on your group's public site and on the site-wide **What's on** list, and anyone with an account can say they are coming.

This is the one part of the site that brings you people who have never heard of you. Someone looking for a ghost walk nearby finds your event, shows up, and meets your group — so the listing features your group's name prominently and reads as an invitation.

What can be made public

Events at **landmarks, businesses, and your own addresses**. Not events at a private residence, and not events attached to a case.

This can't be overridden. A public listing advertises a date and an address to strangers, and a client never agreed to have people show up at their home. If you want to publicize work you are doing on a case, create a separate event at a venue you are free to publish.

Hiding the address until somebody is coming

Hide exact location shows the town but not the street address. People who say they are coming can see the full address; nobody else ever gets it. The listing explains this up front, so nobody feels tricked into signing up just to find out where to go.

If someone cancels, they can no longer see the address.

Places and sign-ups

- **Places** limits how many people can come. Leave it empty for no limit.
- **Sign-ups close** sets a deadline. Leave it empty and people can sign up until half an hour after the start, to allow for guests who reach the meeting point a few minutes after you set off. Set it earlier to require booking ahead, or later to keep a particular night open longer.
- **Anyone who can edit the calendar can sign someone up by hand**, at any time, from the event's attendee list. This is for the walk-up guest with no account, or the latecomer who shows up with three friends — you are there in person, so it's your call. Type their email address in the invite box: if they already have an account, they go straight onto the list; if not, they get a sign-up link instead.
- **A link you sent still works after sign-ups close, and even when the event is full.** That is the difference between you signing someone up and them signing up on their own. You vouched for them in person, so you can make an exception to your own deadline and capacity. A guest signing up through the public page on their own can't get past those limits.
- The guest still has to open the link. It only takes a moment on their phone while you are taking payment, and it confirms the email address is really theirs — otherwise anyone could sign any address up for any event. Until they open it, they aren't on the list, and **they can't share what they recorded on the night**, because that depends on having been there.

- When someone cancels, their place opens up for someone else.

The link you can share

A public event gets a readable web address — `/o/your-group/events/2026-08-24-ghost-walk` — made from its date and title the first time you publish it. That is the link to share on social media.

It doesn't change afterward, even if you rename the event, so links people have already shared keep working.

People coming who don't have an account

Someone who finds your event and has never used the site before doesn't have to sign up for anything first. They enter an email address, we send them a link, and clicking it confirms they're coming.

The link matters. Typing an address into a box proves nothing, and if your event hides its exact location until people sign up, that would mean nothing if anyone could type any address and see where you're meeting.

Confirming creates an account for them with no password. They can set one later if they want to sign in properly, but they don't have to. The account gives you a way to reach them, and lets them see what they've signed up for.

You'll see them in the attendee list like anyone else.

The reminder the day before

Everyone who has said they are coming automatically gets a reminder email about a day before. You don't send it, and there is nothing to turn on.

Someone who signed up three weeks ago may well have forgotten, and a stranger who doesn't show up is worse for you than one who never signed up at all. So the reminder repeats the time and place, includes the link to your event page, and lets them say they can no longer come while you still have time to offer the place to someone else.

It only goes to people who answered **yes**. Someone invited who never replied, or who said maybe, doesn't get one: they never agreed to come, and a reminder about something they didn't agree to is just unwanted email.

Everyone is reminded once. If the site can't reach someone's email address, it tries again next time instead of quietly giving up.

Applications from would-be members

When **Accepting Membership Applications** is on (on the group's Edit screen), your public page shows an apply box to signed-in visitors. Applications arrive on the **Members** tab, where any member with the requests permission can Accept or Deny. Denying asks for a reason, and the applicant sees your answer. **Allow this applicant to reapply in the future** starts ticked; untick it and that person can't send your group another application.

Somebody who left the group, or was removed, and comes back through your join link returns as an ordinary member on your starting role, not with the rank or roles they had before.

What kind of group you are

Every group is either an **investigation group** or a **ghost walking tour**. You choose when you create the group, and you can change it in **Settings**. The choice only decides what a NEW group starts with — a tour starts with a public, searchable meeting point and public events, while an investigation group starts private. After that it is just a label, never a restriction. Both kinds can use every feature.

Next to it is a separate **runs public tours** switch. Many investigation groups also run paid public tours, and they shouldn't have to register a second group to be found for them. Turn it on and your group appears under **Walking tours** in the group finder, while its badge still says investigation group — both of which are true.

Promoting your group

Settings → Promote your group builds a promotional card that rotates through the group finder's Featured groups, the home page, and the public feed, always marked "Promoted". In the feed, cards are shown first to people closest to your group's public address; a group with no public address still rotates, just without that ranking. Once the card is approved, the page shows two straightforward numbers: how many times the card was shown, and how many people clicked through. The builder walks you through it — a headline (say who you help and where), a short message (what you do, what it costs, what to do next), an optional picture from your media library, and where the card leads: your public page or the group finder. Only send people to your public page once it has something worth seeing — a great headline that leads to an empty page loses the visitor you just won.

Every card is reviewed before anyone sees it. When you submit it, a platform administrator approves it or declines it with a reason, and you get a message either way. Any later edit is reviewed again, so only approved text is ever shown. Each group can have one card. You can withdraw it at any time, and it disappears from every placement immediately.

Feed posts made from your cases

When a member (or a client) creates a video from one of your cases in the video editor and posts it to the public feed, the post is credited to *them*. **Your group's name doesn't appear on it until you say so. Settings → Feed attribution** lists that footage so you can decide:

- **Claim** adds your group's name and a link to your public page to the post, plus a **Group verified** badge — your confirmation that the footage is what it claims to be. The badge also helps the post rank higher in the feed.

- **Decline** leaves the post up, credited to the person, and never linked to your group.

You can change either decision later. Footage from a **private engagement** also needed the poster's explicit, recorded confirmation before it could be posted at all. Claiming or declining only affects whether your name is on it, never whether the post exists.

Location data in your photos, audio and video

Cameras and phones save the location where they were into the file itself. On a case at someone's home, that means the file contains the address — and the site's deliberately vague map pin is pointless if the photo next to it reveals the exact spot.

Photos are always cleaned, for every group. The copy anyone downloads is rebuilt from the image alone, so no hidden data survives. There is no setting for this, because nobody needs the alternative.

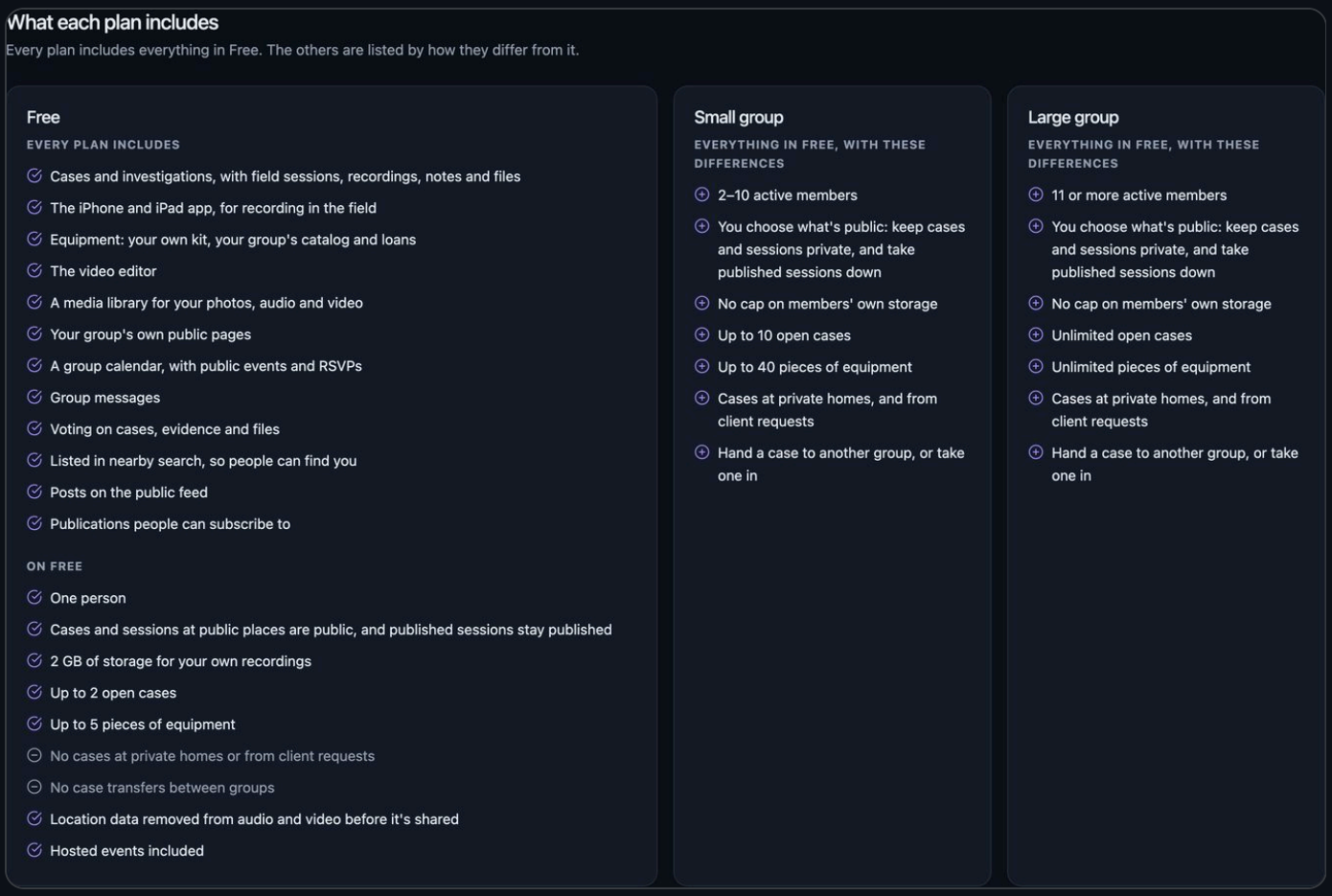
For audio and video, it is a setting, under Settings on your group's page. Cleaning a recording means rebuilding the file, so it is available on plans that include it. If yours doesn't, the switch tells you so, and who to contact. Groups working only at landmarks and businesses may reasonably leave it off; a group that goes into people's homes should turn it on.

What is removed is still yours. When you upload any file, its details are saved with its record: where and when it was taken, the device, and the technical details. Removing them from the copy people download never removes them from your own records — you keep the information, and the public copy doesn't include it. A clip you cut from a recording keeps the recording's location, since a clip has no location of its own.

Your group's plan

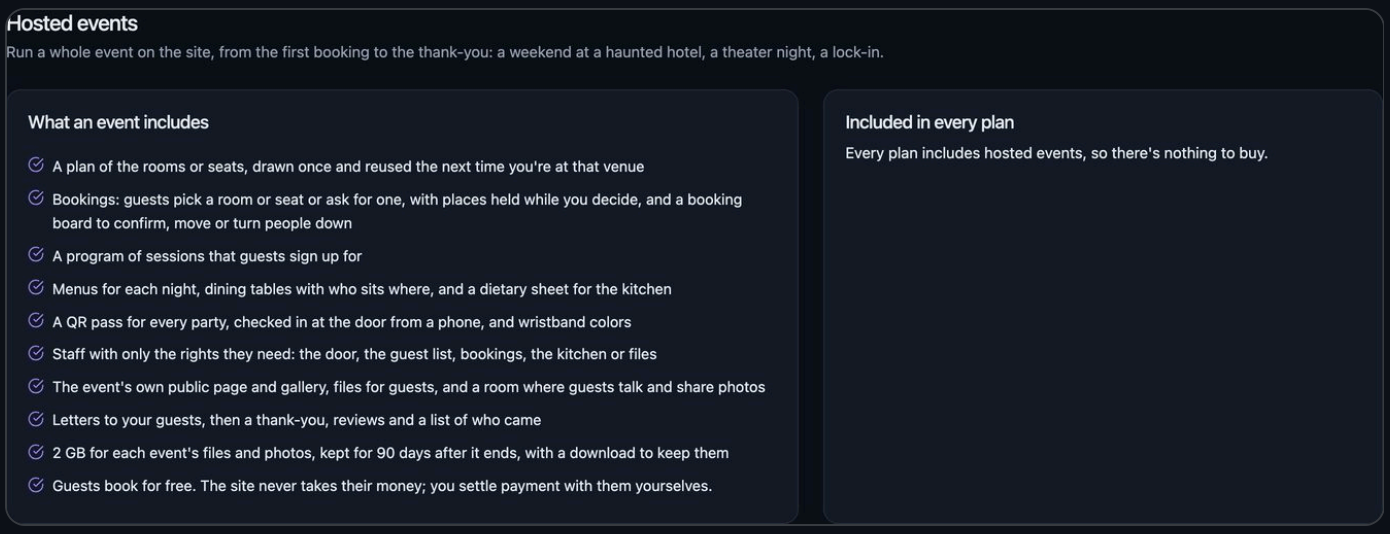
Plans are priced by **active members, per group**. The price list is on the **Pricing** page, which anyone can see. Yearly billing usually costs less than paying monthly, and the card shows how much you save.

What's included, on each band, takes you to that plan in the list further down the page. The first plan is listed in full, including the parts of the site every plan has. Each of the others is listed by how it differs from the first: how many members it's for, the open cases it allows, private work, cases at private homes, storage and so on. The list follows what's switched on for the whole site, so a part of the site that's turned off isn't offered on any plan.



While something outside the plans is on sale, a button at the top of the page, beside **How plans work**, names it and takes you straight down to it.

Below the plans, **Hosted events** says what an event includes: the rooms or seats plan, bookings and the booking board, the program, menus, dining tables and the dietary sheet, passes and the door, staff, the event's page, files, the guests' room, and the thank-you afterwards. It also says what an event costs. No plan includes events, so every event is bought on its own: **the price shown on the Pricing page**, or **a share of that price** for a group with a paid plan, with bundles of several events when they're offered. Once you're signed in you can buy one or more right there, for a group whose billing you look after or for yourself; they go to that group's event credits, or to your own, the same as buying them on the billing page (see Buying event credits).



When it's offered, **Ghost Walk Tour subscription** comes after that: $29 a month per tour route, with unlimited walks and guests, separate from the investigation plans. If you look after a group's billing, **Subscribe** takes you to Stripe's page for that group, paying for every route it runs.

Each band on the Pricing page has its own button. If you don't run a group yet, **Start a group on this plan** opens the new-group steps with that plan shown at the top; once the group exists, you go straight to its billing page to confirm the plan and pay. If you already run a group, **Choose this plan** takes you to that group's billing page with the same billing period selected (if you run several groups, it asks which one). The price is always based on the group's size: if the band you picked doesn't match your group's size, the billing page tells you which band applies. The band marked **Most groups start here** is simply the middle of the member bands.

Two things worth knowing about how plans work:

What you signed up for is guaranteed for the period you paid for. If the plan changes after you subscribe, improvements apply right away — a higher limit or a lower price, with nothing for you to do. Changes that would reduce what you get wait until your renewal, and you'll get a message about them **before** your period ends, so nothing changes partway through a period. If your current terms are better than what the pricing page shows, your Pricing page tells you: "you keep the terms you signed up for until" your renewal date.

Plans can include limits — on open cases, equipment, loans out at a time, open investigations, and public pages. If your group reaches one, the screen you were using tells you exactly which limit you hit and what your plan includes. Closed cases and retired equipment never count toward a limit. A larger plan raises the limit.

If a renewal payment doesn't go through, your plan keeps going for two more weeks while we try the card again each day. The people who look after your group's billing get a message saying so, and your billing page shows the date. Nothing changes during those two weeks. If the payment still hasn't gone through by then, the plan ends. You get these two weeks once a year: a second missed renewal within twelve months ends the plan on its renewal date. A plan you cancel ends on the date you chose.

Have a coupon code? There's a box for it at checkout — enter it and the price updates before you confirm anything. Codes can be limited to first subscriptions, to renewals, to yearly billing, or to a specific account, so if a code is refused, the message tells you why.

If your group grows beyond what your plan covers, your plan doesn't change, and nobody is stopped from joining. Each person who joins beyond your member count pays for their own seat at a per-person price. They are told the price when they are accepted, and it appears on their own Pricing page. Your group keeps one plan and one renewal date.

Tax appears as a separate line on the quote if your state taxes the service. It is calculated from your group's address and is never hidden in the price. Every payment your group makes also has a **receipt**: open **Billing history** on your group's card on the Pricing page to see every charge, payment and adjustment, and download any receipt by its number. Receipts are generated from the payment record itself, so a receipt you download five years from now will say exactly what it said on the day you paid.

GROUP ADMINISTRATION

Publishing with Publications

Setting up a publication, writing posts, and deciding when the public sees them.

Written for: **Group owners & administrators**

A **publication** is a place for your group to write for people outside the group, under a title of its own: case write-ups, research, field notes, anything that needs more room than the Feed gives it.

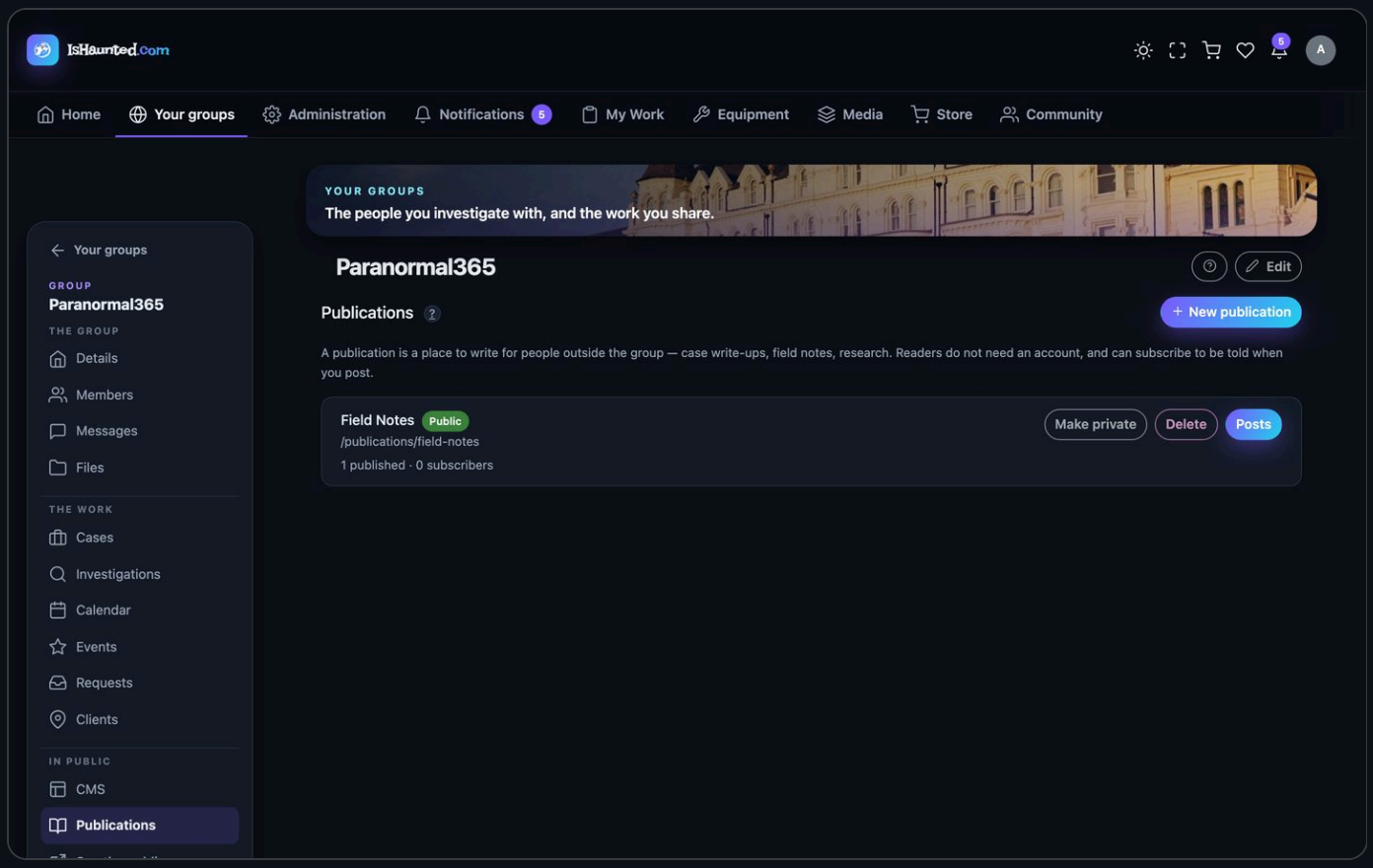
Readers don't need an account to read what you publish, and they can subscribe to follow along.

Where it lives

Publications is a tab on your group's page. If you don't see it, either you don't have permission to edit the group's public material, or publications are switched off for the whole site — a site administrator controls that.

It uses the same permission as the group's CMS pages, so anyone who can speak for the group in public can write in a publication.

Not the place for a case's finding. A publication is for what your group wants to say — an article, a notice, a piece of research. What you concluded about a particular case belongs on that case, and is published by checking **Show this on our public case page** on the report itself. See *Showing your finding on your public page* in Working a case. A publication post can of course link to it.



Each publication shows its address, how many posts are published, how many are still drafts, and how many people subscribe.

Creating one

New publication asks for three things.

Title — what the publication is called. *Field Notes*, *The Ridgeway Case*, *Ashcroft Research*.

Description — a line or two shown in the public directory, explaining what a reader will find.

Visible to the public — leave this **off** while you're getting started. Nothing you write can be read outside the group until *both* the publication is public *and* a post has been published. Having two switches means you can get a few pieces ready before anyone can even see that the publication exists.

About the address

The address — `/publications/field-notes` — is made from the title **once**, when you create the publication, and never changes after that.

If you rename the publication later, the heading readers see changes, but the link stays the same, so a link somebody shares today still works next year. If the address matters to you, get the title right the first time.

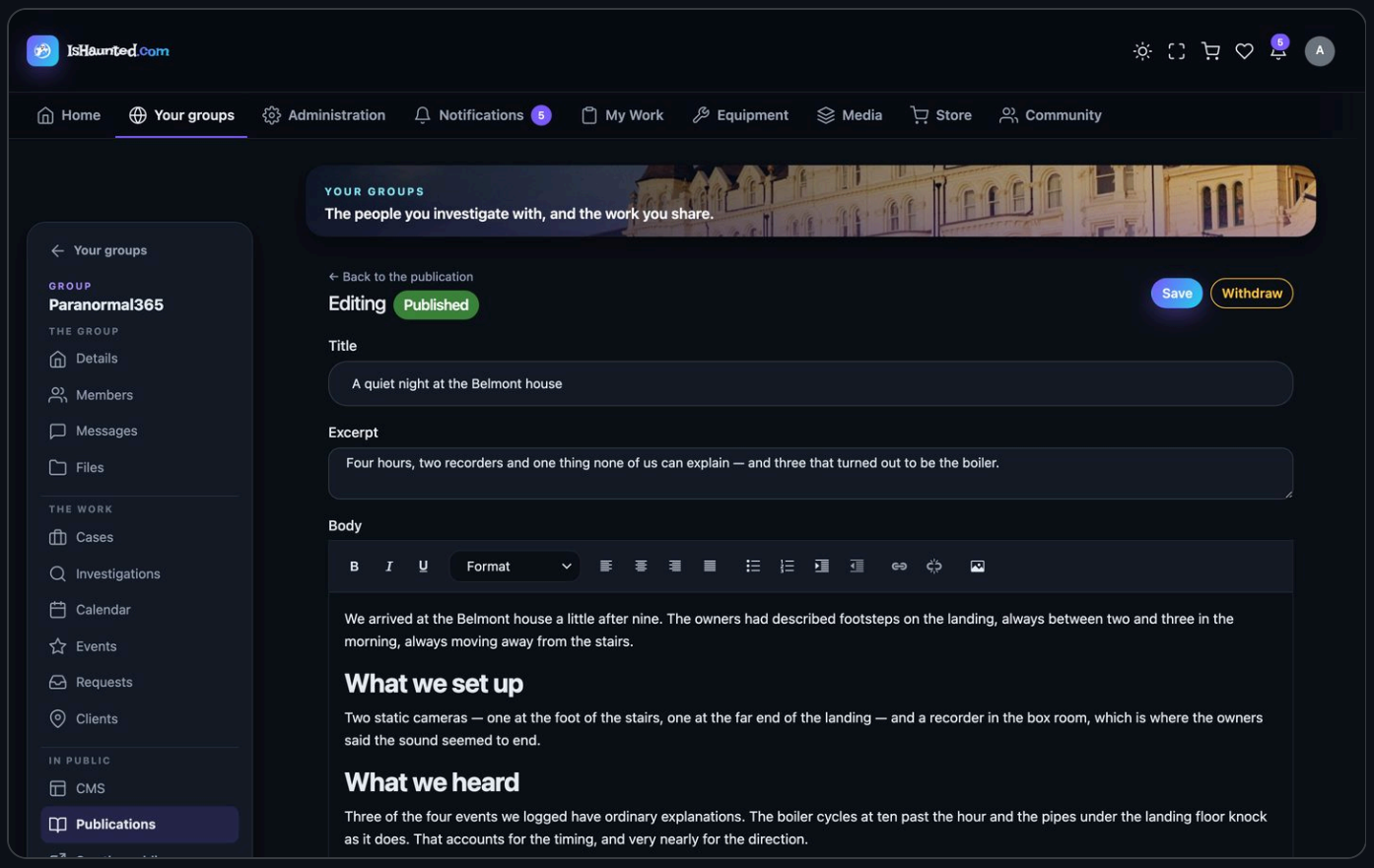
Writing a post

Posts on a publication opens everything in it, drafts included. **New post** opens the writing page, which uses the full width of the screen so you have room for longer pieces.

Title — the heading. The post's address is made from it when you first save, and like the publication's address, it never changes after that.

Excerpt — a line or two shown in listings. It's worth writing one, because it's what readers in the directory use to decide whether to open the post.

Body — the piece itself, in the full editor.



The writing page.

Save keeps a draft as a draft; Save & publish saves and publishes it.

Drafts and publishing

A new post is always a draft. Saving doesn't publish it. Nothing you write is shown to the public until you choose to publish it.

Save & publish saves what's on screen and then publishes it, so readers get exactly what you were looking at, not the last version you saved.

Publish and **Withdraw** are also on the post list, if you'd rather work from there.

What withdrawing does, and does not do

Withdraw takes a post off the site. It does **not** undo the fact that it was published: anyone who already read it has still read it, and any link they shared stops working.

Use it to take down something you published by mistake.

Publishing again after withdrawing gives the post a **new** date, so it appears at the top of the list where readers will notice it, rather than back in the middle.

Subscribers

The publications list shows how many people subscribe to each one. Subscribing needs an account — reading doesn't — so a subscriber is somebody you can actually reach.

Nobody can subscribe to a publication that isn't public, even if they know its address.

"Subscribers only" posts

You may see posts described as being for subscribers, but there's currently no way to mark a post like that: **every post you publish is free to read in full**, and there is no billing anywhere on the platform.

If paid publications are ever added, what you've already published won't change.

Deleting

Delete on a post removes it permanently, after asking you to confirm. (A feed post, by contrast, is hidden rather than deleted, so a moderation record is kept.) A publication post belongs to the group that wrote it.

Deleting a whole publication

Delete on the publication itself appears only while the publication is **completely empty** — nothing written, nobody subscribed. It's there for when you've just created one and got the title wrong: renaming doesn't change the address, so you can delete it and start again.

Once there's anything in it, the button disappears, because deleting a publication people have written in and subscribed to would destroy the work and break every link anybody shared. If you really want it gone, delete the posts first — or ask a site administrator, who can remove any publication along with everything in it.

One thing that surprises people: **somebody who subscribed and then unsubscribed still counts.** A publication can only be deleted if nobody has ever subscribed to it. If Delete is missing on a publication that

looks empty, that's usually why.

SITE ADMINISTRATION

Site Administration

Sitewide settings, the clipart library, and the audit log.

Written for: **Platform administrators**

Visible to app administrators only.

The dashboard

Administration → Dashboard is the overview for everything else in this menu: four headline numbers above a grid of charts, with a 7 / 30 / 90-day range picker.

The first three headline cards are links: **People** opens the user list, **In a group** opens the groups, and **Cases** opens the case list, so you can go straight from a number to the details behind it. *Signed in this week* isn't a link, because there's no page that lists recent sign-ins.

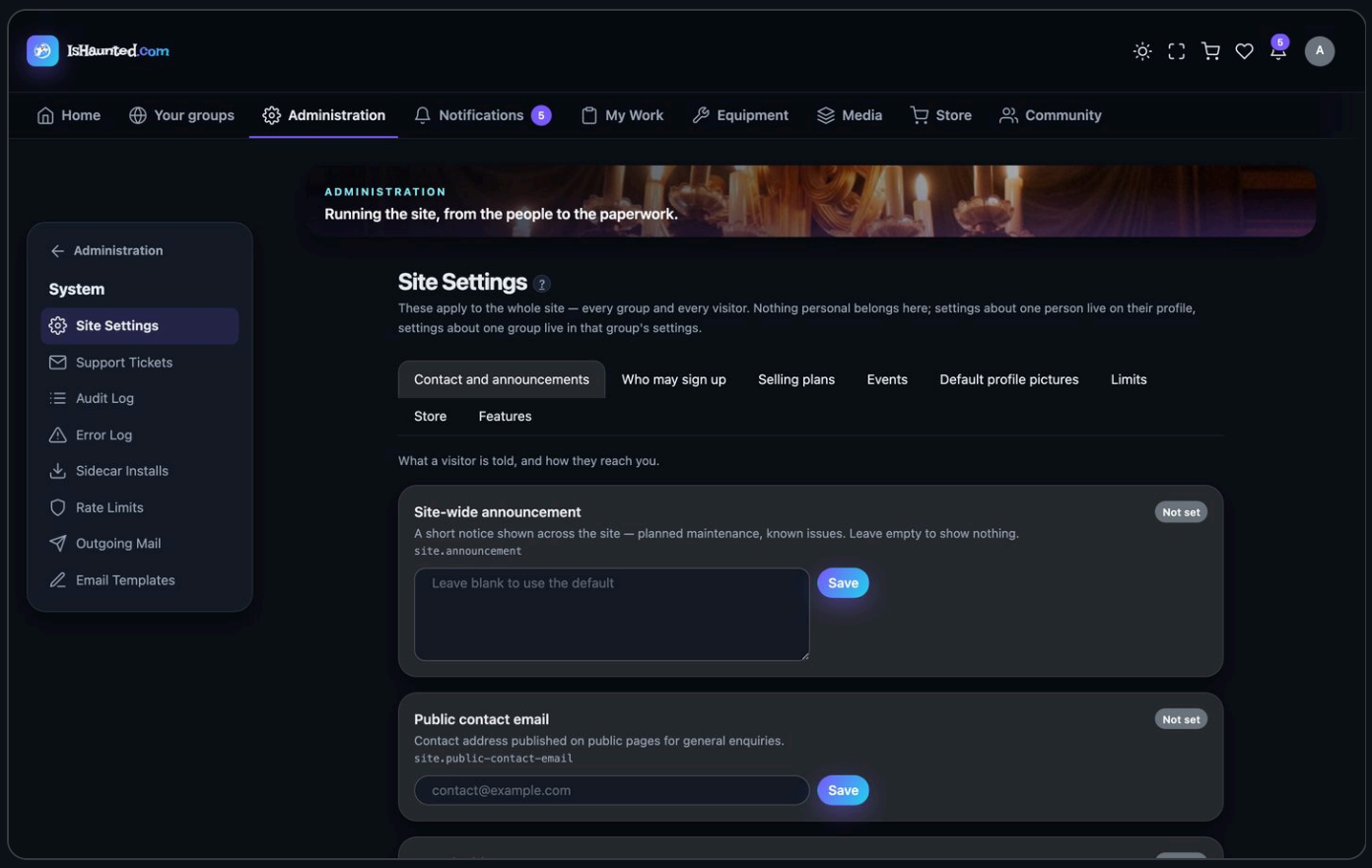
Some of the numbers need a little explaining:

- **People** and **In a group**: the second number is your funnel. Someone who registers but never joins a group hasn't been won over yet, and the percentage under the number shows how many people are in that position.
- **Signed in this week** counts *people*, not sign-ins; the caption below it gives the raw number of attempts. Someone who signs in on a laptop and a phone is one person with two sign-ins.
- **Busiest groups** counts cases and investigations started within the chosen range, so it changes with the range picker. **Largest groups** counts active members and doesn't change.
- **Where this is happening** has a People / Cases / Investigations toggle, and all three use addresses already on record: people by their profile addresses, cases by the address the case is about, and investigations by the place visited. Expect People to trail the other two, because it only counts people who have filled in an address, and most haven't.

What the dashboard cannot tell you

There's no count of visitors who never sign in, and no "new versus returning" split. The site doesn't record anonymous visitors: a page view by someone without an account leaves no trace in the database. Every number on this page is about accounts and what they did.

Site settings



Site settings apply to every group and every visitor.

Administration → Site Settings holds values that apply to the whole site. Nothing personal belongs here: settings for one person are on their profile, and settings for one group are in that group's settings.

You can't add a new setting from this page. Settings are declared in code, in `SiteSettingKeys.Seed`, and the page shows whatever is declared there.

The prices (the *Selling plans*, *Events* and *Ghost Walk Tour subscription* tabs) are also on **Administration → Pricing**, beside the plans; see Prices in one place.

Allowing groups to sign themselves up

Allow groups to self-register controls whether an ordinary signed-in visitor can start a group. When it's on (the default, and how the site normally runs), anyone can start one from **Organizations → Start a Group** and becomes its owner. When it's off, that button disappears, the page behind it explains that new groups aren't being accepted and points to the contact form, and the server refuses the request even if someone has the address saved. Either way, you're exempt: an administrator can always create a group from the administration side.

Use it when you want to pause growth, for example partway through a billing change, or during a period when every new group needs a conversation first. It has no effect on existing groups.

The default profile picture

There are **three default pictures**: a generic one, one for members whose profile says they're a man, and one for members whose profile says they're a woman. Each is an ordinary upload: press **Upload image**, pick a JPEG, PNG, GIF or WebP, and it takes effect immediately. The preview under the row shows what's live. Uploading a replacement removes the previous image, so there's nothing to clean up. The images are stored publicly so that they can appear for visitors who aren't signed in.

Which picture a viewer sees depends on the person's own profile: the optional **Sex** field under their name (Male, Female, Unspecified; blank by default). It's self-declared and never guessed from a name. Blank or Unspecified gets the generic image. Male or Female gets the matching image **if you've uploaded one**, and the generic one otherwise. A real photo always takes priority over any default.

The site-wide announcement

Site-wide announcement is for maintenance windows and known issues. While the box has text, an info banner shows it at the top of every page to everyone, signed in or not, with your line breaks kept. To take the banner down, clear the box and save. Posting and removing both reach visitors within about half a minute, with no restart needed. The text appears exactly as typed: plain text, with no formatting or links.

Turning sections of the site on and off

Near the bottom of Site Settings is a set of switches labeled **Feature — ...**, one for each major section: the video editor, equipment, events and calendars, local discovery and maps, group public pages, the media library, group messaging, voting, and the two newer features described below.

Each switch does exactly what it says. The links disappear from the navigation **and the addresses stop working**, so someone who bookmarked a page, or who gets a link from a colleague, sees the ordinary "page not found" screen instead of a way in.

Here's what some of the switches take down. **Local discovery and maps** removes the "what's near you" panel, the home-page maps and the nearby search. **Group public pages** removes every /o/{group} page (for visitors who aren't signed in, too), along with the CMS editor and its tab. **Voting** removes the vote controls from cases, evidence and files, and the server refuses votes sent any other way. **Events and calendars** removes the Calendar tab, the public What's-on list, event pages, RSVPs and the reminder emails all at once, so nobody can sign up for an event and then never get a reminder.

What a switch does **not** do is delete anything. Equipment records, saved videos, messages and votes all stay exactly where they are, and turning the switch back on brings the section back with its contents intact. Use it to take a section down while something is being fixed, or to run the site without a feature your groups don't want. Don't use it to remove data.

Two things worth knowing:

- **A change takes up to about half a minute** to reach every page, because the site keeps the setting in memory instead of checking the database on every click. Your own browser sees the change as soon as you flip the switch.

- **If the site can't reach its API**, the switches fall back to their normal settings: the established sections on, unreleased features off. A connection problem will never make the site look as if it has lost half its features.

A switch that has never been saved shows the setting's default, marked **(default)** next to On or Off, so the row always shows what the site is actually doing.

Two switches start **off**: **Public feed** and **Publications**. Both features are built, but each one adds a public area that members and visitors will start using as soon as it appears. Turning either one on should be a deliberate decision, not something a site gets by default.

- **Public feed** — the complete feature: anyone can read it without an account; members and clients post text, photos and video; posts carry experience-type categories the site learns from; groups decide which videos from their cases link back to them; and promoted cards rotate through it, shown nearest-first to viewers who share their location. Turning it on means taking on the job of moderating it (see Moderating the Feed). The **Feed Media** page tells you whether screening is **automatic** (the on-server model is installed) or **manual-only** (every photo and video waits for a person). Don't launch on manual-only unless you mean to. While the feed is off but has content, every SuperAdmin sees a reminder banner naming this switch, so the feature can't be forgotten by accident.
- **Publications** — long-form writing by groups, readable by visitors without an account. Turning it on adds a **Publications** entry to the menu for everyone, and a **Publications** tab to each group's page for its administrators. Nothing appears in the public directory until a group actually publishes something, so at worst visitors see an empty directory, not an unfinished one.

Closing the door to new ghost walking tours

Administration → Site Settings → Allow new ghost walking tours switches off new sign-ups as a ghost walking tour.

It only affects new tours. Every tour business already signed up carries on as before: its tours, dates, sign-ups and billing are untouched, and nobody loses anything they're paying for. What stops is starting a new one. The option disappears from the Start a Group wizard with a sentence explaining why, the server refuses a new tour registration, and an existing group can't start running tours while the switch is off. A SuperAdmin can still create one at any time.

Paranormal events businesses aren't affected. They're on the same flat plan, but they're a different kind of business, and this switch is only about walking tours.

If the setting has never been saved, it counts as **on**, so a site that never touches it behaves exactly as it always has.

A person's record

Administration → Users lists every account. The view button on a row opens that person's record in tabs: their profile fields, addresses, emails, phones, links, notes, memberships, files and site roles. You can edit each tab directly, and every change is written to the audit log under your name. A photo in the files tab opens in the photo editor; see *Editing a photo* in Organization Administration.

Former members

Closing an account doesn't remove it. The person's name, contact details and sign-in credentials are removed, but the account itself stays, so the cases, evidence and messages they wrote for a group stay where the group left them, signed "A former member". Deleting the account outright would also delete the group's record of its own work.

So every account that has ever been closed is still in this list. **Include former members**, above the grid, controls whether you see them. It's off when you arrive, and a count next to it shows how many are hidden. If a search finds nobody, that count reminds you to check the box before assuming the person was never here.

A group's own member list never shows former members. Nobody there can give a closed account a role, invite it or ask it to do anything, so it would only clutter a screen people work from.

Last sign-in and how many

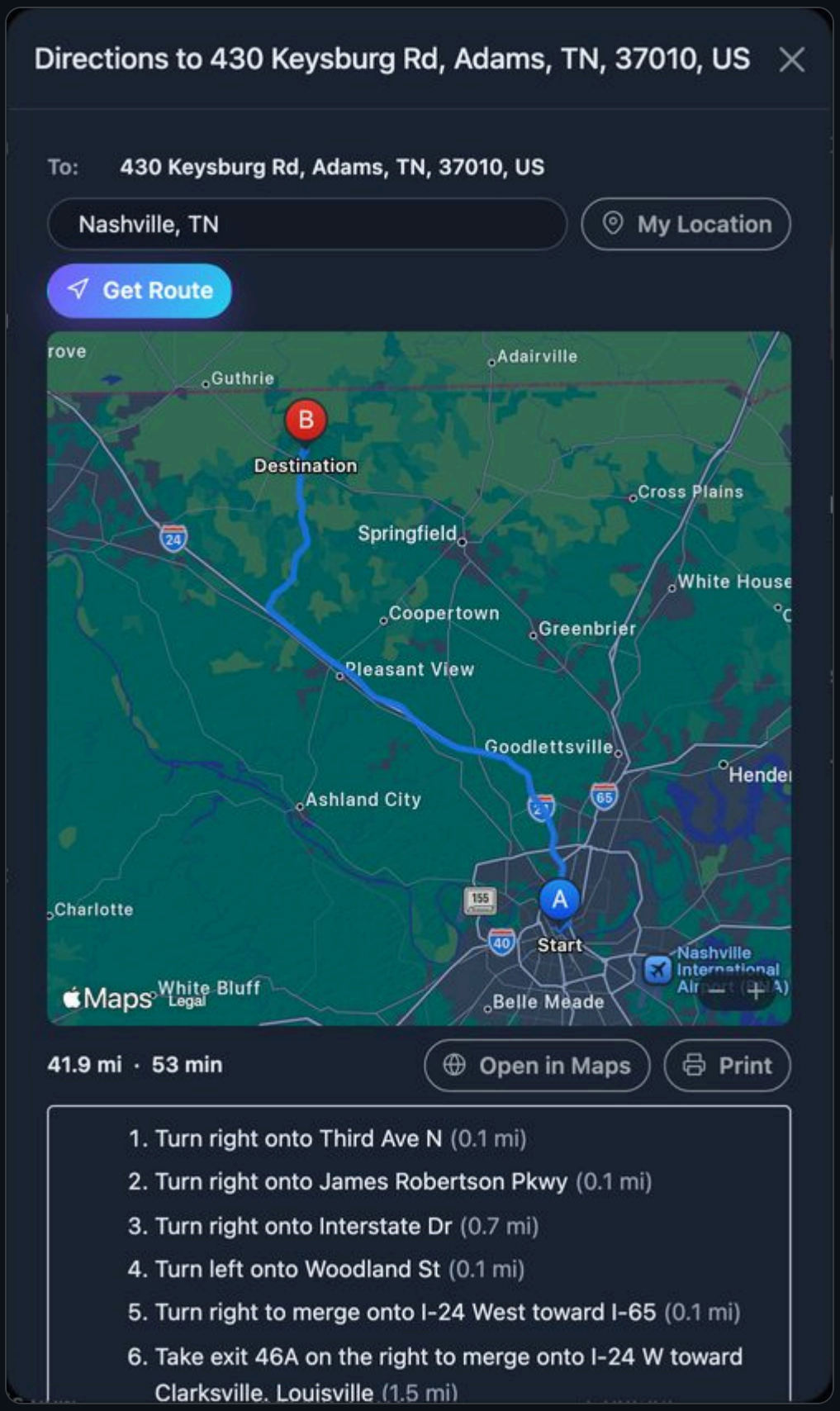
Two columns on the list show who is actually using the site. **Last sign-in** is the most recent sign-in; **Sign-ins** is the total. Both columns sort, so clicking either heading puts the quietest or busiest accounts at the top. An account that has never been signed in to shows **Never** instead of a blank.

Every way of signing in counts the same: a password, Sign in with Apple, a Microsoft account, and the code that passes a session to the standalone editor.

Two things to keep in mind before you read too much into a number:

- **Nothing goes back further than August 20, 2026**, when the site started recording sign-ins. An account older than that has a count starting from that day, not from the day it was created.
- **A Microsoft account is counted once every twelve hours of use**, not once per sign-in. A Microsoft session doesn't have a single moment when someone signs in; it's checked on every page. So there's no exact count: a working day counts as one, and coming back in the evening counts as another. Microsoft sign-ins weren't recorded at all before September 19, 2026.

Once an address has been placed on the map, the **Addresses** tab shows two buttons beside it: **Map** shows the address with its region circle, and **Directions** opens the directions window.



Directions from a typed starting point, drawn on the map and read out beneath it.

Type a starting address (a town is enough), or press **My Location** to use where your browser says you are, then press **Get Route**. The route is drawn on the map with the start marked **A** and the address marked **B**, and

the distance, driving time and turn-by-turn steps appear below. **Print** prints the window as it is; **Open in Maps** sends the same route to Apple Maps, which opens the Maps app on a phone. The route isn't saved.

An address that couldn't be placed on the map has neither button. Correct it and save, and the lookup runs again.

Impersonating a member

Administration → Users → the impersonate button signs you in as that person, and you see exactly what they see: their navigation and groups under Home, their notification counts on the bell, their pages, and anything they'd be refused. Your own Administration menu disappears while you're viewing, since it's your tool and not part of their experience. A banner at the bottom of the sidebar shows who you're viewing as, with **Return to SuperAdmin** next to it. Both stay in place if you reload the page, so getting out of impersonation always takes just one click.

Use it to see a reported problem through the reporter's eyes before you decide what's causing it. Anything you do while impersonating really happens on their account.

Site roles

There are four roles that apply across the whole site, separate from anyone's role inside a group. They combine: one person can hold any mix of them.

- **SuperAdmin** — everything: every page under Administration, impersonation, billing, and the power to give out these roles.
- **Admin** — can see the administration help documents and, for now, nothing else. The role exists so that its powers can be widened one at a time rather than all at once.
- **Moderator** — reviews what people post: the feed's report queue and the media waiting for review, with the power to approve, hold or hide. No billing, no user administration, no impersonation. A SuperAdmin can moderate without holding this role.
- **Seller** — a member who makes and sells their own items in the store. Only people with this role are listed in a product's **Seller** field. It doesn't open any part of Administration, and a seller never sets a price or puts an item on sale; a SuperAdmin does both.

Everyone else is an ordinary member. Creating an account and confirming an email address makes someone a verified member; it never puts them in a site role.

To give somebody a role, open **Administration → Users**, view the person, and open the **Site Roles** tab. Check the roles they should hold and press **Save Roles**. Whatever is checked when you save is exactly what they end up with, so unchecking a role removes it. The roles they hold also show as badges beside their name at the top of the page.

The change takes effect the next time they sign in. Any session they already have open ends within the hour, so a removed role can't linger longer than that.

The page won't let you do two things. You can't remove your **own** SuperAdmin role; another SuperAdmin has to do that, and the box is locked to show it. And nobody can remove the **last** SuperAdmin on the site, so make someone else a SuperAdmin first. Either change would leave nobody able to reach this screen.

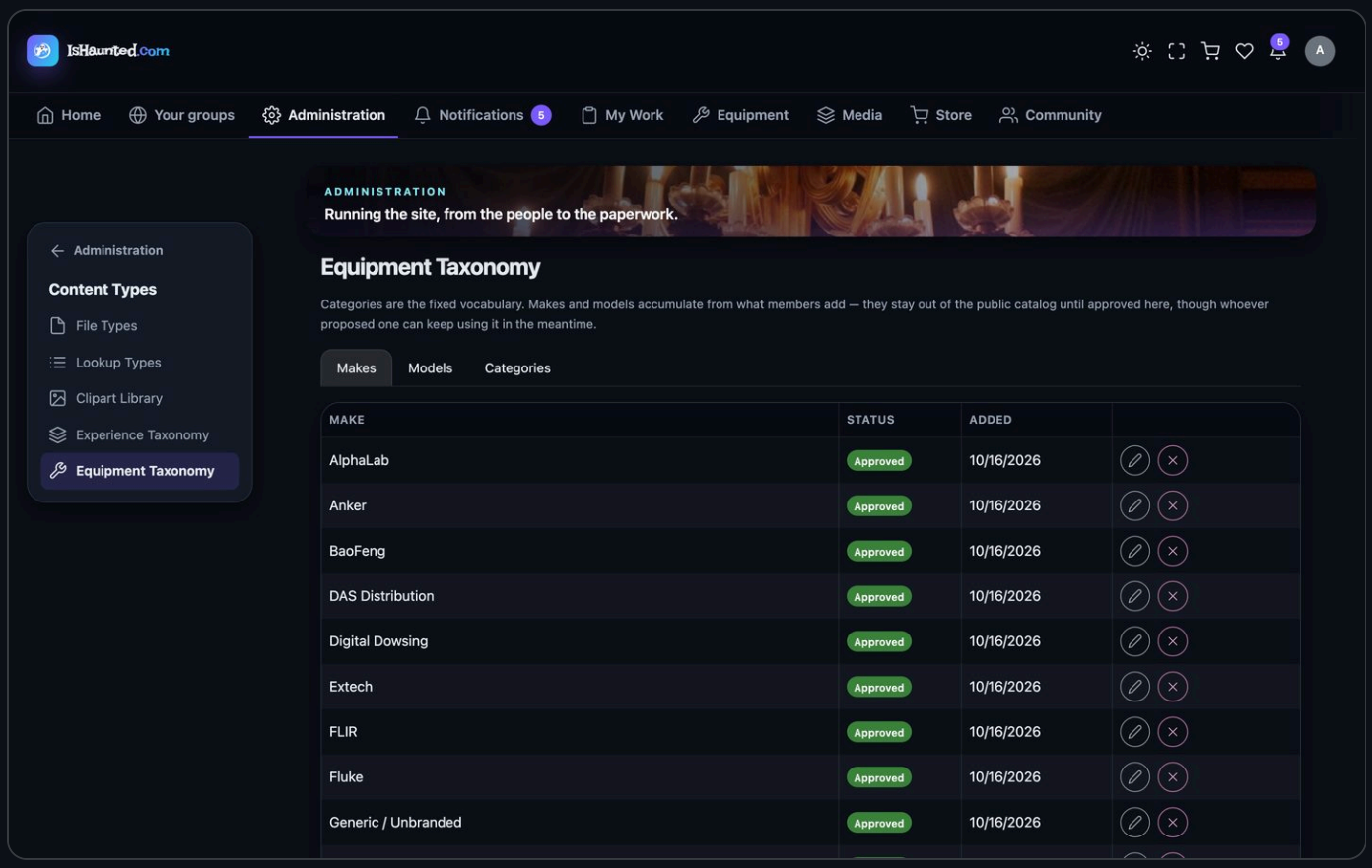
Administration → Site Roles lists the roles themselves. Here you can add a new role name or delete one that nobody holds, and see how many people hold each role. A role you add here appears on the Site Roles tab right away, but it doesn't grant anything until the site's code checks for it by name. It's a label, not a permission.

The clipart library

Administration → Clipart Library manages the shared artwork every group can use in the video editor. Upload the file first, then choose it from your media library with the picker and publish it. The format is read from the file itself (SVG, PNG, WebP, AVIF, GIF or Lottie), and anything else is refused, so nothing is published that the editor can't draw.

Artwork is **retired**, never deleted. Projects refer to artwork by id, so deleting a piece would break videos that already use it. Retired artwork leaves the catalog but can still be downloaded.

Keeping the shared vocabulary tidy



Makes and models members have proposed, waiting to be approved, merged or renamed.

Two lists grow from members' suggestions rather than being set from the top: the **experience taxonomy** and the **equipment catalog**. Groups add what they need while they're out investigating, and you confirm entries or tidy up afterward.

Confirming an entry marks it as reviewed. That does more than add a badge: only reviewed entries are offered to the next person as "did you mean" suggestions, and they're no longer cleaned up automatically. Confirming is how a word becomes shared vocabulary instead of one group's note.

Renaming does what it says, unless the new name is already taken. In that case you're shown the existing entry with that name and offered a merge instead. Renaming onto an existing name turns two entries into one and changes what some people's records mean, so it's always a separate, deliberate step.

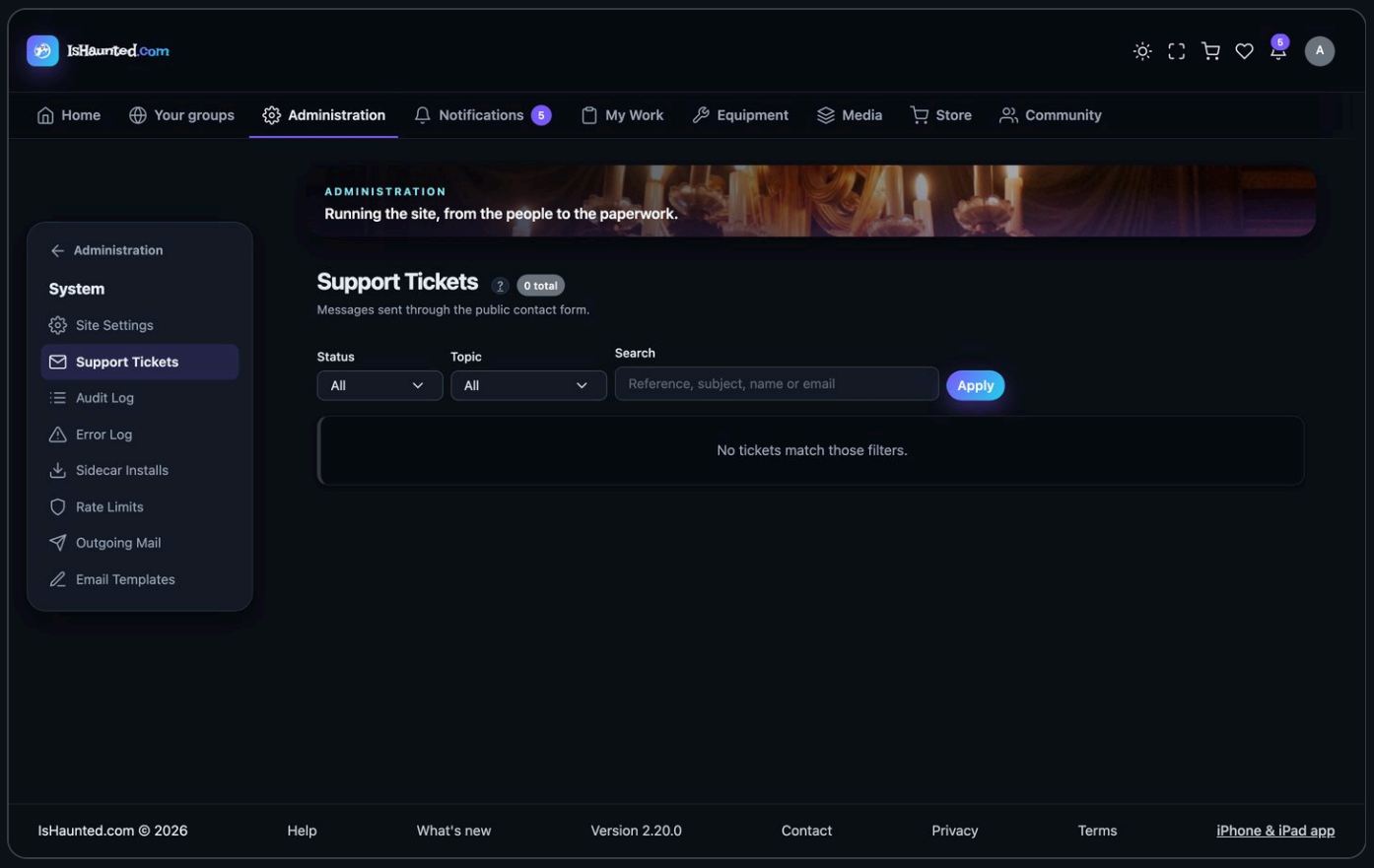
Merging moves everything over to the other entry and removes the duplicate. It can't be undone. There are two safeguards:

- You can't merge a **confirmed** entry into an unconfirmed one. That's almost always the wrong way around: the approved word would disappear and the mistake would remain. Merge the other way, or confirm the target first.
- You can't merge an experience type into a **different category**. Moving a tag from Visual to Auditory changes what someone recorded about their own experience, which is more than a rename.

Deleting is only for an entry nothing uses. If it's tagged on anything, you're told how many times and the delete is refused. **Reject** is the action that removes a type along with its tags, and it tells you how many tags it removed.

Most tidying happens without you. An unconfirmed entry that a group suggested disappears on its own once nothing uses it anymore.

Support tickets



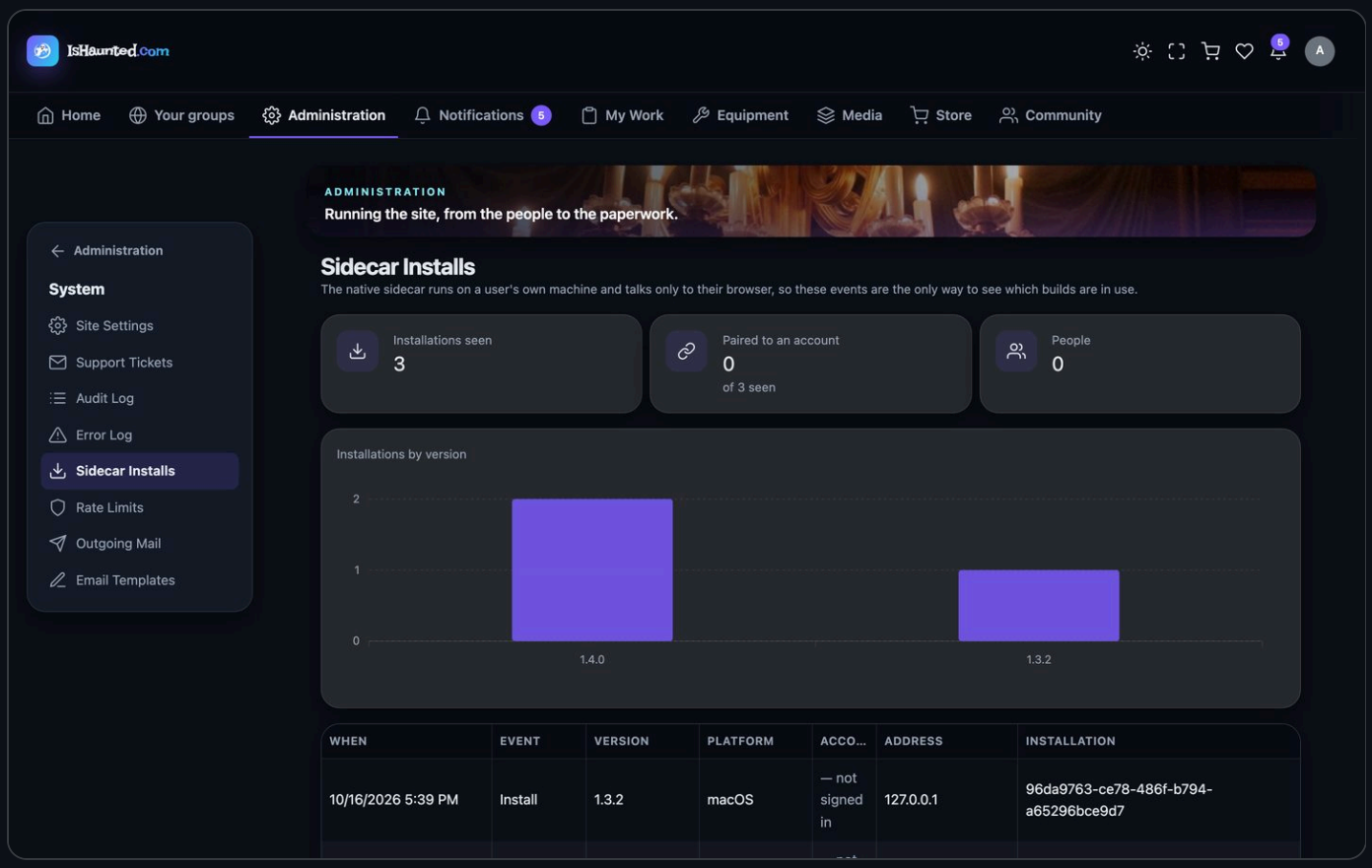
Every message sent through the contact form arrives here.

Administration → Support Tickets is the queue for the public contact form. A ticket arrives as **New**. Replying to the sender marks it **Answered** and assigns it to you if nobody had it yet.

The sender follows the conversation through a private tracking link, whether or not they have an account, so your reply reaches them even if they can't sign in. **Internal notes are never shown there.** They're for staff to talk among themselves, and adding one doesn't mark the ticket answered.

The contact details shown beside the form (postal address, phone, email and reply times) are site settings, so you can correct them on the Site Settings page without a site update.

Sidecar installs



Which builds of the native helper are actually in use.

Administration → Sidecar Installs shows the optional native helper people install to make the video editor faster. The sidecar runs on a person's own computer and talks only to their browser, so these records are the only way to see which versions people are actually running. That's useful before you change anything about it, and it answers "can we stop supporting that version yet?"

Three numbers and a chart:

- **Installations seen** — distinct machines that have reported in.
- **Paired to an account** — how many of those were paired with a signed-in person. A gap between the two means people are installing it but not finishing setup.
- **People** — distinct accounts. This is lower than installations when someone uses two computers.
- **Installations by version** — how installations are spread across versions. Watch this after releasing a new build: a version that never grows suggests people aren't being told an update exists.

The table below lists the individual events. Nothing here identifies a machine beyond the installation id the sidecar creates for itself.

Outgoing mail

Administration → System → Outgoing Mail answers one question: *can this machine actually send email right now?*

This matters because a mail failure doesn't show up anywhere else. Someone signs up, no email arrives, and nothing on the site looks wrong: the account exists, the site is up, and the person just can't get in.

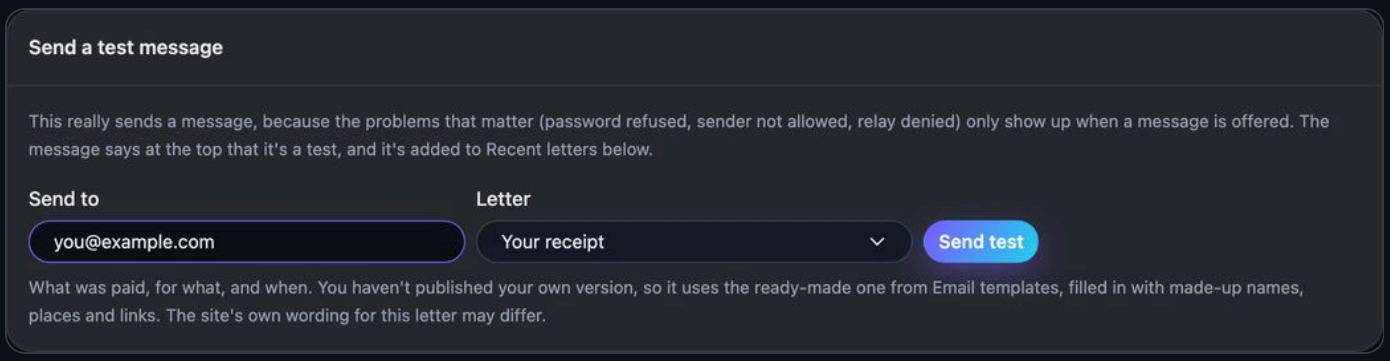
The answer can differ from one machine to another, so check it on the one you care about. The mail password is given to the running website as an environment variable on its application pool, not read from a file in the repository. So a developer's laptop, a shell on the server and the website itself can each get a different answer, and only the website's answer reflects what your members experience.

The page shows the settings the machine will send with (host, port, security, user and from-address) and whether a **password is present**. It never shows the password itself. There are three states to know about:

WHAT IT SAYS	WHAT IT MEANS
Mail is switched off on this machine	No host is set, so nothing is even attempted. Every confirmation, invitation and password reset is silently going nowhere.
A host is set but no password is present	The most likely real fault, and the one that looks as if nothing is wrong. Every visible setting can be correct and sending will still fail.
Settings listed, password present	Configured. Send a test to be sure.

Send a test message does exactly that: it really sends a message instead of just checking the connection. The failures that matter happen after the connection opens (authentication rejected, sender not permitted, relay denied), and none of them show up until a message is actually sent.

Letter chooses what to send. Leave it on *A plain test message* to check that mail gets through, or pick one of the site's letters (a receipt, a booking confirmation, a password reset) to see how it looks when it arrives. A picked letter uses the version you published in **Email templates**, or the ready-made version there if you haven't published your own. Either way it's filled in with made-up names, places and links, so nothing real goes out and its buttons don't work.



Every test says at the top that it's a test, and its subject starts with **[Test]**. It's also added to **Recent letters** below, so you can open it with **Read it** and see exactly what was sent.

If the test fails, you see the server's exact error, not a tidied-up "could not send". *"535 authentication failed"* and *"connection timed out"* need completely different fixes, and a polite summary wouldn't tell you which one you need.

If the test succeeds but the message still doesn't arrive, look in the junk or spam folder first. If it isn't there either, the mail left this server and the problem is delivery: the recipient's provider rejected or filtered it after accepting it. The most common cause is mail sent through a server the domain doesn't list as one of its senders. The site's own domain only allows its email hosting's mail server, so mail must go out through that server.

Every letter the site meant to send

Below the settings, **Recent letters** lists what the site has actually tried to send recently. It opens on the list you most likely came for: the ones it has **given up on**.

Each row shows who the letter was for, what it was, when it was written and how far it got: accepted by the mail server, still waiting (with the time of its next attempt), or given up, with the server's last error.

Accepted isn't the same as received. It means the mail server took the message. Only bounce reports could tell you whether anyone got it, and this site doesn't collect them. If a letter was accepted and the person still has nothing, the problem is delivery, not sending, and the mail settings above won't help.

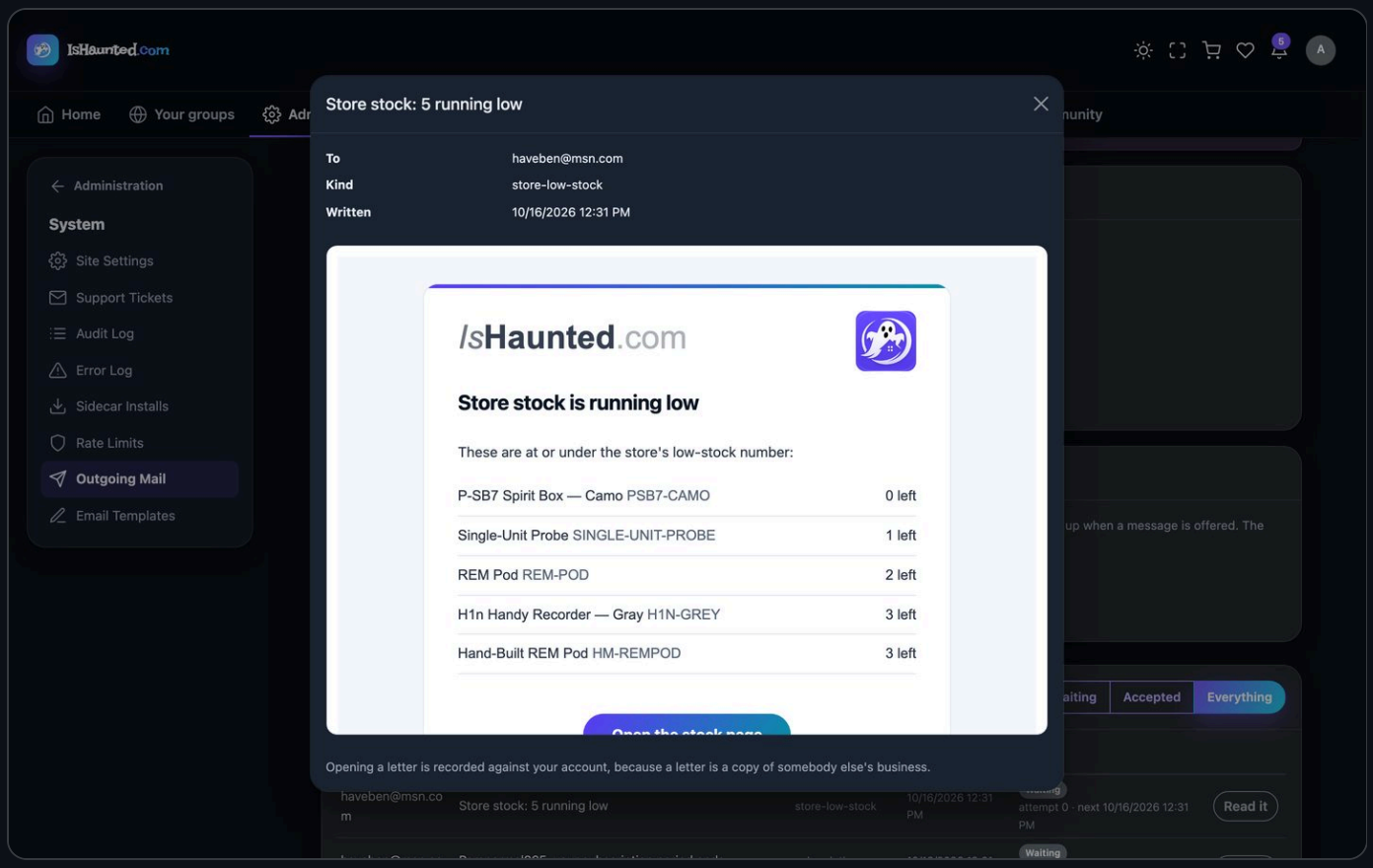
Send again puts one given-up letter back in the queue, and the sender picks it up on its next pass, within five minutes. There's also a bulk version for after you've fixed a relay problem; it tells you how many letters it will requeue.

Two kinds of letter can't be sent again, and they say so instead of offering a button that would fail:

- One the mail server already accepted. Sending it again would send a duplicate.
- One whose **words were cleared**. A letter's body is deleted a month after it's accepted, because it can contain someone's name, what they booked and, for a hosted event, a working door code. The record of the letter is kept for as long as you need it, but its contents aren't. To send it again, the part of the site that wrote it has to write it again.

Reading a letter

Read it on a row opens the letter the site actually sent, shown as the person received it. The rest of the row tells you *whether it went*; this tells you *what it said*. That's what you need when someone reports that a confirmation was wrong, blank or meant for someone else.



Three things to know before you use it.

Opening a letter is recorded against your account. A letter contains someone else's private details: a booking names a guest, a password reset contains a working link, and an event pass contains a code that opens a door. You're allowed to read letters, because someone has to be able to check what was sent, but the site keeps a record of who read whose letter. It appears in the audit log as a **Read**.

A letter whose words were cleared can't be read. Instead of showing an empty frame, it tells you when the words were removed, so you won't mistake it for a letter that was sent blank.

The letter can't do anything. It's shown in a sealed frame that runs nothing: no scripts, and no requests out to anywhere else. A letter can contain whatever someone typed into a form, so this keeps it from doing any harm while you're looking at it.

Email templates

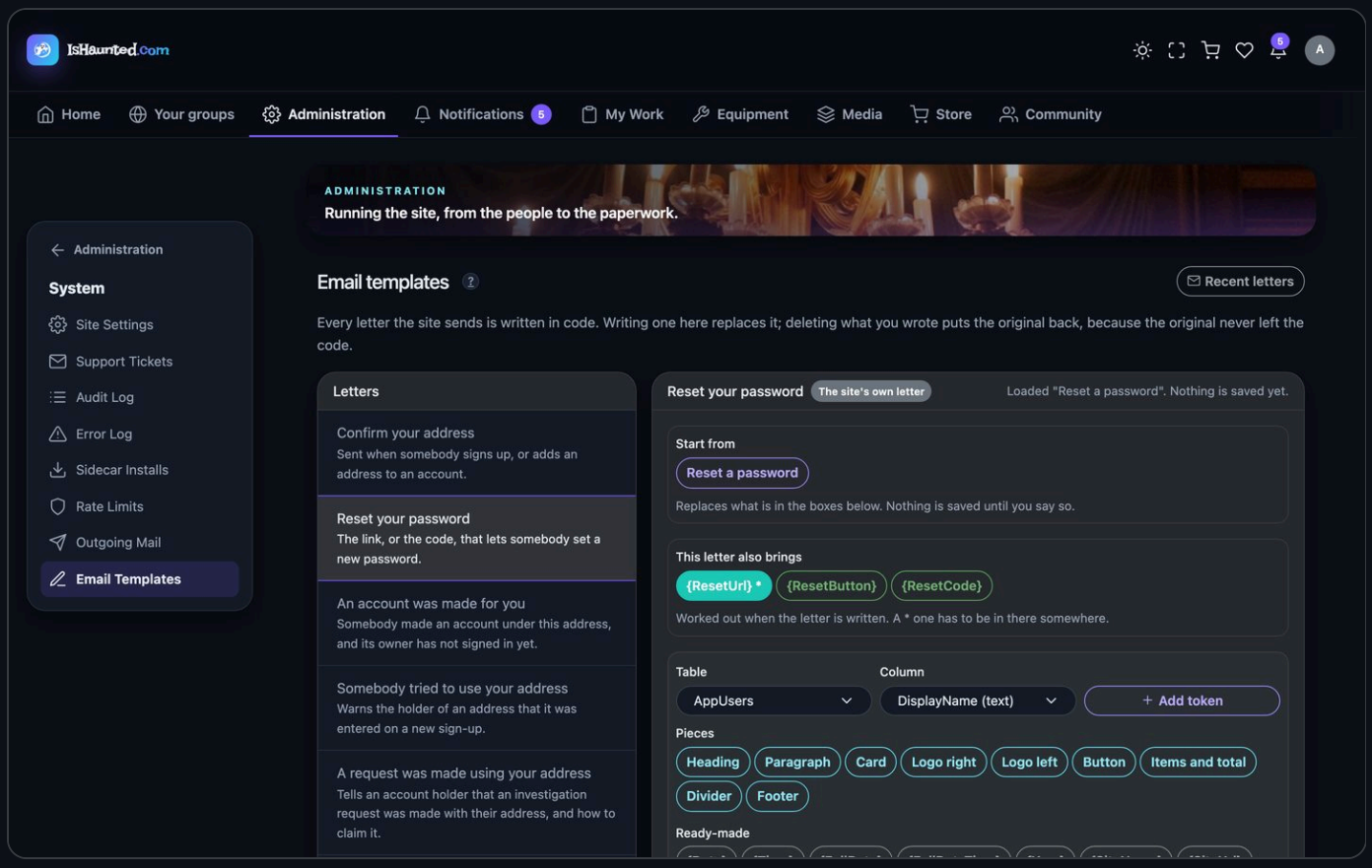
Every letter the site sends is written in code. **Email templates** lets you write your own version of any of them, and your version is used as soon as you publish it.

Deleting your version brings back the original. Your template only takes the place of the built-in letter, which never changes, so "Use the site's letter" undoes everything and there's nothing to restore.

Filling in the details

A letter can include the reader's name or the date by using a **token**: a word in braces that is replaced when the letter is written.

Pick a **table**, then a **column**, then press **Add token**, and `{AppUsers.DisplayName}` is added to the body. Move it wherever you want it.



The tables offered are the ones *that letter* actually has information from. A password-reset letter only knows about the person, so it offers only `AppUsers`, and it won't save a token it could never fill in, so no letter goes out with a gap in it. Columns meant for the site's own use rather than for readers (anything holding a password, a security code or internal record-keeping) are never offered.

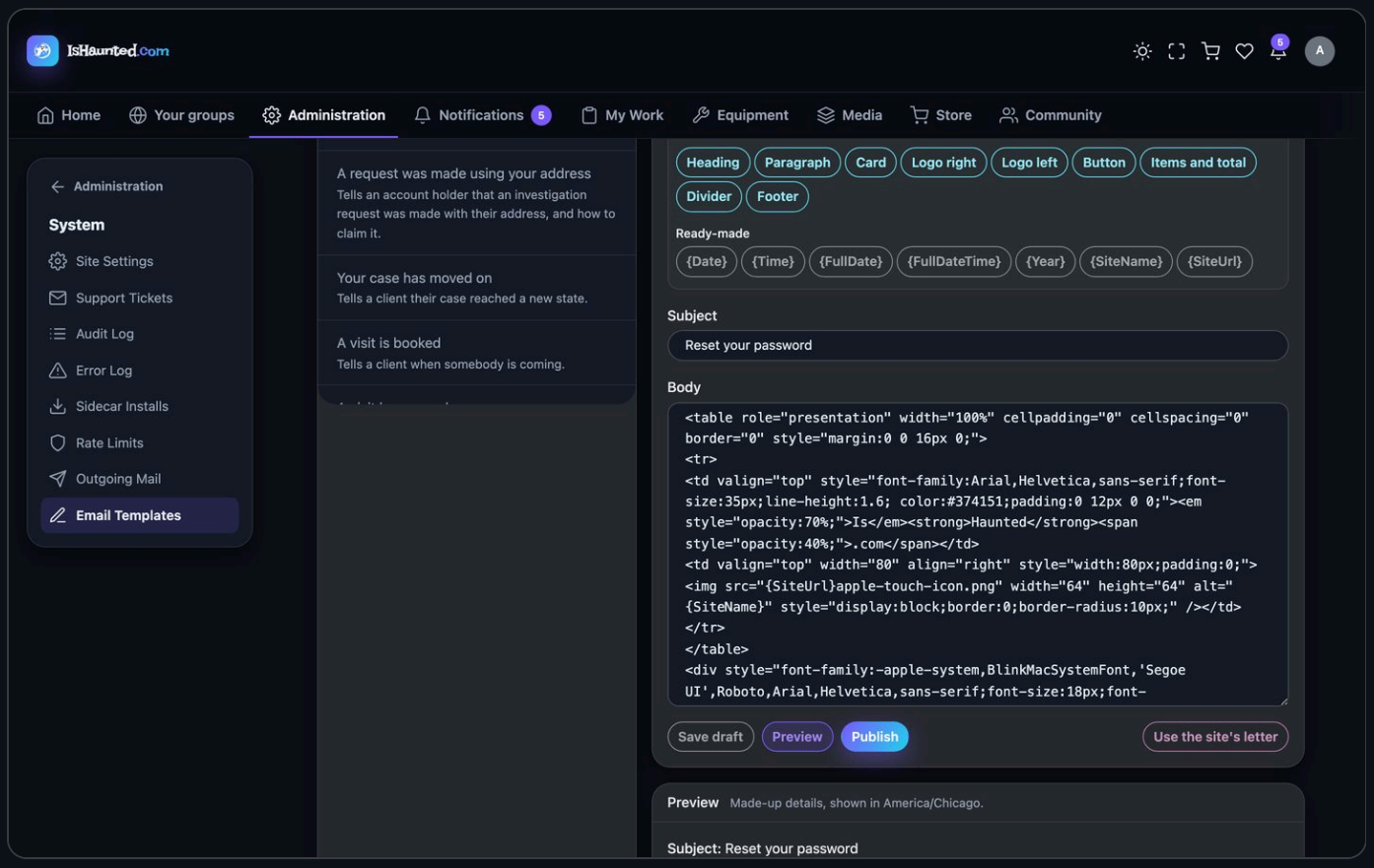
There are also ready-made tokens that don't need a table:

TOKEN	LOOKS LIKE
`{Date}`	09/20/2026
`{Time}`	9:05 AM
`{FullDate}`	September 20, 2026
`{FullDateTime}`	September 20, 2026 9:05 AM
`{Year}`	2026
`{SiteName}`	IsHaunted.com
`{SiteUrl}`	https://ishaunted.com

Times are shown in the reader's time zone, not yours. A letter written at 9:05 in the morning in Tennessee says 10:05 to someone in New York and 3:05 in the afternoon to someone in London. Date columns from a table work the same way, so everyone sees times in their own time zone.

Looking at it before anybody gets it

Preview fills in the tokens with made-up details (Marguerite Ashdown, at 1201 Del Rio Pike) and shows the letter as it would arrive. No real data is used, so a preview never shows you anyone's actual name or address.



Save draft keeps what you're working on without changing anything anyone receives. **Publish** is what makes it take effect, starting with the next letter of that kind. Letters already in the queue aren't rewritten.

Writing the body

The body is HTML, and email HTML isn't the same as web HTML: use tables for layout, write every style directly on the element, and don't use a stylesheet. Outlook displays mail using Word's engine and Gmail strips out style blocks, so anything fancier breaks somewhere. That's why the box is a plain one rather than a word processor: a rich editor would quietly rewrite the very markup that keeps a letter looking right in those email programs.

If a template ever fails to render, the site sends its own letter instead and records why. Nothing you write here can stop a letter from going out.

The store's letters

The store sends six letters, and you can edit each one here like any other: the buyer's **receipt** ("Thank you for your order"), **Your order is on its way** (with the carrier and tracking, or a note that it was sent without tracking), **A refund on your order**, **A link to your order** (for "Find my order"), and, to SuperAdmins, **A new store order** and **Store stock is running low**. Each has a starter version to begin from and sample values in the preview. Once you publish a template, it's used from then on; deleting it brings back the site's own letter.

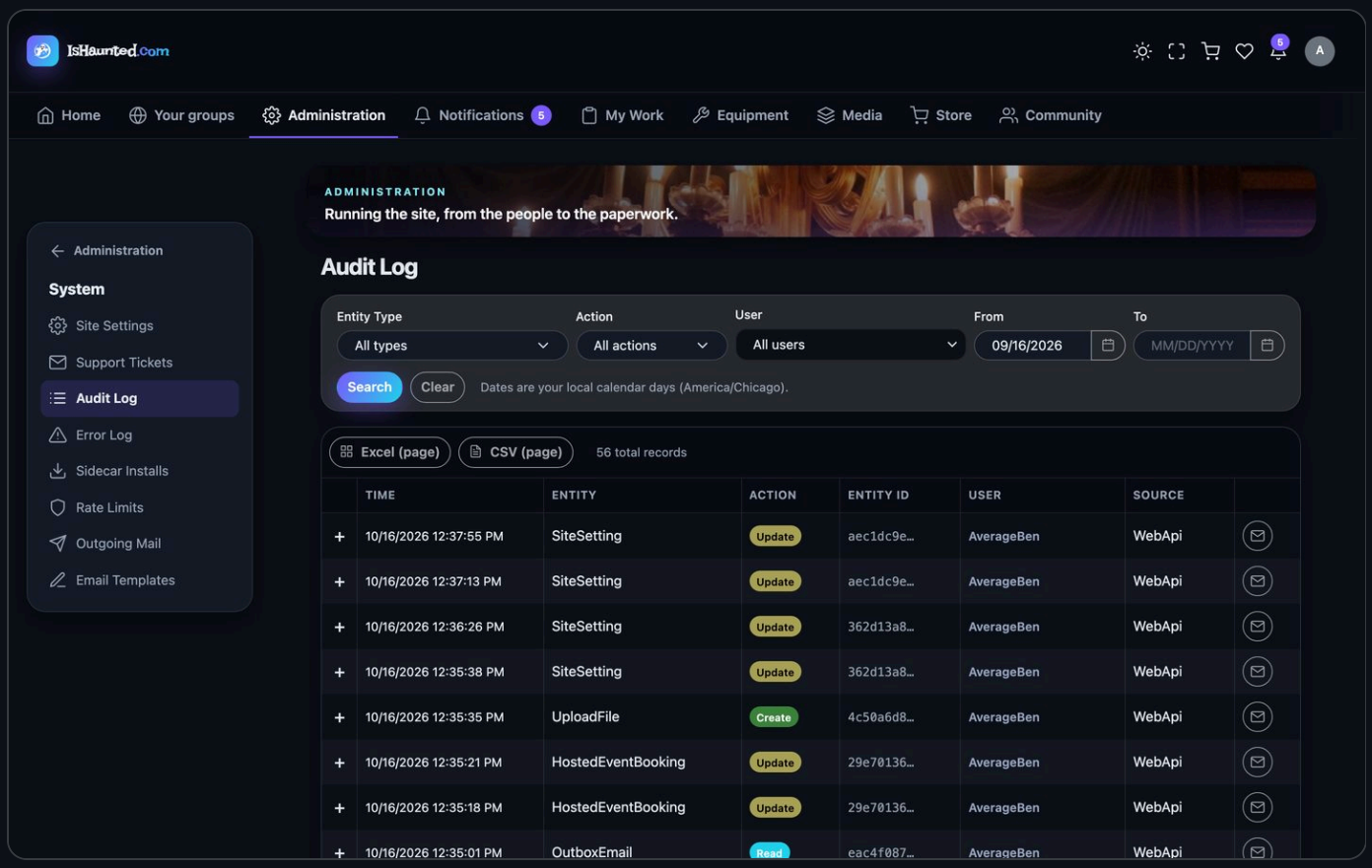
Knowing whether a member was ever emailed

Administration → Users has a **Verified** column that shows which of three situations an account is in:

- A check mark with a date — confirmed, and when.
- **Sent \<date>** — the link went out and they haven't used it yet. Nothing is wrong; they just haven't gotten around to it, or it's in their spam folder.
- **No email sent**, in red — no confirmation email has ever successfully left this machine for that account. **Nobody can complete it**, however long they wait. The fault is with the site, not the member; check Outgoing Mail above.

That last one is the row worth scanning for. It's how you tell someone who hasn't bothered from someone who never got the chance.

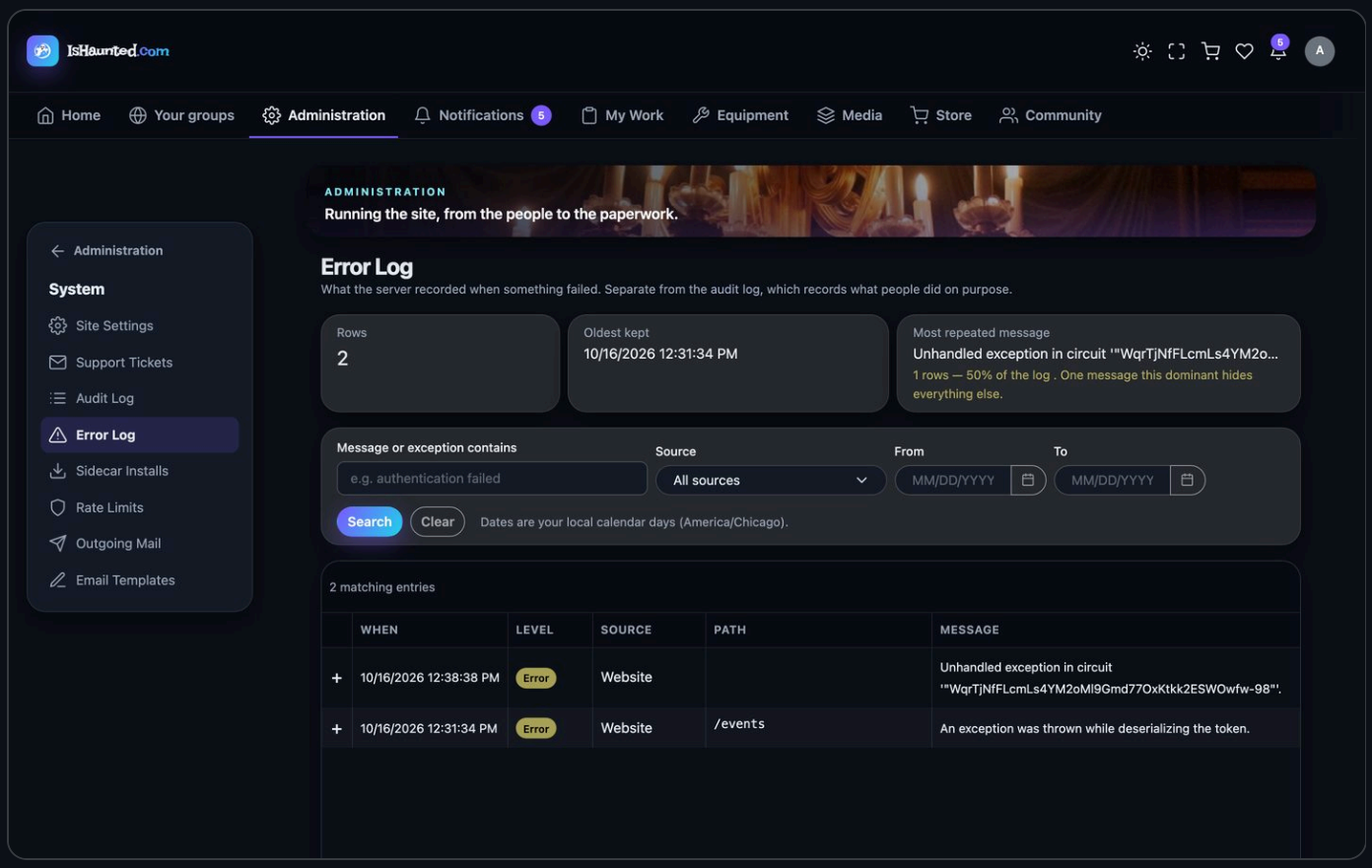
Audit log



The audit log records who changed what, and when. Filter it by entity, action, person or date.

Administration → Audit Log records every change and who made it. Filtering and paging happen on the server, so date and user filters search the whole history, not just the page on screen.

Error log



The error log: how many rows, the oldest kept, the most repeated message — then the rows themselves, newest first.

Administration → Error Log is the audit log's counterpart, and the two are easy to confuse. The audit log records what people did on purpose and is kept for years. The error log records what broke, and old entries are removed after a retention period (thirty days unless configured otherwise).

Open a row to see the full message, the exception and the request path. The path is usually the quickest way to pin down a fault, because it names the endpoint that was being called when it happened.

Read the cards before the rows. If one message makes up half the log or more, the page tells you. That's a finding in itself: a flood of one message buries everything else until you deal with it, even though each entry looks harmless on its own. The *Most repeated message* card is there to catch exactly that.

What isn't here. Only errors are recorded. The database log is set to Error level, so warnings never reach it. That matters more than it sounds: a failure logged as a warning leaves no trace on this page at all. If something is clearly failing and nothing shows up here, suspect the logging level before deciding there's no fault.

Nothing on this page deletes anything. Old entries are removed only by the retention job, which has a minimum window and works in batches. There's no button to empty the log, so evidence someone is about to need can't be wiped out with one click.

Administrators and SuperAdministrators can both open it, so whoever is on call can always see why the site is failing.

Prices in one place

Administration → Pricing shows every price the site charges on one page, with one plain sentence under each part saying what a group or a visitor pays right now:

- **Plans**: each plan with its members and its monthly and yearly price, how many groups are on it, and the **Sell plans and seats** switch. Plans and their prices are changed in **Price Bands**; **Edit plans and prices** takes you there.
- **Events**: **Sell event credits**, the price of one event, the share a group with a paid plan pays, and the bundles. The sentence says what one event costs and what a group with a paid plan pays for it.
- **Ghost Walk Tour subscription**: on or off, and the monthly price for each tour route.

These are the same settings as the *Selling plans*, *Events* and *Ghost Walk Tour subscription* tabs in Site Settings, so a change in either place shows in both. A price the site can't use is refused with a sentence saying why, and nothing is changed. **See what visitors see** opens the public Pricing page.

Everybody can reach the Pricing page from the menu bar, a **See pricing** button on the home page, and the footer. Those links only disappear when **Sell plans and seats** and **Sell event credits** are both off, because then there's nothing to buy.

Billing

Tour businesses: the Ghost Walk Tour subscription

Ghost walk tours aren't priced by a tier any more. They have their own subscription, priced per tour route (see The Ghost Walk Tour subscription). The old per-tour tier — a tier with **banded by members** unchecked — is retired the first time the Ghost Walk Tour subscription is switched on: every group on it is moved onto the subscription, and the tier is switched off. Until then, it works as it always has.

Role areas on a price band

Each band has a **Role areas** checklist: the parts of the site (Cases, Equipment, Public pages and so on) that a group on that band can build custom role permissions for. Every band starts with everything checked, which changes nothing; unchecking areas is how you turn bands into different products. Changes save as you click and apply to every group on the band.

The checklist is fully enforced. When a group's band leaves out an area, the role editor grays out that area's section with a note naming the plan, and the server refuses changes to it while keeping the saved permissions exactly as they are. Those permissions also stop taking effect: members lose the tabs they gave access to,

while owners and group administrators notice no difference. Nothing is ever deleted. A paused permission comes back exactly as it was set up as soon as the area is included again. Whenever any band leaves something out, the public Pricing page lists each band's included areas.

Because unchecking saves with every click, the notices sent to groups are **netted**. A removal is queued (groups with no plan hear about it after a short grace period, and paid groups hear before their renewal), and checking the area again before the notice goes out cancels it. So an accidental click means groups hear nothing, rather than getting two contradictory messages. Newly included areas are announced right away.

Capabilities on a price band

Next to the role areas is a **Capabilities** checklist of simple yes-or-no permissions. **Case transfers**: a band without it can't send a case to another group or accept a case transferred in. Both ends are enforced, so a case can't be handed TO a group whose band lacks it either. Declining a transfer never requires the capability. **Audio/video location stripping**: whether the group's media privacy setting can remove location data from audio and video files. (Photos are always cleaned, and every file's metadata is always extracted and kept regardless.) **Private-residence cases**: whether the group can take on client and residence work at all. Accepting a client request, placing an investigation at a residence, receiving a private case and publishing one are each checked. Work a group already has keeps working, and a client moving their own case is only ever limited by the receiving group's band. Unchecking doesn't affect existing cases. Changes save as you click and notify the affected groups through the same netted notices as the role areas, and the public Pricing page says plainly what a band leaves out.

Administration → Billing has three screens.

Price Bands is the price list shown on the public Pricing page: member ranges, a price for each billing cadence, and the caps each band includes. Every save checks the whole list: the bands must cover every possible member count with no gaps or overlaps, and a save that would leave anyone without a price is refused, with the reason. Bands are retired, never deleted, because a band that has priced a billing period is part of the billing record. When an edit would affect groups already on the band, the save pauses and first shows you who will be affected. Improvements are announced to those groups immediately. Reductions are queued and delivered up to two weeks before each group's own renewal, and paid groups keep the terms they bought until then.

Reshaping the ladder

Editing one band at a time works for ordinary changes, but it can't make every valid change, because each save is checked against the list as it will look after that single edit. Splitting an open-ended top band shows the problem: giving the top band an upper limit leaves the members above it without a price, and adding the new band above it first overlaps the open-ended band below. Both orders are refused, so you can't get there one band at a time.

Reshape the ladder lets you edit every band on one form, and only the end result is checked. Add a band, remove one, move the boundaries, and save once. The rules are the same (start at one member, leave no gaps between bands, and give the last band no upper limit), but they're checked against the finished ladder rather than each step. If the save is refused, nothing changes.

The list on that form **is** the ladder. A band you remove there is retired, not deleted, for the same reason as everywhere else: a band that has priced a period is part of the billing record. Groups already on a retired band keep the terms they bought until they renew.

There's no free band, and there shouldn't be. A group is free by having no plan at all, not by having a plan that costs nothing. A plan that costs nothing is still a plan, and every paid feature treats it as one. The editor warns you if a band is ever priced at zero.

Coupons manages discount campaigns. A *shared* campaign is one code that everyone types in. A *generated* campaign is a batch of single-use codes you can print or mail; each one can be withdrawn on its own and assigned to a specific account. A campaign can be limited by date range, total redemptions (the budget), billing cadence and occasion (first subscriptions only, or renewals only). A misconfigured campaign (one that takes nothing off, or whose window closes before it opens) shows a red **Broken** badge in the list instead of silently failing for whoever types it.

Every code also works as a **referral link**. The codes panel's *Copy link* button gives you a `/pricing?code=…` URL to pass to whoever is promoting or selling access. Visitors arrive with the code already applied and see it priced for their group before they confirm anything. The code's redemption count is the referrer's scorecard.

Subscriptions shows every group's billing status, including groups that were never set up, which is the first thing to look for. Card payments made on the site are recorded here by themselves; when a group pays some other way, set their band, cadence and period here. The member count and price are locked in when you save, and the group keeps those terms for the whole period, whatever happens to the price list. The Members column shows the current count next to the locked-in one. At renewal, the group is re-banded based on the current count.

Taking plans off sale

Sell plans and seats, under *Selling plans* in Site Settings and on **Administration → Pricing**, controls whether anyone can buy. It's on unless someone has turned it off.

When it's off:

- the pricing page still shows every band and price, with one line saying plans aren't on sale;
- a group's billing page shows the same sentence instead of **Subscribe**, and a member with an unpaid seat is told seats can't be paid for on the site at the moment;
- the site refuses to start a payment for a plan or a seat, even from a page that was already open.

Nothing already bought changes: plans and paid seats continue and renew as before. Event credits have their own switch, **Sell event credits**.

What plans include, and what they don't

Plans cover **investigations**. No plan includes hosted events, the top band included: every event uses one event credit, bought on its own. The tier editor no longer offers *Host events*, *Buy event credits* or *Sell tickets*, and it

has no *Events at once* limit, because none of them can be part of a plan. Ghost walk tours aren't part of a plan either; they have their own subscription (see The Ghost Walk Tour subscription).

Events that were already published before this change stay live, and putting one back up never uses a credit. When the site was updated, each group whose plan used to include events was given one credit for every draft event it was preparing, with the reason written on the credit, so nothing it was building needs a purchase it wasn't told about. That happened once and doesn't repeat.

Event credit prices

Under *Events* in Site Settings, and on **Administration → Pricing**:

- **Event credit price ($)** is the full price of one credit. Leave it empty for $99.
- **Paid-subscriber price (% of the full price)** is what a group with an active paid plan pays. 20 makes a $99 credit $19.80. Leave it empty for 20. It applies to bundles too.
- **Event credit bundles** are several credits for one price, one per line as *how many = price*, for example `3 = 249`. Up to six, each for 2 to 20 credits.
- **Extra month for a show's run (% of a credit)** is what one extra month costs, as a percentage of what the buyer pays for a credit. Leave it empty for 50: $49.50, or $9.90 for a group with a paid plan. A show's run fits a month from its first performance on one credit; each extra month adds a month. Extra months only lengthen a run and never publish an event.
- **Most extra months for one show** is the cap. Leave it empty for 11, a run of a year.

The **Event credits** page also lists every extra month sold or given. **Give them** hands a group months for a reason (nothing reaches the ledger), and **Refund** stops one counting at once and writes the adjustment on the ledger.

The home page, the Pricing page, the billing pages and the help all show these prices as they are set, so changing one changes every place it appears. A value that doesn't make sense, such as a percentage over 100 or a bundle line the site can't read, is refused when you save it, with a sentence saying why. Anyone can buy credits: a group on its Billing page, or a person on **My event credits**. A person always pays the full price.

The Ghost Walk Tour subscription

A monthly subscription of its own, separate from the investigation plans, priced **per tour route**: one tour on a group's Tours page, with unlimited walks (dates) and guests on it. Under *Ghost Walk Tour subscription* in Site Settings, and on **Administration → Pricing**:

- **Sell the Ghost Walk Tour subscription** turns it on. It's off until you turn it on.
- **Ghost Walk Tour price ($ a month per tour route)** is the price of one route for one month. Leave it empty for $29.

While it's on sale, any group can subscribe from its Billing page or the Pricing page, paying for every route it runs. Adding a route when every paid route is in use asks the group to add a route to its subscription; dates on a paid route are unlimited. A route added part-way through a month is charged only for the days left, and a

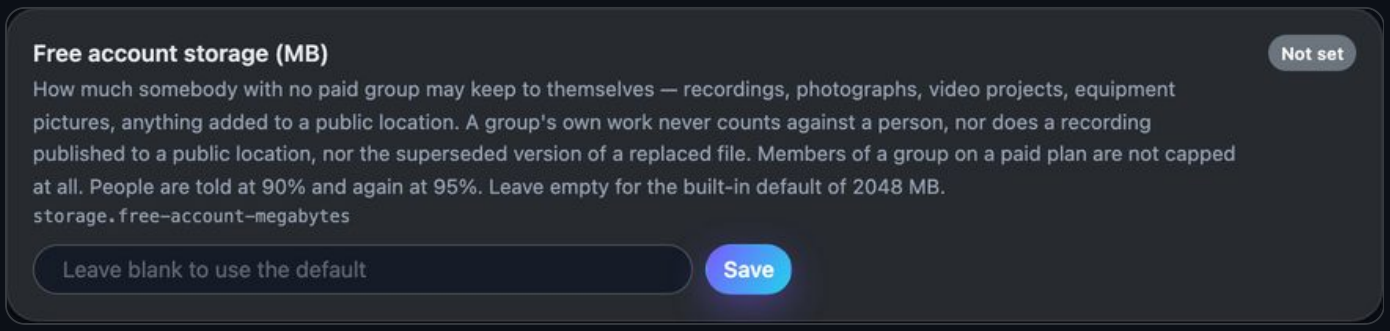
retired one is credited for its unused days — both on the group's next monthly bill, the way Stripe prorates by default. Tours and dates already on the calendar keep running. While it's off, the subscription isn't mentioned anywhere on the site or in the help, and tours aren't held back by it. Months already paid for run out and aren't renewed while it's off.

The first time it's switched on, every group on the old per-tour plan is moved onto it, once: the same number of routes as the tours it had paid for, for the rest of the period it had already paid for, at no charge and with the same saved card. Its per-tour plan is set not to renew, so its next bill is the subscription's and never both. The per-tour tiers are switched off.

The storage ceiling

Administration → Site Settings → Limits → Free account storage (MB) sets how much a free account can store for itself. Leaving the box empty is safe: there's a built-in default of 2048 MB.

Raising it takes effect immediately, with no site update needed. When more disk space becomes available, this is the one number to change.



Free account storage, in the Limits group. Empty means the built-in default.

What counts against it is everything stored under the person: recordings, photographs, video projects, equipment pictures, place evidence and feed media. What doesn't count: a group's own work, the old version of a replaced file, and anything published to a public location's archive, which earns its space. Members of a group on a paid plan have no cap at all.

People are warned before they reach it. A message goes out at 90% used and a stronger one at 95%, each sent once. Someone who frees up space and drops back under 90% is warned again the next time they fill up, so nobody is warned once and then hits the limit later without notice. This means lowering the ceiling can put accounts straight into the warning range on the next check. That's intended, but worth expecting.

Places

Administration → Places lists every location on the site: the homes groups work in and the public locations anyone signed in can contribute to. Search by name, street, town or state, and filter to one kind or the other.

Each row shows the three counts that decide what you can do with it: cases, visits and pieces of evidence. A row with nothing linked to it can be removed. A row with anything linked to it should be merged or made private instead.

Add a place opens the same form everyone else uses, so a location you add is checked against existing places instead of becoming a second record of the same building.

Correcting a place

The pencil on a row opens the place for editing: its name, street, town, state and ZIP, and its position on the map.

This is the only way to correct a place. When someone adds a public location at an address that's already recorded as a home, the page tells them "there is already a place at that address, and it is recorded as somebody's home — if that is wrong, ask a site administrator to correct it". This is where you make that correction.

An address that already belongs to another record is refused. Two records for one building would split its evidence between them, which the archive is designed to prevent. So an edit that would move a place onto an address already in use stops and names the record that's already there. Use **Duplicate Places** to combine the two instead.

Coordinates. If you type them in, they're kept exactly as entered, since someone correcting a record by hand usually knows better than an automatic lookup. If you leave them empty and change the address, the old position is discarded and the new address is looked up. A pin left over from the previous address would be worse than no pin, because nothing on the map would show it's wrong.

Look up the address again reruns that lookup without changing anything else. Use it on a row that says "not on the map". If the lookup still can't place the address, the page tells you why instead of showing an empty map, because otherwise a misspelled street and an address the mapping service simply doesn't have would look the same.

Taking a place off the public map

This fixes the mistake that matters most: someone's home entered as a public location. A public location has a page strangers can read and add photos to, so a home listed that way becomes a public evidence page for the address where a family lives.

Make it a private residence removes the page and stops anyone from adding to it. Nothing recorded there is deleted: the group working the case keeps every file, session and note. It's the safe choice, and almost always the right one.

Going the other way, **Make it a public location** is refused for any place with a street number. If a genuine landmark has a street address, clear the address first. This is deliberate: one wrong click on a list of fifty places is exactly how someone's home could end up public.

Deleting a place

You can only delete a place when nothing at all is linked to it: no case, visit, evidence, event, room, venue profile, contact or claim. If anything is, the refusal says what ("3 cases and 6 pieces of evidence still point at it") so you know what to move first.

For a place that duplicates another, use **Duplicate Places** instead: merging moves everything onto the record you keep and then removes the empty one. For a place with real history that shouldn't be public, make it private rather than trying to empty it.

Merging two groups

Administration → Groups → Merge Groups combines two organizations into one. Choose the **base** (the group that remains, keeping its URL and settings) and the group to merge into it, then read the preview before anything happens. It lists exactly what will move and every conflict, and viewing it changes nothing.

The merge happens in a single step that either completes fully or leaves both groups untouched. Here's what it does:

- **Everything the merged group owns moves to the base**: members, cases, investigations, files, equipment, pages, calendar and messages. The preview's list is built directly from the database structure, so nothing is left out.
- **A person in both groups** keeps one membership, at the **higher** of their two roles.
- **Case numbers collide by design**, since both groups started at #1, so merged cases with clashing numbers are renumbered to follow the base's sequence. Page addresses that clash get a suffix.
- **The merged group's URL becomes a permanent alias** of the base, so old links keep working and no new group can ever take that name.
- **The merged group's subscription is dropped**, and the base's plan covers the combined group. If money is owed back, record it as a ledger adjustment.
- **Everyone is told**: former members get a message that their group is now part of the base, and clients with open cases are told the group handling their case has a new name.

You choose the name after the merge: either group's name or a new one. To confirm, you type the merged group's name, because there's no undo.

Deleting a case

Administration → Groups → Delete a Case, or the trash button on any row of **Administration → Cases & Investigations → All Cases**, which opens the same screen with that case already chosen.

This is the only place on the site where a case can be deleted. Groups can't delete cases; they close a case and keep it. This page is for mistakes that closing can't fix: a duplicate, a test case, or a case opened under the

wrong group.

Read the preview first. It has two parts, describing two different things that will happen.

Destroyed. Everything that exists only because the case does: its timeline, files, notes, messages, research boards, reports, investigations, contacts, votes, transfer records and any client access records. Files the case made its own copy of are destroyed with it.

Kept, with the case reference removed. Anything that belongs to someone else and only mentions the case. In particular, **field sessions survive**: a recording belongs to the person who made it, so each one goes back to them as a personal session, with its files, readings and share links untouched. Feed posts, calendar events, video projects, evidence votes and public pages all stay, and simply stop pointing at the deleted case. The client's original request is kept too.

You're warned about two things, but neither stops you: the case has a **client**, whose record of the work they asked for is deleted with it; or the case is **public**, so its page and any links to it stop working. Neither one blocks the delete. The point is that you know.

Then type the case title exactly. The button does nothing until it matches, both on screen and on the server.

Deleting a person

Administration → Groups → Delete a Person, or the trash button on any row of **Administration → Users**, which opens the same screen with that account already chosen.

Read the preview before you agree to anything. It has two parts, describing two different things that will happen.

Destroyed. Everything that's only theirs and that nobody else has a claim on: field sessions they recorded on their own rather than for an investigation, the files in those sessions, their memberships, sign-in history, messages they received, follows, blocks, contact details and any external sign-in methods. An Apple sign-in is also revoked with Apple, so IsHaunted disappears from the list of apps using their Apple ID. If Apple can't be reached at that moment, the deletion still goes through and the revocation is retried later.

Kept, with their name removed. Anything they wrote for a group: case notes, timeline entries, group messages, evidence, and sessions recorded for an investigation. Those belong to the group, and often to a paying client. One person leaving shouldn't erase a group's record of its own work, so these records stay and are credited to a former member.

Whether the account itself disappears

Before you press anything, the screen tells you which of these will happen.

- **Removed completely** when nothing else in the database refers to the account. A sign-up that never did anything disappears entirely.

- **Kept, emptied** when anything still refers to it: records written for a group, a session recorded for an investigation, or a file something else still uses. Everything about the person is removed (name, email, password, sign-in methods) and the account can never sign in again, but the account record stays so those other records still link up correctly.

The difference matters. If you're clearing out a test sign-up, you want the first, and the screen will say so. If you're removing a real member of a real group, you'll get the second, and you'll know that before you go ahead.

Two warnings, and one refusal

The screen warns you, without stopping you, when:

- **They own a group.** Each group has exactly one owner, so the group will be left with nobody able to manage it. Appoint a new owner first, or be ready to do it right afterward.
- **They're paying for a seat.** Nothing here cancels a subscription, so the card on file keeps being charged for an account that no longer exists. Cancel it first.

It refuses outright in only one case: **the last SuperAdmin account**. A site nobody can administer can't be recovered.

To confirm, type the person's display name exactly, just as you would when deleting a group, and for the same reason: there's no undo.

You can't delete your own account here; do that from your own profile.

The money trail

Three more screens under **Administration → Billing** handle the actual money.

Ledger is the record: every charge, payment, adjustment and referral payout, newest first. You can only add to it. There's no edit and no delete, here or in the API behind it. To fix a wrong entry, record an **adjustment** that names the mistake, just as you would in a paper ledger. That way the answer to "who changed this number?" is always the same: nobody. Recording a **charge** calculates tax from the group's state and locks both the rate and the dollar amount on the row. Recording a **payment** assigns the next receipt number, and the group can download that receipt (and download it again at any time) from their own billing history on the Pricing page. A payment carries no tax of its own: the tax was on the charge it pays, and counting it twice would make the figures wrong.

Tax Rates holds the current rate for each state, matched against the group's address. A state with no rate is taxed at **zero**. That's the honest default, since many states don't tax this service, and a visible zero on a bill gets questioned, while a quietly guessed rate might not. Editing a rate never changes history: every document keeps the rate it used.

Overflow seats

A band covers a range of member counts. When a group grows past its band, the group's own plan doesn't change. Instead, each person who joins beyond the band is billed **individually**, at the per-extra-member price you set on that band's price row. The group keeps one contract with one renewal date, and each extra person holds a seat.

To set it up, put a **per-extra-member price** on a band's price row in **Price Bands**. That also changes what the price list accepts. Normally the top band must have no upper limit, so that a group can never outgrow the list. A band that prices extra members can have an upper limit, because growth beyond it is priced per seat instead of by a bigger band.

Member Seats is the worklist. A new member who takes a group past its band gets a seat marked **Awaiting payment**, and their acceptance message tells them the price. A seat never stops anyone from joining: they're a member from the moment they're accepted, and the seat is only the billing record. When they pay, record the payment on the Ledger and set the seat to **Active** with its period. Recording the payment and activating the seat are deliberately two separate steps.

Event credits

Event Credits lists every credit ever bought, by a group or by a person for themselves. One credit publishes one hosted event, whatever it costs to run and however many days in a row it runs, and is good for a year from the day it was bought. It's spent as soon as the event goes live. The price it was bought at is locked in on the row, so changing the price never affects a credit someone already holds.

The screen shows who holds each credit, when it expires, whether it has been spent and on what, and the receipt from the purchase. An envelope next to the expiry date means the holder has already had the thirty-day warning. That warning goes out by email, or to the notification bell for anyone who can't be emailed.

Granting gives a group credits nobody paid for: a purchase that never went through, an apology, or a credit someone was promised. Choose the group and how many, and give a reason. The reason is required, because it and your name on the row are the only record that the grant happened. In every other way, a granted credit works exactly like a bought one: a year to use it, spent when an event is published, oldest first, with a warning at thirty days. It shows as **Granted** instead of $0.00 in the Paid column, both on this screen and on the group's own.

A grant adds nothing to the ledger. A $0 charge and payment would put a sale that never happened into the money trail, and the receipt would say someone paid nothing. If money really did change hands outside Stripe (a check or a bank transfer, say), record that on the Ledger as well, as its own payment.

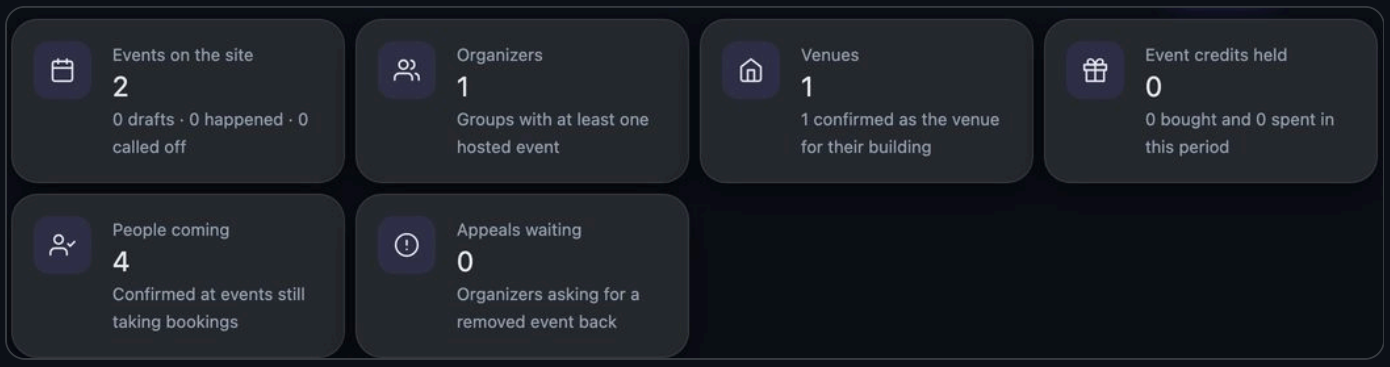
Refunding is the other reason this screen exists, since nobody can refund themselves. A refund needs a reason. It marks the credit so it can never be spent, whatever its date says, and adds a credit adjustment to the group's ledger. Uncheck that box if you've already returned the money through Stripe, because Stripe's own record reaches the ledger separately.

A **spent** credit can't be refunded, and the refusal names the event it was used on. Each event uses one credit for its whole life. Giving the credit back would make that event's payment record wrong, and republishing the event would then never charge for it. If money really does have to be returned for a live event, record a **credit adjustment** on the Ledger instead. An **expired** credit can still be refunded. That's the goodwill case, for someone who paid and never got to use it. Refunding a **granted** credit just revokes it and adds nothing to the ledger, since there's no money to return.

Hosted events

The events dashboard

Administration → Dashboard has three tabs. **The site** is the dashboard described above; **Events** is a similar page for hosted events across every group; and **Event health** shows whether hosted events are working (see below). The range picker controls all three.



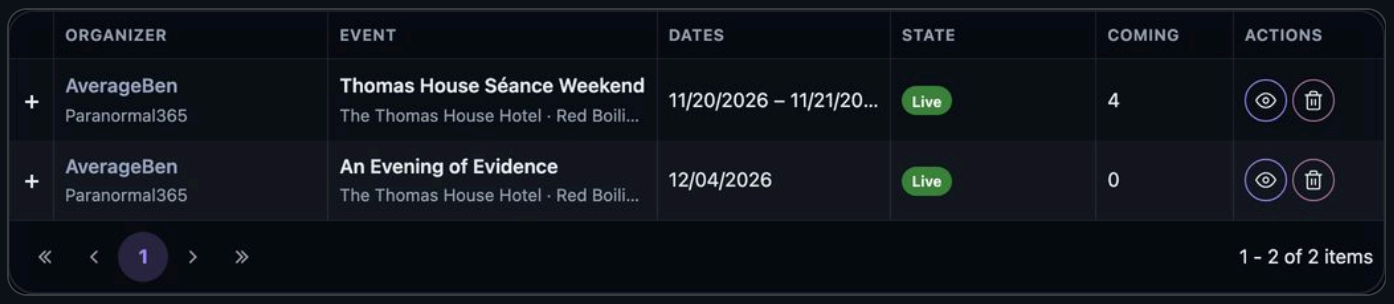
The cards show where things stand right now: - events on the site, with drafts, past events and canceled events listed underneath; - organizers (groups with at least one hosted event); - venues, and how many are confirmed for their building; - event credits held; - people confirmed at events that are still taking bookings; - appeals waiting for an answer.

The charts cover the chosen period: events created and published, bookings made and their status, credits bought and spent, the biggest events, and the busiest organizers and venues. **Where events happen** counts published events by the state their venue is in.

The dashboard only shows counts; it never names a guest. To see individual events, use the events list.

Every event, and removing one

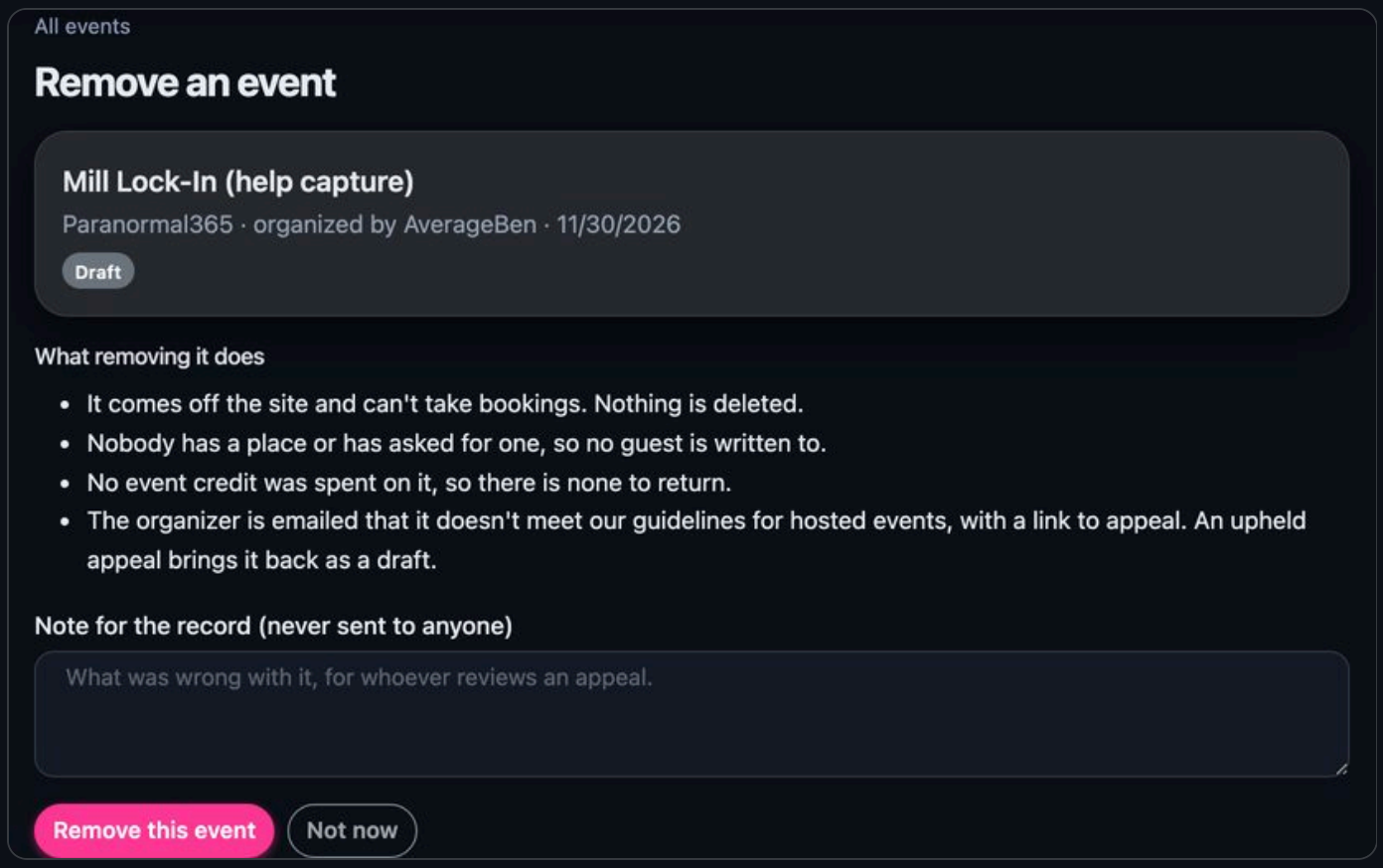
Administration → Events lists every hosted event, whatever its state: the person who created it and their group, the event and its venue, the dates, its state, and how many people are coming. Search matches the event, the group, the organizer or the place, and the state filter narrows the list.



The eye icon opens the event's own page as its organizer sees it. The arrow at the start of each row opens every other screen for that event: plan, bookings, menus, the kitchen's sheet, program, staff, the door, bands, files, gallery, what happened afterward, keeping the files, copying it, the photo wall and, while it's published, in progress or just ended, its public page. A SuperAdmin can open all of them for any group's event, including groups you don't belong to.

The trash icon opens **Remove an event**, which tells you what removing it will do before you confirm:

- **It comes off the site** and can't take bookings. Nothing is deleted: the event, its bookings and its history all stay.
- **Everyone who has a place or is on the waiting list is told** it isn't going ahead, with no reason given, and their passes stop working.
- **The event credit spent on it is returned** to whoever paid for it, regardless of timing. Publishing the event again later spends another credit.
- **The organizer is emailed** that the event doesn't meet the guidelines for hosted events, with a link to appeal. The letter is deliberately generic. Your **note for the record** is kept with the removal for whoever reviews an appeal, and is never sent to anyone.



The organizer can't un-cancel, restore or publish a removed event.

Appeals

The removal letter takes the organizer to their event's page, where a card explains the removal and lets them appeal once. When they send the appeal, SuperAdmins get a message, and the appeal waits at the top of **Administration → Events**. It shows the organizer's message, what the event looked like when it was removed, whether its credit was returned, and your note from the removal.

- **Uphold** brings the event back as a **draft**, never straight onto the site. Its guests were told it wasn't going ahead, so putting it back up has to be the organizer's deliberate decision.
- **Decline** requires an answer. The organizer reads it, and the event stays removed.

Either way, the organizer is told by email and in their messages. Each removal allows one appeal. If an event is removed again after an upheld appeal, it can be appealed again.

Event health

Event health is for whoever builds or looks after hosted events. It shows whether the feature is working, while **Events** shows how it's being used. It counts and names addresses and jobs, but it never names a guest.

The cards show where things stand right now: - **holds live**, and how many will expire in the next 24 hours unless someone answers them; - **waiting for an answer**: requests and holds nobody has answered at events

still taking bookings, and how long the oldest one has been waiting; - **letters in the outbox** not yet sent, and how many were given up on during the period. This covers all of the site's mail, because the outbox doesn't record which letters are about events; - **errors on event addresses** the server logged during the period.

The charts cover the chosen period: - **Bookings made, answered and lapsed**, by day. If lapses climb while answers stay flat, nobody is watching the board. - **How long parties waited** for an answer, from within an hour to over three days. - **Letters** queued, sent and failed, by day. - **Turned away by a limit** — requests refused by the booking and attendance limits, for all time, with the last day each limit turned someone away. - **Errors on event addresses**, by day and by address, from the server's error log. Ids in the addresses are shown as `{id}`. Days follow the server's own clock. Where the log can't be read (it's only kept on SQL Server), the panels say so instead of drawing an empty chart.

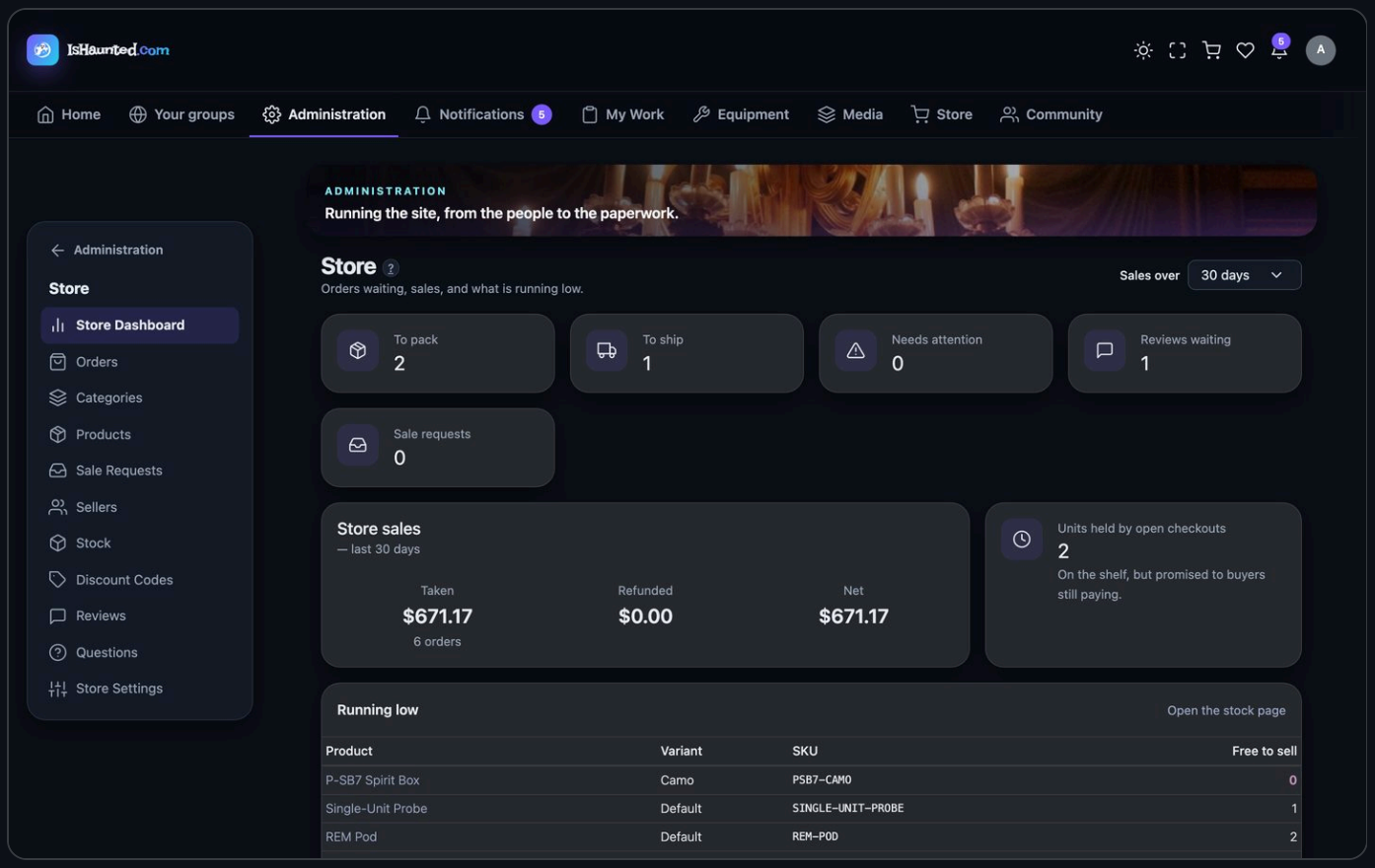
Scheduled jobs lists every background job (expiring holds, moving events through their states, alerts and digests, reminders, thank-you letters, retention, sending mail and the rest) with when it last ran, how long it took, whether it failed and the first line of its most recent error. It counts from when the server last started, so a restart clears it. Every job runs every five minutes, so a job that stops appearing or keeps failing is the first place to look.

Referrals and what they earn

Referrals shows where every referrer stands. A referrer is anyone a coupon campaign is credited to (set on the campaign, using their account email), and every redemption of their codes counts as their referral, with the amounts locked in at the time of redemption. The screen shows what their codes brought in, the discount given, what they're **owed**, what has been paid, and the outstanding **balance**. Owed is a **percent of what redeemers actually paid**, set on each campaign, because deals differ from one referrer to another. A campaign with no percent isn't counted, and when that happens the owed figure shows a **partial** badge, so a low number is never mistaken for a final one. Recording a payout fills in the outstanding balance for you, and it goes on the ledger like everything else.

The store

The store sells scientific gear for investigations (EMF meters, spirit boxes, recorders) to anyone, with or without an account. Everything about it is managed under **Store** in the administration menu: the dashboard, categories, products, stock, discount codes, reviews and the store's own settings. All of those screens work while the store is switched off, so you can enter, price and photograph the catalog before any visitor can see it.

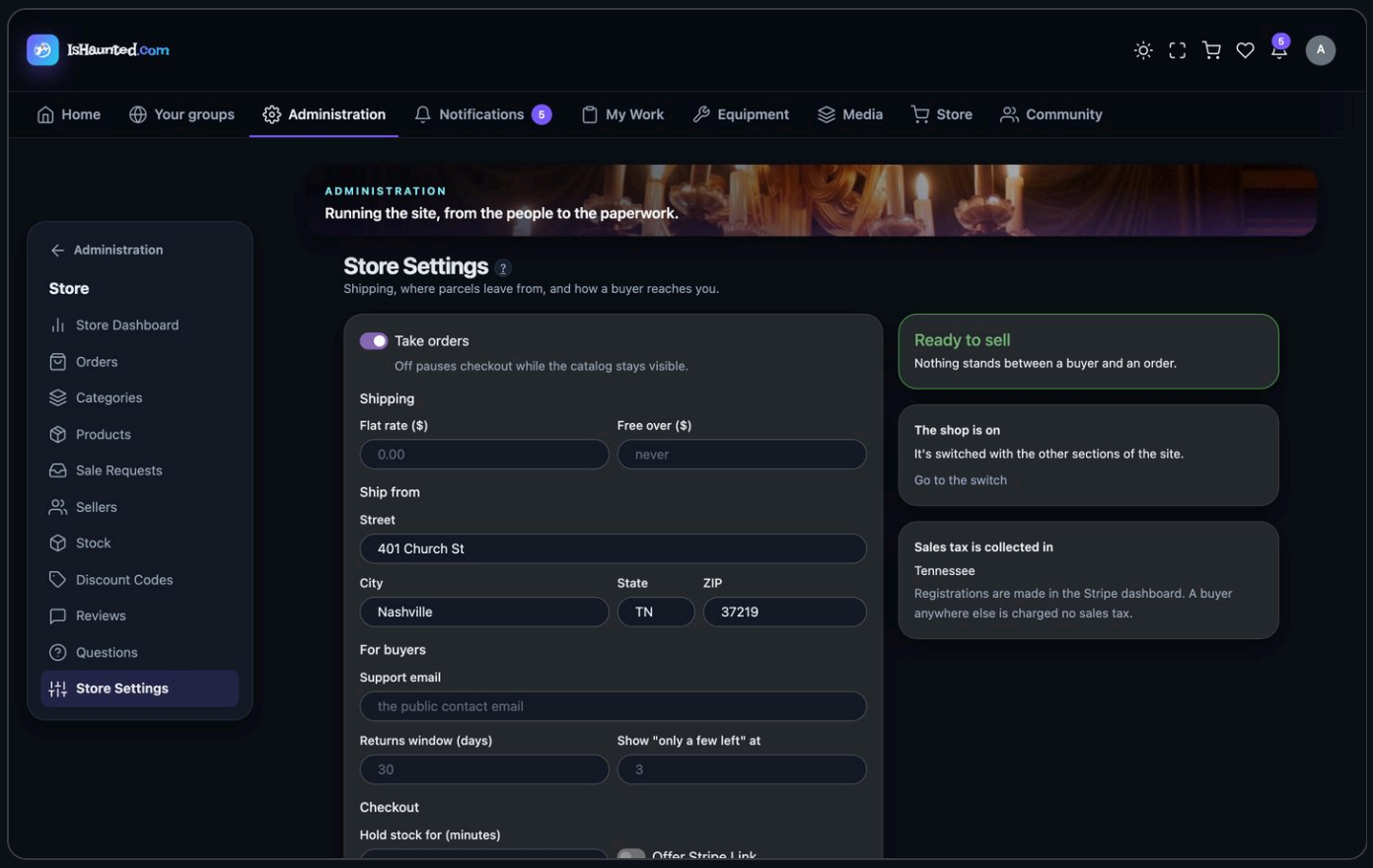


Turning the store on

There are two switches, for two different jobs:

- **Feature — Store**, under Site Settings → Features, shows or hides the whole store. When it's off, the store's pages, cart and checkout show "page not found". Orders already placed aren't affected: a buyer's order page, the thank-you page and the links in their emails keep working, and so do these admin screens.
- **Take orders**, on the store settings page, pauses buying without hiding anything. Visitors can still browse the catalog, and every cart says the store isn't taking orders at the moment. This is the switch to use if something goes wrong with payments.

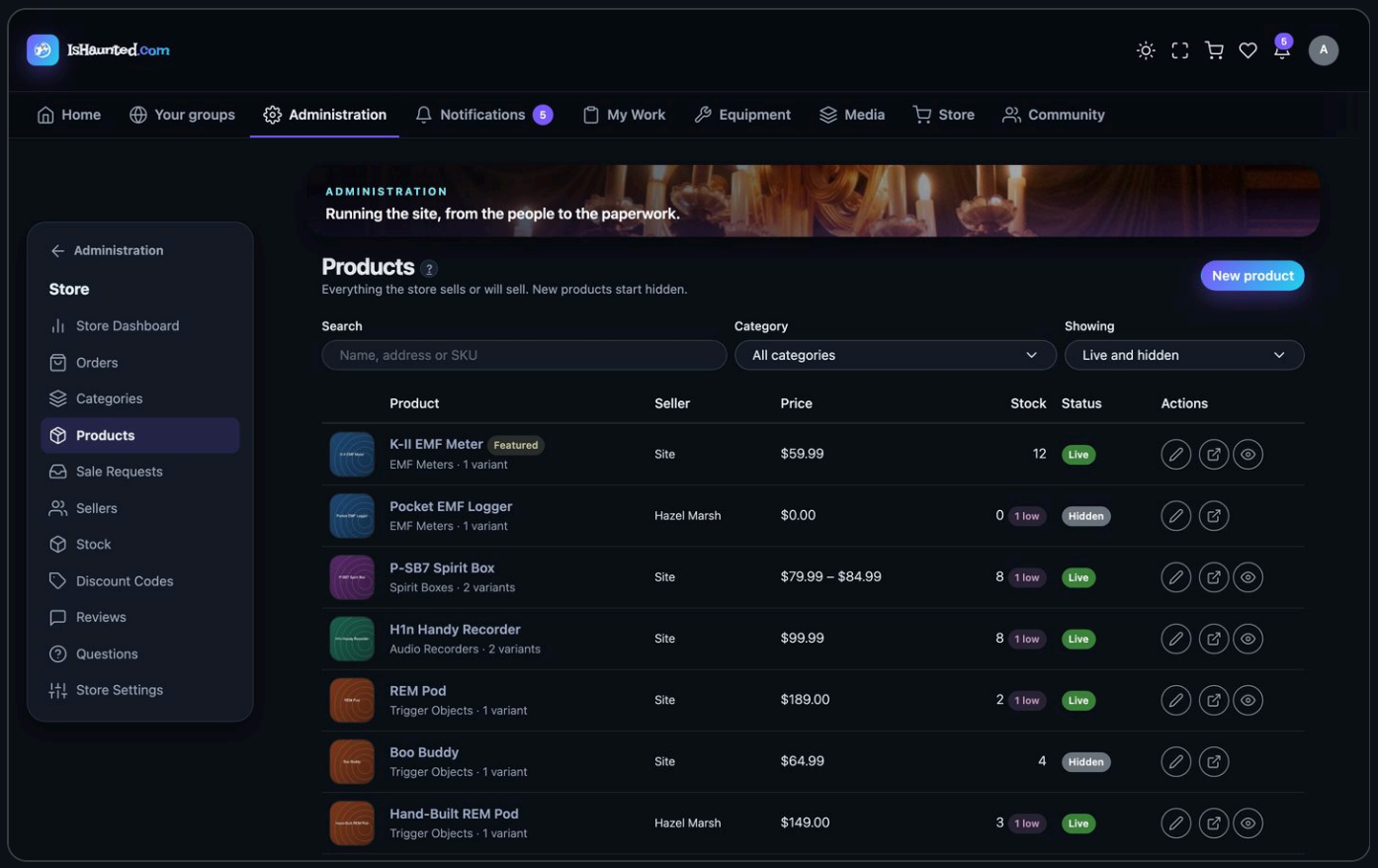
Before turning the store on, open **Store Settings** and read the **Ready to sell** checklist. It lists every reason the store couldn't take an order right now (no ship-from address, nothing live with stock, missing Stripe keys, Stripe Tax not active in the Stripe dashboard, the store switched off) and shows **Ready to sell** only when the list is empty.



Categories and products

A **category** is a shelf: EMF meters, spirit boxes, field accessories. Each one has an address (/store/c/emf-meters), an optional picture, a position in the order and its own on/off switch. Hiding a category takes its products off the store without changing them. Before you confirm, the page tells you how many live products it will hide, and showing the category again restores exactly what was live. A category with products in it can't be removed; move them first. The last remaining category can't be removed either.

Subcategories. A category can be placed under another one: choose the parent in **Sits under** when editing it. Subcategories only go one level deep. A subcategory sits under a top-level category, and a category that has subcategories stays at the top level. On the Categories page, subcategories are indented under their category, and the arrows move a row up or down within its own level. In a product's **Category** list they appear as "Category › Subcategory". Hiding a category hides its subcategories' products too, and a category with subcategories can't be removed until they're moved or removed.



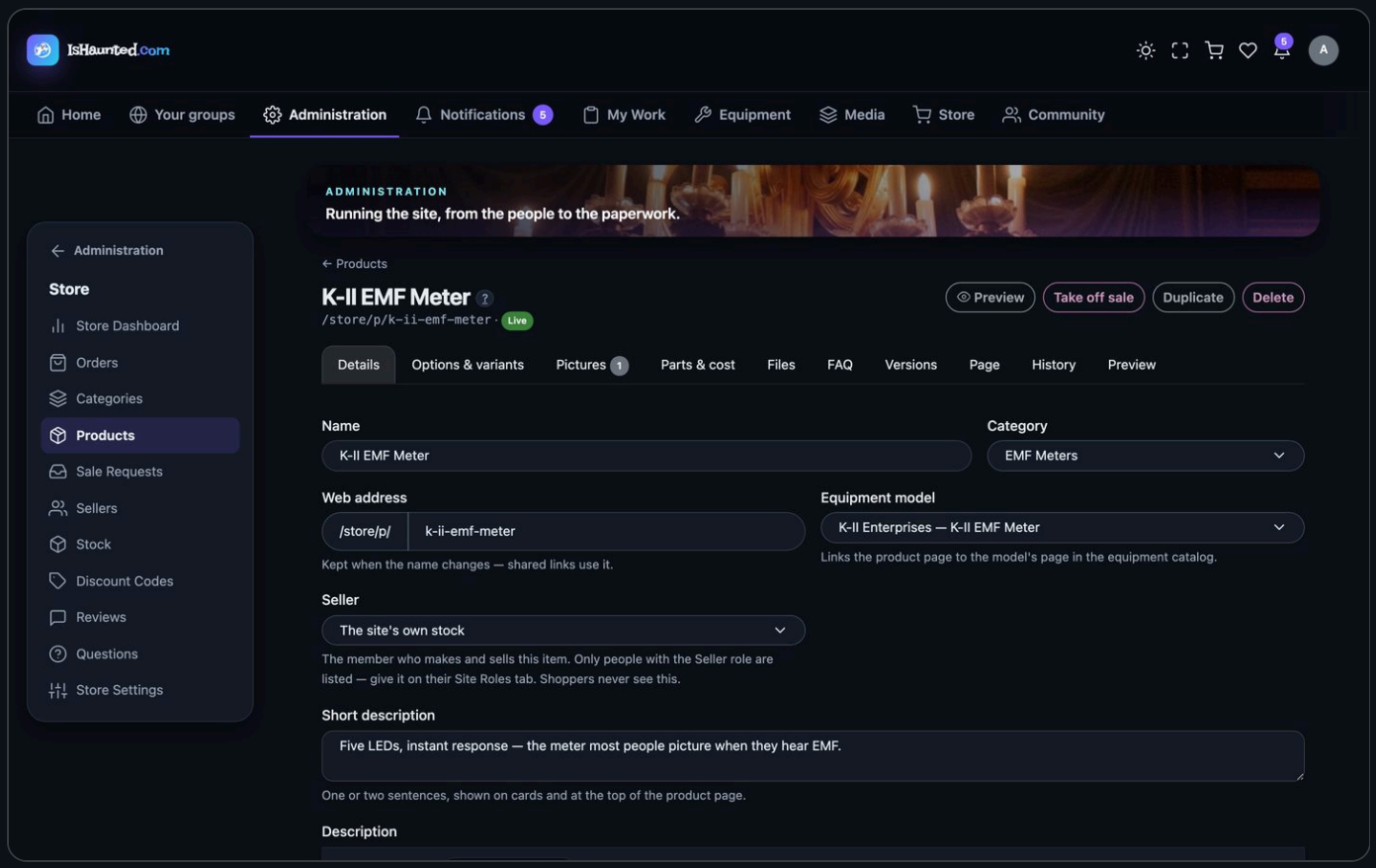
What shoppers see. A category or subcategory appears on the store only when something under it is on sale. A category includes its subcategories' products, so it appears as soon as any of them has something for sale. An empty one stays hidden (its address says "Page not found"), but you can always file products in it. The store's front page shows top-level categories, and the side list on product pages shows subcategories under them. Only SuperAdmins can change categories.

A **product** starts with just a name. It's created hidden, with one variant at $0.00 waiting for a price. **Activate** puts it on sale, but it refuses (and tells you what to do) until the product has a price, at least one picture, a live variant and a visible category. A product's address (/store/p/k-ii-emf-meter) is created from its name once and then kept, so renaming a product doesn't break links people have shared. Only type a new address if you really mean to change it.

Preview (the button at the top of the product, the tab next to Pictures, or the eye icon on the products list) shows the product page as shoppers will see it: the pictures, the price, the options, the description and the specifications. It uses what's on the form right now, so changes show up before you save them (the note above it tells you when something is unsaved), and it works while the store is switched off. With the store on, **Open the saved page** shows the real page as it currently is.

Seller names the member who makes and sells the product. Leave it on "The site's own stock" for anything the site sells itself. Only people with the Seller role are listed, so give them the role on their **Site Roles** tab first. Shoppers never see who the seller is; the products list shows it in its **Seller** column. If a seller leaves the site, their products stay and become the site's own.

A product that has been sold can be switched off but never deleted, because its orders, invoices and refunds refer to it. For a product that differs only slightly, **Duplicate** makes a hidden copy: options, variants with new SKUs and no stock, specifications and copies of every picture.



Options, variants and stock

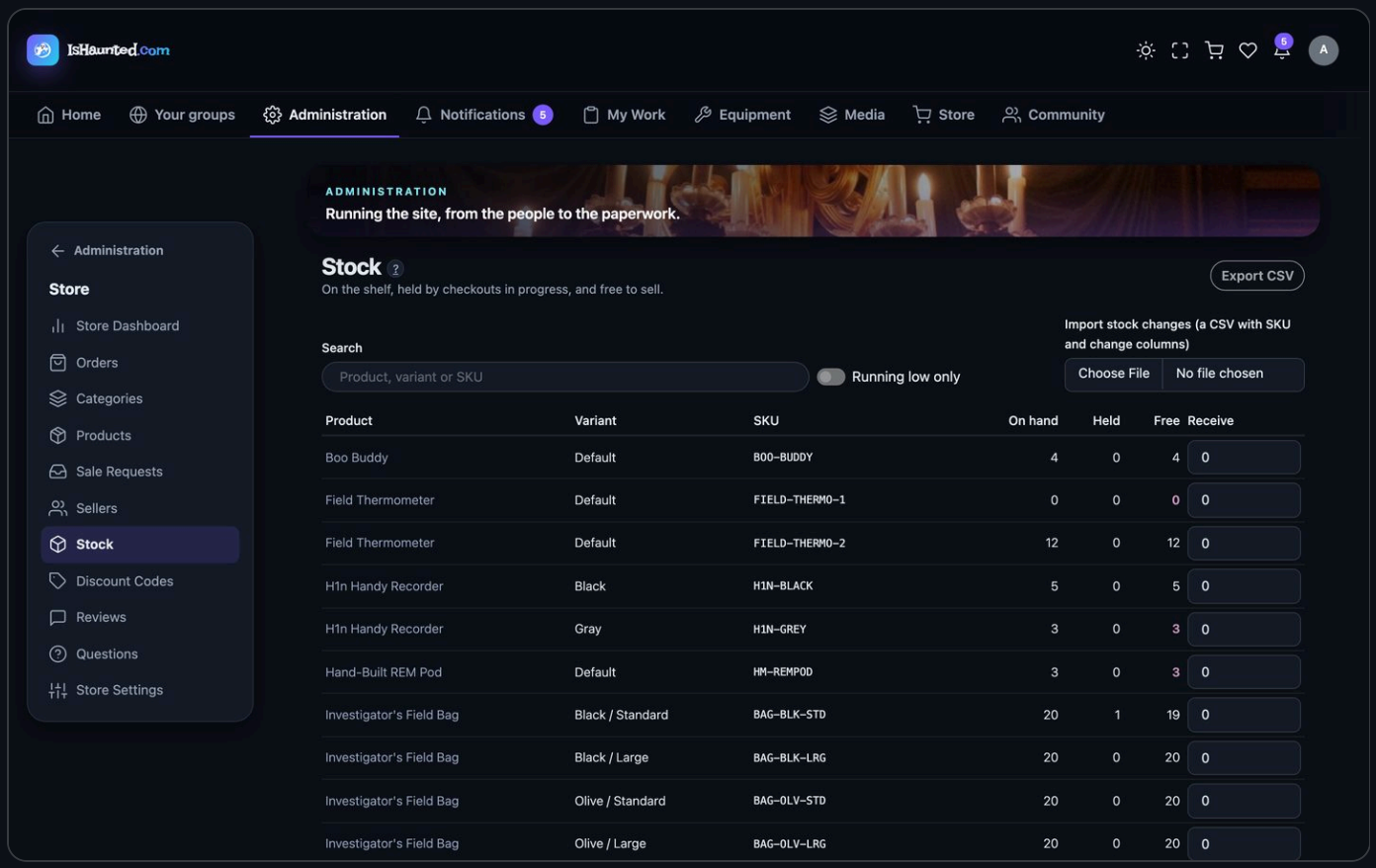
Options are what a buyer chooses, such as Color or Size. A product can have up to three, each with its own values. (A Color can show round swatches from a hex color; everything else shows as buttons.) **Generate variants** makes one variant for every combination the product doesn't have yet, so two colors and three sizes make six. Running it again adds nothing. You can't remove a value from an option while a variant still uses it.

Each **variant** has its own SKU, price, optional old price (shown crossed out; it must be higher than the price) and stock. A variant that has been ordered can be switched off but not deleted, and a live product always keeps at least one live variant.

Stock only ever changes with a reason (**Received**, **Correction** or **Damaged**), and every change adds a line to the variant's stock log showing who made it, when, by how much and what was left. The store writes **Sold**, **Refunded** and **Canceled** lines itself. A change is refused if it would leave fewer on the shelf than open checkouts are holding.

The **Stock** page shows every live variant at once: on hand, held by checkouts in progress, and free to sell, with a low-stock filter. Enter a delivery in the **Receive** column for each variant it covers and save once. Either all of

it is applied or none of it is, and a refusal names the SKU that caused it. You can also upload a supplier's sheet as a CSV of `Sku,Delta` rows, with the same all-or-nothing rule. **Export CSV** downloads the whole stock list for an inventory count.



Product pictures

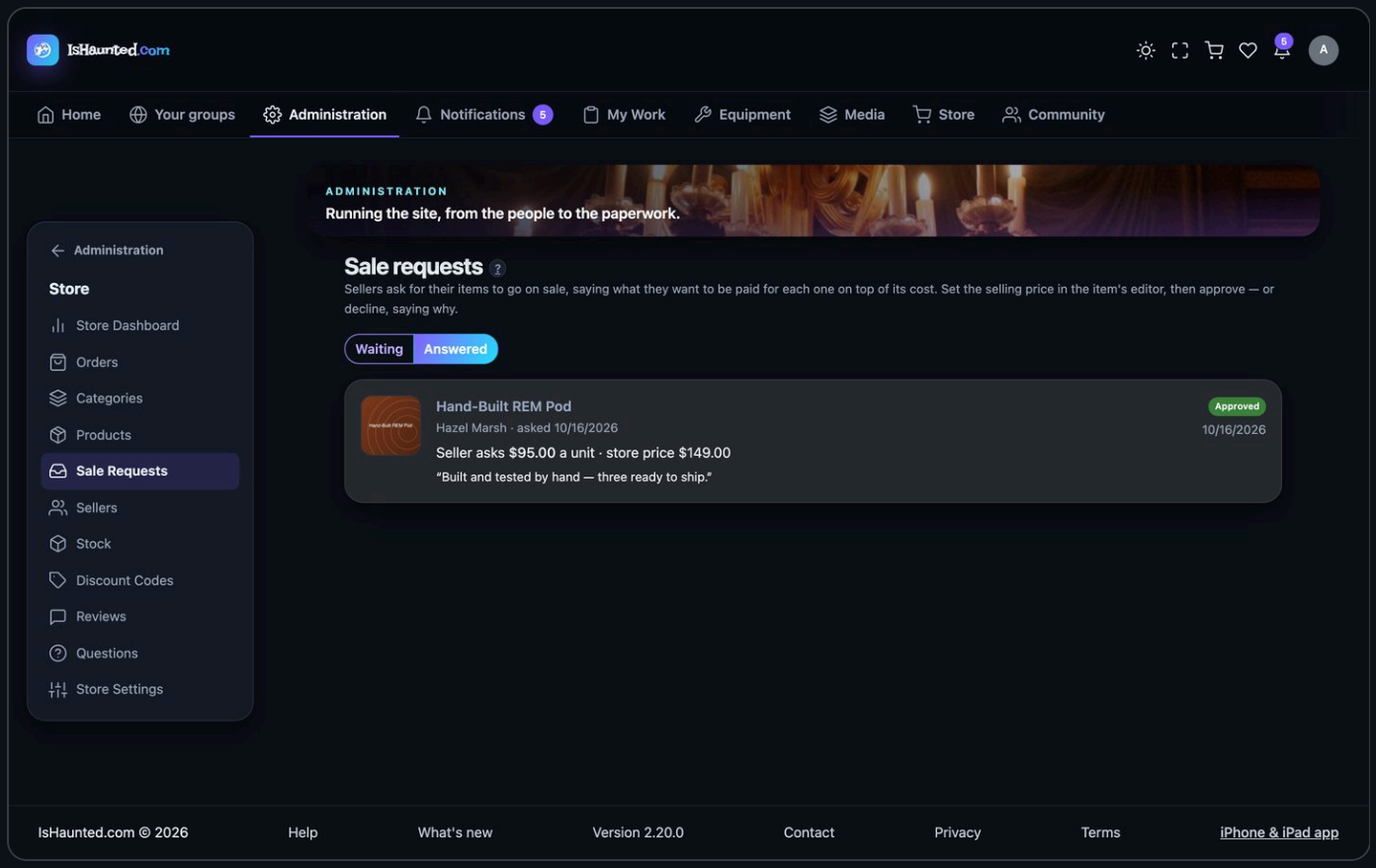
Each product can have up to twelve pictures, shown in the order you drag them into. A picture can be tied to a variant, so choosing that color shows that photo. Every picture is stored as a clean copy, with the camera details and location removed, sized for a sharp product page, plus a small copy for cards and the cart. A live product keeps at least one picture.

Sellers and sale requests

A member with the **Seller** role (given on their Site Roles tab) has their own **Selling** section. It only appears in their menu while the store is switched on, like every other way into the store, but its pages still work at their addresses while the store is off. So a seller you send to `/store/selling` can prepare their items before the store opens. There they add items as hidden drafts and edit the wording, pictures, options, variants and stock. They can never change the price, web address, placement, tax code or seller, and never another seller's item. A variant they add starts switched off and unpriced.

A seller's item only goes on sale when they ask. **Store → Sale Requests** lists the waiting requests, oldest first, each showing what the seller wants per unit (on top of cost) and what the item still needs before it can go on sale. Set the selling price on the item's **Options & variants** tab, then press **Approve and put on sale**. This locks in the seller's asking price on the item as what they're paid. Or press **Decline…** and give a reason, which the seller will read. The dashboard's **Sale requests** tile and a **Waiting** badge on the products list show when requests are waiting.

Put on sale isn't offered on a seller's item. Approving their request is how it goes on sale, because that records what they're paid. A seller can take their own item off sale at any time, and SuperAdmins get a message when they do.

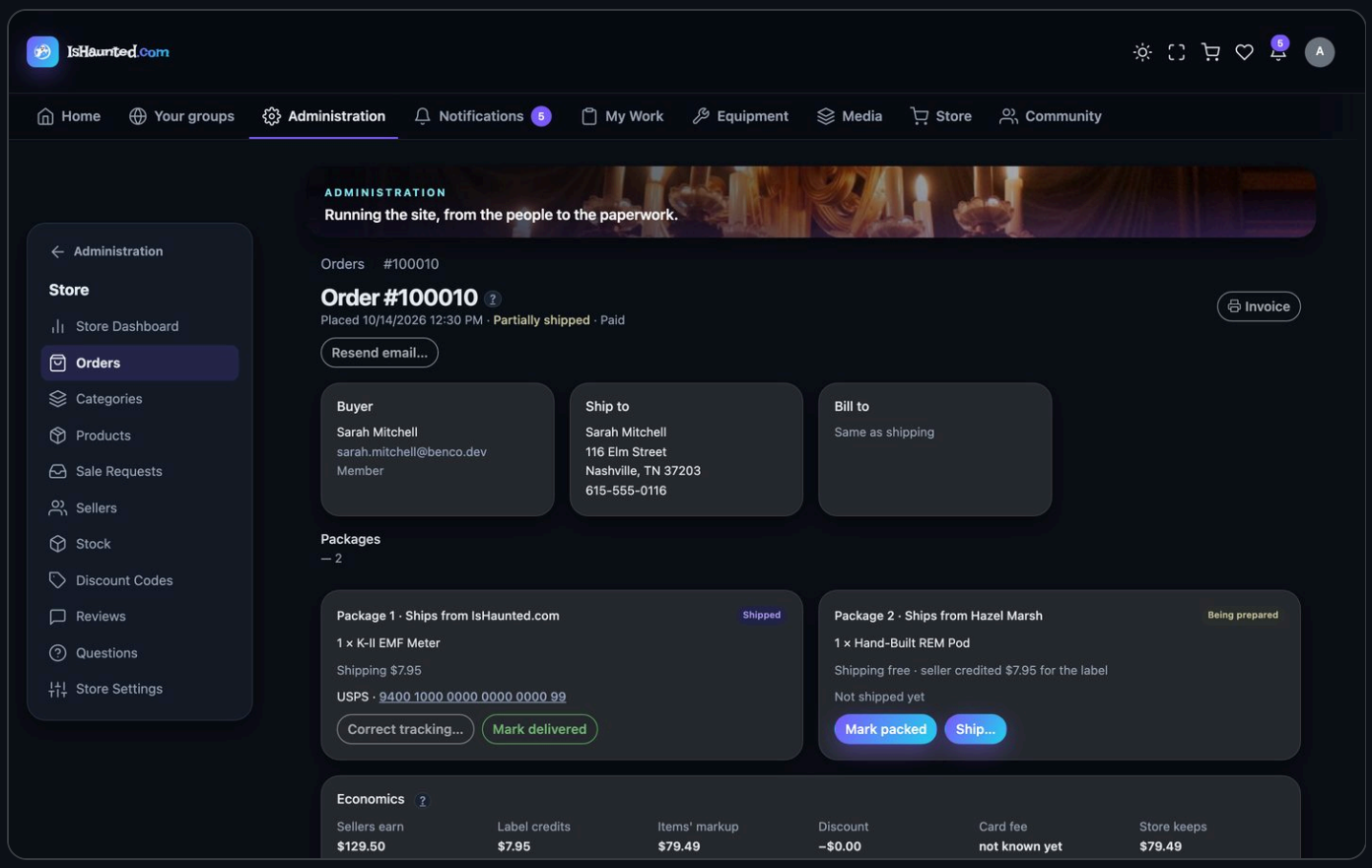


Packages and partial shipping

An order ships as one **package per seller**: the store's own stock is one package, and each seller sends their own. Every package has its own status (being prepared, packed, shipped, delivered), carrier and tracking, or "No tracking provided". The order page shows a card for each package with its own **Mark packed**, **Ship…**, **Correct tracking…** and **Mark delivered** buttons. A seller does the same for their own packages from **Selling → My Packages**.

The order's status follows its packages: **Partially shipped** while some have gone and some haven't, **Shipped** once all have gone, and **Delivered** once all have arrived. The buyer gets one "on its way" email per package, listing only that package's items. Once any package has shipped, the order can't be canceled as a whole and

its address can't be changed; refund the items instead. **Refunds and packages.** The **Refund…** dialog can return a package's shipping (and the tax on it) along with items, but each package's shipping can only be refunded once. **Cancel package…** on a package that hasn't shipped refunds its items and its shipping, puts the items back on the shelf if you check that box, and marks the package canceled. The rest of the order carries on, and it shows **Shipped** once everything left has gone. If it's the only package left, it can't be canceled on its own; cancel the whole order instead, which refunds every package's shipping. A package that has shipped can't be canceled; refund its items instead. The **To ship** tile counts partly shipped orders too. The CSV export has a row for each item with its package, sender, carrier and tracking.



Parts and cost

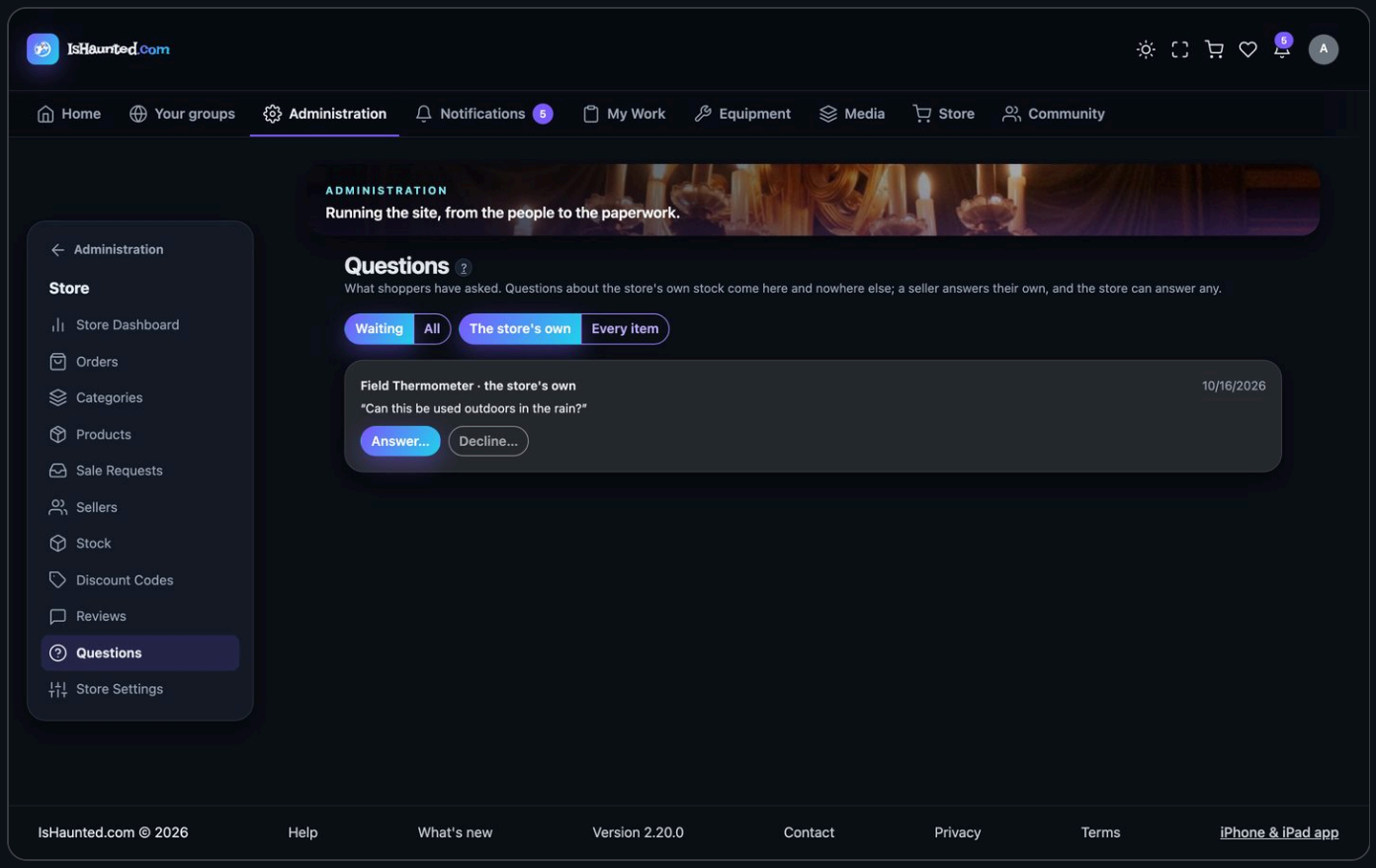
Every product's **Parts & cost** tab holds its parts list (each part's price per pack or per piece, how many one unit uses, links and a picture) and an **other costs** line. Together they make up the product's **cost basis**, rounded to the cent once at the end. Sellers keep the list for their own items; the store keeps it for its own stock. For each unit sold, a seller is paid the cost basis plus their approved asking price. None of this is ever shown to shoppers.

Product files

A product's **Files** tab holds its manuals, firmware, software and documents: uploads up to 95 MB, or a manual written on the site (in Markdown, or imported from a `.md` or `.txt` file). Each file is either **for buyers** or **private**. A file for buyers appears under **Downloads** on the order page of everyone who bought the product, once they've paid, as long as the order isn't canceled and that line wasn't refunded in full. A private file is only for the store and the product's seller. Sellers manage their own items' files; the store can change any of them. Changes are recorded in the product's history.

FAQ and questions

Each product has an **FAQ** tab: questions and answers shown on its page after the reviews, with a switch to hide them. Signed-in shoppers can also **ask a question** from the page. A question about a seller's item goes to that seller. A question about the store's own stock goes to every SuperAdmin and waits under **Store → Questions**. (**The store's own** shows those; **Every item** includes sellers' questions too, and the store can answer any of them.) Answering or declining notifies the shopper, who reads the reply under **My Questions**. Neither side is told who the other is. **Add to the FAQ…** copies an answered question into the product's FAQ, reworded if needed, and leaves the answer the shopper received unchanged. A person's questions are removed along with their account when it's closed or deleted.



Versions

A product that has been on sale can have a **new version** (**Versions** tab → **Start a new version…**). This creates a hidden draft that copies everything except the stock (wording, pictures, options and variants with new SKUs, parts, FAQ and files) and links back to the old product. Whoever starts it chooses what happens to the old version when the new one **first goes on sale**: sell what's left and then come off sale (a daily job takes it off once none are on hand), stay on sale alongside it, or come off sale immediately. This happens only once; after that, the choice is fixed. An old version taken off sale this way keeps its page, marked "No longer made" with a link to the new one, but can't be bought. Putting it back on sale by hand clears that. Each product can have at most one newer version, and a product that a newer version links back to can't be deleted.

The item's page

A product's **Page** tab holds its own **returns** wording (shown under the store's returns window), its **warranty**, and up to three **videos** (mp4, webm or mov, 95 MB each). Where the server has ffmpeg, videos are served from a copy with the location and camera details removed, and a video file is only served while a product uses it. **Take and show reviews** is controlled by the store only; a seller can't change it. Turning it off hides the item's reviews and stars everywhere (cards, sorting, the rating filter), and nobody can write a new one. Turning it back on brings them back.

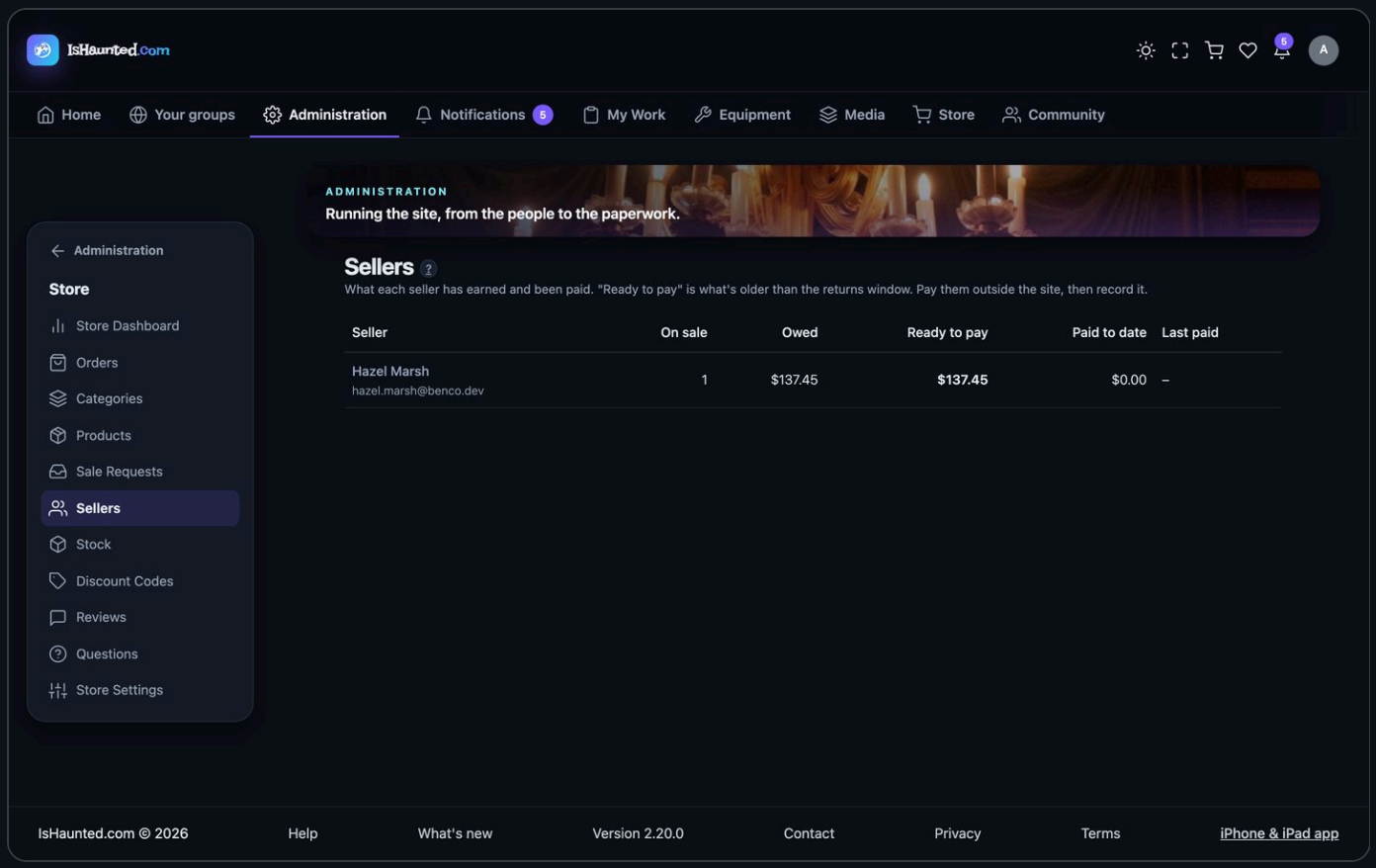
Paying sellers

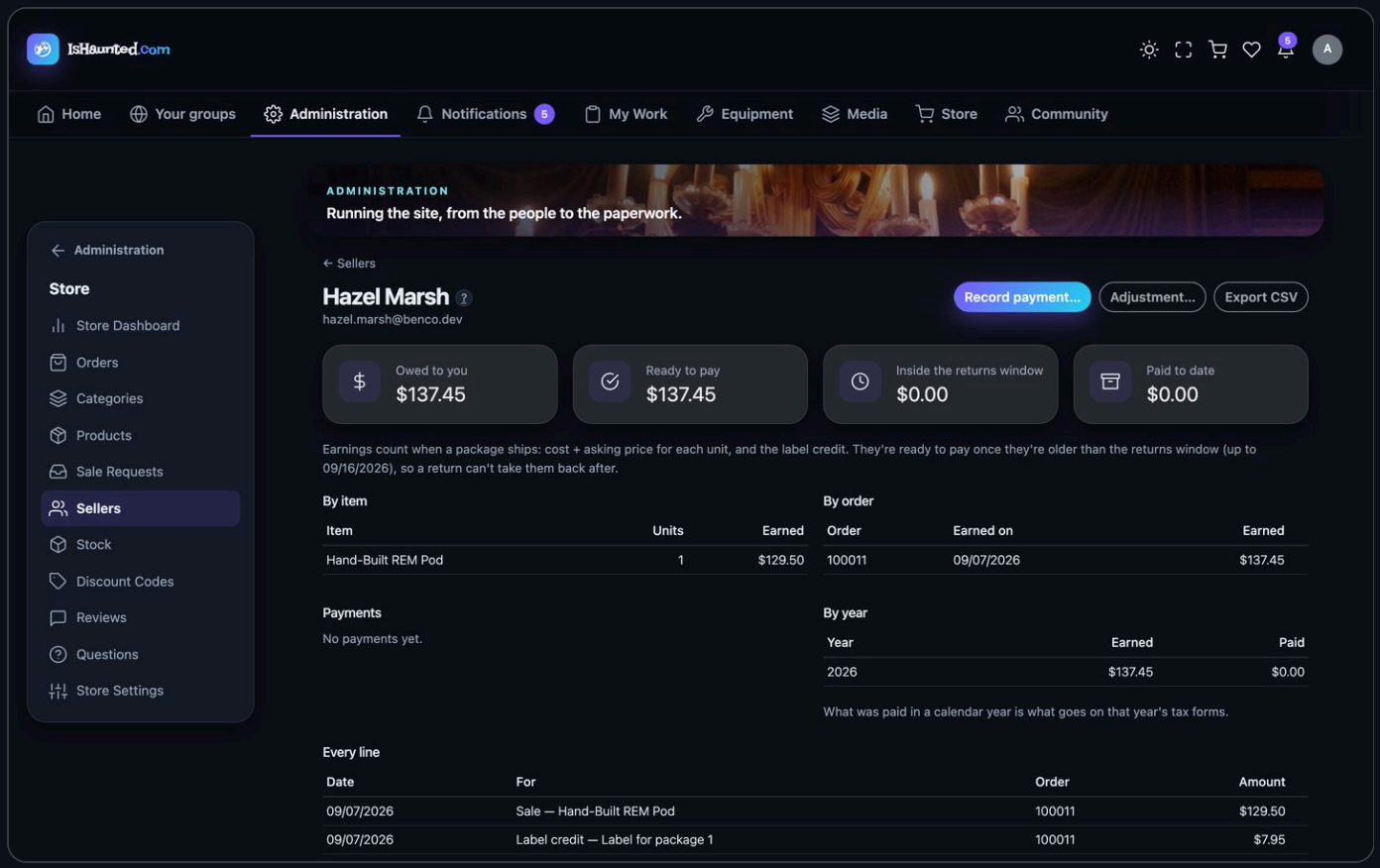
Sellers are paid by hand. The store takes the whole payment for every order, pays its sellers outside the site (by bank transfer or check, for example), and then records the payment. **Store → Sellers** lists everyone with the Seller role or with earnings on record: what each one is **owed**, what's **ready to pay**, what they've been paid so far and when they were last paid.

A seller's earnings are recorded when their package **ships**: cost plus asking price for each unit (as fixed when the order was placed), plus the label credit. Refunding units that had already shipped takes back those earnings; units refunded before shipping were never earned. A refund by amount comes out of the store's share. To charge a seller for one, add an **Adjustment…** with a note the seller will read.

Ready to pay is the part that's older than the returns window, so a return can't take it back after it's paid. On a seller's page, **Record payment…** pays either what's ready or everything owed, and marks exactly those earnings as paid. If their earnings changed while the page was open, it refuses and shows the new figure; record the payment again. A seller who owes the store (because of refunds after they were paid) carries that balance forward, and no payment can be recorded until their balance is positive again. **Void…** a payment recorded by mistake, and its earnings become owed again. **Export CSV** lists every line with when it was paid.

A seller can close their account even with earnings unpaid. SuperAdmins are notified, and the seller's page stays here so you can settle up.


IsHaunted.com
Home
Your groups
Administration
Notifications 5
My Work
Equipment
Media
Store
Community
ADMINISTRATION
Running the site, from the people to the paperwork.
Administration
Store
Store Dashboard
Orders
Categories
Products
Sale Requests
Sellers
Stock
Discount Codes
Reviews
Questions
Store Settings
Sellers
What each seller has earned and been paid. "Ready to pay" is what's older than the returns window. Pay them outside the site, then record it.
Seller
On sale
Owed
Ready to pay
Paid to date
Last paid
Hazel Marsh
hazel.marsh@benco.dev
1
$137.45
$137.45
$0.00
–
IsHaunted.com © 2026
Help
What's new
Version 2.20.0
Contact
Privacy
Terms
iPhone & iPad app


IsHaunted.com
Home
Your groups
Administration
Notifications 5
My Work
Equipment
Media
Store
Community
ADMINISTRATION
Running the site, from the people to the paperwork.
Administration
Store
Store Dashboard
Orders
Categories
Products
Sale Requests
Sellers
Stock
Discount Codes
Reviews
Questions
Store Settings
← Sellers
Hazel Marsh
hazel.marsh@benco.dev
Record payment...
Adjustment...
Export CSV
Owed to you
$137.45
Ready to pay
$137.45
Inside the returns window
$0.00
Paid to date
$0.00
Earnings count when a package ships: cost + asking price for each unit, and the label credit. They're ready to pay once they're older than the returns window (up to 09/16/2026), so a return can't take them back after.
By item
Item
Units
Earned
Hand-Built REM Pod
1
$129.50
By order
Order
Earned on
Earned
100011
09/07/2026
$137.45
Payments
No payments yet.
By year
Year
Earned
Paid
2026
$137.45
$0.00
What was paid in a calendar year is what goes on that year's tax forms.
Every line
Date
For
Order
Amount
09/07/2026
Sale — Hand-Built REM Pod
100011
$129.50
09/07/2026
Label credit — Label for package 1
100011
$7.95

Economics and fees

A product's **Parts & cost** tab ends with its **Economics**: what one unit costs to make, what its seller asks and earns (cost plus asking price), the price, the card fee on a single unit bought on its own, and what the store keeps. **Suggested price** covers the seller's earnings (or the cost of the store's own stock), adds the store's markup and leaves room for the card fee. A price that wouldn't cover the seller's earnings plus the fee is flagged in red.

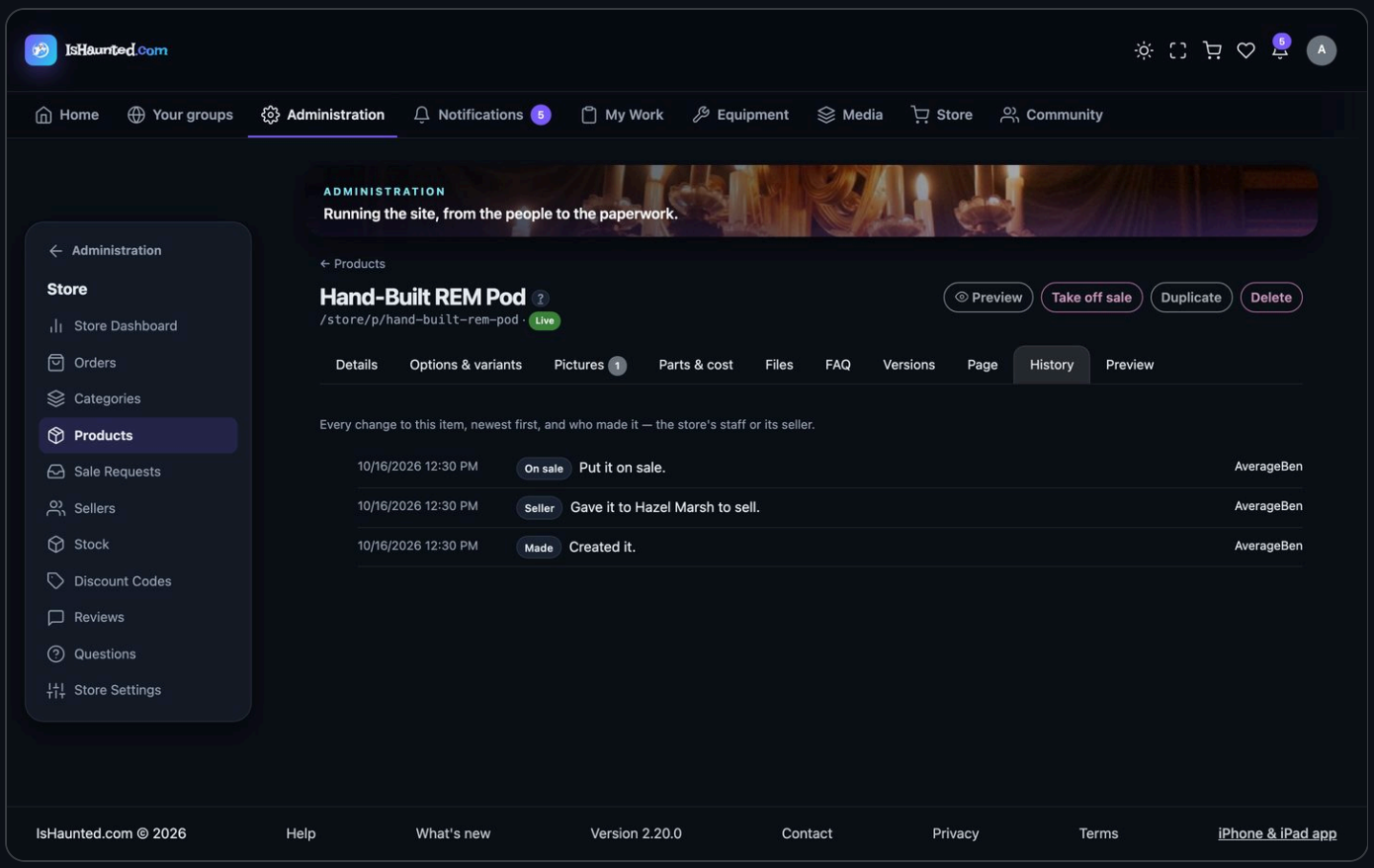
The markup and the fee estimate are set in **Store Settings → Prices and fees** (30%, 2.9% and $0.30 unless changed). The estimate is for one unit bought on its own; an order of several units pays the fixed part of the fee only once.

What an order came to is locked in at checkout on every line (its cost, the seller's asking price and earnings, and the store's markup), so later changes to a parts list or an asking price affect the next order, never one already placed. For whatever wasn't refunded, an order's **Economics** card shows the sellers' earnings and label credits, the items' markup minus the discount, the shipping the store kept, the card fee Stripe actually charged (read from Stripe shortly after payment, and shown as "not known yet" until then) and what the store keeps. Stripe keeps its fee when a payment is refunded, and the store absorbs discount codes and fees.

A product's history

The **History** tab on a product lists every change to it, newest first: who made it, when, and what it was, in a sentence such as "Renamed it from “REM Pod” to “REM Pod II””, "Changed Default’s price from $59.99 to $64.99" or "Received 12 of Large". It covers details, going on and off sale, the seller, options, variants, prices, stock received or written off, and pictures. Sales and refunds appear in each variant's stock log instead. A save that changed nothing doesn't add a line.

If an item has a seller, the seller sees its history too, with two differences: price lines are left out, and changes made by store staff show **The store** instead of a name.

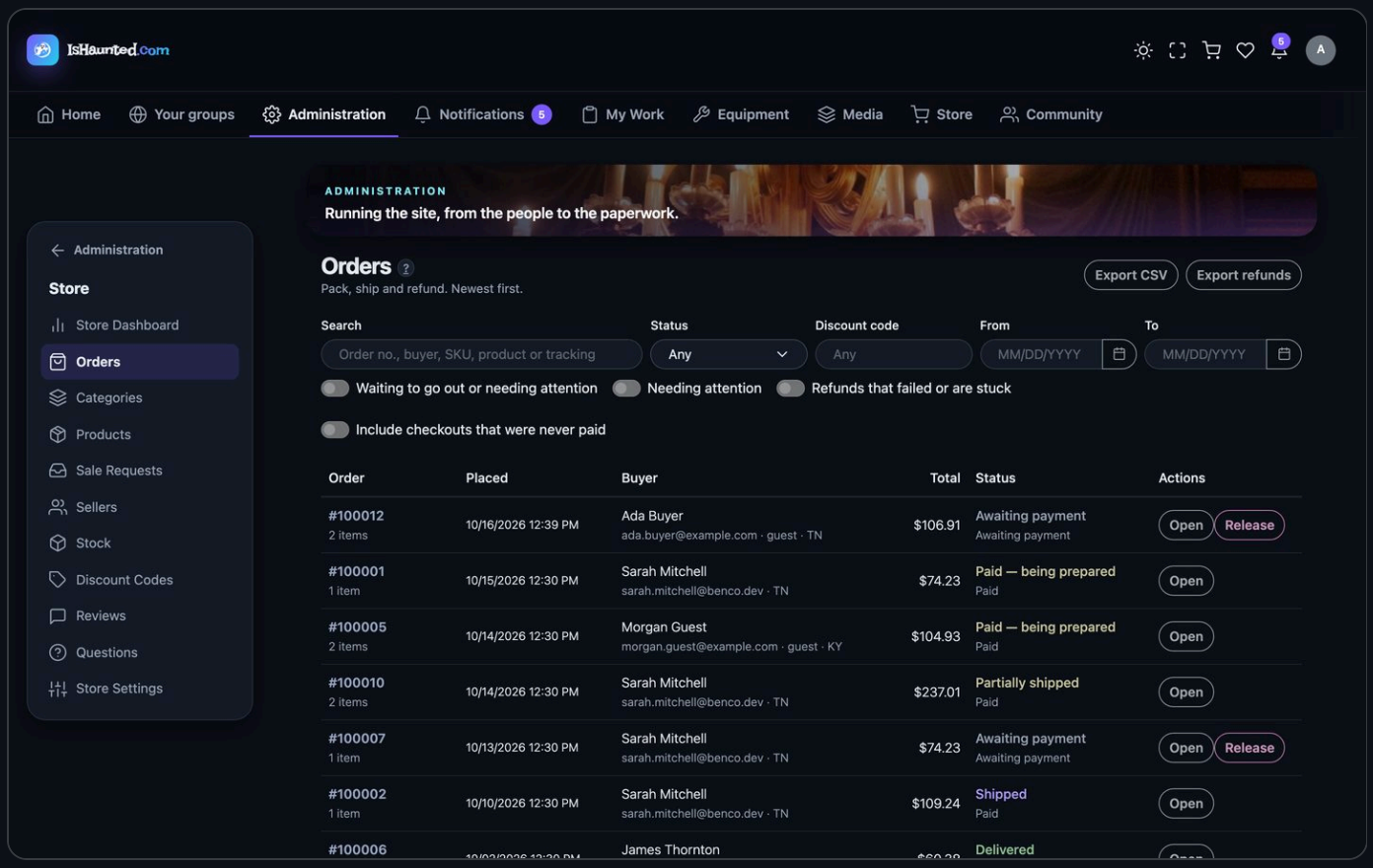


Discount codes

Store discount codes (such as GHOST10) are separate from the plan coupons under Billing. A code takes a percentage or a dollar amount off the products, never shipping or tax, and can have a minimum order, a start and end date, a total number of uses and a number of uses per buyer. The list shows anything that stops a code from working today: **Takes nothing off**, **Expires before it starts**, **Used up** or **Expired**. Once an order has used a code, the code can be retired (switched off) but not renamed or deleted, because the order keeps the code it was bought with.

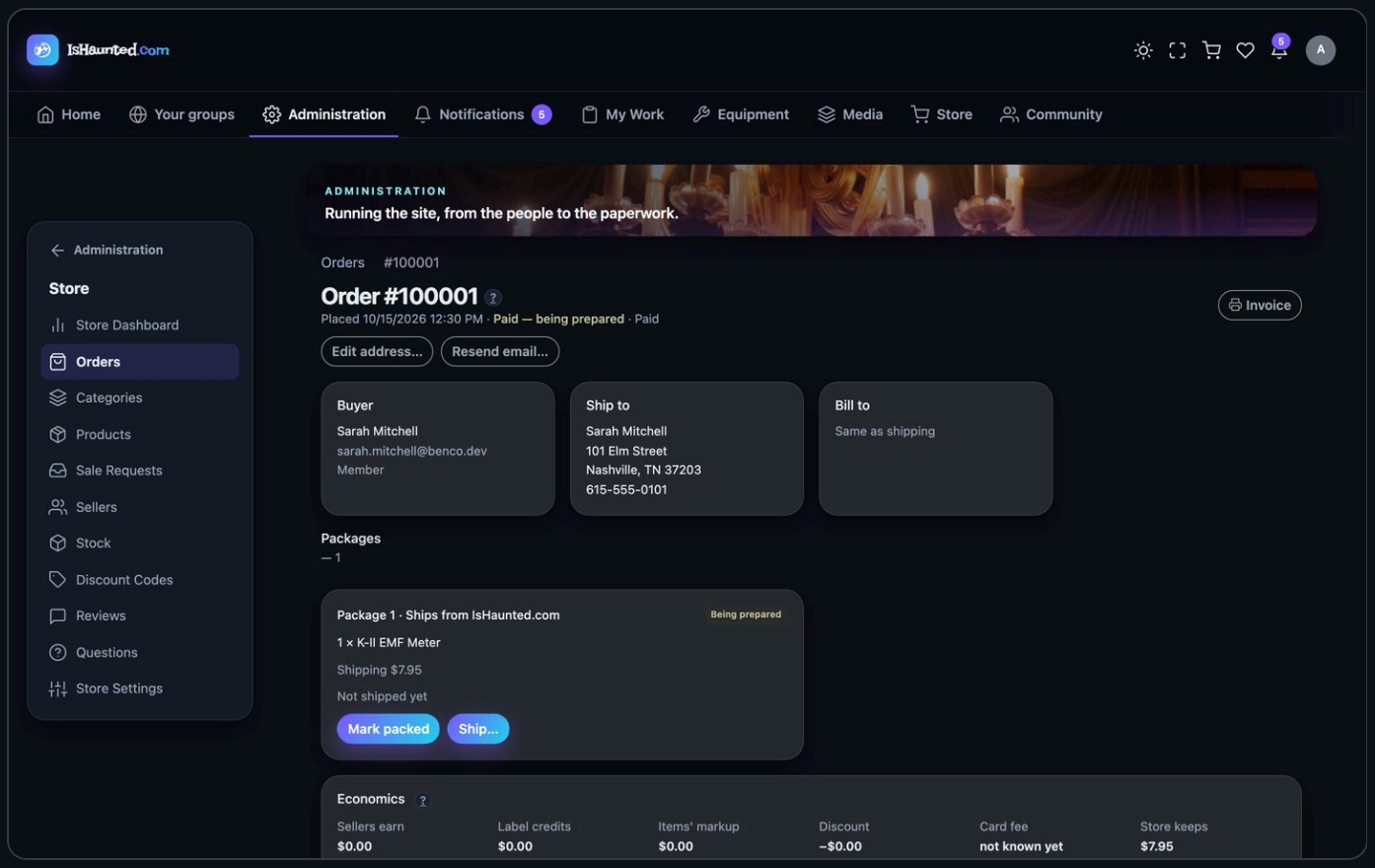
Orders and fulfillment

Orders (under Store) lists every paid order and every checkout still waiting for payment, newest first. Search by order number, buyer, email, SKU, product or tracking number; filter by status, discount code, dates, **Waiting to go out or needing attention**, **Needing attention**, and **Refunds that failed or are stuck**. Finished checkouts that were never paid are left out unless you ask for them. The dashboard's **To pack**, **To ship** and **Needs attention** tiles, and a discount code's "N orders" link, open this list with the matching filter already applied. **Export CSV** downloads whatever the filters show, one row per item: number, date, buyer's state, SKU, quantity, prices, discount, tax, shipping and refunds.



Open an order to see everything about it: the buyer, where it's going, the items, the money, its refunds and its history. Packing, shipping and delivery are done **on each package's card**. An order with one package has one card; for orders with more than one, see **Packages and partial shipping**. Only the buttons that make sense right now are shown:

- **Mark packed** — for a paid package.
- **Ship…** — choose the **carrier** (USPS, UPS, FedEx, DHL or Other) and type the **tracking number**. The tracking link is built from the two, and the dialog shows it before you confirm. For "Other", you can paste the carrier's own https link. If the parcel isn't tracked, check **No tracking provided**: it ships with the carrier and no number, and the buyer is told it was sent without tracking. Shipping emails the buyer right away.
- **Correct tracking…** (or **Add tracking…** for a parcel sent untracked) — fixes the carrier or number on a shipped package. It doesn't email the buyer; use **Resend email…** if they need it.
- **Mark delivered** — for a shipped package.
- **Edit address…** — available until the first package ships. Changing the buyer's email replaces the order's private link (the old one stops working) and sends the receipt to the new address. Sales tax isn't recalculated for a new state; the history notes this.
- **Resend email…** — the receipt, or "Your order is on its way" once it has shipped.
- **Release checkout** — releases a checkout that's still waiting for payment, returning its stock and discount code. It's refused while the payment is still being processed at Stripe.
- **Invoice** prints the order's invoice; **Open in Stripe** opens the payment in Stripe's dashboard.



Needs attention. An order is flagged when something about its payment needs a person to look at it, such as a payment that arrived after its checkout was canceled, or an amount that didn't match. It can't be packed or shipped until you read the reason and press **I've looked — clear it**.

Notes you add go into the order's history with your name. Everything done to an order is recorded there, newest first.

Refunds and cancellations

Refund… on an order returns money to the buyer's card through Stripe. You can refund **by item** (choosing how many of each, and whether they go back on the shelf) or **by amount** (for shipping or a goodwill amount), which never restocks. Every refund needs a reason. You can refund up to whatever is still refundable, and a refund still being processed at Stripe counts against that.

A refund changes nothing until Stripe confirms the money has gone back. Then the stock is returned (if you chose that), the order's refunded total goes up, the order becomes **Refunded** when nothing is left to refund, the buyer is emailed, and the sales tax filing is reversed. **A pending refund finishes when Stripe confirms it.** Until then the refund shows **Awaiting Stripe**, and the order updates on its own. If Stripe refuses, the refund shows **Failed** with Stripe's reason, and nothing else changes. **Try again** checks Stripe for the refund first, so it never refunds twice. A refund made in Stripe's own dashboard is recorded on the order too ("Refunded from the Stripe dashboard"), without restocking.

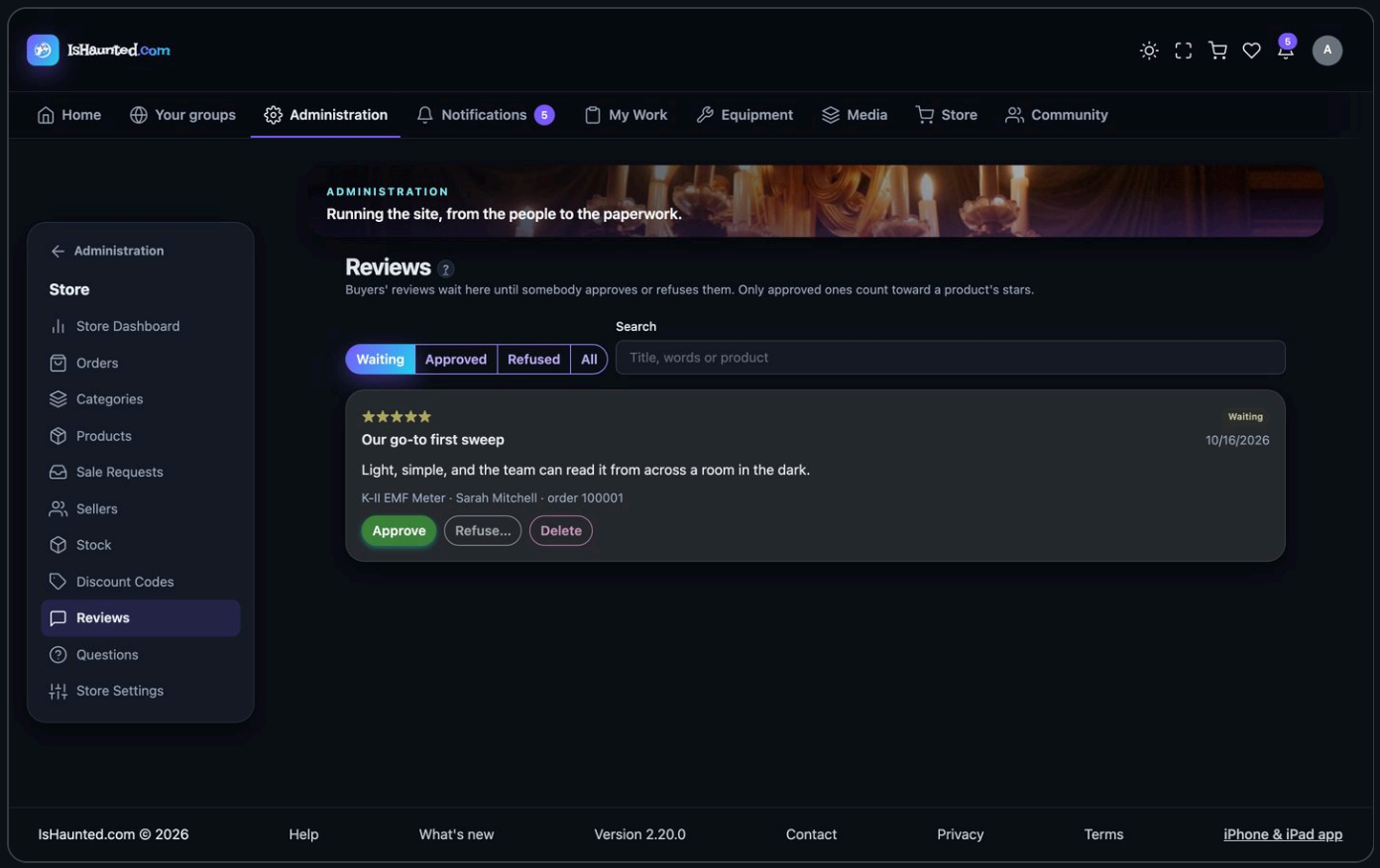
Cancel... is for a paid order that hasn't shipped. It refunds everything still refundable, including shipping, puts the items back on the shelf if you check that box, and marks the order Canceled once the refund goes through. A shipped order should be refunded instead.

Refunds that failed or are stuck, on the Orders list, finds the refunds that need a look. **Export refunds** on the same page downloads every refund in the chosen date range with its status and Stripe's ids.

Store reviews

Buyers can review what they bought, and every review waits in **Reviews** until someone approves or refuses it. Only approved reviews count toward a product's stars. Refusing requires a reason, because the reviewer is told why. The store can reply under an approved review; refusing a review later removes the reply too. The queue shows the oldest waiting review first.

The reviewer can see their own review on the product page the whole time: "Waiting for approval", then published, or the reason it wasn't. If a reviewer edits a published review, it goes back to the queue and is hidden until it's approved again.



Store settings

The store settings page holds the flat shipping rate and the free-shipping threshold, the low-stock number, the ship-from address Stripe Tax uses to work out sales tax, the support email shown as "Need help?", the returns window, how long a checkout holds its stock, and whether to offer Stripe Link. The whole form is checked before anything is saved, so a single mistyped value means nothing is saved, and the page tells you which value it was. Site Settings also shows these values, read-only, with a link here.

The page also lists the states Stripe Tax is registered in. Registrations are made in the Stripe dashboard, and buyers in any other state aren't charged sales tax.

Stock alerts

Every morning while the store is on, each SuperAdmin gets a notification on the bell and an email ("Store stock: N running low") listing the variants on sale that are at or below the store's low-stock number, with a button to the Stock page. It comes once a day, and not at all when nothing is low. The dashboard's low-stock table and the Stock page's **Running low only** filter show the same information at any time.

SITE ADMINISTRATION

Moderating the Feed

The reported-posts queue, and what hiding a post does.

Written for: **Platform administrators**

Visible to app administrators only.

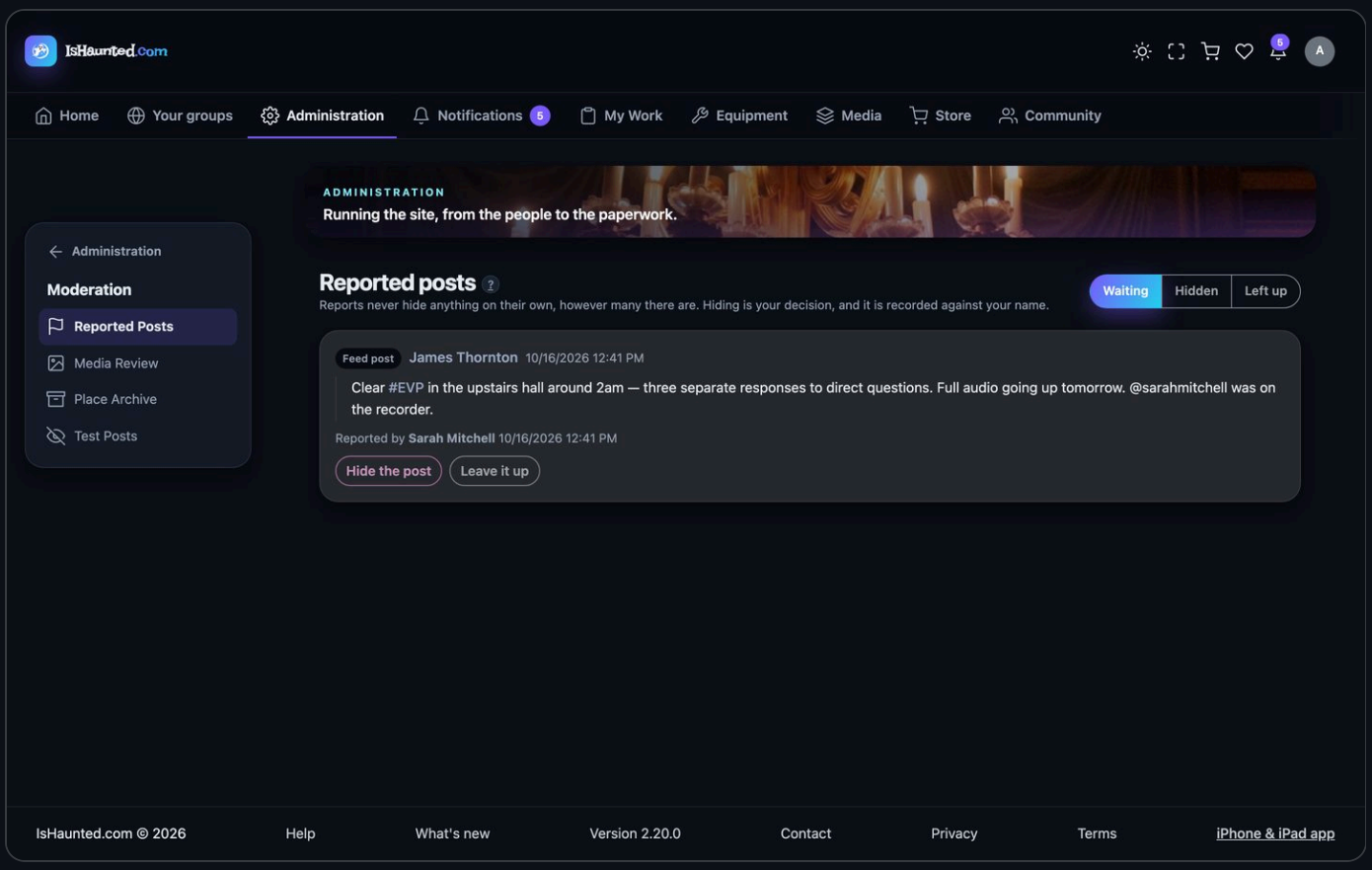
Administration → Content → Reported Posts is the queue of posts someone has objected to.

What a report is, and is not

A report is one person saying a post shouldn't be here. **It hides nothing.** Neither do five reports, or fifty. There's no threshold, on purpose: an automatic one would remove whatever is least popular rather than whatever breaks the rules. That hurts people with unusual things to say, and unusual things are most of what this site is about.

Hiding is your decision, and your name is recorded with it.

Working the queue



Each row shows the post as readers saw it, who reported it, and why.

Reports are listed **oldest first**, so the person who has been waiting longest gets an answer first.

Each row shows the post as its readers saw it, who reported it and why, and, if more than one person reported the same post, how many. Treat that number as context, not a verdict.

BUTTON	WHAT HAPPENS
Hide the post	It disappears from every feed, thread, tag page and profile.
Leave it up	Nothing changes for readers. The report is marked as reviewed.

Both buttons resolve **every** waiting report on that post at once. Five reports about one post are one decision, so the others don't stay in the queue for a colleague to handle all over again.

Reports about a published case

The same queue also holds reports about **published cases** and about **comments on them**, so you work from one screen instead of three. A case report names the case and links to it. The decision works the same way: a person makes it, and a report on its own hides nothing.

Photos and videos waiting for a look

Administration → Content → Feed Media is the other queue: photos and videos that haven't been cleared for the feed yet. Nothing anyone uploads is shown to readers until it has been screened, either automatically (if the site's screening model is installed) or by a person on this page. The page tells you which applies.

A file the automatic screener held shows its reason ("blocked", or "borderline, needs a person") and a confidence score. **Approve** publishes it; **Hold** keeps it unpublished with your note. Neither one deletes anything. The author is only ever told that their upload is being checked, never which check it failed, so nobody learns how to get the next one past it.

The page opens on the **Waiting** pile, which holds only what nobody has looked at yet. Under automatic screening it's usually empty. Anything the screener refused is in the **Held** pile, and that refusal isn't final: Approve there publishes it just as it does anywhere else. Scary content is fine. The screener only looks for nudity, so a ghost, a dark hallway or a frightening frame looks "normal" to it.

When an account keeps sending it

Uploads are normally queued, not refused. The one exception is an account that has used up the benefit of the doubt: **three confident refusals in a day** (scores the screener is sure about, not borderline ones) pause that account's photo and video uploads until the oldest of the three is a day old. Text posts still work. The poster is told only that their uploads are paused.

Rows from a paused account carry an **Uploads paused** badge, and rows from an account one refusal short of a pause are marked too. Approving any one of the three lifts the pause right away, because the rule counts what a person *decided*, not what the screener first said. So if the model misread a run of genuine evidence, a single Approve clears it. Borderline scores never count toward a pause.

The category question

Next to the safety question is a different one: **is this what it says it is?** A post's category label (Apparition, Voices / Whispering…) is the author's claim, shown alongside the site's own match score. **Is what it says** and **Category is wrong** each record your judgment, and that's all they do. A wrong category never hides a post. It prompts the author to fix the label and slightly lowers the post's ranking.

These judgments are worth the click even when nothing is wrong. Each one becomes a labeled example the site's classifier learns from, and the classifier can only be as good as the decisions people record.

Posts about a place

A post written on a public location's page is an ordinary feed post that also names that place, so everything on this page applies to it: it appears in the same queues, its photo goes through the same check, reports reach you the same way, and hiding it removes it from the place's page as well as from the feed. There's no separate screen for moderating places, and nothing new to learn.

One thing worth knowing: **anybody signed in may post about a public location**, which is a wider group than can post on the feed's front page. That's intentional, since anyone can visit a public place and its page is meant to be filled in by visitors. But it does make a place's page the most likely first stop for someone with no group and no history. Private residences don't accept posts at all.

The place archive

Moderation → Place Archive is a second queue, and it isn't about posts. It covers three things that can appear on a public location's page: **files people added to the place** themselves, a **field session** someone published from the app, and a piece of **event evidence** a guest published from an event held there.

Files added to a place

Anyone signed in can add a photo, video or recording to a public location's page. If the screener doesn't clear it, the person is told somebody will look at it first, and it waits at the top of this page under **Files added to places**.

Each file is a card you can look at right there: a photo fills the card, a video plays in it, and a recording opens the waveform player when you click it. Press **Approve** to put it on the place's page, or **Hold** to keep it off. A held file stays, with your note, so you can approve it later. Turn on **Show held files too** to see those.

When a place has a **confirmed venue** — a group whose claim to run the property was approved — that group's owners and administrators can decide about files at their place too. They're sent a message when one arrives, and they find it on their group's **Your venue** page. Anyone who can decide also sees a notice at the top of the site while files are waiting for them.

Sessions and event evidence

These two work the opposite way from the feed. They go public as soon as their owner publishes them, and they only show up in this queue when something has been questioned: either a screener couldn't clear the media, or **any signed-in reader flagged it**.

A flag hides the item immediately, and then you decide. If it stayed up until a moderator got to it, the thing someone objected to would be visible that whole time, which is exactly what a flag is meant to prevent. Hiding first costs a contributor some visibility for a while. Not hiding could expose people to whatever the picture showed.

That means **one flag from one person is enough to hide someone's work**, and it stays hidden until you look at it. That's why this screen exists, and why it opens on what's already held rather than only what's new. A held session is hidden from the public and from its owner's audience, and only an administrator on this screen can release it.

- **Approve** puts it back on the place's page.
- **Hold** takes it down again. That's how you undo an approval.

- The row shows the reason given with the flag, which usually tells you all you need.

The readings stay up either way. A flag is about what a photo shows. Magnetic-field numbers can't be objectionable, and pulling the whole session would let one flag erase someone's contribution to the archive instead of just hiding a picture.

If a place is later changed to a **private residence**, its media is taken down automatically. You don't need to deal with it here.

Hidden, not deleted

A hidden post is still there. Nothing is destroyed: its replies, its reports and the record of who decided what all remain, so the next person asking "what happened here?" can find out. Deleting it would lose all of that.

Put it back on a hidden post undoes the hiding.

What the author is told

Nothing, for now. The author gets no notification; the post simply stops appearing.

When the feed is switched off

This page still works. Turning the feed off doesn't clear any reports, and a site that turns it off may still have complaints nobody got to. Every other feed page disappears with the feature, but this one stays, so those reports are never stranded.